

SHAKESPEARE

PREFACE AND NOTES

Samuel Johnson

Comedies, Histories and Tragedies

Contents

Preface to Shakespeare	1
Notes on the Comedies	41
The Tempest	41
The Two Gentlemen of Verona	53
The Merry Wives of Windsor	61
Measure for Measure	71
The Comedy of Errors	99
Much Ado About Nothing	103
Love's Labour's Lost	113
A Midsummer-Night's Dream	128
The Merchant of Venice	143
As You Like It	152
The Taming of the Shrew	167
All's Well That Ends Well	173
Twelfth-Night	194
The Winter's Tale	204

Notes on the Histories	218
King John	218
Richard II	241
Henry IV, Part 1	264
Henry IV, Part 2	299
Henry V	332
Henry VI, Part 1	370
Henry VI, Part 2	384
Henry VI, Part 3	398
Richard III	414
Henry VIII	433
 Notes on the Tragedies	 457
Macbeth	457
Coriolanus	487
Julius Caesar	505
Antony and Cleopatra	513
Timon of Athens	536
Titus Andronicus	564
Troilus and Cressida	568
Cymbeline	587
King Lear	609
Romeo and Juliet	640
Hamlet	652
Othello	686

PREFACE TO SHAKESPEARE

That praises are without reason lavished on the dead, and that the honours due only to excellence are paid to antiquity, is a complaint likely to be always continued by those, who, being able to add nothing to truth, hope for eminence from the heresies of paradox; or those, who, being forced by disappointment upon consolatory expedients, are willing to hope from posterity what the present age refuses, and flatter themselves that the regard which is yet denied by envy, will be at last bestowed by time.

Antiquity, like every other quality that attracts the notice of mankind, has undoubtedly votaries that reverence it, not from reason, but from prejudice. Some seem to admire indiscriminately whatever has been long preserved, without considering that time has sometimes co-operated with chance; all perhaps are more willing to honour past than present excellence; and the mind contemplates genius through the shades of age, as the eye surveys the sun through artificial opacity. The great contention of criticism is to find the faults of the moderns, and the beauties of the ancients. While an authour is yet living we estimate his powers by his worst performance, and when he is dead we rate them by his best.

To works, however, of which the excellence is not absolute and definite, but gradual and comparative; to works not raised upon principles demonstrative and scientifick, but appealing wholly to observation and experience, no other test can be applied than length of duration and continuance of esteem. What mankind have long possessed they have often examined and compared, and if they persist to value the possession, it is because frequent comparisons have confirmed opinion in its favour. As among the works of nature no man can properly call a river deep or a mountain high, without the knowledge of many mountains and many rivers; so in the productions of genius, nothing can be stiled excellent till it has been compared with other works of the same kind. Demonstration immediately displays its power, and has nothing to hope or fear from the flux of years; but works tentative and experimental must be estimated by their proportion to the general and collective ability of man, as it is discovered in a long succession of endeavours. Of the first building that was raised, it might be with certainty determined that it was round or square, but whether it was spacious or lofty must have been referred to time. The

Pythagorean scale of numbers was at once discovered to be perfect; but the poems of Homer we yet know not to transcend the common limits of human intelligence, but by remarking, that nation after nation, and century after century, has been able to do little more than transpose his incidents, new name his characters, and paraphrase his sentiments.

The reverence due to writings that have long subsisted arises therefore not from any credulous confidence in the superior wisdom of past ages, or gloomy persuasion of the degeneracy of mankind, but is the consequence of acknowledged and indubitable positions, that what has been longest known has been most considered, and what is most considered is best understood.

The Poet, of whose works I have undertaken the revision, may now begin to assume the dignity of an ancient, and claim the privilege of established fame and prescriptive veneration. He has long outlived his century, the term commonly fixed as the test of literary merit. Whatever advantages he might once derive from personal allusions, local customs, or temporary opinions, have for many years been lost; and every topick of merriment or motive of sorrow, which the modes of artificial life afforded him, now only obscure the scenes which they once illuminated. The effects of favour and competition are at an end; the tradition of his friendships and his enmities has perished; his works support no opinion with arguments, nor supply any faction with invectives; they can neither indulge vanity nor gratify malignity, but are read without any other reason than the desire of pleasure, and are therefore praised only as pleasure is obtained; yet, thus unassisted by interest or passion, they have past through variations of taste and changes of manners, and, as they devolved from one generation to another, have received new honours at every transmission.

But because human judgment, though it be gradually gaining upon certainty, never becomes infallible; and approbation, though long continued, may yet be only the approbation of prejudice or fashion; it is proper to inquire, by what peculiarities of excellence Shakespeare has gained and kept the favour of his countrymen.

Nothing can please many, and please long, but just representations of general nature. Particular manners can be known to few, and therefore few only can judge how nearly they are copied. The irregular combinations of fanciful invention may delight a-while, by that nov-

elty of which the common satiety of life sends us all in quest; but the pleasures of sudden wonder are soon exhausted, and the mind can only repose on the stability of truth.

Shakespeare is above all writers, at least above all modern writers, the poet of nature; the poet that holds up to his readers a faithful mirror of manners and of life. His characters are not modified by the customs of particular places, unpractised by the rest of the world; by the peculiarities of studies or professions, which can operate but upon small numbers; or by the accidents of transient fashions or temporary opinions: they are the genuine progeny of common humanity, such as the world will always supply, and observation will always find. His persons act and speak by the influence of those general passions and principles by which all minds are agitated, and the whole system of life is continued in motion. In the writings of other poets a character is too often an individual; in those of Shakespeare it is commonly a species.

It is from this wide extension of design that so much instruction is derived. It is this which fills the plays of Shakespeare with practical axioms and domestick wisdom. It was said of Euripides, that every verse was a precept and it may be said of Shakespeare, that from his works may be collected a system of civil and oeconomical prudence. Yet his real power is not shown in the splendour of particular passages, but by the progress of his fable, and the tenour of his dialogue; and he that tries to recommend him by select quotations, will succeed like the pedant in Hierocles, who, when he offered his house to sale, carried a brick in his pocket as a specimen.

It will not easily be imagined how much Shakespeare excels in accommodating his sentiments to real life, but by comparing him with other authours. It was observed of the ancient schools of declamation, that the more diligently they were frequented, the more was the student disqualified for the world, because he found nothing there which he should ever meet in any other place. The same remark may be applied to every stage but that of Shakespeare. The theatre, when it is under any other direction, is peopled by such characters as were never seen, conversing in a language which was never heard, upon topicks which will never arise in the commerce of mankind. But the dialogue of this authour is often so evidently determined by the incident which produces it, and is pursued with so much ease and simplicity, that it seems scarcely to claim the merit of fiction, but to have

been gleaned by diligent selection out of common conversation, and common occurrences.

Upon every other stage the universal agent is love, by whose power all good and evil is distributed, and every action quickened or retarded. To bring a lover, a lady and a rival into the fable; to entangle them in contradictory obligations, perplex them with oppositions of interest, and harrass them with violence of desires inconsistent with each other; to make them meet in rapture and part in agony; to fill their mouths with hyperbolical joy and outrageous sorrow; to distress them as nothing human ever was distressed; to deliver them as nothing human ever was delivered, is the business of a modern dramatist. For this probability is violated, life is misrepresented, and language is depraved. But love is only one of many passions, and as it has no great influence upon the sum of life, it has little operation in the dramas of a poet, who caught his ideas from the living world, and exhibited only what he saw before him. He knew, that any other passion, as it was regular or exorbitant, was a cause of happiness or calamity.

Characters thus ample and general were not easily discriminated and preserved, yet perhaps no poet ever kept his personages more distinct from each other. I will not say with Pope, that every speech may be assigned to the proper speaker, because many speeches there are which have nothing characteristic; but, perhaps, though some may be equally adapted to every person, it will be difficult to find, any that can be properly transferred from the present possessor to another claimant. The choice is right, when there is reason for choice.

Other dramatists can only gain attention by hyperbolical or aggravated characters, by fabulous and unexampled excellence or depravity, as the writers of barbarous romances invigorated the reader by a giant and a dwarf; and he that should form his expectations of human affairs from the play, or from the tale, would be equally deceived. Shakespeare has no heroes; his scenes are occupied only by men, who act and speak as the reader thinks that he should himself have spoken or acted on the same occasion: Even where the agency is supernatural the dialogue is level with life. Other writers disguise the most natural passions and most frequent incidents: so that he who contemplates them in the book will not know them in the world: Shakespeare approximates the remote, and familiarizes the wonderful; the event which he represents will not happen, but if it were possible, its

effects would be probably such as he has assigned; and it may be said, that he has not only shewn human nature as it acts in real exigences, but as it would be found in trials, to which it cannot be exposed. This therefore is the praise of Shakespeare, that his drama is the mirror of life; that he who has mazed his imagination, in following the phantoms which other writers raise up before him, may here be cured of his delirious extasies, by reading human sentiments in human language; by scenes from which a hermit may estimate the transactions of the world, and a confessor predict the progress of the passions.

His adherence to general nature has exposed him to the censure of criticks, who form their judgments upon narrower principles. Dennis and Rhymer think his Romans not sufficiently Roman; and Voltaire censures his kings as not completely royal. Dennis is offended, that Menenius, a senator of Rome, should play the buffoon; and Voltaire perhaps thinks decency violated when the Danish Usurper is represented as a drunkard. But Shakespeare always makes nature predominate over accident; and if he preserves the essential character, is not very careful of distinctions superinduced and adventitious. His story requires Romans or kings, but he thinks only on men. He knew that Rome, like every other city, had men of all dispositions; and wanting a buffoon, he went into the senate-house for that which the senate-house would certainly have afforded him. He was inclined to shew an usurper and a murderer not only odious but despicable, he therefore added drunkenness to his other qualities, knowing that kings love wine like other men, and that wine exerts its natural power upon kings. These are the petty cavils of petty minds; a poet overlooks the casual distinction of country and condition, as a painter, satisfied with the figure, neglects the drapery.

The censure which he has incurred by mixing comick and tragick scenes, as it extends to all his works, deserves more consideration. Let the fact be first stated, and then examined.

Shakespeare's plays are not in the rigorous and critical sense either tragedies or comedies, but compositions of a distinct kind; exhibiting the real state of sublunary nature, which partakes of good and evil, joy and sorrow, mingled with endless variety of proportion and innumerable modes of combination; and expressing the course of the world, in which the loss of one is the gain of another; in which, at the same time, the reveller is hasting to his wine, and the mourner burying his friend; in which the malignity of one is sometimes defeated

by the frolick of another; and many mischiefs and many benefits are done and hindered without design.

Out of this chaos of mingled purposes and casualties the ancient poets, according to the laws which custom had prescribed, selected some the crimes of men, and some their absurdities; some the momentous vicissitudes of life, and some the lighter occurrences; some the terrors of distress, and some the gayeties of prosperity. Thus rose the two modes of imitation, known by the names of tragedy and comedy, compositions intended to promote different ends by contrary means, and considered as so little allied, that I do not recollect among the Greeks or Romans a single writer who attempted both.

Shakespeare has united the powers of exciting laughter and sorrow not only in one mind, but in one composition. Almost all his plays are divided between serious and ludicrous characters, and, in the successive evolutions of the design, sometimes produce seriousness and sorrow, and sometimes levity and laughter.

That this is a practice contrary to the rules of criticism will be readily allowed; but there is always an appeal open from criticism to nature. The end of writing is to instruct; the end of poetry is to instruct by pleasing. That the mingled drama may convey all the instruction of tragedy or comedy cannot be denied, because it includes both in its alterations of exhibition, and approaches nearer than either to the appearance of life, by shewing how great machinations and slender designs may promote or obviate one another, and the high and the low co-operate in the general system by unavoidable concatenation.

It is objected, that by this change of scenes the passions are interrupted in their progression, and that the principal event, being not advanced by a due gradation of preparatory incidents, wants at last the power to move, which constitutes the perfection of dramatick poetry. This reasoning is so specious, that it is received as true even by those who in daily experience feel it to be false. The interchanges of mingled scenes seldom fail to produce the intended vicissitudes of passion. Fiction cannot move so much, but that the attention may be easily transferred; and though it must be allowed that pleasing melancholy be sometimes interrupted by unwelcome levity, yet let it be considered likewise, that melancholy is often not pleasing, and that the disturbance of one man may be the relief of another; that different auditors have different habits; and that, upon the whole, all pleasure consists in variety.

The players, who in their edition divided our authour's works into comedies, histories, and tragedies, seem not to have distinguished the three kinds, by any very exact or definite ideas.

An action which ended happily to the principal persons, however serious or distressful through its intermediate incidents, in their opinion constituted a comedy. This idea of a comedy continued long amongst us, and plays were written, which, by changing the catastrophe, were tragedies to-day and comedies to-morrow.

Tragedy was not in those times a poem of more general dignity or elevation than comedy; it required only a calamitous conclusion, with which the common criticism of that age was satisfied, whatever lighter pleasure it afforded in its progress.

History was a series of actions, with no other than chronological succession, independent of each other, and without any tendency to introduce or regulate the conclusion. It is not always very nicely distinguished from tragedy. There is not much nearer approach to unity of action in the tragedy of "Antony and Cleopatra", than in the history of "Richard the Second". But a history might be continued through many plays; as it had no plan, it had no limits.

Through all these denominations of the drama, Shakespeare's mode of composition is the same; an interchange of seriousness and merriment, by which the mind is softened at one time, and exhilarated at another. But whatever be his purpose, whether to gladden or depress, or to conduct the story, without vehemence or emotion, through tracts of easy and familiar dialogue, he never fails to attain his purpose; as he commands us, we laugh or mourn, or sit silent with quiet expectation, in tranquillity without indifference.

When Shakespeare's plan is understood, most of the criticisms of Rhymer and Voltaire vanish away. The play of "Hamlet" is opened, without impropriety, by two sentinels; Iago bellows at Brabantio's window, without injury to the scheme of the play, though in terms which a modern audience would not easily endure; the character of Polonius is seasonable and useful; and the Grave-diggers themselves may be heard with applause.

Shakespeare engaged in dramattick poetry with the world open before him; the rules of the ancients were yet known to few; the publick judgment was unformed; he had no example of such fame as might force him upon imitation, nor criticks of such authority as might restrain his extravagance: He therefore indulged his natural disposi-

tion, and his disposition, as Rhymer has remarked, led him to comedy. In tragedy he often writes with great appearance of toil and study, what is written at last with little felicity; but in his comick scenes, he seems to produce without labour, what no labour can improve. In tragedy he is always struggling after some occasion to be comick, but in comedy he seems to repose, or to luxuriate, as in a mode of thinking congenial to his nature. In his tragick scenes there is always something wanting, but his comedy often surpasses expectation or desire. His comedy pleases by the thoughts and the language, and his tragedy for the greater part by incident and action. His tragedy seems to be skill, his comedy to be instinct.

The force of his comick scenes has suffered little diminution from the changes made by a century and a half, in manners or in words. As his personages act upon principles arising from genuine passion, very little modified by particular forms, their pleasures and vexations are communicable to all times and to all places; they are natural, and therefore durable; the adventitious peculiarities of personal habits, are only superficial dies, bright and pleasing for a little while, yet soon fading to a dim tinct, without any remains of former lustre; but the discriminations of true passion are the colours of nature; they pervade the whole mass, and can only perish with the body that exhibits them. The accidental compositions of heterogeneous modes are dissolved by the chance which combined them; but the uniform simplicity of primitive qualities neither admits increase, nor suffers decay. The sand heaped by one flood is scattered by another, but the rock always continues in its place. The stream of time, which is continually washing the dissoluble fabricks of other poets, passes without injury by the adamant of Shakespeare.

If there be, what I believe there is, in every nation, a stile which never becomes obsolete, a certain mode of phraseology so consonant and congenial to the analogy and principles of its respective language as to remain settled and unaltered; this stile is probably to be sought in the common intercourse of life, among those who speak only to be understood, without ambition of elegance. The polite are always catching modish innovations, and the learned depart from established forms of speech, in hope of finding or making better; those who wish for distinction forsake the vulgar, when the vulgar is right; but there is a conversation above grossness and below refinement, where propriety resides, and where this poet seems to have gathered

his comick dialogue. He is therefore more agreeable to the ears of the present age than any other authour equally remote, and among his other excellencies deserves to be studied as one of the original masters of our language.

These observations are to be considered not as unexceptionably constant, but as containing general and predominant truth. Shakespeare's familiar dialogue is affirmed to be smooth and clear, yet not wholly without ruggedness or difficulty; as a country may be eminently fruitful, though it has spots unfit for cultivation: His characters are praised as natural, though their sentiments are sometimes forced, and their actions improbable; as the earth upon the whole is spherical, though its surface is varied with protuberances and cavities.

Shakespeare with his excellencies has likewise faults, and faults sufficient to obscure and overwhelm any other merit. I shall shew them in the proportion in which they appear to me, without envious malignity or superstitious veneration. No question can be more innocently discussed than a dead poet's pretensions to renown; and little regard is due to that bigotry which sets candour higher than truth.

His first defect is that to which may be imputed most of the evil in books or in men. He sacrifices virtue to convenience, and is so much more careful to please than to instruct, that he seems to write without any moral purpose. From his writings indeed a system of social duty may be selected, for he that thinks reasonably must think morally; but his precepts and axioms drop casually from him; he makes no just distribution of good or evil, nor is always careful to shew in the virtuous a disapprobation of the wicked; he carries his persons indifferently through right and wrong, and at the close dismisses them without further care, and leaves their examples to operate by chance. This fault the barbarity of his age cannot extenuate; for it is always a writer's duty to make the world better, and justice is a virtue independent on time or place.

The plots are often so loosely formed, that a very slight consideration may improve them, and so carelessly pursued, that he seems not always fully to comprehend his own design. He omits opportunities of instructing or delighting which the train of his story seems to force upon him, and apparently rejects those exhibitions which would be more affecting, for the sake of those which are more easy.

It may be observed, that in many of his plays the latter part is evidently neglected. When he found himself near the end of his work, and, in view of his reward, he shortened the labour, to snatch the profit. He therefore remits his efforts where he should most vigorously exert them, and his catastrophe is improbably produced or imperfectly represented.

He had no regard to distinction of time or place, but gives to one age or nation, without scruple, the customs, institutions, and opinions of another, at the expence not only of likelihood, but of possibility. These faults Pope has endeavoured, with more zeal than judgment, to transfer to his imagined interpolators. We need not wonder to find Hector quoting Aristotle, when we see the loves of Theus and Hippolyta combined with the Gothic mythology of fairies. Shakespeare, indeed, was not the only violator of chronology, for in the same age Sidney, who wanted not the advantages of learning, has, in his "*Arcadia*", confounded the pastoral with the feudal times, the days of innocence, quiet and security, with those of turbulence, violence and adventure.

In his comick scenes he is seldom very successful, when he engages his characters in reciprocations of smartness and contest of sarcasm; their jests are commonly gross, and their pleasantry licentious; neither his gentlemen nor his ladies have much delicacy, nor are sufficiently distinguished from his clowns by any appearance of refined manners. Whether he represented the real conversation of his time is not easy to determine; the reign of Elizabeth is commonly supposed to have been a time of stateliness, formality and reserve, yet perhaps the relaxations of that severity were not very elegant. There must, however, have been always some modes of gayety preferable to others, and a writer ought to chuse the best.

In tragedy his performance seems constantly to be worse, as his labour is more. The effusions of passion which exigence forces out are for the most part striking and energetick; but whenever he solicits his invention, or strains his faculties, the offspring of his throes is tumour, meanness, tediousness, and obscurity.

In narration he affects a disproportionate pomp of diction and a wearisome train of circumlocution, and tells the incident imperfectly in many words, which might have been more plainly delivered in few. Narration in dramattick poetry is, naturally tedious, as it is unanimated and inactive, and obstructs the progress of the action; it should

therefore always be rapid, and enlivened by frequent interruption. Shakespeare found it an encumbrance, and instead of lightening it by brevity, endeavoured to recommend it by dignity and splendour.

His declamations or set speeches are commonly cold and weak, for his power was the power of nature; when he endeavoured, like other tragick writers, to catch opportunities of amplification, and instead of inquiring what the occasion demanded, to show how much his stores of knowledge could supply, he seldom escapes without the pity or resentment of his reader.

It is incident to him to be now and then entangled with an unwieldy sentiment, which he cannot well express, and will not reject; he struggles with it a while, and if it continues stubborn, comprises it in words such as occur, and leaves it to be disentangled and evolved by those who have more leisure to bestow upon it.

Not that always where the language is intricate the thought is subtle, or the image always great where the line is bulky; the equality of words to things is very often neglected, and trivial sentiments and vulgar ideas disappoint the attention, to which they are recommended by sonorous epithets and swelling figures.

But the admirers of this great poet have never less reason to indulge their hopes of supreme excellence, than when he seems fully resolved to sink them in dejection, and mollify them with tender emotions by the fall of greatness, the danger of innocence, or the crosses of love. He is not long soft and pathetick without some idle conceit, or contemptible equivocation. He no sooner begins to move, than he counteracts himself; and terrour and pity, as they are rising in the mind, are checked and blasted by sudden frigidity.

A quibble is to Shakespeare, what luminous vapours are to the traveller; he follows it at all adventures, it is sure to lead him out of his way, and sure to engulf him in the mire. It has some malignant power over his mind, and its fascinations are irresistible. Whatever be the dignity or profundity of his disquisition, whether he be enlarging knowledge or exalting affection, whether he be amusing attention with incidents, or enchaining it in suspense, let but a quibble spring up before him, and he leaves his work unfinished. A quibble is the golden apple for which he will always turn aside from his career, or stoop from his elevation. A quibble poor and barren as it is, gave him such delight, that he was content to purchase it, by the sacrifice of

reason, propriety and truth. A quibble was to him the fatal Cleopatra for which he lost the world, and was content to lose it.

It will be thought strange, that, in enumerating the defects of this writer, I have not yet mentioned his neglect of the unities; his violation of those laws which have been instituted and established by the joint authority of poets and of criticks.

For his other deviations from the art of writing, I resign him to critical justice, without making any other demand in his favour, than that which must be indulged to all human excellence; that his virtues be rated with his failings: But, from the censure which this irregularity may bring upon him, I shall, with due reverence to that learning which I must oppose, adventure to try how I can defend him.

His histories, being neither tragedies nor comedies, are not subject to any of their laws; nothing more is necessary to all the praise which they expect, than that the changes of action be so prepared as to be understood, that the incidents be various and affecting, and the characters consistent, natural and distinct. No other unity is intended, and therefore none is to be sought.

In his other works he has well enough preserved the unity of action. He has not, indeed, an intrigue regularly perplexed and regularly unravelled; he does not endeavour to hide his design only to discover it, for this is seldom the order of real events, and Shakespeare is the poet of nature: But his plan has commonly what Aristotle requires, a beginning, a middle, and an end; one event is concatenated with another, and the conclusion follows by easy consequence. There are perhaps some incidents that might be spared, as in other poets there is much talk that only fills up time upon the stage; but the general system makes gradual advances, and the end of the play is the end of expectation.

To the unities of time and place he has shewn no regard, and perhaps a nearer view of the principles on which they stand will diminish their value, and withdraw from them the veneration which, from the time of Corneille, they have very generally received by discovering that they have given more trouble to the poet, than pleasure to the auditor.

The necessity of observing the unities of time and place arises from the supposed necessity of making the drama credible. The criticks hold it impossible, that an action of months or years can be possibly believed to pass in three hours; or that the spectator can suppose him-

self to sit in the theatre, while ambassadors go and return between distant kings, while armies are levied and towns besieged, while an exile wanders and returns, or till he whom they saw courting his mistress, shall lament the untimely fall of his son. The mind revolts from evident falsehood, and fiction loses its force when it departs from the resemblance of reality.

From the narrow limitation of time necessarily arises the contraction of place. The spectator, who knows that he saw the first act at Alexandria, cannot suppose that he sees the next at Rome, at a distance to which not the dragons of Medea could, in so short a time, have transported him; he knows with certainty that he has not changed his place; and he knows that place cannot change itself; that what was a house cannot become a plain; that what was Thebes can never be Persepolis.

Such is the triumphant language with which a critick exults over the misery of an irregular poet, and exults commonly without resistance or reply. It is time therefore to tell him, by the authority of Shakespeare, that he assumes, as an unquestionable principle, a position, which, while his breath is forming it into words, his understanding pronounces to be false. It is false, that any representation is mistaken for reality; that any dramatick fable in its materiality was ever credible, or, for a single moment, was ever credited.

The objection arising from the impossibility of passing the first hour at Alexandria, and the next at Rome, supposes, that when the play opens the spectator really imagines himself at Alexandria, and believes that his walk to the theatre has been a voyage to Egypt, and that he lives in the days of Antony and Cleopatra. Surely he that imagines this, may imagine more. He that can take the stage at one time for the palace of the Ptolemies, may take it in half an hour for the promontory of Actium. Delusion, if delusion be admitted, has no certain limitation; if the spectator can be once persuaded, that his old acquaintance are Alexander and Caesar, that a room illuminated with candles is the plain of Pharsalia, or the bank of Granicus, he is in a state of elevation above the reach of reason, or of truth, and from the heights of empyrean poetry, may despise the circumscriptions of terrestrial nature. There is no reason why a mind thus wandering in extasy should count the clock, or why an hour should not be a century in that calenture of the brains that can make the stage a field.

The truth is, that the spectators are always in their senses, and know, from the first act to the last, that the stage is only a stage, and that the players are only players. They come to hear a certain number of lines recited with just gesture and elegant modulation. The lines relate to some action, and an action must be in some place; but the different actions that compleat a story may be in places very remote from each other; and where is the absurdity of allowing that space to represent first Athens, and then Sicily, which was always known to be neither Sicily nor Athens, but a modern theatre?

By supposition, as place is introduced, time may be extended; the time required by the fable elapses for the most part between the acts; for, of so much of the action as is represented, the real and poetical duration is the same. If, in the first act, preparations for war against Mithridates are represented to be made in Rome, the event of the war may, without absurdity, be represented, in the catastrophe, as happening in Pontus; we know that there is neither war, nor preparation for war; we know that we are neither in Rome nor Pontus; that neither Mithridates nor Lucullus are before us. The drama exhibits successive imitations of successive actions, and why may not the second imitation represent an action that happened years after the first; if it be so connected with it, that nothing but time can be supposed to intervene? Time is, of all modes of existence, most obsequious to the imagination; a lapse of years is as easily conceived as a passage of hours. In contemplation we easily contract the time of real actions, and therefore willingly permit it to be contracted when we only see their imitation.

It will be asked, how the drama moves, if it is not credited. It is credited with all the credit due to a drama. It is credited, whenever it moves, as a just picture of a real original; as representing to the auditor what he would himself feel, if he were to do or suffer what is there feigned to be suffered or to be done. The reflection that strikes the heart is not, that the evils before us are real evils, but that they are evils to which we ourselves may be exposed. If there be any fallacy, it is not that we fancy the players, but that we fancy ourselves unhappy for a moment; but we rather lament the possibility than suppose the presence of misery, as a mother weeps over her babe, when she remembers that death may take it from her. The delight of tragedy proceeds from our consciousness of fiction; if we thought murders and treasons real, they would please no more.

Imitations produce pain or pleasure, not because they are mistaken for realities, but because they bring realities to mind. When the imagination is recreated by a painted landscape, the trees are not supposed capable to give us shade, or the fountains coolness; but we consider, how we should be pleased with such fountains playing beside us, and such woods waving over us. We are agitated in reading the history of "Henry the Fifth", yet no man takes his book for the field of Agencourt. A dramattick exhibition is a book recited with concomitants that encrease or diminish its effect. Familiar comedy is often more powerful on the theatre, than in the page; imperial tragedy is always less. The humour of Petruchio may be heightened by grimace; but what voice or what gesture can hope to add dignity or force to the soliloquy of Cato.

A play read, affects the mind like a play acted. It is therefore evident, that the action is not supposed to be real, and it follows that between the acts a longer or shorter time may be allowed to pass, and that no more account of space or duration is to be taken by the auditor of a drama, than by the reader of a narrative, before whom may pass in an hour the life of a hero, or the revolutions of an empire.

Whether Shakespeare knew the unities, and rejected them by design, or deviated from them by happy ignorance, it is, I think, impossible to decide, and useless to inquire. We may reasonably suppose, that, when he rose to notice, he did not want the counsels and admonitions of scholars and criticks, and that he at last deliberately persisted in a practice, which he might have begun by chance. As nothing is essential to the fable, but unity of action, and as the unities of time and place arise evidently from false assumptions, and, by circumscribing the extent of the drama, lessen its variety, I cannot think it much to be lamented, that they were not known by him, or not observed: Nor, if such another poet could arise, should I very vehemently reproach him, that his first act passed at Venice, and his next in Cyprus. Such violations of rules merely positive, become the comprehensive genius of Shakespeare, and such censures are suitable to the minute and slender criticism of Voltaire:

Non usque adeo permiscuit imis

Longus summa dies, ut non, si voce Metelli

Serventur leges, malint a Caesare tolli.

Yet when I speak thus slightly of dramattick rules, I cannot but recollect how much wit and learning may be produced against me; be-

fore such authorities I am afraid to stand, not that I think the present question one of those that are to be decided by mere authority, but because it is to be suspected, that these precepts have not been so easily received but for better reasons than I have yet been able to find. The result of my enquiries, in which it would be ludicrous to boast of impartiality, is, that the unities of time and place are not essential to a just drama, that though they may sometimes conduce to pleasure, they are always to be sacrificed to the nobler beauties of variety and instruction; and that a play, written with nice observation of critical rules, is to be contemplated as an elaborate curiosity, as the product of superfluous and ostentatious art, by which is shewn, rather what is possible, than what is necessary.

He that, without diminution of any other excellence, shall preserve all the unities unbroken, deserves the like applause with the architect, who shall display all the orders of architecture in a citadel, without any deduction from its strength; but the principal beauty of a citadel is to exclude the enemy; and the greatest graces of a play, are to copy nature and instruct life.

Perhaps, what I have here not dogmatically but deliberately written, may recal the principles of the drama to a new examination. I am almost frightened at my own temerity; and when I estimate the fame and the strength of those that maintain the contrary opinion, am ready to sink down in reverential silence; as Aeneas withdrew from the defence of Troy, when he saw Neptune shaking the wall, and Juno heading the besiegers.

Those whom my arguments cannot persuade to give their approbation to the judgment of Shakespeare, will easily, if they consider the condition of his life, make some allowance for his ignorance.

Every man's performances, to be rightly estimated, must be compared with the state of the age in which he lived, and with his own particular opportunities; and though to the reader a book be not worse or better for the circumstances of the authour, yet as there is always a silent reference of human works to human abilities, and as the enquiry, how far man may extend his designs, or how high he may rate his native force, is of far greater dignity than in what rank we shall place any particular performance, curiosity is always busy to discover the instruments, as well as to survey the workmanship, to know how much is to be ascribed to original powers, and how much to casual and adventitious help. The palaces of Peru or Mexico were

certainly mean and incommodious habitations, if compared to the houses of European monarchs; yet who could forbear to view them with astonishment, who remembered that they were built without the use of iron?

The English nation, in the time of Shakespeare, was yet struggling to emerge from barbarity. The philology of Italy had been transplanted hither in the reign of Henry the Eighth; and the learned languages had been successfully cultivated by Lilly and More; by Pole, Cheke, and Gardiner; and afterwards by Smith, Clerk, Haddon, and Ascham. Greek was now taught to boys in the principal schools; and those who united elegance with learning, read, with great diligence, the Italian and Spanish poets. But literature was yet confined to professed scholars, or to men and women of high rank. The publick was gross and dark; and to be able to read and write, was an accomplishment still valued for its rarity.

Nations, like individuals, have their infancy. A people newly awakened to literary curiosity, being yet unacquainted with the true state of things, knows not how to judge of that which is proposed as its resemblance. Whatever is remote from common appearances is always welcome to vulgar, as to childish credulity; and of a country unenlightened by learning, the whole people is the vulgar. The study of those who then aspired to plebeian learning was laid out upon adventures, giants, dragons, and enchantments. The Death of Arthur was the favourite volume.

The mind, which has feasted on the luxurious wonders of fiction, has no taste of the insipidity of truth. A play which imitated only the common occurrences of the world, would, upon the admirers of Palmerin and Guy of Warwick, have made little impression; he that wrote for such an audience was under the necessity of looking round for strange events and fabulous transactions, and that incredibility, by which maturer knowledge is offended, was the chief recommendation of writings, to unskilful curiosity.

Our authour's plots are generally borrowed from novels, and it is reasonable to suppose, that he chose the most popular, such as were read by many, and related by more; for his audience could not have followed him through the intricacies of the drama, had they not held the thread of the story in their hands.

The stories, which we now find only in remoter authours, were in his time accessible and familliar. The fable of "As You Like It",

which is supposed to be copied from Chaucer's *Gamelyn*, was a little pamphlet of those times; and old Mr. Cibber remembered the tale of Hamlet in plain English prose, which the criticks have now to seek in Saxo Grammaticus.

His English histories he took from English chronicles and English ballads; and as the ancient writers were made known to his countrymen by versions, they supplied him with new subjects; he dilated some of Plutarch's lives into plays, when they had been translated by North.

His plots, whether historical or fabulous, are always crowded with incidents, by which the attention of a rude people was more easily caught than by sentiment or argumentation; and such is the power of the marvellous even over those who despise it, that every man finds his mind more strongly seized by the tragedies of Shakespeare than of any other writer; others please us by particular speeches, but he always makes us anxious for the event, and has perhaps excelled all but Homer in securing the first purpose of a writer, by exciting restless and unquenchable curiosity, and compelling him that reads his work to read it through.

The shows and bustle with which his plays abound have the same original. As knowledge advances, pleasure passes from the eye to the ear, but returns, as it declines, from the ear to the eye. Those to whom our authour's labours were exhibited had more skill in pomps or processions than in poetical language, and perhaps wanted some visible and discriminated events, as comments on the dialogue. He knew how he should most please; and whether his practice is more agreeable to nature, or whether his example has prejudiced the nation, we still find that on our stage something must be done as well as said, and inactive declamation is very coldly heard, however musical or elegant, passionate or sublime.

Voltaire expresses his wonder, that our authour's extravagancies are endured by a nation, which has seen the tragedy of Cato. Let him be answered, that Addison speaks the language of poets, and Shakespeare, of men. We find in Cato innumerable beauties which enamour us of its authour, but we see nothing that acquaints us with human sentiments or human actions; we place it with the fairest and the noblest progeny which judgment propagates by conjunction with learning, but "*Othello*" is the vigorous and vivacious offspring of observation impregnated by genius. Cato affords a splendid exhibition

of artificial and fictitious manners, and delivers just and noble sentiments, in diction easy, elevated and harmonious, but its hopes and fears communicate no vibration to the heart; the composition refers us only to the writer; we pronounce the name of Cato, but we think on Addison.

The work of a correct and regular writer is a garden accurately formed and diligently planted, varied with shades, and scented with flowers; the composition of Shakespeare is a forest, in which oaks extend their branches, and pines tower in the air, interspersed sometimes with weeds and brambles, and sometimes giving shelter to myrtles and to roses; filling the eye with awful pomp, and gratifying the mind with endless diversity. Other poets display cabinets of precious rarities, minutely finished, wrought into shape, and polished unto brightness. Shakespeare opens a mine which contains gold and diamonds in unexhaustible plenty, though clouded by incrustations, debased by impurities, and mingled with a mass of meaner minerals.

It has been much disputed, whether Shakespeare owed his excellence to his own native force, or whether he had the common helps of scholastick education, the precepts of critical science, and the examples of ancient authours.

There has always prevailed a tradition, that Shakespeare wanted learning, that he had no regular education, nor much skill in the dead languages. Johnson, his friend, affirms, that "He had small Latin and no Greek."; who, besides that he had no imaginable temptation to falsehood, wrote at a time when the character and acquisitions of Shakespeare were known to multitudes. His evidence ought therefore to decide the controversy, unless some testimony of equal force could be opposed.

Some have imagined, that they have discovered deep learning in many imitations of old writers; but the examples which I have known urged, were drawn from books translated in his time; or were such easy coincidences of thought, as will happen to all who consider the same subjects; or such remarks on life or axioms of morality as float in conversation, and are transmitted through the world in proverbial sentences.

I have found it remarked, that, in this important sentence, "Go before, I'll follow," we read a translation of, *I prae, sequar*. I have been told, that when Caliban, after a pleasing dream, says, "I cry'd

to sleep again," the authour imitates Anacreon, who had, like every other man, the same wish on the same occasion.

There are a few passages which may pass for imitations, but so few, that the exception only confirms the rule; he obtained them from accidental quotations, or by oral communication, and as he used what he had, would have used more if he had obtained it.

The "*Comedy of Errors*" is confessedly taken from the *Menaechmi* of Plautus; from the only play of Plautus which was then in English. What can be more probable, than that he who copied that, would have copied more; but that those which were not translated were inaccessible?

Whether he knew the modern languages is uncertain. That his plays have some French scenes proves but little; he might easily procure them to be written, and probably, even though he had known the language in the common degree, he could not have written it without assistance. In the story of "*Romeo and Juliet*" he is observed to have followed the English translation, where it deviates from the Italian; but this on the other part proves nothing against his knowledge of the original. He was to copy, not what he knew himself, but what was known to his audience.

It is most likely that he had learned Latin sufficiently to make him acquainted with construction, but that he never advanced to an easy perusal of the Roman authours. Concerning his skill in modern languages, I can find no sufficient ground of determination; but as no imitations of French or Italian authours have been discovered, though the Italian poetry was then high in esteem, I am inclined to believe, that he read little more than English, and chose for his fables only such tales as he found translated.

That much knowledge is scattered over his works is very justly observed by Pope, but it is often such knowledge as books did not supply. He that will understand Shakespeare, must not be content to study him in the closet, he must look for his meaning sometimes among the sports of the field, and sometimes among the manufactures of the shop.

There is however proof enough that he was a very diligent reader, nor was our language then so indigent of books, but that he might very liberally indulge his curiosity without excursion into foreign literature. Many of the Roman authours were translated, and some of the Greek; the reformation had filled the kingdom with theological

learning; most of the topicks of human disquisition had found English writers; and poetry had been cultivated, not only with diligence, but success. This was a stock of knowledge sufficient for a mind so capable of appropriating and improving it.

But the greater part of his excellence was the product of his own genius. He found the English stage in a state of the utmost rudeness; no essays either in tragedy or comedy had appeared, from which it could be discovered to what degree of delight either one or other might be carried. Neither character nor dialogue were yet understood. Shakespeare may be truly said to have introduced them both amongst us, and in some of his happier scenes to have carried them both to the utmost height.

By what gradations of improvement he proceeded, is not easily known; for the chronology of his works is yet unsettled. Rowe is of opinion, that "perhaps we are not to look for his beginning, like those of other writers, in his least perfect works; art had so little, and nature so large a share in what he did, that for ought I know," says he, "the performances of his youth, as they were the most vigorous, were the best." But the power of nature is only the power of using to any certain purpose the materials which diligence procures, or opportunity supplies. Nature gives no man knowledge, and when images are collected by study and experience, can only assist in combining or applying them. Shakespeare, however favoured by nature, could impart only what he had learned; and as he must increase his ideas, like other mortals, by gradual acquisition, he, like them, grew wiser as he grew older, could display life better, as he knew it more, and instruct with more efficacy, as he was himself more amply instructed.

There is a vigilance of observation and accuracy of distinction which books and precepts cannot confer; from this almost all original and native excellence proceeds. Shakespeare must have looked upon mankind with perspicacity, in the highest degree curious and attentive. Other writers borrow their characters from preceding writers, and diversify them only by the accidental appendages of present manners; the dress is a little varied, but the body is the same. Our author had both matter and form to provide; for except the characters of Chaucer, to whom I think he is not much indebted, there were no writers in English, and perhaps not many in other modern languages, which shewed life in its native colours.

The contest about the original benevolence or malignity of man had not yet commenced. Speculation had not yet attempted to analyse the mind, to trace the passions to their sources, to unfold the seminal principles of vice and virtue, or sound the depths of the heart for the motives of action. All those enquiries, which from that time that human nature became the fashionable study, have been made sometimes with nice discernment, but often with idle subtilty, were yet unattempted. The tales, with which the infancy of learning was satisfied, exhibited only the superficial appearances of action, related the events but omitted the causes, and were formed for such as delighted in wonders rather than in truth. Mankind was not then to be studied in the closet; he that would know the world, was under the necessity of gleaning his own remarks, by mingling as he could in its business and amusements.

Boyle congratulated himself upon his high birth, because it favoured his curiosity, by facilitating his access. Shakespeare had no such advantage; he came to London a needy adventurer, and lived for a time by very mean employments. Many works of genius and learning have been performed in states of life, that appear very little favourable to thought or to enquiry; so many, that he who considers them is inclined to think that he sees enterprise and perseverance predominating over all external agency, and bidding help and hindrance vanish before them. The genius of Shakespeare was not to be depressed by the weight of poverty, nor limited by the narrow conversation to which men in want are inevitably condemned; the incumbrances of his fortune were shaken from his mind, "as dewdrops from a lion's mane."

Though he had so many difficulties to encounter, and so little assistance to surmount them, he has been able to obtain an exact knowledge of many modes of life, and many casts of native dispositions; to vary them with great multiplicity; to mark them by nice distinctions; and to shew them in full view by proper combinations. In this part of his performances He had none to imitate, but has himself been imitated by all succeeding writers; and it may be doubted, whether from all his successors more maxims of theoretical knowledge, or more rules of practical prudence, can be collected, than he alone has given to his country.

Nor was his attention confined to the actions of men; he was an exact surveyor of the inanimate world; his descriptions have always

some peculiarities, gathered by contemplating things as they really exist. It may be observed, that the oldest poets of many nations preserve their reputation, and that the following generations of wit, after a short celebrity, sink into oblivion. The first, whoever they be, must take their sentiments and descriptions immediately from knowledge; the resemblance is therefore just, their descriptions are verified by every eye, and their sentiments acknowledged by every breast. Those whom their fame invites to the same studies, copy partly them, and partly nature, till the books of one age gain such authority, as to stand in the place of nature to another, and imitation, always deviating a little, becomes at last capricious and casual. Shakespeare, whether life or nature be his subject, shews plainly, that he has seen with his own eyes; he gives the image which he receives, not weakened or distorted by the intervention of any other mind; the ignorant feel his representations to be just, and the learned see that they are compleat.

Perhaps it would not be easy to find any authour, except Homer, who invented so much as Shakespeare, who so much advanced the studies which he cultivated, or effused so much novelty upon his age or country. The form, the characters, the language, and the shows of the English drama are his. "He seems," says Dennis, "to have been the very original of our English tragical harmony, that is, the harmony of blank verse, diversified often by dissyllable and trissyllable terminations. For the diversity distinguishes it from heroick harmony, and by bringing it nearer to common use makes it more proper to gain attention, and more fit for action and dialogue. Such verse we make when we are writing prose; we make such verse in common conversation."

I know not whether this praise is rigorously just. The dissyllable termination, which the critick rightly appropriates to the drama, is to be found, though, I think, not in *Gorboduc* which is confessedly before our authour; yet in *Hieronnymo*, of which the date is not certain, but which there is reason to believe at least as old as his earliest plays. This however is certain, that he is the first who taught either tragedy or comedy to please, there being no theatrical piece of any older writer, of which the name is known, except to antiquaries and collectors of books, which are sought because they are scarce, and would not have been scarce, had they been much esteemed.

To him we must ascribe the praise, unless Spenser may divide it with him, of having first discovered to how much smoothness and

harmony the English language could be softened. He has speeches, perhaps sometimes scenes, which have all the delicacy of Rowe, without his effeminacy. He endeavours indeed commonly to strike by the force and vigour of his dialogue, but he never executes his purpose better, than when he tries to sooth by softness.

Yet it must be at last confessed, that as we owe every thing to him, he owes something to us; that, if much of his praise is paid by perception and judgement, much is likewise given by custom and veneration. We fix our eyes upon his graces, and turn them from his deformities, and endure in him what we should in another loath or despise. If we endured without praising, respect for the father of our drama might excuse us; but I have seen, in the book of some modern critick, a collection of anomalies which shew that he has corrupted language by every mode of depravation, but which his admirer has accumulated as a monument of honour.

He has scenes of undoubted and perpetual excellence, but perhaps not one play, which, if it were now exhibited as the work of a contemporary writer, would be heard to the conclusion. I am indeed far from thinking, that his works were wrought to his own ideas of perfection; when they were such as would satisfy the audience, they satisfied the writer. It is seldom that authours, though more studious of fame than Shakespeare, rise much above the standard of their own age; to add a little of what is best will always be sufficient for present praise, and those who find themselves exalted into fame, are willing to credit their encomiasts, and to spare the labour of contending with themselves.

It does not appear, that Shakespeare thought his works worthy of posterity, that he levied any ideal tribute upon future times, or had any further prospect, than of present popularity and present profit. When his plays had been acted, his hope was at an end; he solicited no addition of honour from the reader. He therefore made no scruple to repeat the same jests in many dialogues, or to entangle different plots by the same knot of perplexity, which may be at least forgiven him, by those who recollect, that of Congreve's four comedies, two are concluded by a marriage in a mask, by a deception, which perhaps never happened, and which, whether likely or not, he did not invent.

So careless was this great poet of future fame, that, though he retired to ease and plenty, while he was yet little "declined into the vale of years," before he could be disgusted with fatigue, or disabled by

infirmity, he made no collection of his works, nor desired to rescue those that had been already published from the depravations that obscured them, or secure to the rest a better destiny, by giving them to the world in their genuine state.

Of the plays which bear the name of Shakespeare in the late editions, the greater part were not published till about seven years after his death, and the few which appeared in his life are apparently thrust into the world without the care of the authour, and therefore probably without his knowledge.

Of all the publishers, clandestine or professed, their negligence and unskilfulness has by the late revisers been sufficiently shown. The faults of all are indeed numerous and gross, and have not only corrupted many passages perhaps beyond recovery, but have brought others into suspicion, which are only obscured by obsolete phraseology, or by the writer's unskilfulness and affectation. To alter is more easy than to explain, and temerity is a more common quality than diligence. Those who saw that they must employ conjecture to a certain degree, were willing to indulge it a little further. Had the authour published his own works, we should have sat quietly down to disentangle his intricacies, and clear his obscurities; but now we tear what we cannot loose, and eject what we happen not to understand.

The faults are more than could have happened without the concurrence of many causes. The stile of Shakespeare was in itself ungrammatical, perplexed and obscure; his works were transcribed for the players by those who may be supposed to have seldom understood them; they were transmitted by copiers equally unskilful, who still multiplied errors; they were perhaps sometimes mutilated by the actors, for the sake of shortening the speeches; and were at last printed without correction of the press.

In this state they remained, not as Dr. Warburton supposes, because they were unregarded, but because the editor's art was not yet applied to modern languages, and our ancestors were accustomed to so much negligence of English printers, that they could very patiently endure it. At last an edition was undertaken by Rowe; not because a poet was to be published by a poet, for Rowe seems to have thought very little on correction or explanation, but that our authour's works might appear like those of his fraternity, with the appendages of a life and commendatory preface. Rowe has been clamorously blamed for not performing what he did not undertake, and it is time that jus-

tice be done him, by confessing, that though he seems to have had no thought of corruption beyond the printer's errors, yet he has made many emendations, if they were not made before, which his successors have received without acknowledgment, and which, if they had produced them, would have filled pages and pages with censures of the stupidity by which the faults were committed, with displays of the absurdities which they involved, with ostentatious exposition of the new reading, and self congratulations on the happiness of discovering it.

Of Rowe, as of all the editors, I have preserved the preface and have likewise retained the authour's life, though not written with much elegance or spirit; it relates however what is now to be known, and therefore deserves to pass through all succeeding publications.

The nation had been for many years content enough with Mr. Rowe's performance, when Mr. Pope made them acquainted with the true state of Shakespeare's text, shewed that it was extremely corrupt, and gave reason to hope that there were means of reforming it. He collated the old copies, which none had thought to examine before, and restored many lines to their integrity; but, by a very compendious criticism, he rejected whatever he disliked, and thought more of amputation than of cure.

I know not why he is commended by Dr. Warburton for distinguishing the genuine from the spurious plays. In this choice he exerted no judgement of his own; the plays which he received, were given by Hemings and Condell, the first editors; and those which he rejected, though, according to the licentiousness of the press in those times, they were printed during Shakespeare's life, with his name, had been omitted by his friends, and were never added to his works before the edition of 1664, from which they were copied by the later printers.

This was a work which Pope seems to have thought unworthy of his abilities, being not able to suppress his contempt of "the dull duty of an editor". He understood but half his undertaking. The duty of a collator is indeed dull, yet, like other tedious tasks, is very necessary; but an emendatory critick would ill discharge his duty, without qualities very different from dulness. In perusing a corrupted piece, he must have before him all possibilities of meaning, with all possibilities of expression. Such must be his comprehension of thought, and such his copiousness of language. Out of many readings possible,

he must be able to select that which best suits with the state, opinions, and modes of language prevailing in every age, and with his authour's particular cast of thought, and turn of expression. Such must be his knowledge, and such his taste. Conjectural criticism demands more than humanity possesses, and he that exercises it with most praise has very frequent need of indulgence. Let us now be told no more of the dull duty of an editor.

Confidence is the common consequence of success. They whose excellence of any kind has been loudly celebrated, are ready to conclude, that their powers are universal. Pope's edition fell below his own expectations, and he was so much offended, when he was found to have left any thing for others to do, that he past the latter part of his life in a state of hostility with verbal criticism.

I have retained all his notes, that no fragment of so great a writer may be lost; his preface, valuable alike for elegance of composition and justness of remark, and containing a general criticism on his authour, so extensive that little can be added, and so exact, that little can be disputed, every editor has an interest to suppress, but that every reader would demand its insertion.

Pope was succeeded by Theobald, a man of narrow comprehension and small acquisitions, with no native and intrinsick splendour of genius, with little of the artificial light of learning, but zealous for minute accuracy, and not negligent in pursuing it. He collated the ancient copies, and rectified many errors. A man so anxiously scrupulous might have been expected to do more, but what little he did was commonly right.

In his report of copies and editions he is not to be trusted, without examination. He speaks sometimes indefinitely of copies, when he has only one. In his enumeration of editions, he mentions the two first folios as of high, and the third folio as of middle authority; but the truth is, that the first is equivalent to all others, and that the rest only deviate from it by the printer's negligence. Whoever has any of the folios has all, excepting those diversities which mere reiteration of editions will produce. I collated them all at the beginning, but afterwards used only the first.

Of his notes I have generally retained those which he retained himself in his second edition, except when they were confuted by subsequent annotators, or were too minute to merit preservation. I have sometimes adopted his restoration of a comma, without inserting the

panegyrick in which he celebrated himself for his achievement. The exuberant excrescence of diction I have often lopped, his triumphant exultations over Pope and Rowe I have sometimes suppressed, and his contemptible ostentation I have frequently concealed; but I have in some places shewn him, as he would have shewn himself, for the reader's diversion, that the inflated emptiness of some notes may justify or excuse the contraction of the rest.

Theobald, thus weak and ignorant, thus mean and faithless, thus petulant and ostentatious, by the good luck of having Pope for his enemy, has escaped, and escaped alone, with reputation, from this undertaking. So willingly does the world support those who solicit favour, against those who command reverence; and so easily is he praised, whom no man can envy.

Our authour fell then into the hands of Sir Thomas Hanmer, the Oxford editor, a man, in my opinion, eminently qualified by nature for such studies. He had, what is the first requisite to emendatory criticism, that intuition by which the poet's intention is immediately discovered, and that dexterity of intellect which dispatches its work by the easiest means. He had undoubtedly read much; his acquaintance with customs, opinions, and traditions, seems to have been large; and he is often learned without shew. He seldom passes what he does not understand, without an attempt to find or to make a meaning, and sometimes hastily makes what a little more attention would have found. He is solicitous to reduce to grammar, what he could not be sure that his authour intended to be grammatical. Shakespeare regarded more the series of ideas, than of words; and his language, not being designed for the reader's desk, was all that he desired it to be, if it conveyed his meaning to the audience.

Hanmer's care of the metre has been too violently censured. He found the measures reformed in so many passages, by the silent labours of some editors, with the silent acquiescence of the rest, that he thought himself allowed to extend a little further the license, which had already been carried so far without reprehension; and of his corrections in general, it must be confessed, that they are often just, and made commonly with the least possible violation of the text.

But, by inserting his emendations, whether invented or borrowed, into the page, without any notice of varying copies, he has appropriated the labour of his predecessors, and made his own edition of little authority. His confidence indeed, both in himself and others,

was too great; he supposes all to be right that was done by Pope and Theobald; he seems not to suspect a critick of fallibility, and it was but reasonable that he should claim what he so liberally granted.

As he never writes without careful enquiry and diligent consideration, I have received all his notes, and believe that every reader will wish for more.

Of the last editor it is more difficult to speak. Respect is due to high place, tenderness to living reputation, and veneration to genius and learning; but he cannot be justly offended at that liberty of which he has himself so frequently given an example, nor very solicitous what is thought of notes, which he ought never to have considered as part of his serious employments, and which, I suppose, since the ardour of composition is remitted, he no longer numbers among his happy effusions.

The original and predominant error of his commentary, is acquiescence in his first thoughts; that precipitation which is produced by consciousness of quick discernment; and that confidence which presumes to do, by surveying the surface, what labour only can perform, by penetrating the bottom. His notes exhibit sometimes perverse interpretations, and sometimes improbable conjectures; he at one time gives the authour more profundity of meaning than the sentence admits, and at another discovers absurdities, where the sense is plain to every other reader. But his emendations are likewise often happy and just; and his interpretation of obscure passages learned and sagacious.

Of his notes, I have commonly rejected those, against which the general voice of the publick has exclaimed, or which their own incongruity immediately condemns, and which, I suppose, the authour himself would desire to be forgotten. Of the rest, to part I have given the highest approbation, by inserting the offered reading in the text; part I have left to the judgment of the reader, as doubtful, though specious; and part I have censured without reserve, but I am sure without bitterness of malice, and, I hope, without wantonness of insult.

It is no pleasure to me, in revising my volumes, to observe how much paper is wasted in confutation. Whoever considers the revolutions of learning, and the various questions of greater or less importance, upon which wit and reason have exercised their powers, must lament the unsuccessfulness of enquiry, and the slow advances of

truth, when he reflects, that great part of the labour of every writer is only the destruction of those that went before him. The first care of the builder of a new system, is to demolish the fabricks which are standing. The chief desire of him that comments an authour, is to shew how much other commentators have corrupted and obscured him. The opinions prevalent in one age, as truths above the reach of controversy, are confuted and rejected in another, and rise again to reception in remoter times. Thus the human mind is kept in motion without progress. Thus sometimes truth and error, and sometimes contrarieties of error, take each other's place by reciprocal invasion. The tide of seeming knowledge which is poured over one generation, retires and leaves another naked and barren; the sudden meteors of intelligence which for a while appear to shoot their beams into the regions of obscurity, on a sudden withdraw their lustre, and leave mortals again to grope their way.

These elevations and depressions of renown, and the contradictions to which all improvers of knowledge must for ever be exposed, since they are not escaped by the highest and brightest of mankind, may surely be endured with patience by criticks and annotators, who can rank themselves but as the satellites of their authours. How canst thou beg for life, says Achilles to his captive, when thou knowest that thou art now to suffer only what must another day be suffered by Achilles?

Dr. Warburton had a name sufficient to confer celebrity on those who could exalt themselves into antagonists, and his notes have raised a clamour too loud to be distinct. His chief assailants are the authours of the *Canons of Criticism* and of the *Review of Shakespeare's Text*; of whom one ridicules his errors with airy petulance, suitable enough to the levity of the controversy; the other attacks them with gloomy malignity, as if he were dragging to justice an assassin or incendiary. The one stings like a fly, sucks a little blood, takes a gay flutter, and returns for more; the other bites like a viper, and would be glad to leave inflammations and gangrene behind him. When I think on one, with his confederates, I remember the danger of Coriolanus, who was afraid that "girls with spits, and boys with stones, should slay him in puny battle;" when the other crosses my imagination, I remember the prodigy in "*Macbeth*",

An eagle tow'ring in his pride of place, was by a mousing owl hawk'd at and kill'd.

Let me however do them justice. One is a wit, and one a scholar. They have both shewn acuteness sufficient in the discovery of faults, and have both advanced some probable interpretations of obscure passages; but when they aspire to conjecture and emendation, it appears how falsely we all estimate our own abilities, and the little which they have been able to perform might have taught them more candour to the endeavours of others.

Before Dr. Warburton's edition, "*Critical Observations on Shakespeare*" had been published by Mr. Upton, a man skilled in languages, and acquainted with books, but who seems to have had no great vigour of genius or nicety of taste. Many of his explanations are curious and useful, but he likewise, though he professed to oppose the licentious confidence of editors, and adhere to the old copies, is unable to restrain the rage of emendation, though his ardour is ill seconded by his skill. Every cold empirick, when his heart is expanded by a successful experiment, swells into a theorist, and the laborious collator some unlucky moment frolicks in conjecture.

"*Critical, historical and explanatory notes*" have been likewise published upon Shakespeare by Dr. Grey, whose diligent perusal of the old English writers has enabled him to make some useful observations. What he undertook he has well enough performed, but as he neither attempts judicial nor emendatory criticism, he employs rather his memory than his sagacity. It were to be wished that all would endeavour to imitate his modesty who have not been able to surpass his knowledge.

I can say with great sincerity of all my predecessors, what I hope will hereafter be said of me, that not one has left Shakespeare without improvement, nor is there one to whom I have not been indebted for assistance and information. Whatever I have taken from them it was my intention to refer to its original authour, and it is certain, that what I have not given to another, I believed when I wrote it to be my own. In some perhaps I have been anticipated; but if I am ever found to encroach upon the remarks of any other commentator, I am willing that the honour, be it more or less, should be transferred to the first claimant, for his right, and his alone, stands above dispute; the second can prove his pretensions only to himself, nor can himself always distinguish invention, with sufficient certainty, from recollection.

They have all been treated by me with candour, which they have not been careful of observing to one another. It is not easy to dis-

cover from what cause the acrimony of a scholiast can naturally proceed. The subjects to be discussed by him are of very small importance; they involve neither property nor liberty; nor favour the interest of sect or party. The various readings of copies, and different interpretations of a passage, seem to be questions that might exercise the wit, without engaging the passions. But, whether it be, that "small things make mean men proud," and vanity catches small occasions; or that all contrariety of opinion, even in those that can defend it no longer, makes proud men angry; there is often found in commentaries a spontaneous strain of invective and contempt, more eager and venomous than is vented by the most furious controvertist in politicks against those whom he is hired to defame.

Perhaps the lightness of the matter may conduce to the vehemence of the agency; when the truth to be investigated is so near to inexistence, as to escape attention, its bulk is to be enlarged by rage and exclamation: That to which all would be indifferent in its original state, may attract notice when the fate of a name is appended to it. A commentator has indeed great temptations to supply by turbulence what he wants of dignity, to beat his little gold to a spacious surface, to work that to foam which no art or diligence can exalt to spirit.

The notes which I have borrowed or written are either illustrative, by which difficulties are explained; or judicial, by which faults and beauties are remarked; or emendatory, by which depravations are corrected.

The explanations transcribed from others, if I do not subjoin any other interpretation, I suppose commonly to be right, at least I intend by acquiescence to confess, that I have nothing better to propose.

After the labours of all the editors, I found many passages which appeared to me likely to obstruct the greater number of readers, and thought it my duty to facilitate their passage. It is impossible for an expositor not to write too little for some, and too much for others. He can only judge what is necessary by his own experience; and how long soever he may deliberate, will at last explain many lines which the learned will think impossible to be mistaken, and omit many for which the ignorant will want his help. These are censures merely relative and must be quietly endured. I have endeavoured to be neither superfluously copious, nor scrupulously reserved, and hope that I have made my authour's meaning accessible to many who before

were frightened from perusing him, and contributed something to the publick, by diffusing innocent and rational pleasure.

The compleat explanation of an authour not systematick and consequential, but desultory and vagrant, abounding in casual allusions and light hints, is not to be expected from any single scholiast. All personal reflections, when names are suppressed, must be in a few years irrecoverably obliterated; and customs, too minute to attract the notice of law, such as mode of dress, formalities of conversation, rules of visits, disposition of furniture, and practices of ceremony, which naturally find places in familiar dialogue, are so fugitive and unsubstantial that they are not easily retained or recovered. What can be known, will be collected by chance, from the recesses of obscure and obsolete papers, perused commonly with some other view. Of this knowledge every man has some, and none has much; but when an authour has engaged the publick attention, those who can add any thing to his illustration, communicate their discoveries, and time produces what had eluded diligence.

To time I have been obliged to resign many passages, which, though I did not understand them, will perhaps hereafter be explained, having, I hope, illustrated some, which others have neglected or mistaken, sometimes by short remarks or marginal directions, such as every editor has added at his will, and often by comments more laborious than the matter will seem to deserve; but that which is most difficult is not always most important, and to an editor nothing is a trifle by which his authour is obscured.

The poetical beauties or defects I have not been very diligent to observe. Some plays have more, and some fewer judicial observations, not in proportion to their difference of merit, but because I gave this part of my design to chance and to caprice. The reader, I believe, is seldom pleased to find his opinion anticipated; it is natural to delight more in what we find or make, than in what we receive. Judgement, like other faculties, is improved by practice, and its advancement is hindered by submission to dictatorial decisions, as the memory grows torpid by the use of a table book. Some initiation is however necessary; of all skill, part is infused by precept, and part is obtained by habit; I have therefore shewn so much as may enable the candidate of criticism to discover the rest.

To the end of most plays, I have added short strictures, containing a general censure of faults, or praise of excellence; in which I know

not how much I have concurred with the current opinion; but I have not, by any affectation of singularity, deviated from it. Nothing is minutely and particularly examined, and therefore it is to be supposed, that in the plays which are condemned there is much to be praised, and in these which are praised much to be condemned.

The part of criticism in which the whole succession of editors has laboured with the greatest diligence, which has occasioned the most arrogant ostentation, and excited the keenest acrimony, is the emendation of corrupted passages, to which the publick attention having been first drawn by the violence of contention between Pope and Theobald, has been continued by the persecution, which, with a kind of conspiracy, has been since raised against all the publishers of Shakespeare.

That many passages have passed in a state of depravation through all the editions is indubitably certain; of these the restoration is only to be attempted by collation of copies or sagacity of conjecture. The collator's province is safe and easy, the conjecturer's perilous and difficult. Yet as the greater part of the plays are extant only in one copy, the peril must not be avoided, nor the difficulty refused.

Of the readings which this emulation of amendment has hitherto produced, some from the labours of every publisher have advanced into the text; those are to be considered as in my opinion sufficiently supported; some I have rejected without mention, as evidently erroneous; some I have left in the notes without censure or approbation, as resting in equipoise between objection and defence; and some, which seemed specious but not right, I have inserted with a subsequent animadversion.

Having classed the observations of others, I was at last to try what I could substitute for their mistakes, and how I could supply their omissions. I collated such copies as I could procure, and wished for more, but have not found the collectors of these rarities very communicative. Of the editions which chance or kindness put into my hands I have given an enumeration, that I may not be blamed for neglecting what I had not the power to do.

By examining the old copies, I soon found that the late publishers, with all their boasts of diligence, suffered many passages; to stand unauthorised, and contented themselves with Rowe's regulation of the text, even where they knew it to be arbitrary, and with a little consideration might have found it to be wrong. Some of these alterations

are only the ejection of a word for one that appeared to him more elegant or more intelligible. These corruptions I have often silently rectified; for the history of our language, and the true force of our words, can only be preserved, by keeping the text of authours free from adulteration. Others, and those very frequent, smoothed the cadence, or regulated the measure; on these I have not exercised the same rigour; if only a word was transposed, or a particle inserted or omitted, I have sometimes suffered the line to stand; for the inconstancy of the copies is such, as that some liberties may be easily permitted. But this practice I have not suffered to proceed far, having restored the primitive diction wherever it could for any reason be preferred.

The emendations, which comparison of copies supplied, I have inserted in the text; sometimes where the improvement was slight, without notice, and sometimes with an account of the reasons of the change.

Conjecture, though it be sometimes unavoidable, I have not wantonly nor licentiously indulged. It has been my settled principle, that the reading of the ancient books is probably true, and therefore is not to be disturbed for the sake of elegance, perspicuity, or mere improvement of the sense. For though much credit is not due to the fidelity, nor any to the judgement of the first publishers, yet they who had the copy before their eyes were more likely to read it right, than we who only read it by imagination. But it is evident that they have often made strange mistakes by ignorance or negligence, and that therefore something may be properly attempted by criticism, keeping the middle way between presumption and timidity.

Such criticism I have attempted to practise, and where any passage appeared inextricably perplexed, have endeavoured to discover how it may be recalled to sense, with least violence. But my first labour is, always to turn the old text on every side, and try if there be any interstice, through which light can find its way; nor would Huetius himself condemn me, as refusing the trouble of research, for the ambition of alteration. In this modest industry I have not been unsuccessful. I have rescued many lines from the violations of temerity, and secured many scenes from the inroads of correction. I have adopted the Roman sentiment, that it is more honourable to save a citizen, than to kill an enemy, and have been more careful to protect than to attack.

I have preserved the common distribution of the plays into acts, though I believe it to be in almost all the plays void of authority. Some

of those which are divided in the later editions have no division in the first folio, and some that are divided in the folio have no division in the preceding copies. The settled mode of the theatre requires four intervals in the play, but few, if any, of our authour's compositions can be properly distributed in that manner. An act is so much of the drama as passes without intervention of time or change of place. A pause makes a new act. In every real, and therefore in every imitative action, the intervals may be more or fewer, the restriction of five acts being accidental and arbitrary. This Shakespeare knew, and this he practised; his plays were written, and at first printed in one unbroken continuity, and ought now to be exhibited with short pauses, interposed as often as the scene is changed, or any considerable time is required to pass. This method would at once quell a thousand absurdities.

In restoring the authour's works to their integrity, I have considered the punctuation as wholly in my power; for what could be their care of colons and commas, who corrupted words and sentences. Whatever could be done by adjusting points is therefore silently performed, in some plays with much diligence, in others with less; it is hard to keep a busy eye steadily fixed upon evanescent atoms, or a discursive mind upon evanescent truth.

The same liberty has been taken with a few particles, or other words of slight effect. I have sometimes inserted or omitted them without notice. I have done that sometimes, which the other editors have done always, and which indeed the state of the text may sufficiently justify.

The greater part of readers, instead of blaming us for passing trifles, will wonder that on mere trifles so much labour is expended, with such importance of debate, and such solemnity of diction. To these I answer with confidence, that they are judging of an art which they do not understand; yet cannot much reproach them with their ignorance, nor promise that they would become in general, by learning criticism, more useful, happier or wiser.

As I practised conjecture more, I learned to trust it less; and after I had printed a few plays, resolved to insert none of my own readings in the text. Upon this caution I now congratulate myself, for every day encreases my doubt of my emendations.

Since I have confined my imagination to the margin, it must not be considered as very reprehensible, if I have suffered it to play some

freaks in its own dominion. There is no danger in conjecture, if it be proposed as conjecture; and while the text remains uninjured, those changes may be safely offered, which are not considered even by him that offers them as necessary or safe.

If my readings are of little value, they have not been ostentatiously displayed or importunately obtruded. I could have written longer notes, for the art of writing notes is not of difficult attainment. The work is performed, first by railing at the stupidity, negligence, ignorance, and asinine tastelessness of the former editors, and shewing, from all that goes before and all that follows, the inelegance and absurdity of the old reading; then by proposing something, which to superficial readers would seem specious, but which the editor rejects with indignation; then by producing the true reading, with a long paraphrase, and concluding with loud acclamations on the discovery, and a sober wish for the advancement and prosperity of genuine criticism.

All this may be done, and perhaps done sometimes without impropriety. But I have always suspected that the reading is right, which requires many words to prove it wrong; and the emendation wrong, that cannot without so much labour appear to be right. The justness of a happy restoration strikes at once, and the moral precept may be well applied to criticism, *quod dubitas ne feceris*.

To dread the shore which he sees spread with wrecks, is natural to the sailor. I had before my eye, so many critical adventures ended in miscarriage, that caution was forced upon me. I encountered in every page Wit struggling with its own sophistry, and Learning confused by the multiplicity of its views. I was forced to censure those whom I admired, and could not but reflect, while I was dispossessing their emanations, how soon the same fate might happen to my own, and how many of the readings which I have corrected may be some other editor defended and established.

Criticks, I saw, that other's names efface,
And fix their own, with labour, in the place;
Their own, like others, soon their place resign'd,
Or disappear'd, and left the first behind. — Pope.

That a conjectural critick should often be mistaken, cannot be wonderful, either to others or himself, if it be considered that in his art there is no system, no principal and axiomatical truth that regulates subordinate positions. His chance of error is renewed at every at-

tempt; an oblique view of the passage a slight misapprehension of a phrase, a casual inattention to the parts connected, is sufficient to make him not only fail but fail ridiculously; and when he succeeds best, he produces perhaps but one reading of many probable, and he that suggests another will always be able to dispute his claims.

It is an unhappy state, in which danger is hid under pleasure. The allurements of emendation are scarcely resistible. Conjecture has all the joy and all the pride of invention, and he that has once started a happy change, is too much delighted to consider what objections may rise against it.

Yet conjectural criticism has been of great use in the learned world; nor is it my intention to depreciate a study, that has exercised so many mighty minds, from the revival of learning to our own age, from the Bishop of Aleria to English Bentley. The criticks on ancient authours have, in the exercise of their sagacity, many assistances, which the editor of Shakespeare is condemned to want. They are employed upon grammatical and settled languages, whose construction contributes so much to perspicuity, that Homer has fewer passages unintelligible than Chaucer. The words have not only a known regimen, but invariable quantities, which direct and confine the choice. There are commonly more manuscripts than one; and they do not often conspire in the same mistakes. Yet Scaliger could confess to Salmasius how little satisfaction his emendations gave him. *Illudunt nobis conjecturae nostrae, quarum nos pudet, posteaquam in meliores cofices incidimus.* And Lipsius could complain, that criticks were making faults, by trying to remove them, *Ut olim vitiis, ita nunc remediis laboratur.* And indeed, where mere conjecture is to be used, the emendations of Scaliger and Lipsius, notwithstanding their wonderful sagacity and erudition, are often vague and disputable, like mine or Theobald's.

Perhaps I may not be more censured for doing wrong, than for doing little; for raising in the publick expectations, which at last I have not answered. The expectation of ignorance is indefinite, and that of knowledge is often tyrannical. It is hard to satisfy those who know not what to demand, or those who demand by design what they think impossible to be done. I have indeed disappointed no opinion more than my own; yet I have endeavoured to perform my task with no slight solicitude. Not a single passage in the whole work has appeared to me corrupt, which I have not attempted to restore;

or obscure, which I have not endeavoured to illustrate. In many I have failed like others; and from many, after all my efforts, I have retreated, and confessed the repulse. I have not passed over, with affected superiority, what is equally difficult to the reader and to myself, but where I could not instruct him, have owned my ignorance. I might easily have accumulated a mass of seeming learning upon easy scenes; but it ought not to be imputed to negligence, that, where nothing was necessary, nothing has been done, or that, where others have said enough, I have said no more.

Notes are often necessary, but they are necessary evils. Let him, that is yet unacquainted with the powers of Shakespeare, and who desires to feel the highest pleasure that the drama can give, read every play from the first scene to the last, with utter negligence of all his commentators. When his fancy is once on the wing, let it not stoop at correction or explanation. When his attention is strongly engaged, let it disdain alike to turn aside to the name of Theobald and Pope. Let him read on through brightness and obscurity, through integrity and corruption; let him preserve his comprehension of the dialogue and his interest in the fable. And when the pleasures of novelty have ceased, let him attempt exactness; and read the commentators.

Particular passages are cleared by notes, but the general effect of the work is weakened. The mind is refrigerated by interruption; the thoughts are diverted from the principal subject; the reader is weary, he suspects not why; and at last throws away the book, which he has too diligently studied.

Parts are not to be examined till the whole has been surveyed; there is a kind of intellectual remoteness necessary for the comprehension of any great work in its full design and its true proportions; a close approach shews the smaller niceties, but the beauty of the whole is discerned no longer.

It is not very grateful to consider how little the succession of editors has added to this authour's power of pleasing. He was read, admired, studied, and imitated, while he was yet deformed with all the improprieties which ignorance and neglect could accumulate upon him; while the reading was yet not rectified, nor his allusions understood; yet then did Dryden pronounce "that Shakespeare was the man, who, of all modern and perhaps ancient poets, had the largest and most comprehensive soul. All the images of nature were still present to him, and he drew them not laboriously, but luckily: When

he describes any thing, you more than see it, you feel it too. Those who accuse him to have wanted learning, give him the greater commendation: he was naturally learned: he needed not the spectacles of books to read nature; he looked inwards, and found her there. I cannot say he is every where alike; were he so, I should do him injury to compare him with the greatest of mankind. He is many times flat and insipid; his comick wit degenerating into clenches, his serious swelling into bombast. But he is always great, when some great occasion is presented to him: No man can say, he ever had a fit subject for his wit, and did not then raise himself as high above the rest of poets,

"Quantum lenta solent inter viburna cupressi."

It is to be lamented, that such a writer should want a commentary; that his language should become obsolete, or his sentiments obscure. But it is vain to carry wishes beyond the condition of human things; that which must happen to all, has happened to Shakespeare, by accident and time; and more than has been suffered by any other writer since the use of types, has been suffered by him through his own negligence of fame, or perhaps by that superiority of mind, which despised its own performances, when it compared them with its powers, and judged those works unworthy to be preserved, which the criticks of following ages were to contend for the fame of restoring and explaining.

Among these candidates of inferiour fame, I am now to stand the judgment of the publick; and wish that I could confidently produce my commentary as equal to the encouragement which I have had the honour of receiving. Every work of this kind is by its nature deficient, and I should feel little solicitude about the sentence, were it to be pronounced only by the skilful and the learned.

THE TEMPEST

I.i (4,2) [*Enter a Ship-master and a Boatswain*] In this naval dialogue, perhaps the first example of sailor's language exhibited on the stage, there are, as I have been told by a skilful narrator, some inaccuracies and contradictory orders.

I.i.8 (4,4) [blow, till thou burst thy wind, if room enough] Perhaps it might be read,—*blow till thou burst, wind, if room enough*.

I.i.30 (5,5) It may be observed of Gonzalo, that, being the only good man that appears with the king, he is the only man that preserves his cheerfulness in the wreck, and his hope on the island.

I.i.52 (6,7) [set her two courses; off to sea again] The courses are the main-sail and fore-sail. This term is used by Raleigh, in his *Discourse on Shipping*.

I.i.63 (6,9)

[He'll be hang'd yet;
Though every drop of water swear against it,
And gape at wid'st to glut him.]

Shakespeare probably wrote, *t'englut him, to swallow him*; for which I know not that *glut* is ever used by him. In this signification *englut*, from *engloutir*, French, occurs frequently, as in *Henry VI*.

"—Thou art so near the gulf

Thou needs must be *englutted*."

And again in *Timon* and *Othello*. Yet Milton writes *glutted offal* for *swallowed*, and therefore perhaps the present text may stand.

I.i.65 (7,1) [Farewell, brother!] All these lines have been hitherto given to Gonzalo, who has no brother in the ship. It is probable that the lines succeeding the *confused noise within* should be considered as spoken by no determinate characters, but should be printed thus.

1 *Sailor*. Mercy on us! We split, we split!

2 *Sailor*. Farewell, my, &c.

3 *Sailor*. Brother, farewell, &c. (see 1765, I,6,6)

I.ii.15 (8,3) [*Mira*. O, woe the day! *Pro*. No harm, I have done nothing but in care of thee] I know not whether Shakespeare did not make Miranda speak thus:

O, woe the day! no harm?

To which Prospero properly answers:

I have done nothing but in care of thee. Miranda, when he speaks the words, *O, woe the day!* supposes, not that the crew had escaped, but that her father thought differently from her, and counted their destruction *no harm*.

I.ii.27 (8,4) [virtue of compassion] Virtue; the most efficacious part, the energetic quality; in a like sense we say, *The virtue of a plant is in the extract*.

I.ii.29 (8,5)

[I have with such provision in mine art
So safely order'd, that there is no soul—
No, not so much perdition as an hair,
Betid to any creature in the vessel]

Thus the old editions read, but this is apparently defective. Mr. Rowe, and after him Dr. Warburton, read *that there is no soul lost*, without any notice of the variation. Mr. Theobald substitutes *no foil*, and Mr. Pope follows him. To come so near the right, and yet to miss it, is unlucky: the author probably wrote *no soil*, no stain, no spot: for so Ariel tells,

Not a hair perish'd; On their sustaining garments not a blemish, But fresher than before.

And Gonzalo, *The rarity of it is, that our garments being drench'd in the sea, keep notwithstanding their freshness and glosses*. Of this emendation I find that the author of notes on *The Tempest* had a glimpse, but could not keep it.

I.ii.58 (10,7) [and thy father Was duke of Milan, thou his only heir] Perhaps—and thou *his only heir*.

I.ii.83 (11,1)

[having both the key Of officer and office, set all hearts i' the state
To what tune pleas'd his ear]

Key in this place seems to signify the key of a musical instrument, by which he set *Hearts to tune*.

I.ii.93 (11,2) [and my trust,*Like a good parent, did beget of him* A falsehood] Alluding to the observation, that a father above the common rate of men has commonly a son below it. *Heroum filii noxae*.

I.ii.155 (14,6) [deck'd the sea] *To deck the sea*, if explained, to honour, adorn, or dignify, is indeed ridiculous, but the original import of the verb *deck* is, *to cover*; so in some parts they yet say *deck the table*. This sense may be borne, but perhaps the poet wrote *fleck'd*, which I think is still used in rustic language of drops falling upon water. Dr. Warburton reads *mock'd*, the Oxford edition *brack'd*. (see 1765, I,13,5)

I.ii.185 (15,8) [Thou art inclin'd to sleep: 'tis a good dulness] Dr. Warburton rightly observes, that this sleepiness, which Prospero by his art had brought upon Miranda, and of which he knew not how soon the effect would begin, makes him question her so often whether she is attentive to his story.

I.ii.196 (16,1) [I boarded the king's ship: now on the beak] The beak was a strong pointed body at the head of the ancient gallies; it is used here for the fore-castle, or the bolt-sprit.

I.ii.197 (16,2) [Now in the waste] The part between the quarter-deck and the fore-castle.

I.ii.209 (16,3) [Not a soul *But felt a fever of the mad*] In all the later editions this is changed to a *fever of the mind*, without reason or authority, nor is any notice given of an alteration.

I.ii.218 (17,4) [*On their sustaining garments not a blemish* Thomas Edwards' MSS: sea-stained] This note of Mr. Edwards, with which I suppose no reader is satisfied, shews with how much greater ease critical emendations are destroyed than made, and how willingly every man would be changing the text, if his imagination would furnish alterations. (1773)

I.ii.239 (19,7) [What is the time o' the day?] This passage needs not be disturbed, it being common to ask a question, which the next moment enables us to answer; he that thinks it faulty may easily adjust it thus:

Pro. *What is the time o' the day? Past the mid season.*

Ari. *At least two glasses.*

Pro. *The time 'twixt six and now—*

I.ii.250 (19,8) [*Pro.* Dost thou forget *From what a torment I did free thee?*] That the character and conduct of Prospero may be understood, something must be known of the system of enchantment, which supplied all the marvellous found in the romances of the middle ages. This system seems to be founded on the opinion that the fallen spirits, having different degrees of guilt, had different habitations allotted them at their expulsion, some being confined in hell, *some* (as Hooker, who delivers the opinion of our poet's age, expresses it) *dispersed in air, some on earth, some in water, others in caves, dens, or minerals under the earth.* Of these, some were more malignant and mischievous than others. The earthy spirits seem to have been thought the most depraved, and the aerial the least vitiated. Thus Prospero observes of Ariel:

—*Thou wast a spirit too delicate To act her earthy and abhorr'd commands.*

Over these spirits a power might be obtained by certain rites performed or charms learned. This power was called *The Black Art*, or *Knowledge of Enchantment*. The enchanter being (as king James observes in his *Demonology*) *one who commands the devil, whereas the witch serves him.* Those who thought best of this art, the existence of which was, I am afraid, believed very seriously, held, that certain sounds and characters had a physical power over spirits, and compelled their agency; others who condemned the practice, which in reality was surely never practised, were of opinion, with more reason, that the power of charms arose *only* from compact, and was no more than the spirits voluntary allowed them for the seduction of man. The art was held by all, though not equally criminal, yet unlawful, and therefore Causabon, speaking of one who had commerce with spirits, blames him, though he imagines him *one of the best kind who dealt with them by way of command.* Thus Prospero repents of his art in the last scene. The spirits were always considered as in some measure enslaved to the enchanter, at least for a time, and as serving with unwillingness, therefore Ariel so often begs for liberty; and Caliban observes, that the spirits serve Prospero with no good will, but *hate him rootedly.*—Of these trifles enough.

I.ii.306 (22,1) [*Mira.* The strangeness of your story put *Heaviness in me.*] Why should a wonderful story produce sleep? I believe experience will prove, that any violent agitation of the mind easily subsides

in slumber, especially when, as in Prospero's relation, the last images are pleasing.

I.ii.321 (23,2)

[As wicked dew, as e'er my mother brush'd
With raven's feather from unwholsome fen,
Drop on you both!]

[Some critics, Bentley among them, had spoken of Caliban's new language.] Whence these critics derived the notion of a new language appropriated to Caliban, I cannot find: they certainly mistook brutality of sentiment for uncouthness of words. Caliban had learned to speak of Prospero and his daughter, he had no names for the sun and moon before their arrival, and could not have invented a language of his own without more understanding than Shakespeare has thought it proper to bestow upon him. His diction is indeed somewhat clouded by the gloominess of his temper, and the malignity of his purposes; but let any other being entertain the same thoughts, and he will find them easily issue in the same expressions.

[*As wicked dew*,] — *Wicked*; having baneful qualities. So Spenser says, *wicked weed*; so, in opposition, we say herbs or medicines have *virtues*. Bacon mentions *virtuous Bezoar*, and Dryden *virtuous herbs*.

I.ii.351 (25,4) [Abhorred slave] This speech, which the old copy gives to Miranda, is very judiciously bestowed by Mr. Theobald on Prospero.

I.ii.364 (27,7) [the red plague] I suppose from the redness of the body universally inflamed.

I.ii.396 (28,9) [Full fathom five thy father lies] [Charles Gildon had criticized the song as trifling, and Warburton had defended its dramatic propriety.] I know not whether Dr. Warburton has very successfully defended these songs from Gildon's accusation. Ariel's lays, however seasonable and efficacious, must be allowed to be of no supernatural dignity or elegance, they express nothing great, nor reveal any thing above mortal discovery.

The reason for which Ariel is introduced thus trifling is, that he and his companions are evidently of the fairy kind, an order of beings to which tradition has always ascribed a sort of diminutive agency, powerful but ludicrous, a humorous and frolick controlment of nature, well expressed by the songs of Ariel.

I.ii.425 (31,3)

[Fer. my prime request,
Which I do last pronounce, is, O you wonder!
If you be maid, or no?
Mira. No wonder, Sir;
But, certainly, a maid.]

[Nothing could be more prettily imagined to illustrate the singularity of her character, than this pleasant mistake. W.] Dr. Warburton has here found a beauty, which I think the author never intended. Ferdinand asks her not whether she was a *created being*, a question which, if he meant it, he has ill expressed, but whether she was unmarried; for after the dialogue which Prospero's interruption produces, he goes on pursuing his former question.

O, if a virgin, I'll make you queen of Naples.

I.ii.439 (32,5) [controul thee] Confute thee, unanswerably contradict thee.

I.ii.471 (33,7) [come from thy ward] Desist from any hope of awing me by that posture of defence.

II.i.3 (36,1) [our hint of woe] *Hint* is that which recals to the memory. The cause that fills our minds with grief is common. Dr. Warburton reads *stint* of woe.

II.i.11 (36,3) [*Ant.* The visitor will not give him o'er so] Why Dr. Warburton should change *visitor* to '*vizer* for *adviser*, I cannot discover. Gonzalo gives not only advice, but comfort, and is therefore properly called *The Visitor*, like others who visit the sick or distressed to give them consolation. In some of the Protestant churches there is a kind of officers termed consolators for the sick.

II.i.78 (38,6) [Widow Dido!] The name of a widow brings to their minds their own shipwreck, which they consider as having made many widows in Naples.

II.i.132 (39,7)

[Milan and Naples have
More widows in them of this business' making,
Than we bring men to comfort them]

It does not clearly appear whether the king and these lords thought the ship lost. This passage seems to imply, that they were themselves

confident of returning, but imagined part of the fleet destroyed. Why, indeed, should Sebastian plot against his brother in the following scene, unless he knew how to find the kingdom which he was to inherit?

II.i.232 (43,1) [this lord of weak remembrance] This lord, who, being now in his dotage, has outlived his faculty of remembering; and who, once laid in the ground, shall be as little remembered himself, as he can now remember other things.

II.i.235 (43,2)

[For he's a spirit of persuasion, only
Professes to persuade the king his son's alive]

Of this entangled sentence I can draw no sense from the present reading, and therefore imagine that the author gave it thus:

*For he, a spirit of persuasion, only
Professes to persuade.*

Of which the meaning may be either, that *he alone, who is a spirit of persuasion, professes to persuade the king*; or that, *He only professes to persuade, that is, without being so persuaded himself, he makes a show of persuading the king.*

II.i.242 (44,3) [Ambition cannot pierce a wink beyond] That this is the utmost extent of the prospect of ambition, the point where the eye can pass no further, and where objects lose their distinctness, so that what is there discovered, is faint, obscure, and doubtful. (rev. 1778, I,50,4)

II.i.251 (44,5)

[though some cast again;
And, by that destiny, to perform an act,
Whereof what's past is prologue; what to come,
In yours, and my discharge.]
These lines stand in the old edition thus:

*—though some cast again;
And, by that destiny, to perform an act,
Whereof what's past, is prologue; what to come,
In your and my discharge.*

The reading in the later editions is without authority. The old text may very well stand, except that in the last line *in* should be *is*. and

perhaps we might better say — *and that by destiny*. It being a common plea of wickedness to call temptation destiny.

II.i.259 (45,6) [Keep in Tunis] There is in this passage a propriety lost, which a slight alteration will restore:

—Sleep *in Tunis*,
And let Sebastian wake!

II.i.278 (45,7) [Twenty consciences, That stand 'twixt me and Milan, candy'd be they, Or melt e'er they molest] I had rather read,

Would melt e'er they molest.

i.e. *Twenty consciences, such as stand between me and my hopes, though they were congealed, would melt before they could molest one, or prevent the execution of my purposes.* (see 1765, I,40,7)

II.i.286 (46,8) [This ancient morsel] For *morsel* Dr. Warburton reads *ancient moral*, very elegantly and judiciously, yet I know not whether the author might not write *morsel*, as we say a *piece of a man*.

II.i.288 (46,9) [take suggestion] i.e. Receive any hint of villainy, (1773)

II.i.297 (46,1)

[*Ari*. My master through his art foresees the danger, That you, his friend, are in; and sends me forth (For else his project dies) to keep them living]

[i.e. Alonzo and Antonio; for it was on their lives that his project depended. Yet the Oxford Editor alters *them* to *you*, because in the verse before, it is said—*you his friend*; as if, because Ariel was *sent forth to save his friend*, he could not have another purpose in sending him, viz. to *save his project* too. W.]

I think Dr. Warburton and the Oxford Editor both mistaken. The sense of the passage, as it now stands, is this: He sees *your* danger, and will therefore save *them*. Dr. Warburton has mistaken Antonio for Gonzalo. Ariel would certainly not tell Gonzalo, that his master saved him only for his project. He speaks to himself as he approaches,

My master through his art foresees the danger
That these his friends are in.

These written with a *y*, according to the old practice, did not much differ from *you*.

II.i.308 (47,2) [Why are you drawn?] Having your swords drawn. So in *Romeo and Juliet*:

"What art thou *drawn* among these heartless hinds?"

II.ii.12 (48,3) [sometime am I All wound with adders] Enwrapped by adders *wound* or twisted about me.

II.ii.32 (49,5) [make a man] That is, make a man's fortune. So in *Midsummer Night's Dream*—"we are all *made men*."

II.ii.176 (54,5) [I'll get thee Young scamels from the rock] This word has puzzled the commentators: Dr. Warburton reads *shamois*. Mr. Theobald would read any thing rather than *scamels*. Mr. Holt, who wrote notes upon this play, observes, that limpets are in some places called *scams*, therefore I have suffered *scamels* to stand.

III.i.48 (58,8) [Of every creature's best] Alluding to the picture of Venus by Apelles.

III.ii.71 (62,5) [What a py'd ninny's this?] This line should certainly be given to Stephano. *Py'd ninny* alludes to the striped coat worn by fools, of which Caliban could have no knowledge. Trinculo had before been reprimanded and threatened by Stephano for giving Caliban the lie, he is now supposed to repeat his offence. Upon which Stephano cries out,

What a py'd ninny's this? Thou scurvy patch!—

Caliban, now seeing his master in the mood that he wished, instigates him to vengeance:

I do beseech thy greatness, give him blows.

III.iii.48 (67,2) [Each putter out on five for one] This passage alluding to a forgotten custom is very obscure: the *putter out* must be a traveller, else how could he give this account? the *five for one* is money to be received by him at his return, Mr. Theobald has well illustrated this passage by a quotation from Jonson.

III.iii.82 (69,3) [clear life] Pure, blameless, innocent.

III.iii.86 (69,4)

[so with good life, And observation strange, my meaner ministers
Their several kinds have done]

This seems a corruption. I know not in what sense *life* can here be used, unless for alacrity, liveliness, vigour, and in this sense the

expression is harsh. Perhaps we may read, — *with good* lift, with good will, with sincere zeal for my service. I should have proposed, — *with good* lief, in the same sense, but that I cannot find *lief* to be a substantive. *With good life* may however mean, with *exact presentation of their several characters, with observation strange* of their particular and distinct parts. So we say, he acted to the *life*. (see 1765, I,60,4)

III.iii.99 (70,5) [bass my trespass] The deep pipe told it me in a rough bass sound.

IV.i.2 (71,7) [for I Have given you here a third of mine own life] [Theobald had argued that Miranda was at least half of Prospero's life and had emended.] In consequence of this ratiocination Mr. Theobald printed the text, *a thread of my own life*. I have restored the ancient reading. Prospero, in his reason subjoined why he calls her the *third* of his life, seems to allude to some logical distinction of causes, making her the final cause.

IV.i.7 (71,8) [strangely stood the test] Strangely is used by way of commendation, *merveilleusement, to a wonder*; the sense is the same in the foregoing scene, with *observation strange*.

IV.i.37 (72,1) [the rabble] The crew of meaner spirits.

IV.i.59 (73,4) [No tongue] Those who are present at incantations are obliged to be strictly silent, "else," as we are afterwards told, "the spell is marred."

IV.i.166 (80,4) [We must prepare to meet with Caliban] *To meet with* is to counteract; to play stratagem against stratagem. — *The parson knows the temper of every one in his house, and accordingly either meets with their vices, or advances their virtues.*

HERBERT'S *Country Parson*.

IV.i.178 (80,5)

[so I charm'd their ears,
That, calf-like, they my loving follow'd through
Tooth'd briars, sharp furzes, pricking goss, and thorns,
Which enter'd their frail shins]
Thus Drayton, in his *Court of Fairie of Hobgoblin caught in a Spell*:
"But once the circle got within,
"The charms to work do straight begin,

"And he was caught as in a gin:
 "For as be thus was busy,
 "A pain he in his head-piece feels,
 "Against a stubbed tree he reels,
 "And up went poor Hobgoblin's heels:
 "Alas, his brain was dizzy.
 "At length upon his feet he gets,
 "Hobgoblin fumes, Hobgoblin frets;
 "And as again he forward sets,
 "And through the bushes scrambles,
 "A stump doth hit him in his pace,
 "Down comes poor Hob upon his face,
 "And lamentably tore his case
 "Among the briers and brambles."

IV.i.196 (81,7) [your fairy ... has done little better than play'd the Jack with us] Has led us about like an *iguia fatuus*, by which travellers are decoyed into the mire.

IV.i.246 (83,3) [put some lime] That is, *birdlime*.

V.i.102 (90,7) [*Ari*. I drink the air before me] Is an expression of swiftness of the same kind as *to devour the way* in *Henry IV*.

V.i.144 (92,1)

[*Alon*. You the like loss? *Pro*. As great to me, as late;]

My loss is as great as yours, and has as lately happened to me.

V.i.174 (93,2) [Yes, for a score of kingdoms] I take the sense to be only this: Ferdinand would not, he says, play her false for the *world*; yes, answers she, I would allow you to do it for something less than the world, for *twenty kingdoms*, and I wish you well enough to allow you, after a little *wrangle*, that your play was fair. So likewise Dr. Gray.

V.i.213 (94,3) [When no man was his own] For *when* perhaps should be read *where*.

V.i.247 (96,4)

[at pick'd leisure

(Which shall be shortly) single I'll resolve you,

(Which to you shall seem probable) of every

These happen'd accidents]

These words seem, at the first view, to have no use; some lines are perhaps lost with which they were connected. Or we may explain them thus: I will resolve you, by yourself, which method, when you hear the story [of Anthonio's and Sebastian's plot] *shall seem probable*, that is, *shall deserve your approbation*.

V.i.267 (97,5)

[Mark but the badges of these men, my lords,
Then say, if they be true]

That is, *honest*. A *true man* is, in the language of that time, opposed to a thief. The sense is, *Mark what these men wear, and say if they are honest*.

Epilogue.10 (100,7) With the help of your good hands] By your applause, by clapping hands. (1773)

General Observation (100) It is observed of *The Tempest*, that its plan is regular; this the author of *The Revisal* thinks, what I think too, an accidental effect of the story, not intended or regarded by our author. But whatever might be Shakespeare's intention in forming or adopting the plot, he has made it instrumental to the production of many characters, diversified with boundless invention, and preserved with profound skill in nature, extensive knowledge of opinions, and accurate observation of life. In a single drama are here exhibited princes, courtiers, and sailors, all speaking in their real characters. There is the agency of airy spirits, and of an earthly goblin. The operation of magick, the tumults of a storm, the adventures of a desert island, the native effusion of untaught affection, the punishment of guilt, and the final happiness of the pair for whom our passions and reason are equally interested. (1773)

THE TWO GENTLEMEN OF VERONA

It is observable (I know not for what cause) that the stile of this comedy is less figurative, and more natural and unaffected than the greater part of this author's, though supposed to be one of the first he wrote. [Pope.] To this observation of Mr. Pope, which is very just, Mr. Theobald has added, that this is one of Shakespeare's *worst plays, and is less corrupted than any other*. Mr. Upton peremptorily determines, *that if any proof can be drawn from manner and stile, this play must be sent packing, and seek for its parent elsewhere*. How otherwise, says he, *do painters distinguish copies from originals, and have not authors their peculiar stile and manner from which a true critic can form as unerring judgment as a painter?* I am afraid this illustration of a critic's science will not prove what is desired. A painter knows a copy from an original by rules somewhat resembling these by which critics know a translation, which if it be literal, and literal it must be to resemble the copy of a picture, will be easily distinguished. Copies are known from originals, even when the painter copies his own picture; so if an author should literally translate his work, he would lose the manner of an original.

Mr. Upton confounds the copy of a picture with the imitation of a painter's manner. Copies are easily known, but good imitations are not detected with equal certainty, and are, by the best judges, often mistaken. Nor is it true that the writer has always peculiarities equally distinguishable with those of the painter. The peculiar manner of each arises from the desire, natural to every performer, of facilitating his subsequent works by recurrence to his former ideas; this recurrence produces that repetition which is called habit. The painter, whose work is partly intellectual and partly manual, has habits of the mind, the eye and the hand, the writer has only habits of the mind. Yet, some painters have differed as much from themselves as from any other; and I have been told, that there is little resemblance between the first works of Raphael and the last. The same variation may be expected in writers; and if it be true, as it seems, that they are less subject to habit, the difference between their works may be yet greater.

But by the internal marks of a composition we may discover the author with probability, though seldom with certainty. When I read this play, I cannot but think that I find, both in the serious and ludi-

crous scenes, the language and sentiments of Shakespeare. It is not indeed one of his most powerful effusions, it has neither many diversities of character, nor striking delineations of life, but it abounds in [Greek: gnomai] beyond most of his plays, and few have more lines or passages, which, singly considered, are eminently beautiful. I am yet inclined to believe that it was not very successful, and suspect that it has escaped corruption, only because being seldom played, it was less exposed to the hazards of transcription.

I.i.34 (108,6)

[However, but a folly bought with wit;
Or else a wit by folly vanquished]

This love will end in a *foolish action*, to produce which you are long to spend your *wit*, or it will end in the loss of your *wit*, which will be overpowered by the folly of love.

I.i.69 (109,7) [Made wit with musing weak] For *made* read *make*. *Thou, Julia, hast made me war with good counsel, and make wit weak with musing.*

I.i.70 (109,8) [*Enter Speed*] [Pope found this scene low and full of "trifling conceits" and suggested it was possibly an interpolation by the actors.] That this, like many other scenes, is mean and vulgar, will be universally allowed; but that it was interpolated by the players seems advanced without any proof, only to give a greater licence to criticism.

I.i.153 (112,4) [you have testern'd me] You have gratified me with a *tester*, *testern*, or *testen*, that is, with a sixpence.

I.ii.41 (114,5) [a goodly broker!] A *broker* was used for matchmaker, sometimes for a procuress.

I.ii.68 (115,6) [stomach on your meat] *Stomach* was used for *passion* or *obstinacy*.

I.ii.137 (117,8) [I see you have a month's mind to them] [*A month's mind* was an *anniversary* in times of popery. Gray.] A *month's mind*, in the ritual sense, signifies not desire or inclination, but remonstrance; yet I suppose this is the true original of the expression. (1773) I.iii.1 (118,9) [what sad talk] *Sad* is the same as *grave* or *serious*.

I.iii.26 (119,2) [Valentine, Attends the emperor in his royal court] [Theobald had tried to straighten out an historical error.] Mr. Theobald discovers not any great skill in history. Vienna is not the court of the emperor as emperor, nor has Milan been always without its princes since the days of Charlemagne; but the note has its use.

I.iii.44 (120,3) [in good time] *In good time* was the old expression when something happened which suited the thing in hand, as the French say, *a propos*.

I.iii.84 (121,4) [Oh, how this spring of love resembleth] At the end of this verse there is wanting a syllable, for the speech apparently ends in a quatrain. I find nothing that will rhyme to *sun*, and therefore shall leave it to some happier critic. But I suspect that the author might write thus:

*Oh, how this spring of love resembleth right,
The uncertain glory of an April day;
Which now shews all the glory of the light,
And, by and by, a cloud takes all away.*

Light was either by negligence or affectation changed to *sun*, which, considered without the rhyme, is indeed better. The next transcriber, finding that the word *right* did not rhyme to *sun*, supposed it erroneously written, and left it out.

II.i.27 (123,1) [Hallowmas] That is, about the feast of All-Saints, when winter begins, and the life of a vagrant becomes less comfortable.

II.i.39 (123,2) [without you were so simple, none else would] None else would *be so simple*.

II.i.148 (127,5) [reasoning with yourself?] That is, *discoursing, talking*. An Italianism.

II.iii.22 (129,2) [I am the dog] This passage is much confused, and of confusion the present reading makes no end. Sir T. Hammer reads, *I am the dog, no, the dog is himself and I am me, the dog is the dog, and I am myself*. This certainly is more reasonable, but I know not how much reason the author intended to bestow on Launce's soliloquy.

II.iv.57 (133,1) [not without desert] And not dignified with so much reputation without proportionate merit.

II.iv.115 (134,2) [No: that you are worthless] I have inserted the particle *no* to fill up the measure.

II.iv.129 (135,4)

[I have done penance for contemning love;
Whose high imperious thoughts have punish'd me
With bitter fasts, with penitential groans]

For *whose* I read *those*. I have contemned love and am punished. *Those* high thoughts by which I exalted myself above human passions or frailties have brought upon me fasts and groans.

II.iv.138 (136,5) [no woe to his correction] No misery that *can be compared to* the punishment inflicted by love. Herbert called for the prayers of the liturgy a little before his death, saying, *None to them, none to them*.

II.iv.152 (136,6) [a principality] The first or *principal* of women. So the old writers use *state*. *She is a lady, a great state*. Latymer. *This look is called in states warlike, in others otherwise*. Sir T. More.

II.iv.167 (137,8) [She is alone] She stands by herself. There is none to be compared to her.

II.iv.207 (138,1) [with more advice] With more prudence, with more discretion.

II.iv.209 (138,2) ['Tis but her picture I have yet beheld] This is evidently a slip of attention, for he had seen her in the last scene, and in high terms offered her his service.

II.v.28 (139,4) [My staff understands me] This equivocation, miserable as it is, has been admitted by Milton in his great poem. B. VI.

" — — The terms we sent were terms of weight,
"Such as we may perceive, amaz'd them all,
"And stagger'd many who receives them right,
"Had need from head to foot well *understand*,
"Not *understood*, this gift they have besides,
"To shew us when our foes stand not upright."

II.vi (141,5) [Enter Protheus] It is to be observed, that in the first folio edition, the only edition of authority, there are no directions concerning the scenes; they have been added by the later editors, and may

therefore be changed by any reader that can give more consistency or regularity to the drama by such alterations. I make this remark in this place, because I know not whether the following soliloquy of Protheus is so proper in the street.

II.vi.7 (141,6) [O sweet-suggesting love] To *suggest* is to *tempt* in our author's language. So again:

"Knowing that tender youth is soon *suggested*."

The sense is, O tempting love, *if thou hast* influenced me to sin, *teach me to excuse it*. Dr. Warburton reads, *if I have sinn'd*; but, I think, not only without necessity, but with less elegance.

II.vi.35 (142,7) [Myself in counsel, his competitor] *Myself, who am his competitor or rival*, being admitted to his counsel.

II.vi.37 (142,8) [pretended flight] We may read *intended flight*.

II.vi.43 (142,9) [Love, lend me wings to make my purpose swift, As thou hast lent me wit to plot this drift!] I suspect that the author concluded the act with this couplet, and that the next scene should begin the third act; but the change, as it will add nothing to the probability of the action, is of no great importance.

III.i.45 (146,1) [be not aimed at] Be not *guessed*.

III.i.47 (147,2) [of this pretence] Of this *claim* made to your daughter.

III.i.86 (148,4) [the fashion of the time] The modes of courtship, the acts by which men recommended themselves to ladies.

III.i.148 (150,5) [for they are sent by me] *For* is the same as *for that, since*.

III.i.153 (150,6) [why, Phaeton (for thou art Merops' son)] Thou art Phaeton in thy rashness, but without his pretensions; thou art not the son of a divinity, but a *terrae filius*, a low born wretch; Merops is thy true father, with whom Phaeton was falsely reproached.

III.i.185 (151,7) [I fly not death, to fly his deadly doom] *To fly his doom*, used for *by flying*, or *in flying*, is a gallicism. The sense is, By avoiding the execution of his sentence I shall not escape death. If I stay here, I suffer myself to be destroyed; if I go away, I destroy myself.

III.i.261 (153,8) [*Laun.* I am but a fool, look you; and yet I have the wit to think my master is a kind of a knave: but that's all one, if he be but one knave] [W: but one kind] This alteration is acute and specious, yet I know not whether, in Shakespeare's language, *one knave* may not signify a *knave on only one occasion, a single knave*. We still use a *double villain* for a villain beyond the common rate of guilt.

III.i.265 (154,9) [a team of horse shall not pluck] I see how Valentine suffers for telling his love-secrets, therefore I will keep mine close.

III.i.330 (156,4) [*Speed. Item, she hath a. sweet mouth*] This I take to be the same with what is now vulgarly called a *sweet tooth*, a luxurious desire of dainties and sweetmeats.

III.i.351 (157,5) [*Speed. Item, she will often praise her liquor*]
That is, shew how well she likes it by drinking often.

III.i.355 (157,6) [*Speed. Item, she is too liberal*] *Liberal*, is licentious and gross in language. So in *Othello*, "Is he not a profane and very *liberal* counsellor."

III.ii.7 (158,8) [Trenched in ice] Cut, carved in ice. *Trencher*, to cut, French.

III.ii.36 (159,9) [with circumstance] With the addition of such incidental particulars as may induce belief.

III.ii.51 (160,1)

[Therefore as you unwind her love from him,
Lest it should ravel, and be good to none,
You must provide to bottom it on me]

As you wind off her love from him, make me the *bottom* on which you wind it. The housewife's term for a ball of thread wound upon a central body, is a *bottom of thread*.

III.ii.68 (160,2) [lime] That is, *birdlime*.

III.ii.98 (161,4) [*Duke.* Even now about it. I will pardon you]
I will excuse you from waiting.

IV.i.36 (163,2) [By the bare scalp of Robin Hood's fat friar] *Robin Hood* was captain of a band of robbers, and was much inclined to rob churchmen.

IV.i.46 (163,3) [awful men] Reverend, worshipful, such as magistrates, and other principal members of civil communities.

IV.ii.12 (165,1) [sudden quips] That is, hasty passionate reproaches and scoffs. So Macbeth is in a kindred sense said to be *sudden*; that is, irascible and impetuous.

IV.ii.45 (166,2) [*For beauty lives with kindness*] Beauty without kindness *dies* unenjoyed, and undelighting.

IV.ii.93 (168,4) [You have your wish; my will is even this] The word *will* is here ambiguous. He wishes to *gain* her *will*; she tells him, if he wants her *will* he has it.

IV.ii.130 (169,5) [But, since your falsehood shall become you well]
This is hardly sense. We may read, with very little alteration,
But since *you're false*, it shall become you well.

IV.iii.37 (171,2) [Madam, I pity much your grievances] Sorrows, sorrowful affections.

IV.iv.13 (172,1) [I would have, as one should say, one that takes upon him to be a dog indeed, to be, as it were, a dog at all things] I believe we should read, *I would have*. &c. *one that takes upon him to be a dog*, to be a dog *indeed*, to be, &c.

IV.iv.79 (174,3) [It seems, you lov'd not her, to leave her token] Protheus does not properly leave his lady's token, he gives it away. The old edition has it,

It seems you lov'd her not, *not* leave her token.

I should correct it thus,

It seems you lov'd her not, *nor love* her token.

IV.iv.106 (175,4) [To carry that which I would have refus'd] The sense is, To go and present that which I wish to be not accepted, to praise him whom I wish to be dispraised.

IV.iv.159 (176,5)

[The air hath starv'd the roses in her cheeks,

And pinch'd the lily-tincture of her face.

That now she is become as black as I]

[W: And pitch'd] This is no emendation; none ever heard of a face being *pitched* by the weather. The colour of a part *pinched*, is livid, as it is commonly termed, *black and blue*. The weather may therefore be

justly said to *pinch* when it produces the same visible effect. I believe this is the reason why the cold is said to *pinch*.

IV.iv.198 (179,2) [her forehead's low] A high forehead was in our author's time accounted a feature eminently beautiful. So in *The History of Guy of Warwick*, Felice his lady is said to have *the same high forehead as Venus*.

IV.iv.206 (179,3) [My substance should be statue in thy stead] [W: statued] *Statued* is, I am afraid, a new word, and that it should be received, is not quite evident.

Vi.i.12 (180,4) [sure enough] *Sure* is safe, out of danger.

V.iv.71 (185,1) [The private wound is deepest. Oh time, most curst!]

I have a little mended the measure. The old edition, and all but Sir T. Hammer, read,
The private wound is deepest, oh time most accurst.

V.iv.106 (187,4) [if shame live In a disguise of love] That is, *if it be any shame to wear a disguise for the purposes of love*.

V.iv.126 (187,5) [Come not within the measure of my wrath] The length of my sword, the reach of my anger.

General Observation (189,8) In this play there is a strange mixture of knowledge and ignorance, of care and negligence. The versification is often excellent, the allusions are learned and just; but the author conveys his heroes by sea from one inland town to another in the same country; he places the emperor at Milan, and sends his young men to attend him, but never mentions him more; he makes Protheus, after an interview with Silvia, say he has only seen her picture; and, if we may credit the old copies, he has, by mistaking places, left his scenery inextricable. The reason of all this confusion seems to be, that he took his story from a novel, which he sometimes followed, and sometimes forsook, sometimes remembered, and sometimes forgot.

That this play is rightly attributed to Shakespeare, I have little doubt. If it be taken from him, to whom shall it be given? This question may be asked of all the disputed plays, except *Titus Andronicus*; and it will be found more credible, that Shakespeare might sometimes sink below his highest flights, than that any other should rise up to his lowest. (see 1765, I,259,5)

THE MERRY WIVES OF WINDSOR

I.i.7 (194,4) [*Custalorum*] This it, I suppose, intended for a corruption of *Custos Rotulorum*. The mistake was hardly designed by the author, who, though he gives Shallow folly enough, makes him rather pedantic than illiterate. If we read:

Shal. *Ay, cousin Slender, and Custos Rotulorum.*

It follows naturally:

Slen. *Ay, and Ratalorum too.*

I.i.22 (194,5) [The luce is the fresh fish; the salt fish is an old coat] I see no consequence in this answer. Perhaps we may read, *the salt fish is not an old coat*. That is, the *fresh fish* is the coat of an ancient family, and the *salt fish* is the coat of a merchant grown rich by trading over the sea.

I.i.115 (198,1) [and broke open my lodge] This probably alludes to some real incident, at that time well known.

I.i.121 (198,2) ['Twere better for you, if 'twere not known in council; you'll be laugh'd at] The old copies read, *'Twere better for you, if 'twere known in council*. Perhaps it is an abrupt speech, and must be read thus: *'Twere better for you — if 'twere known in council, you'll be laugh'd at*. *'Twere better for you*, is, I believe, a menace.(1773)

I.i.127 (199,3) [coney-catching rascals] A *coney-catcher* was, in the time of Elizabeth, a common name for a cheat or sharper. Green, one of the first among us who made a trade of writing pamphlets, published *A Detection of the Frauds and Tricks of Coney-catchers and Couzeners*.

I.i.159 (200,6) [Edward shovel-boards] By this term, I believe, are meant brass castors, such as are shoveled on a board, with king Edward's face stamped upon them.

I.i.166 (201,8) [Word of denial in thy Labra's here] I suppose it should rather be read,

Word of denial in my Labra's hear;

that is, *hear* the word of denial in my *lips*. *Thou ly'st*.

I.i.170 (201,9) [*marry trap*] When a man was caught in his own stratagem, I suppose the exclamation of insult was *marry, trap*!

I.i.184 (202,3) [and so conclusions pass'd the careires] I believe this strange word is nothing but the French *carriere*; and the expression means, that *the common bounds of good behaviour were overpassed*.

I.i.211 (203,4) [upon Allhallowmas last, a fortnight afore Michaelmas?] [Theobald suspected that Shakespeare had written "Martlemas."] This correction, thus seriously and wisely enforced, is received by Sir Tho. Hammer; but probably Shakespeare intended a blunder.

I.iii.56 (210,7) [The anchor is deep: will that humour pass?] I see not what relation *the anchor* has to *translation*. Perhaps we may read, *the author is deep*; or perhaps the line is out of its place, and should be inserted lower after Falstaff has said,

Sail like my pinnacle to those golden shores.

It may be observed, that in the tracts of that time *anchor* and *author* could hardly be distinguished. (see 1765, II,464,7)

I.iii.110 (213,6) [I will possess him with yellowness] *Yellowness* is jealousy. (1773)

I.iii.III (213,7) [for the revolt of mine is dangerous] I suppose we may read, *the revolt* of men. Sir T. Hammer reads, *this revolt of mine*. Either may serve, for of the present text I can find no meaning.

I.iv.9 (213,8) [at the latter end of a sea-coal fire] That is, when my master is in bed.

II.i.5 (219,1) [though love use reason for his precisian, he admits him not for his counsellor] Of this word I do not see any meaning that is very apposite to the present intention. Perhaps Falstaff said, *Though love use reason as his physician, he admits him not for his counsellor*. This will be plain sense. Ask not the *reason* of my love; the business of *reason* is not to assist love, but to *cure* it. There may however be this meaning in the present reading. *Though love*, when he would submit to regulation, may *use reason as his precisian*, or director in nice cases, yet when he is only eager to attain his end, he takes not reason for *his counsellor*. (1773)

II.i.27 (220,2) [I was then frugal of my mirth] By breaking this speech into exclamations, the text may stand; but I once thought it must be read, *If I was not then frugal of my mirth.*

II.i.29 (220,3) [Why, I'll exhibit a bill in the parliament for the putting down of men] [T: of fat men] [W: of mum] I do not see that any alteration is necessary; if it were, either of the foregoing conjectures might serve the turn. But surely Mrs. Ford may naturally enough, in the first heat of her anger, rail at the sex for the fault of one.

II.i.52 (222,4) [These knights will hack, and so thou shouldst not alter the article of thy gentry] [W: lack] Upon this passage the learned editor has tried his strength, in my opinion, with more spirit than success.

I read thus—*These knights we'll hack, and so thou shouldest not alter the article of thy gentry.* The punishment of a recreant or undeserving knight, was to *hack* off his spurs: the meaning therefore is; it is not worth the while of a gentlewoman to be made a knight, for we'll degrade all these knights in a little time, by the usual form of *hacking* off their spurs, and thou, if thou art knighted, shalt be hacked with the rest.

II.i.79 (223,5) [for he cares not what he puts into the press] Press is used ambiguously, for a *press* to print, and a *press* to squeeze.

II.i.114 (224,7) [curtail-dog] That is, a dog that misses hie game. The tail is counted necessary to the agility of a greyhound; and one method of disqualifying a dog, according to the forest laws, is to cut his tail, or make him a *curtail*. (see 1765, II,477,+)

II.i.128 (225,9) [Away, Sir corporal Nym.—Believe it, Page, he speaks sense] Nym, I believe, is out of place, and we should read thus:

Away, Sir corporal.

Nym. *Believe it. Page, he speaks sense.*

II.i.135 (225,1) [I have a sword, and it shall bite upon my necessity.—He loves your wife] [V: bite—upon my necessity, he] I do not see the difficulty of this passage: no phrase is more common than—*you may, upon a need, thus.* Nym, to gain credit, says, that he is above the mean office of carrying love-letters; he has nobler means of living; *he has a sword, and upon his necessity, that is, when his need drives him to unlawful expedients, his sword shall bite.*

II.i.148 (226,3) [I will not believe such a Cataian] [Theobald and Warburton had both explained "Cataian" as a liar.] Mr. Theobald and Dr. Warburton have both told their stories with confidence, I am afraid, very disproportionate to any evidence that can be produced. That *Cataian* was a word of hatred or contempt is plain, but that it signified a *boaster* or a *liar* has not been proved. Sir Toby, in *Twelfth Night*, says of the Lady Olivia to her maid, "thy Lady's a *Cataian*;" but there is no reason to think he means to call her *liar*. Besides, Page intends to give Ford a reason why Pistol should not be credited. He therefore does not say, *I would not believe such a liar*: for that he is a liar is yet to be made probable: but he says, *I would not believe such a Cataian on any testimony of his veracity*. That is, "This fellow has such an odd appearance; is so unlike a man civilized, and taught the duties of life, that I cannot credit him." To be a foreigner was always in England, and I suppose everywhere else, a reason of dislike. So Pistol calls Slender in the first act, a *mountain foreigner*; that is, a fellow uneducated, and of gross behaviour; and again in his anger calls Bardolph, *Hungarian wight*.

II.i.182 (228,4) [very rogues] A *rogue* is a *wanderer* or *vagabond*, and, in its consequential signification, a *cheat*.

II.i.236 (230,7) [my long sword] Not long before the introduction of rapiers, the swords in use were of an enormous length, and sometimes raised with both hands. Shallow, with an old man's vanity, censures the innovation by which lighter weapons were introduced, tells what he could once have done with his *long sword*, and ridicules the terms and rules of the rapier.

II.ii.28 (234,6) [red lattice phrases] Your ale-house conversation.

II.ii.28 (234,7) [your bold-beating oaths] [W: bold-bearing] A *beating oath* is, I think, right; so we now say, in low language, a *thwacking* or *swinging* thing.

II.ii.61 (235,8) [canaries] This is the name of a brisk light dance, and is therefore properly enough used in low language for any hurry or perturbation.

II.ii.94 (236,1) [frampold] This word I have never seen elsewhere, except in Dr. Hacket's *Life of Archbishop Williams*, where a *frampul* man signifies a peevish troublesome fellow.

II.ii.142 (238,3) [Clap on more sails; pursue; up with your fights] [Warburton had quoted a passage from Dryden's *Amboyna* for "fights," explaining them as "small arms."] The quotation from Dryden might at least have raised a suspicion that *fights* were neither *small* arms, nor cannon. *Fights* and *nettings* are properly joined. *Fights*, I find, are *cloaths* hung round the ship to conceal the men from the enemy, and *close-fights* are *bulkheads*, or any other shelter that the *fabrick* of a ship affords.

II.ii.170 (240,5) [not to charge you] That is, not with a purpose of putting you to expence, or *being burthensome*.

II.ii.256 (242,6) [instance and argument] *Instance* is *example*.

II.ii.324 (244,8) [Eleven o'clock] Ford should rather have said *ten o'clock*: the time was between ten and eleven; and his impatient suspicion was not likely to stay beyond the time.

II.iii.60 (246,2) [mock-water] The host means, I believe, to reflect on the inspection of urine, which made a considerable part of practical physick in that time; yet I do not well see the meaning of *mock-water*.

III.i.17 (249,5) [By shallow rivers, to whose falls] [Warburton had introduced *The Passionate Shepherd to his Love* and *The Nymph's Reply* at this point in his text, attributing both to Shakespeare.] These two poems, which Dr. Warburton gives to Shakespeare, are, by writers nearer that time, disposed of, one to Marlow, the other to Raleigh. These poems are read in different copies with great variations.

III.i.123 (253,6) [scald, scurvy] *Scall* was an old word of reproach, as *scab* was afterwards.

Chaucer imprecates on his *scrivener*;

"Under thy longe lockes mayest thou have the *scalle*."

III.ii.58 (255,7) [We have linger'd about a match between Anne Page

and my cousin Slender, and this day we shall have our answer]

They have not linger'd very long. The match was proposed by Sir Hugh but the day before.

III.ii.73 (256,1) [The gentleman is of no having] *Having* is the same as *estate* or *fortune*.

III.ii.90 (257,2) [I think, I shall drink in pipe-wine first with him] [Tyrwhitt: horn-pipe wine] *Pipe* is known to be a vessel of wine, now containing two hogsheads. *Pipe* wine is therefore wine, not from the *bottle*, but the *pipe*; and the text consists in the ambiguity of the word, which signifies both a cask of wine, and a musical instrument. *Horn-pipe wine* has no meaning. (1773)

III.iii.60 (260,4) [that becomes the ship-tire, the tire-valiant, or any tire of Venetian admittance] [Warburton had explained the two tents as head-dresses, and "of Venetian admittance" as "which will admit to be adorned."] This note is plausible, except in the explanation of *Venetian admittance*: but I am afraid this whole system of dress is unsupported by evidence.

III.iv.13 (267,7) [father's wealth] Some light may be given to those who shall endear one to calculate the increase of English wealth, by observing, that Latymer, in the time of Edward VI. mentions it as proof of his father's prosperity, *That though but a yeoman. he gave his daughters five pounds each for her portion.* At the latter end of Elizabeth, seven hundred pounds were such a temptation to courtship, as made all other motives suspected. Congreve makes twelve thousand pounds more than a counterbalance to the affectation of Belinda. Ho poet would now fly his favourite character at less than fifty thousand.

III.iv.100 (270,1) [will you cast away your child on a fool and a physician?] I should read *fool* or a *physician*, meaning Slender and Caius.

III.v.113 (274,4) [bilbo] A *bilbo* is a Spanish blade, of which the excellence is flexibleness and elasticity.

III.v.117 (274,5) [kidney] *Kidney* in this phrase now signifies *kind* or *qualities*, but Falstaff means a man whose *kidnies* are as *fat* as mine.

III.v.155 (275,6) [I'll be horn-mad] There is no image which our author appears so fond of, as that of cuckold's horns. Scarcely a light character is introduced that does not endear to produce merriment by some allusion to horned husbands. As he wrote his plays for the stage rather than the press, he perhaps reviewed them seldom, and did not observe this repetition, or finding the jest, however, frequent, still successful, did not think correction necessary.

IV.i (276,7) [*Page's house. Enter Mrs. Page. Mrs. Quickly, and William*] This is a very trifling scene, of no use to the plot, and I should think of no great delight to the audience; but Shakespeare best knew what would please.

IV.ii.22 (879,8) [he so takes on] *To take on*, which is now used for *to, grieve*, seems to be used by our author for *to, rage*. Perhaps it was applied to any passion.

IV.ii.26 (279,9) [buffets himself on the forehead, crying, *peer-out, peer-out!*] That is, appear horns. Shakespeare is at his old lunes. (see 1765, II, 526,+)

IV.ii.161 (283,1) [this wrongs you] This is below your character, unworthy of your understanding, injurious to your honour. So in *The Taming of the Shrew*, Bianca, being ill treated by her rugged sister, says: "You *wrong* me much, indeed you *wrong* yourself."

IV.ii.195 (284,2) [ronyon!] *Ronyon*, applied to a woman, means, as far as can be traced, much the same with *scall* or *scab* spoken of a man.

IV.ii.204 (284,3) [I spy a great peard under his muffler] As the second stratagem, by which Falstaff escapes, is much the grosser of the two, I wish it had been practiced first. It is very unlikely that Ford, baring been so deceived before, and knowing that he had been deceived, would suffer him to escape in so slight a disguise.

IV.ii.208 (284,4) [cry out upon no trail] The expression is taken from the hunters. *Trail* is the scent left by the passage of the game. *To cry out*, is to *open* or *bark*.

IV.iii.13 (285,5) [they must come off] *To come off*, signifies in our author, sometimes *to be uttered with spirit and volubility*. In this place it seems to mean what is in our time expressed by *to come down*, to pay liberally and readily. These accidental and colloquial senses are the disgrace of language, and the plague of commentators.

IV.iv.32 (287,7) [And there he blasts the tree, and takes the cattle] *To take*, in Shakespeare, signifies to seize or strike with a disease, to blast. So in *Hamlet*;

"No planet *takes*."

So in *Lear*;

" — — Strike her young bones,
 "Ye taking airs, with lameness." (rev. 1778,I,341,4)

IV.v.7 (290,3) [standing-bed, and truckle-bed] The usual furniture of chambers in that time was a standing-bed, under which was a *trochle*, *truckle*, or *running* bed. In the standing-bed lay the master, and in the truckle-bed the servant. So in Hall's *Account of a Servile Tutor*:

"He lieth in the *truckle-bed*.

"While his young master lieth o'er his head."

IV.v.21 (291,4) [Bohemian-Tartar] The French call a *Bohemian* what we call a *Gypsy*; but I believe the Host means nothing more than, by a wild appellation, to insinuate that Simple makes a strange appearance.

IV. v. 29 (291, 5) [mussel-shell] He calls poor Simple mussel-shell, because he stands with his mouth open.

IV. v. 104 (293, 6) [*Primero*] A game at cards.

IV. v. 122 (294, 7) [counterfeiting the action of an old woman] [T: a wood woman] This emendation is received by Sir Thomas Hammer, but rejected by Dr. Warburton. To me it appears reasonable enough.

IV. v. 130 (294, 8) [sure, one of you does not serve heaven well, that you are so cross'd] The great fault of this play, is the frequency of expressions so profane, that no necessity of preserving character can justify them. There are laws of higher authority than those of criticism.

V. v. 28 (300, 3) [my shoulders for the fellow of this walk] Who the *fellow* is, or why he keeps his shoulders for bin, I do not understand.

V. v. 77 (304, 9) [Fairies use flowers for their charactery] For the matter with which they make letters.

V. v. 84 (304, 1) [I smell a man of middle earth] Spirits are supposed to inhabit the ethereal regions, and fairies to dwell under ground, men therefore are in a middle station.

V. v. 99 (305, 4) [*Lust is but a bloody fire*] So the old copies. I once thought it should be read,

Lust is but a cloudy fire,

but Sir T. Hammer reads with less violence,

Lust is but i' the blood a fire.

V. v. 172 (308, 8) [ignorance itself is a plummet o'er me] Though this be perhaps not unintelligible, yet it is an odd way of confessing his dejection. I should wish to read:

—*ignorance itself* has a plume o' me;

That is, I am so depressed, that ignorance itself plucks me, and decks itself with the spoils of my weakness. Of the present reading, which is probably right, the meaning may be, I am so enfeebled, that *ignorance itself* weighs me down and oppresses me. (see 1765, II, 554, 1)

V. v. 181 (309, 1) [laugh at my wife] The two plots are excellently connected, and the transition very artfully made in this speech.

V. v. 249 (311, 2) [*Page*. Tell, what remedy?] In the first sketch of this play, which, as Mr. Pope observes, is much inferior to the latter performance, the only sentiment of which I regret the omission, occurs at this critical time, when Fenton brings in his wife, there is this dialogue.

Mrs. Ford. Come, mistress *Page*. I must be bold with you.

'Tis pity to part love that is so true.

Mrs. *Page*. [*Aside*] Although that I have miss'd in my intent,
Yet I am glad my husband's match is cross'd.

—Here *Fenton*. take her. —

Eva. Come, master *Page*, you must needs agree.

Ford. I' faith, Sir, come, you see your wife is pleas'd.

Page. I cannot tell, and yet my heart is eas'd;

And yet it doth me good the Doctor miss'd.

Come hither, *Fenton*, and come hither, daughter. (1773)

General Observation. Of this play there is a tradition preserved by Mr. Rowe, that it was written at the command of queen Elizabeth, who was so delighted with the character of Falstaff, that she wished it to be diffused through more plays; but suspecting that it might pall by continued uniformity, directed the poet to diversify his manner, by shewing him in love. No task is harder than that of writing to the ideas of another. Shakespeare knew what the queen, if the story be true, seems not to have known, that by any real passion of tenderness, the selfish craft, the careless jollity, and the lazy luxury of Falstaff must have suffered so much abatement, that little of his former cast would have remained. Falstaff could not love, but by ceasing to be Falstaff. He could only counterfeit love, and his professions could be prompted, not by the hope of pleasure, but of money. Thus the poet approached as near as he could to the work enjoined him; yet having perhaps in the former plays completed his own idea, seems not to have been able to give Falstaff all his former power of entertainment.

This comedy is remarkable for the variety and number of the personages, who exhibit more characters appropriated and discriminated, than perhaps can be found in any other play.

Whether Shakespeare was the first that produced upon the English stage the effect of language distorted and depraved by provincial or foreign pronunciations, I cannot certainly decide. This mode of forming ridiculous characters can confer praise only on him, who originally discovered it, for it requires not much of either wit or judgment: its success must be derived almost wholly from the player, but its power in a skilful mouth, even he that despises it, is unable to resist.

The conduct of this drama is deficient; the action begins and ends often before the conclusion, and the different parts might change places without inconvenience; but its general power, that power by which all works of genius shall finally be tried, is such, that perhaps it never yet had reader or spectator, who did not think it too soon at an end.

MEASURE FOR MEASURE

Persons Represented: Varrius might be omitted, for he is only once spoken to, and says nothing.

There it perhaps not one of Shakespeare's plays more darkened than this by the peculiarities of its authour, and the unskilfulness of its editors, by distortions of phrase, or negligence of transcription.

I.i.6 (4,4) [lists] Bounds, limits.

I.i.7 (4,5) [Then no more remains,
But that your sufficiency, as your worth is able,
And let them work]

This is a passage which has exercised the sagacity of the editors, and is now to employ mine. [Johnson adds T's and W's notes] Sir Tho. Hammer, having caught from Mr. Theobald a hint that a line was lost, endeavours to supply it thus.

— *Then no more remains,
But that to your sufficiency you join
A will to serve us, as your worth is able.*

He has by this bold conjecture undoubtedly obtained a meaning, but, perhaps not, even in his own opinion, the meaning of Shakespeare.

That the passage is more or less corrupt, I believe every reader will agree with the editors. I am not convinced that a line is lost, as Mr. Theobald conjectures, nor that the change of *but* to *put*, which Dr. Warburton has admitted after some other editor, will amend the fault. There was probably some original obscurity in the expression, which gave occasion to mistake in repetition or transcription. I therefore suspect that the authour wrote thus,

— *Then no more remains. But that to your sufficiencies your worth is abled, And let them work.*

Then nothing remains more than to tell you, that your virtue is now invested with power equal to your knowledge and wisdom. Let therefore your knowledge and your virtue now work together. It may easily be conceived how *sufficiencies* was, by an inarticulate speaker, or inattentive hearer, confounded with *sufficiency as*, and how *abled*, a word very unusual, was changed into *able*. For *abled*, however, an authority is not wanting. Lear uses it in the same sense, or nearly the same, with the Duke. As for *sufficiencies*, D. Hamilton, in his dying

speech, prays that Charles II. *may exceed both the virtues and sufficiencies of his father.*

I.i.11 (6,6) [the terms For common justice, you are as pregnant in]
 The later editions all give it, without authority,
 —*the terms*
 Of justice,—

and Dr. Warburton makes *terms* signify *bounds* or *limits*. I rather think the Duke meant to say, that Escalus was *pregnant*, that is, *ready* and knowing in all the forms of law, and, among other things, in the *terms* or *times set apart* for its administration.

I.i.18 (7,7) [we have with special soul Elected him our absence to supply] [W: roll] This editor is, I think, right in supposing a corruption, but less happy in his emendation. I read,

—*we have with special seal Elected him our absence to supply.*

A special *seal* is a very natural metonymy for a special *commission*.

I.i.28 (8,8)

[There is a kind of character in thy life,
 That to the observer doth thy history
 Fully unfold]

Either this introduction has more solemnity than meaning, or it has a meaning which I cannot discover. What is there peculiar in this, that a man's *life* informs the observer of his *history*? Might it be supposed that Shakespeare wrote this?

There is a kind of character in thy look.

History may be taken in a more diffuse and licentious meaning, for *future occurrences*, or the part of life yet to come. If this sense be received, the passage is clear and proper.

I.i.37 (8,1) [to fine issues] To great consequences. For high purposes.

I.i.41 (9,2) [But I do bend my speech To one that can my part in him advertise] I know not whether we may not better read,

One that can my part to him advertise,

One that can *inform himself* of that which it would be otherwise *my part* to tell him.

I.i.43 (9,3) [Hold therefore, Angelo] That is, continue to be Angelo; *hold* as thou art.

I.i.47 (9,4) [first in question] That is, first called for; first appointed.

I.i.52 (9,5) [We have with a leaven'd and prepared choice Proceeded to you] [W: a levell'd] No emendation is necessary. *Leaven'd* choice is one of Shakespeare's harsh metaphors. His train of ideas seems to be this. *I have proceeded to you with choice* mature, concocted, fermented, *leavened*. When bread is *leavened* it is left to ferment: a *leavened* choice is therefore a choice not hasty, but considerate, not declared as soon as it fell into the imagination, but suffered to work long in the mind. Thus explained, it suits better with *prepared* than *levelled*.

I.i.65 (10,6) [your scope is as mine own] That is, Your amplitude of power.

I.ii.22 (12,7) [in metre?] In the primers, there are metrical graces, such as, I suppose, were used in Shakespeare's time.

I.ii.25 (12,9) [Grace is grace, despite of all controversy] [Warborton had suspected an allusion to ecclesiastical disputes.] I am in doubt whether Shakespeare's thoughts reached so far into ecclesiastical disputes. Every commentator is warped a little by the tract of his own profession. The question is, whether the second gentleman has ever heard grace. The first gentleman limits the question to *grace in metre*. Lucio enlarges it to *grace in any form or language*. The first gentleman, to go beyond him, says, or *in any religion*, which Lucio allows, because the nature of things is unalterable; grace is as immutably grace, as his merry antagonist is a *wicked villain*. Difference in religion cannot make a *grace* not to be *grace*, a *prayer* not to be *holy*; as nothing can make a *villain* not to be a *villain*. This seems to be the meaning, such as it is.

I.ii.28 (12,1) [there went but a pair of sheers between us] We are both of the same piece.

I.ii.35 (13,2) [be pil'd, as thou art pil'd, for a French velvet?] The jest about the pile of a French velvet alludes to the loss of hair in the French disease, a very frequent topick of our authour's jocularly. Lucio finding that the gentleman understands the distemper so well, and mentions it so *feelingly*, promises to remember to drink his *health*, but to forget *to drink after him*. It was the opinion of Shakespeare's time, that the cup of an infected person was contagious.

I.ii.50 (13,3) [To three thousand dollars a year] [A quibble intended between *dollars* and *dolours*. Hammer.] The same jest occurred before in the *Tempest*.

I.ii.83 (15,5) [what with the sweat] This may allude to the *sweating sickness*, of which the memory was very fresh in the time of Shakespeare: but more probably to the method of cure then used for the diseases contracted in brothels.

I.ii.124 (16,6)

[Thus can the demi-god, Authority,
Make us pay down, for our offence, by weight. —
The words of heaven;—on whom it will, it will;
On whom it will not, so; yet still 'tis just]

[Warburton had emended the punctuation of the second line] I suspect that a line is lost.

I.ii.162 (18,8) [the fault, and glimpse, of newness] *Fault* and *glimpse* have so little relation to each other, that both can scarcely be right: we may read *flash* for *fault* or, perhaps we may read,

Whether it be the fault or glimpse—

That is, whether it be the seeming enormity of the action, or the glare of new authority. Yet the same sense follows in the next lines, (see 1765, I, 275, 4)

I.ii.188 (19,2) [There is a prone and speechless dialect] I can scarcely tell what signification to give to the word *prone*. Its primitive and translated senses are well known. The authour may, by a *prone* dialect, mean a dialect which men are *prone* to regard, or a dialect natural and unforced, as those actions seem to which we are *prone*. Either of these interpretations are sufficiently strained; but such distortion of words is not uncommon in our authour. For the sake of an easier sense, we may read,

—*In her youth There is a pow'r, and speechless dialect, Such as moves men.*

Or thus,

There is a prompt and speechless dialect.

I.ii.194 (20,3) [under grievous imposition] I once thought it should be *inquisition*, but the present reading is probably right. *The crime would be under grievous penalties imposed.*

I.iii.2 (20,4) [Believe not, that the dribbling dart of love Can pierce a compleat bosom] Think not that a breast *compleatly armed* can be pierced by the dart of love that comes *fluttering without force*.

I.iii.12 (21,5) [(A man of stricture and firm abstinence)] [W: strict ure] *Stricture* may easily be used for *strictness*; *ure* is indeed an old word, but, I think, always applied to things, never to persons.

I.iii.43 (22,9) [To do it slander] The text stood,

So do in slander. —

Sir Thomas Hammer has very well corrected it thus,

To do it slander. —

Yet perhaps less alteration might have produced the true reading,
And yet my nature never, in the fight,

So doing slandered. —

And yet my nature never suffer slander by doing any open acts of severity. (see 1765, I,279,3)

I.iii.51 (23,2) [Stands at a guard] Stands on terms of defiance.

I.iv.30 (24,3) [make me not your story] Do not, by deceiving me, make me a subject for a tale.

I.iv.41 (26,5)

[as blossoming time

That from the seedness the bare fallow brings

To teeming foyson, so her plenteous womb

Expresseth his full tilth and husbandry]

As the sentence now stands, it is apparently ungrammatical. I read,

At blossoming time, &c.

That is, *As they that feed grow full, so her womb now at blossoming time, at that time through which the feed time proceeds to the harvest*, her womb shows what has been doing. Lucio ludicrously calls pregnancy *blossoming time*, the time when fruit is promised, though not yet ripe.

I.iv.51 (26,6) [Bore many gentlemen, myself being one, In hand, and hope of action] *To bear in hand* is a common phrase for *to keep in expectation and dependance*, but we should read,

—with *hope of action*.

I.iv.56 (26,7) [with full line] With full extent, with the whole length.

I.iv.62 (27,8) [give fear to use] To intimidate *use*, that is, practices long countenanced by *custom*.

I.iv.69 (27,9) [Unless you have the grace] That is, the acceptableness, the power of gaining favour. So when she makes her suit, the provost says,

Heaven give thee moving graces. (1765, I,282,1)

I.iv.70 (27,1) [pith Of business] The inmost part, the main of my message.

I.iv.86 (28,4) [the mother] The abbess, or prioress.

II.i.8 (29,7) [Let but your honour know] To *know* is here to *examine*, to *take cognisance*. So in *Midsummer-Night's Dream*,

*Therefore, fair Hermia, question your desires;
Know of your truth, examine well your blood.*

II.i.23 (29,8)

['Tis very pregnant,
The jewel that we find, we stoop and take it,
Because we see it; but what we do not see,
We tread upon, and never think of it]

'Tis *plain* that we must act with bad as with good; we punish the faults, as we take the advantages, that lie in our way, and what we do not see we cannot note.

II.i.28 (30,8) [For I have had such faults] That is, *because, by reason that* I have had faults.

II.i.57 (31,9) [This comes off well] This is nimbly spoken; this is volubly uttered.

II.i.63 (32,1) [a tapster, sir; parcel-bawd] This we should now express by saying, *he is half-tapster, half-bawd.* (1773)

II.i.66 (32,2) [she professes a hot-house] A *hot-house* is an English name for a *bagnio*.

*Where lately harbour'd many a famous whore,
A purging-bill now fix'd upon the door,
Tells you it it a hot-house, so it may.
And still be a whore-house.* Ben. Jonson.

II.i.85 (32,3) [Ay, sir, by mistress Over-done's means] Here seems to have been some mention made of Froth, who was to be accused, and some words therefore may have been lost, unless the irregularity of the narrative may be better imputed to the ignorance of the constable.

II.i.180 (35,4) [Justice or Iniquity?] These were, I suppose, two personages well known to the audience by their frequent appearance in the old moralities. The words, therefore, at that time, produced a combination of ideas, which they have now lost.

II.i.183 (35,5) [Hannibal] Mistaken by the constable for *Cannibal*.

II.i.215 (36,6) [they will draw you] *Draw* has here a cluster of senses. As it refers to the tapster, it signifies *to drain, to empty*; as it is related to hang, it means *to be conveyed to execution on a hurdle*. In Froth's answer, it is the same as *to bring along by some motive or power*.

II.i.254 (37,7) [I'll rent the fairest house in it, after three pence a bay] A *bay* of building is, in many parts of England, a common term, of which the best conception that I could ever attain, is, that it is the space between the main beams of the roof; so that a barn crossed twice with beams is a barn of three *bays*.

II.ii.26 (40,8) [Stay yet a while] It is not clear why the provost is bidden to stay, nor when he goes out.

II.ii.32 (40,9) [For which I must not plead but that I am at war, 'twixt will, and will not] This is obscure; perhaps it may be mended by reading,

For which I must now plead; but yet I am At war, 'twixt will, and will not.

Yet and *yt* are almost indistinguishable in a manuscript. Yet no alteration is necessary, since the speech is not unintelligible as it now stands, (see 1765, 9I,294,5)

II.ii.78 (42,2) [And mercy then will breathe within your lips, Like man new made] I rather think the meaning is, *You would then change the severity of your present character*. In familiar speech, *You would be quite another man*. (see 1765, 1,296,7)

II.ii.99 (43,6)

[*Isab.* Yet shew some pity. *Ang.* I shew it most of all, when I shew justice; For then I pity those I do not know]

This was one of Bale's memorials. *When I find myself swayed to mercy, let me remember, that there is a mercy likewise due to the country.*

II.ii.126 (45,2) [We cannot weigh our brother with ourself] [W: yourself] The old reading is right. We mortals proud and foolish cannot prevail on our passions to *weigh* or compare *our brother*, a being of like nature and frailty, with *ourself*. We have different names and different judgments for the same faults committed by persons of different condition. (1773)

II.ii.141 (46,3) [She speaks, and 'tis Such sense, that my sense breeds with it] Thus all the folios. Some later editor has changed *breeds* to *bleeds*, and Dr. Warburton blames poor Mr. Theobald for recalling the old word, which yet is certainly right. *My sense* breeds *with her sense*, that is, new thoughts are stirring in my mind, new conceptions are *hatched* in my imagination.

So we say to *brood* over thought.

II.ii.149 (46,4) [tested gold] Rather cupelled, brought to the *test*, refined, (see 1765,I,299,6)

II.ii.157 (47,6) [For I am that way going to temptation, Where prayers cross] Which way Angelo is going to temptation, we begin to perceive; but how *prayers cross* that way, or cross each other, at that way, more than any other, I do not understand.

Isabella prays that his *honour* may be safe, meaning only to give him his title: his imagination is caught by the word *honour*; he feels that his *honour* is in danger, and therefore, I believe, answers thus:

I am that way going to temptation, Which your prayers cross.

That is, I am tempted to lose that honour of which thou implorest the preservation. The temptation under which I labour is that which thou hast unknowingly *thwarted* with thy prayer. He uses the same mode language a few lines lower. Isabella, parting, says, Save your *honour*! Angelo catches the word—*Save it! From what? From thee; even from thy virtue!*—(rev. 1778,II,52,3)

II.ii.165 (47,7)

[But it is I,
That lying, by the violet, in the sun,
Do, as the carrion does, not as the flower,
Corrupt with virtuous season.]

I am not corrupted by her, but by my own heart, which excites foul desires under the same benign influences that exalt her purity, as the carrion grows putrid by those beams which encrease the fragrance of the violet.

II.ii.186 (48,8) [Ever, till now, When men were fond, I smil'd, and wonder'd how] As a day must now intervene between this conference of Isabella with Angelo, and the next, the act might more properly end here; and here, in my opinion, it was ended by the poet.

II.iii.11 (49,1) [Who falling in the flaws of her own youth, Hath blister'd her report] Who doth not see that the integrity of the metaphor requires we should read, —*flames of her own youth?* Warburton.]

Who does not see that, upon such principles, there is no end of correction?

II.iii.36 (50,3) [There rest] Keep yourself in this temper.

II.iii.40 (50,4) [Oh, injurious love] Her execution was respited on account of her pregnancy, the effects of her love: therefore she calls it *injurious*; not that it brought her to shame, but that it hindered her freeing herself from it. Is not this all very natural? yet the Oxford editor changes it to *injurious law*.

II.iv.9 (51,6) [Grown fear'd and tedious] [W: sear'd] I think *fear'd* may stand. What we go to with reluctance may be said to be *fear'd*.

II.iv.13 (51,7) [case] For outside; garb; external shew.

II.iv.14 (51,8) [Wrench awe from fools, and tie the wiser souls To thy false seeming?] Here Shakespeare judiciously distinguishes the different operations of high place upon different minds. Fools are frightened, and wise men are allured. Those who cannot judge but by the eye, are easily awed by splendour; those who consider men as well as conditions, are easily persuaded to love the appearance of virtue dignified with power.

II.iv.16 (51,9) [Let's write good angel on the devil's horn; 'Tis not the devil's crest] [Hammer: Is't not the devil's crest] I am still inclined to the opinion of the Oxford editor. Angelo, reflecting on the difference between his seeming character, and his real disposition, observes, that he *could change his gravity for a plume*. He then digresses into an apostrophe, *O dignity, how dost thou impose upon the world!* then

returning to himself, *Blood*, says he, *thou art but blood*, however concealed with appearances and decorations. Title and character do not alter nature, which is still corrupt, however dignified.

Let's write good angel on the devil's horn; Is't not? — or rather — 'Tis yet the devil's crest.

It may however be understood, according to Dr. Warburton's explanation. O place, how dost thou impose upon the world by false appearances! so much, that if we *write good angel on the devil's horn*, 'tis not taken any longer to be *the devil's crest*. In this sense,

Blood, thou art but blood.!

is an interjected exclamation. (1773)

II.iv.27 (53,1) [The gen'ral subjects to a well-wish'd king] So the later editions: but the old copies read,

The general subject to a well-wish'd king.

The *general subject* seems a harsh expression, but *general subjects* has no sense at all; and *general* was, in our authour's time, a word for *people*, so that the *general* is the *people*, or *multitude*, *subject* to a king. So in *Hamlet*: *The play pleased not the million; 'twas caviare to the general.*

II.iv.47 (54,3) [Falsely to take away a life true made] *Falsely* is the same with *dishonestly*, *illegally*: so *false*, in the next lines, is *illegal*, *illegitimate*.

II.iv.48 (54,4) [As to put metal in restrained means] In forbidden moulds. I suspect *means* not to be the right word, but I cannot find another.

II.iv.50 (55,5) ['Tis set down so in heaven, but not in earth] I would have it considered, whether the train of the discourse does not rather require Isabel to say,

'Tis so set down in earth, but not in heaven.

When she has said this, *Then*, says Angelo, *I shall poze you quickly*. Would you, who, for the present purpose, declare your brother's crime to be less in the sight of heaven, than the law has made it; would you commit that crime, light as it is, to save your brother's life? To this she answers, not very plainly in either reading, but more appositely to that which I propose:

I had rather give my body, than my soul. (1773)

II.iv.67 (56,6)

[Pleas'd you to do't at peril of your soul,
Were equal poize of sin and charity]

The reasoning is thus: Angelo asks, whether there might *not be a charity in sin to save this brother*. Isabella answers, that *if Angelo will save him, she will stake her soul that it were charity, not sin*. Angelo replies, that *if Isabella would save him at the hazard of her soul, it would be not indeed no sin, but a sin to which the charity would be equivalent*.

II.iv.73 (56,7) [And nothing of your answer] I think it should be read,
And nothing of yours answer.

You, and whatever is *yours*, be exempt from penalty.

II.iv.86 (56,9) [Accountant to the law upon that pain] *Pain* is here for *penalty, punishment*.

II.iv.90 (57,2) [But in the loss of question,] The *loss* of question I do not well understand, and should rather read,
But in the toss of question.

In the *agitation*, in the *discussion* of the question. To *toss* an argument is a common phrase.

II.iv.106 (57,4) [a brother dy'd at once] Perhaps we should read,

Better it were, a brother died for once, Than that a sister, by redeeming him. Should die for ever.

II.iv.123 (58,6) [Owe, and succeed by weakness] To *owe* is, in this place, to *own*, to *hold*, to have possession.

II.iv.125 (59,7) [the glasses where they view themselves; Which are as easily broke, as they make forms] Would it not be better to read, — — take *forms*.

II.iv.128 (59,8) [In profiting by them] In imitating them, in taking them for examples.

II.iv.139 (59,1)

[I have no tongue but one. Gentle my lord,
Let me intreat you, speak the former language]

Isabella answers to his circumlocutory courtship, that she has but *one tongue*, she does not understand this new phrase, and desires him to talk his *former language*, that is, to talk as he talked before.

II.iv.150 (60,3) [Seeming, seeming!] Hypocrisy, hypocrisy; counterfeit virtue.

II.iv.156 (60,4) [My Touch against you] [The calling his denial of her charge *his vouch*, has something fine. *Vouch* is the testimony one man bears for another. So that, by this, he insinuates his authority was so great, that his *denial* would have the same credit that a *vouch* or testimony has in ordinary cases. Warburton.] I believe this beauty is merely imaginary, and that *vouch against* means no more than denial.

II.iv.165 (60,5) [die the death] This seems to be a solemn phrase for death inflicted by law. So in *Midsummer Night's Dream*.

Prepare to die the death.

II.iv.178 (61,6) [prompture] Suggestion, temptation, instigation.

III.i.5 (62,8) [Be absolute for death] Be determined to die, without any hope of life. *Horace*, —

— *The hour, which exceeds expectation will be welcome.*

III.i.7 (62,9) [I do lose a thing, That none but fools would keep] [W: would reck] The meaning seems plainly this, that *none but fools would wish to keep life*; or, *none but fools would keep it*, if choice were allowed. A sense, which whether true or not, is certainly innocent.

III.i.14 (63,3) [For all the accommodations, that thou bear'st Are nurs'd by baseness] Dr. Warburton is undoubtedly mistaken in supposing that by *baseness* is meant *self-love* here assigned as the motive of all human actions. Shakespeare only meant to observe, that a minute analysis of life at once destroys that splendour which dazzles the imagination. Whatever grandeur can display, or luxury enjoy, is procured by *baseness*, by offices of which the mind shrinks from the contemplation. All the delicacies of the table may be traced back to the shambles and the dunghill, all magnificence of building was hewn from the quarry, and all the pomp of ornaments dug from among the damps and darkness of the mine.

III.i.16 (64,4) [the soft and tender fork Of a poor worm] *Worm* is put for any creeping thing or *serpent*. Shakespeare supposes falsely, but according to the vulgar notion, that a serpent wounds with his tongue, and that his tongue is *forked*. He confounds reality and fiction, a serpent's tongue is *soft* but not *forked* nor hurtful. If it could

hurt, it could not be soft. In *Midsummer Night's Dream* he has the same notion.

— *With doubler tongue Than thine, O serpent, never adder stung.*

III.i.17 (64,5)

[Thy best of rest is sleep,
And that thou oft provok'st; yet grosly fear'st
Thy death which is no more]

Here Dr. Warburton might have found a sentiment worthy of his animadversion. I cannot without indignation find Shakespeare saying, that *death is only sleep*, lengthening out his exhortation by a sentence which in the friar is impious, in the reasoner is foolish, and in the poet trite and vulgar.

III.i.19 (64,6)

[Thou art not thyself,
For thou exist'st on many thousand grains,
That issue out of dust]

Thou art perpetually repaired and renovated by external assistance, thou subsistest upon foreign matter, and hast no power of producing or continuing thy own being.

III.i.24 (64,7) [strange effects] For *effects* read *affects*; that is, *affections, passions* of mind, or disorders of body variously *affected*. So in *Othello*, *The young affects*.

III.i.32 (65,9)

[Thou hast nor youth, nor age;
But, as it were, an after-dinner's sleep,
Dreaming on both]

This is exquisitely imagined. When we are young, we busy ourselves in forming schemes for succeeding time, and miss the gratifications that are before us; when we are old, we amuse the languor of age with the recollection of youthful pleasures or performances; so that our life, of which no part is filled with the business of the present time, resembles our dreams after dinner, when the events of the morning are mingled with the designs of the evening.

III.i.34 (65,1)

[for all thy blessed youth Becomes as aged, and doth beg the alms
Of palsied eld]

[W: for pall'd, thy blazed youth Becomes assuaged] Here again I think Dr. Warburton totally mistaken. Shakespeare declares that man has *neither youth nor age*; for in *youth*, which is the *happiest* time, or which might be the happiest, he commonly wants means to obtain what he could enjoy; he is dependent on *palsied eld*; *must beg alms* from the coffers of hoary avarice: and being very niggardly supplied, *becomes as aged*, looks, like an old man, on happiness which is beyond his reach. And when *he is old and rich*, when he has wealth enough for the purchase of all that formerly excited his desires, he has no longer the powers of enjoyment,

—has neither heat, affection, limb, nor beauty, To make his riches pleasant.—

I have explained this passage according to the present reading, which may stand without much inconvenience; yet I am willing to persuade my reader, because I have almost persuaded myself, that our authour wrote,

—for all thy blasted youth Becomes as aged—

III.i.37 (66,2) [Thou has neither heat, affection, limb, nor beauty To make thy riches pleasant] [W: nor bounty] I am inclined to believe, that neither man nor woman will have much difficulty to tell how *beauty makes riches pleasant*. Surely this emendation, though it is elegant and ingenious, is not such as that an opportunity of inserting it should be purchased by declaring ignorance of what every one knows, by confessing insensibility to what every one feels.

III.i.40 (66,3) [more thousand deaths] For this sir T. Hammer reads, — — *a thousand deaths*: — — The meaning is not only *a thousand deaths*, but *a thousand deaths* besides what have been mentioned.

III.i.55 (67,5) [Why, as all comforts are; most good in Deed] If this reading be right, Isabella must mean that she brings something better than *words* of comfort, she brings an assurance of *deeds*. This is harsh and constrained, but I know not what better to offer. Sir Thomas Hammer reads, — *in speed*.

III.i.59 (68,6) [an everlasting leiger. Therefore your best appointment] *Leiger* is the same with *resident*. *Appointment*; preparation; act of fitting, or state of being fitted for any thing. So in old books, we have a knight well *appointed*; that is, well armed and mounted or fitted at all points.

III.i.68 (68,8)

[Tho' all the world's vastidity you had,
To a determin'd scope]

A confinement of your mind to one painful idea; to ignominy, of which the remembrance can neither be suppressed nor escaped.

III.i.79 (69,9)

[And the poor beetle, that we tread upon,
In corporal sufferance finds a pang as great,
As when a giant dies]

The reasoning is, *that death is no more than every being must suffer, though the dread of it is peculiar to man*; or perhaps, that we are inconsistent with ourselves, when we so much dread that which we carelessly inflict on other creatures, that feel the pain as acutely as we.

III.i.91 (69,1) [follies doth emmew] Forces follies to lie in cover without daring to show themselves.

III.1.93 (69,3) [His filth within being cast] To *cast* a pond is to empty it of mud.

Mr. Upton reads,
*His pond within being cast, he would appear
A filth as deep as hell.*

III.1.94 (70,4)

[*Claud.* The princely Angelo?
Isab. Oh, 'tis the cunning livery of hell,
The damned'st body to invest and cover
In princely guards!]

[*W:* priestly guards] The first folio has, in both places, *prenzie*, from which the other folios made *princely*, and every editor may make what he can.

III.i.113 (71,7)

[If it were damnable, he being so wise,
Why would he for the momentary trick
Be perdurably fin'd?]

Shakespeare shows his knowledge of human nature in the conduct of Claudio. When Isabella first tells him of Angelo's proposal, he answers, with honest indignation, agreeably to his settled principles,
Thou shalt not do't.

But the love of life being permitted to operate, soon furnishes him with sophistical arguments, he believes it cannot be very dangerous to the soul, since Angelo, who is so wise, will venture it.

III.i.121 (71,8) [delighted spirit] This reading may perhaps stand, but many attempts have been made to correct it. The most plausible is that which substitutes,

— *the benighted spirit*,

alluding to the darkness always supposed in the place of future punishment.

Perhaps we may read,

— *the delinquent spirit*,

a word easily changed to *delighted* by a bad copier, or unskilful reader. *Delinquent* is proposed by Thirlby in his manuscript. (1773)

III.i.127 (72,9) [lawless and incertain thoughts] Conjecture sent out to wander without any certain direction, and ranging through all possibilities of pain.

III.i.139 (73,2) [Is't not a kind of incest, to take life From thine own sister's shame?] In Isabella's declamation there is something harsh, and something forced and far-fetched. But her indignation cannot be thought violent, when we consider her not only as a virgin, but as a nun.

III.i.149 (74,4) [but a trade] A custom; a practice, an established habit. So we say of a man much addicted to any thing, *he makes a trade of it*.

III.i.176 (75,6) [Hold you there] Continue in that resolution.

III.i.255 (77,1) [only refer yourself to this advantage] This is scarcely to be reconciled to any established mode of speech. We may read, *only reserve yourself to, or only reserve to yourself this advantage*.

III.i.266 (77,2) [the corrupt deputy scaled] *To scale the deputy* may be, *to reach him, notwithstanding the elevation of his place*; or it may be, *to strip him and discover his nakedness, though armed and concealed by the investments of authority*.

III.ii.6 (78,4) [since, of two usuries] Sir Thomas Hammer corrected this with less pomp [than Warburton], then *since of two usurers the merriest was put down, and the worser allowed, by order of law, a furr'd gown, &c.* His punctuation is right, but the alteration, small as it is,

appears more than was wanted. Usury may be need by an easy licence for the *professors of usury*.

III.ii.14 (79,5) [father] This word should be expunged.

III.ii.40 (80,7) [That we were all, as some would seem to be,
Free from all faults, as faults from seeming free!]

Sir T. Hammer reads,

Free from all faults, as from faults seeming free.

In the interpretation of Dr. Warburton, the sense is trifling, and the expression harsh. To wish *that men were as free from faults, as faults are free from comeliness* [instead of *void of comeliness*] is a very poor conceit. I once thought it should be read,

O that all were, as all would seem to be. Free from all faults, or from false seeming free.

So in this play,

O place, O power—how dost thou Wrench awe from fools, and tie the wiser souls To thy false seeming.

But now I believe that a less alteration will serve the turn.

Free from all faults, or faults from seeming free;

that men were really good, or that their faults were known, that men were free from faults, *or faults from hypocrisy*. So Isabella calls Angelo's hypocrisy, *seeming, seeming*.

III.ii.42 (81,8) [His neck will come to your waist] That is, his neck will be tied, like your waist, with a rope. The friars of the Franciscan order, perhaps of all others, wear a hempen cord for a girdle. Thus Buchanan,

Fac gemant suis, Variata terga funibus.

III.ii.51 (81,1) [what say'st thou to this tune, matter and method? Is't not drown'd i' the last rain?] [W: It's not down i' the last reign] Dr. Warburton's emendation is ingenious, but I know not whether the sense may not be restored with less change. Let us consider it. Lucio, a prating fop, meets his old friend going to prison, and pours out upon him his impertinent interrogatories, to which, when the poor fellow makes no answer, he adds, *What reply? ha? what say'st thou to this? tune, matter, and method,—is't not? drown'd i' th' last rain? ha? what say'st thou, trot? &c.* It is a common phrase used in low raillery of a man crest-fallen and dejected, that *he looks like a drown'd puppy*,

Lucio, therefore, asks him, whether he was *drowned in the last rain*, and therefore cannot speak.

III.ii.52 (82,2) [what say'st thou, trot?] *Trot*, or as it is now often pronounced, honest *trout*, is a familiar address to a man among the provincial vulgar. (1773)

III.ii.54 (82,3) [Which is the way?] *What is the mode now?*

III.ii.59 (82,4) [in the tub] The method of cure for venereal complaints is grossly celled the *powdering tub*.

III.ii.89 (83,6) [Go—to kennel, Pompey—go] It should be remembered, that Pompey is the common name of a dog, to which allusion is made in the mention of a *kennel*. (1773)

III.ii.135 (85,9) [clack-dish] The beggars, two or three centuries ago, used to proclaim their wont by a wooden dish with a moveable cover, which they clacked to shew that their vessel was empty. This appears in a passage quoted on another occasion by Dr. Gray, (see 1765, I,331,9 and the note in the 1765 Appendix)

III.ii.144 (86,1) [The greater file of the subject] The larger list, the greater number.

III.ii.193 (87,5) [He's now past it] Sir Thomas Hammer, *He is not past it yet*. This emendation was received in the former edition, but seems not necessary. It were to be wished, that we all explained more, and amended less. (see 1765, I,333,5)

III.ii.277 (90,9)

[Pattern in himself to know,
Grace to stand, and virtue go]

These lines I cannot understand, but believe that they should be read thus:

Patterning *himself to know*,
In *grace to stand*, in *virtue go*;

To *pattern* is to *work after a pattern*, and, perhaps, in Shakespeare's licentious diction, simply to work. The sense is, *he that bears the sword of heaven should be holy as well as severe; one that after good examples labours to know himself, to live with innocence, and to act with virtue*.

III.ii.294 (91,5)

[So disguise shall, by the disguis'd
Pay with falshood false exacting]

So *disguise* shall by means of a person *disguised*, return an *injurious demand* with a *counterfeit person*.

IY.i.13 (93,4) [My mirth it much displeas'd, but pleas'd my woe]
Though the musick soothed my sorrows, it had no tendency to produce light merriment.

IV.i.21 (93,5) [constantly] Certainly; without fluctuation of mind.

IV.i.28 (93,6) [circummur'd with brick] *Circummured*, walled round.
He caused the doors to be mured and cased up.

Painter's Palace of Pleasure.

IV.i.40 (94,7) [In action all of precept] I rather think we should read,
In precept all of action,—
that is, *in direction given not by words, but by mute signs.*

IV.i.44 (94,8) [I have possess'd him] I have made him clearly and strongly comprehend.

IV.i.60 (95,9) [O place and greatness] [It plainly appears, that *this* fine speech belongs to *that* which concludes the preceding scene, between the Duke and Lucio.... But that some time might be given to the two women to confer together, the players, I suppose, took part of the speech, beginning at *No might nor greatness*, &c. and put it here, without troubling themselves about its pertinency. Warburton.] I cannot agree that these lines are placed here by the players. The sentiments are common, and such as a prince, given to reflection, must have often present. There was a necessity to fill up the time in which the ladies converse apart, and they must have quick tongues and ready apprehensions, if they understood each other while this speech was uttered.

IV.i.60 (95,1) [false eyes] That is, Eyes insidious and traiterous.

IV.i.62 (95,2) [contrarious quests] Different reports, *running counter* to each other.

IV.i.76 (96,4) [for yet our tithe's to sow] [W: tilth] The reader is here attacked with a pretty sophism. We should read *tilth*, i.e. our *tillage is to make*. But in the text it is *to sow*; and who has ever said that his

tillage was to *sow*? I believe *tythe* is right, and that the expression is proverbial, in which *tithe* is taken, by an easy metonymy, for *harvest*.

IV.ii.69 (100,7) [As fast lock'd up in sleep, as guiltless labour
When it lies starkly in the traveller's bones]

Stiffly. These two lines afford a very pleasing image.

IV.ii.83 (101,1) [Even with the stroke] *Stroke* is here put for the *stroke* of a pen or a line.

IV.ii.86 (101,2) [To qualify] To temper, to moderate, as we say wine is *qualified* with water.

IV.ii.86 (101,3) [Were he meal'd] Were he sprinkled; were he defiled, A figure of the same kind our authour uses in *Macbeth*, *The blood-bolter'd Banquo*.

IV.ii.91 (101,4) [that spirit's possess'd with haste, That wounds the unresisting postern with these strokes] The line is irregular, and the *unresisting postern* so strange an expression, that want of measure, and want of sense, might justly raise suspicion of an error, yet none of the later editors seem to have supposed the place faulty, except sir Tho. Hammer, who reads,

the unresting postern.

The three folio's have it,

unsisting postern,

out of which Mr. Rowe made *unresisting*, and the rest followed him. Sir Thomas Hammer seems to have supposed *unresisting* the word in the copies, from which he plausibly enough extracted *unresting*, but be grounded his emendation on the very syllable that wants authority. What can be made of *unsisting* I know not; the best that occurs to me is *unfeeling*.

IV.ii.103 (103,6) [*Duke*. This is his lordship's man. *Prov*. And here comes Claudio's pardon]

[Tyrwhitt suggested that the names of the speakers were misplaced] When, immediately after the Duke had hinted his expectation of a pardon, the Provost sees the Messenger, he supposes the Duke to to have *known something*, and changes his mind. Either reading may serve equally well. (1773)

IV.ii.153 (104,7) [desperately mortal] This expression is obscure. Sir Thomas Hammer reads, *mortally desperate*. *Mortally* is in low conversation used in this sense, but I know not whether it was ever written. I am inclined to believe, that *desperately mortal* means *desperately mischievous*. Or *desperately mortal* may mean a man likely to die in a *desperate* state, without reflection or repentance. (see 1765, I,348,7)

IV.ii.187 (106,8) [and tie the beard] A beard tied would give a very new air to that face, which had never been seen but with the beard loose, long, and squalid. (1773)

IV.iii.4 (107,2) [First, here's young master Rash] This enumeration of the inhabitants of the prison affords a very striking view of the practices predominant in Shakespeare's age. Besides those whose follies are common to all times, we have four fighting men and a traveller. It is not unlikely that the originals of the pictures were then known.

IV.iii.17 (108,4) [master Forthlight] Should not *Forthlight* be *Forthright*, alluding to the line in which the thrust is made? (1773)

IV.iii.21 (108,6) [in for the Lord's sake] [i.e. to beg for the rest of their lives. Warburton.] I rather think this expression intended to ridicule the puritans, whose turbulence and indecency often brought them to prison, and who considered themselves as suffering for religion.

It is not unlikely that men imprisoned for other crimes, might represent themselves to casual enquirers, as suffering for puritanism, and that this might be the common cant of the prisons. In Donne's time, every prisoner was brought to jail by suretiship.

IV.iii.68 (110,7) [After him, fellows] Here was a line given to the Duke, which belongs to the Provost. The Provost, while the Duke is lamenting the obduracy of the prisoner, cries out,

After him, fellows, &c.

and, when they are gone out, turns again to the Duke.

IV.iii.72 (110,8) [to transport him] To remove him from one world to another. The French *trepas* affords a kindred sense.

IV.iii.115 (112,1)

[I will keep her ignorant of her good,
To make her heavenly comforts of despair,
When least it is expected.]

A better reason might have been given. It was necessary to keep Isabella in ignorance, that she might with more keenness accuse the deputy.

IV.iii.139 (113,2) [your bosom] Your wish; your heart's desire.

IV.iii.149 (113,3) [I am combined by a sacred vow] I once thought this should be *confined*, but Shakespeare uses *combine* for to *bind by a pact or agreement*, so he calls Angelo the *combinat*e husband of Mariana.

IV.iii.163 (113,4) [if the old fantastical duke] Sir Thomas Hammer reads, *the odd fantastical duke*, but *old* is a common word of aggravation in ludicrous language, as, *there was old revelling*.

IV.iii.170 (114,5) [woodman] That is, *huntsman*, here taken for a *hunter of girls*.

IV.iv.19 (115,6) [sort and suit] Figure and rank.

IV.iv.27 (115,7) [Yet reason dares her No] Mr. Theobald reads,

— *Yet reason dares her note*.

Sir Thomas Hammer,

— *Yet reason dares her: No*.

Mr. Upton,

— *Yet reason dares her — No*,

which he explains thus: *Yet*, says Angelo, *reason will give her courage — No*, that is, *it will not*. I am afraid *dare* has no such signification. I have nothing to offer worth insertion.

IV.iv.28 (116,8)

[For my authority bears a credent bulk;

That no particular scandal once can touch]

Credent is *creditable*, *inforcing credit*, not *questionable*. The old English writers often confound the active and passive adjectives. So Shakespeare, and Milton after him, use *inexpressive* from *inexpressible*.

Particular is *private*, a French sense. No scandal from any *private* mouth can reach a man in my authority.

IV.iv.36 (116,9) [Nothing goes right; we would, and we would not] Here undoubtedly the act should end, and was ended by the poet; for here is properly a cessation of action, and a night intervenes, and the place is changed, between the passages of this scene, and those of

the next. The next act beginning with the following scene, proceeds without any interruption of time or change of place.

IV.v.1 (117,1) [*Duke*. These letters at fit time deliver me] Peter never delivers the letters, but tells his story without any credentials. The poet forgot the plot which he had formed.

IV.vi.4 (118,2) [He says, to vail full purpose] [T: t'availful] [Warburton had explained "full" as "beneficial."] *To vail full* purpose, may, with very little force on the words, mean, *to hide the whole extent of our design*, and therefore the reading may stand; yet I cannot but think Mr. Theobald's alteration either lucky or ingenious. To interpret words with such laxity, as to make *full* the same with *beneficial*, is to put an end, at once, to all necessity of emendation, for any word may then stand in the place of another.

IV.vi.9 (118,3) [*Enter Peter*] This play has two Friars, either of whom might singly have served. I should therefore imagine, that Friar Thomas, in the first act, might be changed, without any harm, to Friar Peter; for why should the Duke unnecessarily trust two in an affair which required only one. The none of Friar Thomas is never mentioned in the dialogue, and therefore seems arbitrarily placed at the head of the scene.

IV.vi.14 (119,4) [Have bent the gates] Have taken possession of the gates, (rev. 1778, II,134,4)

V.i.20 (120,5) [vail your regard] That is, withdraw your thoughts from higher things, let your notice descend upon a wronged woman. To *vail*, is to lower.

V.i.45 (121,6) [truth is truth To the end of reckoning] That is, truth has no gradations; nothing which admits of encrease can be so much what it is, as *truth* is *truth*. There may be a *strange* thing, and a thing *more strange*, but if a proposition be *true*, there can be none *more true*.

V.i.54 (121,7) [as shy, as grave, as just, as absolute] *As shy*; as reserved, as abstracted: *as just*; as nice, as exact: *as absolute*; as complete in all the round of duty.

V.i.56 (121,8) [In all his dressings] In all his semblance of virtue, in all his habiliments of office.

V.i.64 (122,1) [do not banish reason For inequality] Let not the high quality of my adversary prejudice you against me.

V.i.104 (124,4) [Oh, that it were as like, as it is true!] [Warburton had explained "like" as "seemly."] *Like* I have never found for *seemly*.

V.i.107 (124,8) [In hateful practice] *Practice* was used by the old writers for any unlawful or insidious stratagem. So again,

This must needs be practice:

and again,

Let me have way to find this practice out.

V.i.145 (125,6) [nor a temporary medler] It is hard to know what is meant by a *temporary* medler. In its usual sense, as opposed to *perpetual*, it cannot be used here. It may stand for *temporal*: the sense will then be, *I know him for a holy man, one that meddles not with secular affairs*. It may mean *temporising*: I know him to be a holy man, one who would not temporise, or take the opportunity of your absence to defame you. Or we may read,

Not scurvy, nor a tamperer and medler:

not one who would bare *tampered* with this woman to make her a false evidence against your deputy.

V.i.160 (126,8) [So vulgarly and personally accus'd] Meaning either so grossly, with such *indecenty* of invective, or by so *mean* and inadequate witnesses.

V.i.205 (128,2) [This is a strange abuse] *Abuse* stands in this place for *deception*, or *puzzle*. So in *Macbeth*,

This strange and self abuse,

means, *this strange deception of himself*.

V.i.219 (129,3) [her promised proportions Came short of composition] Her fortune, which was promised *proportionate* to mine, fell short of the *composition*, that is, contract or bargain.

V.i.236 (129,4) [These poor informal women] I once believed *informal* had no other or deeper signification than *informing*, *accusing*. The *scope* of justice, is the full extent; but think, upon farther enquiry, that *informal* signifies *incompetent*, *not qualified to give testimony*. Of this use there are precedents to be found, though I cannot now recover them.

Vi.245 (130,5) [That's seal'd in approbation?] Then any thing subject to counterfeits is tried by the proper officers and approved, a stamp or *seal* is put upon it, as among us on plate, weights, and measures. So the Duke says, that Angela's faith has been tried, *approved*, and *seal'd* in testimony of that *approbation*, and, like other things so *sealed*, is no more to be called in question.

Vi.255 (131,6) [to hear this matter forth] To hear it to the end; to search it to the bottom.

Vi.303 (132,4) [to retort your manifest appeal] To *refer back* to Angelo and the cause in which you *appealed* from Angelo to the Duke.

Vi.317 (133,5) [his subject I am not, Nor here provincial] Nor here *accountable*. The meaning seems to be, I am not one of his natural subjects, nor of any dependent province.

Vi.323 (133,6) [the forfeits in a barber's shop] [Warburton had explained that a list of forfeitures were posted in barber shops to warn patrons to keep their hands off the barber's surgical instruments.] This explanation may serve till a better is discovered. But whoever has seen the instruments of a chirurgeon, knows that they may be very easily kept out of improper hands in a very small box, or in his pocket.

Vi.336 (134,7) [And was the duke a fleshmonger, a fool, and a coward, as you then reported him to be?] So again afterwards,

You, sirrah, that know me for a fool, a coward, One of all luxury—

But Lucio had not, in the former conversation, mentioned *cowardice* among the faults of the duke.—Such failures of memory are incident to writers more diligent than this poet.

Vi.359 (135,8) [show your sheep-biting face, and be hang'd an hour' Will't not off?] This is intended to be the common language of vulgar indignation. Our phrase on such occasions is simply; *show your sheep-biting face, and be hanged*. The words *an hour* have no particular use here, nor are authorised by custom. I suppose it was written thus, *show your sheep-biting face, and be hanged—an' how? wilt not off?* In the midland counties, upon any unexpected obstruction or resistance, it is common to exclaim *an' how?*

Vi.388 (136,9) [Advertising, and holy] Attentive and faithful.

Vi.393 (136,1) [be you as free to us] Be as *generous* to us, pardon us as we have pardoned you.

Vi.401 (136,2) [That brain'd my purpose] We now use in conversation a like phrase. *This it was that knocked my design on the head.* Dr. Warburton reads,
—baned *my purpose*.

Vi.413 (137,3) [even from his proper tongue] Even from Angelo's *own tongue*. So above.

*In the witness of his proper ear
To call him villain.*

Vi.438 (138,5) [Against all sense you do importune her] The meaning required is, against all reason and natural affection; Shakespeare, therefore, judiciously uses a single word that implies both; *sense* signifying both reason and affection.

Vi.452 (139,6) ['Till he did look on me] The duke has justly observed that Isabel is *importuned against all sense* to solicit for Angelo, yet here *against all sense* she solicits for him. Her argument is extraordinary.

*A due sincerity govern'd his deeds, 'Till he did look on me; since it is so.
Let him not die.*

That Angelo had committed all the crimes charged against him, as far as he could commit them, is evident. The only *intent* which *his* act did not overtake, was the defilement of Isabel. Of this Angelo was only intentionally guilty.

Angela's crimes were such, as must sufficiently justify punishment, whether its end be to secure the innocent from wrong, or to deter guilt by example; and I believe every reader feels some indignation when he finds him spared. From what extenuation of his crime, can Isabel, who yet supposes her brother dead, form any plea in his favour. *Since he was good 'till he looked on me, let him not die.* I am afraid our varlet poet intended to inculcate, that women think ill of nothing that raises the credit of their beauty, and are ready, however virtuous, to pardon any act which they think incited by their own charms.

Vi.488 (140,7) [But, for those earthly faults, I quit them all] Thy faults, so far as they are punishable on earth, so far as they are cognisable by temporal power, I forgive.

V.i.499 (141,8) [By this, lord Angelo perceives he's safe] It is somewhat strange, that Isabel is not made to express either gratitude, wonder or joy at the sight of her brother.

V.i.501 (141,9) [your evil quits you well] *Quits you*, recompenses, requites you.

V.i.502 (141,1) [Look, that you love your wife; her worth, worth yours] Sir T. Hammer reads,

Her worth works yours.

This reading is adopted by Dr. Warburton, but for what reason? How does her *worth work Angelo's worth*? it has only contributed to *work* his pardon. The words are, as they are too frequently, an affected gingle, but the sense is plain. *Her worth, worth yours*; that is, her value is equal to your value, the match is not unworthy of you.

V.i.504 (141,2) [And yet here's one in place I cannot pardon] After the pardon of two murderers, Lucio might be treated by the good duke with less harshness; but perhaps the poet intended to show, what is too often seen, *that men easily forgive wrongs which are not committed against themselves.*

V.i.509 (142,3) [according to the trick] To my custom, my habitual practice.

V.i.526 (142,4) [thy other forfeits] Thy other punishments.

V.i.534 (142,5) [Thanks, good friend Escalus, for thy much goodness] I have always thought that there is great confusion in this concluding speech. If my criticism would not be censured as too licentious, I should regulate it thus,

Thanks, good friend Escalus, for thy much goodness.

Thanks. Provost, for thy care and secrecy;

We shall employ thee in a worthier place.

Forgive him, Angelo, that brought you home

The head of Ragozine for Claudio's.

Ang. Th' offence pardons itself.

Duke, There's more behind

That is more grate. Dear Isabel,

I have a motion,&c,

Vi.545 (143,6) General Observation The novel of Cynthio Giraldi, from which Shakespeare is supposed to have borrowed this fable, may be read in *Shakespeare illustrated*, elegantly translated, with remarks which will assist the enquirer to discover how much absurdity Shakespeare has admitted or avoided. I cannot but suspect that some other had new-modelled the novel of Cynthio, or written a story which in some particulars resembled it, and that Cynthio was not the authour whom Shakespeare immediately followed. The emperour in Cynthio is named Maximine; the duke, in Shakespeare's enumeration of the persons of the drama, is called Vincentio. This appears a very slight remark; but since the duke has no name in the play, nor is ever mentioned but by his title, why should he be called Vincentio among the *persons*, but because the name was copied from the story, and placed superfluously at the head of the list by the mere habit of transcription? It is therefore likely that there was then a story of Vincentio duke of Vienna, different from that of Maximine emperor of the Romans.

Of this play the light or comick part is very natural and pleasing, but the grave scenes, if a few passages be excepted, have more labour than elegance. The plot is rather intricate than artful. The time of the action is indefinite; some time, we know not how much, must have elapsed between the recess of the duke and the imprisonment of Claudio; for he must have learned the story of Mariana in his disguise, or he delegated his power to a man already known to be corrupted. The unities of action and place are sufficiently preserved.

THE COMEDY OF ERRORS

I.ii.96 (155,3) [o'er-raught] That is, *over-reached*.

I.ii.98 (156,5)

[As, nimble jugglers, that deceive the eye,
Dark-working sorcerers, that change the mind,
Soul-killing witches, that deform the body]

[W: Drug-working] The learned commentator has endeavoured with much earnestness to recommend his alteration; but, if I may judge of other apprehensions by my own, without great success. This interpretation of *soul-killing* is forced and harsh. Sir T. Hammer reads *soul-selling*, agreeable enough to the common opinion, but without such improvement as may justify the change. Perhaps the epithets have only been misplaced, and the lines should be read thus,

Soul-killing sorcerers, that change the mind;

Dark-working witches that deform the body.

This change seems to remove all difficulties.

By *soul-killing* I understand destroying the rational faculties by such means as make men fancy themselves beasts.

I.ii.102 (157,6) [liberties of sin] Sir T. Hammer reads, *libertines*, which, as the author has been enumerating not acts but persons, seems right.

II.i.30 (158,8) [How if your husband start some other where?] I cannot but think, that our authour wrote,

—start some other hare?

So in *Much ado about Nothing*, Cupid is said to be a *good hare-finder*.

II.i.32 (159,9) [tho' she pause] To *pause* is to rest, to be in quiet.

II.i.41 (159,1) [fool-begg'd] She seems to mean, by *fool-begg'd patience*, that patience which is so near to *idiotical simplicity*, that your next relation would take advantage from it to represent you as a *fool*, and beg the guardianship of your fortune.

II.i.82 (161,3) [Am I so round with you, as you with me] He plays upon the word *round*, which signified *spherical* applied to himself, and *unrestrained*, or *free in speech or action*, spoken of his mistress. So the king, in *Hamlet*, bids the queen be *round* with her son.

II.i.100 (161,5) [too unruly deer] The ambiguity of *deer* and *dear* is borrowed, poor as it is, by Waller, in his poem on the *Ladies Girdle*.

"This was my heav'n's extremest sphere,

"This pale that held my lovely deer."

II.i.101 (161,6) [poor I am but his stale] The word *stale*, in our authour, used as a substantive, means, not something offered to *allure* or *attract*, but something *vitiating* with *use*, something of which the best part has been enjoyed and consumed.

II.ii.86 (166,4) [Not a man of those, but he hath the wit to lose his hair] That is, *Those who have more hair than wit*, are easily entrapped by loose women, and suffer the consequences of lewdness, one of which, in the first appearance of the disease in Europe, was the loss of hair.

II.ii.173 (169,6) [Be it my wrong, you are from me exempt] Exempt, separated, parted. The sense is, *If I am doomed to suffer the wrong of separation, yet injure not with contempt me who am already injured*.

II.ii.210 (171,1) [And shrive you] That is, I will *call you to confession*, and make you tell your tricks.

III.i.4 (172,2) [carkanet] seems to have been a necklace or rather chain, perhaps hanging down double from the neck. So Lovelace in his poem,

The empress spreads her carcanets.

III.i.15 (173,3) [Marry, so it doth appear By the wrongs I suffer, and the blows I bear] [T: don't appear] I do not think this emendation necessary. He first says, that his *wrongs* and *blows* prove him an *ass*; but immediately, with a correction of his former sentiment, such as may be hourly observed in conversation, he observes that, if he had been an ass, he should, when he was *kicked*, have *kicked* again.

III.i.101 (177,7) [supposed by the common rout] For *suppose* I once thought it might be more commodious to substitute *supported*; but there is no need of change: *supposed* is *founded on supposition*, made by conjecture.

III.i.105 (178,8) [For slander lives upon succession] The line apparently wants two syllables: what they were, cannot now be known. The line may be filled up according to the reader's fancy, as thus:

For lasting slander lives upon succession.

III.ii.27 (180,3) ['Tis holy sport to be a little vain] is *light of tongue, not veracious*.

III.ii.64 (181,2) [My sole earth's heaven, and my heaven's claim] When he calls the girl his *only heaven on the earth*, he utters the common cant of lovers. When he calls her *his heaven's claim*, I cannot understand him. Perhaps he means that which he asks of heaven.

III.ii.125 (184,5)

[S. *Ant.* Where France? S. *Dro.* In her forehead; arm'd and reverted, making war against her hair]

[T, from the first Folio: *heir*] With this correction and explication Dr. Warburton concurs, and sir T. Hammer thinks an equivocation intended, though he retains *hair* in the text. Yet surely they have all lost the sense by looking beyond it. Our authour, in my opinion, only sports with an allusion, in which he takes too much delight, and means that his mistress had the French disease. The ideas are rather too offensive to be dilated. By a forehead *armed*, he means covered with incrustated eruptions: by reverted, he means having the hair turning backwards. An equivocal word must have senses applicable to both the subjects to which it is applied. Both *forehead* and *France* might in some sort make war against their *hair*, but how did the *forehead* make war against its *heir*? The sense which I have given immediately occurred to me, and will, I believe, arise to every reader who is contented with the meaning that lies before him, without sending out conjecture in search of refinements.

IV.ii.19 (192,9) [*sere*] that is, *dry*, withered.

IV.ii.22 (192,1) [Stigmatical in making] This is, *marked* or *stigmatized* by nature with deformity, as a token of his vicious disposition.

IV.ii.35 (193,3) [A fiend, a fairy, pitiless and rough] [T: A fiend, a fury] There were fairies like *hobgoblins*, pitiless and rough, and described as malevolent and mischievous, (see 1765, III,143,3)

IV.ii.39 (193,5) [A hound that runs counter, and yet draws dry-foot well] To *run counter* is to *run backward*, by mistaking the course of the animal pursued; to *draw dry-foot* is, I believe, to pursue by the *track* or *prick of the foot*; to *run counter* and *draw dry-foot well* are, therefore, inconsistent. The jest consists in the ambiguity of the word *counter*,

which means the *wrong way in* the chase*. and a *prison* in London. The officer that arrested him was a serjeant of the counter. For the congruity of this jest with the scene of action, let our authour answer.

IV.iii.13 (196,9) [what, have you got the picture of old Adam new apparel'd] [T: got rid of the picture] The explanation is very good, but the text does not require to be amended.

IV.iii.27 ('is rest to do more exploits with his mace than a morris pike] [W: a Maurice-pike] This conjecture is very ingenious, yet the commentator talks unnecessarily of the *rest of a musket*. by which he makes the hero of the speech set up the *rest of a musket*, to do exploits with a *pike*. The rest of a *pike* was a common term, and signified, I believe, the manner in which it was fixed to receive the rush of the enemy. A *morris-pike* was a pike used in a morris or a military dance, and with which great *exploits* were *done*, that is, great feats of dexterity were shewn. There is no need of change.

IV.iv.78 (202,3) [kitchen-vestal] Her charge being like that of the vestal virgins, to keep the fire burning.

V.1.137 (210,6) [important letters] *Important* seems to be for *importantune*. (1773)

Vi.i.298 (216,2) [time's deformed hand Have written strange defeatures in my face] *Defeature* is the privative of *feature*. The meaning is, time hath cancelled my features.

Vi.406 (220,7) [After so long grief such nativity!] We should surely read. *After so long grief, such festivity*.

Nativity lying so near, and the termination being the same of both words, the mistake was easy.

MUCH ADO ABOUT NOTHING

I.i.27 (226,3) [no faces truer] That is, none *honester*, none *more sincere*.

I.i.40 (227,7) [challenged Cupid at the flight] The disuse of the bow makes this passage obscure. Benedick is represented as challenging Cupid at archery. To challenge *at the flight is*, I believe, to wager who shall shoot the arrow furthest without any particular mark. To *challenge at the bird-bolt*, seems to mean the same as to challenge at children's archery, with snail arrows such as are discharged at birds. In Twelfth Night Lady Olivia opposes a *bird-bolt* to a *cannon-bullet*, the lightest to the heaviest of missive weapons.

I.i.66 (228,9) [four of his five wits] In our author's time *wit* was the general term for intellectual powers. So Davies on the Soul.

Wit, seeking truth from cause to cause ascends.

And never rests till it the first attain;

Will, seeking good, finds many middle ends,

But never stays till it the last do gain.

And in another part,

But if a phrenzy do possess the brain,

It so disturbs and blots the form of things,

As fantasy proves altogether vain,

And to the wit, no true relation brings.

Then doth the wit, admitting all for true,

Build fond conclusions on those idle grounds;—

The *wits* seem to have reckoned five, by analogy to the five senses, or the five inlets of ideas.

I.i.79 (229,4) [the gentleman is not in your books] This is a phrase used, I believe, by more than understand it. *To be in one's books is to be in one's codicils or will, to be among friends set down for legacies.*

I.i.82 (230,5) [young squarer] A *squarer* I take to be a cholerick, quarrelsome fellow, for in this sense Shakespeare uses the word to *square*. So in *Midsummer Night's Dream* it is said of Oberon and Titalia, that *they never meet but they square*. So the sense may be, *Is there no hot-blooded youth that will keep him company through all his mad pranks?*

I.i.103 (231,6) [You embrace your charge] That is your *burthen*, your *incumbrunce*.

I.i.185 (233,7) [to tell us Cupid is a good hare-finder] I know not whether I conceive the jest here intended. Claudio hints his love of Hero. Benedick asks whether he is serious, or whether he only means to jest, and tell them that *Cupid is a good hare-finder, and Vulcan a rare carpenter*. A man praising a pretty lady in jest, may shew the quick sight of Cupid, but what has it to do with the *carpentry* of Vulcan? Perhaps the thought lies no deeper than this, *Do you mean to tell us as new what we all know already?*

I.i.200 (234,8) [wear his cap with suspicion?] That is, subject his head to the disquiet of jealousy.

I.i.217 (235,1) [*Claud.* If this were so, so were it uttered] This and the three next speeches I do not well understand; there seems something omitted relating to Hero's consent, or to Claudio's marriage, else I know not what Claudio can wish *not to be otherwise*. The copies all read alike. Perhaps it may be better thus,

Claud. *If this were so, so were it.*

Bene. *Uttered like the old tale, &c.*

Claudio gives a sullen answer, *if it is so, so it is*. Still there seems something omitted which Claudio and Pedro concur in wishing.

I.i.243 (236,3) [but that I will have a recheate winded in my forehead] That is, *I will wear a horn on my forehead which the huntsman may blow*. A *recheate* is the sound by which dogs are called back. Shakespeare had no mercy upon the poor cuckold, his *horn* is an inexhaustible subject of merriment.

1.1.258 (236,4) [notable argument] An eminent subject for satire.

1.1.259 (237,5) [Adam] Adam Bell was a companion of Robin Hood, as may be seen in Robin Hood's Garland; in which, if I do not mistake, are these lines,

For he brought Adam Bell, Clim of the Clough,

And William of Cloudeslea,

To shoot with this forester for forty marks,

And the forester beat them all three.

(see 1765, III,182,2)

I.i.290 (238,4) [ere you flout old ends any further, examine your conscience] *Before you endeavour to distinguish yourself any more by antiquated allusions, examine whether you can fairly claim them for your own.* This, I think is the meaning; or it may be understood in another sense, *examine, if your sarcasms do not touch yourself.*

I.iii.14 (241,6) [I cannot hide what I am] This is one of our authour's natural touches. An envious and unsocial mind, too proud to give pleasure, and too sullen to receive it, always endeavours to hide its malignity from the world and from itself, under the plainness of simple honesty, or the dignity of haughty independence.

I.iii.19 (241,7) [claw no man in his humour] To *claw* is to flatter. So *the pope's claw-backs*, in bishop Jewel, are the pope's *flatterers*. The sense is the same in the proverb, *Mulus mulum scabit*.

I.iii.28 (242,8) [I had rather be a canker in a hedge, than a rose in his grace] A *canker* is the *canker* rose, *dog-rose*, *cynosbatus*, or *hip*. The sense is, I would rather live in obscurity the wild life of nature, than owe dignity or estimation to my brother. He still continues his wish of gloomy independence. But what is the meaning of the expression, *a rose in his grace*? if he was a *rose* of himself, his brother's *grace* or *favour* could not degrade him. I once read thus, *I had rather be a canker in a hedge, than a rose in his garden*; that is, I had rather be what nature makes me, however mean, than owe any exaltation or improvement to my brother's kindness or cultivation. But a less change will be sufficient: I think it should be read, *I had rather be a canker in a hedge, than a rose by his grace*.

II.i.3 (244,1) [I never can see him, but I am heart-burn'd an hour after] The pain commonly called the *heart-burn*, proceeds from an *acid* humour in the stomach, and is therefore properly enough imputed to *tart* looks.

II.i.53 (245,3) [Well then, go you into hell] Of the two next speeches Mr. Warburton says, *All this impious nonsense thrown to the bottom is the players, and foisted in without rhyme or reason.* He therefore puts them in the margin. They do not deserve indeed so honourable a place, yet I am afraid they are too much in the manner of our authour, who is sometimes trying to purchase merriment at too dear a rate. (see 1765, III,190,9)

II.i.73 (246,4) [if the prince be too important] *Important* here, and in many other places, is *importunate*.

II.i.99 (247,6) [My visor is Philemon's roof; within the house is Jove] [T: house is love] This amendment, thus impressed with all the power of his eloquence and reason, Theobald found in the quarto edition of 1600, which he professes to have seen; and in the first folio, the *l* and the *I* are so much alike, that the printers, perhaps, used the same type for either letter. (1773)

II.i.143 (249,2) [his gift is in devising impossible slanders] [W: impassible] *Impossible* slanders are, I suppose, such slanders as, from their absurdity and impossibility, bring their own confutation with them.

II.i.195 (251,4) [usurer's chain] I know not whether the *chain* was, in our authour's time, the common ornament of wealthy citizens, or whether he satirically uses *usurer* and *alderman* as synonymous terms.

II.i.214 (252,5) [It is the base, the bitter disposition of Beatrice, that puts the world into her person] That is, *It is the disposition of Beatrice, who takes upon her to personate the world, and therefore represents the world as saying what she only says herself.*

Base, tho bitter. I do not understand how *base* and *bitter* are inconsistent, or why what is *bitter* should not be *base*. I believe, we may safely read, *It is the base, the bitter disposition.*

II.i.253 (253,8) [such impossible conveyance] [W: impassible] I know not what to propose. *Impossible* seems to have no meaning here, and for *impassible* I have not found any authority. Spenser uses the word *importable* in a sense very congruous to this passage, for *insupportable*, or *not to be sustained*.

*Both him charge on either side,
With hideous strokes and importable power,
Which forced him his ground to traverse wide.*

It may be easily imagined, that the transcribers would change a word so unusual, into that word most like it, which they could readily find. It must be however confessed, that *importable* appears harsh to our ears, and I wish a happier critick may find a better word.

Sir Tho. Hammer reads *impetuous*, which will serve the purpose well enough, but is not likely to have been changed to *impossible*.

Importable was a word not peculiar to Spenser, but used by the last translators of the Apocrypha, and therefore such a word as Shakespeare may be supposed to have written. (1773) II.i.330 (256,2) [Thus goes every one to the world but I, and I am sun-burn'd] What is it, *to go the world*? perhaps, to enter by marriage into a settled state: but why is the unmarried lady *sun-burnt*? I believe we should read, *Thus goes every one to the wood* but I, and I am sun-burnt. Thus does every one but I find a shelter, and I am left exposed to wind and *sun*. *The nearest way to the wood*, is a phrase for the readiest means to any end. It is said of a woman, who accepts a worse match than those which she had refused, that she has passed through the *wood*, and at last taken a crooked stick. But conjectural criticism has always something to abate its confidence. Shakespeare, in All's well that Ends well, uses the phrase, *to go to the world*, for *marriage*. So that my emendation depends only on the opposition of *wood* to *sun-burnt*.

II.i.380 (258,4) [to bring signior Benedick, and the lady Beatrice into a mountain of affection, the one with another] *A mountain of affection with one another* is a strange expression, yet I know not well how to change it. Perhaps it was originally written, *to bring Benedick into a mooring of affection*; to bring them not to any more *mootings* of contention, but to a *mooting* or conversation of love. This reading is confirmed by the preposition *with*; *a mountain with each other*, or *affection with each other*, cannot be used, but *a mooring with each other* is proper and regular.

II.iii.104 (265,7) [but, that she loves him, with an enraged affection, it is past the infinite of thought] [W: the definite of] Here are difficulties raised only to shew how easily they can be removed. The plain sense is, *I know not what to think otherwise, but that she loves him with an enraged affection*: *It* (this affection) [is past the infinite of thought. Here are no abrupt stops, or imperfect sentences. *Infinite* may well enough stand; it is used by more careful writers for *indefinite*; and the speaker only means, that *thought*, though in itself *unbounded*, cannot reach or estimate the degree of her passion.

II.iii.146 (267,8) [O, she tore the letter into a thousand half-pence] [i.e. into a thousand pieces of the same bigness.] This is farther explained by a passage in As you Like it.

—There were none principal; they were all like one

another as half-pence *are*. [Theobald.] How the quotation explains the passage, to which it is applied, I cannot discover.

II.iii.188 (268,9) [contemptible spirit] That is, a temper inclined to scorn and contempt. It has been before remarked, that our authour uses his verbal adjectives with great licence. There is therefore no need of changing the word with sir T. Hammer to *contemptuous*.

III.i.52 (273,3) [Misprising] Despising, contemning.

III.i.96 (275,8) [argument] This word seems here to signify *discourse*, or, the *powers* of reasoning. III.i.104 (275,7) [She's lim'd] She is ensnared and entangled as a sparrow with *birdlime*.

III.i.107 (275,9) [Taming my wild heart to thy loving hand] This image is taken from falconry. She had been charged with being as wild as *haggards of the rock*; she therefore says, that *wild* as her *heart* is, she will tame it *to the hand*.

III.ii.31 (277,2) [There is no appearance of fancy in him, unless it be a fancy that he hath to strange disguises] Here is a play upon the word *fancy*, which Shakespeare uses for *love* as well as for *humour*, *caprice*, or *affectation*.

III.ii.71 (278,3) [She shall be buried with her face upwards] [T: heels upwards] This emendation, which appears to me very specious, is rejected by Dr. Warburton. The meaning seems to be, that she who acted upon principles contrary to others, should be buried with the same contrariety.

III.iii.43 (282,5) [only have a care that your bills be not stolen] A *bill* is still carried by the watchmen at Litchfield. It was the old weapon of the English infantry, which, says Temple, *gave the most ghastly and deplorable wounds*. It may be called *securis falcata*.

III.iv.44 (289,3) [Light o' love] A tune so called, which has been already mentioned by our authour.

III.iv.49 (290,4) [you'll look he shall lack no burns] A quibble between *barns*, repositories of corn, and *bairns*, the old word for children.

III.iv.56 (290,5) [For the letter that begins them all, H] This is a poor jest, somewhat obscured, and not worth the trouble of elucidation.

Margaret asks Beatrice for what she cries, *hey ho*; Beatrice answers, for an *H*, that is, for an *ache* or *pain*.

III.iv.57 (290,6) [turn'd Turk] [i.e. taken captive by love, and turned a renegade to his religion. Warburton.] This interpretation is somewhat far-fetched, yet, perhaps, it is right.

III.iv.78 (291,7) [some morel] That is, some secret meaning, like the *moral* of a fable.

III.iv.89 (291,8) [he eats his meat without grudging] I do not see how this is a proof of Benedick's change of mind. It would afford more proof of amourosness to say, *he eats not his meat without grudging*; but it is impossible to fix the meaning of proverbial expressions: perhaps, *to eat meat without grudging*, was the same as, *to do as others do*, and the meaning is, *he is content to live by eating like other mortals and will be content, notwithstanding his boasts, like other mortals, to have a wife*.

III.v.15 (293,9) [I am as honest as any man living, that is an old man, and no honester than I] [There is much humour, and extreme good sense under the covering of this blundering expression. It is a sly insinuation that length of years, and the being much *hacknied in the ways of men*, as Shakespeare expresses it, take off the gloss of virtue, and bring much defilement on the manners. Warburton.] Much of this is true, but I believe Shakespeare did not intend to bestow all this reflection on the speaker.

III.v.40 (294,1) [an two men ride of a horse, one must ride behind] This is not out of place, or without meaning. Dogberry, in his vanity of superiour parts, apologizing for his neighbour, observes, that *of two men on an horse, one must ride behind*. The *first* place of rank or understanding can belong but to *one*, and that happy *one* ought not to despise his inferiour.

IV.i.22 (296,2) [Interjections? Why, then some be of laughing] This is a quotation from the Accidence.

IV.i.42 (296,3) [luxurious bed] That is, *lascivious*. *Luxury* is the confessor's term for unlawful pleasures of the sex.

IV.i.53 (297,5) [word too large] So he uses *large jests* in this play, for *licitious, not restrained within due bounds*.

IV.i.57 (297,6) [I will write against it] [W: rate against] As to *subscribe* to any thing is to *allow* it, so to *write against* is to *disallow* or *deny*.

IV.i.59 (297,7) [chaste as is the bud] Before the air has tasted its sweetness.

IV.i.75 (298,8) [kindly power] That is, *natural power*. Kind is *nature*.

IV.i.93 (298,9) [liberal villain] *Liberal* here, as in many places of these plays, means, *frank beyond honesty or decency*. *Free of tongue*. Dr. Warburton unnecessarily reads, *illiberal*.

IV.i. 101 (299,1) [O Hero! What a Hero hadst thou been] I am afraid here is intended a poor conceit upon the word *Hero*.

IV.i.123 (300,2) [The story that is printed in her blood?] That is, *the story which her blushes discover to be true*.

IV.i.128 (300,3) [Griev'd I, I had but one? Chid I for that at frugal nature's frame?] [W: nature's 'fraine] Though *frame* be not the word which appears to a reader of the present time most proper to exhibit the poet's sentiment, yet it may as well be used to shew that he had *one child*, and *no more*, as that he had a *girl*, not a *boy*, and as it may easily signify *the system of things*, or *universal scheme*, the whole order of beings is comprehended, there arises no difficulty from it which requires to be removed by so violent an effort as the introduction of a new word offensively mutilated.

IV.i.137 (301,4) [But mine, and mine I lov'd, and mine I prais'd, And mine that I was proud on] [W: "as mine" in three places] Even of this small alteration there is no need. The speaker utters his emotion abruptly, But *mine*, and *mine* that *I loved*, &c. by an ellipsis frequent, perhaps too frequent, both in verse and prose.

IV.i.187 (303,6) [bent of honour] *Bent* is used by our authour for the utmost degree of any passion, or mental quality. In this play before Benedick says of Beatrice, *her affection has its full bent*. The expression is derived from archery; the bow has its *bent*, when it is drawn as far as it can be.

IV.i.206 (304,8) [ostentation] Show; appearance.

IV.i.251 (305,1) [The smallest twine nay lead me] This is one of our author's observations upon life. Men overpowered with distress, ea-

gerly listen to the first offers of relief, close with every scheme, and believe every promise. He that has no longer any confidence in himself, is glad to repose his trust in any other that will undertake to guide him.

IV.ii.70 (311,6) [*Sexton*. Let them be in hand] There is nothing in the old quarto different in this scene from the common copies, except that the names of two actors, Kempe and Cowley, are placed at the beginning of the speeches, instead of the proper words, (see 1765, III,249,7)

Vi.i.15 (313,7)

[If such a one will smile and stroke his beard;
And, sorrow wag! cry; hem, when he should groan]
Sir Thomas Hammer, and after him Dr. Warburton, for *wag* read *waive*, which is, I suppose, the same as, *put aside* or *shift off*.
None of these conjectures satisfy me, nor perhaps any other reader.

I cannot but think the true meaning nearer than it is imagined.

I point thus,

*If such an one will smile, and stroke his beard,
And, sorrow wag! cry; hem, when he should groan;*

That is, *If he will smile, and cry* sorrow be gone, and *hem* instead of groaning. The order in which *and* and *cry* are placed is harsh, and this harshness made the sense mistaken. Range the words in the common order, and my reading will be free from all difficulty.

*If such an one will smile, and stroke his beard,
Cry, sorrow, wag! and hem when he should groan.*

Vi.i.32 (314,8) [My griefs cry louder than advertisement] That is, than *admonition*, than *moral instruction*.

Vi.i.102 (318,4) [we will not wake your patience] [W: wrack] This emendation is very specious, and perhaps is right; yet the present reading may admit a congruous meaning with less difficulty than many other of Shakespeare's expressions.

The old men have been both very angry and outrageous; the prince tells them that he and Claudio *will not wake their patience*; will not any longer force them to *endure* the presence of those whom, though they look on them as enemies, they cannot resist.

V.i.138 (319,6) [to turn his girdle] We have a proverbial speech, *If he be angry, let him turn the buckle of his girdle*. But I do not know its original or meaning.

V.i.166 (320,7) [a wise gentleman] This jest depending on the colloquial use of words is now obscure; perhaps we should read, *a wise gentle man*, or *a man wise enough to be a coward*. Perhaps *wise gentleman* was in that age used ironically, and always stood for *silly fellow*.

V.i.231 (322,9) [one meaning well suited] That is, *one meaning is put into many different dresses*; the prince having asked the same question in four modes of speech.

V.ii.9 (326,3) [To have no man come over me? why, shall I always keep below stairs?] [T: above] I suppose every reader will find the meaning of the old copies.

V.ii.17 (327,4) [I give thee the bucklers] I suppose that *to give the bucklers* is, *to yield*, or *to lay by all thoughts of defence*, so *clipeum abjicere*. The rest deserves no comment.

V.iii.13 (330,7) [*Those that slew thy virgin knight*] *Knight*, in its original signification, means *follower* or *pupil*, and in this sense may be feminine. Helena, in *All's well that Ends well*, uses *knight* in the same signification.

LOVE'S LABOUR'S LOST

I.i.31 (342,2)

[To love, to wealth, to pomp, I pine and die;
With all these, living in philosophy]

The stile of the rhyming scenes in this play is often entangled and obscure. I know not certainly to what *all these* is to be referred; I suppose he means, that he finds *love, pomp, and wealth* in *philosophy*.

I.i.75 (344,4) [while truth the while Doth falsly blind] *Falsly* is here, and in many other places, the same as *dishonestly* or *treacherously*. The whole sense of this gingling declamation is only this, that *a man by too close study may read himself blind*, which might have been told with less obscurity in fewer words.

I.i.82 (344,5)

[Who dazzling so, that eye shall be his heed,
And give him light, that it was blinded by]

This is another passage unnecessarily obscure: the meaning is, that when he *dazzles*, that is, has his eye made weak, *by fixing his eye upon a fairer eye, that fairer eye shall be his heed*, his *direction* or *lode-star*, (See *Midsummer-Night's Dream*) [*and give him light that was blinded by it*.

I.i.92 (345,6)

[Too much to know, is, to know nought but fame;
And every godfather can give a name]

[W: "shame" or "feign"] That there are *two ways of setting* a passage *right* gives reason to suspect that there may be a third way better than either. The first of these emendations *makes a fine sense*, but will not unite with the next line; the other makes a sense less fine, and yet will not rhyme to the correspondent word. I cannot see why the passage may not stand without disturbance. *The consequence*, says Biron, *of too much knowledge*, is not any real solution of doubts, but mere empty *reputation*. That is, *too much knowledge gives only fame, a name which every godfather can give likewise*. (1773)

I.i.95 (345,7) [Proceeded well to stop all good proceeding] *To proceed* is an academical term, meaning, *to take a degree*, as he *proceeded bachelor in physick*. The sense is, *he has taken his degrees on the art of hindering the degrees of others*.

I.i.153 (348,1) [Not by might master'd, but by especial grace] Biron, amidst his extravagancies, speaks with great justness against the folly of vows. They are made without sufficient regard to the variations of life, and are therefore broken by some unforeseen necessity. They proceed commonly from a presumptuous confidence, and a false estimate of human power.

I.i.159 (349,2) [Suggestions] Temptations.

I.i.162 (349,3) [quick recreation] Lively sport, spritely diversion.

I.i.169 (349,4)

[A man of complements, whom right and wrong
Have chose as umpire of their mutiny]

This passage, I believe, means no more than that Don Armado was a man nicely versed in ceremonial distinctions, one who could distinguish in the most delicate questions of honour the exact boundaries of right and wrong. *Compliment*, in Shakespeare's time, did not signify, at least did not only signify verbal civility, or phrases of courtesy, but according to its original meaning, the trapping, or ornamental appendages of a character, in the same manner, and on the same principles of speech with *accomplishment*. *Compliment* is, as Arwado well expresses it, *the varnish of a complete man*.

I.i.174 (350,6) [in the world's debate] The *world* seems to be used in a monastick sense by the king, now devoted for a time to a monastic life. *In the world, in seculo*, in the bustle of human affairs, from which we are now happily sequestered, *in the world*, to which the votaries of solitude have no relation.

I.i.252 (353,1) [*base minnow of thy mirth*] A *minnow* is a little fish which cannot be intended here. We may read, *the base minion of thy mirth*.

I.ii.5 (355,2) [dear imp] *Imp* was anciently a term of dignity. Lord Cromwell in his last letter to Henry VIII. prays for *the imp his son*. It is now used only in contempt or abhorrence; perhaps in our authour's time it was ambiguous, in which state it suits well with this dialogue.

I.ii.36 (356,3) [crosses love not him] By *crosses* he means money. So in *As you like it*, the Clown says to Celia, *if I should bear you, I should bear no cross*.

I.ii.150 (360,7) [*Jaq.* Fair weather after you! *Dull.* Come, Jaquenetta, away]

[Theobald had reassigned two speeches] Mr. Theobald has endeavoured here to dignify his own industry by a very slight performance. The folios all read as he reads, except that instead of naming the persons they give their characters, enter *Clown*, *Constable*, and *Wench*.

I.ii.168 (361,8) [It is not for prisoners to be silent in their words] I suppose we should read, it is not for prisoners to be silent in their *wards*, that is, in *custody*, in the *holds*.

I.ii.183 (361,9) [The first and second cause will not serve my turn]
See the last act of *As you like it*, with the notes.

II.i.15 (362,1)

[Beauty is bought by judgment of the eye,
Not utter'd by base sale of chapmen's tongues]

Chapman here seems to signify the *seller*, not, as now commonly, the *buyer*. *Cheap* or *cheping* was anciently the *market*, *chapman* therefore is *marketman*. The meaning is, that *that the estimation of beauty depends not on the uttering or proclamation of the seller, but on the eye of the buyer*.

II.i.45 (363,2) [Well fitted] is *well qualified*.

II.i.49 (363,3) [match'd with] is *combined* or *joined* with.

II.i.105 (365,4) ['Tis deadly sin to keep that oath, my lord; And sin to break it] Sir T. Hammer reads,

Not *sin to break it*.

I believe erroneously. The Princess shews an inconvenience very frequently attending rash oaths, which, whether kept or broken, produce guilt.

II.i.203 (369,6) [God's blessing on your beard!] That is, mayst thou have sense and seriousness more proportionate to thy beard, the length of which suits ill with such idle catches of wit.

II.i.223 (370,7) [My lips are no common, though several they be] *Several*, is an inclosed field of a private proprietor, so Maria says, *her lips* are *private property*. Of a lord that was newly married one observed

that he grew fat; Yes, said sir Walter Raleigh, any beast will grow fat, if you take him from the *common* and graze him in the *several*.

II.i.238 (370,8) [His tongue, all impatient to speak and not see] That is, *his tongue being impatiently desirous to see as well as speak*.

II. i. 241 (370,9) [To feel only looking] Perhaps we may better read, *To feed only by looking*.

II. i. 262 (371,1) [*Boyet*. You are too hard for me] [Theobald did not end Act II here] Mr. Theobald has reason enough to propose this alteration, but he should not have made it in his book without better authority or more need. I have therefore preserved his observation, but continued the former division.

III.i (372,2) [*Enter Armado, and Moth.*] In the folios the direction is, *enter Braggart and Moth*, and at the beginning of every speech of Armado stands *Brag*, both in this and the foregoing scene between him and his boy. The other personages of this play are likewise noted by their characters as often as by their names. All this confusion has been well regulated by the later editors.

III.i.3 (372,3) [*Concolinel*] Here is apparently a song lost.

III. i. 22 (373,5) [These are complements] Dr. Warburton has here changed *complements* to '*complishments*, for accomplishments, but unnecessarily.

III. i. 32 (374,8) [but a colt] *Colt* is a hot, mad-brained, unbroken young fellow; or sometimes an old fellow with youthful desires.

III. i. 62 (375,9) [You are too swift, Sir, to say so] How is he too swift for saying that lead is slow? I fancy we should read, as well to supply the rhyme as the sense,

You are too swift, sir, to say so, so soon Is that lead slow, sir, which is fir'd from a gun?

III. i. 68 (375,1) [By thy favour, sweet welkin] Welkin is the sky, to which Armado, with the false dignity of a Spaniard, makes an apology for sighing in its face.

III. i. 73 (376,3) [no salve in the male, Sir] The old folio reads, *no salve in thee male, sir*, which, in another folio, is, *no salve, in the male, sir*. What it can mean is not easily discovered: if *mail* for a *packet* or *bag* was a word then in use, *no salve in the mail* may mean, no salve in the mountebank's budget. Or shall we read, *no enigma, no riddle, no l'envoy—in the vale, sir—O, sir. plantain*. The matter is not great, but one would wish for some meaning or other.

III. i.112 (377,5) [how was there a Costard broken in a shin?] *Costard* is the name of a species of apple.

III. i.136 (378,7) [my in-cony Jew] [W. jewel] I know not whether it be fit, however specious, to change *Jew* to *jewel*. *Jew*, in our author's time, was, for whatever reason, apparently a word of endearment. So in *Midsummer-Night's Dream*,

Most tender Juvenile, and eke most lovely Jew. (see 1765, II,144,9)

III.i.182 (381,2) [This signior Junto's giant-dwarf. Don Cupid] Mr. Upton has made a very ingenious conjecture on this passage. He reads,

This signior Julio's giant-dwarf —

Shakespeare, says he, intended to compliment Julio Romano, who drew Cupid in the character of a giant-dwarf. Dr. Warburton thinks, that by Junio is meant youth in general.

III.i.188 (382,3) [Of trotting paritors] An *apparitor*, or *paritor*. is an officer of the bishop's court who carries out citations; as citations are most frequently issued for fornication, the *paritor* is put under Cupid's government.

III.i.189 (382,4)

[And I to be a corporal of his field,
And wear his colours! like a tumbler's hoop!]

The conceit seems to be very forced and remote, however it be understood. The notion is not that the *hoop wears colours*, but that the colours are worn as a *tumbler* carries his *hoop*, hanging on one shoulder and falling under the opposite arm.

III.i.207 (383,5) [Some men must love my lady, and some Joan] To this line Mr. Theobald extends his second act, not injudiciously, but, as was before observed, without sufficient authority.

IV.i.19 (384,6) [Here,—good my glass] To understand how the princess has her glass so ready at hand in a casual conversation, it must be remembered that in those days it was the fashion among the French ladies to wear a looking-glass,' as Mr. Bayle coarsely represents it, *on their bellies*; that is, to have a small mirror set in gold hanging at the girdle, by which they occasionally viewed their faces or adjusted their hair.

IV.i.35 (385,8) [that my heart means no ill] [W: tho'] *That my heart means no ill*, is the same with *to whom my heart means no ill*; the common phrase suppresses the particle, as *I mean him* [not to him] *no harm*.

IV.i.41 (386,9) [a member of the commonwealth] Here, I believe, is a kind of jest intended; a member of the *common-wealth* is put for one of the *common* people, one of the meanest.

IV.i.49 (386,1)

[An' your waist, mistress, were as slender as my wit,
One o' these maids girdles for your waist should be fit]

[W: my waste ... your wit ... my waste] This conjecture is ingenious enough, but not well considered. It is plain that the ladies girdles would not fit the princess. For when she has referred the clown to *the thickest and the tallest*, he turns immediately to her with the blunt apology, *truth is truth*; and again tells her, *you are the thickest here*. If any alteration is to be made, I should propose,

An' your waist, mistress, were as slender as your wit.

This would point the reply; but perhaps he mentions the slenderness of his own wit to excuse his bluntness.

IV.i.59 (387,3) [Break the neck of the wax] Still alluding to the capon.

IV.i.65 (388,5) [*king* Cophetua] This story is again alluded to in Henry IV.

Let king Cophetua know the truth thereof.

But of this king and beggar, the story, then doubtless well known, is, I am afraid, lost. Zenelophon has not appearance of a female name, but since I know not the true none, it is idle to guess.

IV.i.99 (389,7) [ere while] Just now; a little while ago. So Raleigh,
Here lies Hobbinol our shepherd, while e'er.

IV.i.108 (390,9) [Come, lords, away] Perhaps the Princess said rather,
—*Come, ladies, away.*

The rest of the scene deserves no care.

IV.ii (392,2) [*Enter Dull, Holofernes, and Sir Nathaniel*] I am not of the learned commentator's [Wurburton] opinion, that the satire of Shakespeare is so seldom personal. It is of the nature of personal invectives to be soon unintelligible; and the authour that gratifies pri-

vate malice, *aniuam in vulnere ponit*, destroys the future efficacy of his own writings, and sacrifices the esteem of succeeding times to the laughter of a day. It is no wonder, therefore, that the sarcasms, which, perhaps, in the authour's time, *set the playhouse in a roar*, are now lost among general reflections. Yet whether the character of Holofernes was pointed at any particular man, I am, notwithstanding the plausibility of Dr. Warburton's conjecture, inclined to doubt. Every man adheres as long as he can to his own pre-conceptions. Before I read this note I considered the character of Holofernes as borrowed from the Rhombus of sir Philip Sidney, who, in a kind of pastoral entertainment, exhibited to queen Elizabeth, has introduced a school-master so called, speaking *a leash of languages at once*, and puzzling himself and his auditors with a jargon like that of Holofernes in the present play. Sidney himself might bring the character from Italy; for, as Peacham observes, the school-master has long been one of the ridiculous personages in the farces of that country.

IV.ii.29 (395,4)

[And such barren plants are set before us, that we
thankful should be,
Which we taste and feeling are for those parts that do fructify
in us, more than he]
Sir T. Hammer reads thus,
*And such barren plants are set before us, that we
thankful should be,
For those parts which we taste and feel do fructify
in us more than he.*

And Mr. Edwards, in his animadversions on Dr. Warburton's notes, applauds the emendation. I think both the editors mistaken, except that sir T. Hammer found the metre, though he missed the sense. I read, with a slight change,

*And such barren plants are set before us, that we
thankful should be,
When we taste and feeling are for those parts that
do fructify in us more than he.*

That is, *such barren plants* are exhibited in the creation, to make us *thankful when we have more taste and feeling than he, of those parts or qualities which produce fruit in us*, and preserve as from being likewise *barren plants*. Such is the sense, just in itself and pious, but a little clouded by the diction of sir Nathaniel. The length of these lines was

no novelty on the English stage. The moralities afford scenes of the like measure. (1773)

IV.ii.32 (396,5)

[For as it would ill become me to be vain, indiscreet,
or a fool;
So were there a patch set on learning, to see
him in a school]

The meaning is, to be in a school would as ill become a *patch*, or low fellow, as folly would become me.

IV.ii.99 (399,2) [*Vinegia. Vinegia, Chi non te vedi, ei non te pregia*] [This reading is an emendation by Theobald] The proverb, as I am informed, is this; *He that sees Venice little, values it much; he that sees it much, values it little*. But I suppose Mr. Theobald is right, for the true proverb would not serve the speaker's purpose.

IV.ii.156 (403,6) [colourable colours] That is specious, or fair seeming appearances.

IV.iii.3 (403,7) [I am toiling in a pitch] Alluding to lady Rosaline's complexion, who is through the whole play represented as a black beauty.

IV.iii.29 (404,8) [The night of dew, that on my cheeks down flows] I cannot think the *night of dew* the true reading, but know not what to offer.

IV.iii.47 (405,9) [he comes in like a perjure, wearing papers] The punishment of perjury is to wear on the breast a paper expressing the crime.

IV.iii.74 (406,2) [the liver-vein] The liver was anciently supposed to be the seat of love.

IV.iii.110 (408,5) [*Air, would I might triumph so!*] Perhaps we may better read,

Ah! *would I might triumph so!*

IV.iii.117 (409,7) [ay true love's fasting pain] [W: festring] There is no need of any alteration. *Fasting* is *longing, hungry, wanting*.

IV.iii.148 (410,8) [How will he triumph, leap, and laugh at it?]
[W: geap] To *leap* is to *exult*, to skip for joy. It must stand.

IV.iii.166 (410,9) [To see a king transformed to a knot!] *Knot* has no sense that can suit this place. We may read *sot*. The rhimes in this play are such, as that *sat* and *sot* may be well enough admitted.

IV.iii.180 (412,2) [With men like men] [W: vane-like] This is well imagined, but perhaps the poet may mean, with *men like* common *men*.

IV.iii.231 (414,3) [She (an attending star)] Something like this is a stanza of sir Henry Wotton, of which the poetical reader will forgive the insertion.

— *Ye stars, the train of night,*
That poorly satisfy our eyes
More by your number than your light:
Ye common people of the skies,
What are ye when the sun shall rise.

IV.iii.256 (415,6) [And beauty's crest becomes the heavens well] [W: crete] This emendation cannot be received till its authour can prove that *crete* is an English word. Besides, *crest* is here properly opposed to *badge*. *Black*, says the King, is the *badge of hell*, but that which graces the heaven is *the crest of beauty*. *Black* darkens hell, and is therefore hateful; *white* adorns heaven, and is therefore lovely.

IV.iii.290 (417,8) [affection's men at arms] *A man at arms*, is a soldier armed at all points both offensively and defensively. It is no more than, *Ye soldiers of affection*.

IV.iii.313 (418,2) [Teaches such beauty as a woman's eye] i.e. a lady's eyes gives a fuller notion of beauty than any authour.

IV.iii.321 (418,3) [In leaden contemplation have found out Such fiery numbers] *Numbers* are, in this passage, nothing more than *poetical measures*. *Could you*, says Biron, *by solitary contemplation, have attained such poetical fire, such spritely numbers, as have been prompted by the eyes of beauty?* The astronomer, by looking too much aloft, falls into a ditch.

IV.iii.358 (422,9)

[Or for love's sake, a word, that loves all men;
 Or for men's sake, the author of these women;
 Or women's sake, by whom we men are men]
 Perhaps we might read thus, transposing the lines,
Or for love's sake, a word that loves all men;
For women's sake, by whom we men are men;
Or for men's sake, the authours of these women.

The antithesis of *a word that all men love*, and *a word which loves all men*, though in itself worth little, has much of the spirit of this play.

IV.iii.386 (423,2) [If so, our copper buys no better treasure] Here Mr. Theobald ends the third act.

Vi.3 (423,3) [your reasons at dinner have been sharp and sententious] I know not well what degree of respect Shakespeare intends to obtain for this vicar, but he has here put into his mouth a finished representation of colloquial excellence. It is very difficult to add any thing to this character of the school-master's table-talk, and perhaps all the precepts of Castiglione will scarcely be found to comprehend a rule for conversation so justly delineated, so widely dilated, and so nicely limited.

It may be proper just to note, that *reason* here, and in many other places, signifies *discourse*; and that *audacious* is used in a good sense for *spirited, animated, confident*. *Opinion* is the same with *obstinacy* or *opinionated*.

Vi.14 (424,4) [He is too picked] To have the beard *piqued* or shorn so as to end in a point, was, in our authour's time, a mark of a traveller affecting foreign fashions: so says the Bastard in K. John, —I catechise *My piqued man of countries*.

Vi.29 (425,6) [(*Ne intelligis, Domine.*) to make frantick, lunatick?] There seems yet something wanting to the integrity of this passage, which Mr. Theobald has in the most corrupt and difficult places very happily restored. For *ne intelligis domine, to make frantick, lunatick*, I read, (*nonne intelligis, domine?*) to be mad, frantick, lunatick.

Vi.44 (427,6) [*honorificabilitudinitatibus*] This word, whencesoever it comes, is often mentioned as the longest word known. (1773)

V.i.110 (429,6) [dally with my excrement] The authour has before called the beard *valour's excrement* in the Merchant of Venice.

V.ii.43 (432,5) ['Ware pencils!] The former editions read,

Were *pencils* — —

Sir T. Hammer here rightly restored,

'Ware *pencils* — —

Rosaline, a black beauty, reproaches the fair Catherine for painting.

V.ii.69 (434,9) [None are so surely caught when they are catch'd, As wit turn'd fool] These are observation worthy of a man who has surveyed human nature with the closest attention.

V.ii.87 (434,1) [Saint Dennis to St. Cupid!] The Princess of France invokes, with too much levity, the patron of her country, to oppose his power to that of Cupid.

V.ii.117 (435,2) [spleen ridiculous] is, a ridiculous *fit*.

V.ii.205 (439,5) [Vouchsafe, bright moon, and these thy stars] When queen Elizabeth asked an ambassadour how he liked her ladies, *It is hard*, said he, *to judge of stars in the presence of the sun*.

V.ii.235 (440,6) [Since you can cog] To *cog* signifies *to falsify the dice*, and *to falsify a narrative*, or *to lye*.

V.ii.281 (442,7) [better wits have worn plain statute-caps] This line is not universally understood, because every reader does not know that a statute cap is part of the academical habit. Lady Rosaline declares that her expectation was disappointed by these courtly students, and that *better wits* might be found in the common places of education. [Gray had offered a different explanation] I think my own interpretation of this passage right. (see 1765, II,197,3)

V.ii.295 (443,8)

[Fair ladies, mask'd, are roses in their bud;

Dismask'd, their damask sweet commixture shewn,

Are angels vailing clouds, or roses blown]

[Hammer: angels vailing clouds] [Warburton exercised his sarcasm on this] I know not why Sir T. Hanmer's explanation should be treated with so much contempt, or why *vailing clouds* should be *cap-ping the sun*. *Ladies unmask'd*, says Boyet, *are like angels vailing clouds*,

or letting those clouds which obscured their brightness, sink from before them. What is there in this absurd or contemptible?

V.ii.309 (444,1) [*Exeunt ladies*] Mr. Theobald ends the fourth act here.

V.ii.337 (447,4) [—behaviour, what wert thou, 'Till this mad man shew'd thee? and what art thou now?] [These are two wonderfully fine lines, intimating that what courts call *manners*, and value themselves so much upon teaching, as a thing no where else to be learnt, is a modest silent accomplishment under the direction of nature and common sense, which does its office in promoting social life without being taken notice of. But that when it degenerates into shew and parade, it becomes an unmanly contemptible quality. Warburton.] What is told in this note is undoubtedly true, but is not comprised in the quotation.

V.ii.348 (448,5) [The virtue of your eye must break my oath] I believe the author means that the *virtue*, in which word *goodness* and *power* are both comprised, *must dissolve* the obligation of the oath. The Princess, in her answer, takes the most invidious part of the ambiguity.

V.ii.374 (449,6)

[when we greet
With eyes best seeing, heaven's fiery eye,
By light we lose light: your capacity
Is of that nature, as to your huge store
Wise things seem foolish, and rich things but poor]
This is a very lofty and elegant compliment.

V.ii.419 (450,7) [Write, *Lord have mercy on us*, on those three] This was the inscription put upon the door of the houses infected with the plague, to which Biron compares the love of himself and his companions; and pursuing the metaphor finds the *tokens* likewise on the ladies. The *tokens* of the plague are the first spots or discolorations, by which the infection is known to be received.

V.ii.426 (451,8) [how can this be true, That you stand forfeit, being those that sue?] That is, how can those be liable to forfeiture that begin the process. The jest lies in the ambiguity of *sue*, which signifies *to prosecute by law*, or *to offer a petition*.

V.ii.440 (451,9) [you force not to forswear] *You force not* is the same with *you make no difficulty*. This is a very just observation. The crime which has been once committed, is committed again with less reluctance.

V.ii.471 (452,2) [in will and error. Much upon this it is:—And might not you] I, believe this passage should be read thus,

—*in will and error*. Boyet. *Much upon this it is*. Biron. *And might not you, &c.*

V.ii.490 (453,5) [You cannot beg us] That is, we are not fools, our next relations cannot *beg* the wardship of our persons and fortunes. One of the legal tests of a *natural* is to try whether he can number.

V.ii.517 (454,6)

[That sport best pleases, that doth least know how.

Where zeal strives to content, and the contents

Dies in the zeal of that which it presents]

The third line may be read better thus,

—*the contents Die in the zeal of him which them presents*.

This sentiment of the Princess is very natural, but less generous than that of the Amazonian Queen, who says, on a like occasion, in *Midsummer-Night's Dream*,

I love not to see wretchedness o'ercharg'd, Nor duty in his service perishing.

V.ii.547 (455,8) [A bare throw at novum] This passage I do not understand. I fancy that *novum* should be *novem*, and that some allusion is intended between the play of *nine pins* and the play of the *nine* worthies, but it lies too deep for my investigation.

V.ii.581 (457,2) [A-jax] There is a conceit of *Ajax* and *a jakes*.

V.ii.694 (461,4) [more Ates] That is, more instigation. Ate was the mischievous goddess that incited bloodshed.

V.ii.702 (461,5) [my arms] The weapons and armour which he wore in the character of Pompey.

V.ii.744 (463,8) [In the converse of breath] Perhaps *converse* may, in this line, mean *interchange*.

V.ii.755 (464,2) [which fain it would convince] We must read,

—*which fain* would it *convince*;

that is, the entreaties of love which would fain *over-power* grief. So Lady Macbeth declares, *That she will convince the chamberlain with wine.*

V.ii.762 (464,3) [Honest plain words best pierce the ear of grief] As it seems not very proper for Biron to court the princess for the king in the king's presence, at this critical moment, I believe the speech is given to a wrong person. I read thus,

Prin. *I understand you not, my griefs are double:*

Honest plain words best pierce the ear of grief.

King. *And by these badges, &c.*

V.ii.779 (465,4) [Suggested us] That is, *tempted* us.

V.ii.790 (465,5) [As bombast, and as lining to the time] This line is obscure. *Bombast* was a kind of loose texture not unlike what is now called wadding, used to give the dresses of that time bulk and protruberance, without much increase of weight; whence the same name is given a tumour of words unsupported by solid sentiment. The Princess, therefore, says, that they considered this courtship as but *bombast*, as something to fill out life, which not being closely united with it, might be thrown away at pleasure.

V.ii.795 (466,7) [We did not quote them so] [We should read, *quote*, esteem, reckon. Warburton] though our old writers spelling by the ear, probably wrote *cote*, as it was pronounced. (see 1765, II,218,5)

V.ii.823 (467,8) [To flatter up these powers of mine with rest] Dr. Warburton would read *fetter*, but *flatter* or *sooth* is, in my opinion, more apposite to the king's purpose than *fetter*. Perhaps we may read,

To flatter on these hours of time with rest;

That is, I would not deny to live in the hermitage, to make the year of delay pass in quiet.

V.ii.873 (469,2) [dear groans] *Dear* should here, as in many other places, be *dere*, sad, odious.

V.ii.904 (470,3) [*When daisies pied, and violets blue*] The first lines of this song that were transposed, have been replaced by Mr. Theobald.

V.ii.907 (470,5) [*Do paint the meadows with delight*] [W: much bedight]
Much less elegant than the present reading.

(472,7) General Observation. In this play, which all the editors have concurred to censure, and some have rejected as unworthy of him.

A MIDSUMMER-NIGHT'S DREAM

I.i.6 (4,2) [Long withering out a young man's revenue] [W: wintering] That the common reading is not good English, I cannot perceive, and therefore find in myself no temptation to change it.

I.i.47 (5,6) [To leave the figure, or disfigure it] [W: 'leve] I know not why so harsh a word should be admitted with so little need, a word that, spoken, could not be understood, and of which no example can be shown. The sense is plain, *you owe to your father a being which he may at pleasure continue or destroy.*

I.i.68 (6,8) [Know of your youth] Bring your youth to the question.

Consider your youth. (1773)

I.i.76 (7,9) [But earthlier happy is the rose distill'd] Thus all the copies, yet *earthlier* is so harsh a word, and *earthlier happy* for *happier earthly*, a mode of speech so unusual, that I wonder none of the editors have proposed *earlier happy*.

I.i.110 (8,2) [spotted] As *spotless* is innocent, so *spotted* is wicked. (1773)

I.i.131 (9,3) [Beteem them] give them, bestow upon then. The word is used by Spenser.

I.i.157 (10,8) [I have a widow aunt, a dowager] These lines perhaps might more properly be regulated thus:

*I have a widow aunt, a dowager
Of great revenue, and she hath no child,
And she respects me as her only son;
Her house from Athens is remov'd seven leagues,
There, gentle Hermia, may I marry thee,
And to that place—*

I.i.169-178 (11,1) [Warburton had reassigned speeches here] This emendation is judicious, but not necessary. I have therefore given the note without altering the text. The censure of men, as oftner perjured than women, seems to make that line more proper for the lady.

I.i.183 (12,3) [Your eyes are lode-stars] This was a complement not unfrequent among the old poets. The lode star is the *leading* or guiding star, that is, the pole-star. The magnet is, for the same reason, called the *lode-stone*, either because it leads iron, or because it guides the sailor. Milton has the same thought in L'Allegro:

*Tow'rs and battlements he sees
Bosom'd high in tufted trees,
Where perhaps some beauty lies,
The Cynosure of neighb'ring eyes.*

Davies calls Elizabeth, *lode-stone* to hearts, and *lode-stone* to all eyes, (see 1765, 1,97,9)

I.i.204 (13,6)

[Before the time I did Lysander see,
Seem'd Athens like a paradise to me]

Perhaps every reader may not discover the propriety of these lines. Hermia is willing to comfort Helena, and to avoid all appearance of triumph over her. She therefore bids her not to consider the power of pleasing, as an advantage to be much envied or much desired, since Hermia, whom she considers as possessing it in the supreme degree, has found no other effect of it than the loss of happiness.

I.i.232 (15,8) [Things base and vile, holding no quantity] *quality* seems a word more suitable to the sense than quantity, but either may serve. (1773)

I.i.240 (15,9) [in game] *Game* here signifies not contentious play, but *sport, jest*. So Spenser,

'Twixt earnest and 'twixt game.

I.ii (16,2) [*Enter Quince the carpenter, Snug the joiner. Bottom the weaver. Flute the bellows-mender. Snout the tinker, and Starveling the taylor*] In this scene Shakespeare takes advantage of his knowledge of the theatre, to ridicule the prejudices and competitions of the players. Bottom, who is generally acknowledged the principal actor, declares his inclination to be for a tyrant, for a part of fury, tumult, and noise, such as every young man pants to perform when he first steps upon the stage. The same Bottom, who seems bred in a tiring-room, has another histrionical passion. He is for engrossing every part, and would exclude his inferiors from all possibility of distinction. He is

therefore desirous to play Pyramus, Thisbe, and the Lyon at the same time.

I.ii.10 (17,4) [grow on to a point] Dr. Warburton read *go on*; but *grow* is used, in allusion to his name, Quince. (see 1765, I,100,8)

I.ii.52 (18,6)

[*Flu.* Nay, faith, let me not play a woman; I have a beard coming.
Quin. That's all one, you shall play it in a masque; and you may speak as small as you will]

This passage shews how the want of women on the old stage was supplied. If they had not a young man who could perform the part with a face that might pass for feminine, the character was acted in a mask, which was at that time part of a lady's dress so much in use that it did not give any unusual appearance to the scene: and he that could modulate his voice in a female tone might play the women very successfully. It is observed in Downes's Memoirs of the Playhouse, that one of these counterfeit heroines moved the passions more strongly than the women that have since been brought upon the stage. Some of the catastrophes of the old comedies, which make lovers marry the wrong women, are, by recollection of the common use of masks, brought nearer to probability.

I.ii.98 (20,8) [*Bot.* I will discharge it in either your straw-coloured beard, your orange tawny beard, your purple-in grain beard, or your French crown-coloured beard; your perfect yellow] Here Bottom again discovers a true genius for the stage by his solicitude for propriety of dress, and his deliberation which beard to chuse among many beards, all unnatural.

II.i.2 (21,3) [Over hill, over dale] So Drayton in his Court of Fairy,

Thorough brake, thorough brier. Thorough muck, thorough mire. Thorough water, thorough fire.

II.i.9 (22,4) [To dew her orbs upon the green] For *orbs* Dr. Gray is inclined to substitute *herbs*. The orbs here mentioned are the circles supposed to be made by the Fairies on the ground, whose verdure proceeds from the fairy's care to water them.

They in their courses make that round, In meadows and in marshes found, Of then so called the fairy ground. Drayton.

II.i.10 (22,5) [The cowslips tall her pensioners be] The cowslip was a favourite among the fairies. There is a hint in Drayton of their attention to May morning.

—*for the queen a fitting tow'r, Quoth he, is that fair cowslip flow'r. — In all your train there's not a fay That ever went to gather May, But she hath made it in her way, The tallest there that groweth.*

II.i.16 (22,7) [lob of spirits] *Lob, lubber, looby, lobcock*, all denote both inactivity of body and dulness of mind.

II.i.23 (23,8) [changeling] *Changeling* is commonly used for the child supposed to be left by the fairies, but here for the child taken away.

II.i.29 (23,9) [sheen] Shining, bright, gay.

II.i.30 (23,1) [But they do square] [To *square* here is to quarrel. *And now you are such fools to square for this?* Gray.]

The French word *contrecarrer* has the same import.

II.i.36 (24,4)

[Skim milk; and sometimes labour in the quern,
And bootless make the breathless huswife churn]

The sense of these lines is confused. *Are not you he*, says the fairy, *that fright the country girls. that skim milk, work in the hand-mill, and make the tired dairy-woman churn without effect?* The mention of the mill seem out of place, for she is not now telling the good but the evil that he does. I would regulate the lines thus:

And sometimes make the breathless housewife churn Skim milk, and bootless labour in the quern.

Or by a simple transposition of the lines;

And bootless, make the breathless housewife churn Skim milk, and sometimes labour in the quern.

Yet there is no necessity of alteration. (see 1765, I,106,1)

II.i.40 (24,6) [Those that Hobgoblin call you, and sweet Puck, You do their work] To those traditionary opinions Milton has reference in *L'Allegro*,

*Then to the spicy nut-brown ale,
With stories told of many a feat.
How Fairy Mab the junkets eat;
She was pinch'd and pull'd she said.
And he by Frier's lapthorp led;*

*Tells how the drudging goblin sweat
 To earn his cream-bowl duly set,
 When in one night ere glimpse of morn
 His shadowy flail had thresh'd the corn
 Which ten day-labourers could not end.
 Then lies him down the lubber fiend.
 A like account of Puck is given by Drayton,
 He meeteth Puck, which most men call
 Hobgoblin, and on him doth fall. —
 This Puck seems but a dreaming dolt,
 Still walking like a ragged colt,
 And oft out of a bed doth bolt,
 Of purpose to deceive us;
 And leading us makes us to stray.
 Long winter's nights out of the way.
 And when we stick in mire and clay.
 He doth with laughter leave us.*

It will be apparent to him that shall compare Drayton's poem with this play, that either one of the poets copied the other, or, as I rather believe, that there was then some system of the fairy empire generally received, which they both represented as accurately as they could. Whether Drayton or Shakespeare wrote first, I cannot discover.

II.i.42 (25,7) [*Puck*. Thou speak'st aright] I have filled up the verse which I suppose the author left complete,

It seems that in the Fairy mythology Puck, or Hobgoblin, was the trusty servant of Oberon, and always employed to watch or detect the intrigues of Queen Mab, called by Shakespeare Titania. For in Drayton's *Nymphidia*, the same fairies are engaged in the same business. Mab has an amour with Pigwiggen; Oberon being jealous, sends Hobgoblin to catch them, and one of Mab's nymphs opposes him by a spell.

II.i.54 (26,8) [And *taylor* cries] The custom of crying *taylor* at a sudden fall backwards, I think I remember to have observed. He

that slips beside his chair falls as a taylor squats upon his board. The Oxford editor and Dr. Warburton after him, read *and rails or cries*, plausibly, but I believe not rightly. Besides, the trick of the fairy is represented as producing rather merriment than anger.

II.i.56 (26,9) [And waxen] And *encrease*, as the *moon waxes*.

II.i.58 (26,1) [But room, Faery] All the old copies read—*But room Fairy*. The word Fairy or Faery, was sometimes of three syllables, as often in Spenser.

II.i.84 (28,5) [paved fountain] A fountain laid round the edge with stone.

II.i.88 (28,6) [the winds, piping] So Milton,
While rocking winds are piping loud.

II.i.91 (28,7) [pelting river] Thus the quarto's: the folio reads *petty*.

Shakespeare has in *Lear* the same word, *low pelting farms*. The meaning is plainly, *despicable, mean, sorry, wretched*; but as it is a word without any reasonable etymology, I should be glad to dismiss it for *petty*, yet it is undoubtedly right. We have *petty pelting officer* in *Measure for Measure*.

II.i.92 (28,8) [over-born their continents] Born down the banks that contained then. So in *Lear*,

Close pent guilts
Rive their concealing continents.

II.i.98 (29,1) [The nine-men's morris] This was some kind of rural game played in a marked ground. But what it was more I have not found.

II.i.100 (29,2) [The human mortals want their winter here] After all the endeavours of the editors, this passage still remains to me unintelligible. I cannot see why winter is, in the general confusion of the year now described, more wanted than any other season. Dr. Warburton observes that he alludes to our practice of singing carols in December; but though Shakespeare is no great chronologer in his dramas, I think he has never so mingled true and false religion, as to give us reason for believing that he would make the moon incensed for the omission of our carols. I therefore imagine him to have meant heathen rites of adoration. This is not all the difficulty. Titania's account of this calamity is not sufficiently consequential. *Men find no winter*, therefore they sing no hymns; the moon provoked by this omission, alters the seasons: that is, the alteration of the seasons produces the alteration of the seasons. I am far from supposing that Shakespeare

might not sometimes think confusedly, and therefore am not sure that the passage is corrupted. If we should read,

And human mortals want their wonted year,

yet will not this licence of alteration much mend the narrative;

the cause and the effect are still confounded. Let us carry critical temerity a little further. Scaliger transposed the lines of Virgil's Gallus. Why may not the same experiment be ventured upon Shakespeare.

The human mortals want their wonted year,

The seasons alter; hoary-headed frosts

Fall in the fresh lap of the crimson rose;

And on old Hyems' chin, and icy crown,

An od'rous chaplet of sweet summer buds

Is, as in mock'ry set. The spring, the summer,

The chiding autumn, angry winter, change

Their wonted liveries; and the 'mazed world,

By their increase, now knows not which is which.

No night is now with hymn or carol blest;

Therefore the moon, the governess of floods,

Pale in her anger, washes all the air;

And thorough this distemperature, we see

That rheumatick diseases do abound.

And this same progeny of evil comes

From our debate, from our dissension.

I know not what credit the reader will give to this emendation, which I do not much credit myself.

II.i.114 (31,4) [By their increase] That is, *By their produce*.

II.i.130 (32,6) [Which she, with pretty and with swimming gate, Following] [cf: follying] The foregoing note is very ingenious, but since *follying* is a word of which I know not any example, and the Fairy's favourite might, without much licentiousness of language, be said to *follow* a ship that sailed in the direction of the coast; I think there is no sufficient reason for adopting it. The coinage of new words is a violent remedy, not to be used but in the last necessity.

II.i.157 (35,8) [Cupid all-arm'd] *All-armed*, does not signify *dressed in panoply*, but only enforces the word *armed*, as we might say *all-booted*. I am afraid that the general sense of *alarmed*, by which it is used for *put into fear or care by whatever cause*, is later than our authour.

II.i.220 (38,4) [For that It is not night when I do see your face]
 This passage is paraphrased from two lines of an ancient poet,
 — *Tu nocte vel atra*
Lumen, et in solis tu mihi turba locis.
 (see 1765, I,118,6)

II.i.251 (39,5) [over-canopy'd with the luscious woodbine] All the old editions have,

Quite *over-canopied with luscious woodbine.*

On the margin of one of my folio's an unknown hand has written *lush* woodbine, which, I think, is right.

This hand I have since discovered to be Theobald's, (see 1765, I,119,4)

II.ii. (41,9) [quaint spirits] For this Dr. Warburton reads against all authority,

— — *quaint* sports. — —

But Prospero, in *The Tempest*, applies *quaint* to Ariel.

II.ii.30 (42.2) [Be it ounce]
 The ounce is a snail tiger, or tiger-cat. (1773)

II.ii.45 (43,3)

[O take the sense, sweet, of my innocence;

Love takes the meaning in love's conference]

[Warburton wished to transpose "innocence" and "conference"]

I am by no means convinced of the necessity of this alteration. Lysander in the language of love professes, that as they have one heart, they shall have one bed; this Hernia thinks rather too much, and intreats him to *lye further off*. Lysander answers,

O take the sense, sweet, of my innocence.

understand *the meaning of my innocence, or my innocent meaning*. Let no suspicion of ill enter thy mind.

Love takes the meaning, in love's conference.

In the conversation of those who are assured of each other's kindness, not *suspicion*, but *love takes the meaning*. No malevolent interpretation is to be made, but all is to be received in the sense which *love* can find, and which *love* can dictate.

II.ii.89 (45,6) [my grace] My acceptableness, the favour that I can gain. (1773)

II.ii.120 (46,7) [Reason becomes the marshal to my will] That is,
My will now follows reason.

III.i (48,3) In the time of Shakespeare, there were many companies of players, sometimes five at the same time, contending for the favour of the publick. Of these some were undoubtedly very unskilful and very poor, and it is probable that the design of this scene was to ridicule their ignorance, and the odd expedients to which they might be driven by the want of proper decorations. Bottom was perhaps the head of a rival house, and is therefore honoured with an ass's head.

III.i.110 (52,8) [Through bog, through bush, through brake, through bryer] Here are two syllables wanting. Perhaps, it was written,
Through bog, through mire, — — —

III.i.116 (52,9) [to make me afeard]

Afeard is from *to fear*, by the old form of the language, as *an hungred*, from *to hunger*. So *adry*, for *thirsty*. (1773)

III.i.117 (52,1) [O Bottom! thou art chang'd! what do I see on thee?]
It is plain by Bottom's answer, that Snout mentioned an *ass's head*. Therefore we should read,

Snout. *O Bottom, thou art changed! what do I see on thee? An ass's head?*

III.i.141 (53,3) [Mine ear is much enamour'd of thy note,]

So is mine eye enthralled to thy shape;

And thy fair virtue's force

(perforce) [doth move me, On the first view to say, to swear I love thee]

These lines are in one quarto of 1600, the first folio of 1623, the second of 1632, and the third of 1664, &c. ranged in the following order:

Mine ear is much enamour'd of thy note.

On the first view to say, to swear, I love thee;

So is mine eye enthralled to thy shape,

And thy fair virtue's force (perforce) [doth move me.

This reading I have inserted, not that it can suggest any thing better than the order to which the lines have been restored by Mr. Theobald from another quarto, but to shew that some liberty of conjecture must be allowed in the revisal of works so inaccurately printed, and so long neglected.

III.i.173 (55,6) [the fiery glow-worm's eyes] I know not how Shakespeare, who commonly derived his knowledge of nature from his own observation, happened to place the glow-worm's light in his eyes, which is only in his tail.

III.ii.9 (56,1) [patches] *Patch* was in old language used as a term of opprobry; perhaps with much the same import as we use *raggamuffin*, or *tatterdemalion*.

III.ii.17 (56,2) [nowl] A head. Saxon.

III.ii.19 (57,4) [minnock] This is the reading of the old quarto, and I believe right, *Minnekin*, now *minx*, is a nice trifling girl. *Minnock* is apparently a word of contempt.

III.ii.21 (57,5) [sort] Company. So above,
 — *that barren sort*;
 and in Waller,
A sort of lusty shepherds strive.

III.ii.25 (57,6) [And, at our stamp] This seems to be a vicious reading. Fairies are never represented stamping, or of a size that should give force to a stamp, nor could they have distinguished the stamps of Puck from those of their own companions. I read,

And at a stump here o'er and o'er one falls.
 So Drayton,
A pain he in his head-piece feels,
Against a stubbed tree he reels,
And up went poor hobgoblin's heels;
Alas, his brain was dizzy. — —
At length upon his feet he gets,
Hobgoblin fumes, Hobgoblin frets,
And as again he forward sets,
And through the bushes scrambles,
A stump doth trip him in his pace,
Down fell poor Hob upon his face,
Among the briars and brambles.

III.ii.30 (58,7) [Some, sleeves; some, hats] There is the like image in Drayton of queen Mab and her fairies flying from Hobgoblin.

Some tore a ruff, and some a gown,
'Gainat one another jostling;

*They flew about like chaff i' th' wind,
For haste some left their masks behind,
Some could not stay their gloves to find,
There never was such bustling.*

III.ii.48 (58,1) [Being o'er shoes in blood] An allusion to the proverb, *Over shoes, over boots.*

III.ii.70 (59,3) [O brave touch!] *Touch* in Shakespeare's time was the same with our *exploit*, or rather *stroke*. A brave touch, a noble stroke, *un grand coup*. *Mason was very merry, pleasantly playing both with the shrewd touches of many curst boys, and the small discretion of many lewd schoolmasters.* Ascham.

III.ii.74 (60,4) [mispris'd] Mistaken; so below *misprision* is mistake.

III.ii.141 (62,5) [Taurus' snow] Taurus is the name of a range of mountains in Asia.

III.ii.144 (62,7) [seal of bliss!] Be has elsewhere the same image,
But my kisses bring again Seals of love, but seal'd in vain, (rev. 1778, III,74,4)

III.ii.150 (62,8) [join in souls] This is surely wrong. We may read, *Join in scorns*, or *join in scoffs*. [Tyrwhitt: join, ill souls] This is a very reasonable conjecture, though I think it is hardly right. (1773)

III.ii.160 (63,9) [extort A poor soul's patience] Harrass, torment.

III.ii.171 (63,1) [My heart with her] We should read,
My heart with her but as guest-wise sojourn'd.
So Prior,
*No matter what beauties I saw in my way,
They were but my visits, but then not my home.* (rev. 1778, III,76,9)

III.ii.188 (64,2) [all yon fiery O's] I would willingly believe that the poet wrote *fiery orbs*.

III.ii.194 (64,3) [in spite to me] I read, *in spite to me*.

III.ii.242 (66,2) [such an argument] Such a *subject* of light merriment.

III.ii.352 (71,1) [so sort] So happen in the issue.

III.ii.367 (71,2) [virtuous property] Salutiferous. So be calls, in the Tempest, *poisonous dew*, wicked *dew*.

III.ii.426 (74,5) [buy this dear] i.e. *thou shalt dearly pay for this*. Though this is sense, and may well enough stand, yet the poet perhaps wrote *thou shalt 'by it dear*. So in another place, *thou shalt* aby it. So Milton, *How dearly I abide that boust so vain*.

IV.i (75,6) I see no reason why the fourth act should begin here, when there seems no interruption of the action. In the old quartos of 1600, there is no division of acts, which seems to have been afterwards arbitrarily made in the first folio, and may therefore be altered at pleasure, (see 1765, I,149,5)

IV.i.2 (75,7) [do coy] To *coy* is to sooth. Skinner, (rev. 1778, III, 89,6)

IV.i.45 (77,2) [So doth the woodbine, the sweet honey-suckle, Gently entwist] Mr. Upton reads,

So doth the woodrine the sweet honey-suckle,

for bark of the wood. Shakespeare perhaps only meant so, the leaves involve the flower, using *woodbine* for the plant and *honeysuckle* for the flower; or perhaps Shakespeare made a blunder, (rev. 1778, III,91,2)

IV.i.107 (81,9) [our observation is perform'd] The honours due to the morning of May. I know not why Shakespear calls this play a *Midsummer- Night's Dream*, when he so carefully informs us that it happened on the night preceding *May* day.

IV.i.123 (81,4) [so sanded] So marked with small spots.

IV.i.166 (83,6) [Fair Helena in fancy following me] *Fancy* is here taken for *love* or *affection*, and is opposed to *fury*, as before.

Sighs and tears poor Fancy's followers.

Some now call that which a man takes particular delight in his *Fancy*. *Flower-fancier*, for a florist, and *bird-fancier*, for a lover and feeder of birds, are colloquial words.

IV.i.194 (84,6) [And I have found Demetrius like a jewel] [W: gewell]

This emendation is ingenious enough to deserve to be true.

IV.i.213 (85,8) [patch'd fool] That is, a fool in a particolour'd coat.

IV.ii.14 (86,2) [a thing of nought] which Mr. Theobald changes with great pomp to *a thing of naught*, is, a *good for nothing thing*.

IV.ii.18 (86,3) [made men] In the same sense us in the *Tempest*, *any monster in England makes a man*.

V.i.2-22 (88,4)

[More strange than true. I never may believe
These antique fables, nor these fairy toys]

These beautiful lines are in all the old editions thrown out of metre. They are very well restored by the later editors.

V.i.26 (89,5) [constancy] Consistency; stability; certainty.

V.i.79 (92,4) [Unless you can find sport in their intents] Thus all the copies. But as I know not what it is to *stretch* and *con* an *intent*, I suspect a line to be lost.

V.i.91 (92,5)

[And what poor duty cannot do,
Noble respect takes it in might, not merit.]

The sense of this passage, as it now stands, if it has any sense, is this: *What the inability of duty cannot perform, regardful generosity receives as an act of ability, though not of merit*. The contrary is rather true: *What dutifulness tries to perform without ability, regardful generosity receives as having the merit, though not the power, of complete performance*.

We should therefore read,

And what poor duty cannot do, Noble respect takes not in might, but merit.

V.i.147 (95,4) [Whereat, with blade, with bloody blameful blade] Mr. Upton rightly observes, that Shakespeare in this line ridicules the affectation of beginning many words with the same letter. He might have remarked the same of

The raging rocks and shivering shocks.

Gascoigne, contemporary with our poet, remarks and blames the same affectation.

V.i.199 (97,6) [And like Limander am I trusty still] Limander and Helen, are spoken by the blundering player, for Leander and

Hero.

Shafalus and Procrus, for Cephalus and Procris.

Vi.254 (99,1) [in snuff] An equivocation. *Snuff* signifies both the cinder of a caudle, and hasty anger.

Vi.379 (104,2) [And the wolf beholds the moon] [W: behowls] The alteration is better than the original reading; but perhaps the author meant only to say, that the wolf *gazes at* the moon, (see 1765, I,173,2)

Vi.396 (105,4)

[I am sent, with broom, before,
To sweep the dust behind the door]

Cleanliness is always necessary to invite the residence and the favour of Fairies.

*These make our girls their slutt'ry rue,
By pinching them both black and blue.
And put a penny in their shoe
The house for cleanly sweeping.* Drayton.

Vi.398 (105,5) [Through this house give glimmering light] Milton perhaps had this picture in his thought:

Glowing cabers through the room Teach light to counterfeit a gloom. Il Penseroso.

So Drayton:

*Hence shadows seeming idle shapes
Of little frisking elves and apes,
To earth do make their wanton 'scapes
As hope of pastime hastes them.*

I think it should be read,
Through this house in glimmering light.

Vi.408 (106,6) [Now, until the break of day] This speech, which both the old quartos give to Oberon, is in the edition of 1623, and in all the following, printed as the song. I have restored it to Oberon, as it apparently contains not the blessing which he intends to bestow on the bed, but his declaration that he will bless it, and his orders to the fairies how to perform the necessary rites. But where then is the song?—I am afraid it is gone after many other things of greater value. The truth is that two songs are lost. The series of the scene is this; after the speech of Puck, Oberon enters, and calls his fairies to a song, which song is apparently wanting in all the copies. Next

Titania leads another song, which is indeed lost like the former, tho' the editors have endeavoured to find it. Then Oberon dismisses his fairies to the dispatch of the ceremonies.

The songs, I suppose, were lost, because they were not inserted in the players parts, from which the drama was printed.

V.i.440 (107,8) [Now to 'scape the serpent's tongue] That is, If we be dismiss'd without hisses.

V.i.444 (107,9) [Give me your hands] That is, Clap your hands. Give us your applause.

(107,8) General Observation. Of this play there are two editions in quarto; one printed for Thomas Fisher, the other for James Roberts, both in 1600. I have used the copy of Roberts, very carefully collated, as it seems, with that of Fisher. Neither of the editions approach to exactness. Fisher is sometimes preferable, but Roberts was followed, though not without some variations, by Hemings and Condell, and they by all the folios that succeeded them.

Wild and fantastical as this play is, all the parts in their various modes are well written, and give the kind of pleasure which the author designed. Fairies in his time were much in fashion; common tradition had made them familiar, and Spenser's poem had made them great.

THE MERCHANT OF VENICE

I.i.9 (112,2) [Argosies] [a ship from Argo. Pope.] Whether it be derived from Argo I am in doubt. It was a name given in our author's time to ships of great burthen, probably galleons, such as the Spaniards now use in their East India trade. [An Argosie meant originally a ship from Ragusa, a city and territory on the gulph of Venice, tributary to the Porte. Steevens.]

I.i.18 (112,3) [Plucking the grass, to know where sits the wind] By holding up the grass, or any light body that will bend by a gentle blast, the direction of the wind is found.

This way I used in shooting. Betwixt the markes was an open place, there I take a fethere, or a lytle grasse, and so learned how the wind stood. Ascham.

I.i.27 (113,5) [And see my wealthy Andrew dock'd in sand] The name of the ship.

I.i.113 (116,3) [Is that any thing now?] All the old copies read, *is that any thing now?* I suppose we should read, *is that any thing new?*

I.i.146 (117,4) [like a wilful youth] [W: witless] Dr. Warburton confounds the time past and present. He has formerly lost his money like a *wilful* youth, he now borrows more in *pure innocence*, without disguising his former fault, or his present designs.

I.ii.44 (120,6) [Ay, that's a colt, indeed] *Colt* is used for a witless, heady, gay youngster, whence the phrase used of an old man too juvenile, that he still retains his *colt's tooth*. See Hen. VIII.

I.ii.49 (120,7) [there is the Count Palatine] I am always inclined to believe, that Shakespeare has more allusions to particular facts and persons than his readers commonly suppose. The count here mentioned was, perhaps, Albertus a Lasco, a Polish Palatine, who visited England in our author's time, was eagerly caressed, and splendidly entertained; but running in debt, at last stole away, and endeavoured to repair his fortune by enchantment.

I.ii.90 (122,3) [How like you the young German] In Shakespeare's time the duke of Bavaria visited London, and was made knight of the garter.

Perhaps in this enumeration of Portia's suitors, there may be some covert allusion to those of Queen Elizabeth.

I.iii.47 (125,4) [catch him once upon the hip] A phrase taken from the practice of wrestlers.

I.iii.63 (126,5) [the ripe wants of my friend] *Ripe wants* are wants *come to the height*, wants that can have no longer delay. Perhaps we might read, *rife wants*, wants that come thick upon him.

I.iii.100 (127,6)

[An evil soul, producing holy witness,
Is like a villain with a smiling cheek;
A goodly apple rotten at the heart.

O, what a goodly outside falshood hath?]

I wish any copy would give the authority to range and read the lines thus:

O, what a godly outside falshood hath!

An evil soul producing holy witness,

Is like a villain with a sailing cheek;

Or goodly apply rotten at the heart.

Yet there is no difficulty in the present reading. *Falsehood*, which as *truth* means *honesty*, is taken here for *treachery* and *knavery*, does not stand for *falsehood* in general, but for the dishonesty now operating. (1773)

I.iii.156 (129,8) [dwell in my necessity] To *dwell* seems in this place to mean the same as to *continue*. To *abide* has both the senses of *habitation* and *continuance*.

I.iii.176 (130,9) [left in the fearful guard] [W: fearless] Dr. Warburton has forgotten that *fearful* is not only that which fears, but that which is feared or causes fear. *Fearful guard*, is a guard that is not to be trusted, but gives cause of fear. To *fear* was anciently to *give* as well as *feel* *terrors*. (see 1765, I,402,4)

I.iii.180 (130,1) [I like not fair terms] Kind words, good language.

II.i.7 (131,2) [To prove whose blood is reddest, his or mine] To understand how the tawney prince, whose savage dignity is very well supported, means to recommend himself by this challenge, it must be remembered that *red* blood is a traditionary sign of courage: Thus Macbeth calls one of his frightened soldiers, a *lilly liver'd* Lown; again

in this play, Cowards are said to *have livers as white as milk*; and an effeminate and timorous man is termed a *milksop*.

II.i.18 (132,4) [And hedg'd me by his will] I suppose we may safely read, *and hedg'd me by his will*. Confined me by his will.

II.i.25 (132,5) [That slew the Sophy] Shakespeare seldom escapes well when he is entangled with geography. The prince of Morocco must have travelled far to kill the Sophy of Persia.

II.i.42 (133,7) [Therefore be advis'd] Therefore be not precipitant; consider well what we are to do. *Advis'd* is the word opposite to *rash*.

II.ii.38 (134,8) [try conclusions] —So the old quarto. The first folio, by a mere blunder, reads, try *confusions*, which, because it makes a kind of paltry jest, has been copied by all the editors.

II.ii.91 (136,1) [your child that shall be] The distinction between *boy* and *son* is obvious, but child seems to have some meaning, which is now lost.

II.ii.166 (138,3) [Well, if any man in Italy have a fairer table, which doth suffer to swear upon a book] Mr. Theobald's note is as obscure as the passage. It may be read more than once before the complication of ignorance can be completely disentangled. Table is the palm expanded. What Mr. Theobald conceives it to be cannot easily be discovered, but he thinks it somewhat that promises a full belly.

Dr. Warburton understood the word, but puzzles himself with no great success in the pursuit of the meaning. The whole matter is this: Launcelot congratulates himself upon his dexterity and good fortune, and, in the height of his rapture, inspects his hand, and congratulates himself upon the felicities in his table. The act of expounding his hand puts him in mind of the action in which the palm is shewn, by raising it to lay it on the book, in judicial attestations. *Well*, says he, *if any man in Italy have a fairer table, that doth offer to swear upon a book*—Here he stops with an abruptness very common, and proceeds to particulars.

II.ii.194 (140,5) [Something too liberal] Liberal I have already shewn to be mean, gross, coarse, licentious.

II.ii.205 (141,9) [sad ostent] Grave appearance; shew of staid and serious behaviour.

II.vi.5 (146,1) [O, ten times faster Venus' pigeons fly] [W: widgeons] I believe the poet wrote as the editors have printed. How it is so very *high humour* to call lovers *widgeons* rather than pigeons. I cannot find. Lovers have in poetry been alway called *Turtles*, or *Doves*, which in lower language may be pigeons.

II.vi.51 (148,3) [a Gentile, and no Jew] A jest rising from the ambiguity of *Gentile*, which signifies both a *Heathen*, and *one well born*.

II.vii.8 (149,4) [This third, dull lead, with warning all as blunt]
That is, as gross as the dull metal.

II.vii.69 (151,5) [*Gilded tombs do worms infold*] In all the old editions this line is written thus:

Gilded timber do worms infold.

From which Mr. Rowe and all the following editors have made
Gilded wood may worms infold.

A line not bad in itself, but not so applicable to the occasion as that which, I believe, Shakespeare wrote,

Gilded tombs do worms infold.

A tomb is the proper repository of a *death's-head*.

II.vii.72 (151,6) [Your answer had not been inscol'd] Since there is an answer inscol'd or written in every casket, I believe for *your* we should read *this*. When the words were written y'r and y's, the mistake was easy.

II.vii.79 (151,7) [chuse ce so] The old quarto edition of 1600 has no distribution of acts, but proceeds from the beginning to the end in an unbroken tenour. This play therefore having been probably divided without authority by the publishers of the first folio, lies open to a new regulation, if any more commodious division can be proposed. The story is itself so wildly incredible, and the changes of the scene so frequent and capricious, that the probability of action does not deserve much care; yet it may be proper to observe, that, by concluding the second act here, time is given for Bassanio's passage to Belmont.

II.viii.42 (153,8) [*Let it not enter in your mind of love*] So all the copies, but I suspect some corruption.

II.viii.52 (153,9) [embraced heaviness] [W: enraced] Of Dr. Warburton's correction it is only necessary to observe, that it has produced a new word, which cannot be received without necessity.

When I thought the passage corrupted, it seemed to me not improbable that Shakespeare had written *entranced heaviness*, musing, abstracted, moping melancholy. But I know not why any great efforts should be made to change a word which has no uncommodious or unusual sense. We say of a man now, *that he hugs his sorrows*, and why might not Anthonio *embrace heaviness*.

II.ix.46 (155,2) [How much low peasantry would then be gleaned From the true seed of honour?] The meaning is, *How much meanness would be found among the great, and how much greatness among the mean*. But since men are always said to *glean* corn though they may *pick* chaff, the sentence had been more agreeable to the common manner of speech if it had been written thus,

How much low peasantry would then be pick'd
From the true seed of honour? how much honour
Glean'd from the chaff?

II.ix.70 (157,4) [*Take what wife you will to-bed*] Perhaps the poet had forgotten that he who missed Portia was never to marry any woman.

III.i.47 (160,7) [a bankrupt, a prodigal] There is no need of alteration. There could be, in Shylock's opinion, no prodigality more culpable than such liberality as that by which a man exposes himself to ruin for his friend.

III.ii.21 (163,9) [And so though yours, not yours. — Prove it so] It may be more grammatically read,

And so though yours I'm not yours.

III.ii.54 (165,2) [With no less presence] With the same *dignity of mien*.

III.ii.73 (166,5) [So may the outward shows] He begins abruptly, the first part of the argument has passed in his mind.

III.ii.76 (166,6) [gracious voice] Pleasing; winning favour.

III.ii.112 (167,9) [In measure rain thy joy] The first quarto edition reads,

In measure range thy joy.
The folio and one of the quartos,

In measure raine thy joy.

I once believ'd Shakespeare meant,

In measure rein thy joy.

The words *rain* and *rein* were not in these times distinguished by regular orthography. There is no difficulty in the present reading, only where the copies vary some suspicion of error is always raised, (see 1765, I,437,1)

III.ii.125 (168,1) [Methinks, it should have power to steal both his, And leave itself unfurnish'd] I know not how *unfinish'd* has intruded without notice into the later editions, as the quartos and folio have *unfurnished*, which Sir Tho. Banner has received. Perhaps it might be

And leave himself unfurnish'd.

III.ii.191 (170,4) [you can wish none from me] That is, none *away from* me; none that I shall lose, if you gain it.

III.v.70 (182,5) [how his words are suited!] I believe the meaning is: What a *series* or *suite* of *words* he has independent of meaning; how one word draws on another without relation to the matter.

IV.i.21 (184,6) [apparent] That is, *seeming*; not real.

IV.i.22 (184,7) [*where*] for *whereas*.

IV.i.29 (184,8) [Enough to press a royal merchant down] This epithet was in our poet's time more striking and better understood, because Gresham was then commonly dignified with the title of the *royal merchant*.

IV.i.42 (185,1) [I'll not answer that; But, say, it is my humour] [Cf: By saying] Dr. Warburton has mistaken the sense. The Jew being asked a question which the law does not require him to answer, stands upon his right, and refuses; but afterwards gratifies his own malignity by such answers as he knows will aggravate the pain of the enquirer. I will not answer, says he, as to a legal or serious question, but since you want an answer, will this serve you?

IV.i.56 (187,4)

[For affection,

Masters of passion, sway it to the mood

Of what it likes, or loaths]

As for *affection*, those that know how to operate upon the passions of men, rule it by making it operate in obedience to the notes which please or disgust it. (1773)

[Woollen bag pipe] As all the editors agree with complete uniformity in this reading, I can hardly forbear to imagine that they understood it. But I never saw a *woollen bag-pipe*, nor can well conceive it. I suppose the authour wrote *wooden bag-pipe*, meaning that the bag was of leather, and the pipe of *wood*.

IV.i.90 (189,5) [many a purchas'd slave] This argument considered as used to the particular persons, seems conclusive. I see not how Venetians or Englishmen, while they practise the purchase and sale of slaves, can much enforce or demand the law of *doing to others as we would that they should do to us*.

IV.i.105 (189,6) [Bellario, a learned doctor, Whom I have sent for] The doctor and the court are here somewhat unskilfully brought together. That the duke would, on such an occasion, consult a doctor of great reputation, is not unlikely, but how should this be forknown by Portia?

IV.i.214 (193,8) [malice bears down truth] Malice oppresses honesty, a *true man* in old language is an *honest man*. We now call the jury *good men and true*.

IV.i.382 (198,8) [I am content] The terms proposed have been misunderstood. Antonio declares, that as the duke quits one half of the forfeiture, he is likewise content to abate his claim, and desires not the property but the *use* or produce only of the half, and that only for the Jew's life, unless we read, as perhaps is right, *upon my death*.

V.i.63 (204,3) [Such harmony is in immortal souls] [W: sounds] This passage is obscure. *Immortal sounds* is a harsh combination of words, yet Milton uses a parallel expression:

*Spiritus & rapidos qui circinat igneus orbes,
Nunc quoque sidereis intercinit ipse choreia
Immortale melos, & inenarrabile curmen.*

It is proper to exhibit the lines as they stand in the copies of the first, second, third, and fourth editions, without any variation, for a change has been silently made, by Rowe, and adopted by all the succeeding editors.

Such harmony is in immortal souls, But while this muddy vesture of decay Doth grosly close in it, we cannot hear it.

That the third is corrupt must be allowed, but it gives reason to suspect that the original was,

Doth grosly close it in.

Yet I know not whether from this any thing better can be produced than the received reading. Perhaps *harmony* is the power of perceiving harmony, as afterwards, *Musick in the soul* is the quality of being moved with concord of sweet sounds. This will somewhat explain the old copies, but the sentence is still imperfect; which might be completed by reading,

Such harmony is in th' immortal soul, But while this muddy vesture of decay Doth grosly close it in, we cannot hear it. (1773)

V.i.66 (205,4) [wake Diana with a hymn] Diana is the moon, who is in the next scene represented as sleeping.

V.i.99 (207,6) [Nothing is good, I see, without respect] Not absolutely good, but relatively, good as it is modified by circumstances.

V.i.129 (208,7) [Let me give light] There is scarcely any word with which Shakespeare delights to trifle as with *light*, in its various significations.

V.i.203 (210,2)

[What man is there so much unreasonable,
If you had pleas'd to have defended it
With any terms of zeal, wanted the modesty
To urge the thing held as a ceremony?]

This is a very licentious expression. The sense is, *What man could have so little modesty or wanted modesty so much*, as to urge the demand of a thing kept on an account in some sort religious. (see 1785, 1,476,7)

V.i.249 (212,4) [I once did lend my body for his wealth] For his advantage; to obtain his happiness. *Wealth* was, at that time, the term opposite to *adversity*, or *calamity*.

V.i.294 (213,5) [*Lor.* Fair ladies, you drop manna in the way Of starved people] [Shakespeare is not more exact in any thing, than in adapting his images with propriety to his speakers; of which he has here given an instance in making the young Jewess call good fortune,

manna. Warburton.] The commentator should have remarked, that this speech is not, even in his own edition, the speech of the Jewess.

V.i.307 (214,6) [*Exeunt omnes*] It has been lately discovered, that this fable is taken from a story in the Pecorope of Ser Giovauni Fiorentino, a novellist, who wrote in 1378. The story has been published in English, and I have epitomised the translation. The translator is of opinion, that the choice of the caskets is borrowed from a tale of Boccace, which I have likewise abridged, though I believe that Shakespeare must have had some other novel in view.

(223) General Observation. Of The MERCHANT of VENICE the stile is even and easy, with few peculiarities of diction, or anomalies of construction. The comick part raises laughter, and the serious fixes expectation. The probability of either one or the other story cannot be maintained. The union of two actions in one event is in this drama eminently happy. Dryden was much pleased with his own address in connecting the two plots of his Spanish Friar, which yet, I believe, the critick will find excelled by this play.

AS YOU LIKE IT

I.i.3 (229,2) [As I remember, Adam, it was upon this fashion bequeathed me. By will, but a poor thousand crowns] There is, in my opinion, nothing but a point misplaced, and an omission of a word which every hearer can supply, and which therefore an abrupt and eager dialogue naturally excludes.

I read thus: *As I remember, Adam, it was on this fashion bequeathed me. By will but a poor thousand crowns; and, as thou sayest, charged my brother on his blessing to breed me well.* What is there in this difficult or obscure? The nominative *my father* is certainly left out, but so left out that the auditor inserts it, in spite of himself.

I.i.9 (230,3) [stays me here at home, unkept] [W: Stys] *Sties* is better than *stays*, and more likely to be Shakespeare's.

I.i.19 (230,4) [his countenance seems to take from me] [W: discountenance] There is no need of change, a countenance is either good or bad.

I.i.33 (231,5) [be better employ'd, and be nought a while] Warburton explained ["be nought a while" as "a mischief on you"] If *be nought a while* has the signification here given it, the reading may certainly stand; but till I learned its meaning from this note, I read,

Be better employed, and be naught a while.

In the same sense as we say, *it is better to do mischief, than to do nothing.*

I.i.59 (233,7) [I am no villain] The word *villain* is used by the elder brother, in its present meaning, for a *worthless, wicked, or bloody man*; by Orlando in its original signification, for a *fellow of base extraction*.

I.ii.34 (237,9) [mock the good housewife Fortune from her wheel] The wheel of Fortune is not the *wheel* of a *housewife*. Shakespeare has confounded Fortune, whose wheel only figures uncertainty and vicissitude, with the Destiny that spins the thread of life, though indeed not with a wheel.

I.ii.87 (239,1)

[*Clo.* One, that old Frederick your father loves. *Cel.* My father's love is enough to honour him]

[T. invoking the *Dramatis Personae*: Celia] Mr. Theobald seems not to know that the *Dramatis Personae* were first enumerated by Rowe.

I.ii.95 (239,2) [since the little wit that fools have, was silenc'd] Shakespeare probably alludes to the use of *fools* or *jesters*, who for some ages had been allowed in all courts an unbridled liberty of censure and mockery, and about this time began to be less tolerated.

I.ii.112 (240,3) [laid on with a trowel] I suppose the meaning is, that there is too heavy a mass of big words laid upon a slight subject.

I.ii.115 (240,4) [You amaze me, ladies] To *amaze*, here, is not to astonish or strike with wonder, but to perplex; to confuse; as, to put out of the intended narrative.

I.ii.131 (241,5) [With bills on their necks: *Be it known unto all men by these presents*] This conjecture is ingenious. Where meaning is so very thin, as in this vein of jocularly, it is hard to catch, and therefore I know not well what to determine; but I cannot see why Rosalind should suppose, that the competitors in a wrestling match carried *bills* on their shoulders, and I believe the whole conceit is in the poor resemblance of *presence* and *presents*.

I.ii.149 (241,6) [is there any else longs to see this broken musick in his sides?] [W: set] If any change were necessary, I should write, *feel this broken musick*, for *see*. But *see* is the colloquial term for perception or experiment. So we say every day, *see* if the water be hot; I will *see* which is the best time; she has tried, and *sees* that she cannot lift it. In this sense *see* may be here used. The sufferer can, with no propriety, be said to *set* the musick; neither is the allusion to the act of tuning an instrument, or pricking a tune, one of which must be meant by *setting* musick. Rosalind hints at a whimsical similitude between the series of ribs gradually shortening, and some musical instruments, and therefore calls *broken ribs*, *broken musick*.

I.ii.185 (243,8) [If you saw yourself with your eyes, or knew yourself with your judgment] [W: our eyes, and our judgment] I cannot find the absurdity of the present reading. *If you were not blinded and intoxicated*, says the princess, *with the spirit of enterprise, if you could use your own eyes to see, or your own judgment to know yourself, the fear of your adventure would counsel you*.

I.ii.195 (243,9) [I beseech you, punish me not with your hard thoughts, wherein I confess me much guilty] I should wish to read, *I beseech you, punish me not with your hard thoughts*. Therein *I confess myself much guilty to deny so fair and excellent ladies any thing*.

I.ii.257 (246,1) [one out of suits with Fortune] This seems an allusion to cards, where he that has no more cards to play of any particular sort is *out of suit*.

I.ii.275 (247,3) [the Duke's condition] The word *condition* means character, temper, disposition. So Anthonio the merchant of Venice, is called by his friend the *best conditioned man*.

I.iii.33 (249,5) [you should love his son dearly? By this kind of chase, I should hate him, for my father hated his father dearly] That is, by this way of *following* the argument. *Dear* is used by Shakespeare in a double sense, for *beloved*, and for *hurtful*, *hated*, *baleful*. Both senses are authorised, and both drawn from etymology, but properly *beloved* is *dear*, and *hateful* is *dere*. Rosalind uses *dearly* in the good, and Celia in the bad sense.

I.iii.83 (251,6) [And thou wilt show more bright, and seem more virtuous] [W: shine] The plain meaning of the old and true reading is, that when she was seen alone, she would be more noted.

I.iii.98 (251,7) [Rosalind lacks then the love Which teacheth thee that thou and I am one][W: which teacheth me] Either reading may stand. The sense of the established text is not remote or obscure. Where would be the absurdity of saying, *You know not the law which teaches you to do right*.

I.iii.119 (252,9) [curtle-ax] —*curtle-axe*. or *cutlace*. a broad sword.

II.i.13 (254,3)

[Which, like the toad, ugly and venomous
Wears yet a precious jewel in his head]

It was the current opinion in Shakespeare's time, that in the head of an old toad was to be found a stone, or pearl, to which great virtues were ascribed. This stone has been often sought, but nothing has been found more than accidental or perhaps morbid indurations of the skull.

II.i.18 (254,4) [I would not change it] Mr. Upton, not without probability, gives these words to the Duke, and makes Amiens begin, *Happy is your grace*.

II.i.67 (256,6) [to cope him] To encounter him; to engage with him.

II.iii.8 (257,8) [The bony priser] So Milton, *Giants of mighty bone*.

II.iii.37 (258,9) [diverted blood] Blood turned out of the course of nature.

II.iii.60 (259,1)

[promotion; And, having that, do choak their service up Even with the having]

Even with the *promotion* gained by service is service extinguished.

II.iv.33 (261,4) [If thou remember'st not the slightest folly] I am inclined to believe that from this passage Suckling took the hint of his song.

*Honest lover, whosoever,
If in all thy love there ever
Were one wav'ring thought, thy flame
Were not even, still the same.
Know this
Thou lov'st amiss,
And to love true
Thou must begin again and love anew, &c. (rev. 1778, III,297,4)*

II.iv.48 (262,5) [batlet] The instrument with which washers beat their coarse cloaths.

II.iv.51 (262,6) [two cods] For *cods* it would be more like sense to read *peas*, which having the shape of pearls, resembled the common presents of lovers.

II.iv.55 (262,7) [so is all nature in love, mortal in folly] This expression I do not well understand. In the middle counties, *mortal*, from *mort*, a great quantity, is used as a particle of amplification; as *mortal tall*, *mortal little*. Of this sense I believe Shakespeare takes advantage to produce one of his darling equivocations. Thus the meaning will be, *so is all nature in love abounding in folly*.

II.iv.87 (263,8) [And in my voice most welcome shall ye be] *In my voice*, as far as I have a voice or vote, as far as I have power to bid you welcome.

II.v.56 (265,2) [Duc ad me] For *duc dame* sir T. Hammer, very acutely and judiciously, reads *duc ad me*. That is, *bring him to me*.

II.v.63 (266,3) [the first-born of Egypt] A proverbial expression for high-born persons. (1773)

II.vii.13 (267,4) [A motley fool!—a miserable world.'] [W: miserable varlet] I see no need of changing *fool* to *varlet*, nor, if a change were necessary, can I guess how it should certainly be known that *varlet* is the true word. *A miserable world* is a parenthetical exclamation, frequent among melancholy men, and natural to Jaques at the sight of a fool, or at the hearing of reflections on the fragility of life.

II.vii.44 (268,5) [only suit] *Suit* means *petition*. I believe, not *dress*.

II.vii.55 (269,7)

[If not,

The wise man's folly is anatomiz'd

Even by the squandring glances of the fool]

Unless men have the prudence not to appear touched with the sarcasm of a jester, they subject themselves to his power, and the wise man will have his folly *anatomised*, that is *dissected* and *laid open* by the *squandring glances* or *random shots* of a fool.

II.vii.66 (269,8) [As sensual as the brutish sting] Though the *brutish sting* is capable of a sense not inconvenient in this passage, yet as it is a harsh and unusual mode of speech, I should read the *brutish sty*.

II.vii.04 (270,9)

[The thorny point

Of bare distress hath ta'en from me the shew

Of smooth civility]

We might read *torn* with more elegance, but elegance alone will not justify alteration.

II.vii.125 (271,1) [And take upon command what help we have] It seems necessary to read, *then take upon demand what help*, &c. that is, *ask* for what we can supply, and have it.

II.vii.156 (272,3) [Full of wise saws and modern instances] I am in doubt whether *modern* is in this place used for absurd; the meaning seems to be, that the justice is full of *old* sayings and *late* examples.

II.vii.167 (273,5) [Set down your venerable burden] Is it not likely that Shakespeare had in his mind this line of the *Metamorphoses*?

—*Patremque*

Fert humeris, venerabile onus Cythereius heros.

II.vii.177 (274,5)

[Thy tooth is not so keen,
Because thou art not seen]

[W: art not sheen] I am afraid that no reader is satisfied with Dr. Warburton's emendation, however vigorously enforced; and it is indeed enforced with more art than truth. *Sheen*, i.e. *smiling*, *shining*. That *sheen* signifies *shining*, is easily proved, but when or where did it signify *smiling*? yet *smiling* gives the sense necessary in this place. Sir T. Banner's change is less uncouth, but too remote from the present text. For my part, I question whether the original line is not lost, and this substituted merely to fill up the measures and the rhyme. Yet even out of this line, by strong agitation may sense be elicited, and sense not unsuitable to the occasion. *Thou winter wind*, says the Duke, *thy rudeness gives the less pain*, as thou art not seen, *as thou art an enemy that dost not brave us with thy presence*, and *whose unkindness is therefore not aggravated by insult*.

II.vii.187 (275,6) [Tho' thou the waters warp] To *warp* was probably, in Shakespeare's time, a colloquial word, which conveyed no distant allusion to any thing else, physical or medicinal. To warp is to *turn*, and to *turn* is to *change*; when milk is *changed* by curdling, we now say, it is *turned*; when water is *changed* or *turned* by frost, Shakespeare says, it is *curdled*. To be *warp'd* is only to be changed from its natural state. (1773)

III.i.3 (276,7) [an absent argument] An *argument* is used for the *contents* of a book, thence Shakespeare considered it as meaning the *subject*, and then used it for *subject* in yet another sense.

III.i.18 (277,8) [Do this expeditiously] That is, *expeditiously*.

would not thank her lover for the comparison. There is a more obscure Atalanta, a huntress and a heroine, but of her nothing bad is recorded, and therefore I know not which was the better part. Shakespeare was no despicable mythologist, yet he seems here to have mistaken some other character for that of Atalanta.

III.ii.156 (283,4) [Sad] is *grave, sober, not light*.

III.ii.160 (284,5) [the touches] The features; *les traits*.

III.ii.186 (284,6) [I was never so be-rhimed since Pythagoras's time, that I was an Irish rat] Rosalind is a very learned lady. She alludes to the Pythagorean doctrine, which teaches that souls transmigrate from one animal to another, and relates that in his time she was an Irish *rat*, and by some metrical charm was rhymed to death. The power of killing rats with rhymes Donne mentions in his Satires, and Temple in his Treatises. Dr. Gray has produced a similar passage from Randolph.

—*My poets*

Shall with a saytire steeped in vinegar

Rhyme then to death as they do rats in Ireland.

III.ii.206 (285,8) [One inch of delay more is a South-sea of discovery] This sentence is rightly noted by the commentator [W] as nonsense, but not so happily restored to sense. I read thus:

One inch of delay more is a South-sea. Discover, I pr'ythee; tell me who is it quickly;— When the transcriber had once made *discovery* from *discover*, I, he easily put an article after South-sea.

But it may be read with still less change, and with equal probability. *Every inch of delay more is a South-sea discovery: Every delay*, however short, is to me tedious and irksome as the longest voyage, as a voyage of *discovery* on the *South-sea*. How such voyages to the South-sea, on which the English had then first ventured, engaged the conversation of that time, may be easily imagined.

III.ii.238 (287,9) [Garagantua's mouth] Rosalind requires nine questions to be answered in *one word*. Celia tells her that a word of such magnitude is too big for any mouth but that of Garagantua the giant of Rabelais.

III.ii.290 (288,2) [but I answer you right painted cloth] Sir T. Hammer reads, *I answer you right*, in the stile of the painted cloth. Something

seems wanting, and I know not what can be proposed better. *I answer you right painted cloth*, may mean, I give you a true painted cloth answer; as we say, she talks *right Billingsgate*; that is, exactly such language as is used at Billingsgate. (1773)

III.ii.363 (291,3) [in-land man] Is used in this play for one *civilised*, in opposition to the *rustick* of the priest. So Orlando before—*Yet am I in-land bred, and know some nurture*.

III.ii.393 (291,4) [an unquestionable spirit] That is, a spirit not *inquisitive*, a mind indifferent to common objects, and negligent of common occurrences. Here Shakespeare has used a passive for an active mode of speech; so in a former scene, *The Duke is too disputable for me*, that is, too *disputatious*.

III.ii.439 (293,5) [to a living humour of madness] If this be the true reading we must by *living* understand *lasting*, or *permanent*, but I cannot forbear to think that some antithesis was intended which is now lost; perhaps the passage stood thus, *I drove my suitor from a dying humour of love to a living humour of madness*. Or rather thus, *from a mad humour of love to a loving humour of madness*, that is, from a *madness* that was *love*, to a *love* that was *madness*. This seems somewhat harsh and strained, but such modes of speech are not unusual in our poet; and this harshness was probably the cause of the corruption.

III.iii.21 (294,7) [and what they swear in poetry, may be said, as lovers, they do feign] This sentence seems perplexed and inconsequent, perhaps it were better read thus, *What they swear as lovers they may be said to feign as poets*.

III.iii.32 (295,8) [A material fool!] A fool with *matter* in bin; a fool stocked with notions.

III.iii.51 (295,1) [what tho?] What then.

III.iii.65 (296,2) [Sir Oliver] He that has taken his first degree at the university, is in the academical style called *Dominus*, and in common language was heretofore termed *Sir*. This was not always a word of contempt; the graduates assumed it in their own writings; so Trevisa the historian writes himself *Syr John de Trevisa*.

III.iii.101 (297,4) [Not, O sweet Oliver] Of this speech, as it now appears, I can make nothing, and think nothing can be made. In the

same breath he calls his mistress to be married, and sends away the man that should marry them. Dr. Warburton has very happily observed, that *O sweet Oliver* is a quotation from an old song; I believe there are two quotations put in opposition to each other. For *wind* I read *wend*, the old word for go. Perhaps the whole passage may be regulated thus,

Clo. *I am not in the mind. but it were better for me to be married of him than of another, for he is not like to marry me well, and not being well married, it will be a good excuse for me hereafter to leave my wife—Come, sweet Audrey, we must be married, or we must live in bawdry.*

Jaq. *Go then with me, and let me counsel thee.* [they whisper.]

Clo. *Farewel, good sir Oliver, not O sweet Oliver, O brave Oliver, leave Be not behind thee,—but*

Wend away

Begone, I say,

I will not to wedding with thee to-day.

Of this conjecture the reader may take as much as shall appear necessary to the sense, or conducive to the humour. I have received all but the additional words. The song seems to be complete without them. (1773)

III.iv.11 (298, 5) [I' faith, his hair is of a good colour] There is much of nature in this petty perverseness of Rosalind; she finds faults in her lover, in hope to be contradicted, and when Celia in sportive malice too readily seconds her accusations, she contradicts herself rather than suffer her favourite to want a vindication.

III.v.5 (301, 1) [Will you sterner be Than he that dies and lives by bloody drops?] [W: deals and lives] [Hammer: lives and thrives] Either Dr. Warburton's emendation, except that the word *deals*, wants its proper construction, or that of sir T. Hammer may serve the purpose; but I believe they have fixed corruption upon the wrong word, and should rather read,

Than he that dies his lips by bloody drops?

Will you speak with more sternness than the executioner, whose *lips* are used to be *sprinkled* with blood? The mention of *drops* implies some part that must be sprinkled rather than dipped.

III. v. 23 (303, 2) [The cicatrice and capable impressure] Cicatrice is here not very properly used; it is the scar of a wound. *Capable impressure* arrows mark.

III. v. 29 (303, 3) [power of fancy] *Fancy* is here used for *love*, as before in *Midsummer Night's Dream*.

III. v. 35 (304, 4) [Who might be your mother] It is common for the poets to express cruelty by saying, of those who commit it, that they were born of rocks, or suckled by tigresses.

III. v. 48 (305, 8) [That can entame ay spirits to your worship]
[W: entraine] The common reading seems unexceptionable.

III. v. 62 (305, 9) [Foal is most foul, being foul to be a scoffer]
[W: being found] The sense of the received reading is not fairly represented; it is, *The ugly seem most ugly, when, though ugly, they are scoffers*.

III.v.78 (306,2) [Though all the world could see, None could be so abus'd in sight, as he] Though all mankind could look on you, none could be so *deceived* as to think you beautiful but he.

IV.i.37 (309,3) [swam in a gondola] That is, *been at Venice*, the sweat at that time of all licentiousness, where the young English gentlemen waited their fortunes, debased their morals, and sometimes lost their religion.

The fashion of travelling, which prevailed very much in our author's time, was considered by the wiser men as one of the principal causes of corrupt manners. It was therefore gravely censored by Aschaa in his *Schoolmaster*, and by bishop Hall in his *Quo Vadis*; and is here, and in other passages, ridiculed by Shakespeare.

IV.i.157 (312,6) [and that when you are inclin'd to sleep] [W: to weep] I know not why we should read *to weep*. I believe most men would be more angry to have their *sleep* hindered than their *grief* interrupted.

IV.i.168 (313,8) [Wit, *whither wilt?*] This must be some allusion to a story well known at that time, though not perhaps irretrievable.

IV.i.177 (313,9) [make her fault her husband's occasion] That is, represent her fault as occasioned by her husband. Sir T. Banner reads, *her husband's accusation*.

IV.i.195 (314,1) [I will think you the most pathological break-promise]
[W: atheistical] I do not see but that *pathetical* may stand, which seems to afford as much sense and as much humour as *atheistical*.

IV.ii.14 (315,2) [*Take thou no scorn*] [T: In former editions: *Then sing him home, the rest shall bear his burden*. This is an admirable instance of the sagacity of our preceding editors, to say nothing worse. One should expect, when they were *poets*, they would at least have taken care of the *rhimes*, and not foisted in what has nothing to answer it. Now, where is the rhyme to, *the rest shall bear this burden*? Or, to ask another question, where is the sense of it? Does the poet mean, that He, that kill'd the deer, shall be sung home, and the rest shall bear the deer on their backs? This is laying a burden on the poet, that we must help him to throw off. In short, the mystery of the whole is, that a marginal note is wisely thrust into the text: the song being design'd to be sung by a single voice, and the stanzas to close with a burden to be sung by the whole company.] This note I have given as a specimen of Mr. Theobald's jocularly, and the eloquence with which he recommends his emendations.

IV.iii (316,4) [*Enter Rosalind and Celia*] The foregoing noisy scene was introduced only to fill up an interval, which is to represent two hours. This contraction of the time we might impute to poor Rosalind's impatience, but that a few minutes after we find Orlando sending his excuse. I do not see that by any probable division of the acts this absurdity can be obviated.

IV.iii.48 (318,3) [*That could do no vengeance to me*] *Vengeance* is used for *mischief*.

IV.iii.59 (318,4) [youth and kind] *Kind* is the old word for *nature*.

IV.iii.101 (319,5) [Within an hour] We must read, *within two hours*.

IV.iii.160 (321,6) [cousin—Ganymed!] Celia in her first fright forgets Rosalind's character and disguise, and calls out *cousin*, then recollects herself, and says Ganymed.

V.ii.21 (325,9) [And you, fair sister] I know not why Oliver should call Rosalind sister. He takes her yet to be a man. I suppose we should read, *and you*, and your *fair sister*.

V.ii.45 (326,1) [Clubs cannot part them] Alluding to the way of parting dogs in wrath.

V.ii.74 (327,2) [human as she is] That is, not a phantom, but the real Rosalind, without any of the danger generally conceived to attend the rites of incantation.

V.iii.17 (329,3) [*It was a lover and his lass*] The stanzas of this song are in all the editions evidently transposed: as I have regulated them, that which in the former copies was the second stanza is now the last.

The same transposition of these stanzas is made by Dr. Thirlby, in a copy containing some notes on the margin, which I have perused by the favour of Sir Edward Walpole. (see 1765, II,97,3)

V.iii.36 (330,4) [the note was very untuneable] [T: untuneable] This emendation is received. I think very undeservedly, by Dr. Warburton.

V.iv.4 (331,5) [As those that fear, they hope, and know they fear] [W: their hap, and know their] The deprivation of this line is evident, but I do not think the learned commentator's emendation very happy. I read thus,

As those that fear with hope, and hope with fear.

Or thus, with less alteration,

As those that fear, they hope, and now they fear.

V.iv.36 (332,6) [Here comes a pair of very strange beasts] [W: unclean beasts] *Strange beasts* are only what we call *odd* animals. There is no need of any alteration.

V.iv.51 (333,7) [found the quarrel was upon the seventh cause] So all the copies; but it is apparent from the sequel that we must read, *the quarrel was not upon the seventh cause*.

V.iv.56 (333,8) [I desire you of the like] [W: of you] I have not admitted the alteration, because there are other examples of this mode of expression. (1773)

V.iv.59 (333,9) [according as marriage binds, and blood breaks] I cannot discover what has here puzzled the commentator [W]: *to swear according as marriage binds*, ii to take the oath enjoin'd in the ceremonial of marriage.

V.iv.68 (334,1) [dulcet diseases] This I do not understand. For *diseases* it is easy to read *discourses*: but, perhaps the fault may lie deeper.

V.iv.114 (336,4) [*Enter Hymen*] Rosalind is imagined by the rest of the company to be brought by enchantment, and is therefore introduced by a supposed aerial being in the character of Hymen.

V.iv.125 (336,5) [If there be truth in sight] The answer of Phebe makes it probable that Orlando says, *if there be truth in shape: that is, if a form may be trusted*; if one cannot usurp the form of another.

V.iv.136 (337,6) [If truth holds true contents] That is, if there be *truth in truth*, unless truth fails of veracity.

V.iv.147 (337,7) [*Wedding is great Juno's crown*] Catullus, addressing himself to Hymen, has this stanza:

Quae tuis careat sacris,
Non queat dare praesides
Terra finibus: at queat
Te volente. Quis huic deo
Compararier ausit? (1773)

Epilogue.7 (340,5) [What a case am I in then] Here seems to be a chasm, or some other depravation, which destroys the sentiment here intended. The reasoning probably stood thus, *Good wine needs no bush, good plays need no epilogue*, but bad wine requires a good bush, and a bad play a good epilogue. *What case am I in then?* To restore the words is impossible; all that can be done without copies is, to note the fault.

Epilogue.10 (340,1) [furnish'd like a beggar] That is dressed: so before, he was *furnished* like a huntsman.

Epilogue.13 (340,2) [I charge you, O women, for the love you bear to men, to like as much of this Play as pleases them: and I charge you, O men, for the love you bear to women — — that between you and the women] [W: pleases them...pleases them] The words *you* and *of* written as was the custom in that time, were in manuscript scarcely distinguishable. The emendation is very judicious and probable.

(341,4) General Observation. Of this play the fable is wild and pleasing. I know not how the ladies will approve the facility with which both Rosalind and Celia give away their hearts. To Celia much may be forgiven for the heroism of her friendship. The character of Jaques is natural and well preferred. The comick dialogue is very sprightly, with less mixture of low buffoonery than in some other plays; and the graver part is elegant and harmonious. By hastening to the end of

his work, Shakespeare suppressed the dialogue between the usurper and the hermit, and lost an opportunity of exhibiting a moral lesson in which he might have found matter worthy of his highest powers.

THE TAMING OF THE SHREW

Induction.i.1 (346,1) [I'll pheeze you] To *pheeze* or *fease*. is to separate a twist into single threads. In the figurative sense it may well enough be taken, like *teaze* or *toze*, for to *harrass*. to *plague*. Perhaps *I'll pheeze you*, may be equivalent to *I'll comb your head*, a phrase vulgarly used by persons of Sly's character on like occasions. The following explanation of the word is given by Sir Tho. Sayth in his book de Ser-mone Anglico, printed by Robert Stephens, 4vo. To *feize*. means *in fila diducere*. (see 1765, III,[3],1)

Induction.i.3 (347,2) [no rogues] That is *vagrants*, no mean fellows, but gentlemen.

Induction.i.17 (348,7) [Brach Merriman, the poor cur is imboat] Sir T. Banner reads, Leech *Merriman*. that is, apply some remedies to Merriman, the poor cur has his *joints swelled*. Perhaps we might read, *bathe* Merriman, which is I believe the common practice of huntsmen, but the present reading may stand:

—*tender well my hounds*: Brach—Merriman—the poor cur is imboat.

Induction.i.64 (351,8) [And when he says he is,—say that he dreams] [*steevens*:he's poor,—say] If any thing should be inserted, it may be done thus,

"And when he says he's *Sly*, say that he dreams."

The likeness in writing of *Sly* and *say* produced the omission.(1773)

Induction.i.67 (352,9)

[It will be pastime excellent,

If it be husbanded with modesty]

By *modesty* is meant *moderation*, without suffering our merriment to break into an excess.

Induction.i.82 (352,1) [to accept our duty] It was in those times the custom of players to travel in companies, and offer their service at great houses.

Induction.i.101 (353,4) [property] in the language of a playhouse, is every implement necessary to the exhibition.

Induction.i.125 (355,7) [To rain a shower of commanded toars,
An onion will do well for such a shift]

It is not unlikely that the *onion* was an expedient used by the actors of interludes.

Induction.ii.89 (359,8) [Leet] As the *Court leet*. or courts of the manor.

I.i.9 (362,2) [ingenious studies] I rather think it was written ingenious studies, but of this and a thousand such observations there is little certainty.

I.i.18 (363,4) [Virtue, and that part of philosophy Will I apply] Sir Thomas Hammer, and after him Dr. Warburton, read to virtues but formerly ply and apply were indifferently used, as to ply or apply his studies.

I.i.78 (365,7) [A pretty peat!] Peat or pet is a word of endearment from petit, little, as if it meant pretty little thing.

I.i.85 (365,8) [will you be so strange?] That is, so odd, so different from others in your conduct.

I.i.97 (366,9) [cunning men] Cunning had not yet lost its original signification of knowing, learned, as may be observed in the translations of the Bible.

I.i.167 (368,2) [Redime te captum quasi queas minimi] Our author had this line from Lilly, which I mention, that it may not be brought as an argument of his learning.

I.i.208 (369,3) [port] Pert, is figure, show, appearance.

I.ii.52 (372,5) [Where small experience grows. But, in a few] Why this should seem nonsense, I cannot perceive. In few words it means the same as in short.

I.ii.68 (373,6) [As wealth is burthen of my wooing dance] The burthen of a dance is an expression which I have never heard; the burthen of his wooing song had been more proper.

I.ii.72 (373,8) [Affection's edge in me] Surely the sense of the present reading is too obvious to be missed or mistaken. Petruchio says, that, if a girl has money enough, no bad qualities of mind or body will remove affection's edge; i.e. hinder him from liking her.

I.ii.112 (375,1) [an' he begin once, he'll rail—In his rope-tricks] This is obscure. Sir Thomas Hammer reads, he'll rail in his rhetorick; I'll tell you, &c. Rhetorick agrees very well with figure in the succeeding

part of the speech, yet I am inclined to believe that rope-tricks is the true word.

I.ii.115 (375,2) [that she shall have no more eyes to see withal than a cat] It may mean, that he shall swell up her eyes with blows, till she shall seem to peep with a contracted pupil like a cat in the light. (1773)

I.ii.276 (381,9) [Please ye, we may contrive this afternoon] The word is used in the same sense of spending or wearing out in the Palace of Pleasure.

II.1.17 (382,2) [You will have Gremio, to keep you fair] I wish to read, To keep you fine. But either word may serve.

II.i.26 (388,3) [hilding] The word hilding or hinderling—a low wretch; it is applied to Catharine for the coarseness of her behaviour.

II.i.209 (389,7) [Ay, for a turtle; as he takes a buzzard] Perhaps we may read better, Ay, for a turtle, and he take a buzzard. That is, he may take me for a turtle, and he shall find me a hawk.

II.i.310 (393,9) [kill on kiss She vy's so fast] I know not that the word vie has any construction that will suit this place; we may easily read, —kiss on kiss She ply'd so fast.

II.i.340 (394,1)

[Tra. Grey-beard! thy love doth freeze.

Ore. But thine doth fry]

Old Gremio's notions are confirmed by Shadwell:

The fire of love in youthful blood.

Like what is kindled in brush-wood.

But for a moment burns—

But when crept into aged reins,

It slowly burns, and long remains,

It glows, and with a sullen heat.

Like fire in logs, it burns, and warms us long;

And though the flame be not so great,

Yet is the heat as strong.

II.1.407 (397,4) [Yet have I fac'd it with a card of ten] [W. quoted Jonson for "a hart of ten"] If the word hart be right, I do not see any use of the latter quotation.

II.1.413 (398,5) [Here the former editors add, Sly. Sim, when will the fool come again? Steevens.] The character of the fool has not been introduced in this drama, therefore I believe that the word again should be omitted, and that Sly asks, When will the fool come? the fool being the favourite of the vulgar, or, as we now phrase it, of the upper gallery, was naturally expected in every interlude.

III.1.37 (400,6) [pantaloon] the old cully in Italian farces.

III.ii.10 (403,1) [full of spleen] That is, full of humour, caprice; and inconstancy.

III.ii.45 (404,3) [a pair of boots that have been candle—eases; one buckled, another lac'd; an old rusty sword ta'en out of the town armory, with a broken hilt, and chapeless, with two broken points] Bow a sword should have two broken points, I cannot tell. There is, I think, a transposition caused by the seeming relation of point to sword. I read, a pair of boots, one buckled, another

laced with two broken points; an old rusty sword—with a broken hilt, and chapeless.

III.ii.109 (406,7) [to digress] to deviate from any promise.

IV.i.3 (412,9) [was ever man so ray'd?] That is, was ever man so mark'd with lashes.

IV.i.93 (416,7) [garters of an indifferent knit] What is the sense of this I know not, unless it means, that their *garters* should be *fellows; indifferent, or not different*, one from the other.

IV.i.139 (417,8) [no link, to colour Peter's hat] *Link*, I believe, is the name with what we now call *lamp-black*.

IV.i.145 (418,9) [Soud, soud] That is, *sweet, sweet*. *Soot*, and sometimes *sooth*, is *sweet*. So in Milton, *to sing soothly*, is, to sing sweetly.

IV.i.196 (420,3) [to man my haggard] A *haggard* is a *wild hawk*; to *man* a hawk is to *tame* her.

IV.iii.43 (428,8) [And all my pains is sorted to no proof] And all *my* labour has ended in nothing, or *proved* nothing. *We tried an experiment, but it sorted not*. Bacon.

IV.iii.56 (428,9) [With silken coats, and caps, and golden rings, With ruffs, and cuffs, and fardingals, and things] Though *things* is a poor

word, yet I have no better, and perhaps the authour had not another that would rhyme. I once thought to transpose the words *rings* and *things*, but it would make little improvement.

IV.iii.91 (430,2) [censer] in barber's shops, are now disused, but they may easily be imagined to have been vessels which, for the emission of the smoke, were cut with great number and varieties of interstices.

IV.iii.107 (430,3) [thou thimble] The taylor's trade having an appearance of effeminacy, has always been, among the rugged English, liable to sarcasms and contempt.

IV.iii.140 (431,3) [a small compass'd cape] A *compass'd cape* is a round cape. To *compass* is to *come round*. (1773)

IV.iv (434,5) I cannot but think that the direction about the Tinker, who is always introduced at the end of the acts, together with the change of the scone, and the proportion of each act to the rest, make it probable that the fifth act begins here.

IV.iv.48 (436,7) [Where then do you know best, Be we affied] This seems to be wrong. We may read more commodiously, — — *Where then you do know best Be we affied*; — —

Or thus, which I think is right, *Where then do you trow best, We be affied*; — —

V.i.70 (443,2) [a copatain hat!] is, I believe, a hat with a conical crown, such as was anciently worn by well-dressed men.

V.ii.54 (448,5) [A good swift simile] besides the original sense of *speedy in motion*, signified *witty, quick-witted*. So in *As You Like It*, the Duke says of the Clown, *He is very swift and sententious*. *Quick* is now used in almost the same sense as *nimble* was in the age after that of our author. Heylin says of Hales, that *he had known Laud for a nimble, disputant*.

V.ii.186 (453,7) [tho' you hit the white] To hit the *white* is a phrase borrowed from archery: the mark was commonly white. Here it alludes to the name *Bianca*, or *white*.

(454) General Observation. From this play the Tatler formed a story, [Johnson here copies out the *Tatler* story.] It cannot but seem strange that Shakespeare should be so little known to the author of the Tatler, that he should suffer this story to be obtruded upon him; or so little

known to the publick, that he could hope to make it pass upon his readers as a real narrative of a transaction in Lincolnshire; yet it is apparent, that he was deceived, or intended to deceive, that he knew not himself whence the story was taken, or hoped that he might rob so obscure a writer without detection.

Of this play the two plots are so well united, that they can hardly be called two without injury to the art with which they are interwoven. The attention is entertained with all the variety of a double plot, yet is not distracted by unconnected incidents.

The part between Catharine and Petruchio is eminently spritely and diverting. At the marriage of Bianca the arrival of the real father, perhaps, produces more perplexity than pleasure. The whole play is very popular and diverting, (see 1765, III,97,5)

ALL'S WELL THAT ENDS WELL

I.i.1 (3,2) [In delivering my son from me] [W: dissevering] Of this change I see no need: the present reading is clear, and, perhaps, as proper as that which the great commentator would substitute; for the king *dissevers* her son from her, she only *delivers* him.

I.i.5 (4,3) [to whom I am now in ward] Under his particular care, as my guardian, till I come to age. It is now almost forgotten in England that the heirs of great fortunes were the king's *wards*. Whether the same practice prevailed in France, it is of no great use to enquire, for Shakespeare gives to all nations the manners of England.

I. i.19 (4,5) [This young gentlewoman had a father, (O, that *had!* how sad a passage 'tis!)] [W: presage 'tis] This emendation is ingenious, perhaps preferable to the present reading, yet since *passage* may be fairly enough explained, I have left it in the text. *Passage* is *anything that passes*, so we now say, a *passage* of an *authour*. and we said about a century ago, the *passages* of a *reign*. When the *countess* mentions Helena's loss of a father, she recollects her own loss of a husband, and stops to observe how heavily that word *had* passes through her mind.

I.i.48 (6,6) [for where an unclean mind carries virtuous qualities, there commendations go with pity, they are virtues and traitors too; in her they are the better for their simpleness; she derives her honesty, and atchieves her goodness] [W: her simpleness] This is likewise a plausible but unnecessary alteration. *Her virtues are the better for their simpleness*, that is, her excellencies are the better because they are artless and open, without fraud, without design. The learned commentator has well explained *virtues*. but has not, I think, reached the force of the word *traitors*, and therefore has not shown the full extent of Shakespeare's masterly observation. *Virtues in an unclean mind are virtues and traitors too*. Estimable and useful qualities, joined with evil disposition, give that evil disposition power over others, who, by admiring the virtue, are betrayed to the malevolence. The *Tatler* mentioning the sharpers of his time, observes, that some of them are men of such elegance and knowledge, that a *young man who falls into their way* is betrayed *as much by his judgment as his passions*.

I.i.86 (7,8) [If the living be enemy to the grief, the excess makes it soon mortal] [W: be not enemy] This emendation I had once admitted into the text, but restored the old reading, because I think it capable of an easy explication. *Lafeu* says, *excessive grief is the enemy of the living*: the countess replies, *If the living be an enemy to grief, the excess soon makes it mortal*: that is, *if the living do not indulge grief, grief destroys itself by its own excess*. By the word *mortal* I understand *that which dies*, and Dr. Warburton, *that which destroys*. I think that my interpretation gives a sentence more acute and more refined. Let the reader judge.

I.i.78 (8,9) [That thee may furnish] That may help thee with more and better qualifications.

I.i.84 (8,1) [The best wishes that can befor'd in your thoughts, be servants to you!] That is, may you be mistress of your wishes, and have power to bring then to effect.

I.i.91 (8,2) [And these great tears grace his remembrance more] The tears which the king and countess shed for him.

I.i.99 (8,3) [In his bright radiance and collateral light Must I be comforted, not in his sphere] I cannot be united with him and move in the same *sphere*, but *must be comforted* at a distance by the *radiance* that shoots on all sides from him.

I.i.107 (9,4) [Of every line and trick of his sweet favour!] So in King John; *he hath a trick of Coeur de Lion's face*. *Trick* seen to be some peculiarity of look or feature.

I.i.122 (9,6) [you have some stain of soldier in you] [W: "*Stain* for colour."] *Stain* rather for what we now say *tincture*, some qualities, at least superficial, of a soldier. (1773)

I.i.150 (10,8) [He, that hangs himself, is a virgin] [W: As he..so is] I believe most readers Will spare both the emendations, which I do not think much worth a claim or a contest. The old reading is more spritely and equally just.

I.i.165 (11,1) [Marry, ill, to like him that ne'er it likes] Parolles, in answer to the question, *how one shall lose virginity to her own liking?* plays upon the word *liking*, and says, *she must do ill, for virginity, to be so lost, must like him that likes not virginity*.

I.i.178-191 (12,5) [Not my virginity yet] This whole speech is abrupt, unconnected, and obscure. Dr. Warburton thinks much of it supposititious. I would be glad to think so of the whole, for a commentator naturally wishes to reject what he cannot understand. Something, which should connect Helena's words with those of Parolles, seems to be wanting. Hammer has made a fair attempt by reading,

Not my virginity yet—You're for the court, There shall your master, &c.

Some such clause has, I think, dropped out, but still the first words want connection. Perhaps Parolles, going away after his harangue, said, *will you any thing with me?* to which Helen may reply—I know not what to do with the passage.

I.i.184 (13,7) [a traitress] It seems that traitress was in that age a term of endearment, for when Lafeu introduces Helena to the king, he says, *You like a traytor, but such traytors his majesty does not much fear.*

I.i.199 (14,8) [And shew what we alone must think] And *shew* by realities what we now *must only think*.

I.i.218 (14,9) [is a virtue of a good wing, and I like the wear well] [W: good ming] This conjecture I could wish to see better proved. This *common* word *ming* I have never found. The first edition of this play exhibits wing without a capital: yet, I confess, that a *virtue of good wing* is an expression that I cannot understand, unless by a metaphor taken from falconry, it may mean, *a virtue that will fly high*, and in the stile of Hotspur, *Pluck honour from the moon*.

I.i.235 (15,1) [What power is it, which mounts my love so high;
That makes me see, and cannot feed mine eye?]

She means, by what influence is my love directed to a person so much above me. [why am I made to discern excellence, sad left to long after it, without the food of hope.]

I.i.237 (15,2)

[The mightiest space in fortune, nature brings
To join like likes, and kiss, like native things.
Impossible be strange attempts, to those
That weigh their pain in sense; and do suppose,
What hath been]

All these four lines are obscure, and, I believe, corrupt. I shall propose an emendation, which those who can explain the present reading, are at liberty to reject.

Through *mightiest space in fortune nature brings*

Likes to join likes, and kiss, like native things.

That is, *nature brings like qualities and dispositions to meet through any distance that fortune may have set between them; she joins them and makes them kiss like things born together.*

The next lines I read with Hammer.

Impossible be strange attempts to those That weigh their pains in sense, and do suppose What ha'n't been, cannot be.

New attempts seen impossible to those who estimate their labour or enterprises by sense, and believe that nothing can be but what they see before them.

I.ii.32 (17,3)

[He had the wit, which I can well observe

To-day in our young lords, but they may jest,

Till their own scorn return to them; unnoted,

Ere they can hide their levity in honour]

I believe *honour is not dignity of birth or rank, but acquired reputation: Your father, says the king, had the same airy flights of satirical wit-with the young lords of the present time, but they do not what he did, hide their unnoted levity in honour, cover petty faults with great merit.*

This is an excellent observation. Jocose follies, and slight offences, are only allowed by mankind in him that overpowers them by great qualities.

I.ii.36 (18,4)

[So like a courtier, contempt nor bitterness

Were in his pride or sharpness; if they were,

His equal had awak'd them]

[W: no contempt or] The original edition reads the first line thus, *So like a courtier, contempt nor bitterness.*

The sense is the same. *Nor* was used without reduplication. So in *Measure for Measure*,

More nor less to others paying, Than by self-offences weighing.

The old text needs to be explained. He was so like a courtier, that there was in *his dignity of manner nothing contemptuous*, and

I.ii.41 (19, 5) [His tongue obey'd his hand] We should read,
His tongue obeyed the hand.

That is, the *hand* of his honour's clock, shewing the true minute when exceptions *bad* him speak.

I.ii.44 (19, 7) [Making then proud of his humility, In their poor praise he humbled] [W: proud; and his] Every man has seen the *mean* too often *proud* of the *humility* of the great, and perhaps the great may sometimes be *humbled in the praises* of the mean, of those who commend them without conviction or discernment: this, however is not so common; the *mean* are found more frequently than the *great*.

I.ii.50 (19, 8)

[So in approof lives not his epitaph,
 As in your royal speech]

[W: *Epitaph* for character.] I should wish to read,
Approof so lives not in his epitaph, *As in your royal speech*.

Approof is approbation. If I should allow Dr. Warburton's interpretation of *Epitaph*, which is more than can be reasonably expected, I can yet find no sense in the present reading.

I.ii.61 (20, 9) [*whose judgments are meer fathers of their garments*] Who have no other use of their faculties, than to invent new modes of dress.

I.iii (21, 1) [*Enter Countess, Steward, and Clown*] A *Clown* in Shakespeare is commonly taken for a *licensed jester*, or domestick *fool*. We are not to wonder that we find this character often in his plays, since fools were, at that time, maintained in all great families, to keep up merriment in the house. In the picture of Sir Thomas More's family, by Hans Holbein, the only servant represented is Patison the *fool*. This is a proof of the familiarity to which they were admitted, not by the great only, but the wise.

In some plays, a servant, or a rustic, of remarkable petulance and freedom of speech, is likewise called a clown.

I.iii.3 (21, 2) [to even your content] To act up to your desires.

I.iii.45 (23, 4) [You are shallow, madam, in great friends; for the knaves come to do that for me, which I am a weary of] [Tyrwhitt: my great] The meaning seems to be, you are not deeply skilled in the character of offices of great friends. (1773)

I.iii.96 (26, 1) [Clo. That man should be at woman's command, and yet no hurt done!—Tho' honesty be no puritan, yet it will do no hurt; it will wear the surplice of humility over the black gown of a big heart] The clown's answer is obscure. His lady bids him do as he is *commanded*. He answers with the licentious petulance of his character, that *if a man does as a woman commands, it is likely he will do amiss*; that he does not amiss, being at the command of a woman, he makes the effect, not of his lady's goodness, but of his own *honesty*, which, though not very nice or *puritanical*, will *do no hurt*; and will not only do no hurt, but, unlike the *puritans*, will comply with the injunctions of superiors, and wear the *surplice of humility over the black gown of a big heart*; will obey commands, though not much pleased with a state of subjection.

Here is an allusion, violently enough forced in, to satirize the obstinacy with which the *puritans* refused the use of the ecclesiastical habits, which was, at that time, one principal cause of the breach of union, and, perhaps, to insinuate, that the modest purity of the surplice was sometimes a cover for pride.

I.iii.140 (28,3) [By our remembrances] That is, *according to* our recollection. So we say, he is old *by* my reckoning.

I.iii.169 (29,5)

[—or, were you both our mothers I care no more for, than I do for heaven. So I were not his sister]

[W: I can no more fear, than I do fear heav'n.] I do not much yield to this emendation; yet I have not been able to please myself with any thing to which even my own partiality can give the preference.

Sir Thomas Banner reads,

Or were you both our mothers. I cannot ask for more than that of heaven. *So I were not his sister*; can be no other Way *I your daughter*, but *he must be my brother*?

I.iii.171 (30,6) [can't no other, But, I your daughter, he must be my brother?] The meaning is obscur'd by the elliptical diction. Can *it be no other way*, but if *I be your daughter he must be my brother*?

I.iii.178 (30,8) [Your salt tears' head] The force, the fountain of your tears, the cause of your grief.

I.iii.208 (31,9) [captious and intenable sieve] The word *captious* I never found in this sense; yet I cannot tell what to substitute, unless *carious*, for *rotten*, which yet is a word more likely to have been mistaken by the copyers than used by the author.

I.iii.232 (32,2)

[As notes, whose faculties inclusive were
Receipts in which greater *virtues* were inclosed]

Do not throw from you; you, my lord,, farewell; Share the advice betwixt you; if both gain all, The gift doth stretch itself as 'tis receiv'd, And is enough for both.

The first edition, from which the passage is restored, was sufficiently clear; yet it is plain, that the latter editors preferred a reading which they did not understand.

II.i.12 (35,8)

[let higher Italy
(Those 'hated, that inherit but the fall
Of the last monarchy) [see, that you come
Not to woo honour, but to wed it]

[Hammer: Those bastards that inherit] Dr. Warburton's observation is learned, but rather too subtle; Sir Tho. Hanmer's alteration is merely arbitrary. The passage is confessedly obscure, and therefore I may offer another explanation. I am of opinion that the epithet *higher* is to be understood of situation rather than of dignity. The sense may then be this, *Let upper Italy*, where you are to exercise your valour, *see that you come to gain honour, to the abatement, that is, to the disgrace and depression of those that have now lost their ancient military fame, and inherit but the fall of the last monarchy.* To *abate* is used by Shakespeare in the original sense of *abatere*, to depress, to sink, to deject, to subdue. So in *Coriolanus*,

— 'till ignorance deliver you.

As moat abated captives to some nation

That won you without blows.

And *bated* is used in a kindred sense in the Jew of Venice.

—in a bondman's key With *bated* breath and whisp'ring humbleness.

The word has still the same meaning in the language of the law.

II.i.21 (37,9) [Beware of being captives, Before you serve] The word *serve* is equivocal; the sense is, *Be not captives before you serve in the war. Be not captives before you are soldiers.*

II.i.36 (37,1) [I grow to you, and our parting is a tortur'd body] I read thus, *Our parting is the parting of a tortured body.* Our parting is as the disruption of limbs torn from each other. Repetition of a word is often the cause of mistakes, the eye glances on the wrong word, and the intermediate part of the sentence is omitted.

II.i.54 (38,3) [they wear themselves in the cap of the time, there, do muster true gait] [W: to muster] I think this amendment cannot be said to give much light to the obscurity of the passage. Perhaps it might be read thus, *They do muster with the true gait.* that is, they have the true military step. Every man has observed something peculiar in the strut of a soldier, (rev. 1778, IV,35,8)

II.i.70 (39,4) [across] This word, as has been already observed, is used when any pass of wit miscarries.

II.i.74 (39,5) [Yes, but you will, my noble grapes, as if] These words, *my noble grapes*, seem to Dr. Warburton and Sir T. Hammer, to stand so much in the way, that they have silently omitted them. They may be indeed rejected without great loss, but I believe they are Shakespeare's words. *You will eat*, says Lafen, *no grapes. Yes, but you will eat such noble grapes as I bring you, if you could reach them.*

II.i. 100 (41,8) [I am Cressid's uncle] I am like Pandarus. See Troilus and Cressida. (see 1765, III,310,2)

II.i.114 (41,9) [wherein the honour Of my dear father's gift stands chief in power] Perhaps we may better read,—*wherein the power Of my dear father's gift stands chief in honour*,

II.i.144 (42,1) [When miracles have by the greatest been deny'd] I do not see the import or connection of this line. As the next line stands without a correspondent rhyme, I suspect that something has been lost.

II.i.159 (43,2) [Myself against the level of mine aim] I rather think that she means to say, *I am not an impostor that proclaim* one thing and design another, *that proclaim* a cure and aim at a fraud: I think what I speak.

II.i.174 (43,3)

[a divulged shame
Traduc'd by odious ballds; my maiden's name
Sear'd otherwise; no worse of worst extended,
With vilest torture let my life be ended]

This passage is apparently corrupt, and how shall it be rectified? I have no great hope of success, but something must be tried. I read the whole thus,

King. *What darest thou venture?*

Hal. *Tax of impudence.*

*A strumpet's boldness; a divulged shame,
Traduc'd by odious ballads my maiden name;
Sear'd otherwise, to worst of worst extended;
With vilest torture let my life be ended.*

When this alteration first came into my mind, I supposed Helen to mean thus, *First*, I venture what is dearest to me, my maiden reputation; but if your distrust *extends* my character *to the worst of the worst*, and supposes me *seared* against the sense of infamy, I will add to the stake of reputation, the stake of life. This certainly is sense, and the language as grammatical as many other passages of Shakespeare. Yet we may try another experiment.

*Fear otherwise to worst of worst extended;
With vilest torture let my life be ended.*

That is, let me act under the greatest terrors possible.

But once again we will try to find the right way by the glimmer of Hanmer's amendment, who reads thus,

— *my maiden name*
Sear'd; otherwise the worst of worst extended. etc.

Perhaps it were better thus,
— *my maiden name Sear'd; otherwise the worst to worst extended;
With vilest torture let my life be ended.*

II.i.182 (45,5) [Thy life is dear; for all, that life can rate Worth name of life, in thee hath estimate] May be *counted* among the gifts enjoyed by them.

II.i.185 (45,7) [prime] Youth; the spring or morning of life.

II.ii.40 (48,1) [To be young again] The lady censures her own levity in trifling with her jester, as a ridiculous attempt to return back to youth.

II.iii.6 (49,3) [unknown fear] *Fear* is here the object of fear.

II.iii.11 (50,4)

[*Par.* So I say, both of Galen and Paracelsus. *Laf.* Of all the learned and authentic fellows]

As the whole merriment of this scene consists in the pretensions of Parolles to knowledge and sentiments which he has not, I believe here are two passages in which the words and sense are bestowed upon him by the copies, which the author gave to Lafen. I read this passage thus,

Laf. To be relinquished of the artists — —

Par. So I say.

Laf. Both of Galen and Paracelsus, of all the learned and authentick fellows — —

Par. Right, so I say.

II.iii.41 (51,7)

[which should, indeed, give us a farther use to be made, than alone the recovery of the King; as to be — *Laf.* Generally thankful]

I cannot see that there is any *hiatus*, or other irregularity of language than such as is very common in these plays. I believe Parolles has again usurped words and sense to which he has no right; and I read this passage thus,

Laf. In a most weak and debile minister, great power, great transcendence; which should, indeed, give us a farther use to be made than the mere recovery of the king. *Par.* As to be. *Laf.* Generally thankful.

II.iii.66 (52,9) [My mouth no more were broken than these boys']

A broken mouth is a mouth which has lost part of its teeth.

II.iii.77 (53,1) [Let the white death sit on thy cheek for ever]

[*W:* dearth] The white death is the chlorosis.

II.iii.80 (53,2) [And to imperial Love] [*W.* The old editions read IMPARTIAL, which is right.] There is no edition of this play older than that of 1623, the next is that of 1632, of which both read imperials the second reads imperial Jove.

II.iii.92 (53,3) [*Laf.* Do they all deny her?] None of them have yet denied her, or deny her afterwards but Bertram. The scene must be so regulated that Lafeu and Parolles talk at a distance, where they

may see what passes between Helena and the lords, but not hear it, so that they know not by whom the refusal is made.

II.iii.105 (54,4) [There's one grape yet, — I am sure, they father drunk wine. — But if thou be'st not an ass, I am a youth of fourteen. I have known thee already] This speech the three last editors have perplexed themselves by dividing between Lafeu and Parolles, without any authority of copies, or any improvement of sense. I have restored the old reading, and should have thought no explanation necessary, but that Mr. Theobald apparently misunderstood it.

Old Lafeu having, upon the supposition that the lady was refused, reproached the young lords as *boys of ice*, throwing his eyes on Bertram who remained, cries out, "*There is one yet into whom his father put good blood, — — but I have known thee long enough to know thee for an ass.*"

II.iii.135 (55,6) [good alone Is good, without a name, vileness is so] [W: good; and with a name,] The present reading is certainly wrong, and, to confess the truth, I do not think Dr. Warburton's emendation right; yet I have nothing that I can propose with much confidence. Of all the conjectures that I can make, that which least displeases me is this:

— *good alone. Is good without a name; Helen is so;*
The rest follows easily by this change.

II.iii.138 (56,7)

[— She is young, wise, fair;
In these, to nature she's immediate heir;
And these breed honour]

Here is a long note [W's] which I wish had been shorter. *Good* is better than *young*, as it refers to *honour*. But she is more the *immediate heir* of *nature* with respect to *youth* than *goodness*. To be *immediate heir* is to inherit without any intervening transmitter: thus she inherits beauty *immediately* from *nature*, but honour is transmitted by ancestors; youth is received *immediately* from *nature*. but *goodness* may be conceived in part the gift of parents, or the effect of education. The alteration therefore loses on one side what it gains on the other.

II.iii.170 (58,9) [Into the staggers] One species of the *staggers*, or the *horses apoplexy*, is a raging impatience which makes the animal dash

himself with destructive violence against posts or walls. To this the allusion, I suppose, is made.

II.iii.185 (59,1)

[whose ceremony Shall seem expedient on the now-born brief,
And be perform'd to-night]

This, if it be at all intelligible, is at least obscure and inaccurate.

Perhaps it was written thus,

—what *ceremony Shall seem expedient on the now-born brief* Shall be
perform'd to-night; the solemn feast Shall more attend—

The *brief* is the *contract of espousal*, or the *licence* of the church. The King means, What *ceremony* is necessary to make this *contract a marriage*, shall be immediately *performed*; the rest may be delayed.

II.iii.211 (60,2) [I did think thee, for two ordinaries, to be a pretty wise fellow] While I sat twice with thee at table.

II.iii.217 (60,3) [yet art then good for nothing but taking up] To take up, is to *contradict*, to *call to account*, as well as to *pick off the ground*.

II.iii.242 (60,4) [in the default] That is, *at a need*.

II.iii.246 (61,5) [for doing, I am past; as I will by thee, in what motion age will give me leave] [Warburton suspected a line lost after "past"] This suspicion of chasm is groundless. The conceit which is so thin that it might well escape a hasty reader, is in the word *past*, *I am past*, *as I will be past by thee*.

II.iii.309 (63,9) [To the dark house] The *dark house* is a house made gloomy by discontent. Milton says of *death* and the *king* of hell preparing to combat,

So frown'd the mighty combatants, that hell Grew darker at their frown.

II.iv.45 (65,1) [Whose want, and whose delay, is strew'd with sweets] The *sweets* with which this *want* are *strewed*, I suppose, are compliments and professions of kindness.

II.iv.52 (65,2) [probable need] A specious appearance of necessity.

III.i.10 (70,5) [The reasons of our state I cannot yield] I cannot inform you of the reasons.

III.i.11 (70,6) [an outward man] [W: i.e. one not in the secret of affairs] So *inward* is familiar, admitted to secrets. *I was an inward of his.* Measure for Measure.

III.ii.59 (73,1) [*When thou canst get the ring upon my finger*] [W: When thou canst get the ring, which is on my finger, into thy possession] I think Dr. Warburton's explanation sufficient, but I once read it thus, *When thou canst get the ring upon thy finger, which newer shall come off mine.*

III.ii.100 (74,3) [Not so, but as we change our courtesies] The gentlemen declare that they are servants to the Countess, she replies, No otherwise than as she returns the same offices of civility.

III.iv.4 (77,4) [St. Jaques' pilgrim] I do not remember any place famous for pilgrimages consecrated in Italy to St. James, but it is common to visit St. James of Compostella, in Spain. Another saint might easily have been found, Florence being somewhat out of the road from Bonsillon to Compostella.

III.iv.13 (77,6) [Juno] Alluding to the story of Hercules.

III.iv.19 (77,6) [Rinaldo, you did never lack advice so much] *Advice*, is *discretion* or *thought*.

III.v.21 (79,7) [are not the things they go under] [W: Mr. Theobald explains these words by, *They are not really so true and sincere as in appearance they seem to be.*] I think Theobald's interpretation right; *to go under* the name of any thing is a known expression. The meaning is, they are not the things for which their names would make them pass.

III.v.66 (81,8) [examin'd] That is, *question'd*, *doubted*.

III.v.74 (81,9) [brokes] Deals as a *broker*.

III.vi.107 (86,6) [we have almost imboss'd him] To imboss a deer is to inclose him in a wood. Milton uses the same word:

Like that self-begotten bird In th' Arabian woods embost. Which no second knows or third.

III.vi.III (87,7) [ere we case him] This is, before we strip him naked. (1773)

III.vii.9 (88,2) [to your sworn council] To your private knowledge, after having required from you an oath of secrecy.

III.vii.21 (88,9) [Now his important blood will nought deny] *Important* here, and elsewhere, is *importunate*.

IV.i.16 (90,2) [some band of strangers i' the adversary's entertainment]

That is, *foreign troops in the enemy's pay*.

IV.i.44 (91,3) [the instance] The *proof*.

IV.ii.13 (94,5)

[No more of that!

I pr'ythee, do not strive against my vows:

I was compell'd to her]

I know not well what Bertram can mean by entreating Diana *not to strive against his vows*. Diana has just mentioned his *wife*, so that the *vows* seem to relate to his marriage. In this sense not Diana, but himself, *strives against his vows*. His *vows* indeed may mean *vows* made to Diana; but, in that case, to *strive against* is not properly used for to reject, nor does this sense cohere well with his first exclamation of impatience at the mention of his wife. *No more of that!* Perhaps we might read,

I Pr'ythee do not drive against my vows.

Do not run *upon that topick; talk of any thing else that I can bear to hear.*

I have another conceit upon this passage, which I would be thought to offer without much confidence:

No more of that! I pr'ythee do not strive—against my voice I was compell'd to her.

Diana tells him unexpectedly of his wife. He answers with perturbation, *No more of that! I pr'ythee do not play the confessor —against my own consent I was compelled to her.*

When a young profligate finds his courtship so gravely repressed by an admonition of his duty, he very naturally desires the girl not to take upon her the office of a confessor.

IV.ii.23 (95,6) [What is not holy, that we swear not 'bides] [W: not 'bides] This is an acute and excellent conjecture, and I have done it the due honour of exalting it to the text; yet, methinks, there is something yet wanting. The following words, *but take the High'st to witness*, even though it be understood as an anticipation or assumption in

this sense,—*but* now suppose that you *take the Highest to witness*,—has not sufficient relation to the antecedent sentence. I will propose a reading nearer to the surface, and let it take its chance.

Ber. *How have I sworn!*

Diana. *'Tis not the many oaths, that make the truth,
But the plain single vow, that is vow'd true.*

Ber. *What is not holy, that we swear not by.
But take the High'st to witness.*

Diana. *Then, pray tell me.*

If I should swear, &c.

Bertram means to enforce his suit, by telling her, that he has bound himself to her, not by the pretty protestations usual among lovers, but by vows of greater solemnity. She then makes a proper and rational reply.

IV.ii.25 (96,7) [If I should swear by Jove's great attributes] In the print of the old folio, it is doubtful whether it be *Jove's* or *Love's*, the characters being not distinguishable. If it is read *Love's*, perhaps it may be something less difficult. I am still at a loss.

It may be read thus,

—"this has no holding, "To swear by him whom I *attest* to love,
"That I will work against him."

There is no consistence in expressing reverence for Jupiter by calling him to *attest* my love, and shewing at the same time, by *working against him* by a wicked passion, that I have no respect to the name which I invoke. (1773)

IV.ii.28 (96,8) [To swear by him whom I protest to love, That I will work against him] This passage likewise appears to me corrupt. She swears not *by* him whom she *loves*, but by Jupiter. I believe we may read, *to swear to him*. There is, says she, no *holding*, no consistency, in swearing to one that *I love him*, when I swear it only to *injure* him.

IV.ii.73 (98,9) [Since Frenchmen are so braid, Marry that will, I'll live and die a maid] [W: Marry 'em] The passage is very unimportant, and the old reading reasonable enough. Nothing is more common than for girls, on such occasions, to say in a pet what they do not think, or to think for a time what they do not finally resolve.

IV.iii.7 (98,1) [I *Lord*] The later editors have with great liberality bestowed lordship upon these interlocutors, who, in the original edition, are called, with more propriety, *capt. E.* and *capt. G.* It is true that *captain E.* is in a former scene called *lord E.* but the subordination in which they seem to act, and the timorous manner in which they converse, determines them to be only captains. Yet as the later readers of Shakespeare have been used to find them lords, I have not thought it worth while to degrade them in the margin.

IV.iii.29 (99,2) [he, that in this action contrives against his own nobility, in his proper stream o'erflows himself] That is, *betrays his own secrets in his own talk.* The reply shows that this is the meaning.

IV.iii.38 (100,3) [he might take a measure of his own judgment] This is a very just and moral reason. Bertram, by finding how erroneously he has judged, will be less confident, and more easily moved by admonition.

IV.iii.113 (102,4) [bring forth this counterfeit module] [W: medal] *Module* being the *pattern* of any thing, may be here used in that sense. Bring forth this fellow, who, by *counterfeit* virtue pretended to make himself a *pattern*.

IV.iii.237 (106,8) [Dian. *the Count's a fool, and full of gold*] After this line there is apparently a line lost, there being no rhyme that corresponds to gold.

IV.iii.254 (106,9) [Half won, is match well made; match, and well make it] This line has no meaning that I can find. I read, with a very slight alteration, *Half won is match well made; watch, and well make it.* That is, *a match well made is half won; watch, and make it well.*

This is, in my opinion, not all the error. The lines are misplaced, and should be read thus:

Half won is match well made; watch, and well make it; when he swears oaths, bid him drop gold, and take it. After he scores, he never pays the score: He never pays after-debts, take it before. And say —

That is, take his money and leave him to himself. When the players had lost the second line, they tried to make a connection out of the rest. Part is apparently in couplets, and the note was probably uniform.

IV.iii.280 (107,1) [He will steal, sir, an egg out of a cloister] I know not that *cloister*, though it may etymologically signify *any thing shut* is used by our author, otherwise than for a *monastery*, and therefore I cannot guess whence this hyperbole could take its original: perhaps it means only this: *He will steal any thing, however trifling, from any place, however holy.*

IV.iii.307 (108,2) [he's a cat still] That is, throw him how you will, he lights upon his legs. [Steevens offered another explanation] I am still of my former opinion. The same speech was applied by king James to Coke, with respect to his subtilties of law, that throw him which way we would, he could still like a cat light upon his legs. (see 1765, III,372,1)

IV.iii.317 (109,3) [Why does he ask him of me?] This is nature. Every man is on such occasions more willing to hear his neighbour's character than his own.

IV.iii.332 (109,4) [Only to seem to deserve well, and to beguile the supposition of that lascivious young boy the Count, have I run into this danger] That is, *to deceive the opinion*, to make the count think me a man that *deserves well*.

IV.iv.23 (III,6) [When saucy trusting of the cozen'd thoughts Defiles the pitchy night!] [W: When Fancy,] This conjecture is truly ingenious, but, I believe, the author of it will himself think it unnecessary, when he recollects that *saucy* may very properly signify *luxurious*, and by consequence *lascivious*.

IV.iv.31 (112,7)

[But with the word, the time will bring on summer,
When briars shall have leaves as well as thorns,
And be as sweet as sharp]

The meaning of this observation is, that *as briars have sweetness with their prickles*, so shall these *troubles* be recompensed with *joy*.

IV.iv.34 (112,8) [Our waggon is prepar'd, and time revives us] [W: revyes] The present reading is corrupt, and I am afraid the emendation none of the soundest. I never remember to have seen the word *revye*. One may as well leave blunders as make them. Why may we not read for a shift, without much effort, *the time invites us*?

IV.v.8 (114,1) [I would, I had not known him!] This dialogue serves to connect the incidents of Parolles with the main plan of the play.

IV.v.66 (116,4) [*Laf.* A shrewd knave, and an unhappy] That is, *mischievously waggish; unlucky*. (see 1765, III,379,3)

IV.v.70 (116,5) [he has no pace, but runs where he will] [Tyrrwhit: place] A *pace* is a certain or prescribed walk, so we say of a man meanly obsequious, that he has learned his *paces*. (1773) [(rev. 1778, IV,126,3]

V.i.35 (120,8)

[I will come after you, with what good speed
Our means will make us means]

Shakespeare delights much in this kind of reduplication, sometimes so as to obscure his meaning. Helena says, *they will follow with such speed as the means which they have will give them ability to exert*.

V.ii.57 (123,3) [tho' you are a fool and a knave, you shall eat] Parolles has many of the lineaments of Falstaff, and seems to be the character which Shakespeare delighted to draw, a fellow that had more wit than virtue. Though justice required that he should be detected and exposed, yet his *vices sit so fit in him* that he is not at last suffered to starve.

V.iii.1 (123,4) [We lost a jewel of her, and our esteem Was made much poorer by it] Dr. Warburton, in Theobald's edition, altered this word to *estate*, in his own he lets it stand and explains it by worth or estate. But *esteem* is here *reckoning* or *estimate*. Since the loss of *Helen* with her *virtues* and *qualifications*, our *account* is *sunk*; what we have to *reckon* ourselves king of, is much *poorer* than before.

V.iii.4 (123,5) [home] That is, *completely, in its full extent*.

V.iii.6 (123,6) [done i' the blade of youth] In the *spring* of *early life*, when the man is yet *green*, *oil* and *fire* suit but ill with *blade*, and therefore Dr. Warburton reads, *blaze* of youth.

V.iii.21 (124,7) [the first view shall kill All repetition] *The first interview shall put an end to all recollection of the past*. Shakespeare is now hastening to the end of the play, finds his matter sufficient to fill up his remaining scenes, and therefore, as on other such occasions, contracts his dialogue and precipitates his action. Decency required

that Bertram's double crime of cruelty and disobedience, joined likewise with some hypocrisy, should raise more resentment; and that though his mother might easily forgive him, his king should more pertinaciously vindicate his own authority and Helen's merit: of all this Shakespeare could not be ignorant, but Shakespeare wanted to conclude his play.

V.iii.50 (125,9) [My high repented blames] [A long note by Warburton] It was but just to insert this note, long as it is, because the commentator seems to think it of importance. Let the reader judge.

V.iii.65 (127,1)

[Our own love, waking, cries to see what's done,
While shameful hate sleeps out the afternoon]

These two lines I should be glad to call *an interpolation of a player*. They are ill connected with the former, and not very clear or proper in themselves. I believe the author made two couplets to the same purpose, wrote them both down that he might take his choice, and so they happened to be both preserved.

For *sleep* I think we should read *slept*. *Love cries* to see what was done while hatred *slept*, and suffered mischief to be done. Or the meaning may be, that *hatred* still *continues* to *sleep* at ease, while *love* is weeping; and so the present reading may stand.

V.iii.93 (128,3) [In Florence was it from a casement thrown me]

Bertram still continues to have too little virtue to deserve Helen.

He did not know indeed that it was Helen's ring, but he knew that he had it not from a window.

V.iii.95 (128,4) [Noble she was, and thought I stood engag'd] [T: I don't understand this reading; if we are to understand, that she thought Bertram engag'd to her in affection, insnared by her charms, this meaning is too obscurely express'd.] The context rather makes me believe, that the poet wrote,

noble she was, and thought I stood unag'd; — —

i.e. unengag'd: neither my heart, nor person, dispos'd of.—The plain meaning is, when she saw me receive the ring, she thought me *engaged* to her.

V.iii.101 (129,5) [*King* Plutus himself, That knows the tinct and multiplying medicine] Plutus the grand alchemist, who knows the *tincture* which confers the properties of gold upon base metals, and the *matter*

by which *gold* is *multiplied*, by which a small quantity of gold is made to communicate its qualities to a large mass of metal.

In the reign of Henry the fourth a law was made to forbid *all men thenceforth to multiply gold, or use any craft of multiplication*. Of which law Mr. Boyle, when he was warm with the hope of transmutation, procured a repeal.

V.iii.105 (129,6) [Then if you know, That you are well acquainted with yourself] The true meaning of this *strange* [Warburton's word] expression is, *If you know that your faculties are so found, as that you have the proper consciousness of your own actions, and are able to recollect and relate what you have done, tell me. &c.*

V.iii.121 (130,7)

[My fore-past proofs, howe'er the matter fall,
Shall tax my fears of little vanity,
Having vainly fear'd too little]

The *proofs which I have already had*, are sufficient to show that my *fears* were not *vain* and irrational. I have rather been hither-to more easy than I ought, and have *unreasonably* had *too little fear*.

V.iii.131 (130,8) [Who hath, some four or five removes, come short] *Removes* are *journies* or *post-stages*.

V.iii.191 (133,1) [O, behold this ring. Whose high respect and rich validity] *Validity* is a very bad word for *value*, which yet I think is its meaning, unless it be considered as making a contract *valid*.

V.iii.214 (133,2)

[As all impediments in fancy's course,
Are motives of more fancy: and in fine,
Her insult coming with her modern grace,
Subdu'd me to her rate: she got the ring]

Every thing that obstructs love is an occasion by which love is heightened. And, to conclude, her solicitation concurring with her fashionable appearance, she got the ring.

I am not certain that I have attained the true meaning of the word *modern*, which, perhaps, signifies rather *meanly pretty*.

V.iii.296-305 (137,3) This dialogue is too long, since the audience already knew the whole transaction; nor is there any reason for puzzling the king and playing with his passions; but it was much easier

than to make a pathetic interview between Helen and her husband, her mother, and the king.

V.iii.305 (137,4) [exorcist] This word is used not very properly for *enchanter*.

V.iii.339 (139,2) [Ours be your patience then, and yours our parts] The meaning is: *Grant us then your patience*; hear us without interruption. *And take our parts*; that is, support and defend us. (see 1765, III,399)

(139) General Observation. This play has many delightful scenes, though not sufficiently probable, and some happy characters, though not new, nor produced by any deep knowledge of human nature. Parolles is a boaster and a coward, such as has always been the sport of the stage, but perhaps never raised more laughter or contempt than in the hands of Shakespeare.

I cannot reconcile my heart to Bertram; a man noble without generosity, and young without truth; who marries Helen as a coward, and leaves her as a profligate: when she is dead by his unkindness, sneaks home to a second marriage, is accused by a woman whom he has wronged, defends himself by falsehood, and is dismissed to happiness.

The story of Bertram and Diana had been told before of Mariana and Angelo, and, to confess the truth, scarcely merited to be heard a second time.

TWELFTH-NIGHT

(142) The persons of the drama were first enumerated, with all the cant of the modern stage, by Mr. Rowe.

I.i.2 (143,2) [that, surfeiting, The appetite may sicken, and so die] [W: app'tite, Love] It is true, we do not talk of the *death of appetite*, because we do not ordinarily speak in the figurative language of poetry; but that *appetite sickens by a surfeit* is true, and therefore proper.

I.i.21 (145,6) [That instant was I turn'd into a hart] This image evidently alludes to the story of Acteon, by which Shakespeare seems to think men cautioned against too great familiarity with forbidden beauty. Acteon, who saw Diana naked, and was torn in pieces by his hounds, represents a man, who indulging his eyes, or his imagination, with the view of a woman that he cannot gain, has his heart torn with incessant longing. An interpretation far more elegant and natural than that of Sir Francis Bacon, who, in his *Wisdom of the Antients*, supposes this story to warn us against enquiring into the secrets of princes, by shewing, that those who knew that which for reasons of state is to be concealed, will be detected and destroyed by their own servants.

I.ii.25 (147,9) [A noble Duke in nature, as in name] I know not whether the nobility of the name is comprised in *Duke*, or in *Orsino*, which is, I think, the name of a great Italian family.

I.ii.42 (148,1)

[*Vio.* O, that I serv'd that lady;
And might not be deliver'd to the world,
'Till I had made mine own occasion mellow
What my estate is!]

I wish I might not be *made public* to the world, with regard to the *state* of my birth and fortune, till I have gained a *ripe opportunity* for my design.

Viola seems to have formed a very deep design with very little premeditation: she is thrown by shipwreck on an unknown coast, hears that the prince is a batchelor, and resolves to supplant the lady whom he courts.

I.ii.55 (149,2) [I'll serve this Duke] Viola is an excellent schemer, never at a loss; if she cannot serve the lady, she will serve the Duke.

I.iii.77 (152,5) [It's dry, sir] What is the jest of *dry hand*, I know not any better than Sir Andrew. It may possibly mean, a hand with no money in it; or, according to the rules of physiognomy, she may intend to insinuate, that it is not a lover's hand, a moist hand being vulgarly accounted a sign of an amorous constitution.

I.iii.148 (154,9) [Taurus? that's sides and heart] Alluding to the medical astrology still preserved in almanacks, which refers the affections or particular parts of the body, to the predominance of particular constellations.

I.iv.34 (155,1) [And all is semblative—a woman's part] That is, thy proper part in a play would be a woman's. Women were then personated by boys.

I.v.9 (156,2) [lenten answer] A *lean*, or as we now call it, a *dry* answer.

I.v.39 (157,4) [Better be a witty fool, than a foolish wit] Hall, in his *Chronicle*, speaking of the death of Sir Thomas More, says, that he knows not whether to call him *a foolish wise man, or a wise foolish man*.

I.v.105 (159,5) [Now Mercury indue thee with leasing, for thou speak'st well of fools!] [W: pleasing] I think the present reading more humorous. *May Mercury teach thee to lie, since thou liest in favour of fools*.

I.v.213 (164,1) [to make one in so skipping a dialogue] Wild, frolick, mad.

I.v.218 (164,2) [Some mollification for your giant] Ladies, in romance, are guarded by giants, who repel all improper or troublesome advances. Viola seeing the waiting-maid so eager to oppose her message, intreats Olivia to pacify her giant.

I.v.328 (168,8)

[*Oli*. I do, I know not what; and fear to find Mine eye too great a flatterer for my mind]

I believe the meaning is; I am not mistress of my own actions, I am afraid that my eyes betray me, and flatter the youth without my consent, with discoveries of love.

II.i.15 (169,9) [to express myself] That is, *to reveal myself*.

II.i.28 (169,1) [with such estimable wonder] These words Dr. Warburton calls *an interpolation of the players*, but what did the players gain by it? they may be sometimes guilty of a joke without the concurrence of the poet, but they never lengthen a speech only to make it longer. Shakespeare often confounds the active and passive adjectives. *Estimable wonder* is *esteeming wonder*, or *wonder and esteem*. The meaning is, that he could not venture to think so highly as others of his sister.

II.ii.21 (171,2) [her eyes had lost her tongue] [W: crost] That the fascination of the eyes was called *crossing* ought to have been proved. But however that be, the present reading has not only sense but beauty. We say a man *loses* his company when they go one way and he goes another. So Olivia's tongue *lost* her eyes; her tongue was talking of the Duke and her eyes gazing on his messenger.

II.ii.29 (171,3) [the pregnant enemy] is, I believe, the dexterous fiend, or enemy of mankind. (1773)

II.ii.30 (171,4)

[How easy is it, for the proper false

In women's waxen hearts to set their forms]

This is obscure. The meaning is, *how easy is disguise to women*; how easily does *their own falsehood*, contained in their waxen changeable hearts, enable them to assume deceitful appearances. The two next lines are perhaps transposed, and should be read thus,

For such as we are made, if such we be, Alas, our frailty is the cause, not we.

II.iii.27 (175,9) [I did impeticoat thy gratility] This, Sir T. Hammer tells us, is the same with *impocket thy gratuity*. He is undoubtedly right; but we must read, *I did impeticoat thy gratuity*. The fools were kept in long coats, to which the allusion is made. There is yet much in this dialogue which I do not understand.

II.iii.51 (176,1) [In delay there lies no plenty] [W: decay] I believe *delay* is right.

II.iii.52 (176,2) [Then come kiss me, sweet, and twenty] This line is obscure; we might read,

Come, a kiss then, sweet, and twenty.

Yet I know not whether the present reading be not right, for in some counties *sweet and twenty*, whatever be the meaning, is a phrase of endearment.

II.iii.59 (176,3) [make the welkin dance] That is, drink till the sky seems to turn round.

II.iii.75 (177,5) [They sing a catch] This catch is lost.

II.iii.81 (177,6) [Peg-a-Ramsey] *Peg-a-Ramsey* I do not understand. *Tilly vally* was an interjection of contempt, which Sir Thomas More a lady is recorded to have had very often in her mouth.

II.iii.97 (178,7) [ye squeak out your coziers catches] A *Cozier* is a taylor, from *coudre* to sew, part, *consu*, French, (see 1765, 11,383,2)

II.iii.128 (180,1) [rub your chin with crumbs] I suppose it should be read, *rub your chin with crumbs*, alluding to what had been said before that. Malvolio was only a steward, and consequently dined after his lady.

II.iii.131 (180,2) [you would not give means for this uncivil rule] *Rule* is, method of life, so *misrule* is tumult and riot.

II.iii.149 (181,3) [Possess us] That is, *inform us, tell us*, make us masters of the matter.

II.iv.5 (183,5) [light airs, and recollected terms] I rather think that *recollected* signifies, more nearly to its primitive sense, *recalled, repeated*, and alludes to the practice of composers, who often prolong the song by repetitions.

II.iv.26 (184,6) [favour] The word *favour* ambiguously used.

II.iv.35 (184,7) [lost and worn] Though *lost and worn* may mean *lost and worn out*, yet *lost and won* being, I think, better, these two words coming usually and naturally together, and the alteration being very slight, I would so read in this place with Sir Tho. Hammer.

II.iv.46 (185,8) [free] is, perhaps, *vacant, unengaged, easy in mind*.

II.iv.47 (185,9) [silly sooth] It is plain, simple truth.

II.iv.49 (185,2) [old age] The *old age* is the *ages past*, the times of simplicity.

II.iv.58 (185,3) [My part of death no one so true Did share it] Though *death* is a *part* in which every one acts his *share*, yet of all these actors no one is *so true* as I.

II.iv.87 (187,6)

[But 'tis that miracle, and queen of gems,
That nature pranks her in]

[W: pranks, her mind] The *miracle and queen of gems* is her *beauty*, which the commentator might have found without so emphatical an enquiry. As to her mind, he that should be captious would say, that though it may be formed by nature it must be *pranked* by education.

Shakespeare does not say that *nature pranks her in a miracle*, but in *the miracle of gems*, that is, in a *gem miraculously beautiful*.

II.v.43 (191,2) [the lady of the Strachy] [W: We should read *Trachy*. i.e. *Thrace*; for so the old English writers called it] What we should read is hard to say. Here it an allusion to some old story which I have not yet discovered.

II.v.51 (191,3) [stone-bow] That is, a cross-bow, a bow which shoots stones.

II.v.66 (192,4) [wind up my watch] In our author's time watches were very uncommon. When Guy Faux was taken, it was urged as a circumstance of suspicion that a watch was found upon him.

II.v.70 (192,5) [Tho' our silence be drawn from us with carts] I believe the true reading is, *Though our silence be drawn from us with carts, yet peace*. In the *The Two Gentlemen of Verona*, one of the Clowns says, *I have a mistress, but who that is, a team of horses shall not draw from me*. So in this play, *Oxen and wainropes will not bring them together*.

II.v.97 (193,7) [her great P's] [Steevens: In the direction of the letter which Malvolio reads, there is neither a C, nor a P, to be found] There may, however, be words in the direction which he does not read. To formal directions of two ages ago were often added these words, Humbly *Present*. (1773)

II.v.144 (195,2) [And O shall end, I hope] By *O* is here meant what we now call a *hempen collar*.

II.v.207 (197,6) [tray-trip] The word *tray-trip* I do not understand.

II.v.215 (198,7) [aqua vitae] Is the old name of *strong waters*.

III.i.57 (200,9) [lord Pandarus] See our author's play of *Troilus and Cressida*.

III.i.71 (200,1) [And, like the haggard, check at every feather] The meaning may be, that he must catch every opportunity, as the wild hawk strikes every bird. But perhaps it might be read more properly,
Not like the haggard.

He must chuse persons and times, and observe tempers, he must fly at proper game, like the trained hawk, and not fly at large like the haggard, to seize all that comes in his way. (1773)

III.i.75 (201,2) [But wise-men's folly fall'n] Sir Thomas Hammer reads, *folly shewn*. [The sense is, *But wise men's folly, when it is once fallen into extravagance, overpowers their discretion*. Revisal.] I explain it thus. The folly which he shows with proper adaptation to persons and times, *is fit*, has its propriety, and therefore produces no censure; but the folly of wise men when it *falls* or *happens*, taints their wit, destroys the reputation of their judgment. (see 1765, II,402,2)

III.i.86 (202,4) [she is the list of my voyage] Is the *bound, limit, farthest point*.

III.i.100 (202,5) [most pregnant and vouchsafed ear] *Pregnant* is a word in this writer of very lax signification. It may here mean *liberal*. (1773)

III.i.123 (203,6) [After the last enchantment (you did hear)] [W: enchantment you did here] The present reading is no more nonsense than the emendation.

III.i.132 (203,8) [a Cyprus] Is a transparent stuff.

III.i.135 (204,9) [a grice] Is a *step*, sometimes written *greese* from *degres*, French.

III.i.170 (205,1) [I have one heart, one bosom, and one truth, And that no woman has] And that heart and boson I have never yielded to any woman.

III.ii.45 (207,5) [Go, write it in a martial hand; be curst and brief] *Martial hand*, seems to be a careless scrawl, such as shewed the writer

to neglect ceremony. *Curst*, is petulant, crabbed—a curst cur, is a dog that with little provocation snarls and bites. (1773)

III.iv.61 (213,1) [midsummer madness] Hot weather often turns the brain, which is, I suppose, alluded to here.

III.iv.82 (214,3) [I have lim'd her] I have entangled or caught her, as a bird is caught with birdlime.

III.iv.85 (214,4) [Fellow:] This word which originally signified companion, was not yet totally degraded to its present meaning; and Malvolio takes it in the favourable sense.

III.iv.130 (215,6) [Hang him, foul collier] The devil is called *Collier* for his blackness, *Like will to like, says the Devil to the Collier*. (1773)

III.iv.154 (216,7) [a finder of madmen] This is, I think, an allusion to the *witch-finders*, who were very busy.

III.iv.184 (217,8) [*God have mercy upon one of our souls! He may have mercy upon mine, but my hope is better*] We may read, *He may have mercy upon thine, but my hope is better*. Yet the passage may well enough stand without alteration.

It were much to be wished, that Shakespeare in this and some other passages, had not ventured so near profaneness.

III.iv.228 (218,9) [wear this jewel for me] *Jewel* does not properly signify a single gem, but any precious ornament or superfluity.

III.iv.257 (219,2) [Be is knight, dubb'd with unhack'd rapier, and on carpet consideration] That is, he is no soldier by profession, not a Knight Banneret, dubbed in the field of battle, but, *on carpet consideration*, at a festivity, or on some peaceable occasion, when knights receive their dignity kneeling not on the ground, as in war, but on a *carpet*. This is, I believe, the original of the contemptuous term a carpet knight, who was naturally held in scorn by the men of war.

III.iv.301 (222,4) [I have not seen such a virago] *Virago* cannot be properly used here, unless we suppose Sir Toby to mean, I never saw one that had so much the look of woman with the prowess of man.

III.iv.408 (225,7) [Methinks, his words do from such passion fly, That he believes himself;—so do not I]

This I believe, means, I do not yet believe myself, when, from this accident, I gather hope of my brother's life.

IV.i.14 (227,8) [I am afraid this great lubber the world will prove a cockney] That is, affectation and foppery will overspread the world.

IV.i.57 (228,2) [In this uncivil and unjust extent] *Extent* is, in law, a writ of execution, whereby goods are seized for the king. It is therefore taken here for *violence* in general.

IV.i.60 (228,3) [This ruffian hath botch'd up] I fancy it is only a coarse expression for *made up*, as a bad taylor is called a *botcher*. and to botch is to make clumsily.

IV.i.63 (229,4) [He started one poor heart of mine in thee] I know not whether here be not an ambiguity intended between *heart* and *hart*. The sense however is easy enough. *He that offends thee attacks one of my hearts*; or, as the antients expressed it, *half my heart*.

IV.i.64 (229,5) [What relish is this?] How does it taste? What judgment am I to make of it?

IV.ii.53 (231,9) [constant question] A settled, a determinate, a regular question.

IV.ii.68 (232,1) [Nay, I am for all waters] I rather think this expression borrowed from sportsmen, and relating to the qualifications of a complete spaniel.

IV.ii.99 (233,2) [They have here property'd me] They have taken possession of me as of a man unable to look to himself.

IV.ii.107 (233,3) [Maintain no words with him] Here the Clown in the dark acts two persons, and counterfeits, by variation of voice, a dialogue between himself and Sir Topas. — *I Will, sir, I Will*. is spoken after a pause, as if, in the mean time, Sir Topas had whispered.

IV.ii.121 (234,4) [tell me true, are you not mad, indeed, or do you but counterfeit?] If he was not mad, what did he counterfeit by declaring that he was not mad? The fool, who meant to insult him, I think, asks, *are you mad, or do you but counterfeit?* That is, *you look like a madman, you talk like a madman: Is your madness real, or have you any secret design in it?* This, to a man in poor Malvolio's state, was a severe taunt.

IV.ii.134 (234,5) [like to the old vice] *Vice* was the fool of the old moralities. Some traces of this character are still preserved in puppet-shows, and by country mummers.

IV.ii.141 (235,6) '*Adieu, Goodman Devil*] This last line has neither rhyme nor meaning. I cannot but suspect that the fool translates Malvolio's name, and says,

Adieu, Goodman Mean-Evil. (1773)

IV.iii.12 (236,8) [all instance, all discourse] *Instance* is *example*. (see 1765, II,433,9)

IV.iii.15 (236,9) [To any other trust] To any other belief, or confidence, to any other fixed opinion.

IV.iii.29 (236,1) [Whiles] Is *until*. This word is still so used in the northern counties. It is, I think, used in this sense in the preface to the *Accidence*.

IV.iii.33 (237,2) [And, having sworn truth, ever will be true] *Truth* is *fidelity*.

Vi.23 (238,3) [so that, conclusions to be as kisses, if your four negatives make your two affirmatives, why, then the worse for my friends, and the better for my foes] Though I do not discover much ratiocination in the Clown's discourse, yet, methinks, I can find some glimpse of a meaning in his observation, that *the conclusion is as kisses*. For, says he, *if four negatives make two affirmatives, the conclusion is as kisses*; that is, the conclusion follows by the conjunction of two negatives, which, by *kissing* and embracing, coalesce into one, and make an affirmative. What the *four* negatives are I do not know. I read, *So that conclusions be as kisses*.

Vi.42 (239,4) [bells of St. Bennet] When in this play he mentioned the *bed of Ware*, he recollected that the scene was in Illyria, and added *in England*; but his sense of the same impropriety could not restrain him from the bells of St. Bennet.

Vi.67 (240,5) [desperate of shame, and state] Unattentive to his character or his condition, like a desperate man.

Vi.112 (241,5) [as fat and fulsome] [W: flat] *Fat* means *dull*; so we say a *fatheaded* fellow; *fat* likewise means *gross*, and is sometimes used for *obscene*; and *fat* is more congruent to *fulsome* than *flat*.

V.i.168 (244,7) [case] *Case* is a word used contemptuously for *skin*. We yet talk of a *fox case*, meaning the stuffed skin of a fox.

V.i.204 (246,9) [A natural perspective] A *perspective* seems to be taken for shows exhibited through a glass with such lights as make the pictures appear really protruberant. The Duke therefore says, that nature has here exhibited such a show, where shadows seem realities; where that which is *not* appears like that which is.

V.i.306 (249,3) [but to read his right wits, is to read thus] Perhaps so,—*but to read his wits right is to read thus*. To represent his present state of mind, is to read a madman's letter, as I now do, like a madman. (1773)

V.i.326 (249,4) [One day shall crown the alliance on't, so please you] [Revisal: an't so] This is well conjectured; but *on't* may relate to the double character of sister and wife. (1773)

V.i.347 (250,5) [to frown Upon sir Toby, and the lighter people] People of less dignity or importance.

V.i.351 (250,6) [geck] A fool.

(253) General Observation. This play is in the graver part elegant and easy, and in some of the lighter scenes exquisitely humorous. Ague—cheek is drawn with great propriety, but his character is, in a great measure, that of natural fatuity, and is therefore not the proper prey of a satirist. The soliloquy of Malvolio is truly comic; he is betrayed to ridicule merely by his pride. The marriage of Olivia, and the succeeding perplexity, though well enough contrived to divert on the stage, wants credibility, and fails to produce the proper instruction required in the drama, as it exhibits no just picture of life.

THE WINTER'S TALE

(257,1) The story of this play is taken from the *Pleasaunt History of Dorastus and Fawnia*, written by Robert Greene. (1773)

I.i.9 (258,2) [Wherein our entertainment shall shame us, we will be justified in our loves] Though we cannot give you equal entertainment, yet the consciousness of our good-will shall justify us.

I.i.30 (258,3) [royally attornied] Nobly supplied by substitution of embassies, &c.

I.i.43 (259,4) [physicks the subject] Affords a cordial to the state; has the power of assuaging the sense of misery.

I.ii.13 (259,5) [that may blow No sneaping rinds] *That may blow* is a Gallicism, for *may there blow*. (1773)

I.ii.31 (261,6) [All in Bohemia's well: this satisfaction The bygone day proclaim'd] We had satisfactory accounts yesterday of the state of Bohemia. (1773)

I.ii.123 (266,6) [We must be neat] Leontes, seeing his son's nose smutched, cries, *We must be neat*, then recollecting that *neat* is the term for *horned cattle*, he says, *not neat, but cleanly*.

I.ii.125 (266,7) [Still virginalling] Still playing with her fingers, as a girl playing on the *virginals*.

I.ii.132 (266,8) [As o'er-dy'd blacks] Sir T. Hammer understands, blacks died too much, and therefore rotten.

I.ii.136 (267,9) [welkin-eye] Blue eye; an eye of the same colour with the *welkin*, or sky.

I.ii.139 (267,2) [Thou dost make possible things not so held] i.e. thou dost make those things possible, which are conceived to be impossible. (1773)

I.ii.161,3 (268,3) [will you take eggs for mony?] This seems to be a proverbial expression, used when a man sees himself wronged and makes no resistance. Its original, or precise meaning, I cannot find, but I believe it means, will you be a *cuckold* for hire. The cuckow is

reported to lay her eggs in another bird's nest; he therefore that has eggs laid in his nest, is said to be *cocullatus*, *cuckow'd*, or *cuckold*.

I.ii.163 (268,4) [happy man be his dole!] May his *dole* or *share* in life be to be a *happy man*.

I.ii.176 (269,5) [he's Appareat to my heart] That is, *heir apparent*. or the next claimant.

I.ii.186 (269,6) [a fork'd one] That is, a *horned one*; a *cuckold*.

I.ii.217 (270,9) [whispering, rounding] *To round in the ear*, is to *whisper*, or to *tell secretly*. The expression is very copiously explained by H. Casaubon, in his book *de Ling. Sax.*

I.ii.227 (271,1) [lower messes] *Mess* is a contraction of *Master*, as *Mess John*. Master John; an appellation used by the Scots, to those who have taken their academical degree. *Lower Messes*, therefore are graduates of a lower form.

The speaker is now mentioning gradations of understanding, and not of rank, (see 1765, II,244,9)

I.ii.260 (372,2) [Whereof the execution did cry out Against the non-performance] This is one of the expressions by which Shakespeare too frequently clouds his meaning. This sounding phrase means, I think, no more than *a thing necessary to be done*. [*Revisal*; the now-performance] I do not see that this attempt does any thing more, than produce a harsher word without on easier sense, (see 1765, II,245,1)

I.ii.320 (275,5) [But with a ling'ring dram, that should not work, Maliciously, like poison] [Hammer: Like a malicious poison] *Rash* is *hasty*, as in another place, *rash gunpowder*. *Maliciously* is *malignantly*, with effects *openly hurtful*. Shakespeare had no thought of *betraying the user*. The Oxford emendation is harmless and useless.

1.ii.321 (275,6)

[But I cannot Believe this crack to be in my dread mistress, So sovereignly being honourable. *Leo*. I have lov'd thee—Make that thy question, and go rot!]

[Theobald had emended the text to give the words "I have lov'd thee" to Leontes] I have admitted this alteration, as Dr. Warburton has done, but am not convinced that it is necessary. Camillo, desirous to defend the queen, and willing to secure credit to his apology, begins, by telling the king that he *has loved him*, is about to give

instances of his love, and to infer from them his present zeal, when he is interrupted.

I.ii.394 (278,7) [In whose success we are gentle] I know not whether *success* here does not mean *succession*.

I.ii.424 (279,1) [*Cam.* Swear this thought over By each particular star in heaven] [T: this though] *Swear his thought over*

May however perhaps mean, *overswear his present persuasion*, that is, endeavour to *overcome his opinion*, by swearing oaths numerous as the stars. (1773)

I.ii.458 (281,3) [Good expedition be my friend, and comfort The gracious queen] [W: queen's] Dr. Warburton's conjecture is, I think, just; but what shall be done with the following words, of which I can make nothing? Perhaps the line which connected them to the rest, is lost.

—and comfort

The gracious queen, part of his theme, but nothing

Of his ill-ta'en suspicion!

Jealousy is a passion compounded of love and suspicion, this passion is the theme or subject of the king's thoughts.—Polixenes, perhaps, wishes the queen, for her comfort, so much of that *theme* or subject as is good, but deprecates that which causes misery. May part of the king's present sentiments comfort the queen, but away with his suspicion. This is such meaning as can be picked out. (1773)

II.i.38 (283,4) [Alack, for lesser knowledge!] That is, *O that my knowledge were less*.

II.i.50 (284,5) [He hath discover'd my design, and I Remain a pinch'd thing] [*Revisal*: The sense, I think, is, He hath now discovered my design, and I am treated as a mere child's baby, a thing pinched out of clouts, a puppet for them to move and actuate as they please.] This sense is possible, but many other meanings might serve as well. (1773)

II.i.100 (286,7)

[No, if I mistake

In these foundations which I build upon,

The center is not big enough to bear

A school-boy's top]

That is, if the proofs which I can offer will not support the opinion I have formed, no foundation can be trusted.

II.i.104 (286,8) [He, who shall speak for her, is far off guilty, But that he speaks] [T: far of] It is strange that Mr. Theobald could not find out that *far off guilty*, signifies, *guilty in a remote degree*.

II.i.121 (287,9) [this action] The word *action* is here taken in the lawyer's sense, for *indictment*, *charge*, or *accusation*.

II.i.143 (288,2) [land-damn him] Sir T. Hammer interprets, *stop his urine*. *Land* or *lant* being the old word for *urine*.

Land-damn is probably one of those words which caprice brought into fashion, and which, after a short time, reason and grammar drove irrecoverably away. It perhaps meant no more than I will *rid the country* of him; *condemn* him to quit the *land*, (see 1765, II,259,2)

II.i.177 (290,5) [nought for approbation, But only seeing] *Approbation*, in this place, is put for *proof*.

II.i.185 (290,6) [stuff'd sufficiency] That is, of abilities more than enough.

II.i.195 (291,7) [Left that the treachery of the two, fled hence, Be left her to perform] He has before declared, that there is a *plot against his life and crown*, and that Hermione is *federary* with Polixenes and Camillo.

II.iii.5 (294,9) [out of the blank And level of my brain] Beyond the *aim* of any attempt that I can make against him. *Blank* and *level* are terms of archery.

II.iii.60 (296,1) [And would by combat make her good, so were I A man, the worst about you] The *worst* means only the *lowest*. Were I the meanest of your servants, I would yet claim the combat against any accuser.

II.iii.67 (297,2) [A mankind witch:] A *mankind* woman, is yet used in the midland counties, for a woman violent, ferocious, and mischievous. It has the same sense in this passage. Witches are supposed to be *mankind*, to put off the softness and delicacy of women, therefore Sir Hugh, in the *Merry Wives of Windsor*, says, of a woman inspected to be a witch, *that he does not like when a woman has a beard*. Of this meaning Mr. Theobald has given examples.

II.iii.77 (298, 5)

[Unvenerable be thy hands, if thou
Tak'st up the princess, by that forced baseness]

Leontes had ordered Antigonus to *take up the bastard*, Paulina forbids him to touch the princess under that appellation. *Forced* is false, uttered with violence to truth.

II.iii.106 (299, 6) [No yellow in't] *Yellow* is the colour of jealousy.

II.iii.181 (301, 8) [commend it strangely to some place] Commit to some place, *as a stranger*, without more provision.

III.i.2 (302, 9) [Fertile the isle] [Warburton objected to "isle" as impossible geographically and offered "soil"] Shakespeare is little careful of geography. There is no need of this emendation in a play of which the whole plot depends upon a geographical error, by which Bohemia is supposed to be a maritime country.

III.i.3 (303, 1) [I shall report, For most it caught me] [W: It shames report, Foremost] Of this emendation I see no reason; the utmost that can be necessary is, to change, *it caught me*, to *they caught me*; but even this may well enough be omitted. *It* may relate to the whole spectacle.

III.i.14 (304, 2) [The time is worth the use on't] [W: The use is worth the time on't] Either reading may serve, but neither is very elegant. *The time is worth the use on't*, means, the time which we have spent in visiting Delos, has recompensed us for the trouble of so spending it.

III.ii.18 (305, 4) [pretence] Is, in this place, taken for a *scheme laid*, a *design formed*; to *pretend* means to *design*, in the *Gent. of Verona*.

III.ii.27 (305, 5) [mine integrity, Being counted falsehood, shall, as I express it, Be so receiv'd] That is, my *virtue* being accounted *wickedness*, my assertion of it will pass but for a *lie*. *Falsehood* means both *treachery* and *lie*.

III.ii.43 (306, 6) [For life I prize it As I weigh grief which I would spare] *Life* is to me now only *grief*, and as such only is considered by me, I would therefore willingly dismiss it.

III.ii.44 (306, 5) [I would spare] To *spare* any thing is to *let it go*. to *quit the possession of it*. (1773)

III.ii.49 (306, 7)

[Since he came,
With what encounter so uncurrent I
Have strain'd, to appear thus?]

These lines I do not understand; with the license of all editors, what I cannot understand I suppose unintelligible, and therefore propose that they may be altered thus,

— — — — *Since he came, With what encounter so uncurrent have I Been stain'd to appear thus.*

At least I think it might be read,
With what encounter so uncurrent have I Strain'd to appear thus? If one Jet beyond. (see 1765, II,276,5)

III.ii.55 (307,8)

[I ne'er heard yet,
That any of those bolder vices wanted
Less impudence to gain—say what they did,
Than to perform it first]

It is apparent that according to the proper, at least according to the present, use of words, *less* should be *more*, or *wanted* should be *had*. But Shakespeare is very uncertain in his use of negatives. It may be necessary once to observe, that in our language two negatives did not originally affirm, but strengthen the negation. This mode of speech was in time changed, but as the change was made in opposition to long custom, it proceeded gradually, and uniformity was not obtained but through an intermediate confusion.

III.ii.82 (308,9) [My life stands in the level of your dreams] To be *in the level* is by a metaphor from archery to *be within the reach*.

III.ii.85 (308,1) [As you were past all shame, (Those of your fact are so) [so past all truth] I do not remember that *fact* is used any where absolutely for *guilt*, which must be its sense in this place. Perhaps we may read,

Those of your pack are so.

Pack is a low coarse word well suited to the rest of this royal invective.

III.ii.107 (309,3) [I have got strength of limit] I know not well how *strength of limit* can mean *strength to pass the limits* of the childbed

chamber, which yet it must mean in this place, unless we read in a more easy phrase, *strength of limb*. And now, &c.

III.ii.123 (310,4) [The flatness of my misery] That is, how low, how *flat* I am laid by my calamity.

III.ii.146 (310,5) [Of the queen's speed] Of the *event* of the queen's trial: so we still say, he *sped* well or ill.

III.ii.173 (311,6) [Does my deeds make the blacker!] This vehement retraction of Leontes, accompanied with the confession of more crimes than he was suspected of, is agreeable to our daily experience of the vicissitudes of violent tempers, and the eruptions of minds oppressed with guilt.

III.ii.187 (312,7)

[That thou betray'st Polixenes, 'twas nothing
That did but shew thee, of a fool, inconstant,
And damnable ungrateful]

[T: of a soul] [W: shew thee off, a fool] Poor Mr. Theobald's courtly remark cannot be thought to deserve much notice. Or. Warburton too might have spared his sagacity if he had remembered, that the present reading, by a mode of speech anciently much used, means only, *It shew'd thee first a fool, then inconstant and ungrateful*.

III.ii.219 (314,9) [I am sorry for't] This is another instance of the sudden changes incident to vehement and ungovernable minds.

III.iii.1 (315,1) [Thou art perfect then] *Perfect* is often used by Shakespeare for *certain, well assured, or well informed*.

III.iii.56 (317,2) [A savage clamour! — Well may I get aboard — This is the chace] This clamour was the cry of the dogs and hunters; then seeing the bear, he cries, *this is the chace*. or, the *animal pursued*.

IV.i.6 (321,9) [and leave the growth untry'd Of that wide gap] [W: gulf untry'd] This emendation is plausible, but the common reading is consistent enough with our author's manner, who attends more to his ideas than to his words. *The growth of the wide gap*, is somewhat irregular; but he means, the *growth*, or progression of the time which filled up the *gap* of the story between Perdita's birth and her sixteenth year. *To leave this growth untried, is to leave the passages of the intermediate*

years unnoted and unexamined. *Untried* is not, perhaps, the word which he would have chosen, but which his rhyme required.

IV.i.7 (321,1)

[since it is in my power
To o'erthrow law, and in one self-born hour
To plant and o'erwhelm custom. Let me pass
The same I am, ere ancient'st order was,
Or what is now receiv'd]

The reasoning of *Time* is not very clear! he seems to mean, that he who has broke so many laws may now break another; that he who introduced every thing, may introduce Perdita on her sixteenth year; and he intreats that he may pass as of old, before any *order* or succession of objects, ancient or modern, distinguished his periods.

IV.i.19 (322,2)

[Imagine me,
Gentle spectators, that I now may be
In fair Bohemia]

Time is every where alike. I know not whether both sense and grammar may not dictate,

—*imagine* we,
Gentle spectators, that you *now may be*, &c.

Let *us* imagine that *you*, who behold these scenes, are now in Bohemia?

IV.i.29 (322,3) [Is the argument of time] *Argument* is the same with *subject*.

IV.i.32 (322,4) [He wishes earnestly you newer may] I believe this speech of *time* rather begins the fourth act than concludes the third.

IV.ii.21 (323,6) [and my profit therein, the heaping friendships] [W. reaping] I see not that the present reading is nonsense; the sense of *heaping friendships* is, though like many other of our author's, unusual, at least unusual to modern ears, is not very obscure. *To be more thankful shall be my study; and my profit therein the heaping friendships.* That is, *I will for the future be more liberal of recompence, from which I shall receive this advantage, that as I heap benefits I shall heap friendships, as I confer favours on thee I shall increase the friendship between us.*

IV.ii.35 (324,7) [but I have, missingly, noted] [W. missing him]
[Hammer; musingly noted] I see not how the sense is mended by
Sir

T. Hammer's alteration, nor how is it at all changed by Dr.
Warburton's.

IV.iii.3 (325,9)

[*Why, then comes in the sweet o' the year; For the red blood reigns in the
winter pale*]

Dr. Thirlby reads, perhaps rightly, certainly with much more probability, and easiness of construction;

For the red blood runs in the winter pale. That is, *for the red blood runs
pale in the winter.* Sir T. Banner reads,

For the red blood reigns o'er the winter's pale.

IV.iii.7 (326,1) [pugging tooth] Sir T. Hammer, and after his, Dr. Warburton, read, *proggng tooth*. It is certain that *pugging* is not now understood. But Dr. Thirlby observes, that this is the cant of gypsies.

IV.iii.28 (327,7) [Gallows, and knock, are too powerful on the highway; beating and hanging are terrors to me] The resistance which a highwayman encounters in the fact, and the punishment which he suffers on detection, withhold me from daring robbery, and determine me to the silly cheat and petty theft. (1773)

IV.iii.99 (330,4) [abide] To *abide*, here, must signify, to *sojourn*, to live for a time without a settled habitation.

IV.iv.6 (331,7) [To chide at your extremes, it not becomes me] That is, your *excesses*, the *extravagance* of your praises.

IV.iv.8 (331,8) [The gracious mark o' the land] The *object* of all men's *notice* and expectation.

IV.iv.13 (332,9) [sworn, I think, To shew myself a glass] [Banner: swoon] Dr. Thirlby inclines rather to Sir T. Hammer's emendation, which certainly makes an easy sense, and is, in my opinion, preferable to the present reading. But concerning this passage I know not what to decide.

IV.ii.21 (333,1) [How would he look, to see his work, so noble, Vilely bound up!] It is impossible for any man to rid his mind of his profession. The authorship of Shakespeare has supplied him with a

metaphor, which rather than he would lose it, he has put with no great propriety into the mouth of a country maid. Thinking of his own works, his mind passed naturally to the binder. I am glad that he has no hint at an editor.

IV.ii.76 (335,2) [Grace and remembrance] *Rue* was called *herb of grace*. *Rosemary* was the emblem of remembrance; I know not why, unless because it was carried at funerals. (see 1765, II,300,5)

IV.iv.143 (338,6)

[Each your doing,
So singular in each particular,
Crowns what you're doing in the present deeds]
That is, your manner in each act crowns the act.

IV.iv.155 (338,8) [*Per*. I'll swear for 'em] I fancy this half line is placed to a wrong person. And that the king begins his speech aside

Pol. I'll swear for 'em
This is the prettiest. &c.

IV.iv.164 (339,1) [we stand upon our manners] That is, we are now on our behaviour.

IV.iv.169 (339,2) [a worthy feeding] I conceive *feeding* to be a *pasture*, and a *worthy feeding* to be a tract of pasturage not inconsiderable, not unworthy of my daughter's fortune.

IV.iv.204 (340,3) [unbraided wares?] Surely we must read *braided*, for such are all the *wares* mentioned in the answer.

IV.iv.212 (341,5) [sleeve-band] Is put very properly by Sir T. Hammer, it was before *sleeve—hand*.

IV.iv.316 (346,9) [sad] For *serious*. (1773)

IV.iv.330 (346,1) [*That doth utter all mens' wear-a*] To *utter*. To *bring out*, or *produce*. (1773)

IV.iv.333 (347,3) [all men of hair] [W: i.e. nimble, that leap as if they rebounded] This is a strange interpretation. *Errors*, says Dryden, *flow upon the surface*, but there are men who will fetch them from the bottom. *Men of hair*, are *hairy men*, or *satyrs*. A dance of satyrs was no unusual entertainment in the middle ages. At a great festival celebrated in France, the king and some of the nobles personated satyrs dressed

in close habits, tufted or shagged all over, to imitate hair. They began a wild dance, and in the tumult of their merriment one of them went too near a candle and set fire to his satyr's garb, the flame ran instantly over the loose tufts, and spread itself to the dress of those that were next him; a great number of the dancers were cruelly scorched, being neither able to throw off their coats nor extinguish them. The king had set himself in the lap of the dutchess of Burgundy, who threw her robe over him and saved him.

IV.iv.338 (347,4) [bowling] *Bowling*, I believe, is here a term for a dance of smooth motion with great exertion of agility.

IV.iv.411 (350,6) [dispute his own estate?] Perhaps for *dispute* we might read *compute*; but *dispute his estate* may be the same with *talk over his affairs*.

IV.iv.441 (351,7) [Not hold thee of our blood, no, not our kin, Far than Deucalion off] I think for *far than* we should read *far as*. We will not hold thee of our kin even so far off as Deucalion the common ancestor of all.

IV.iv.493 (354,2) [and by my fancy] It must be remembered that *fancy* in this author very often, as in this place, means *love*.

IV.iv.551 (356,3) [Ourselves to be the slaves of chance, and flies] As *chance* has driven me to these extremities, so I commit myself to *chance* to be conducted through them.

IV.iv.613 (359,6) [as if my trinkets had been hallowed] This alludes to beads often sold by the Romanists, as made particularly efficacious by the touch of some relick.

IV.iv.651 (360,7) [boot] that is, *something over and above*, or, as we now say, *something to boot*.

IV.iv.734 (362,9) [pedler's excrement] Is pedler's beard, (see 1765, II,323,2)

IV.iv.748 (363,1) [therefore they do not give us the lye] [W: do give] The meaning is, they are *paid* for lying, therefore they do not give us the lye, they *sell* it us. (1773)

IV.iv.768 (363,2) [Advocate's the court-word for a pheasant] This satire, or this pleasantry, I confess myself not well to understand.

IV.iv.779 (364,3) [A great man, I'll warrant; I know, by the picking on's teeth] It seems, that to pick the teeth was, at this time, a mark of some pretension to greatness or elegance. So the Bastard in *King John*, speaking of the traveller, says,

He and his pick-tooth at my worship's mess.

IV.iv.816 (365,4) [the hottest day prognostication proclaims] That is, *the hottest day foretold in the almanack.*

Vi.i.14 (368,7) [Or, from the All that are, took something good] This is a favourite thought; it was bestowed on Miranda and Rosalind before.

Vi.i.19 (368,8) [What were more holy, Than to rejoice, the former queen is well] [W: rejoice the...queen? This will.] This emendation is one of those of which many may be made; It is such as we may wish the authour had chosen, but which we cannot prove that he did chuse; the reasons for it are plausible, but not cogent.

Vi.i.58 (370,9) [on this stage, (Where we offend her now)] [The offenders now appear] The Revisal reads,

*Were we offenders now — —
very reasonably. (1773)*

Vi.i.74 (371,1) [Affront his eye] *To affront, is to meet.*

Vi.i.98 (372,2) [Sir, you yourself Have said, and writ so] The reader must observe, that *so* relates not to what precedes, but to what follows that, *she had not been' — —equall'd.*

Vi.i.159 (374, 3) [whose daughter His tears proclaim'd his, parting with her] This is very ungrammatical and obscure. We aay better read,

— —whose daughter His tears proclaim'd her parting with her.

The prince first tells that the lady came *from Lybia*. the king interrupting him, says, *from Smalus; from him*, says the prince, *whose tears, at parting, shewed her to be his daughter.*

Vi.i.214 (376, 4) [Your choice is not so rich in worth as beauty] [W. in birth] *Worth* is as proper as *birth*. *Worth* signifies any kind of *worthiness*, and among others that of high descent. The King means that he

is sorry the prince's choice is not in other respects as worthy of him as in beauty.

V.ii.105 (380, 5) [that rare Italian meter, Jolio Romano] [Theobald praised the passage but called it an anachronism] Poor Theobald's eucomium of this passage is not very happily conceived or expressed, nor is the passage of any eminent excellence; yet a little candour will clear Shakespeare from part of the impropriety imputed to him. By *eternity* he means only *immortality*, or that part of eternity which is to come; so we talk of *eternal* renown and *eternal* infamy. *Immortality* may subsist without *divinity*, and therefore the meaning only is, that if Julio could always continue his labours, he would mimic nature.

V.ii.107 (381, 6) [would beguile nature of her custom] That is, *of her trade*, — would draw her customers from her.

V.ii.118 (381, 7) [Who would be thence, that has the benefit of access?] It was, I suppose, only to spare his own labour that the poet put this whole scene into narrative, for though part of the transaction was already known to the audience, and therefore could not properly be shewn again, yet the two kings might have met upon the stage, and after the examination of the old shepherd, the young lady might have been recognised in sight of the spectators.

V.ii.173 (383, 8) [franklins say it] *Franklin* is a *freeholder*, or *yeoman*, a man above a *Villain*, but not a *gentleman*.

V.ii.179 (383, 9) [tall fellow] *Tall*, in that time, was the word used for *stout*.

V.iii.17 (384, 1) [therefore I keep it Lonely, apart] [Hammer: lovely] I am yet inclined to *lonely*, which in the old angular writing cannot be distinguished from lovely. To say, that *I keep it alone, separate from the rest*, is a pleonasm which scarcely any nicety declines.

V.iii.46 (385, 2) [Oh, patience] That is, *Stay a while, be not go eager*.

V.iii.56 (386, 3)

[Indeed, my lord,

If I had thought, the sight of my poor image

Would thus have wrought you, (for the stone is mine)

I'd not have shew'd it]

[Tyrwhitt: for the stone i' th' mine] To change an accurate expression for an expression confessedly not accurate, has somewhat of retrogradation. (1773)

V.iii.131 (389,6) [You precious winners all] You who by this discovery have *gained* what you desired may join in festivity, in which I, who have lost what never can be recovered, can have no part.

(300) General Observation, Of this play no edition is known published before the folio of 1623.

This play, as Dr. Warburton justly observes, is, with all its absurdities, very entertaining. The character of Antolycus is very naturally conceived, and strongly represented, (see 1765, II, 349)

KING JOHN

[*The Troublesome Reign of King John* was written in two parts, by W. Shakespeare and W. Rowley, and printed 1611. But the present play is intirely different, and infinitely superior to it. POPE]

The edition of 1611 has no mention of Rowley, nor in the account of Rowley's works is any mention made of his conjunction with Shakespeare in any play. *King John* was reprinted in two parts in 1622. The first edition that I have found of this play in its present form, is that of 1623 in fol. The edition of 1591 I have not seen.

I.1.2 CHATILLON.

Thus, after greeting, speaks the King of France,
In my behaviour, to the Majesty,
The borrow'd Majesty of England here.

The word "behaviour" seems here to have a signification that I have never found in any other authour. "The King of France," says the envoy, "thus speaks in my *behaviour* to the Majesty of England": that is, the King of France speaks in the "character" which I here assume. I once thought that these two lines, "in my behaviour," &c. had been uttered by the ambassador as part of his master's message, and that "behaviour" had meant the "conduct" of the King of France towards the King of England, but the ambassador's speech, as continued after the interruption, will not admit this meaning. III.404

I.1.17 CHATILLON.

The proud controul of fierce and bloody war
"Opposition" from "contreller [i.e. contreroller]." (III.404)

I.1.24 KING JOHN.

Be thou as lightning in the eyes of France,
For ere thou canst report, I will be there

The simile does not suit well: the lightning indeed appears before the thunder is heard, but the lightning is destructive, and the thunder innocent. (III.404)

I.1.27 KING JOHN.

So, hence! be thou the trumpet of our wrath,
And sullen presage of your own decay.

By the epithet "sullen," which cannot be applied to a trumpet, it is plain, that our authour's imagination had now suggested a new idea. It is as if he had said, be a "trumpet" to alarm with our invasion, be a "bird" of "ill omen" to croak out the prognostick of your own ruin. (III.404)

I.1.125 KING JOHN.

then, if he were my brother's,
My brother might not claim him; nor your father,
Being none of his, refuse him; this concludes.

This is a "decisive argument." As your father, if he liked him, could not have been forced to resign him, so, not liking him, he is not at liberty to reject him. (III.408)

I.1.137 QUEEN ELINOR.

Lord of thy presence, and no land beside?
[Warburton: the presence]

"Lord of thy presence" may signify something more distinct than "master of thyself." It means master of that dignity, and grandeur of appearance, that may sufficiently distinguish thee from the vulgar without the help of fortune.

"Lord of his presence" apparently signifies, "great in his own person," and is used in this sense by King John in one of the following scenes. (III.408)

I.1.138 PHILIP.

Madam, and if my brother had my shape,
And I had his, Sir Robert his, like him

This is obscure and ill expressed. The meaning is: "If I had his shape—Sir *Robert's* —as he has."

"Sir Robert his," for "Sir Robert's" is agreeable to the practice of that time, when the 's added to the nominative was believed, I think erroneously, to be a contraction of "his." So Donne,

—Who now lives to age,
Fit to be call'd *Methusalem his* page?

III.408 I.1.168 QUEEN ELINOR.

I am thy grandam; Richard, call me so.

PHILIP.

Madam, by chance, but not by truth; what tho'?

I am your grandson, Madam, by chance, but not by "honesty" — what "then?" (III.410)

I.1.170 PHILIP.

Something about, a little from the right;
In at the window, or else o'er the hatch,
Who dares not stir by day, must walk by night,
And have his have, however men do catch;
Near or far off, well won is still well shot;
And I am I, howe'er I was begot.

This speech, composed of allusive and proverbial sentences, is obscure. "I am," says the spritely knight, "your grandson," a little "irregularly," but every man cannot get what he wishes the legal way. He that "dares not go" about his designs "by day" must "make his motions" in the "night"; "he," to whom the door is shut, must climb "the window," or leap "the hatch." This, however, shall not depress me; for the world never enquires how any man got what he is known to possess, but allows that "to have" is "to have," however it was "caught," and that he "who wins shot well," whatever was his skill, whether the arrow fell "near" the mark, or "far off it." III.411

I.1.182 PHILIP.

A foot of honour better than I was.

A "step," *un pas*. (III.411)

I.1.189 PHILIP.

Now your traveller

It is said in *All's Well, That Ends Well*, that "a traveller is a good thing after dinner." In that age of newly excited curiosity, one of the entertainments at great tables seems to have been the discourse of a traveller. (III.411)

I.1.190 PHILIP.

He and his tooth-pick at my worship's mess

It has been already remarked, that "to pick the tooth," and wear a "piqued beard," were, in that time, marks of a man affecting foreign fashions. (III.411)

I.I.196 PHILIP.

And then comes answer like an ABC-book

An a, b, c book, or, as they spoke and wrote it, an “absey” book, is a “catechism.” (III.412)

I.I.200 PHILIP.

And so e’er answer knows what question would,

Saving in dialogue of compliment

[Warburton: Serving]

This passage is obscure; but such an irregularity, and perplexity runs thro’ the whole speech, that I think this emendation not necessary. (III.412)

I.I.214 PHILIP.

Which tho’ I will not practise to deceive,

Yet, to avoid deceit, I mean to learn

The construction will be mended, if instead of “which though,” we read, “this though.” (III.413)

I.I.217 PHILIP.

But who comes in such haste, in riding robes?

Milton, in his tragedy, introduces Dallilah with such an interrogatory exclamation. (III.413)

I.I.218 PHILIP.

hath she no husband,

That will take pains to blow a horn before her?

He means, that a woman who travelled about like a “post” was likely to “horn” her husband. (III.413)

I.I.225 PHILIP.

Colbrand the giant

Colbrand was a Danish giant, whom Guy of Warwick discomfited in the presence of King Athelstan. The combat is very pompously described by Drayton in his *Polyolbion*. III.413

I.I.231 PHILIP.

Philip! — sparrow — James

[Warburton: spare me, James]

The old reading is far more agreeable to the character of the speaker.

Dr. Gray observes, that Skelton has a poem to the memory of Philip Sparrow; and Mr. Pope in a short note remarks, that a sparrow is called Philip. (III.414)

I.i.244 PHILIP.

Knight, Knight, good mother — Basilisco like.

[Theobald: Basilisco in Soliman and Perseda.] [Warburton: "the beauty of the passage consists in Philip's alluding, at the same time, to his high original. His father, Richard the First, was surnamed *Coeur-de-lion*. And the *Cor Leonis*, a fixed star of the first magnitude, in the sign *Leo*, is called *Basilisco*."]]

Could one have thought it! (III.414)

I.i.261 PHILIP.

Some sins do bear their privilege on earth

There are "sins," that whatever be determined of them above, are not much censured "on earth." (III.415)

II.i.7 DAUPHIN.

At our importance hither is he come

At my "importunity." (III.417)

II.i.23 ARCHDUKE.

Together with that pale, that white-faced shore

England is supposed to be called *Albion* from the "white rocks" facing France. (III.417)

II.i.50 [Stage direction] Enter Chatillon.

KING PHILIP.

A wonder, lady! — Lo, upon thy wish

Our messenger Chatillon is arrived.

The wonder is only that Chatillon happened to arrive at the moment when Constance mentioned him, which the French king, according to a superstition which prevails more or less in every mind agitated by great affairs, turns into a miraculous interposition, or omen of good. (III.418)

II.i.60 CHATILLON.

His marches are expedient to this town

Immediate, "expeditious." (III.418)

II.i.70 CHATILLON.

Bearing their birthrights proudly on their backs
 So in *Henry VIII*.
 Many broke their backs
 With bearing manors on them. (III.419)

II.i.75 CHATILLON.

To do offence and scathe in christendom.
 "Scathe." Destruction; waste. (III.419)

II.i.114 KING PHILIP.

To look into the blots and stains of right.

Mr. Theobald reads, with the first folio, "blots," which being so early authorised, and so much better understood, needed not to have been changed by Dr. Warburton to "bolts," tho' "bolts" might be used in that time for "spots": so Shakespeare calls Banquo "spotted with blood," the "blood-bolter'd" Banquo. The verb to "blot" is used figuratively for to "disgrace" a few lines lower. And, perhaps, after all, "bolts" was only a typographical mistake. (III.420)

II.i.141 BLANCH.

O, well did he become that lion's robe,
 That did disrobe the lion of that robe.

PHILIP.

It lies as sightly on the back of him,
 As great Alcides' shews upon an ass

[But why his "shoes," in the name of propriety? For let Hercules and his "shoes" have been really as big as they were ever supposed to be, yet they (I mean the "shoes") would not have been an overload for an ass. I am persuaded, I have retrieved the true reading; and let us observe the justness of the comparison now. Faulconbridge in his resentment would say this to Austria, "That lion's skin, which my great father King Richard once wore, looks as uncoothly on thy back, as that other noble hide, which was borne by Hercules, would look on the back of an ass." A double allusion was intended; first, to the fable of the ass in the lion's skin; then Richard I is finely set in competition with Alcides; as Austria is satirically coupled with the ass. THEOBALD]

Mr. Theobald had the art of making the most of his discoveries.
 III.421

II.1.183 CONSTANCE.

I have but this to say,
 That he's not only plagued for her sin,
 But God hath made her sin and her the plague
 On this removed issue, plagu'd for her,
 And with her. — Plague her sin; his injury,
 Her injury, the beadle to her sin

This passage appears to me very obscure. The chief difficulty arises from this, that Constance having told Elinor of her "sinconceiving womb," pursues the thought, and uses "sin" through the next lines in an ambiguous sense, sometimes for "crime," and sometimes for "offspring."

"He's not only plagued for her *sin*," &c. He is not only made miserable by vengeance for her "sin" or "crime," but her "sin," her "offspring," and she, are made the instruments of that vengeance, on this descendant, who, though of the second generation, is "plagued for her and with her"; to whom she is not only the cause but the instrument of evil.

The next clause is more perplexed. All the editions read,
 Plagu'd for her,
 And with her plague her sin; his injury,
 Her injury, the beadle to her sin,
 All punish'd in the person of this child.
 I point thus:
 Plagu'd for her
 And with her. — Plague her son! his injury
 Her injury, the beadle to her sin.

That is; instead of inflicting vengeance on this innocent and remote descendant, "punish her son," her immediate offspring: then the affliction will fall where it is deserved; "his injury" will be "her injury," and the misery of her "sin"; her son will be a "beadle," or chastiser, to her "crimes," which are now "all punished in the person of this child." (III.423)

II.1.196 KING PHILIP.

It ill beseems this presence to cry aim
 To these ill tuned repetitions.

Dr. Warburton has well observed on one of the former plays, that to "cry aim" is to "encourage." I once thought it was borrowed from archery; and that "aim!" having been the word of command, as we

now say "present!" to "cry aim" had been to "incite notice," or raise "attention." But I rather think, that the old word of applause was *J'aime*, "love it," and that to applaud was to cry *J'aime*, which the English, not easily pronouncing *Je*, sunk into "aime" or "aim." Our exclamations of applause are still borrowed, as "bravo," and "encore." III.424

II.1.300 FRENCH HERALD.

Ye men of Angiers, open wide your gates,
And let young Arthur Duke of Bretagne in;
Who by the hand of France this day hath made
Much work for tears in many an English mother,
Whose sons lye scatter'd on the bleeding ground:
And many a widow's husband groveling lies,
Coldly embracing the discolour'd earth;
While victory with little loss doth play
Upon the dancing banners of the French,
Who are at hand triumphantly display'd,
To enter conquerors, and to proclaim
Arthur of Bretagne, England's King, and yours.

This speech is very poetical and smooth, and except the conceit of the "widow's husband" embracing "the earth," is just and beautiful. (III.427)

II.1.312 ENGLISH HERALD.

Rejoice, ye men of Angiers; ring your bells;
King John, your King and England's, doth approach,
Commander of this hot malicious day.
Their armours, that march'd hence so silver-bright,
Hither return all gilt in Frenchmen's blood.
There stuck no plume in any English crest,
That is removed by a staff of France.
Our colours do return in those same hands,
That did display them, when we first march'd forth

The English herald falls somewhat below his antagonist. "Silver armour gilt with blood," is a poor image. Yet our authour has it again in *Macbeth*.

Here lay Duncan,
His *silver* skin lac'd with his *golden* blood. III.428

II.i.321 ENGLISH HERALD.

And, like a jolly troop of huntsmen, come
 Our lusty English, all with purpled hands;
 Dy'd in the dying slaughter of their foes.
 Open your gates, and give the victors way.

It was, I think, one of the savage practices of the chase, for all to stain their hands in the blood of the deer, as a trophy. III.428

II.i.325 CITIZEN.

Heralds, from off our tow'rs we might behold,
 From first to last, the onset and retire
 Of both your armies, whose equality
 By our best eyes cannot be censured;
 Blood hath bought blood, and blows have answer'd blows;
 Strength match'd with strength, and power confronted power.
 Both are alike, and both alike we like;
 One must prove greatest. While they weigh so even,
 We hold our town for neither; yet for both.

These three speeches seem to have been laboured. The citizen's is the best; yet "both alike we like," is a poor jingle. III.428

II.i.357 PHILIP.

Cry havock, Kings
 That is, "command slaughter to proceed"; so in another place.
 He with Atè by his side,
 Cries, havock! III.429

II.i.428 CITIZEN.

If zealous love should go in search of virtue,
 Where should he find it purer than in Blanch?
 "Zealous" seems here to signify "pious," or "influenced by motives of religion." (III.432)

II.i.447 CITIZEN.

for at this match,
 With swifter spleen than powder can enforce,
 The mouth of passage shall we fling wide ope
 Our authour uses "spleen" for any violent hurry, or tumultuous speed. So in *Midsummer Night's Dream* he applies "spleen" to the "lightning." I am loath to think that Shakespeare meant to play

with the double of "match" for "nuptial," and the "match" of a "gun." (III.432)

II.1.455 PHILIP.

Here's a stay,
That shakes the rotten carcass of old Death
Out of his rags.

I cannot but think that every reader wishes for some other word in the place of "stay," which though it may signify an "hindrance," or "man" that "hinders," is yet very improper to introduce the next line. I read,

Here's a *flaw*,
That shakes the rotten carcass of old Death.

That is, here is a "gust" of bravery, a "blast" of meanace. This suits well with the spirit of the speech. "Stay" and "flaw," in a careless hand, are not easily distinguished, and if the writing was obscure, "flaw" being a word less usual was easily missed. III.433

II.1.477 QUEEN ELINOR.

Lest zeal now melted by the windy breath
Of soft petitions, pity and remorse,
Cool and congeal again to what it was.

We have here a very unusual, and, I think, not very just image of "zeal," which in its highest degree is represented by others as a flame, but by Shakespeare as a frost. To "repress zeal," in the language of others, is to "cool," in Shakespeare's to "melt" it; when it exerts its utmost power it is commonly said to "flame," but by Shakespeare to be "congealed." (III.434)

III.1.45 CONSTANCE.

Full of unpleasing blots, and sightless stains

The poet uses "sightless" for that which we now express by "unsightly," disagreeable to the eyes. (III.439)

III.1.46 CONSTANCE.

Lame, foolish, crooked, swart, prodigious

"Prodigious"; that is, "portentous," so deformed as to be taken for a "foretoken of evil." (III.439)

III.1.68 CONSTANCE.

I will instruct my sorrows to be proud;
 For Grief is proud, and makes his owner stout.
 To me, and to the state of my great grief,
 Let kings assemble

In *Much Ado About Nothing*, the father of Hero, depressed by her disgrace, declares himself so subdued by grief that "a thread may lead him." How is it that grief in Leonato and Lady Constance, produces effects directly opposite, and yet both agreeable to nature. Sorrow softens the mind while it is yet warmed by hope, but hardens it when it is congealed by despair. Distress, while there remains any prospect of relief, is weak and flexible, but when no succour remains, is fearless and stubborn; angry alike at those that injure, and at those that do not help; careless to please where nothing can be gained, and fearless to offend when there is nothing further to be dreaded. Such was this writer's knowledge of the passions. III.440

III.1.71 CONSTANCE.

for my grief's so great,
 That no supporter but the huge firm earth
 Can hold it up: Here I and sorrow sit:
 Here is my throne, bid kings come bow to it.

[Theobald: "in the old editions, the 2d act was made to end here; though 'tis evident, Lady Constance here, in her despair, seats herself on the floor: and she must be supposed, as I formerly observed, immediately to rise again, only to go off and end the act decently; or the 'flat scene' must shut her in from the sight of the audience, an absurdity I cannot wish to accuse Shakespeare of."]

This whole note seems judicious enough; but Mr. Theobald forgets that there were, in Shakespeare's time, no moveable scenes in common playhouses. (III.440)

III.1.75 KING PHILIP.

'Tis true, fair daughter; and this blessed day
 Ever in France shall be kept festival:
 To solemnize this day, the glorious sun
 Stays in his course, and plays the alchymist;
 Turning with splendor of his precious eye
 The meagre cloddy earth to glitt'ring gold.
 The yearly course, that brings this day about,

Shall never see it, but a holy-day.

From this passage Rowe seems to have borrowed the first lines of his *Fair Penitent*. (III.441)

III.I.92 CONSTANCE.

But on this day, let seamen fear no wreck
That is, "except" on this day. (III.442)

III.I.102 CONSTANCE.

You came in arms to spill my enemies blood,
But now in arms, you strengthen it with yours.
I am afraid here is a clinch intended; "You came *in war* to destroy
my enemies, but now you strengthen them *in embraces*." III.442

III.I.111 CONSTANCE.

Set armed discord 'twixt these perjurd kings.
Shakespeare makes this bitter curse effectual. (III.443)

III.I.133 PHILIP.

And hang a calve's-skin on those recreant limbs.
To the insertion of these lines I have nothing to object. There are many other passages in the old play, of great value. The omission of this incident, in the second draught, was natural. Shakespeare, having familiarised the story to his own imagination, forgot that it was obscure to his audience; or, what is equally probable, the story was then so popular that a hint was sufficient at that time to bring it to mind, and these plays were written with very little care for the approbation of posterity. III.443

III.I.147 KING JOHN.

What earthly name to interrogatories
Can task the free breath of a sacred king?
Thou canst not, Cardinal, devise a name
So slight, unworthy, and ridiculous,
To charge me to an answer, as the Pope.

This must have been at the time when it was written, in our struggles with popery, a very captivating scene.

So many passages remain in which Shakespeare evidently takes his advantage of the facts then recent, and of the passions then in motion, that I cannot but suspect that time has obscured much of his art, and that many allusions yet remain undiscovered which perhaps may be gradually retrieved by succeeding commentators. (III.445)

III.I.176 PANDULPHO.

And meritorious shall that hand be call'd,
 Canoniz'd and worshipp'd as a saint,
 That takes away by any secret course
 Thy hateful life.

This may allude to the bull published against Queen Elizabeth. Or we may suppose, since we have no proof that this play appeared in its present state, before the reign of King James, that it was exhibited soon after the popish plot. I have seen a Spanish book in which Garnet, Faux, and their accomplices are registered as saints. (III.446)

III.I.204 DAUPHIN.

Bethink you, father; for the difference
 Is purchase of a heavy curse from Rome,
 Or the light loss of England for a friend;
 Forgo the easier.

It is a political maxim, that "kingdoms are never married." Lewis upon the wedding is for making war upon his new relations. III.447

III.I.208 CONSTANCE.

Lewis, stand fast; the Devil tempts thee here
 In likeness of a new and trimmed bride.

[Theobald and Hanmer: new and trimmed. Warburton: untrimmed, unsteady.]

I think Mr. Theobald's correction more plausible than Dr. Warburton's explanation. A commentator should be grave, and therefore I can read these notes with the proper severity of attention, but the idea of "trimming" a lady to "keep" her "steady," would be too risible for any common power of face. III.447

III.I.239 KING PHILIP.

And shall these hands, so lately purg'd of blood,
 So newly join'd in love, so strong in both
 I believe the meaning is, "love so strong in both" parties. III.448

III.I.271 PANDULPHO.

Is't not amiss, when it is truly done?
 [Warburton: Is yet.]
 I rather read,
Is't not amiss, when it is truly done?

as the alteration is less, and the sense which Dr. Warburton first discovered is preserved. (III.449)

III.I.280 PANDULPHO.

But thou hast sworn against religion:
By what thou swear'st, against the thing thou swear'st:
And mak'st an oath the surety for thy truth,
Against an oath. The truth thou art unsure
To swear, swear only not to be forsworn

[In this long speech, the legate is made to shew his skill in casuistry; and the strange heap of quibble and nonsense of which it consists, was intended to ridicule that of the schools. WARBURTON]

I am not able to discover here any thing inconsequent or ridiculously subtle. The propositions, that the "voice of the church is the voice of heaven," and that "the Pope utters the voice of the church," neither of which Pandulph's auditors would deny, being once granted, the argument here used is irresistible; nor is it easy, notwithstanding the gingle, to enforce it with greater brevity or propriety.

But thou hast sworn against religion:
By *what* thou swear'st, against the thing thou swear'st:
And mak'st an oath the surety for thy truth,
Against an oath the truth thou art unsure
To swear, swear only not to be forsworn.

By "what." Sir T. Hanmer reads, by "that." I think it should be rather by "which." That is, "thou swear'st against the thing, by *which* thou swear'st"; that is, "against religion."

The most formidable difficulty is in these lines.
And mak'st an oath the surety for thy truth,
Against an oath the truth thou art unsure
To swear, &c.

This Sir T. Hanmer reforms thus,
And mak'st an oath the surety for thy truth,
Against an oath; *this* truth thou art unsure
To swear, &c.

Dr. Warburton writes it thus,
Against an oath the truth thou art unsure—
which leaves the passage to me as obscure as before.

I know not whether there is any corruption beyond the omission of a point. The sense, after I had considered it, appeared to me only this:

"In swearing by religion against religion, to which thou hast already sworn, thou makest an oath the security for thy faith against an oath already taken." "I will give," says he, "a rule for conscience in these cases. Thou mayst be in doubt about the matter of an oath; *when thou swearest thou mayst not be always sure to swear rightly*, but let this be thy settled principle, *swear only not to be forsworn*; let not thy latter oaths be at variance with thy former."

"Truth" through this whole speech, means "rectitude" of conduct. (III.449)

III.ii.1 PHILIP.

Now, by my life, this day grows wond'rous hot;

Some airy devil hovers in the sky

[We must read, "some *fiery* devil," if we will have the cause equal to the effect. Warburton]

There is no end of such alterations; every page of a vehement and negligent writer will afford opportunities for changes of terms, if mere propriety will justify them. Not that of this change the propriety is out of controversy. Dr. Warburton will have the devil "*fiery*," because he makes the day "*hot*"; the authour makes him "*airy*," because "*he hovers in the sky*," and the "*heat*" and "*mischief*" are natural consequences of his malignity. (III.453)

III.iii.9 KING JOHN.

the fat ribs of peace

Must by the hungry now be fed upon.

[Warburton: hungry war be]

This emendation is better than the former, but yet not necessary. Sir T. Hanmer reads, "*hungry maw*" with less deviation from the common reading, but with not so much force or elegance as "*war*." (III.454)

III.iii.12 PHILIP.

Bell, book, and candle shall not drive me back

In an account of the Romish curse given by Dr. Gray, it appears that three candles were extinguished, one by one, in different parts of the execration. (III.454)

III.iv.1 KING PHILIP.

So, by a roaring tempest on the flood,

A whole Armada of collected sail

Is scatter'd and disjoint'd from fellowship.

[This similitude, as little as it makes for the purpose in hand, was, I do not question, a very taking one when the play was first represented; which was a winter or two at most, after the Spanish invasion of 1588. WARBURTON]

This play, so far as I can discover, was not played till a long time after the defeat of the Armada. The old play, I think, wants this simile. The commentator should not have affirmed what he could only guess. (III.457)

III.iv.40 CONSTANCE.

that fell anatomy

Which cannot hear a lady's feeble voice,

And scorns a modern invocation.

It is hard to say what Shakespeare means by "modern": it is not opposed to "ancient." In *All's Well, That Ends Well*, speaking of a girl in contempt, he uses this word, "her *modern* grace." It apparently means something "slight" and "inconsiderable." III.458

The *Revisal* thinks it evident that for "modern invocation" should be read "mother's invocation." I think "modern" is used as it is here in other passages of Shakespeare. *Appendix*

III.iv.61 KING PHILIP.

Bind up those tresses; O, what love I note

In the fair multitude of those her hairs;

Where but by chance a silver drop hath fall'n,

Ev'n to that drop ten thousand wivery friends

Do glew themselves in sociable grief;

Like true, inseparable, faithful loves,

Sticking together in calamity.

It was necessary that Constance should be interrupted, because a passion so violent cannot be borne long. I wish the following speeches had been equally happy; but they only serve to shew, how difficult it is to maintain the pathetick long. III.459

III.iv.99 CONSTANCE.

had you such a loss as I,

I could give better comfort than you do.

This is a sentiment which great sorrow always dictates. Whoever cannot help himself casts his eyes on others for assistance, and often mistakes their inability for coldness. (III.460)

III.IV.107 DAUPHIN.

There's nothing in this world can make me joy

The young prince feels his defeat with more sensibility than his father. Shame operates most strongly in the earlier years, and when can disgrace be less welcome than when a man is going to his bride? (III.461)

III.IV.147 PANDULPHO.

For he, that steeps his safety in true blood,

Shall find but bloody safety and untrue.

The blood of him that has the "just" claim. (III.462)

III.IV.176 PANDULPHO.

Or, as a little snow, tumbled about,

Anon becomes a mountain.

Bacon, in his history of Henry VII. speaking of Simnel's march, observes, that "their *snow-ball* did not gather as it went." (III.463)

IV.I.33 HUBERT.

How now, foolish rheum,

Turning dispiteous torture out of door!

For "torture" Sir T. Hanmer reads "nature," and is followed, I think, without necessity, by Dr. Warburton. (III.464)

IV.I.68 ARTHUR.

Oh! if an angel should have come to me,

And told me, Hubert should put out mine eyes,

I would not have believ'd a tongue, but Hubert's.

[Theobald: believ'd him: no tongue, but. Warburton: tongue 'bate Hubert]

I do not see why the old reading may not stand. Mr. Theobald's alteration, as we find, injures the measure, and Dr. Warburton's corrupts the language, and neither can be said much to mend the sense. (III.466)

IV.I.101 ARTHUR.

Hubert, if you will, cut out my tongue,

So I may keep mine eyes.

This is according to nature. We imagine no evil so great as that which is near us. (III.467)

IV.i.106 ARTHUR.

No, in good sooth, the fire is dead with grief,
Being create for comfort, to be us'd
In undeserv'd extreams

The sense is: "The fire," being "created" not to hurt but "to comfort, is dead with grief" for finding itself "used" in acts of cruelty, which, being innocent, I have "not deserved." III.467

IV.ii.3 PEMBROKE.

This once again, but that your highness Pleas'd,
Was once superfluous
"This one time more was one time more than enough." III.469

IV.ii.10 SALISBURY.

To guard a title that was rich before
To "guard," is to "fringe." (III.469)

IV.ii.40 KING JOHN.

Some reasons of this double coronation
I have possest you with, and think them strong.
And more, more strong (the lesser is my fear)
I shall endue you with

I have told you some reasons, in my opinion "strong," and shall tell more yet "stronger"; for the stronger my reasons are, the "less is my fear" of your disapprobation. This seems to be the meaning. (III.470)

IV.ii.48 PEMBROKE.

To sound the purposes of all their hearts
To "declare," to "publish" the desires of all those. (III.470)

IV.ii.76 SALISBURY.

The colour of the King doth come and go,
Between his purpose and his conscience
Between his "consciousness" of guilt, and his "design" to conceal it by fair professions. (III.471)

IV.ii.78 SALISBURY.

Like heralds 'twixt two dreadful battles set
[Theobald: sent]

This Dr. Warburton has followed without much advantage; "set" is not "fixed," but only "placed"; heralds must be "set" between battles in order to be "sent" between them. (III.471)

IV.ii.79 SALISBURY.

His passion is so ripe, it needs must break.

PEMBROKE.

And when it breaks, I fear, will issue thence

The foul corruption of a sweet child's death.

This is but an indelicate metaphor, taken from an impostumated tumour. (III.471)

IV.ii.109 KING JOHN.

How goes all in France?

MESSENGER.

From France to England.

The King asks "how all goes in France," the messenger catches the word "goes" and answers, that "whatever" is in France "goes" now "into" England. (III.472)

IV.ii.158 KING JOHN.

Deliver him to safety

That is, "Give him into safe custody." (III.474)

IV.ii.197 HUBERT.

Standing on slippers, which his nimble haste

Had falsely thrust upon contrary feet

I know not how the commentators understand this important passage, which, in Dr. Warburton's edition, is marked as eminently beautiful, and, on the whole, not without justice. But Shakespeare seems to have confounded a man's shoes with his gloves. He that is frightened or hurried may put his hand into the wrong glove, but either shoe will equally admit either foot. The authour seems to be disturbed by the disorder which he describes. (III.475)

IV.ii.231 KING JOHN.

Hadst thou but shook thy head, or made a pause,

When I spake darkly what I purposed:

Or turn'd an eye of doubt upon my face,

Or bid me tell my tale in express words;

Deep shame had struck me dumb, made me break off,

And those thy fears might have wrought fears in me.

There are many touches of nature in this conference of John with Hubert. A man engaged in wickedness would keep the profit to himself, and transfer the guilt to his accomplice. These reproaches vented against Hubert are not the words of art or policy, but the eruptions of a mind swelling with consciousness of a crime, and desirous of discharging its misery on another.

This account of the timidity of guilt is drawn *ab ipsis recessibus mentis*, from an intimate knowledge of mankind, particularly that line in which he says, that "to have bid him tell his tale" in "express" words, would have "struck him dumb"; nothing is more certain, than that bad men use all the arts of fallacy upon themselves, palliate their actions to their own minds by gentle terms, and hide themselves from their own detection in ambiguities and subterfuges. (III.477)

IV.ii.254 HUBERT.

Within this bosom never enter'd yet
The dreadful motion of a murd'rous thought,
And you have slander'd nature in my form
[Warburton: murderer's.]

I do not see any thing in this change worth the vehemence with which it is recommended. Read the line either way, the sense is nearly the same, nor does Hubert tell truth in either reading when he charges John with "slandering his form." He that could once intend to burn out the eyes of a captive prince, had a "mind" not too "fair" for the "rudest form." (III.478)

IV.iii.29 SALISBURY.

Our griefs, and not our manners, reason now
To "reason," in Shakespeare, is not so often to "argue," as to "talk." (III.480)

IV.iii.67 SALISBURY.

The incense of a vow, a holy vow!
Never to taste the pleasures of the world,
Never to be infected with delight,
Nor conversant with ease and idleness,
Till I have set a glory to this hand
This is a copy of the vows made in the ages of superstition and chivalry. (III.481)

IV.iii.72 SALISBURY.

By giving it the worship of revenge.

The "worship" is the "dignity," the "honour." We still say "worshipful" of "magistrates." (III.481)

IV.iii.84 HUBERT.

Nor tempt the danger of my true defence

"Honest" defence; defence in a "good cause." (III.482)

IV.iii.90 SALISBURY.

Thou art a murd'rer.

HUBERT.

Do not prove me so;

Yet, I am none.

Do not make me a murderer by compelling me to kill you; I am "hitherto" not a murderer. (III.482)

IV.iii.154 PHILIP.

The imminent decay of wrested pomp.

"Wrested pomp" is "greatness obtained by violence." (III.484)

V.i.59 PHILIP.

Forage, and run

To meet displeasure farther from the doors

To "forage" is here used in its original sense, for to "range abroad." (III.486)

V.i.72 PHILIP.

Mocking the air with colours idly spread

He has the same image in *Macbeth*.

Where the Norwegian colours flout the sky,

And fan our people cold. (III.487)

V.i.78 PHILIP.

Away then, with good courage; yet, I know,

Our party may well meet a prouder foe.

"Let us then away with courage"; yet I so well "know" the faintness of "our party," that I think "it may easily happen that they shall encounter enemies who have more spirit than themselves." (III.487)

V.ii.64[Stage direction] Enter Pandulpho.

DAUPHIN.

And even there, methinks, an angel spake!

Sir T. Hanmer, and after him Dr. Warburton read here, "an angel *speeds*." I think unnecessarily. The Dauphin does not yet hear the legate indeed, nor pretend to hear him, but seeing him advance and concluding that he comes to animate and authorise him with the power of the church, he cries out, "at the sight of this holy man, I am encouraged as *by the voice of an angel*." (III.490)

V.iv.11 MELUN.

Unthread the rude eye of rebellion

[Theobald: untread the rude way]

The metaphor is certainly harsh, but I do not think the passage corrupted. (III.495)

V.iv.37 MELUN.

Paying the fine of rated treachery,

Ev'n with a treacherous fine of all your lives

It were easy to change "rated" to "hated" for an easier meaning, but "rated" suits better with "fine." The Dauphin has "rated" your treachery, and set upon it a "fine" which your lives must pay. (III.496)

V.iv.60 SALISBURY.

Away, my friends; new flight;

And happy newness, that intends old right?

Happy innovation, that purposed the restoration of the ancient rightful government. (III.497)

V.vii.19 HENRY.

Which in their throng and press to that last hold,

Confound themselves.

In their tumult and hurry of resorting to the last tenable part. III.500

The tragedy of *King John*, though not written with the utmost power of Shakespeare, is varied with a very pleasing interchange of incidents and characters. The Lady's grief is very affecting, and the character of the Bastard contains that mixture of greatness and levity which this authour delighted to exhibit.

There is extant another play of *King John*, published with Shakespeare's name, so different from this, and I think from all his other

works, that there is reason to think his name was prefixed only to recommend it to sale. No man writes upon the same subject twice, without concurring in many places with himself. (III.503)

RICHARD II

I.i.45 BOLINGBROKE.

my right-drawn sword

Drawn in a right or just cause. (IV.5)

I.i.64 MOWBRAY.

Even to the frozen ridges of the Alps,

Or any other ground inhabitable

That is, "not habitable, uninhabitable." (IV.5)

I.i.118 RICHARD.

Now by my scepter's awe

The reverence due to my scepter. (IV.7)

I.i.164 RICHARD.

there is no boot

That is, "no advantage, no use," in delay or refusal. (IV.8)

I.i.166 MOWBRAY.

My life thou shalt command, but not my shame;

The one my duty owes; but my fair name,

Despight of death, that lives upon my grave

That is, "My name that lives on my grave *in* despight of death."

This easy passage most of the editors seem to have mistaken. IV.8

I.i.193 BOLINGBROKE.

The slavish motive of recanting fear.

["Motive," for instrument. Warburton]

Rather that which fear puts in motion. (IV.9)

I.ii.53 DUCHESS OF GLOUCESTER.

A caitiff recreant to my cousin Hereford!

"Caitiff" originally signified a "prisoner"; next "a slave," from the condition of prisoners; then a "scoundrel," from the qualities of a slave.

Ἡμῖς τῆς ἀρετῆς ἀποαῖνυται δούλιον ἡμεᾶς.

In this passage it partakes of all these significations. (IV.11)

I.iii.19 MOWBRAY.

Both to defend my loyalty and truth,
To God, my king and his succeeding issue

Such is the reading of the first folio; the later editions read "my" issue. Mowbray's "issue" was, by this accusation, in danger of an attainder, and therefore he might come among other reasons for their sake, but the old reading is more just and grammatical. (IV.13)

I.iii.95 MOWBRAY.

As gentle and as jocund, as to jest,
Go I to fight: truth hath a quiet breast.

[Warburton: to just]

The sense would perhaps have been better if the authour had written what his commentator substitutes, but the rhyme to which sense is too often enslaved, obliged Shakespeare to write "jest," and obliges us to read it. (IV.15)

I.iii.156 MOWBRAY.

A dearer merit, not so deep a maim,
As to be cast forth in the common air,
Have I deserved at your Highness' hands.

To "deserve a merit" is a phrase of which I know not any example. I wish some copy would exhibit,

A dearer *mede*, and not so deep a maim.

"To deserve a mede" or "reward," is regular and easy. (IV.18)

I.iii.193 BOLINGBROKE.

Norfolk, — so far, as to mine enemy —
By this time, had the King permitted us,
One of our souls had wandred in the air,
Banish'd this frail sepulchre of our flesh,
As now our flesh is banish'd from this land,
Confess thy treasons

I do not clearly see what is the sense of this abrupt line [line 1 above], but suppose the meaning to be this. Hereford immediately after his oath of perpetual enmity addresses Norfolk, and, fearing some misconstruction, turns to the king and says — "so far as to mine enemy" — that is, "I should say nothing to him but what enemies may say to each other."

Reviewing this passage, I rather think it should be understood thus. Norfolk, "so far" I have addressed myself to thee "as to mine

enemy," I now utter my last words with kindness and tenderness,
 "Confess thy treasons." (IV.19)

I.iii.206 MOWBRAY.

Now no way can I stray,
 Save back to England; all the world's my way.
 Perhaps Milton had this in his mind when he wrote these lines.
 The world was all before them, where to chuse
 Their place of rest, and Providence their guide.

IV.20 I.iii.227 GAUNT.

Shorten my days thou canst with sullen sorrow,
 And pluck nights from me, but not lend a morrow
 It is matter of very melancholy consideration, that all human advantages confer more power of doing evil than good. IV.20

I.iii.241 GAUNT.

A partial slander sought I to avoid,
 And in the sentence my own life destroy'd.
 That is, the "reproach" of "partiality." This is a just picture of the struggle between principle and affection. (IV.21)

I.iii.272 BOLINGBROKE.

and in the end
 Having my freedom, boast of nothing else
 But that I was a journeyman to grief?
 I am afraid our authour in this place designed a very poor quibble, as "journey" signifies both "travel" and a "day's work." However, he is not to be censured for what he himself rejected. (IV.22)

I.iii.275 GAUNT.

All places that the eye of heaven visits,
 Are to a wise man ports and happy havens.
 Teach thy necessity to reason thus:
 There is no virtue like necessity.
 Think not, the King did banish thee;
 But thou the King. Woe doth the heavier sit,
 Where it perceives it is but faintly borne.
 Go say, I sent thee forth to purchase honour,
 And not, the King exil'd thee. Or suppose,
 Devouring pestilence hangs in our air,
 And thou art flying to a fresher clime.

Look, what thy soul holds dear, imagine it
 To lye that way thou go'st, not whence thou com'st.
 Suppose the singing birds, musicians

[The fourteen verses that follow, are found in the first edition.
 POPE]

I am inclined to believe that what Mr. Theobald and Mr. Pope have restored were expunged in the revision by the authour: if the lines inclosed in crotchets [268-93] are omitted, the sense is more coherent. Nothing is more frequent among dramattick writers, than to shorten their dialogues for the stage. (IV.22)

I.III.308 BOLINGBROKE.

Where-e'er I wander, boast of this I can,
 Though banish'd; yet a true-born Englishman.

Here the first act ought to end, that between the first and second acts there may be time for John of Gaunt to accompany his son, return and fall sick. Then the first scene of the second act begins with a natural conversation, interrupted by a message from John of Gaunt, by which the king is called to visit him, which visit is paid in the following scene. As the play is now divided, more time passes between the two last scenes of the first act, than between the first act and the second. IV.23

II.I.21 YORK.

Report of fashions in proud Italy,
 Whose manners still our tardy, apish, nation
 Limp after, in base aukward imitation.

Our authour, who gives to all nations the customs of England, and to all ages the manners of his own; has charged the times of Richard with a folly not perhaps known then, but very frequent in Shakespeare's time, and much lamented by the wisest and best of our ancestors. (IV.27)

II.I.28 YORK.

Where will doth mutiny with wit's regard.

Where the will rebels against the notices of the understanding.
 IV.27

II.I.29 YORK.

Direct not him, whose way himself will chuse

Do not attempt to "guide him who," whatever thou shalt say, "will take his own course." (IV.27)

II.i.43 GAUNT.

This fortress, built by Nature for her self,
Against infection, and the hand of war

I once suspected that for "infection" we might read "invasion"; but the copies all agree, and I suppose Shakespeare meant to say, that islanders are secured by their situation both "from *war and* pestilence." (IV.27)

II.i.49 GAUNT.

Against the envy of less happier lands

So read all the editions, except Hanmer's, which has "less happy." I believe Shakespeare, from the habit of saying, "more happier" according to the custom of his time, inadvertently writ "less happier." (IV.28)

II.i.50 GAUNT.

This nurse, this teeming womb of royal kings,
Fear'd for their breed, and famous by their birth,
Renowned for their deeds, as far from home
For Christian service and true chivalry,
As is the Sepulchre

The first edition in 4to, 1598, reads,
Fear'd *by* their breed, and famous *for* their birth.
The second 4to in 1615,
Fear'd *by* their breed, and famous *by* their birth.

The first folio, though printed from the second quarto, reads as the first. The particles in this authour seem often to have been printed by chance. Perhaps the passage, which appears a little disordered, may be regulated thus:

royal kings,
Fear'd for their breed, and famous for their birth,
For Christian service, and true chivalry;
Renowned for their deeds as far from home
As is the Sepulchre. (IV.28)

II.i.114 GAUNT.

Thy state of law is bonds slave to the law

[“State of law,” i.e. “legal sov’rainty.” But the Oxford editor alters it to “state o’er law,” i.e. “absolute sov’rainty.” A doctrine, which, if our poet ever learnt at all, he learnt not in the reign when this play was written, Queen Elizabeth’s, but in the reign after it, King James’s. By “bondslave to the law,” the poet means his being enslaved to his “favorite” subjects. WARBURTON]

This sentiment, whatever it be, is obscurely expressed. I understand it differently from the learned commentator, being perhaps not quite so zealous for Shakespeare’s political reputation. The reasoning of Gaunt, I think, is this: “By setting thy royalties *to farm* thou hast reduced thyself to a state below sovereignty, thou art *now no longer king but landlord of England*, subject to the same restraint and limitations as other landlords; by making thy condition *a state of law*, a condition upon which the common rules of law can operate, *thou art become a bondslave to the law*; thou hast made thyself amenable to laws from which thou wert originally exempt.”

Whether this interpretation be true or no, it is plain that Dr. Warburton’s explanation of “bondslave to the law,” is not true. (IV.30)

II.i.133 GAUNT.

And thy unkindness be like crooked age,
To crop at once a too-long-wither’d flower.

Thus stand these lines in all the copies, but I think there is an error. Why should Gaunt, already “old,” call on any thing “like age” to end him? How can age be said to “crop at once”? How is the idea of “crookedness” connected with that of “cropping”? I suppose the poet dictated thus:

And thy unkindness be *time’s* crooked *edge*
To crop at once—
That is, “let thy unkindness” be time’s scythe “to crop.”

“Edge” was easily confounded by the ear with “age,” and one mistake once admitted made way for another. (IV.31)

II.i.138 GAUNT.

Love they to live, that love and honour have.
That is, “let them love.” (IV.31)

II.i.203 YORK.

By his attorneys-general to sue
His livery, and deny his offer’d homage

That is, "refuse" to admit the "homage," by which he is to hold his lands. (IV.33)

II.I.265 NORTHUMBERLAND.

We see the wind sit sore upon our sails,
And yet we strike not, but securely perish.

To "strike" the "sails," is, to "contract" them when there is too much wind. (IV.35)

II.II.11 QUEEN.

and my inward soul
With nothing trembles, at something it grieves
[Warburton: With something trembles, yet at nothing grieves]
All the old editions read,
my inward soul
With nothing trembles; at something it grieves.

The reading, which Dr. Warburton corrects, is itself an innovation. His conjecture gives indeed a better sense than that of any copy, but copies must not be needlessly forsaken. IV.37

II.II.31 QUEEN.

As, though, on thinking, on no thought I think,
Makes me with heavy nothing faint and shrink.

We should read, "as though *in* thinking": that is, "though musing I have no distinct idea of calamity." The involuntary and unaccountable depression of the mind, which every one has sometime felt, is here very forcibly described. (IV.38)

II.II.36 QUEEN.

For nothing hath begot my something grief;
Or something hath, the nothing that I grieve

With these lines I know not well what can be done. The Queen's reasoning, as it now stands, is this. My "trouble" is not "conceit," for "conceit is still derived from" some antecedent cause, "some forefather grief"; but with me the case is, that "either my real grief hath no real cause, or some real cause has produced a fancy'd grief." That is, "my grief is not conceit, because it either has not a cause like conceit, or it has a cause like conceit." This can hardly stand. Let us try again, and read thus:

For nothing hath begot my something grief;
Not something hath the nothing which I grieve.

That is: "My grief is not conceit; conceit is an imaginary uneasiness from some past occurrence." But, on the contrary, here is "real grief without a real cause; *not* a real cause with a fanciful sorrow." This, I think, must be the meaning; harsh at the best, yet better than contradiction or absurdity. (IV.38)

II.ii.38 QUEEN.

'Tis in reversion that I do possess;
But what it is, that is not yet known, what
I cannot name, 'tis nameless woe, I wot.

I am about to propose an interpretation which many will think harsh, and which I do not offer for certain. To "possess a man," is, in Shakespeare, to "inform him fully, to make him comprehend." To "be possessed," is, "to be fully informed." Of this sense the examples are numerous.

I have *possest* him my most stay
Can be but short. *Meas. for Meas.*
Is he *possest* what sum you need. *Merch. of Venice*
I therefore imagine the Queen says thus:

'Tis in reversion—that I do possess.—

"The event is yet in futurity — *that I know with full conviction* — but what it is, that is not yet known." In any other interpretation she must say that "she possesses" what is not yet come, which, though it may be allowed to be poetical and figurative language, is yet, I think, less natural than my explanation. IV.39

II.ii.46 GREEN.

That he, our hope, might have retir'd his power?
Might have "drawn" it "back." A French sense. (IV.39)

II.ii.62 QUEEN.

So, Green, thou art the midwife of my woe,
And Bolingbroke my sorrow's dismal heir.

The authour seems to have used "heir" in an improper sense, an "heir" being one that "inherits by succession," is here put for one that "succeeds," though he "succeeds" but in order of time, not in order of descent. (IV.40)

II.iii.79 BERKLEY.

To take advantage of the absent time

[“Absent” for “unprepared.” Not an inelegant synecdoche. WARBURTON]

He means nothing more than, “time of the king’s absence.” IV.45

II.iii.94 YORK.

Frighting her pale-fac’d villages with war,
And ostentation of despised arms?

[Warburton: disposed]

This alteration is harsh. Sir T. Hanmer reads “despightful.” Mr. Upton gives this passage as a proof that our authour uses the passive participle in an active sense. The copies all agree. Perhaps the old Duke means to treat him with contempt as well as with severity, and to insinuate that he despises his power, as being able to master it. In this sense all is right. IV.46

II.iii.106 BOLINGBROKE.

My gracious uncle, let me know my fault;
On what condition stands it, and wherein?

It should be, “*in* what condition.” That is, “in what degree of guilt.” The particles in the old editions are of little credit. IV.47

II.iii.122 BOLINGBROKE.

Wherefore was I born?
If that my cousin king be King of England,
It must be granted, I am Duke of Lancaster.

To what purpose serves birth and lineal succession? I am Duke of Lancaster by the same right of birth as the King is King of England. (IV.47)

II.iv.1 [Stage direction] Enter Salisbury, and a Captain.

Here is a scene so unartfully and irregularly thrust into an improper place, that I cannot but suspect it accidentally transposed; which, when the scenes were written on single pages, might easily happen, in the wildness of Shakespeare’s drama. This dialogue was, in the authour’s draught, probably the second scene of the ensuing act, and there I would advise the reader to insert it, though I have not ventured on so bold a change. My conjecture is not so presumptuous as may be thought. The play was not, in Shakespeare’s time, broken into acts; the two editions published before his death exhibit only a sequence of scenes from the beginning to the end, without any hint

of a pause of action. In a drama so desultory and errattick, left in such a state, transpositions might easily be made. IV.49

II.iv.8 CAPTAIN.

The bay-trees in our country all are wither'd,
And meteors fright the fixed stars of heav'n;
The pale fac'd moon looks bloody on the earth;
And lean-look'd prophets whisper fearful change.
Rich men look sad, and ruffians dance and leap;
The one, in fear to lose what they enjoy;
Th' other, in hope t' enjoy by rage and war.
These signs forerun the death of kings—

This enumeration of prodigies is in the highest degree poetical and striking. (IV.49)

III.i.24 BOLINGBROKE.

From mine own windows torn my household coat

It was the practice, when coloured glass was in use, of which there are still some remains in old seats and churches, to anneal the arms of the family in the windows of the house. (IV.51)

III.i.42 BOLINGBROKE.

Thanks, gentle Uncle, Come, my lords, away,
[To fight with Glendower and his complices;]
A while to work; and, after, holy-day.
[Theobald omits the second line.]

This emendation, which I think is just, has been followed by Sir T. Hanmer, but is neglected by Dr. Warburton. (IV.51)

III.ii.1 [Stage direction] Changes to the coast of Wales.

Here may be properly inserted the last scene of the second act. IV.52

III.ii.26 CARLISLE.

Fear not, my Lord; that Pow'r, that made you king,
Hath pow'r to keep you king, in spight of all.
The means, that heaven yields, must be embrac'd
And not neglected; else, if heaven would,
And we would not heav'n's offer, we refuse
The profer'd means of succour and redress.

Of this speech the four last lines were restored from the first edition by Mr. Pope. They were, I suppose, omitted by the players only to

shorten the scenes, for they are worthy of the authour and suitable to the personage. (IV.53)

III.ii.37 RICHARD.

the searching eye of heaven is hid
Behind the globe that lights the lower world
I should read,
the searching eye of heav'n is hid
Behind the globe *and* lights the lower world. (IV.53)

III.ii.56 RICHARD.

The breath of worldly men cannot depose
The deputy elected by the Lord.

Here is the doctrine of indefeasible right expressed in the strongest terms, but our poet did not learn it in the reign of King James, to which it is now the practice of all writers, whose opinions are regulated by fashion or interest, to impute the original of every tenet which they have been taught to think false or foolish. (IV.54)

III.ii.93 RICHARD.

Mine ear is open, and my heart prepar'd.
The worst is worldly loss thou canst unfold.
Say, is my kingdom lost? why, 'twas my care,
And what loss is it, to be rid of care?
Strives Bolingbroke to be as great as we?
Greater he shall not be; if he serve God,
We'll serve him too, and be his fellow so.
Revolt our subjects? that we cannot mend;
They break their faith to God, as well as us.
Cry, woe, destruction, ruin, loss, decay;
The worst is death, and death will have his day.

It seems to be the design of the poet to raise Richard to esteem in his fall, and consequently to interest the reader in his favour. He gives him only passive fortitude, the virtue of a confessor rather than of a king. In his prosperity we saw him imperious and oppressive, but in his distress he is wise, patient, and pious. (IV.55)

III.ii.116 SCROOP.

Thy very beadsmen learn to bend their bows

Such is the reading of all the copies, yet I doubt whether "beadsmen" be right, for the "bow" seems to be mentioned here as the

proper weapon of a "beadsman." The king's "beadsmen" were his chaplains. Trevisa calls himself the "beadsman" of his patron. "Beadsmen" might likewise be any men maintained by charity to pray for their benefactor. Hanmer reads "the *very* beadsmen," but "thy" is better. (IV.56)

III.ii.122 RICHARD.

Where is the Earl of Wiltshire? where is Bagot?

What is become of Bushy? where is Green?

[Theobald: Wiltshire? where is he got?]

This emendation Dr. Warburton adopts. Hanmer leaves a blank after "Wiltshire." I believe the authour rather than transcriber, made a mistake. "Where is he got" does not sound in my ear like an expression of Shakespeare. (IV.56)

III.ii.153 RICHARD.

And that small model of the barren earth

[He uses "model" here, as he frequently does elsewhere, for "part, portion." WARBURTON]

He uses it rather for "mould." That earth, which closing upon the body, takes its form. This interpretation the next line seems to authorise. (IV.58)

III.ii.154 RICHARD.

Which serves as paste and cover to our bones.

A metaphor, not of the most sublime kind, taken from a "pie." IV.58

III.ii.162 RICHARD.

and there the antick sits,

Scoffing his state, and grinning at his pomp

Here is an allusion to the "antick" or "fool" of old farces, whose chief part is to deride and disturb the graver and more splendid personages. (IV.58)

III.ii.172 RICHARD.

throw away respect,

Tradition, form, and ceremonious duty

This word seems here used in an improper sense, for "traditional practices": that is, "established or customary homage." IV.59

III.ii.184 CARLISLE.

And fight and die, is death destroying death

That is, to “dye fighting,” is to return the evil that we suffer, to destroy the destroyers. I once read “death *defying* death,” but “destroying” is as well. (IV.59)

III.ii.207 RICHARD.

By heav’n, I’ll hate him everlastingly,

That bids me be of comfort any more.

This sentiment is drawn from nature. Nothing is more offensive to a mind convinced that his distress is without a remedy, and preparing to submit quietly to irresistible calamity, than these petty and conjectured comforts which unskilful officiousness thinks it virtue to administer. (IV.60)

III.iii.12 YORK.

he would

Have been so brief with you, to shorten you,

For taking so the head, the whole head’s length.

To “take” the “head” is, to act without restraint; to take undue liberties. We now say, “we give *the horse* his head,” when we relax the reins. (IV.61)

III.iii.95 RICHARD.

But ere the crown, he looks for, live in peace,

Ten thousand bloody crowns of mothers’ sons

Shall ill become the flow’r of England’s face.

[Theobald: the floor of England’s] [By “the flow’r of England’s face,” is meant the choicest youths of England, who shall be slaughter’d in this quarrel, or have “bloody crowns.” WARBURTON]

Dr. Warburton has inserted “light in peace” in the text of his own edition, but “live in peace” is more suitable to Richard’s intention, which is to tell him that though he should get the “crown” by rebellion, it will be long before it will “live” in peace, be so “settled” as to be firm. “The flow’r of England’s face,” is very happily explained, and any alteration is therefore needless. (IV.63)

III.iii.109 NORTHUMBERLAND.

And by the bury’d hand of warlike Gaunt

[It should be read just the other way,

And by the *warlike* hand of *bury’d* Gaunt. WARBURTON]

I see no great difference. (IV.64)

III.iii.133 RICHARD.

Oh God, oh God! that e'er this tongue of mine,
That laid the sentence of dread banishment
On yond proud man, should take it off again
With words of sooth

"Sooth" is "sweet" as well as "true." In this place "sooth" means "sweetness" or softness, a signification yet retained in the verb "to sooth." (IV.65)

III.iii.155 RICHARD.

Or I'll be bury'd in the King's high way,
Some way of common trade
[Theobald: tread]

Dr. Warburton has put "tread" in his own text, but "trade" will serve very well in the sense either of "commerce" or "custom." IV.66

III.iii.156 RICHARD.

where subjects' feet
May hourly trample on their sovereign's head;
For on my heart they tread now, whilst I live;
And, bury'd once, why not upon my head?—
Aumerle, thou weep'st; my tender-hearted cousin!
We'll make foul weather with despised tears;
Our sighs, and they, shall lodge the summer corn,
And make a dearth in this revolting land.
Or shall we play the wantons with our woes,
And make some pretty match, with shedding tears?
As thus, to drop them still upon one place,
Till they have fretted us a pair of graves
Within the earth; and therein laid, there lies
Two kinsmen, digg'd their graves with weeping eyes.
Would not this ill do well?

Shakespeare is very apt to deviate from the *pathetick* to the *ridiculous*. Had the speech of Richard ended at this line [156] it had exhibited the natural language of submissive misery, conforming its intention to the present fortune, and calmly ending its purposes in death. (IV.66)

III.iv.26 QUEEN.

My wretchedness unto a row of pins,
 [Stage direction] Enter a gardiner, and two servants.
 They'll talk of state; for every one doth so,
 Against a change; woe is fore-run with woe.
 [Queen and ladies retire.]

GARDINER.

Go, bind thou up yond dangling apricots
 [Warburton: fore-run with mocks]

There is no need of any emendation. The poet, according to the common doctrine of prognostication, supposes dejection to forerun calamity, and a kingdom to be filled with rumours of sorrow when any great disaster is impending. The sense is that, "publick evils are always presignified by publick pensiveness, and plaintive conversation." The conceit of rhyming "mocks" with "apricocks," which I hope Shakespeare knew better how to spell, shows that the commentator was resolved not to let his conjecture fall for want of any support that he could give it. (IV.69)

III.iv.100 QUEEN.

Gard'ner, for telling me these news of woe,
 I would, the plants, thou graft'st, may never grow.
 [Exeunt Queen and ladies.]

GARDINER.

Poor Queen, so that thy state might be no worse,
 I would my skill were subject to thy curse.
 Here did she drop a tear; here, in this place,
 I'll set a bank of rue, sour "herb of grace";
 Rue, ev'n for ruth, here shortly shall be seen,
 In the remembrance of a weeping Queen.

This execration of the queen is somewhat ludicrous, and unsuitable to her condition; the gardener's reflexion is better adapted to the state both of his mind and his fortune. Mr. Pope, who has been throughout this play very diligent to reject what he did not like, has yet, I know not why, spared the last lines of this act. (IV.72)

IV.1.21 AUMERLE.

Shall I so much dishonour my fair stars,
 On equal terms to give him chastisement?
 [Warburton: fair stem]

I think the present reading unexceptionable. The "birth" is supposed to be influenced by the "stars," therefore our authour with his usual licence takes "stars" for "birth." IV.73

IV.1.33 FITZWATER.

If that thy valour stand on sympathies,
 There is my gage, Aumerle, in gage to thine.

Here is a translated sense much harsher than that of "stars" explained in the foregoing note. Aumerle has challenged Bagot with some hesitation, as not being his equal, and therefore one whom, according to the rules of chivalry, he was not obliged to fight, as a nobler life was not to be staked in a duel against a baser. Fitzwater then throws down his "gage" a "pledge" of battle, and tells him that if he stands upon "sympathies," that is, upon "equality of blood," the combat is now offered him by a man of rank not inferior to his own. "Sympathy" is an "affection" incident at once to two subjects. This "community of affection" implies a "likeness or equality of nature," and thence our poet transferred the term "to equality of blood." (IV.73)

IV.1.39 FITZWATER.

And I will turn thy falshood to thy heart,
 Where it was forged, with my rapier's point.

Shakespeare deserts the manners of the age in which his drama is placed very often, without necessity or advantage. The edge of a sword had served his purpose as well as the "point of a rapier," and he had then escaped the impropriety of giving the English nobles a weapon which was not seen in England till two centuries afterwards. (IV.74)

IV.1.52 ANOTHER LORD.

I take the earth to the like, forsworn Aumerle,
 And spur thee on with full as many lies
 As may be hollow'd in thy treach'rous ear
 From sin to sin. Here is my honour's pawn,
 Engage it to the trial if thou dar'st.

This speech I have restored from the first edition in humble imitation of former editors, though, I believe, against the mind of the authour. For “the earth” I suppose we should read, “thy oath.” (IV.74)

IV.I.74 FITZWATER.

I dare meet Surrey in a wilderness

I dare meet him where no help can be had by me against him. So in *Macbeth*,

O be alive again,

And dare me to the desert with thy sword. IV.75

IV.I.78 FITZWATER.

As I intend to thrive in this new world

In this world where I have just begun to be an actor. Surrey has, a few lines above, called him “boy.” (IV.75)

IV.I.116 CARLISLE.

Yet best beseeming me to speak the truth.

It might be read more grammatically,

Yet best *beseems it* me to speak the truth.

But I do not think it is printed otherwise than as Shakespeare wrote it. (IV.76)

IV.I.125 CARLISLE.

And shall the figure of God’s majesty,

His captain, steward, deputy elect,

Anointed, crown’d, and planted many years,

Be judg’d by subject and inferior breath,

And he himself not present?

Here is another proof that our authour did not learn in King James’s court his elevated notions of the right of kings. I know not any flatterer of the Stuarts who has expressed this doctrine in much stronger terms. It must be observed that the poet intends from the beginning to the end to exhibit this bishop as brave, pious, and venerable. (IV.77)

IV.I.152 NORTHUMBERLAND.

My lord of Westminster, be it your charge,

To keep him safely till his day of tryal.

After this line, whatever follows, almost to the end of the act, containing the whole process of dethroning and debasing King Richard, was added after the first edition of 1598, and before the second of

1615. Part of the addition is proper, and part might have been forborn without much loss. The authour, I suppose, intended to make a very moving scene. IV.77

IV.1.167 RICHARD.

Yet I well remember
The favours of these men
The "countenances"; the "features." (IV.78)

IV.1.181 RICHARD.

Give me the crown.—Here, cousin, seize the crown,
Here, on this side, my hand; on that side, thine.
Now is this golden crown like a deep well,
That owes two buckets, filling one another;
The emptier ever dancing in the air,
The other down, unseen and full of water;
That bucket down, and full of tears, am I;
Drinking my griefs, whilst you mount up on high.

This is a comparison not easily accommodated to the subject, nor very naturally introduced. The best part is this line, in which he makes the usurper the "empty" bucket. (IV.79)

IV.1.194 BOLINGBROKE.

Part of your cares you give me with your crown.

RICHARD.

Your cares set up, do not pluck my cares down.
My care, is loss of care, by old care done;
Your care, is gain of care, by new care won.
The cares I give, I have, though given away;
They tend the crown, yet still with me they stay.

Shakespeare often obscures his meaning by playing with sounds. Richard seems to say here, that "his cares are not made less by the increase of Bolingbroke's cares," for this reason, that "his care is the loss of care," his grief is, that his regal cares are at an end, "by the cessation of the care to which he had been accustomed." (IV.79)

IV.1.207 RICHARD.

With mine own tears I wash away my balm
"My balm." The oil of consecration. He has mentioned it before.

IV.80

IV.I.230 RICHARD.

If thy offences were upon record,
 Would it not shame thee, in so fair a troop,
 To read a lecture of them? if thou would'st
 "If thou would'st." That is, If thou would'st read over a list of thy
 own deeds. (IV.80)

IV.I.246 RICHARD.

But they can see a sort of traitors here.
 [A pack, a company. Warburton]
 The last who used the word "sort" in this sense was, perhaps,
 Waller.
 A *sort* of lusty shepherds strive. IV.81

IV.I.317 RICHARD.

Conveyers are you all.
 That rise thus nimbly by a true king's fall.
 To "convey" is a term often used in an ill sense, and so Richard
 understands it here. Pistol says of "stealing," "*convey* the wise it call";
 and to "convey" is the word for slight of hand, which seems to be
 alluded to here. "Ye are all," says the deposed Prince, "*jugglers who*
rise with this nimble dexterity by the fall of a good king." (IV.83)

IV.I.322 CARLISLE.

The woe's to come; the children yet unborn
 Shall feel this day as sharp to them as thorn.
 This pathetick denunciation shews that Shakespeare intended to
 impress his auditors with dislike of the deposal of Richard. IV.83

V.I.1 QUEEN.

this is the way
 To Julius Caesar's ill-erected Tower
 The Tower of London is traditionally said to have been the work of
 Julius Caesar. (IV.84)

V.I.5 QUEEN.

Here let us rest, if this rebellious earth
 Have any resting for her true king's Queen.
 "Here rest, if any rest can harbour here." Milton (IV.84)

V.I.11 QUEEN.

O thou, the model where old Troy did stand

The Queen uses comparative terms absolutely. Instead of saying, "Thou who appearest" as the ground on which the magnificence of Troy was once erected, she says, "O thou, the model," &c. (IV.84)

V.I.12 QUEEN.

Thou map of honour

Thou "picture" of greatness. (IV.85)

V.I.16 RICHARD.

Join not with grief, fair woman, do not so,
To make my end too sudden.

Do not thou unite with grief against me; do not, by thy additional sorrows, enable grief to strike me down at once. My own part of sorrow I can bear, but thy affliction will immediately destroy me. (IV.85)

V.I.20 RICHARD.

I am sworn brother, Sweet,
To grim Necessity; and he and I

I have reconciled myself to necessity, I am in a state of amity with the constraint which I have sustained. (IV.85)

V.I.40 RICHARD.

In winter's tedious nights sit by the fire
With good old folks, and let them tell thee tales
Of woeful ages, long ago betid;
And ere thou bid good night, to quit their grief,
Tell thou the lamentable fall of me.
To retaliate their mournful stories. (IV.86)

V.I.46 RICHARD.

For why? the senseless brands will sympathize
The heavy accent of thy moving tongue,
And in compassion weep the fire out;
And some will mourn in ashes, some coal-black,
For the deposing of a rightful king.

The poet should have ended this speech with the foregoing line [45], and have spared his childish prattle about the fire. IV.86

V.i.88 RICHARD.

Better far off; than near, be ne'er the near.

To be "never the nigher," or as it is commonly spoken in the mid-land counties, "ne'er the ne-er," is, "to make no advance towards the good desired." (IV.87)

V.ii.23 YORK.

As in a theatre, the eyes of men,
After a well-grac'd actor leaves the stage,
Are idly bent on him that enters next

That is, "carelessly" turned, thrown without attention. This the poet learned by his attendance and practice on the stage. IV.89

V.ii.50 YORK.

Well, bear you well in this new spring of time
That is, "Conduct yourself with prudence." (IV.89)

V.ii.56 YORK.

What seal is that, which hangs without thy bosom?
Yea, look'st thou pale? let me see the writing.

Such harsh and defective lines as this, are probably corrupt, and might be easily supplied, but that it would be dangerous to let conjecture loose on such slight occasions. (IV.90)

V.iii.5 BOLINGBROKE.

Enquire at London, 'mong the taverns there:
For there, they say, he daily doth frequent,
With unrestrained loose companions,
Even such, they say, as stand in narrow lanes,
And beat our watch, and rob our passengers,
While he, young, wanton, and effeminate boy,
Takes on the point of honour, to support
So dissolute a crew.

This is a very proper introduction to the future character of Henry the Fifth, to his debaucheries in his youth, and his greatness in his manhood. (IV.92)

V.iii.79 BOLINGBROKE.

Our scene is alter'd from a serious thing,
And now chang'd to *the Beggar, and the King*.

The *King and Beggar* seems to have been an interlude well known in the time of our authour, who has alluded to it more than once. I cannot now find that any copy of it is left. IV.95

V.iii.119 YORK.

Speak it in French, King; say, "Pardonnez moy."

That is, "excuse me," a phrase used when any thing is civilly denied. This whole passage is such as I could well wish away. IV.97

V.v.51 RICHARD.

My thoughts are minutes; and with sighs they jar,
Their watches to mine eyes the outward watch;
Whereto my finger, like a dial's point,
Is pointing still, in cleansing them from tears.

I think this expression must be corrupt, but I know not well how to make it better. The first quarto reads,

My thoughts are minutes; and with sighs they jar,
There watches on unto mine eyes the outward watch.

The second quarto:

My thoughts are minutes, and with sighs they jar,
There watches to mine eyes the outward watch.

The first folio agrees with the second quarto.

Perhaps out of these two readings the right may be made. "Watch" seems to be used in a double sense for a "quantity of time," and for the "instrument that measures time." I read, but with no great confidence, thus:

My thoughts are minutes, and with sighs they jar
Their watches on; mine eyes the outward watch,
Whereto, &c. IV.100

V.v.65 RICHARD.

and love to Richard

Is a strange brooch, in this all-hating world.

[Fall-hating, i.e., a world that shuns and avoids those who are fallen. WARBURTON]

I believe the meaning is, "this world in which I am universally hated." (IV.100)

V.v.70 RICHARD.

Where no man ever comes, but that sad dog

Dr. Warburton says peremptorily, “read *drudge*” —but I still persist in the old reading. (IV.101)

This play is extracted from the Chronicle of Hollingshead, in which many passages may be found which Shakespeare has, with very little alteration, transplanted into his scenes; particularly a speech of the Bishop of Carlisle in defence of King Richard’s unalienable right, and immunity from human jurisdiction.

Jonson, who, in his *Catiline* and *Sejanus*, has inserted many speeches from the Roman historians, was, perhaps, induced to that practice by the example of Shakespeare, who had condescended sometimes to copy more ignoble writers. But Shakespeare had more of his own than Jonson, and, if he sometimes was willing to spare his labour, shewed by what he performed at other times, that his extracts were made by choice or idleness rather than necessity.

This play is one of those which Shakespeare has apparently revised; but as success in works of invention is not always proportionate to labour, it is not finished at last with the happy force of some other of his tragedies, nor can be said much to affect the passions, or enlarge the understanding. (IV.105)

HENRY IV, PART 1

I.1.1 KING HENRY.

So shaken as we are, so wan with care,
Find we a time for frightened peace to pant,
And breathe short-winded accents of new broils
To be commenc'd in stronds a-far remote.

Shakespeare has apparently designed a regular connection of these dramattick histories from Richard the Second to Henry the Fifth. King Henry, at the end of *Richard the Second*, declares his purpose to visit the Holy Land, which he resumes in this speech. The complaint made by King Henry in the last act of *Richard the Second*, of the wildness of his son, prepares the reader for the frolicks which are here to be recounted, and the characters which are now to be exhibited. (IV.109)

I.1.2 KING HENRY.

Find we a time for frightened peace to pant,
And breathe short-winded accents of new broils
That is, "Let us soften peace to rest a while without disturbance,
that she may recover breath to propose new wars." IV.109

I.1.5 KING HENRY.

No more the thirsty entrance of this soil
Shall damp her lips with her own children's blood
[Warburton: "shall trempe," i.e. moisten]

That these lines are absurd is soon discovered, but how this nonsense will be made sense is not so easily told; surely not by reading "trempe," for what means he, that says, "the thirsty *entrance* of this *soil* shall no more *trempe* her lips with her children's blood," more than he that says "it shall not *damp* her lips"? To suppose the "entrance of the soil" to mean the "entrance" of a king upon "dominion," and King Henry to predict that "kings shall enter hereafter without bloodshed," is to give words such a latitude of meaning, that no nonsense can want a congruous interpretation.

The antient copies neither have "trempe" nor "damp"; the first 4to of 1599, that of 1622, the Folio of 1623, and the 4to of 1639, all read,
No more the thirsty entrance of this soil
Shall *daube* her lips with her own children's blood.

The Folios of 1632 and 1664 read, by an apparent error of the press, "Shall *damb* her lips," from which the later editors have idly adopted "damp." The old reading helps the editor no better than the new, nor can I satisfactorily reform the passage. I think that "thirsty entrance" must be wrong, yet know not what to offer. We may read, but not very elegantly,

No more the thirsty *entrails* of this soil
Shall *daubed be* with her own children's blood.

The relative "her," is inaccurately used in both readings; but to regard sense more than grammar is familiar to our author.

We may suppose a verse or two lost between these two lines. This is a cheap way of palliating an editor's inability; but I believe such omissions are more frequent in Shakespeare than is commonly imagined. (IV.110)

I.I.9 KING HENRY.

Those opposed eyes,
Which, like the meteors of a troubled heav'n,
All of one nature, of one substance bred,
Did lately meet in the intestine shock
[Warburton: opposed files]

This passage is not very accurate in the expression, but I think nothing can be changed. (IV.110)

I.I.18 KING HENRY.

Therefore, friends,
As far as to the sepulchre of Christ,
Whose soldier now, under whose blessed cross
We are impressed, and engag'd to fight,
Forthwith a power of English shall we levy

The lawfulness and justice of the "holy wars" have been much disputed; but perhaps there is a principle on which the question may be easily determined. If it be part of the religion of the Mahometans, to extirpate by the sword all other religions, it is, by the law of self defence, lawful for men of every other religion, and for Christians among others, to make war upon Mahometans, simply as Mahometans, as men obliged by their own principles to make war upon Christians, and only lying in wait till opportunity shall promise them success. (IV.111)

I.i.68 KING HENRY.

Ten thousand bold Scots, three and twenty knights,
Balk'd in their own blood did Sir Walter see

Of the word "balk'd" I know not any sense applicable here. The *Revisal* reads "bath'd," and I have nothing better to offer. *Appendix*

I.i.98 WESTMORELAND.

Which makes him plume himself, and bristle up

[Doubtless Shakespeare wrote "plume." And to this the Oxford editor gives his *fiat*. WARBURTON]

I am not so confident as those two editors. The metaphor is taken from a cock who in his pride "prunes himself"; that is, picks off the loose feathers to smooth the rest. To "prune" and to "plume," spoken of a bird, is the same. (IV.113)

I.i.106 KING HENRY.

For more is to be said, and to be done,
Than out of anger can be utter'd.

That is, "More is to be said than anger will suffer me to say: more than can issue from a mind disturbed like mine." IV.114

I.ii.1 FALSTAFF.

Now, Hal, what time of day is it, lad?

PRINCE HENRY.

Thou art so fat-witted with drinking old sack, and unbuttoning thee after supper, and sleeping upon benches in the afternoon, that thou hast forgotten to demand that truly, which thou would'st truly know.

The Prince's objection to the question seems to be, that Falstaff had asked in the "night" what was the time of "day." IV.114

I.ii.41 PRINCE HENRY.

and is not a buff-jerkin a most sweet robe of durance?

To understand the propriety of the Prince's answer, it must be remarked that the sheriff's officers were formerly clad in buff. So that when Falstaff asks whether "his hostess is not a sweet wench," the Prince asks in return, whether "it will not be a sweet thing to go to prison by running in debt to this sweet wench." (IV.117)

I.ii.67 FALSTAFF.

Well, Hal, well; and in some sort it jumps with my humour, as well as waiting in the court, I can tell you.

PRINCE HENRY.

For obtaining of suits?

"Suit," spoken of one that attends at court, means a "petition"; used with respect to the hangman, means the "cloaths" of the offender. (IV.118)

I.ii.71 FALSTAFF.

'Sblood, I am as melancholy as a gib-cat

A "gib-cat" means, I know not why, an old cat. (IV.118)

I.ii.75 PRINCE HENRY.

What say'st thou to a hare, or the melancholy of Moor-ditch?

A "hare" may be considered as melancholy, because she is upon her form always solitary; and, according to the physic of the times, the flesh of it was supposed to generate melancholy. 1773: V.234

I.ii.75 PRINCE HENRY.

the melancholy of Moor-ditch?

The "melancholy of Moor-ditch" I do not understand, unless it may allude to the croaking of frogs. (IV.118)

I.ii.77 FALSTAFF.

Thou hast the most unsavoury similies; and art, indeed, the most comparative, rascalliest, sweet young Prince

Sir T. Hanmer, and Dr. Warburton after him, read, "incomparative," I suppose for "incomparable," or "peerless," but "comparative" here means "quick at comparisons," or "fruitful in similies," and is properly introduced. (IV.118)

I.ii.88 FALSTAFF.

O, thou hast damnable iteration, and art, indeed, able to corrupt a saint.

For "iteration" Sir T. Hanmer and Dr. Warburton read "attraction," of which the meaning is certainly more apparent; but an editor is not always to change what he does not understand. In the last speech a text is very indecently and abusively applied, to which Falstaff answers, "thou hast damnable iteration," or, a wicked trick of "repeating" and applying holy texts. This I think is the meaning. (IV.118)

I.ii.101 FALSTAFF.

Why, Hal, 'tis my vocation, Hal. 'Tis no sin for a man to labour in his vocation. Poins!—Now shall we know, if Gads-hill have set a match.

[Theobald assigns the speech to Falstaff.]

Mr. Theobald has fastened on an observation made by Pope, hyperbolical enough, but not contradicted by the erroneous reading in this place, the speech not being so characteristick as to be infallibly applied to the speaker. Theobald's triumph over the other editors might have been abated by a confession, that the first edition gave him at least a glimpse of the emendation. IV.119

I.ii.136 FALSTAFF.

if thou dar'st not cry, "stand," for ten shillings.

The present reading may perhaps be right, but I think it necessary to remark, that all the old editions read, "if thou darest not stand for ten shillings." (IV.121)

I.ii.183 POINS.

in the reproof of this, lies the jest

"Reproof" is "confutation." (IV.123)

I.ii.201 PRINCE HENRY.

So, when this loose behaviour I throw off,

And pay the debt I never promised;

By how much better than my word I am,

By so much shall I falsifie men's hopes

[Just the contrary. We should read "fears." WARBURTON]

To "falsify hope" is to "exceed hope," to give much where men "hoped" for little.

This speech is very artfully introduced to keep the Prince from appearing vile in the opinion of the audience; it prepares them for his future reformation, and, what is yet more valuable, exhibits a natural picture of a great mind offering excuses to itself, and palliating those follies which it can neither justify nor forsake. (IV.123)

I.iii.5 KING HENRY.

I will from henceforth rather be myself,

Mighty and to be fear'd, than my condition

[I.e. I will from henceforth rather put on the character that becomes me, and exert the resentment of an injured king, than still con-

tinue in the inactivity and mildness of my natural disposition. And this sentiment he has well expressed, save that by his usual licence, he puts the word "condition" for "disposition." WARBURTON]

The commentator has well explained the sense which was not very difficult, but is mistaken in supposing the use of "condition" licentious. Shakespeare uses it very frequently for "temper of mind," and in this sense the vulgar still say a "good" or "ill-conditioned man." (IV.124)

I.iii.18 KING HENRY.

And majesty might never yet endure
The moody frontier of a servant brow.
[Warburton: frontlet]

So in *Lear*, when one of the King's daughters frowns, he tells her of her "frontlet." All the editions read "frontier" in this place. May it not mean, "Majesty will not endure the moody brow of a servant to *border* upon it, to be near it"? Shakespeare has licences equal to this. (IV.125)

I.iii.35 HOTSPUR.

Shew'd like a stubble land at harvest-home.
That is, "at a time of festivity." (IV.125)

I.iii.49 HOTSPUR.

I, then all smarting with my wounds being cold,
To be so pester'd with a popinjay,
Out of my grief, and my impatience,
Answer'd, neglectingly

[But in the beginning of the speech he represents himself at this time not as "cold" but hot, and inflamed with rage and labour.

When I was dry with rage and extreme toil, &c.

I am persuaded therefore that Shakespeare wrote and pointed it thus,

I then all smarting with my wounds; being *gal'd*
To be so pester'd with a popinjay, &c. WARBURTON]

Whatever Percy might say of his "rage" and "toil," which is merely declamatory and apologetical, his wounds would at this time be certainly "cold," and when they were "cold" would "smart," and not before. If any alteration were necessary I should transpose the lines.

I then all smarting with my wounds being cold,
Out of my grief, and my impatience,

To be so pester'd with a popinjay,
 Answer'd neglectingly.
 A "popinjay" is a "parrot." (IV.126)

I.iii.74 BLUNT.

and never rise

To do him wrong, or any way impeach
 What then he said, so he unsay it now.

[To do him wrong, or any way impeach./ What then he said, *see*, he *unsays* it now. Warburton]

The learned commentator has perplexed the passage. The construction is, "Let *what he then said* never rise to impeach *him so he unsay it now*." (IV.127)

I.iii.87 KING HENRY.

Shall we buy treason? and indent with fears,
 When they have lost and forfeited themselves?

[The reason why he says, bargain and article with "fears," meaning with Mortimer, is, because he supposed Mortimer had wilfully betrayed his own forces to Glendower out of fear, as appears from his next speech. Warburton]

The difficulty seems to me to arise from this, that the King is not desired to "article" or "contract with" Mortimer, but with another "for" Mortimer. Perhaps we may read,

Shall we buy treason? and indent with *peers*,
 When they have lost and forfeited themselves?

Shall we purchase back a traitor? Shall we descend to a composition with Worcester, Northumberland, and young Percy, who by disobedience "have lost and forfeited" their honours and "themselves?" (IV.128)

I.iii.93 HOTSPUR.

Revolted Mortimer?

He never did fall off, my sovereign liege,
 But by the chance of war

["But 'bides the chance of war," i.e. he never did revolt, but "abides" the chance of war, as a prisoner. Warburton.] [Hanmer: bore.]

The plain meaning is, "He came not into the enemy's power but by the chance of war." To "'bide the chance of war" may well enough signify to "stand the hazard of a battle," but can scarcely mean to

"endure the severities of a prison." The King charged Mortimer that "he wilfully betrayed" his army, and, as he was then with the enemy, calls him "revolted Mortimer." Hotspur replies, that he never "fell off," that is, fell into Glendower's hands, "but by the chance of war." I should not have explained thus tediously a passage so hard to be mistaken, but that two editors have already mistaken it. (IV.128)

I.iii.95 HOTSPUR.

to prove that true,
Needs no more but one tongue; for all those wounds,—
Those mouthed wounds

This passage is of obscure construction. The later editors point it, as they understood that "for the wounds *a tongue* was needful, *and only one tongue*." This is harsh. I rather think it is a broken sentence. "To prove the loyalty of Mortimer," says Hotspur, "one speaking witness is sufficient, for his wounds *proclaim his loyalty*, those mouthed wounds," &c. IV.129

I.iii.103 HOTSPUR.

of swift Severn's flood;
Who then affrighted with their bloody looks,
Ran fearfully among the trembling reeds,
And hid his criske head in the hollow bank

This passage has been censured as sounding nonsense, which represents a stream of water as capable of fear. It is misunderstood. "Severn" is here not the "flood" but the tutelary power of the flood, who was frighted, and hid his head in "the hollow bank." (IV.129)

I.iii.108 HOTSPUR.

Never did bare and rotten policy
Colour her working with such deadly wounds

All the quartos which I have seen read "bare" in this place. The first folio, and all the subsequent editions, have "base." I believe "bare" is right; "never did policy lying *open* to detection so *colour* its workings." (IV.129)

I.iii.135 HOTSPUR.

But I will lift the down-trod Mortimer

["But I will lift the *downfall'n* Mortimer." The quarto of 1599 reads "down-trod Mortimer": which is better. Warburton]

All the quartos that I have seen read "down-trod," the three folios read "downfall." (IV.131)

I.iii.143 HOTSPUR.

And on my face he turn'd an eye of death

That is, "an eye *menacing* death." Hotspur seems to describe the King as trembling with rage rather than fear. (IV.131)

I.iii.183 HOTSPUR.

Revenge the jeering, and disdain'd contempt

Of this proud king

"Disdain'd" for "disdainful." (IV.132)

I.iii.201 HOTSPUR.

By heav'n, methinks, it were an easy leap,

To pluck bright honour from the pale-fac'd moon

[Warburton: "the thought is the natural movement of an heroic mind. Euripides at least thought so, when he put the very same sentiment, in the same words, into the mouth of Eteocles: 'I will not, madam, disguise my thoughts; I could scale heaven, I could descend to the very entrails of the earth, if so be that by that price I could obtain a kingdom.'"]

Though I am very far from condemning this speech with Gildon and Theobald as "absolute madness," yet I cannot find in it that profundity of reflection and beauty of allegory which the learned commentator has endeavoured to display. This sally of Hotspur may be, I think, soberly and rationally vindicated as the violent eruption of a mind inflated with ambition and fired with resentment; as the boastful clamour of a man able to do much, and eager to do more; as the hasty motion of turbulent desire; as the dark expression of indetermined thoughts. The passage from Euripides is surely not allegorical, yet it is produced, and properly, as parallel. IV.133

I.iii.208 HOTSPUR.

But out upon this half-fac'd fellowship!

[I think this finely expressed. The image is taken from one who turns from another, so as to stand before him with a side face; which implied neither a full consorting, nor a separation. Warburton]

I cannot think this word rightly explained. It alludes rather to dress. A coat is said to be "faced" when part of it, as the sleeves or bosom, is covered with something finer and more splendid than

the main substance. The mantua-makers still use the word. "Half-fac'd fellowship" is then "partnership but half adorned," partnership "which yet wants half the shew of dignities and honours." (IV.134)

I.iii.209 WORCESTER.

He apprehends a world of figures here

"Figure" is used here equivocally. As it is applied to Hotspur's speech it is a "rhetorical mode"; as opposed to "form," it means "appearance" or "shape." (IV.134)

I.iii.230 HOTSPUR.

And that same sword-and-buckler Prince of Wales

A royster, or turbulent fellow, that fought in the taverns, or raised disorders in the streets, was called a "swash-buckler." In this sense "sword-and-buckler" is used here. (IV.135)

I.iii.253 HOTSPUR.

Look, when his "infant fortune came to age"

Alluding to what passed in *King Richard*, Act II. Sc. ix. IV.135

I.iii.272 WORCESTER.

I speak not this in estimation,

As what, I think, might be; but what, I know,

Is ruminated, plotted and set down

["Estimation" for "conjecture." But between this and the foregoing verse it appears there were some lines which are now lost. WARBURTON]

If the editor had, before he wrote his note, read ten lines forward, he would have seen that nothing is omitted. Worcester gives a dark hint of a conspiracy. Hotspur "smells it," that is, "guesses it." Northumberland reproves him for not suffering Worcester to tell his design. Hotspur, according to the vehemence of his temper, still follows his own conjecture. IV.136

I.iii.278 NORTHUMBERLAND.

Before the game's a-foot, thou still lett'st slip.

"To let slip" is, to loose the greyhound. (IV.136)

I.iii.286 WORCESTER.

The King will always think him in our debt;

And think, we deem ourselves unsatisfy'd,

Till he hath found a time to pay us home.

And see already, how he doth begin
To make us strangers to his looks of love.

This is a natural description of the state of mind between those that have conferred, and those that have received, obligations too great to be satisfied.

That this would be the event of Northumberland's disloyalty was predicted by King Richard in the former play. IV.137

II.i.53 CHAMBERLAIN.

There's a franklin
"Franklin" is a little gentleman. (IV.140)

II.i.70 GADSHILL.

I am join'd with no foot-land-rakers, no long-staff-six-penny strikers, none of those mad mustachio-purple-hu'd-malt-worms

That is, with no padders, no wanderers on foot. No "long-staff six-penny strikers," no fellows that infest the road with long staffs and knock men down for sixpence. "None of those mad mustachio purple hued maltworms, none of those whose faces are red with drinking ale." (IV.141)

II.i.72 GADSHILL.

but with nobility and tranquillity; burgomasters, and great oneyers

[Theobald: moneyers]

This is a very acute and judicious attempt at emendation, and is not undeservedly adopted by Dr. Warburton. Sir Thomas Hanmer reads great "owners," not without equal or greater likelihood of truth. I know not however whether any change is necessary; Gadshill tells the Chamberlain that he is joined with no mean wretches, but with "burgomasters and great ones," or as he terms them in merriment by a cant termination, "great-oneyers," or "greatone-eers," as we say "privateer, auctioneer, circuiter." This is I fancy the whole of the matter. (IV.141)

II.i.74 GADSHILL.

such as can hold in, such as will strike sooner than speak; and speak sooner than think; and think sooner than pray

[Warburton: think, for drink.]

I am in doubt about this passage. There is yet a part unexplained. What is the meaning of "such as can hold in"? It cannot mean "such

as can keep their own secret," for they will, he says, "speak" sooner than "think": it cannot mean "such as will go calmly to work without unnecessary violence," such as is used by "long-staff strikers," for the following part will not suit with this meaning; and though we should read by transposition "such as will speak sooner than strike," the climax will not proceed regularly. I must leave it as it is.

1773: V.259

II.i.83 GADSHILL.

We steal as in a castle, cock-sure; we have the receipt of fern-seed, we walk invisible.

"Fern" is one of those plants which have their seed on the back of the leaf so small as to escape the sight. Those who perceived that "fern" was propagated by semination and yet could never see the seed, were much at a loss for a solution of the difficulty; and as wonder always endeavours to augment itself, they ascribed to "fern-seed" many strange properties, some of which the rustick virgins have not yet forgotten or exploded. (IV.142)

II.i.88 GADSHILL.

thou shalt have a share in our purchase

"Purchase" is the term used in law for any thing not inherited but acquired. 1773:(V.261)

II.i.92 GADSHILL.

Go to, *homo* is a common name to all men.

Gadshill had promised as he was a "true man," the chamber-lain wills him to promise rather as he is a "false thief"; to which Gadshill answers, that though he might have reason to change the word "true," he might have spared "man," for *homo* is a name common to all men, and among others to thieves. (IV.142)

II.ii.12 FALSTAFF.

If I travel but four foot by the square farther afoot, I shall break my wind.

[The thought is humourous, and alludes to his bulk: insinuating, that his legs being four foot asunder, when he advanced four foot, this put together made "four foot square." WARBURTON]

I am in doubt whether there is so much humour here as is suspected: "four foot by the square" is probably no more than "four foot by a rule." (IV.143)

II.ii.17 FALSTAFF.

If the rascal have not given me medicines to make me love him, I'll be hang'd

Alluding to the vulgar notion of "love-powder." (IV.143)

II.ii.21 FALSTAFF.

I'll starve, ere I'll rob a foot further.

This is only a slight error which yet has run through all the copies. We should read "rub" a foot. So we now say "rub" on.

IV.144

II.ii.35 FALSTAFF.

What a plague mean ye, to colt me thus?

"To colt" is, to fool, to trick, but the prince taking it in another sense opposes it by "uncolt," that is, "unhorse." IV.144

II.ii.42 FALSTAFF.

Go hang thy self in thy own heir-apparent garters

Alluding to the order of the garter, in which he was enrolled as heir apparent. (IV.144)

II.ii.49 POINS.

O, 'tis our setter, I know his voice. Bardolph. — What news?

GADSHILL.

Case ye, case ye

In all the copies that I have seen Poins is made to speak upon the entrance of Gadshill thus,

O, 'tis our setter, I know his voice. — Bardolph,
What news?

This is absurd; he knows Gadshill to be the "setter," and asks Bardolph "What news." To countenance this impropriety, the later editions have made Gadshill and Bardolph enter together, but the old copies bring in Gadshill alone, and we find that Falstaff, who knew their stations, calls to Bardolph among others for his horse, but not to Gadshill who was posted at a distance. We should therefore read,

POINS.

O 'tis our setter, &c.

BARD.

What news?

GADSH.

Case ye, &c. IV.145

II.III.49 LADY PERCY.

palisadoes, frontiers, parapets

For "frontiers" Sir Thomas Hanmer, and after him Dr. Warburton, read very plausibly "fortins." (IV.149)

II.III.53 LADY PERCY.

Thy spirit within thee hath been so at war,

And thus hath so bestir'd thee in thy sleep

Perhaps, "And *thought* hath so *disturb'd*." (IV.149)

II.III.74 LADY PERCY.

Out, you mad-headed ape!

This and the following speech of the lady are in the early editions printed as prose; those editions are indeed in such cases of no great authority, but perhaps they were right in this place, for some words have been left out to make the metre. IV.149

II.III.86 HOTSPUR.

Away, away, you trifler:—love! I love thee not,

I care not for thee, Kate; this is no world

To play with mammets

This I think would be better thus,

HOT.

Away, you trifler.

LADY.

Love!

HOT.

I love thee not.

This is no time, go. (IV.150)

II.III.90 HOTSPUR.

We must have bloody noses, and crack'd crowns,

And pass them current too

Signifies at once "crack'd money" and a "broken head." "Current" will apply to both; as it refers to money, its sense is well known; as

it is applied to a broken head, it insinuates that a soldier's wounds entitle him to universal reception. 1773: V.270

II.iv.10 PRINCE HENRY.

I am no proud Jack, like Falstaff, but a Corinthian
A wencher. (IV.151)

II.iv.21 PRINCE HENRY.

I give thee this penny-worth of sugar, clapt even now into my hand by an under-skinker

A tapster; an under-drawer. "Skink" is "drink," and a "skinker" is "one that serves drink at table." (IV.152)

II.iv.34 [Stage direction] Enter Francis the Drawer.

This scene, helped by the distraction of the drawer, and grimaces of the prince, may entertain upon the stage, but affords not much delight to the reader. The authour has judiciously made it short. (IV.152)

II.iv.66 PRINCE HENRY.

Wilt thou rob this leathern-jerkin, crystal-button, knot-pated, agat ring, puke-stocking, caddice-garter, smooth-tongue, Spanish-pouch.

The prince intends to ask the drawer whether he will rob his master whom he denotes by many contemptuous distinctions, of which all are easily intelligible but "puke-stocking," which may have indeed a dirty meaning, but it is not the meaning here intended, for the prince designs to mention the materials of the stocking. There is something wrong which I cannot rectify. (IV.153)

II.iv.70 PRINCE HENRY.

Why then your brown bastard is your only drink

"Bastard" was a kind of sweet wine. The prince finding the drawer not able, or not willing to understand his instigation, puzzles him with unconnected prattle, and drives him away.

IV.153

II.iv.98 PRINCE HENRY.

I am not yet of Percy's mind, the hotspur of the north; he that kills me some six or seven dozen of Scots at breakfast, washes his hands and says to his wife, "Fy upon this quiet life! I want work."

The drawer's answer had interrupted the prince's train of discourse. He was proceeding thus, "I am now of all humours that have

shewed themselves humours—I am not yet of Percy’s mind.” That is, “I am willing to indulge myself in gaiety and frolick, and try all the varieties of human life. I am not yet of Percy’s mind,” who thinks all the time lost that is not spent in bloodshed, forgets decency and civility, and has nothing but the barren talk of a brutal soldier. (IV.154)

II.iv.107 PRINCE HENRY.

“Ribi,” says the drunkard.

“Ribi,” that is, “drink.” HANMER. All the former editions have “rivo,” which certainly had no meaning, but yet was perhaps the cant of English taverns. (IV.155)

II.iv.117 FALSTAFF.

You rogue, here’s lime in this sack too
[Warburton: Spanish wine.]

Dr. Warburton does not consider that “sack” in Shakespeare is most probably thought to mean what we now call “sherry,” which when it is drank is still drank with sugar. 1773: V.278

II.iv.125 FALSTAFF.

I would, I were a weaver; I could sing all manner of songs.

In the first editions the passage is read thus, “I could sing psalms or any thing.” In the first folio thus, “I could sing all manner of songs.” Many expressions bordering on indecency or profaneness are found in the first editions, which are afterwards corrected. The reading of the three last editions, “I could sing psalms and all manner of songs,” is made without authority out of different copies.

I believe nothing more is here meant than to allude to the practice of weavers, who having their hands more employed than their minds, amuse themselves frequently with songs at the loom. The knight, being full of vexation, wishes he could sing to divert his thoughts.

“Weavers” are mentioned as lovers of musick in the *Merchant of Venice*. Perhaps “to sing like a weaver” might be proverbial. (IV.157)

II.iv.207 FALSTAFF.

Their points being broken—

POINS.

Down fell his hose.

To understand Poins’s joke the double meaning of “point” must be remembered, which signifies “the sharp end of a weapon,” and “the

lace of a garment." The cleanly phrase for letting down the hose, *ad levandum alvum*, was "to untruss a point." (IV.159)

II.iv.220 PRINCE HENRY.

thou whorson obscene greasie tallow-catch

This word is in all the editions, but having no meaning, cannot be understood. In some parts of the kingdom, a "cake" or "mass" of wax or tallow, is called a "keech," which is doubtless the word intended here, unless we read "tallow-ketch," that is, "tub of tallow." (IV.160)

II.iv.237 FALSTAFF.

Away, you starveling, you elf-skin

For "elf-skin" Sir T. Hanmer and Dr. Warburton read "eelskin." The true reading, I believe, is "elfkin," or "little fairy." For though the Bastard in *King John* compares his brother's "legs" to "two eelskins stuff'd," yet an "eelskin" simply bears no great resemblance to a man. (IV.160)

II.iv.278 HOSTESS.

Marry, my lord, there is a nobleman of the court at door would speak with you; he says, he comes from your father.

PRINCE HENRY.

Give him as much as will make him a royal man, and send him back again to my mother.

I believe here is a kind of jest intended. He that had received a "noble" was, in cant language, called a "nobleman": in this sense the Prince catches the word, and bids the landlady "give him as much as will make him a royal man," that is, a "real" or "royal" man, and send him away. (IV.162)

II.iv.300 BARDOLPH.

Yea, and to tickle our noses with speargrass, to make them bleed; and then beslobber our garments with it, and swear it was the blood of true men.

That is, of the men with whom they fought, of "honest men," opposed to thieves. (IV.163)

II.iv.307 PRINCE HENRY.

Thou hadst fire and sword on thy side

The "fire" was in his face. A red face is termed a "fiery face."

While I affirm a *fiery face*

Is to the owner no disgrace.

Legend of Capt. Jones.

IV.163

II.iv.314 PRINCE HENRY.

Hot livers, and cold purses.

That is "drunkenness" and "poverty." To "drink" was, in the language of those times, to "heat the liver." (IV.163)

II.iv.317 PRINCE HENRY.

How now, my sweet creature of bombast?

"Bombast" is the stuffing of cloaths. (IV.163)

II.iv.335 PRINCE HENRY.

He that rides at high speed, and with a pistol kills a sparrow flying.

Shakespeare never has any care to preserve the manners of the time. "Pistols" were not known in the age of Henry. Pistols were, I believe, about our authour's time, eminently used by the Scots. Sir Henry Wotton somewhere makes mention of a "Scotish pistol." (IV.164)

II.iv.346 FALSTAFF.

well, he is there too, and one Mordake, and a thousand blue caps more.

A name of ridicule given to the Scots from their blue "bonnets." (IV.164)

II.iv.349 FALSTAFF.

You may buy land now as cheap as stinking mackerel.

In former times the prosperity of the nation was known by the value of land as now by the price of stocks. Before Henry the Seventh made it safe to serve the king regnant, it was the practice at every revolution for the conqueror to confiscate the estates of those that opposed, and perhaps of those who did not assist him. Those, therefore, that foresaw a change of government, and thought their estates in danger, were desirous to sell them in haste for something that might be carried away.

IV.165

II.iv.369 PRINCE HENRY.

Thy state is taken for a joint-stool, thy golden scepter for a leaden dagger, and thy precious rich crown for a pitiful bald crown.

This answer might, I think, have better been omitted. It contains only a repetition of Falstaff's mock-royalty. (IV.165)

II.iv.375 FALSTAFF.

I will do it in King Cambyses' vein.

[A lamentable tragedy, mixed full of pleasant mirth, containing the life of Cambyses King of Persia. By Thomas Preston. THEOBALD]

I question if Shakespeare had ever seen this tragedy; for there is a remarkable peculiarity of measure, which, when he professed to speak in "King Cambyses' vein," he would hardly have missed, if he had known it. (IV.166)

II.iv.377 PRINCE HENRY.

Well, here is my leg.

That is, my "obeisance" to my father. (IV.166)

II.iv.387 FALSTAFF.

Harry, I do not only marvel, where thou spendest thy time, but also, how thou art accompany'd; for though the camomile, the more it is trodden on, the faster it grows, yet youth, the more it is wasted, the sooner it wears.

This whole speech is supremely comick. The simile of camomile used to illustrate a contrary effect, brings to my remembrance an observation of a later writer of some merit, whom the desire of being witty has betrayed into a like thought. Meaning to enforce with great vehemence the mad temerity of young soldiers, he remarks, that "though Bedlam be in the road to Hogsden, it is out of the way to promotion."

IV.166

II.iv.395 FALSTAFF.

Shall the blessed sun of heav'n prove a micher, and eat blackberries?

The allusion is to a truant-boy, who, unwilling to go to school, and afraid to go home, lurks in the fields, and picks wild fruits. IV.166

II.iv.413 FALSTAFF.

If then the fruit may be known by the tree

This passage is happily restored by Sir Thomas Hanmer.

IV.167

II.iv.421 FALSTAFF.

hang me up by the heels for a rabbet-sucker, or a poulterer's hare.
 "Rabbit-sucker" is, I suppose, a "sucking rabbit." The jest is in comparing himself to something thin and little. So a "poulterer's hare," a hare hung up by the hind legs without a skin, is long and slender. (IV.167)

II.iv.433 PRINCE HENRY.

Why dost thou converse with that trunk of humours, that boulding hutch of beastliness

"Bolting-hutch" is, I think, a "meal-bag." (IV.168)

II.iv.436 PRINCE HENRY.

that roasted Manning-tree ox with the pudding in his belly
 Of the "Manning-tree OX" I can give no account, but the meaning is clear. (IV.168)

II.iv.439 PRINCE HENRY.

Wherein is he good, but to taste sack and drink it? wherein neat and cleanly, but to carve a capon and eat it? wherein cunning, but in craft?

"Cunning" was not yet debased to a bad meaning. It signified "knowing" or "skilful." (IV.168)

II.iv.444 FALSTAFF.

I would, your Grace would take me with you.

That is, "go no faster than I can follow you. Let me know your meaning." (IV.168)

II.iv.482 PRINCE HENRY.

Go, hide thee behind the arras

The bulk of Falstaff made him not the fittest to be concealed behind the hangings, but every poet sacrifices something to the scenery; if Falstaff had not been hidden he could not have been found asleep, nor had his pockets searched. (IV.170)

II.iv.508 PRINCE HENRY.

This oily rascal is known as well as Paul's; go call him forth.

PETO.

Falstaff—fast asleep, behind the arras, and snorting like a horse.

The scenery here is somewhat perplexed. When the sheriff came, the whole gang retired, and Falstaff was hidden. As soon as the sher-

iff is sent away the Prince orders Falstaff to be called: by whom? by Peto. But why had not Peto gone up stairs with the rest, and if he had, why did not the rest come down with him? The conversation that follows between the Prince and Peto, seems to be apart from the others.

I cannot but suspect that for "Peto" we should read "Poins": what had Peto done that "his place should be honourable," or that he should be trusted with the plot against Falstaff? Poins has the Prince's confidence, and is a man of courage.

This alteration clears the whole difficulty, they all retired but Poins, who, with the Prince, having only robbed the robbers, had no need to conceal himself from the travellers. We may therefore boldly change the scenical direction thus, "*Exeunt* Falstaff, Bardolph, Gadshill, *and* Peto; *manent* the Prince *and* Poins." (IV.171)

III.I.25 HOTSPUR.

O, then the earth shook to see the heav'ns on fire,
And not in fear of your nativity.
Diseased Nature oftentimes breaks forth
In strange eruptions; and the teeming earth
Is with a kind of colick pinch'd and vext,
By the imprisoning of unruly wind
Within her womb

The poet has here taken, from the perverseness and contrariousness of Hotspur's temper, an opportunity of raising his character, by a very rational and philosophical confutation of superstitious error. (IV.173)

III.I.96 HOTSPUR.

Methinks, my moiety, north from Burton here,
In quantity equals not one of yours.

[Hotspur is here just such a divider as the Irishman who made "three halves": therefore, for the honour of Shakespeare, I will suppose, with the Oxford editor, that he wrote "portion." WARBURTON]

I will not suppose it. (IV.175)

III.I.123 GLENDOWER.

I framed to the harp
Many an English ditty, lovely well,
And gave the tongue a helpful ornament

The English language. (IV.176)

III.I.166 MORTIMER.

Exceedingly well read, and profited
In strange concealments
Skilled in wonderful secrets. (IV.177)

III.I.177 WORCESTER.

In faith, my lord, you are too wilful blame
This is a mode of speech with which I am not acquainted. Perhaps
it might be read "too wilful-blunt," or "too wilful-bent," or thus,
Indeed, my lord, you are to blame, too wilful. IV.178

III.I.213 GLENDOWER.

All on the wanton rushes lay you down
It was the custom in this country, for many ages, to strew the floors
with rushes as we now cover them with carpets. IV.179

III.I.218 GLENDOWER.

Making such difference betwixt wake and sleep,
As is the difference betwixt day and night
She will lull you by her song into soft tranquillity, in which you
shall be so near to sleep as to be free from perturbation, and so much
awake as to be sensible of pleasure; a state partaking of sleep and
wakefulness, as the twilight of night and day. (IV.179)

III.I.222 MORTIMER.

With all my heart I'll sit, and hear her sing:
By that time will our book, I think, be drawn.
Our paper of conditions. (IV.179)

III.I.238 LADY PERCY.

Would'st have thy head broken?

HOTSPUR.

No.

LADY PERCY.

Then be still.

HOTSPUR.

Neither. 'Tis a woman's fault.
I do not plainly see what is "a woman's fault." (IV.180)

III.I.255 HOTSPUR.

leave "insooth,"

And such protest of pepper-ginger-bread,
To velvet-guards, and Sunday-citizens.

To such as have their cloaths adorned with shreds of velvet, which was, I suppose, the finery of Cockneys. (IV.181)

III.I.259 LADY PERCY.

I will not sing.

HOTSPUR.

'Tis the next way to turn tailor

I suppose Percy means, that "singing" is a mean quality, and therefore he excuses his lady. (IV.181)

III.II.22 PRINCE HENRY.

Yet such extenuation let me beg,
As, in reproof of many tales devis'd,
Which oft the ear of greatness needs must hear,
By smiling pick-thanks and base news-mongers,
I may for some things true wherein my youth
Hath faulty wander'd and irregular,
Find pardon on my true submission.

The construction is somewhat obscure. Let me beg so much extenuation, that, "upon confutation of many false charges, I may be pardoned some that are true." I should read "on reproof" instead of "in reproof," but concerning Shakespeare's particles there is no certainty. (IV.182)

III.II.42 KING HENRY.

Opinion, that did help me to the crown,
Had still kept loyal to possession

"True" to "him" that had then "possession" of the crown. IV.183

III.II.60 KING HENRY.

The skipping King, he ambled up and down
With shallow jesters, and rash bavin wits

"Rash" is "heady, thoughtless." "Bavin" is "brushwood," which, fired, burns fiercely, but is soon out. (IV.183)

III.ii.65 KING HENRY.

And gave his countenance, against his name
Made his presence injurious to his reputation. (IV.184)

III.ii.66 KING HENRY.

To laugh at gybing boys, and stand the push
Of every beardless, vain comparative
Of every boy whose vanity incited him to try his wit against the King's.

When Lewis XIV was asked, why, with so much wit, he never attempted raillery, he answered, that he who practised raillery ought to bear it in his turn, and that to stand the butt of raillery was not suitable to the dignity of a king. Scudery's *Conversation*. (IV.184)

III.ii.98 KING HENRY.

He hath more worthy interest to the state,
Than thou, the shadow of succession!

This is obscure. I believe the meaning is, — Hotspur hath a right to the kingdom more worthy than thou, who hast only the "shadowy right of lineal succession," while he has real and solid power. (IV.185)

III.ii.123 KING HENRY.

Which art my near'st and dearest enemy?
"Dearest" is "most fatal, most mischievous." (IV.186)

III.ii.136 PRINCE HENRY.

And stain my favours in a bloody mask
[We should read "favour," i.e. countenance. Warburton]
"Favours" are "features." (IV.186)

III.iii.8 FALSTAFF.

I am a pepper-corn, a brewer's horse.
I suppose a "brewer's" horse was apt to be lean with hard work. (IV.188)

III.iii.26 FALSTAFF.

thou art the knight of the burning lamp.
This is a natural picture. Every man who feels in himself the pain of deformity, however, like this merry knight, he may affect to make sport with it among those whom it is his interest to please, is ready to revenge any hint of contempt upon one whom he can use with freedom. (IV.188)

III.iii.43 FALSTAFF.

but the sack, that thou hast drunk me, would have bought me lights as good cheap

Cheap is "market," and "good cheap" therefore is a *bon marché*. (IV.189)

III.iii.76 FALSTAFF.

How! poor? look upon his face: what call you rich? let him coin his nose, let him coin his cheeks: I'll not pay a denier.

A face set with carbuncles is called a "rich" face. *Legend of Capt. Jones*. (IV.190)

III.iii.87 FALSTAFF.

How now, lad? is the wind in that door? must we all march?

BARDOLPH.

Yea, two and two, Newgate fashion.

As prisoners are conveyed to Newgate, fastened two and two together. (IV.190)

III.iii.112 FALSTAFF.

There's no more faith in thee than in a stew'd prune; no more truth in thee than in a drawn fox

The propriety of these similies I am not sure that I fully understand. A "stewed prune" has the appearance of a prune, but has no taste. A "drawn fox," that is, an "exenterated fox," has the form of a fox without his powers. I think Dr. Warburton's explication wrong, which makes a "drawn fox" to mean, a fox "often hunted"; though to "draw" is a hunters term for persuit by the track. My interpretation makes the "fox" suit better to the "prune." These are very slender disquisitions, but such is the task of a commentator. (IV.191)

III.iii.114 FALSTAFF.

Maid Marian may be the deputy's wife of the ward to thee.

Maid Marian is a man dressed like a woman, who attends the dancers of the morris. (IV.191)

III.iii.156 PRINCE HENRY.

impudent, imboss'd rascal

"Imbossed" is "swoln, puffy." (IV.193)

III.III.161 PRINCE HENRY.

And yet you will stand to it, you will not pocket up wrongs. Art thou not asham'd?

Some part of this merry dialogue seems to have been lost. I suppose Falstaff in pressing the robbery upon his hostess, had declared his resolution "not to pocket up wrongs or injuries," to which the prince alludes. (IV.193)

III.III.196 PRINCE HENRY.

Peto, to horse; for thou and I have thirty miles to ride yet ere dinner-time.

I cannot but think that "Peto" is again put for "Poins." I suppose the copy had only a "P—." We have Peto afterwards, not riding with the Prince, but lieutenant to Falstaff. (IV.194)

IV.I.34 HOTSPUR.

To lay so dangerous and dear a trust
On any soul remov'd, but on his own.

On any "less near" to himself; on any whose interest is "remote." (IV.196)

IV.I.49 HOTSPUR.

therein should we read
The very bottom, and the soul of hope,
The very list, the very utmost bound
Of all our fortunes.

To read "the bottom and soul of hope, and the bound of fortune," though all the copies and all the editors have received it, surely cannot be right. I can think on no other word than "risque."

Therein should we *risque*
The very bottom, &c.

The "list" is the "selvage"; figuratively, the utmost line of circumference, the utmost extent. If we should with less change read "rend," it will only suit with "list," not the "soul," or "bottom." (IV.196)

IV.I.56 DOWGLAS.

A comfort of retirement lives in this.

A support to which we may have recourse. (IV.196)

IV.1.61 WORCESTER.

The quality and hair of our attempt
Brooks no division

The "hair" seems to be "the complexion, the character." The metaphor appears harsh to us, but, perhaps, was familiar in our author's time. We still say, something is "against the hair," as "against the grain," that is, against the natural tendency. (IV.197)

IV.1.69 WORCESTER.

For well you know, we of th' offending side
Must keep aloof from strict arbitrement

All the later editions have this reading, but all the older copies which I have seen, from the first quarto to the edition of Rowe, read, "we of the *offring* side." Of this reading the sense is obscure, and therefore the change has been made; but since neither "offering" nor "offending" are words likely to be mistaken, I cannot but suspect that "offering" is right, especially as it is read in the first copy of 1599, which is more correctly printed than any single edition, that I have yet seen, of a play written by Shakespeare.

The "offering" side may signify that party, which, acting in opposition to the law, strengthens itself only by "offers"; encreases its numbers only by "promises." The King can raise an army, and continue it by threats of punishment; but those, whom no man is under any obligation to obey, can gather forces only by "offers" of advantage: and it is truly remarked, that they, whose influence arises from "offers," must keep danger out of sight.

The "offering side" may mean simply the "assailant," in opposition to the "defendant," and it is likewise true of him that "offers" war, or makes an invasion, that his cause ought to be kept clear from all objections. (IV.197)

IV.1.97 VERNON.

All furnisht, all in arms,
All plum'd like estridges, that with the wind
Baited like eagles, having lately bath'd

"To bait with the wind" appears to me an improper expression. To "bait" is in the style of falconry, to "beat the wing," from the French *battre*, that is, to flutter in preparation for flight.

Besides, what is the meaning of “estridges, that baited with the wind like eagles”; for the relative “that,” in the usual construction, must relate to “estridges.”

Sir Thomas Hanmer reads,
All plum’d like estridges, *and with the wind*
Baiting like eagles.

By which he has escaped part of the difficulty, but has yet left impropriety sufficient to make his reading questionable.

I read,
All furnish’d, all in arms,
All plum’d like estridges that *wing* the wind
Baited like eagles.

This gives a strong image. They were not only plum’d like estridges, but their plumes fluttered like those of an estridge on the wing mounting against the wind. A more lively representation of young men ardent for enterprize perhaps no writer has ever given. (IV.198)

IV.I.104 VERNON.

I saw young Harry, with his beaver on
[Warburton: beaver, visor; beaver up.]

There is no need of all this note, for “beaver” may be a “helmet”; or the prince, trying his armour, might wear his beaver down. (IV.199)

IV.I.105 VERNON.

His cuisses on his thighs, gallantly arm’d

The reason why his “cuisses” are so particularly mentioned, I conceive to be, that his horsemanship is here praised, and the “cuisses” are that part of armour which most hinders a horseman’s activity. (IV.199)

IV.I.122 HOTSPUR.

Harry to Harry shall, hot horse to horse—
Meet, and ne’er part

This reading I have restored from the first edition. The edition in 1623, reads,

Harry to Harry shall, not horse to horse,
Meet, and ne’er part.

which has been followed by all the criticks except Sir Tho. Hanmer, who, justly remarking the impertinence of the negative, reads,

Harry to Harry shall, *and* horse to horse,

Meet, and ne'er part.

But the unexampled expression of "meeting to," for "meeting with" or simply "meeting," is yet left. The ancient reading is surely right. (IV.200)

IV.ii.9 FALSTAFF.

Bid my lieutenant Peto meet me at the town's end.

This passage proves that Peto did not go with the Prince.

IV.201

IV.ii.11 FALSTAFF.

I am a sowc'd gurnet.

I believe a "sowced gurnet" is a "pickled anchovy." Much of Falstaff's humour consists in comparing himself to somewhat little. (IV.201)

IV.ii.19 FALSTAFF.

worse than a struck fowl, or a hurt wild duck.

The repetition of the same image disposed Sir Tho. Hanmer, and after him Dr. Warburton, to read, in opposition to all the copies, a struck "deer," which is indeed a proper expression, but not likely to have been corrupted. Shakespeare, perhaps, wrote a struck "sorel," which, being negligently read by a man not skilled in hunter's language, was easily changed to struck "fowl." "Sorel" is used in *Love's Labour Lost* for a young "deer," and the terms of the chase were, in our authour's time, familiar to the ears of every gentleman. (IV.201)

IV.ii.27 FALSTAFF.

younger sons to younger brothers

Raleigh, in his discourse on "war," uses this very expression for men of desperate fortune and wild adventure. Which borrowed it from the other I know not, but I think the play was printed before the discourse. (IV.202)

IV.ii.29 FALSTAFF.

ten times more dishonourably ragged, than an old-feast ancient
[Warburton: old-feast ancient.]

Dr. Warburton's emendation is very acute and judicious, but I know not whether the licentiousness of our authour's diction may not allow us to suppose that he meant to represent his soldiers, as "more ragged," though less honourably ragged, "than an old ancient." (IV.202)

IV.ii.63 FALSTAFF.

Tut, tut, good enough to toss: food for powder, food for powder
That is, to toss upon a pike. (IV.204)

IV.iii.17 VERNON.

Being men of such great leading as you are
Such "conduct," such experience in martial business. IV.205

IV.iii.77 HOTSPUR.

Upon the naked shore at Ravenspurg.
In this whole speech he alludes again to some passages in *Richard the Second*. (IV.207)

IV.iii.92 HOTSPUR.

task'd the whole state.
I suppose it should be, "tax'd" the whole state. (IV.207)

IV.iii.102 HOTSPUR.

And in conclusion drove us to seek out
This head of safety
This "army" from which I hope for protection. (IV.207)

IV.iv.14 YORK.

What with the sickness of Northumberland,
Whose pow'r was in the first proportion
Whose quota was larger than that of any other man in the confederacy. (IV.208)

IV.iv.17 YORK.

Who with them was a rated sinew too
"A rated sinew" signifies a "strength" on which we "reckoned"; a help of which we "made account." (IV.208)

V.i.1 [Stage direction] The Camp at Shrewsbury.

It seems proper to be remarked, that in the editions printed while the authour lived, this play is not broken into acts. The division which was made by the players in the first folio seems commodious enough, but, being without authority, may be changed by any editor who thinks himself able to make a better. (IV.210)

V.i.3 PRINCE HENRY.

The southern wind
Doth play the trumpet to his purposes

That is, to “the sun’s,” to that which the sun portends by his unusual appearance. (IV.210)

V.I.34 WORCESTER.

For you, my staff of office I did break
In Richard’s time.
See *Richard the Second*. (IV.212)

V.I.59 WORCESTER.

And being fed by us, you us’d us so,
As that ungentle gull, the cuckow’s bird,
Useth the sparrow, did oppress our nest
The cuckow’s chicken, who, being hatched and fed by the sparrow,
in whose nest the cuckow’s egg was laid, grows in time able to devour
her nurse. (IV.212)

V.I.89 PRINCE HENRY.

I do not think a braver gentleman,
More active-valiant, or more valiant-young,
More daring, or more bold, is now alive
Sir T. Hanmer reads, “more *valued* young.” I think the present gingle has more of Shakespeare. (IV.213)

V.II.8 WORCESTER.

Suspicion, all our lives, shall be stuck full of eyes
The same image of “suspicion” is exhibited in a Latin tragedy,
called *Roxana*, written about the same time by Dr. William Alabaster.
(IV.215)

V.II.16 WORCESTER.

My nephew’s trespass may be well forgot,
It hath th’ excuse of youth and heat of blood;
And an adopted name of privilege,
A hair-brain’d Hot-spur, govern’d by a spleen
The name of Hotspur will privilege him from censure. IV.216

V.II.42 DOWGLAS.

for I have thrown
A brave defiance in King Henry’s teeth,
And Westmorland, that was ingag’d, did bear it

"Engag'd" is, "delivered as an hostage." A few lines before, upon the return of Worcester, he orders Westmorland to be dismissed. (IV.217)

V.ii.60 VERNON.

By still dispraising praise, valu'd with you.

[This foolish line is indeed in the Folio of 1623, but it is evidently the players' nonsense. WARBURTON]

This line is not only in the first folio, but in all the editions before it that I have seen. Why it should be censured as nonsense, I know not. To vilify praise, compared or "valued" with merit superiour to praise, is no harsh expression. There is another objection to be made. Prince Henry, in his challenge of Percy, had indeed commended him, but with no such hyperboles as might represent him above praise, and there seems to be no reason why Vernon should magnify the Prince's candour beyond the truth. Did then Shakespeare forget the foregoing scene? or are some lines lost from the Prince's speech? (IV.217)

V.ii.71 HOTSPUR.

never did I hear

Of any prince, so wild, at liberty.

Of any prince that played such pranks, and was not confined as a madman. (IV.218)

V.iii.30 FALSTAFF.

Though I could 'scape shot free at London, I fear the shot here

A play upon "shot," as it means the "part of a reckoning," and a "missive weapon discharged from artillery." (IV.220)

V.iii.33 FALSTAFF.

here's no vanity!

[In our author's time the "negative," in common speech, was used to design, ironically, the excess of a thing. WARBURTON]

I am in doubt whether this interpretation, though ingenious and well supported, is true. The words may mean, here is real honour, "no vanity," or "no empty appearance." IV.220

V.iii.45 FALSTAFF.

I have paid Percy, I have made him sure.

PRINCE HENRY.

He is, indeed, and living to kill thee

The Prince's answer, which is apparently connected with Falstaff's last words, does not cohere so well as if the knight had said,

I have made him sure; *Percy's safe enough.*

Perhaps a word or two like these may be lost. (IV.221)

V.III.48 FALSTAFF.

Nay, Hal, if Percy be alive, thou get'st not my sword, but take my pistol, if thou wilt.

PRINCE HENRY.

Give it me. What, is it in the case?

FALSTAFF.

Ay, Hal, 'tis hot. There's that will sack a city.

[The Prince draws it out, and finds it a bottle of sack.]

A quibble on the word "sack." 1773:(V.353)

V.III.54 FALSTAFF.

If Percy be alive, I'll pierce him.

[Warburton: He'll pierce him.]

I rather take the conceit to be this. To "pierce a vessel" is to "tap" it. Falstaff takes up his bottle which the Prince had tossed at his head, and being about to animate himself with a draught, cries, "if Percy be alive I'll pierce him," and so draws the cork. I do not propose this with much confidence.

IV.222

V.III.56 FALSTAFF.

let him make a carbonado of me.

A "carbonado" is a piece of meat cut crosswise for the gridiron. (IV.222)

V.IV.77 HOTSPUR.

I better brook the loss of brittle life,

Than those proud titles thou hast won of me,

They wound my thoughts, worse than thy sword my flesh;

But thought's the slave of life, and life time's fool,

And time, that takes survey of all the world,

Must have a stop.

Hotspur in his last moments endeavours to console himself. The glory of the Prince "wounds his thoughts," but "thought," being "dependent on life," must cease with it, and will soon be at an end. "Life," on which "thought" depends, is itself of no great value, being the "fool" and sport of "time"; of "time" which, with all its dominion over sublunary things, "must" itself at last "be stopped." (IV.225)

V.iv.88 PRINCE HENRY.

Ill-weav'd ambition, how much art thou shrunk!

A metaphor taken from cloath, which "shrinks" when it is "ill-weav'd," when its texture is loose. (IV.226)

V.iv.89 PRINCE HENRY.

When that this body did contain a spirit,

A kingdom for it was too small a bound

Carminibus confide bonis—jacet ecce Tibullus

Vix manet e toto parva quod urna capit. Ovid

IV.226

V.iv.96 PRINCE HENRY.

But let my favours hide thy mangled face

[We should read "favour," face or countenance. He stooping down here to kiss Hotspur. Warburton]

He rather covers his face with a scarf to hide the ghastliness of death. (IV.226)

V.iv.107 PRINCE HENRY.

Death hath not struck so fair a deer to day

This is the reading of the first edition, and of the other quartos. The first folio has "fat," which was followed by all the editors.

There is in these lines a very natural mixture of the serious and ludicrous produced by the view of Percy and Falstaff. I wish all play on words had been forborn. (IV.226)

V.iv.111 FALSTAFF.

Imbowell'd!—if thou imbowel me to day,

I'll give you leave to powder me, and eat me to morrow!

"To powder" is "to salt." (IV.227)

V.iv.137 FALSTAFF.

No, that's certain; I am not a double man

That is, I am not Falstaff and Percy together, though having Percy on my back, I seem double. (IV.228)

V.v.32 LANCASTER.

I thank your Grace for this high courtesie,

Which I shall give away immediately.

[These two lines are added from the quarto. POPE]

I suspect that they were rejected by Shakespeare himself. IV.229

HENRY IV, PART 2

Mr. Upton thinks these two plays improperly called *The First and Second Parts of Henry the Fourth*. The first play ends, he says, with the peaceful settlement of Henry in the kingdom by the defeat of the rebels. This is hardly true, for the rebels are not yet finally suppressed. The second, he tells us, shews Henry the Fifth in the various lights of a good-natured rake, till, on his father's death, he assumes a more manly character. This is true; but this representation gives us no idea of a dramattick action. These two plays will appear to every reader, who shall peruse them without ambition of critical discoveries, to be so connected that the second is merely a sequel to the first; to be two only because they are too long to be one. (IV.235)

INDUCTION.1 RUMOUR.

Open your ears; for which of you will stop
The vent of hearing, when loud Rumour speaks?

This speech of Rumour is not inelegant or unpoetical, but is wholly useless, since we are told nothing which the first scene does not clearly and naturally discover. The only end of such prologues is to inform the audience of some facts previous to the action, of which they can have no knowledge from the persons of the drama. (IV.233)

INDUCTION.15 RUMOUR.

Rumour is a pipe
Blown by surmises, jealousies, conjectures
Here the poet imagines himself describing Rumour, and forgets that Rumour is the speaker. (IV.233)

I.1.44 TRAVERS.

struck his agile heels
Against the panting sides of his poor jade
Up to the rowel-head
I think that I have observed in old prints the "rowel" of those times to have been only a single spike. (IV.237)

I.1.53 LORD BARDOLPH.

Upon mine honour, for a silken point
I'll give my barony.
A "point" is a "string tagged," or "lace." (IV.237)

I.1.91 MORTON.

You are too great, to be by me gainsaid:

Your spirit is too true, your fears too certain.

The impression upon your mind, by which you conceive the death
of your son. (IV.239)

I.1.93 NORTHUMBERLAND.

Yet for all this, say not, that Percy's dead.

I see a strange confession in thine eye,

Thou shak'st thy head, and hold'st it fear, or sin,

To speak a truth. If he be slain, say so.

The tongue offends not, that reports his death;

And he doth sin, that doth belie the dead,

Not he, which says the dead is not alive.

Yet the first bringer of unwelcome news

Hath but a losing office, and his tongue

Sounds ever after as a sullen bell,

Remember'd, tolling a departing friend.

The contradiction in the first part of this speech might be imputed to the distraction of Northumberland's mind, but the calmness of the reflection, contained in the last lines, seems not much to countenance such a supposition. I will venture to distribute this passage in a manner which will, I hope, seem more commodious, but do not wish the reader to forget, that the most commodious is not always the true reading.

BARD.

Yet for all this, say not that Percy's dead.

NORTH.

I see a strange confession in thine eye,

Thou shak'st thy head, and holdst it fear, or sin,

To speak a truth. If he be slain, say so.

The tongue offends not, that reports his death;

And he doth sin, that doth belie the dead,

Not he that saith the dead is not alive.

MORTON.

Yet the first bringer of unwelcome news

Hath but a losing office, and his tongue

Sounds ever after as a sullen bell,

Remember'd, tolling a departing friend.

Here is a natural interposition of Bardolph at the beginning, who is not pleased to hear his news confuted, and a proper preparation of Morton for the tale which he is unwilling to tell. (IV.239)

I.1.96 NORTHUMBERLAND.

If he be slain, say so.

The words "say so" are in the first folio, but not in the quarto: they are necessary to the verse, but the sense proceeds as well without them. (IV.240)

I.1.116 MORTON.

For from his metal was his party steel'd;
Which once in him abated, all the rest
Turn'd on themselves, like dull and heavy lead.
[Warburton: rebated.]

Here is a great effort to produce little effect. The commentator does not seem fully to understand the word "abated," which is not here put for the general idea of "diminished," nor for the notion of "blunted" as applied to a single edge, but for "reduced to a lower temper," or as the workmen now call it, "let down." It is very proper. (IV.240)

I.1.127 MORTON.

The bloody Dowglas, whose well-labouring sword
Had three times slain th' appearance of the King,
'Gan vail his stomach

Began to fall his courage, to let his spirits sink under his fortune.
(IV.241)

I.1.157 NORTHUMBERLAND.

But let one spirit of the first-born Cain
Reign in all bosoms, that each heart being set
On bloody courses, the rude scene may end,
And darkness be the burier of the dead!

The conclusion of this noble speech is extremely striking. There is no need to suppose it exactly philosophical, "darkness" in poetry may be absence of eyes as well as privation of light. Yet we may remark, that by an ancient opinion it has been held, that if the human race, for whom the world was made, were extirpated, the whole system of sublunary nature would cease. (IV.242)

I.i.166 MORTON.

You cast th' event of war, my noble lord

[The fourteen lines from hence to Bardolph's next speech, are not to be found in the first editions till that in Folio of 1623. A very great number of other lines in this play are inserted after the first edition in like manner, but of such spirit and mastery generally, that the insertions are plainly by Shakespeare himself. POPE]

To this note I have nothing to add, but that the editor speaks of more editions than I believe him to have seen, there having been but one edition yet discovered by me that precedes the first folio. (IV.242)

I.i.207 MORTON.

he doth bestride a bleeding land

That is, stands over his country to defend her as she lies bleeding on the ground. So Falstaff before says to the Prince, "If thou see me down, Hal, and *bestride* me, so; it is an office of friendship." (IV.244)

I.ii.14 FALSTAFF.

Thou whorson mandrake

"Mandrake" is a root supposed to have the shape of a man; it is now counterfeited with the root of briony. (IV.245)

I.ii.15 FALSTAFF.

I was never mann'd with an agate till now

That is, I never before had an agate for my "man." (IV.245)

I.ii.23 FALSTAFF.

he may keep it still as a face-royal

That is, a face exempt from the touch of vulgar hands. So a "stag-royal" is not to be hunted, a "mine-royal" is not to be dug. (IV.245)

I.ii.34 FALSTAFF.

to bear a gentleman in hand, and then stand upon "security."

"To bear in hand," is "to keep in expectation." (IV.246)

I.ii.37 FALSTAFF.

and if a man is thorough with them in honest taking up, then they must stand upon "security."

That is, "If a man by *taking up* goods" is in their debt. "To be thorough" seems to be the same with the present phrase, "to be in with" a tradesman. (IV.246)

I.ii.85 FALSTAFF.

You hunt-counter, hence; avaunt.

That is, "blunderer." He does not, I think, allude to any relation between the judge's servant and the counter-prison. IV.248

I.ii.137 FALSTAFF.

The young prince hath mis-led me. I am the fellow with the great belly, and he my dog.

I do not understand this joke. Dogs lead the blind, but why does a dog lead the fat? (IV.249)

I.ii.147 CHIEF JUSTICE.

What? you are as a candle, the better part burnt out.

FALSTAFF.

A wassel candle, my lord; all tallow; but if I did say of wax, my growth would approve the truth.

A "wassel candle" is a large candle lighted up at a feast. There is a poor quibble upon the word "wax," which signifies "encrease" as well as the "matter of the honeycomb." (IV.250)

I.ii.158 FALSTAFF.

and yet, in some respects, I grant, I cannot go; I cannot tell.

I cannot be taken in a reckoning; I cannot pass current. IV.250

I.ii.159 FALSTAFF.

Virtue is of so little regard in these costermongers' days

In these times when the prevalence of trade has produced that meanness that rates the merit of every thing by money. IV.250

I.ii.172 CHIEF JUSTICE.

Is not your voice broken? your wind short? your chin double? your wit single?

We call a man "single-witted" who attains but one species of knowledge. This sense I know not how to apply to Falstaff, and rather think that the Chief Justice hints at a calamity always incident to a gray-haired wit, whose misfortune is, that his merriment is unfashionable. His allusions are to forgotten facts; his illustrations are drawn from notions obscured by time; his "wit" is therefore "single," such as none has any part in but himself. (IV.251)

I.III.36 LORD BARDOLPH.

Yes, if this present quality of war,
 Indeed the instant action; a cause on foot
 Lives so in hope

These first twenty lines were first inserted in the folio of 1623.

The first clause of this passage is evidently corrupted. All the folio editions and Mr. Rowe's concur in the same reading, which Mr. Pope altered thus,

Yes, if this present quality of war
Impede the instant act.

This has been silently followed by Mr. Theobald, Sir Tho. Hanmer, and Dr. Warburton; but the corruption is certainly deeper, for in the present reading Bardolph makes the inconvenience of "hope" to be that it may cause delay, when indeed the whole tenour of his argument is to recommend delay to the rest that are too forward. I know not what to propose, and am afraid that something is omitted, and that the injury is irremediable. Yet, perhaps, the alteration requisite is no more than this,

Yes, *in* this present quality of war,
 Indeed *of* instant action.

"It never," says Hastings, "did harm to lay down likelihoods of hope." "Yes," says Bardolph, "*it has done harm* in this present quality of war, *in a state of things, such as is now before us*, of war, indeed of instant action." This is obscure, but Mr. Pope's reading is still less reasonable. (IV.254)

I.III.78 HASTINGS.

If he should do so,
 He leaves his back unarm'd, the French and Welsh
 Baying him at the heels; never fear that.

This passage is read in the first editions thus. "If he should do so, French and Welsh he leaves his back unarm'd, they baying him at the heels, never fear that." These lines, which were evidently printed from an interlined copy not understood, are properly regulated in the next edition, and are here only mentioned to show what errors may be suspected to remain. IV.256

II.I.26 HOSTESS.

and he is indited to dinner to the Lubbars-head in Lombard-street.

This is, I suppose, a colloquial corruption of the "Libbard's" head. (IV.258)

II.1.36 HOSTESS.

Yonder he comes, and that arrant malmseynose knave Bardolph with him.

That is, "red nose," from the colour of malmsey wine. IV.258

II.1.54 HOSTESS.

thou wo't, wo't thou?

The first folio reads, I think, less properly, "thou wilt not? thou wilt not?" (IV.259)

II.1.57 FALSTAFF.

Away, you scullion, you rampallian, you fustilarian: I'll tickle your catastrophe.

This speech is given to the Page in all the editions to the folio of 1664. It is more proper for Falstaff, but that the boy must not stand quite silent and useless on the stage. (IV.259)

II.1.86 HOSTESS.

the Prince broke thy head for likening his father to a singing-man of Windsor

Such is the reading of the first edition, all the rest have "for likening him to a singing man." The original edition is right; the Prince might allow familiarities with himself, and yet very properly break the knight's head when he ridiculed his father. IV.260

II.1.109 CHIEF JUSTICE.

I know, you have practised upon the easy-yielding spirit of this woman.

HOSTESS.

Yes, in troth, my lord.

CHIEF JUSTICE.

Pry'thee, peace.—Pay her the debt you owe her, and unpay the villainy you have done her; the one you may do with sterling mony, and the other with current repentance.

In the first quarto it is read thus: "*You have, as it appears to me, practised upon the easy yielding spirit of this woman, and made her serve your uses both in purse and person.*" Without this the following exhortation of the Chief Justice is less proper. (IV.261)

II.i.126 CHIEF JUSTICE.

answer in the effect of your reputation

That is, "answer in a manner suitable to your character." IV.262

II.i.141 FALSTAFF.

the German hunting in water-work, is worth a thousand of these bed-hangings, and these fly-bitten tapestries.

[We should read "*dead* -hangings." i.e. faded. Warburton]

I think the present reading may well stand. He recommends painted paper instead of tapestry, which he calls "bed-hangings," in contempt, as fitter to make curtains than to hang walls. (IV.262)

II.ii.21 PRINCE HENRY.

the rest of thy low countries have made a shift to eat up thy holland.

The quarto of 1600 adds, "And God knows, whether those, that bawl out of the ruins of thy linen, shall inherit his Kingdom: but the midwives say, the children are not in the fault; whereupon the world increases, and kindreds are mightily strengthened." This passage Mr. Pope restored from the first edition. I think it may as well be omitted, and therefore have degraded it to the margin. It is omitted in the first folio, and in all subsequent editions before Mr. Pope's, and was perhaps expunged by the authour. The editors, unwilling to lose any thing of Shakespeare's, not only insert what he has added, but recal what he has rejected. (IV.264)

II.ii.45 PRINCE HENRY.

and keeping such vile company, as thou art, hath in reason taken from me all ostentation of sorrow.

"Ostentation" is here not "boastful shew," but simply "shew." *Merchant of Venice*.

One well studied in a sad *ostent*

To please his grandame. IV.265

II.ii.63 POINS.

I am a proper fellow of my hands

A "tall" or "proper" man of his hands was a "stout fighting man." (IV.266)

II.ii.85 PAGE.

Marry, my lord, Althea dream'd, she was deliver'd of a firebrand; and therefore I call him her dream.

Shakespeare is here mistaken in his mythology, and has confounded Althea's firebrand with Hecuba's. The firebrand of Althea was real; but Hecuba, when she was big with Paris, dreamed that she was delivered of a firebrand that consumed the kingdom. (IV.267)

II.ii.97 PRINCE HENRY.

and how doth the Martlemas, your master?

That is, the "autumn," or rather the "latter spring." The old fellow with juvenile passions. (IV.267)

II.ii.102 PRINCE HENRY.

I do allow this wen to be as familiar with me as my dog
This swoln excrescence of a man. (IV.267)

II.ii.117 PRINCE HENRY.

Peace.

POINS.

"I will imitate the honourable Romans in brevity."

All the editors, except Sir Thomas Hanmer, have left this letter in confusion, making the Prince read part, and Poins part. I have followed his correction. (IV.268)

II.ii.142 PRINCE HENRY.

What company?

PAGE.

Ephesians, my lord, of the old church.

"Ephesian" was a term in the cant of these times of which I know not the precise notion: it was, perhaps, a "toper." So the Host in *The Merry Wives of Windsor*,

It is thine Host, thine *Ephesian* calls.

IV.269

II.ii.163 PRINCE HENRY.

How might we see Falstaff bestow himself to night in his true colours, and not our selves be seen?

POINS.

Put on two leather jerkins and aprons, and wait upon him at his table, as drawers.

This was a plot very unlikely to succeed where the Prince and the drawers were all known, but it produces merriment, which our author found more useful than probability. (IV.269)

II.ii.167 PRINCE HENRY.

From a god to a bull? a heavy descension. It was Jove's case. From a prince to a prentice? a low transformation

[Other editions: declension. Pope and Warburton: descension.]

"Descension" is the reading of the first edition.

Mr. Upton proposes that we should read thus by transposition. "From a god to a bull, a low transformation;—from a prince to a prentice, a heavy declension." This reading is elegant, and perhaps right. (IV.270)

II.iv.11 1 DRAWER.

see if thou can'st find out Sneak's noise

"Sneak" was a street minstrel, and therefore the drawer goes out to listen if he can hear him in the neighbourhood.

IV.273

II.iv.34 FALSTAFF.

how now, Mrs. Dol.

HOSTESS.

Sick of a calm; yea, good sooth.

FALSTAFF.

So is all her sect.

I know not why "sect" is printed in all the copies, I believe "sex" is meant. (IV.274)

II.iv.39 DOLL.

You muddy rascal, is that all the comfort you give me?

FALSTAFF.

You make fat rascals, Mrs. Dol.

Falstaff alludes to a phrase of the forest; "lean" deer are called "rascal" deer. He tells her she calls him wrong, being "fat" he cannot be a "rascal." (IV.274)

II.iv.44 FALSTAFF.

If the cook make the gluttony, you help to make the diseases, Dol; we catch of you, Dol, we catch of you; grant that, my poor vertue, grant that.

DOLL.

Ay, marry, our chains and our jewels.

FALSTAFF.

Your brooches, pearls and owches

I believe Falstaff gives these splendid names as we give that of "carbuncle" to something very different from gems and ornaments, but the passage deserves not a laborious research. IV.274

II.iv.54 HOSTESS.

you are both, in good troth, as rheumatick as two dry toasts, you cannot one bear with another's confirmities.

"As two dry toasts," which cannot meet but they grate one another. (IV.275)

II.iv.65 DRAWER.

Sir, ancient Pistol is below

"Ancient Pistol" is the same as "ensign Pistol." Falstaff was captain, Peto lieutenant, and Pistol ensign, or "ancient." IV.275

II.iv.123 DOLL.

Since when, I pray you, Sir? — what, with two points on your shoulder? much!

[Hanmer: march. Warburton: marry come up.]

I cannot but think the emendation right. This use of "much" I do not remember, nor is it here proved by any example. IV.277

II.iv.137 DOLL.

he lives upon mouldy stew'd prunes and dry'd cakes

That is, he lives at other men's cost, but is not admitted to their tables, and gets only what is too stale to be eaten in the house. (IV.278)

II.iv.154 PISTOL.

These be good humours, indeed. Shall packhorses
And hollow-pamper'd jades of Asia,
Which cannot go but thirty miles a day,
Compare with Caesars, and with Cannibals

"Cannibal" is used by a blunder for "Hannibal." This was afterwards copied by Congreve's Bluff and Wittol. Bluff is a character apparently taken from this of Ancient Pistol. IV.278

II.iv.171 PISTOL.

Si fortuna me tormenta, spero me contenta.

Sir Tho. Hanmer reads, *Si fortuna me tormenta, il sperare me contenta*, which is undoubtedly the true reading, but perhaps it was intended that Pistol should corrupt it. (IV.279)

II.iv.174 PISTOL.

Come we to full points here

That is, shall we stop here, shall we have no further entertainment. (IV.280)

II.iv.180 PISTOL.

Thrust him down stairs? know we not galloway nags?

That is, "common hackneys." (IV.280)

II.iv.221 DOLL.

Thou whorson little tydie Bartholomew boar-pig

For "tidy" Sir T. Hanmer reads "tiny," but they are both words of endearment, and equally proper. "Bartholomew boar-pig" is a little pig made of paste, sold at Bartholomew fair, and given to children for a fairing. (IV.281)

II.iv.234 FALSTAFF.

he plays at quoits well, and eats conger and fennel, and drinks off candles' ends for flap dragons

These qualifications I do not understand.

[Steevens: "a piece of bread sop'd in aqua vitae, and set on fire."]

A "flap-dragon" is some small combustible body, fired at one end, and put afloat in a glass of liquor. It is an act of toppers' dexterity to toss off the glass in such a manner as to prevent the "flap-dragon" from doing mischief. (IV.282)

II.iv.245 PRINCE HENRY.

Would not this nave of a wheel have his ears cut off?

"Nave" and "knave" are easily reconciled, but why "nave of a wheel"? I suppose for his roundness. He was called "round man" in contempt before [Act II, sc. iv of *I Henry IV*].

IV.282

II.iv.253 PRINCE HENRY.

Saturn and Venus this year in conjunction! what says the almanack to that?

This was indeed a prodigy. The astrologers, says Ficinus, remark, that Saturn and Venus are never conjoined. (IV.283)

II.iv.256 POINS.

lisping to his master's old tables

[We should read "*clasping too* his master's old tables, &c." i.e. embracing his master's cast-off whore, and now his bawd ("his notebook, his counsel-keeper.") We have the same phrase again in *Cymbeline*,

You *clasp* young Cupid's tables.

WARBURTON]

This emendation is very specious. I think it right. (IV.283)

II.iv.273 FALSTAFF.

Ha! a bastard son of the King's! and art not thou Poins his brother?

The improbability of this scene is scarcely ballanced by the humour. (IV.283)

II.iv.289 PRINCE HENRY.

You whorson candle-mine

Thou inexhaustible magazine of tallow. (IV.284)

II.iv.325 PRINCE HENRY.

For the women,—

FALSTAFF.

For one of them, she is in hell already, and burns, poor soul!

This is Sir T. Hanmer's reading. Undoubtedly right. The other editions had, "she is in hell already, and burns poor souls." The venereal disease was called in these times the "*brennynge*" or "*burning*." (IV.285)

III.i.30 KING HENRY.

happy lowly clown,

Uneasy lyes the head, that wears a crown.

[Earlier reading: happy low! lye down.]

Dr. Warburton has not admitted this emendation into his text: I am glad to do it the justice which its authour has neglected. (IV.288)

III.I.35 KING HENRY.

Why, then, good morrow to you. Well, my lords

[Earlier reading: you all, my lords.]

Sir T. Hanmer and Dr. Warburton have received this emendation, and read "well" for "all." The reading either way is of no importance. (IV.288)

III.I.41 WARWICK.

It is but as a body yet distemper'd

[Warburton: body slight]

The present reading is right. "Distemper," that is, according to the old physick, a disproportionate mixture of humours, or inequality of innate heat and radical humidity, is less than actual "disease," being only the state which foreruns or produces diseases. The difference between "distemper" and "disease," seems to be much the same as between "disposition" and "habit." (IV.289)

III.I.44 WARWICK.

My lord Northumberland will soon be cool'd.

[Warburton: school'd]

"Cool'd" is certainly right. (IV.289)

III.I.53 KING HENRY.

O, if this were seen,

The happiest youth viewing his progress through,

What perils past, what crosses to ensue,

Wou'd shut the book, and sit him down and die.

[These four lines are supplied from the edition of 1600. WARBURTON]

My copy wants the whole scene, and therefore these lines.

There is some difficulty in the line,

What perils past, what crosses to ensue,

because it seems to make "past perils" equally terrible with "ensuing crosses." (IV.289)

III.I.67 KING HENRY.

[To Warwick]

When Richard, with his eye brim-full of tears,

Then check'd and rated by Northumberland,

Did speak these words, now prov'd a prophecy.

He refers to *King Richard*, act 5. scene 2. But whether the King's or the authour's memory fails him, so it was, that Warwick was not present at that conversation. (IV.290)

III.I.87 WARWICK.

And by the necessary form of this,
King Richard might create a perfect guess
I think we might better read,
The necessary form of *things*.
The word "this" has no very evident antecedent. (IV.290)

III.I.92 KING HENRY.

Are these things then necessities?
Then let us meet them like necessities
I am inclined to read,
Then let us meet them like *necessity*.
That is, with the resistless violence of "necessity"; then comes more aptly the following line:
And that same word even now cries out on us.
That is, the word "necessity." (IV.291)

III.I.106 KING HENRY.

I will take your counsel;
And were these inward wars once out of hand,
We would, dear lords, unto the Holy Land.

This play, like the former, proceeds in one unbroken tenour through the first edition, and there is therefore no evidence that the division of the acts was made by the authour. Since then every editor has the same right to mark the intervals of action as the players, who made the present distribution, I should propose that this scene may be added to the foregoing act, and the remove from London to Gloucestershire be made in the intermediate time, but that it would shorten the next act too much, which has not even now its due proportion to the rest. (IV.291)

III.II.42 SHALLOW.

a fourteen and fourteen and a half
That is fourteen score of yards. (IV.293)

III.ii.70 SHALLOW.

"Accommodated"—it comes of *accommodo*; very good, a good phrase.

The same word occurs in Jonson's *Every Man in his Humour*, Hostess, *accommodate* us with another bed-staff:

The woman does not understand *the words of action*. 1773:(V.439)

III.ii.133 FALSTAFF.

we have a number of shadows do fill up the muster-book

That is, we have in the muster-book many names for which we receive pay, though we have not the men. (IV.296)

III.ii.200 SHALLOW.

She was then a bona-roba.

A fine showy wanton. (IV.298)

III.ii.237 BARDOLPH.

I have three pound to free Mouldy and Bull-calf.

Here seems to be a wrong computation. He had forty shillings for each. Perhaps he meant to conceal part of the profit. IV.299

III.ii.256 FALSTAFF.

swifter than he that gibbets on the brewer's bucket.

Swifter than he that carries beer from the vat to the barrel, in buckets hung upon a gibbet or beam crossing his shoulders. IV.300

III.ii.266 FALSTAFF.

O, give me always a little, lean, old, chopt, bald shot.

"Shot" is used for "shooter," one who is to fight by shooting. IV.300

III.ii.271 SHALLOW.

when I lay at Clement's Inn, I was then Sir Dagonet in Arthur's show

[The only intelligence I have gleaned of this worthy wight, Sir Dagonet, is from Beaumont and Fletcher in their *Knight of the Burning Pestle*. THEOBALD]

The story of Sir Dagonet is to be found in *La Mort d'Arthure*, an old romance much celebrated in our authour's time, or a little before it. "When papistry," says Ascham in his *Schoolmaster*, "as a standing pool overflowed all England, few books were read in our tongue saving certain books of chivalry, as they said, for pastime and pleasure; which books, as some say, were made in monasteries by idle monks.

As one, for example, *La Mort d'Arthur*." In this romance Sir Dagonet is King Arthur's fool. Shakespeare would not have shown his Justice capable of representing any higher character. (IV.300)

III.ii.307 FALSTAFF.

He came ever in the rere-ward of the fashion; and sung those tunes to the over-scutcht huswives

[Over-scutcht, i.e. whipt, carted. POPE]

I rather think that the word means "dirty," or "grimed," the word "huswives" agrees better with this sense. Shallow crept into mean houses, and boasted his accomplishments to the "dirty" women. (IV.302)

III.ii.315 FALSTAFF.

I saw it, and told John of Gaunt he beat his own name

That is, beat "gaunt," a fellow so slender that his name might have been "gaunt." (IV.302)

III.ii.319 FALSTAFF.

it shall go hard but I will make him a philosopher's two stones to me.

[One of which was an universal medicine, and the other a transmuter of baser metals into gold. WARBURTON]

I believe the commentator has refined this passage too much. "A philosopher's two stones," is only "more than the philosopher's stone." The "universal medicine" was never, so far as I know, conceived to be a stone, before the time of Butler's stone. (IV.302)

III.ii.321 FALSTAFF.

If the young dace be a bait for the old pike, I see no reason in the law of nature but I may snap at him.

That is, "If the pike may prey upon the dace, if it be the law of nature that the stronger may seize upon the weaker, Falstaff may with great propriety devour Shallow." (IV.302)

IV.i.24 MOWBRAY.

Let us sway on, and face them in the field.

[Warburton: way on]

I know not that I have ever seen "sway" in this sense, but I believe it is the true word, and was intended to express the uniform and forcible motion of a compact body. There is a sense of the noun

in Milton kindred to this, where speaking of a weighty sword, he says, "It descends with huge two-handed *sway*." (IV.304)

IV.1.32 WESTMORLAND.

If that Rebellion
Came like it self, in base and abject routs,
Led on by bloody youth, goaded with rage
I think "bloody" can hardly be right, perhaps it was "moody," that is, "furious." So in scene 8 of this act.

Being *moody* give him line and scope
Till that his passions, like a whale on ground,
Confound themselves with working.

IV.304

Bloody youth, with which I puzzled myself in the note, is only "sanguine" youth, or youth full of blood, and of those passions which blood is supposed to produce and incite or nourish. (*Appendix*)

IV.1.50 WESTMORLAND.

Turning your books to graves
For "graves" Dr. Warburton very plausibly reads "glaves," and is followed by Sir Thomas Hanmer. (IV.305)

IV.1.53 YORK.

Wherefore do I this? so the question stands.
Briefly, to this end. We are all diseas'd

In this speech after the first two lines, the next twenty-five are either omitted in the first edition, or added in the second. The answer in which both the editions agree, apparently refers to some of these lines, which therefore may be probably supposed rather to have been dropped by a player desirous to shorten his speech, than added by the second labour of the authour. IV.305

IV.1.93 WESTMORLAND.

And consecrate commotion's civil edge?

[In one of my old quarto's of 1600 (for I have two of the self-same edition: one of which, it is evident, was corrected in some passages during the working off the whole impression;) I found this verse. I have ventured to substitute "page" for "edge," with regard to the uniformity of metaphor. Tho' the sword of rebellion, drawn by a bishop, may in some sort be said to be consecrated by his reverence. THEOBALD]

What Mr. Theobald says of two editions seems to be true, for my copy reads, "commotion's *bitter* edge," but "civil" is undoubtedly right, and one would wonder how "bitter" could intrude if "civil" had been written first, perhaps the authour himself made the change. (IV.306)

IV.I.94 YORK.

My brother general, the common-wealth,
To brother born an household cruelty,
I make my quarrel in particular.

[The sense is this, "My brother general, the common-wealth, which ought to distribute its benefits equally, is become an enemy to those of his own house, to *brothers-born*, by giving some all, and others none; and this (*says he*) I make my quarrel or grievance that honours are unequally distributed"; the constant birth of male-contents, and source of civil commotions. WARBURTON]

In the first folio the second line is omitted, yet that reading, unintelligible as it is, has been followed by Sir T. Hanmer. How difficultly sense can be drawn from the best reading the explication of Dr. Warburton may show. I believe there is an error in the first line, which perhaps may be rectified thus,

My *quarrel* general, the common-wealth,
To brother born an household cruelty,
I make my quarrel in particular.

That is, my "general" cause of discontent is publick mismanagement, my "particular" cause a domestick injury done to my "natural brother," who had been beheaded by the King's order. (IV.307)

IV.I.104 WESTMORLAND.

Construe the times to their necessities

That is, "Judge of what is done in these times according to the exigencies that overrule us." (IV.308)

IV.I.107 WESTMORLAND.

Yet, for your part, it not appears to me,
Or from the King, or in the present time,
That you should have an inch of any ground
To build a grief on.

Whether the faults of government be imputed to the "time" or the "king," it appears not that you have, for your part, been injured either by the "king" or the "time." (IV.308)

IV.1.120 MOWBRAY.

Their armed staves in charge, their beavers down

An "armed staff" is a "lance." To be "in charge," is "to be fixed in the rest for the encounter." (IV.308)

IV.1.166 WESTMORLAND.

That is intended in the General's name:

I muse, you make so slight a question.

That is, "This power is included in the name *or office* of a general. We wonder that you can ask a question so trifling." IV.309

IV.1.171 YORK.

All members of our cause, both here and hence,

That are insinewed to this action,

Acquitted by a true substantial form

That is, "by a pardon of due form and legal validity." (IV.310)

IV.1.174 YORK.

And present executions of our wills

To us, and to our purposes, confin'd

[Warburton: To *us* and to our *properties* confin'd]

This passage is so obscure that I know not what to make of it. Nothing better occurs to me, than to read "consign'd," for "confin'd." That is, let the execution of our demands be put into our hands according to our declared purposes. (IV.310)

IV.1.176 YORK.

We come within our awful banks again

[Warburton: lawful]

"Awful banks" are the proper limits of reverence. (IV.310)

IV.1.193 MOWBRAY.

That, were our loyal faiths martyrs in love

In former editions:

That, were our *royal* faiths martyrs in love.

If "royal faiths" can mean "faith to a king," it yet cannot mean it without much violence done to the language. I therefore read, with Sir T. Hanmer, "loyal" faiths, which is proper, natural, and suitable to the intention of the speaker. IV.311

IV.i.198 YORK.

Of dainty and such picking grievances
 I cannot but think that this line is corrupted and that we should
 read,
 Of picking out such dainty grievances. (IV.311)

IV.ii.21 LANCASTER.

Between the grace, the sanctities of heav'n,
 And our dull workings.
 This expression Milton has copied,
 Around him all the sanctities of Heav'n
 Stood thick as stars. (IV.313)

IV.ii.26 LANCASTER.

you've taken up,
 Under the counterfeited zeal of God,
 The subjects of his substitute, my father
 "To take up," is to "levy," to "raise in arms." (IV.313)

IV.ii.33 YORK.

The time mis-order'd doth in common sense
 Crowd us and crush us to this monstrous form
 [Warburton: common fence, i.e. drove by self-defence]
 "Common sense" is the "general sense" of general danger.
 IV.313

IV.ii.81 YORK.

Against ill chances men are ever merry,
 But heaviness fore-runs the good event.

WESTMORLAND.

Therefore be merry, coz
 That is, "Therefore," notwithstanding this sudden impulse to heaviness, "be merry, for such sudden dejections forebode good." (IV.315)

IV.ii.93 LANCASTER.

And, good my lord, so please you, let our trains
 March by us, that we may peruse the men
 We should have cop'd withal.
 That is, our army on each part, that we may both see those that
 were to have opposed us. (IV.315)

IV.ii.122 LANCASTER.

Some guard these traitors to the block of death,
Treason's true bed and yielder up of breath.

It cannot but raise some indignation to find this horrible violation of faith passed over thus slightly by the poet, without any note of censure or detestation. (IV.317)

IV.iii.6 FALSTAFF.

Coleville shall still be your name, a traitor your degree, and the dungeon your place, a place deep enough. So shall you still be Coleville of the dale.

[Tyrwhitt: your place, a dale deep enough]

The sense of "dale" is included in "deep"; a "dale" is a deep place; a "dungeon" is a deep place: he that is in a "dungeon" may be therefore said to be in a "dale." 1773:(V.465)

IV.iii.24 LANCASTER.

The heat is past, follow no farther now

That is, the violence of resentment, the eagerness of revenge.
IV.318

IV.iii.80 FALSTAFF.

My lord, I beseech you, give me leave to go through Glo'stershire; and when you come to court, 'pray, stand my good lord in your good report.

We must either read, "pray *let me* stand," or by a construction somewhat harsh, understand it thus: "Give me leave to go—and—stand." "To stand in a report," referred to the reporter, is "to persist," and Falstaff did not ask the Prince to persist in his present opinion. IV.319

IV.iii.83 LANCASTER.

Fare you well, Falstaff; I, in my condition,
Shall better speak of you than you deserve.

I know not well the meaning of the word "condition" in this place; I believe it is the same with "temper of mind": I shall, "in my good nature," speak better of you than you merit. IV.320

IV.iii.86 FALSTAFF.

Good faith, this same young soberblooded boy doth not love me; nor a man cannot make him laugh

Falstaff speaks here like a veteran in life. The young prince did not love him, and he despaired to gain his affection, for he could not make

him laugh. Men only become friends by community of pleasures. He who cannot be softened into gayety cannot easily be melted into kindness. (IV.320)

IV.iii.98 FALSTAFF.

apprehensive, quick, forgetive, full of nimble, fiery, and delectable shapes

"Forgetive" from "forge"; inventive, imaginative. (IV.320)

IV.iv.34 KING HENRY.

As humourous as winter

That is, changeable as the weather of a winter's day. Dryden says of Almanzor, that he is "humorous as wind." (IV.322)

IV.iv.47 KING HENRY.

it doth work as strong

As aconitum, or rash gun-powder.

"Rash" is "quick, violent, sudden." This representation of the Prince, is a natural picture of a young man whose passions are yet too strong for his virtues. (IV.323)

IV.iv.65 KING HENRY.

Oh, with what wings shall his affection fly

His passions; his inordinate desires. (IV.324)

IV.iv.73 WARWICK.

So, like gross terms,

The Prince will in the perfectness of time

Cast off his followers; and their memory

Shall as a pattern or a measure live,

By which his grace must mete the lives of others;

Turning past evils to advantages.

KING HENRY.

'Tis seldom, when the bee doth leave her comb

In the dead carrion.

As the bee, having once placed her comb in a carcase, stays by her honey, so he that has once taken pleasure in bad company, will continue to associate with those that have the art of pleasing him. (IV.324)

IV.iv.89 WESTMORLAND.

Here at more leisure may your Highness read,
With every course, in his particular.

We should read, I think, in "this" particular; that is, in this "detail," in this account which is minute and distinct. IV.324

IV.iv.121 GLOUCESTER.

The people fear me; for they do observe
Unfather'd heirs and loathly birds of nature.

That is, equivocal births; animals that had no animal progenitors; productions not brought forth according to the stated laws of generation. (IV.326)

IV.v.2 KING HENRY.

Unless some dull and favourable hand
Will whisper musick to my weary spirit.
[Warburton: *doleing* favourable]

I rather think that "dull" signifies, "melancholy, gentle, soothing." "Doleing" cannot be received without some example of its use, which the commentator has not given, and my memory will not supply. (IV.326)

IV.v.80 KING HENRY.

Yield his engrossments to the dying father.
His accumulations. (IV.329)

IV.v.104 KING HENRY.

Thou hast seal'd up my expectation
Thou hast "confirmed" my opinion. (IV.330)

IV.v.129 KING HENRY.

England shall double gild his treble guilt

[Evidently the nonsense of some foolish player: for we must make a difference between what Shakespeare might be suppos'd to have written off hand, and what he had corrected. These scenes are of the latter kind; therefore such lines by no means to be esteemed his. But except Mr. Pope, (who judiciously threw out this line) not one of Shakespeare's editors seem ever to have had so reasonable and necessary a rule in their heads, when they set upon correcting this author. *WARBURTON*]

I know not why this commentator should speak with so much confidence what he cannot know, or determine so positively what so

capricious a writer as our poet might either deliberately or wantonly produce. This line is indeed such as disgraces a few that precede and follow it, but it suits well enough with the “daggers hid in thought, and whetted on the flinty hearts” [107-08]; and the answer which the Prince makes, and which is applauded for wisdom, is not of a strain much higher than this ejected line. (IV.331)

IV.v.147 PRINCE HENRY.

Let me no more from this obedience rise,
Which my most true and inward-duteous spirit
Teacheth this prostrate and exterior bending.

This is obscure in the construction, though the general meaning is clear enough. The order is, “this obedience which is taught this exterior bending by my duteous spirit”; or, “this obedience which teaches this exterior bending to my inwardly duteous spirit.” I know not which is right. (IV.331)

IV.v.163 PRINCE HENRY.

Preserving life in med’cine potable

There has long prevailed an opinion that a solution of gold has great medicinal virtues, and that incorruptibility of gold might be communicated to the body impregnated with it. Some have pretended to make “potable” gold among other frauds practised on credulity. (IV.332)

IV.v.190 KING HENRY.

For all the soil of the atchievement
“Soil” is “spot, dirt, turpitude, reproach.” (IV.333)

IV.v.196 KING HENRY.

Wounding supposed peace.
[“Supposed,” for undermined. WARBURTON]
Rather “counterfeited, imagined, *not* real.” (IV.333)

IV.v.196 KING HENRY.

All these bold fears
Thou seest, with peril I have answered
[Warburton: their bold feats]

There is no need of alteration. “Fear” is here used in the active sense, for that which causes “fear.” (IV.333)

IV.v.199 KING HENRY.

and now my death
Changes the mode

[“Mode,” here, does not signify fashion, but “time” and “measure” in singing, or the “pitch” in speaking: *modus*, a word peculiar to the ancient drama: for the metaphor is continued from the words immediately preceding,

as a scene,
Acting that argument—

WARBURTON]

“Mode” is here in its usual sense, the “form” or “state of things.” Nothing is more easy than to make obscurities and clear them. (IV.333)

IV.v.200 KING HENRY.

for what in me was purchas’d,
Falls upon thee in a much fairer sort;
So thou the garland wear’st successively.

To order of succession. Every usurper snatches a claim of hereditary right as soon as he can. (IV.333)

IV.v.210 KING HENRY.

I cut them off, and had a purpose now
To lead out many to the Holy Land
[Warburton: our many]

As plausible as this emendation is I think it wrong. The sense is: “Of those who assisted my usurpation, *some* I have cut off, and *many* I intended to lead abroad.” This journey to the Holy Land, of which the King very frequently revives the mention, had two motives, religion and policy. He durst not wear the ill-gotten crown without expiation, but in the act of expiation he contrives to make his wickedness successful.

IV.334

IV.v.219 KING HENRY.

How I came by the crown, O God, forgive!
And grant it may with thee in true peace live.

This is a true picture of a mind divided between heaven and earth. He prays for the prosperity of guilt while he deprecates its punishment. (IV.334)

V.i.12 DAVY.

Those precepts cannot be serv'd; and, again, Sir, shall we sow the head-land with wheat?

"Precept" is a justice's warrant. To the offices which Falstaff gives Davy in the following scene, may be added that of justice's clerk. Davy has almost as many employments as Scrub in the *Stratagem*. (IV.336)

V.i.60 FALSTAFF.

If I were saw'd into quantities, I should make four dozen of such bearded hermites-staves as master Shallow.

He had before called him "the starved justice." His want of flesh is a standing jest. (IV.338)

V.i.75 FALSTAFF.

I will devise matter enough out of this Shallow to keep Prince Henry in continual laughter the wearing out of six fashions, which is four terms or two actions, and he shall laugh without *Intervallums*.

There is something humorous in making a spendthrift compute time by the operation of an action for debt. (IV.338)

V.i.80 FALSTAFF.

a fellow that never had the ache in his shoulders

That is, a "young fellow," one whose disposition to merriment, time and pain have not yet impaired. (IV.338)

V.ii.37 CHIEF JUSTICE.

And never shall you see, that I will beg

A ragged and forestall'd remission.

["Ragged" has no sense here. We should read,

A *rated* and forestall'd remission.

i.e. a remission that must be sought for, and bought with supplication. WARBURTON]

Different minds have different perplexities. I am more puzzled with "forestall'd" than with "ragged," for "ragged," in our authour's licentious diction, may easily signify "beggary, mean, base, ignominious"; but "forestalled" I know not how to apply to "remission" in any sense primitive or figurative. I should be glad of another word, but cannot find it. Perhaps by "forestall'd" remission, he may mean a pardon begged by a voluntary confession of offence, and "anticipation" of the charge. (IV.340)

V.ii.46 KING HENRY V.

Brothers, you mix your sadness with some fear;
 This is the English, not the Turkish court
 Not the court where the prince that mounts the throne puts his
 brothers to death. (IV.341)

V.ii.70 KING HENRY V.

What! rate, rebuke, and roughly send to prison
 Th' immediate heir of England? was this easy?
 That is, "Was this not grievous?" Shakespeare has "easy" in this
 sense elsewhere. (IV.341)

V.ii.87 CHIEF JUSTICE.

To trip the course of law
 To defeat the process of justice, a metaphor taken from the act of
 tripping a runner. (IV.342)

V.ii.89 CHIEF JUSTICE.

Nay more, to spurn at your most royal image,
 And mock your working in a second body.
 To treat with contempt your acts executed by a representative.
 (IV.342)

V.ii.99 CHIEF JUSTICE.

And, as you are a king, speak in your state
 In your regal character and office, not with the passion of a man
 interested, but with the impartiality of a legislator. IV.342

V.ii.123 KING HENRY V.

My father is gone wild into his grave
 Mr. Pope, by substituting "wail'd" for "wild," without sufficient
 consideration, afforded Mr. Theobald much matter of ostentatious
 triumph. (IV.343)

V.ii.125 KING HENRY V.

And with his spirit sadly I survive
 "Sadly" is the same as "soberly, seriously, gravely." "Sad" is op-
 posed to "wild" [see line 123]. (IV.343)

V.iii.27 DAVY.

Master Page, sit; good master Page, sit; proface.
 [Italian from *profaccia*; that is, "much good may it do you." HAN-
 MER]

I rather think "proface" is uttered by mistake for "perforce." Davy impertinently asks Bardolph and the Page, who, according to their place, were standing, to sit down. Bardolph complies; the Page, knowing his duty, declines the seat, and Davy cries "proface," and sets him down by force. (IV.345)

V.iii.28 DAVY.

What you want in meat, we'll have in drink; but you must bear; the heart's all.

That is, the intention with which the entertainment is given. The humour consists in making Davy act as master of the house. (IV.345)

V.iii.57 SHALLOW.

I'll drink to master Bardolph, and to all the cavaleroes about London.

This was the term by which an airy splendid irregular fellow was distinguished. The soldiers of King Charles were called "Cavaliers" from the gayety which they affected in opposition to the sour faction of the parliament. (IV.346)

V.iii.72 SILENCE.

[Singing.] "Do me right, and dub me Knight, Samingo."

[He means to say, "San Domingo." HANMER]

Of "Samingo," or "San Domingo," I see not the use in this place. (IV.346)

V.iii.77 SILENCE.

Is't so? why, then say, an old man can do somewhat.

It may be observed that Shakespeare, in the *Merry Wives of Windsor*, which he wrote after this play, for the greater commodiousness of his plot, changed the age of Silence. He is here a man advanced in years, with a son at the university: he there goes a courting to a young girl. Shallow is an old man in both plays. (IV.347)

V.iii.101 FALSTAFF.

Let King Cophetua know the truth thereof.

[Lines taken from an old bombast play of King Cophetua: of whom, as we learn from Shakespeare, there were ballads too. WARBURTON]

See *Love's Labour Lost*. (IV.347)

V.iii.117 PISTOL.

When Pistol lies, do this, and fig me like The bragging Spaniard.

To "fig," in Spanish, *Higas dar*, is to insult by putting the thumb between the fore and middle finger. From this Spanish custom we yet say in contempt, "a fig for you." (IV.348)

V.iv.8 DOLL.

Nut-hook, nut-hook, you lye.

It has been already observ'd on the *Merry Wives of Windsor*, that "nut-hook" seems to have been in those times a name of reproach for a catchpoll. (IV.349)

V.iv.20 DOLL.

you blue-bottle rogue!

A name I suppose given to the beadle from the colour of his livery. (IV.350)

V.iv.21 DOLL.

if you be not swing'd, I'll forswear half-kirtles.

Probably the dress of the prostitutes of that time. (IV.350)

V.v.1 1 GROOM.

More rushes, more rushes.

It has been already observed, that, at ceremonial entertainments, it was the custom to strew the floor with rushes. *Caius de Ephemera*. (IV.350)

V.v.16 FALSTAFF.

It shews my earnestness of affection.

PISTOL.

It doth so.

FALSTAFF.

My devotion.

PISTOL.

It doth, it doth, it doth.

The two little answers here given to Pistol, are transferred by Sir T. Hanmer to Shallow, the repetition of "it doth" suits Shallow best. (IV.351)

V.v.51 KING HENRY V.

So surfeit-swell'd, so old, and so profane

"Profane," in our authour, often signifies "love of talk" without the particular idea now given it. So in *Othello*, "Is he not a *profane* and very liberal counsellor." (IV.352)

V.v.64 KING HENRY V.

Till then I banish thee, on pain of death,

As I have done the rest of my mis-leaders,

Not to come near our person by ten miles.

Mr. Rowe observes, that many readers lament to see Falstaff so hardly used by his old friend. But if it be considered that the fat knight has never uttered one sentiment of generosity, and with all his power of exciting mirth, has nothing in him that can be esteemed, no great pain will be suffered from the reflection that he is compelled to live honestly, and maintained by the king, with a promise of advancement when he shall deserve it.

I think the poet more blameable for Poins, who is always represented as joining some virtues with his vices, and is therefore treated by the Prince with apparent distinction, yet he does nothing in the time of action, and though after the bustle is over he is again a favourite, at last vanishes without notice. Shakespeare certainly lost him by heedlessness, in the multiplicity of his characters, the variety of his action, and his eagerness to end the play. (IV.353)

V.v.92 CHIEF JUSTICE.

Go, carry Sir John Falstaff to the Fleet.

I do not see why Falstaff is carried to the Fleet. We have never lost sight of him since his dismissal from the king; he has committed no new fault, and therefore incurred no punishment; but the different agitations of fear, anger, and surprise in him and his company, made a good scene to the eye; and our authour, who wanted them no longer on the stage, was glad to find this method of sweeping them away. (IV.354)

I fancy every reader, when he ends this play, cries out with Desdemona, "O most lame and impotent conclusion!" As this play was not, to our knowledge, divided into acts by the authour, I could be content to conclude it with the death of Henry the Fourth.

In that Jerusalem shall Harry dye.

These scenes which now make the fifth act of *Henry the Fourth*, might then be the first of *Henry the Fifth*; but the truth is, that they do unite very commodiously to either play. When these plays were represented, I believe they ended as they are now ended in the books; but Shakespeare seems to have designed that the whole series of action from the beginning of *Richard the Second*, to the end of *Henry the Fifth*, should be considered by the reader as one work, upon one plan, only broken into parts by the necessity of exhibition.

None of Shakespeare's plays are more read than the *First and Second Parts of Henry the Fourth*. Perhaps no authour has ever in two plays afforded so much delight. The great events are interesting, for the fate of kingdoms depends upon them; the slighter occurrences are diverting, and, except one or two, sufficiently probable; the incidents are multiplied with wonderful fertility of invention, and the characters diversified with the utmost nicety of discernment, and the profoundest skill in the nature of man.

The Prince, who is the hero both of the comick and tragick part, is a young man of great abilities and violent passions, whose sentiments are right, though his actions are wrong; whose virtues are obscured by negligence, and whose understanding is dissipated by levity. In his idle hours he is rather loose than wicked, and when the occasion forces out his latent qualities, he is great without effort, and brave without tumult. The trifler is roused into a hero, and the hero again reposes in the trifler. This character is great, original, and just.

Percy is a rugged soldier, cholerick, and quarrelsome, and has only the soldier's virtues, generosity and courage.

But Falstaff unimitated, unimitable Falstaff, how shall I describe thee? Thou compound of sense and vice; of sense which may be admired but not esteemed, of vice which may be despised, but hardly detested. Falstaff is a character loaded with faults, and with those faults which naturally produce contempt. He is a thief, and a glutton, a coward, and a boaster, always ready to cheat the weak, and prey upon the poor; to terrify the timorous and insult the defenceless. At once obsequious and malignant, he satirises in their absence those whom he lives by flattering. He is familiar with the Prince only as an agent of vice, but of this familiarity he is so proud as not only to be supercilious and haughty with common men, but to think his interest of importance to the Duke of Lancaster. Yet the man thus corrupt, thus despicable, makes himself necessary to the prince that

despises him, by the most pleasing of all qualities, perpetual gaiety, by an unfailing power of exciting laughter, which is the more freely indulged, as his wit is not of the splendid or ambitious kind, but consists in easy escapes and sallies of levity, which make sport but raise no envy. It must be observed that he is stained with no enormous or sanguinary crimes, so that his licentiousness is not so offensive but that it may be borne for his mirth.

The moral to be drawn from this representation is, that no man is more dangerous than he that with a will to corrupt, hath the power to please; and that neither wit nor honesty ought to think themselves safe with such a companion when they see Henry seduced by Falstaff. (IV.355)

Epilogue [Spoken by a dancer.]

This epilogue was merely occasional, and alludes to some theatrical transaction. (IV.357)

EPILOGUE.20 DANCER.

All the gentlewomen here have forgiven me; if the gentlemen will not, then the gentlemen do not agree with the gentlewomen, which was never seen before in such an assembly.

This trick of influencing one part of the audience by the favour of the other, has been played already in the epilogue to *As You Like It*. (IV.357)

HENRY V

I. PROLOGUE 1 CHORUS.

O for a muse of fire that would ascend
The brightest heaven of invention!

[This goes upon the notion of the Peripatetic system, which imagines several heavens one above another; the last and highest of which was one of fire. Warburton]

It alludes likewise to the aspiring nature of fire, which, by its levity, at the separation of the chaos, took the highest seat of all the elements. (IV.361)

I. PROLOGUE 3 CHORUS.

A kingdom for a stage, princes to act,
And monarchs to behold the swelling scene!

Shakespeare does not seem to set distance enough between the performers and spectators. (IV.361)

I. PROLOGUE 12 CHORUS.

or may we cram,
Within this wooden O

Nothing shews more evidently the power of custom over language, than that the frequent use of calling a circle an "O" could so much hide the meanness of the metaphor from Shakespeare, that he has used it many times where he makes his most eager attempts at dignity of style. (IV.361)

I. PROLOGUE 17 CHORUS.

And let us, cyphers to this great accompt,
On your imaginary forces work.

"Imaginary" for "imaginative," or your powers of fancy. Active and passive words are by this authour frequently confounded. (IV.361)

I. PROLOGUE 24 CHORUS.

Into a thousand parts divide one man,
And make imaginary puissance.

This passage shews that Shakespeare was fully sensible of the absurdity of shewing battles on the theatre, which indeed is never done but tragedy becomes farce. Nothing can be represented to the eye but

by something like it, and "within a wooden O" nothing very like a battle can be exhibited. (IV.362)

I. PROLOGUE 28 CHORUS.

For 'tis your thoughts that now must deck our kings,
Carry them here and there, jumping o'er times,
Turning th' accomplishment of many years
Into an hour-glass

We should read "king" for "kings." The prologue relates only to this single play. The mistake was made by referring "them" to "kings" which belongs to "thoughts." The sense is, "Your thoughts must give the king his proper greatness, carry therefore *your thoughts* here and there, *jumping over time, and crowding years into an hour.*" (IV.362)

I.I.28 CANTERBURY.

Consideration, like an angel, came,
And whipt th' offending Adam out of him;
Leaving his body as a paradise

As paradise when sin and Adam were driven out by the angel became the habitation of celestial spirits, so the king's heart, since "consideration" has driven out his follies, is now the receptacle of wisdom and of virtue. (IV.364)

I.I.33 CANTERBURY.

Never came reformation in a flood
With such a heady current, scow'ring faults;
Nor ever Hydra-headed wilfulness
So soon did lose his seat

Alluding to the method by which Hercules cleansed the famous stables when he turned a river through them. Hercules still is in our authour's head when he mentions the Hydra. (IV.364)

I.I.38 CANTERBURY.

Hear him but reason in divinity,
And, all admiring, with an inward wish
You would desire, the King were made a prelate.

[This speech seems to have been copied from King James's prelates, speaking of their Solomon; when Archbishop Whitgift, who, as an eminent writer says, "died soon afterwards, and probably doated then," at the Hampton-Court conference, declared himself "verily persuaded, that his *sacred* Majesty spake by the Spirit of God."

And, in effect, this scene was added after King James's accession to the crown: so that we have no way of avoiding its being esteemed a compliment to "him," but by supposing it was a satire on "his bishops." *WARBURTON*]

Why these lines should be divided from the rest of the speech and applied to King James, I am not able to conceive; nor why an opportunity should be so eagerly snatched to treat with contempt that part of his character which was least contemptible. King James's theological knowledge was not inconsiderable. To preside at disputations is not very suitable to a king, but to understand the questions is surely laudable. The poet, if he had James in his thoughts, was no skilful encomiast; for the mention of Harry's skill in war, forced upon the remembrance of his audience the great deficiency of their present king; who yet with all his faults, and many faults he had, was such that Sir Robert Cotton says, "he would be content that England should never have a better, provided that it should never have a worse." (IV.365)

I.1.47 CANTERBURY.

When he speaks,
The air, a charter'd libertine, is still
This line is exquisitely beautiful. (IV.365)

I.1.51 CANTERBURY.

So that the art, and practic part of life,
Must be the mistress to this theorique.
Which is a wonder how his Grace should glean it,
Since his addiction was to courses vain;
His companies unletter'd, rude and shallow;
His hours fill'd up with riots, banquets, sports;
And never noted in him any study,
Any retirement, any sequestration
From open haunts and popularity.
[Theobald: So that the act, and]

This emendation is received by Dr. Warburton, but it appears to me founded upon a misinterpretation. The true meaning seems to be this. He discourses with so much skill on all subjects, that "the art and practice of life must be the mistress or teacher of his theorique," that is, "that his theory must have been taught by art and practice," which, says he, "is strange since he could see little of the true art or practice among his loose companions, nor ever retired to digest his

practice into theory": "art" is used by the authour for "practice," as distinguished from "science" or "theory." (IV.366)

I.I.66 BISHOP OF ELY.

Unseen, yet crespive in his faculty.
Encreasing in its proper power. (IV.366)

I.I.86 CANTERBURY.

The severals, and unhidden passages
Of his true titles
This line I suspect of corruption, though it may be fairly enough explained: the "passages" of his "titles" are the "lines" of "succession," by which his claims descend. "Unhidden" is "open, clear." (IV.367)

I.II.5 KING HENRY.

some things of weight,
That task our thoughts
Keep busied with scruples and laborious disquisitions. (IV.368)

I.II.13 KING HENRY.

And, God forbid, my dear and faithful Lord,
That you should fashion, wrest, or bow your reading;
Or nicely charge your understanding soul
Take heed lest by nice and subtle sophistry you burthen your knowing soul, or "knowingly burthen your soul," with the guilt of advancing a false title, or of maintaining, by specious fallacies, a claim which, if shewn in its native and true colours, would appear to be false. (IV.368)

I.II.16 KING HENRY.

With opening titles miscreate
Ill-begotten; illegitimate; spurious. (IV.368)

I.II.21 KING HENRY.

Therefore take heed, how you impawn our person
The whole drift of the king is to impress upon the archbishop a due sense of the caution with which he is to speak. He tells him that the crime of unjust war, if the war be unjust, shall rest upon him.
Therefore take heed how you impawn *your* person.
So I think it should be read.
"Take heed how you *pledge yourself*," your honour, your happiness, in support of bad advice.

Dr. Warburton explains "impawn" by "engage," and so escapes the difficulty. (IV.369)

I.ii.72 CANTERBURY.

To fine his title with some shews of truth

This is the reading of the 4to of 1608, that of the folio is, "To *find* his title." I would read,

To *line* his title with some shew of truth.

To "line" may signify at once to decorate and to strengthen. In *Macbeth*:

He did *line* the rebels with hidden help and vantage.

Dr. Warburton says, that "to fine his title," is to "refine" or improve it. The reader is to judge.

I now believe that "find" is right; the jury "finds" for the plaintiff, or "finds" for the defendant: to "find" his title is, "to determine in favour of his title with some shew of truth." (IV.370)

I.ii.93 CANTERBURY.

And rather chuse to hide them in a net,

Than amply to imbare their crooked titles

[Mr. Pope reads: "Than *openly imbrace*." But where is the antithesis betwixt "hide" in the preceding line, and "imbrace" in this? The two old folio's read, "Than amply to *imbarre* —." THEOBALD.]

Mr. Theobald might have found in the quarto of 1608, this reading, Than amply to *embrace* their crooked causes,

out of which line Mr. Pope formed his reading, erroneous indeed, but not merely capricious. (IV.371)

I.ii.125 WESTMORLAND.

They know, your Grace hath cause;

and means and might

So hath your Highness

[We should read "your *race had* cause," which is carrying on the sense of the concluding words of Exeter: "As did the former lions of your blood." Warburton]

I do not see but the present reading may stand as I have pointed it. (IV.372)

I.ii.130 CANTERBURY.

O, let their bodies follow, my dear Liege,

With blood and sword, and fire, to win your right.

These two lines Dr. Warburton gives to Westmorland, but with so little reason that I have continued them to Canterbury. The credit of old copies, though not great, is yet more than nothing. (IV.372)

I.ii.145 KING HENRY.

Who hath been still a giddy neighbour to us
That is, inconstant, changeable. (IV.373)

I.ii.147 KING HENRY.

Never went with his forces into France
[Warburton: Ne'er ... full forces]
There is no need of alteration. (IV.373)

I.ii.163 CANTERBURY.

And make your chronicle as rich with praise
[Warburton: prize]

The change of "praise" to "prize," I believe no body will approve; the similitude between the chronicle and sea consists only in this, that they are both full, and filled with something valuable. Besides, Dr. Warburton presupposes a reading which exists in no ancient copy, for "his chronicle" as the later editions give it, the quarto has "your," the folio "their chronicle."

"Your" and "their" written by contraction "yr" are just alike, and "her" in the old hands is not much unlike "yr." I believe we should read "her" chronicle. (IV.373)

I.ii.174 BISHOP OF ELY.

It follows then, the cat must stay at home,
Yet that is but a crush'd necessity
[Folios: Crush'd. Quarto: curs'd. Warburton: 'scus'd.]

Neither the old readings nor the emendation seem very satisfactory. "A *cursed* necessity" has no sense, "a '*scus'd* necessity" is so harsh that one would not admit it, if any thing else can be found. "A *crush'd* necessity" may mean, a "necessity" which is "subdu'd" and "overpowered" by contrary reasons. We might read a "crude" necessity, a "necessity" not "complete," or not well considered and digested, but it is too harsh.

Sir T. Hanmer reads,
Yet that is not *o'course* a necessity.
(IV.374)

I.ii.183 CANTERBURY.

Therefore heaven doth divide
 The state of man in diverse functions,
 Setting endeavour in continual motion,
 To which is fixed, as an aim or butt,
 Obedience.

Neither the sense nor the construction of this passage is very obvious. The construction is, "endeavour—as an aim or butt to which endeavour, obedience is fixed." The sense is, that all endeavour is to terminate in obedience, to be subordinate to the publick good and general design of government. (IV.375)

I.ii.192 CANTERBURY.

Others, like merchants, venture trade abroad
 [Warburton: merchant venturers,]

If the whole difficulty of this passage consists in the obscurity of the phrase "to venture trade," it may be easily cleared. To "venture trade" is a phrase of the same import and structure as to "hazard battle." Nothing could have raised an objection but the desire of being busy. (IV.375)

I.ii.199 CANTERBURY.

The civil citizens kneading up the honey
 [Warburton: heading]

"To *head* the honey" can hardly be right; for though we "head" the cask, no man talks of "heading" the commodities. To "knead" gives an easy sense, though not physically true. The bees do in fact "knead" the wax more than the honey, but that Shakespeare perhaps did not know. (IV.376)

I.ii.211 CANTERBURY.

So may a thousand actions, once a-foot
 [Warburton: actions't once a foot, i.e. at once]

Sir T. Hanmer is more kind to this emendation by reading "acts at once." The change is not necessary, the old text may stand. (IV.376)

I.ii.231 KING HENRY.

or else our grave,
 Like Turkish mute, shall have a tongueless mouth;
 Not worshipt with a waxen epitaph.
 [The quarto 1608 reads, "with a *paper* epitaph." STEEVENS]

This reading is more unintelligible, to me at least, than the other; a grave not “dignified” with the slightest memorial. (1773: VI.24)

I.ii.276 KING HENRY.

For that I have laid by my Majesty,
And plodded like a man for working days
To qualify myself for this undertaking, I have descended from my
station, and studied the arts of life in a lower character. (IV.379)

I.ii.281 KING HENRY.

And tell the pleasant Prince, this mock of his
Hath turn’d his balls to gun-stones
When ordnance was first used, they discharged balls not of iron
but of stone. (IV.379)

II. PROLOGUE. 1 CHORUS.

Now all the youth of England are on fire
[In this place, in all the editions hitherto, is inserted the chorus
which I have postponed. That chorus manifestly is intended to ad-
vertise the spectators of the change of the scene to Southampton, and
therefore ought to be placed just before that change, and not here,
where the scene is still continued in London. POPE I have replaced
this chorus here, by the authority of the old folio’s; and ended the
first act, as the poet certainly intended. THEOBALD]

I think Mr. Pope mistaken in transposing this chorus, and Mr.
Theobald in concluding the act with it. The chorus evidently intro-
duces that which follows, not comments on that which precedes, and
therefore rather begins than ends the act, and so I have printed it. Dr.
Warburton follows Mr. Pope. (IV.380)

II. PROLOGUE. 28 CHORUS.

And by their hands this grace of kings must die,
If hell and treason hold their promises,
Ere he take ship for France; and in Southampton.
Linger your patience on, and well digest
Th’ abuse of distance, while we force a play.
The sum is paid, the traitors are agreed,
The King is set from London, and the scene
Is now transported, gentles, to Southampton:
There is the play-house now, there must you sit

I suppose every one that reads these lines looks about for a meaning which he cannot find. There is no connection of sense nor regularity of transition from one thought to the other. It may be suspected that some lines are lost, and in that case the sense is irretrievable. I rather think the meaning is obscured by an accidental transposition, which I would reform thus:

And by their hands this grace of kings must die,
 If hell and treason hold their promises.
 The sum is paid, the traitors are agreed,
 The King is set from London, and the scene
 Is now transported, gentles, to Southampton
 Ere he take ship for France. And in Southampton
 Linger your patience on, and well digest
 Th' abuse of distance, while we force a play.
 There is the play-house now.

This alteration restores sense, and probably the true sense. The lines might be otherwise ranged, but this order pleases me best. (IV.382)

II. PROLOGUE. 40 CHORUS.

We'll not offend one stomach with our play.

That is, you shall pass the sea without the qualms of sea-sickness. (IV.383)

II. PROLOGUE. 41 CHORUS.

But, 'till the King come forth, and not till then,
 Unto Southampton do we shift our scene.

Here seems to be something omitted. Sir T. Hanmer reads
 But *when* the King *comes* forth

which, as the passage now stands, is necessary. These lines, obscure as they are, refute Mr. Pope's conjectures on the true place of the chorus; for they shew that something is to intervene before the scene changes to Southampton. (IV.383)

II.i.1 [Stage direction] Enter Corporal Nim, and Lieutenant Bardolph.

At this scene begins the connection of this play with the latter part of *King Henry IV*. The characters would be indistinct, and the incidents unintelligible, without the knowledge of what passed in the two foregoing plays. (IV.383)

II.i.1 BARDOLPH.

Well met, Corporal Nim.

[I have chose to begin the 2nd act here, because each act may close regularly with a Chorus. THEOBALD]

I have already shewn why in this edition the act begins with the chorus. (IV.383)

II.i.11 BARDOLPH.

and we'll be all three sworn brothers to France.

We should read, "we'll all *go* sworn brothers to France," or "we'll all be sworn brothers *in* France." (IV.384)

II.i.23 NIM.

Tho' patience be a tir'd mare, yet she will plod.

The folio reads by corruption, "*tired name*," from which Sir T. Hammer, sagaciously enough, derived "*tired dame*." Mr. Theobald retrieved from the quarto "*tired mare*," the true reading. (IV.384)

II.i.39 PISTOL.

Pish for thee, Island dog; thou prick-ear'd cur of Island.

I believe we should read "*Iceland dog*." He seems to allude to an account credited in Elizabeth's time, that in the North there was a nation with human bodies and dogs' heads. (IV.385)

II.i.50 PISTOL.

For I can take, and Pistol's cock is up,

And flashing fire will follow.

I know not well what he can "*take*." The quarto reads "*talk*." In our authour, "*to take*," is sometimes to "*blast*," which sense may serve in this place. (IV.385)

II.ii.17 KING HENRY.

Doing the execution and the act

For which we have in head assembled them?

[Warburton: in aid]

It is strange that the commentator should forget a word so eminently observable in this writer, as "*head*" for "*an army formed*." (IV.388)

II.ii.31 GREY.

With hearts create of duty and of zeal.

Hearts "*compounded*" or "*made up*" of duty and zeal. (IV.389)

II.ii.41 KING HENRY.

We consider,
 It was excess of wine that set him on,
 And on his more advice we pardon him.
 On his return to more "coolness of mind." (IV.389)

II.ii.54 KING HENRY.

If little faults, proceeding on distemper,
 Shall not be wink'd at
 ["proceeding on distemper," i.e. sudden passions. WARBUR-
 TON]

Perturbation of mind. "Temper" is equality or calmness of mind, from an equipoise or due mixture of passions. "Distemper" of mind is the predominance of a passion, as "distemper" of body is the predominance of a "humour." (IV.390)

II.ii.55 KING HENRY.

how shall we stretch our eye,
 When capital crimes, chew'd, swallow'd and digested,
 Appear before us?
 If we may not "wink" at small faults, "how wide must we open our eyes *at great*." (IV.390)

II.ii.103 KING HENRY.

though the truth of it stand off as gross
 As black and white, my eye will scarcely see it.
 Though the truth be as apparent and visible as black and white contiguous to each other. To "stand off" is *être relevé*, to be prominent to the eye, as the strong parts of a picture. (IV.391)

II.ii.105 KING HENRY.

Treason and murder ever kept together,
 As two yolk-devils sworn to either's purpose,
 Working so grosly in a natural cause
 ["Grosly" for "commonly," which the Oxford editor not understanding, alters it to "closely." WARBURTON]
 "Grosly" is neither "closely" nor "commonly," but "palpably"; with a plain and visible connexion of cause and effect. (IV.392)

II.ii.118 KING HENRY.

But he, that temper'd thee, bade thee stand up

Though "temper'd" may stand for "formed" or "moulded," yet I fancy "tempted" was the authour's word, for it answers better to "suggest" in the opposition. (IV.392)

II.ii.126 KING HENRY.

Oh, how hast thou with jealousy infected

The sweetness of affiance! Shew men dutiful?

Why so didst thou.

Shakespeare urges this aggravation of the guilt of treachery with great judgment. One of the worst consequences of breach of trust is the diminution of that confidence which makes the happiness of life, and the dissemination of suspicion, which is the poison of society. (IV.392)

II.ii.134 KING HENRY.

Garnish'd and deck'd in modest compliment

["Modest complement," that is, "fulness." Warburton]

This note will not much help the reader, unless he knows to what "fulness" is to be applied. I take the meaning to be this. The King, having mentioned Scroop's temperance in diet, passes on to his decency in dress, and says that he was "decked in modest complement"; that is, he was decorated with ornaments, but such as might be worn without vain ostentation. "Complement" means something more than is necessary; so "complement" in language is what we say *ad conciliandam gratiam*, more than is strictly or literally meant. (IV.393)

II.ii.135 KING HENRY.

Not working with the eye without the ear,

And but in purged judgment trusting neither?

[Warburton: with the ear, but with the eye]

The authour's meaning I should have thought not so difficult to find, as that an emendation should have been proposed. The king means to say of Scroop, that he was a cautious man, who knew that *fronti nulla fides*, that a specious appearance was deceitful, and therefore did not "work with the eye without the ear," did not trust the air or look of any man till he had tried him by enquiry and conversation. Surely this is the character of a prudent man. (IV.393)

II.ii.137 KING HENRY.

Such, and so finely boulded didst thou seem.

[i.e. refined or purged from all faults. POPE]

"Boulded" is the same with "sifted," and has consequently the meaning of "refined." (IV.393)

II.ii.165 GREY.

My fault, but not my body, pardon, Sovereign.

One of the conspirators against Queen Elizabeth, I think Parry, concludes his letter to her with these words, "*a culpa*, but not *a poena*; absolve me most dear Lady." This letter was much read at that time, and the authour doubtless copied it.

This whole scene was much enlarged and improved after the first edition; the particular insertions it would be tedious to mention, and tedious without much use. (IV.394)

II.iii.10 QUICKLY.

He made a finer end

"Finer end," for "final." (IV.396)

II.iii.12 QUICKLY.

A' parted even just between twelve and one, even at the turning o'th' tide.

It has been a very old opinion, which Mead, *De Imperio Solis*, quotes, as if he believed it, that nobody dies but in the time of ebb; half the deaths in London confute the notion, but we find that it was common among the women of the poet's time. (IV.396)

II.iii.16 QUICKLY.

his nose was as sharp as a pen, and a' babled of green fields.

[These words, "and a table of greenfields," are not to be found in the old editions of 1600 and 1608. This nonsense got into all the following editions by a pleasant mistake of the stage editors, who printed from the common piece-meal-written parts in the play-house. A table was here directed to be brought in (it being a scene in a tavern where they drink at parting) and this direction crept into the text from the margin. "Greenfield" was the name of the property-man in that time who furnish'd implements, &c. for the actors, "a table of Greenfield's." POPE] [Theobald emended to "he babled of green fields."] [But he did not consider how ill this agrees with the nature of the Knight's illness, who was now in no "babbling" humour: and

so far from wanting cooling in "green fields," that his feet were cold, and he just expiring. WARBURTON]

Upon this passage Mr. Theobald has a note that fills a page, which I omit in pity to my readers, since he only endeavours to prove, what I think every reader perceives to be true, that at this time no "table" could be wanted. Mr. Pope, in an appendix to his own edition in 12mo, seems to admit Theobald's emendation, which we would have allowed to be uncommonly happy, had we not been prejudiced against it by Mr. Pope's first note, with which, as it excites merriment, we are loath to part. (IV.396)

II.III.22 QUICKLY.

I put my hand into the bed and felt them, and they were as cold as a stone; then I felt to his knees, and so upward, and upward, and all was as cold as any stone.

Such is the end of Falstaff, from whom Shakespeare had promised us in his epilogue to *Henry IV* that we should receive more entertainment. It happened to Shakespeare as to other writers, to have his imagination crowded with a tumultuary confusion of images, which, while they were yet unsorted and unexamined, seemed sufficient to furnish a long train of incidents, and a new variety of merriment, but which, when he was to produce them to view, shrunk suddenly from him, or could not be accommodated to his general design. That he once designed to have brought Falstaff on the scene again, we know from himself; but whether he could contrive no train of adventures suitable to his character, or could match him with no companions likely to quicken his humour, or could open no new vein of pleasantry, and was afraid to continue the same strain lest it should not find the same reception, he has here for ever discarded him, and made haste to dispatch him, perhaps for the same reason for which Addison killed Sir Roger, that no other hand might attempt to exhibit him.

Let meaner authours learn from this example, that it is dangerous to sell the bear which is yet not hunted, to promise to the publick what they have not written.

This disappointment probably inclined Queen Elizabeth to command the poet to produce him once again, and to shew him in love or courtship. This was indeed a new source of humour, and produced a new play from the former characters.

I forgot to note in the proper place, and therefore note here, that Falstaff's courtship, or *The Merry Wives of Windsor*, should be read between *Henry IV* and *Henry V*. (IV.397)

II.iii.47 PISTOL.

My love, give me thy lips.

Look to my chattels, and my moveables. —

Let senses rule.

I think this is wrong, but how to reform it I do not well see. Perhaps we may read,

Let *sense us* rule.

Pistol is taking leave of his wife, and giving her advice as he kisses her; he sees her rather weeping than attending, and supposing that in her heart she is still longing to go with him part of the way, he cries, "Let sense us rule," that is, "let us not give way to foolish fondness, but be ruled by our better understanding." He then continues his directions for her conduct in his absence. (IV.398)

II.iii.49 PISTOL.

The word is, "pitch and pay"

I know not the meaning of "pitch." Perhaps it should be "pinch and pay"; that is, as the language is of the present alehouses, "touch pot, touch penny." (IV.398)

II.iii.54 PISTOL.

Go, clear thy crystals.

Dry thine eyes. (IV.398)

II.iv.2 FRENCH KING.

And more than carefully it us concerns

[Warburton: carelessly]

I do not see any defect in the present reading: "more than carefully" is "with more than common care," a phrase of the same kind with "better than well." (IV.399)

II.iv.34 CONSTABLE.

How modest in exception

How diffident and decent in making objections. (IV.400)

II.iv.51 FRENCH KING.

And he is bred out of that bloody strain,
 That haunted us in our familiar paths.
 [Warburton: hunted]

The emendation weakens the passage. To “haunt” is a word of the utmost horror, which shews that they dreaded the English as goblins and spirits. (IV.401)

II.iv.58 FRENCH KING.

Up in the air, crown'd with the golden sun
 [A nonsensical line of some player. WARBURTON]
 And why of a player? There is yet no proof that the players have interpolated a line. (IV.401)

II.iv.63 FRENCH KING.

let us fear
 The native mightiness and fate of him.
 His “fate” is what is allotted him by destiny, or what he is fated to perform. (IV.401)

II.iv.69 DAUPHINE.

coward dogs
 Most spend their mouths
 That is, “bark”; the sportsman’s term. (IV.402)

II.iv.88 EXETER.

He sends you this most memorable line
 This genealogy; this deduction of his “lineage.” (IV.402)

II.iv.105 EXETER.

upon your head
 Turning the widows’ tears, the orphans’ cries,
 The dead mens’ blood, the pining maidens’ groans
 The disposition of the images were more regular if we were to read thus:

upon your head
 Turning the dead mens’ blood, the widows’ tears,
 The orphans’ cries, the pining maidens’ groans, &c. (IV.403)

II.iv.123 EXETER.

He'll call you to so hot an answer for it,
That caves and womby vaultages of France
Shall hide your trespass

[Mr. Pope rightly corrected it, "shall *chide* —." Warburton]

I doubt whether it be "rightly corrected." The meaning is, that the authours of this insult shall fly to caves for refuge. (IV.403)

II.iv.132 EXETER.

He'll make your Paris Louvre shake for it
This palace was, I think, not built in those times. (IV.404)

III. PROLOGUE. 32 CHORUS.

the nimble gunner

With lynstock now the devilish cannon touches

The staff to which the match is fixed when ordnance is fired.
(IV.406)

III.i.1 KING HENRY.

Once more unto the breach, dear friends, once more;
Or close the wall up with the English dead.

Here is apparently a chasm. One line at least is lost, which contained the other part of a disjunctive proposition. The King's speech is, "Dear friends, *either win the town*, or close up the wall with dead." The old 4to gives no help. (IV.406)

III.i.9 KING HENRY.

Then lend the eye a terrible aspect;
Let it pry thro' the portage of the head,
Like the brass cannon

"Portage," open space, from "port," a gate. Let the eye appear in the head, as cannon through the battlements, or embrasures, of a fortification. (IV.406)

III.i.11 KING HENRY.

let the brow o'erwhelm it,
As fearfully, as doth a galled rock
O'er-hang and jutty his confounded base
His "worn" or "wasted" base. (IV.406)

III.i.16 KING HENRY.

Hold hard the breath, and bend up every spirit
To his full height.

A metaphor from the bow. (IV.406)

III.ii.2 NIM.

the knocks are too hot, and for mine own part, I have not a case of
lives.

A set of lives, of which, when one is worn out, another may serve.
(IV.407)

III.ii.13 PISTOL.

And I;

If wishes would prevail with me,
My purpose should not fail with me,
But thither would I hie.

This passage I have replaced from the first folio, which is the only authentick copy of this play. These lines, which perhaps are part of a song, Mr. Pope did not like, and therefore changed them, in conformity to the imperfect play in 4to, and was followed by the succeeding editors. For "prevail" I should read "avail." (IV.408)

III.ii.21 PISTOL.

Be merciful, great Duke, to men of mould
To men of "earth," to poor mortal men. (IV.408)

III.ii.34 BOY.

For Nim, he hath heard, that men of few words are the best men; and therefore he scorns to say his prayers, lest he should be thought a coward; but his few bad words are match'd with as few good deeds

"Best men." That is, "bravest"; so in the next lines, "good deeds" are "brave actions." (IV.408)

III.ii.44 BOY.

I knew, by that piece of service, the men would carry coals.

It appears that in Shakespeare's age, "to carry coals" was, I know not why, "to endure affronts." So in *Romeo and Juliet*, one servingman asks another whether he will "carry coals." (IV.409)

III.ii.57 FLUELLEN.

for, look you, th' athversary (you may discuss unto the Duke, look you) is digt himself four yards under the countermines

Fluellen means, that the enemy had digged himself "countermines" four yards under the "mines." (IV.409)

III.ii.97 JAMY.

I sall quit you with gud leve, as I may pick occasion

That is, I shall, with your permission, "requite you," that is, "answer you," or interpose with my arguments, as I shall find opportunity. (IV.410)

III.ii.130 FLUELLEN.

Captain Macmorris, when there is more better opportunity to be requir'd, look you, I'll be so bold as to tell you, I know the disciplines of war; and there's an end.

It were to be wished that the poor merriment of this dialogue [ll. 119-133] had not been purchased with so much profaneness. (IV.411)

III.iii.17 KING HENRY.

Do with his smircht complexion all fell feats,
Enlinkt to waste and desolation?

All the savage practices naturally concomitant to the sack of cities. (IV.412)

III.iii.30 KING HENRY.

While yet the cool and temp'rate wind of grace
O'er-blows the filthy and contagious clouds

This is a very harsh metaphor. To "over-blow" is to "drive away," or "to keep off." (IV.413)

III.iv.1 [Stage direction] The French camp. Enter Catharine, and an old gentlewoman.

[I have left this ridiculous scene as I found it; and am sorry to have no colour left, from any of the editions, to imagine it interpolated. **WARBURTON**]

Sir T. Hanmer has rejected it. The scene is indeed mean enough, when it is read, but the grimaces of two French women, and the odd accent with which they uttered the English, made it divert upon the stage. It may be observed, that there is in it not only the French language, but the French spirit. Alice compliments the princess upon her knowledge of four words, and tells her that she pronounces like

the English themselves. The princess suspects no deficiency in her instructress, nor the instructress in herself. Throughout the whole scene there may be found French servility, and French vanity.

I cannot forbear to transcribe the first sentence of this dialogue from the edition of 1608, that the reader who has not looked into the old copies may judge of the strange negligence with which they are printed.

Kate. *Alice venecia, vous aves cates en, vou parte fort bon Angloys englatara, Coman sae palla vou la main en francoy.* (IV.414)

III.IV.40 CATHARINE.

Non, je reciteray à vous promptement; d'hand, de fingre, de mayles, de arme.

ALICE.

De nayles, madame.

It is apparent by the correction of Alice, that the princess forgot "the nails," and therefore it should be left out in her part. (IV.415)

III.V.7 DAUPHINE.

Our syens, put in wild and savage stock

"Savage" is here used in the French original sense, for "silvan," "uncultivated," the same with "wild." (IV.416)

III.v.18 CONSTABLE.

can sodden water,

A drench for sur-reyn'd jades, their barly-broth,

Decoct their cold blood to such valiant heat?

The exact meaning of "sur-reyn'd" I do not know. It is common to give horses over-ridden or feverish, ground malt and hot water mixed, which is called "a mash." To this he alludes. (IV.417)

III.v.40 FRENCH KING.

Charles Delabreth, high constable of France;

You, dukes of Orleans, Bourbon, and of Berry,

Alanson, Brabant, Bar and Burgundy,

Jaques Chatillion, Rambures, Vaudemont,

Beaumont, Grandpree, Roussie, and Faulconbridge,

Loys, Lestraile, Bouciqualt, and Charaloy

Milton somewhere bids the English take notice how their names are misspelt by foreigners, and seems to think that we may lawfully treat foreign names in return with the same neglect. This privilege

seems to be exercised in this catalogue of French names, which, since the sense of the authour is not affected, I have left as I found it. (IV.418)

III.v.50 FRENCH KING.

Rush on his host, as doth the melted snow
Upon the vallies; whose low vassal seat
The Alps doth spit and void his rheum upon.

The poet has here defeated himself by passing too soon from one image to another. To bid the French rush upon the English as the torrents formed from melted snow stream from the Alps, was at once vehement and proper, but its force is destroyed by the grossness of the thought in the next line. (IV.418)

III.vi.38 PISTOL.

Fortune is Bardolph's foe, and frowns on him,
For he hath stol'n a pix, and hanged must a' be,
Damned death!

[Pope: pax. Theobald: pix.]

What Theobald says is true, but might have been told in fewer words: I have examined the passage in Hall. Yet Dr. Warburton rejected the emendation, and continued Pope's note without animadversion. (IV.420)

III.vi.73 GOWER.

they con perfectly in the phrase of war, which they trick up with new-turn'd oaths; and what a beard of the general's cut, and a horrid suite of the camp, will do among foaming bottles and ale-wash'd wits, is wonderful to be thought on! But you must learn to know such slanders of the age, or else you may be marvellously mistook.

This was a character very troublesome to wise men in our authour's time. It is the practice with him, says Ascham, "to be warlike though he never looked enemy in the face, yet some warlike sign must be used, as a slovenly buskin, or an overstarting frownced head, as though out of every hair's top should suddenly start a good big oath." (IV.422)

III.vi.96 FLUELLEN.

the Duke hath lost never a man but one that is like to be executed for robbing a church, one Bardolph, if your Majesty know the man; his face is all bubukles, and whelks, and knobs, and flames of fire;

and his lips blows at his nose, and it is like a coal of fire; sometimes plue, and sometimes red; but his nose is executed, and his fire's out.

This is the last time that any sport can be made with the red face of Bardolph, which, to confess the truth, seems to have taken more hold on Shakespeare's imagination than on any other. The conception is very cold to the solitary reader, though it may be somewhat invigorated by the exhibition on the stage. This poet is always more careful about the present than the future, about his audience than his readers. (IV.423)

III.vi.110 MOUNTJOY.

You know me by my habit.

That is, by his herald's coat. The person of a herald being inviolable was distinguished in those times of formality by a peculiar dress, which is likewise yet worn on particular occasions. (IV.424)

III.vi.118 MOUNTJOY.

Now, speak we on our cue,
With voice imperial.

In our turn. This phrase the authour learned among players, and has imparted it to kings. (IV.424)

III.vi.151 KING HENRY.

Yet, God before, tell him we will come on,
Though France himself

This was an expression in that age for "God being my guide," or, when used to another, "God be thy guide." So in an old dialogue between a herdsman and a maiden going on pilgrimage to Walsingham, the herdsman takes his leave in these words,

Now go thy ways, and *God before*.

To "prevent" was used in the same sense. (IV.425)

III.vii.107 CONSTABLE.

never any body saw it, but his lacquey
He has beaten no body yet but his foot-boy. (IV.429)

III.vii.108 CONSTABLE.

'tis a hooded valour, and when it appears, it will bate.

This is said with allusion to falcons which are kept "hooded" when they are not to fly at game, and as soon as the hood is off "bait" or flap the wing. The meaning is, the dauphin's valour has never been

let loose upon an enemy, yet, when he makes his first essay, we shall see how he will flutter. (IV.429)

III.vii.111 CONSTABLE.

I will cap that proverb

Alluding to the practice of capping verses. (IV.430)

IV. PROLOGUE. 1 CHORUS.

Now entertain conjecture of a time,

When creeping murmur, and the poring dark,

Fills the wide vessel of the universe.

[“Universe” for “horizon”: for we are not to think Shakespeare so ignorant as to imagine it was night over the whole globe at once. He intimates he knew otherwise, by that fine line in *Midsummer Night's Dream*,

following darkness like a dream.

Besides, the image he employs shews he meant but half the globe; the horizon round, which has the shape of a vessel or goblet. WAR-BURTON]

There is a better proof that Shakespeare knew the order of night and day in *Macbeth*.

Now o'er *one half* the world

Nature seems dead.

But there was no great need of any justification. The “universe,” in its original sense, no more means this globe singly than the circuit of the horizon; but, however large in its philosophical sense, it may be poetically used for as much of the world as falls under observation. Let me remark further, that ignorance cannot be certainly inferred from inaccuracy. Knowledge is not always present. (IV.431)

IV. PROLOGUE. 52 CHORUS.

Yet sit and see

Minding true things by what their mock'-ries be.

To “mind” is the same as “to call to remembrance.” (IV.433)

IV.i.21 KING HENRY.

The organs, though defunct and dead before,

Break up their drowsy grave, and newly move

With casted slough and fresh legerity.

"Slough" is the skin which the serpent annually throws off, and by the change of which he is supposed to regain new vigour and fresh youth. "Legerity" is lightness, nimbleness. (IV.434)

IV.1.101 KING HENRY.

the King is but a man as I am: the violet smells to him as it doth to me; the element shews to him as it doth to me; all his senses have but human conditions.

"Conditions" are "qualities." The meaning is, that objects are represented by his senses to him, as to other men by theirs. What is danger to another is danger likewise to him, and when he feels "fear" it is like the fear of meaner mortals. (IV.437)

IV.1.137 WILLIAMS.

some, crying for a surgeon; some, upon their wives left poor behind them; some, upon the debts they owe; some, upon their children rawly left.

That is, "without preparation," "hastily," "suddenly." What is not "matured" is "raw." So in *Macbeth*,

Why in this *rawness* left he wife and children.
(IV.438)

IV.1.174 KING HENRY.

Every subject's duty is the King's, but every subject's soul is his own. Therefore should every soldier in the wars do as every sick man in his bed, wash every moth out of his conscience; and dying so, death is to him advantage; or not dying, the time was blessedly lost, wherein such preparation was gained: and, in him that escapes, it were not sin to think, that making God so free an offer, he let him out-live that day to see his greatness, and to teach others how they should prepare.

This is a very just distinction, and the whole argument is well followed, and properly concluded. (IV.439)

IV.1.195 WILLIAMS.

that's a perilous shot out of an eldergun

In the old play the thought is more opened. "It is a great displeasure that an elder-gun can do against a cannon." (IV.440)

IV.1.222 KING HENRY.

Indeed, the French may lay twenty French crowns to one, they will beat us, for they bear them on their shoulders; but it is no English treason to cut French crowns, and to morrow the King himself will be a clipper.

This conceit, rather too low for the King, has been already explained, as alluding to the venereal disease. (IV.441)

IV.1.226-80 KING HENRY.

Upon the King! let us our lives, our souls,
Our debts, our careful wives, our children and
Our sins, lay on the King; he must bear all.

There is something very striking and solemn in this soliloquy, into which the King breaks immediately as soon as he is left alone. Something like this, on less occasions, every breast has felt. Reflection and seriousness rush upon the mind upon the separation of a gay company, and especially after forced and unwilling merriment. (IV.441)

IV.1.239 KING HENRY.

What are thy rents? what are thy comings in?
O ceremony, shew me but thy worth,
What is thy soul, O adoration?
[Warburton: thy toll]

This emendation is not ill conceived, yet I believe it is erroneous. The first copy reads, "What? is the soul of Adoration." This is incorrect, but I think we may discover the true reading easily enough to be, "What is thy soul, O *adoration*?" That is, "*O reverence paid to Kings*, what art thou within? What are thy real qualities? What is thy intrinsic value?" (IV.441)

IV.1.259 KING HENRY.

The farsed title running 'fore the King
"Farsed" is "stuffed." The tumid puffy titles with which a king's name is always introduced. This I think is the sense. (IV.442)

IV.1.263 KING HENRY.

Not all these, laid in bed majestical,
Can sleep so soundly as the wretched slave;
Who, with a body fill'd, and vacant mind,
Gets him to rest, cramm'd with distressful bread,
Never sees horrid night, the child of hell,

But, like a lacquey, from the rise to set,
Sweats in the eye of Phoebus; and all night
Sleeps in Elysium

These lines are exquisitely pleasing. "To sweat in the eye of Phoebus," and "to sleep in Elysium," are expressions very poetical. (IV.443)

IV.I.286 KING HENRY.

take from them now
The sense of reck'ning; lest th' opposed numbers
Pluck their hearts from them.
[In former editions:
take from them now
The sense of reck'ning of th' opposed numbers:
Pluck their hearts from them.

Thus the first folio. The poet might intend, "take from them the sense of reckoning those opposed numbers; *which* might pluck their courage from them." But the "relative" not being express'd, the sense is very obscure. THEOBALD]

The change is admitted by Dr. Warburton, and rightly. Sir T. Hanmer reads,

th' opposed numbers
Which stand before them.

This reading he borrowed from the old quarto, which gives the passage thus,

Take from them now the sense of reckoning,
That the opposed multitudes that stand before them
May not appall their courage. (IV.444)

IV.I.300 KING HENRY.

Since that my penitence comes after all,
Imploring pardon.

[We must observe, that Henry IV had committed an injustice, of which he, and his *son*, reap'd the fruits. But reason tells us, justice demands that they who share the profits of iniquity, shall share also in the punishment. Scripture again tells us, that when men have sinned, the Grace of God gives frequent invitations to repentance; which, in the language of divines, are stiled "calls." These, if neglected, or carelessly dallied with, are, at length, irrecoverably withdrawn, and then

repentance comes too late. All this shews that the unintelligible reading of the text should be corrected thus,

— — — — comes after *call*.

WARBURTON]

I wish the commentator had explained his meaning a little better; for his comment is to me less intelligible than the text. I know not what he thinks of the king's penitence, whether coming "in consequence of call," it is sufficient; or whether coming when "calls have ceased," it is ineffectual. The first sense will suit but ill with the position, that "all which he can do is nothing worth," and the latter as ill with the intention of Shakespeare, who certainly does not mean to represent the king as abandoned and reprobate.

The old reading is in my opinion easy and right. "I do all this," says the king, "though all that I can do is nothing worth," is so far from an adequate expiation of the crime, "that penitence comes after all, imploring pardon" both for the crime and the expiation. (IV.444)

IV.ii.4 DAUPHINE.

Via! — les eaux & la terre. —

ORLEANS.

Rien puis! le air & feu. —

DAUPHINE.

Ciel! Cousin Orleans. — (IV.445)

The *Revisal* reads,

DAUPHINE.

Voyez — les eaux et la terre.

ORLEANS.

Rien — puis l'air et le feu.

DAUPHINE.

Le ciel — cousin Orleans.

This is well conjectured, nor does the passage deserve that more should be done, yet I know not whether it might not stand thus.

DAUPHINE.

Voyez les eaux et la terre.

ORLEANS.

L'air et le feu — Rien puis?

DAUPHINE.

Le ciel. Appendix

Via is an old hortatory exclamation, as *allons!*

IV.ii.34 CONSTABLE.

Then let the trumpets sound

The tucket sonance, and the note to mount,

For our approach shall so much dare the field,

That England shall couch down in fear, and yield.

He uses terms of the field as if they were going out only to the chase for sport. "To dare the field" is a phrase in falconry. Birds are dared when, by the falcon in the air, they are terrified from rising, so that they will be sometimes taken by the hand.

Such an easy capture the lords expected to make of the English. (IV.446)

IV.ii.49 GRANDPREE.

And in their pale dull mouths the gimmal bitt

"Gimmal" is in the western countries a "ring"; a "gimnal bit" is therefore a "bit" of which the parts play'd one within another. (IV.447)

IV.ii.51 GRANDPREE.

And their executors, the knavish crows,

Fly o'er them, all impatient for their hour.

The crows who are to have the disposal of what they shall leave, their hides and their flesh. (IV.447)

IV.ii.60 CONSTABLE.

I stay but for my guard

It seems, by what follows, that "guard" in this place means rather something of ornament or of distinction than a body of attendants. (IV.447)

IV.iii.23 KING HENRY.

God's will! I pray thee, wish not one man more.

By Jove, I am not covetous of gold

The king prays like a Christian, and swears like a heathen. (IV.449)

IV.iii.49 KING HENRY.

Old men forget; yet shall not all forget,
 But they'll remember, with advantages,
 What feats they did that day.

Old men, notwithstanding the natural forgetfulness of age, shall remember "their feats of this day," and remember to tell them "with advantage." Age is commonly boastful, and inclined to magnify past acts and past times. (IV.449)

IV.iii.57 KING HENRY.

And Crispin Crispian shall ne'er go by,
 From this day to the ending of the world,
 But we in it shall be remembered

It may be observed that we are apt to promise to ourselves a more lasting memory than the changing state of human things admits. This prediction is not verified; the feast of Crispin passes by without any mention of Agincourt. Late events obliterate the former: the civil wars have left in this nation scarcely any tradition of more ancient history. (IV.450)

IV.iii.62 KING HENRY.

be he ne'er so vile,
 This day shall gentle his condition.

This day shall advance him to the rank of a gentleman. (IV.450)

IV.iii.66 KING HENRY.

And hold their manhoods cheap, while any speaks,
 That fought with us upon St. Crispian's day.

This speech, like many others of the declamatory kind, is too long. Had it been contracted to about half the number of lines, it might have gained force, and lost none of the sentiments. (IV.450)

IV.iii.69 SALISBURY.

The French are bravely in their battles set
 "Bravely" is "splendidly, ostentatiously." (IV.450)

IV.iii.74 WESTMORLAND.

God's will, my Liege. 'Would you and I alone
 Without more help could fight this royal battle!

KING HENRY.

Why, now thou hast unwish'd five thousand men

By wishing only thyself and me, thou hast wished five thousand men away. Shakespeare never thinks on such trifles as numbers. In the last scene the French are said to be "full threescore thousand," which Exeter declares to be "five to one"; but, by the King's account, they are twelve to one. (IV.450)

IV.iii.104 KING HENRY.

Mark then a bounding valour in our English:

That being dead, like to the bullet's grazing,

Breaks out into a second course of mischief,

Killing in relapse of mortality.

What it is "to kill in relapse of mortality," I do not know. I suspect that it should be read,

Killing in *reliques* of mortality.

That is, continuing to "kill" when they are the "reliques" that "death" has left behind it.

That the allusion is, as Mr. Theobald thinks, "exceedingly beautiful," I am afraid few readers will discover. The "valour" of a putrid body, that destroys by the stench, is one of the thoughts that do no great honour to the poet. Perhaps from this putrid valour Dryden might borrow the posthumous empire of Don Sebastian, who was to reign wheresoever his atoms should be scattered. (IV.452)

IV.iii.109 KING HENRY.

We are but warriors for the working day

We are soldiers but coarsely dressed; we have not on our holiday apparel. (IV.452)

IV.iv.9 PISTOL.

O Signieur Dewe, thou diest on point of fox

"Point of fox" is an expression which, if the editors understood it, they should have explained. I suppose we may better read,

On point of *faulchion*. (IV.453)

IV.iv.14 PISTOL.

For I will fetch thy rym out at thy throat,

In drops of crimson blood.

[Warburton: Or I will fetch thy *ransom* out of thy throat]

I know not what to do with "rym." The measure gives reason to suppose that it stands for some monosyllable; and besides, "ran-some" is a word not likely to have been corrupted. (IV.454)

IV.iv.16 FRENCH SOLDIER.

Est-il impossible d'échapper la force de ton bras?

PISTOL.

Brass, cur?

Thou damned and luxurious mountain goat,

Offer'st me brass?

[Hawkins: the pun on bras.]

If the pronunciation of the French language be not changed since Shakespeare's time, which is not unlikely, it may be suspected some other man wrote the French scenes. *Appendix*

IV.iv.22 PISTOL.

is that a ton of moys?

"Moy" is a piece of money, whence *moi d'or*, or "moi" of gold. (IV.454)

IV.iv.68 BOY.

Bardolph and Nim had ten times more valour than this roaring devil i'th' old play; every one may pare his nails with a wooden dagger

In modern puppet-shows, which seem to be copied from the old farces, Punch sometimes fights the devil and always overcomes him. I suppose the Vice of the old farce, to whom Punch succeeds, used to fight the devil with a wooden dagger. (IV.455)

IV.vii.1 FLUELLEN.

Kill the poyes and the luggage! 'tis expresly against the law of arms; 'tis as arrant a piece of knavery, mark you now, as can be desir'd in your conscience now, is it not?

GOWER.

'Tis certain, there's not a boy left alive; and the cowardly rascals, that ran away from the battle, have done this slaughter. Besides, they have burn'd or carried away all that was in the King's tent; wherefore the King most worthily has caus'd ev'ry soldier to cut his prisoner's throat. O 'tis a gallant King!

[In resentment of French villainy, the King, "contrary to his wonted lenity, order'd all prisoners' throats to be cut." THEOBALD]

Unhappily the King gives one reason for his order to kill the prisoners, and Gower another. The King killed his prisoners because he expected another battle, and he had not men sufficient to guard one army and fight another. Gower declares that the "gallant King" has "worthily" ordered the prisoners to be destroyed, because the luggage was plundered, and the boys were slain. (IV.458)

IV.vii.44 FLUELLEN.

so also Harry Monmouth, being in his right wits and his good judgments, turn'd away the fat Knight with the great belly-doublet. He was full of jests and gypes, and knaveries, and mocks; I have forgot his name.

This is the last time that Falstaff can make sport. The poet was loath to part with him, and has continued his memory as long as he could. (IV.460)

IV.vii.60 KING HENRY.

Besides, we'll cut the throats of those we have

The King is in a very bloody disposition. He has already cut the throats of his prisoners, and threatens now to cut them again. No haste of composition could produce such negligence; neither was this play, which is the second draught of the same design, written in haste. There must be some dislocation of the scenes. If we place these lines at the beginning of the twelfth [sixth] scene, the absurdity will be removed, and the action will proceed in a regular series. This transposition might easily happen in copies written for the players. Yet it must not be concealed, that in the imperfect play of 1608 the order of the scenes is the same as here. (IV.461)

IV.vii.131 KING HENRY.

It may be, his enemy is a gentleman of great sort
High rank. So in the ballad of Jane Shore,
Lords and ladies of *great sort*. (IV.463)

IV.vii.132 KING HENRY.

[A gentleman] quite from the answer of his degree.

A man of such station as is not bound to hazard his person in "answer" to a challenge from one of the soldier's "low degree." (IV.463)

IV.viii.12 FLUELLEN.

Stand away, Captain Gower, I will give treason his payment into plows, I warrant you.

The *Revisal* reads, very reasonably, "in *two* plows." *Appendix*

IV.viii.38 KING HENRY.

Give me thy glove, soldier; look, here is the fellow of it.

It must be, "give me *my* glove," for of the soldier's glove the King had not the fellow. (IV.466)

IV.viii.85 KING HENRY.

So that in these ten thousand they have lost,

There are but sixteen hundred mercenaries:

The rest are Princes, Barons, Lords, Knights, 'Squires,

And gentlemen of blood and quality.

"Mercenaries" are in this place "common soldiers," or "hired soldiers." The gentlemen served at their own charge in consequence of their tenures. (IV.468)

V.PROLOGUE. 21 CHORUS.

Giving full trophy, signal, and ostent,

Quite from himself to God.

Transferring all the honours of conquest, all trophies, tokens, and shews, from himself to God. (IV.470)

V.PROLOGUE. 29 CHORUS.

As by a lower but by loving likelihood,

Were now the General of our gracious Empress

(As in good time he may) from Ireland coming

The later editors, in hope of mending the measure of this line, have injured the sense. The folio reads as I have printed, but all the books, since *revisal* became fashionable, and editors have been more diligent to display themselves than to illustrate their authour, have given the line thus;

As by a *low*, but loving likelihood.

Thus they have destroyed the praise which the poet designed for Essex; for who would think himself honoured by the epithet "*low*"? The poet, desirous to celebrate that great man, whose popularity was then his boast, and afterwards his destruction, compares him to King Harry; but being afraid to offend the rival courtiers, or perhaps the

queen herself, he confesses that he is “lower” than a king, but would never have represented him absolutely as “low.” (IV.470)

V.PROLOGUE. 32 CHORUS.

Bringing rebellion broached on his sword
Spitted; transfixed. (IV.471)

V.i.1 [Stage direction] The English Camp in France. Enter Fluellen and Gower.

This scene ought, in my opinion, to conclude the fourth act, and be placed before the last chorus. There is no English camp in this act; the quarrel apparently happens before the return of the army to England, and not after so long an interval as the chorus has supplied. (IV.471)

V.i.18 PISTOL.

dost thou thirst, base Trojan,
To have me fold up Parca’s fatal web?
Dost thou desire to have me put thee to death. (IV.472)

V.i.33 FLUELLEN.

I will make you to day a squire of low degree.
That is, “I will bring you to the ground.” (IV.472)

V.i.36 GOWER.

Enough, Captain; you have astonish’d him.
That is, you have stunned him with the blow. (IV.472)

V.i.43 PISTOL.

I eat and eat I swear
Thus the first folio, for which the later editors have put, “I eat and swear.” We should read, I suppose, in the frigid tumour of Pistol’s dialect,
I eat and *eke* I swear. (IV.473)

V.i.74 PISTOL.

Doth fortune play the huswife with me now?
That is, the “jilt.” “Huswife” is here in an ill sense. (IV.474)

V.i.75 PISTOL.

News have I, that my Dol is dead i’ th’ spittle
Of malady of France,
And there my rendezvous is quite cut off

We must read, “my *Nell* is dead.” Doll Tearsheet was so little the favourite of Pistol that he offered her in contempt to Nym. Nor would her death have “cut off his rendezvous”; that is, “deprived him of a home.” Perhaps the poet forgot his plan. (IV.474)

V.i.81 PISTOL.

To England will I steal, and there I'll steal;
And patches will I get unto these cudgell'd scars,
And swear, I got them in the Gallia Wars.

The comick scenes of the history of Henry the Fourth and Fifth are now at an end, and all the comick personages are now dismissed. Falstaff and Mrs. Quickly are dead; Nym and Bardolph are hanged; Gadshill was lost immediately after the robbery; Poins and Peto have vanished since, one knows not how; and Pistol is now beaten into obscurity. I believe every reader regrets their departure. (IV.474)

V.ii.1 KING HENRY.

Peace to this meeting, wherefore we are met.
Peace, for which we are here met, be to this meeting.
Here, after the chorus, the fifth act seems naturally to begin.
(IV.475)

V.ii.26 BURGUNDY.

To bring your most imperial Majesties Unto this bar and royal
interview
To this “barrier”; to this place of congress. (IV.476)

V.ii.41 BURGUNDY.

Her vine, the merry chearer of the heart,
Unpruned dies
[Warburton: lyes.]

This emendation is physically right, but poetically the vine may be well enough said to die which ceases to bear fruit. (IV.476)

V.ii.42 BURGUNDY.

her hedges even pleach'd,
Like prisoners, wildly over-grown with hair

This image of prisoners is oddly introduced. A “prisoner” may be “overgrown with hair,” but “wildness” is contrary to the state of a prisoner. A “hedge even-pleach'd” is more properly imprisoned.
(IV.476)

The incongruity of the comparison I continue to censure, but the expression, "wildly overgrown with hair," is justifiable; the hair may be "wild," though the prisoner be confined. *Appendix*

This image of prisoners is oddly introduced. A "hedge even pleach'd" is more properly imprisoned than when it luxuriates in unpruned exuberance. (1773: VI.135)

V.ii.60 BURGUNDY.

That nothing do but meditate on blood,
To swearing and stern looks, diffus'd attire
[Diffus'd, for extravagant. Warburton]

"Diffus'd" is so much used by our authour for "wild," "irregular," and "strange," that in *The Merry Wives of Windsor*, he applies it to a song supposed to be sung by fairies. (IV.477)

V.ii.121 KING HENRY.

I' faith, Kate, my wooing is fit for thy understanding; I am glad thou canst speak no better English, for if thou couldst, thou wouldst find me such a plain king, that thou wouldst think I had sold my farm to buy my crown.

I know not why Shakespeare now gives the King nearly such a character as he made him formerly ridicule in Percy. This military grossness and unskilfulness in all the softer arts, does not suit very well with the gaities of his youth, with the general knowledge ascribed to him at his accession, or with the contemptuous message sent him by the Dauphin, who represents him as fitter for the ball room than the field, and tells him that he is not "to revel into dutchies," or win provinces "with a nimble galliard." The truth is, that the poet's matter failed him in the fifth act, and he was glad to fill it up with whatever he could get; and not even Shakespeare can write well without a proper subject. It is a vain endeavour for the most skilful hand to cultivate barrenness, or to paint upon vacuity. (IV.479)

V.ii.151 KING HENRY.

And while thou liv'st, Kate, take a fellow of plain and uncoined constancy

[i.e. a constancy in the ingot, that hath suffered no alloy, as all coined metal has. Warburton]

I believe this explanation is more ingenious than true; to "coin" is to "stamp" and to "counterfeit." He uses it in both senses; "un-

coined" constancy signifies "real" and "true" constancy, "unrefined" and "unadorned." (IV.480)

V.ii.177 KING HENRY.

I will tell thee in French, which, I am sure, will hang upon my tongue like a married wife about her husband's neck

Every "wife" is a "married wife." I suppose we should read "new married"; an epithet more expressive of fondness. (IV.481)

V.ii.287 BURGUNDY.

Pardon the frankness of my mirth, if I answer you for that. If you would conjure in her, you must make a circle; if conjure up love in her in his true likeness, he must appear naked and blind. Can you blame her then, being a maid yet ros'd over with the virgin crimson of modesty, if she deny the appearance of a naked blind boy, in her naked seeing self? it were, my Lord, a hard condition for a maid to consign to.

We have here but a mean dialogue for princes; the merriment is very gross, and the sentiments are very worthless. (IV.484)

V.ii.307 KING HENRY.

This moral ties me over to time, and a hot summer

That is, the application of this fable: the "moral" being the application of a fable, our authour calls any application a "moral." (IV.485)

EPILOGUE. 2 CHORUS.

Our blending author hath pursu'd the story;

In little room confining mighty men,

Mangling by starts the full course of their glory.

"By starts." By touching only on select parts. (IV.487)

This play has many scenes of high dignity, and many of easy merriment. The character of the King is well supported, except in his courtship, where he has neither the vivacity of Hal, nor the grandeur of Henry. The humour of Pistol is very happily continued; his character has perhaps been the model of all the bullies that have yet appeared on the English stage.

The lines given to the chorus have many admirers; but the truth is, that in them a little may be praised, and much must be forgiven; nor can it be easily discovered why the intelligence given by the chorus is more necessary in this play than in many others where it is omitted. The great defect of this play is the emptiness and narrowness of

the last act, which a very little diligence might have easily avoided.
(IV.487)

HENRY VI, PART 1

I.1.3 BEDFORD.

Brandish your crystal tresses in the sky
[Warburton: cristed or crested]
I believe "crystal" is right. (IV.492)

I.1.25 EXETER.

Or shall we think the subtle-witted French
Conj'ers and sorc'ers, that, afraid of him,
By magick verse have thus contriv'd his end?

There was a notion prevalent a long time, that life might be taken away by metrical charms. As superstition grew weaker these charms were imagined only to have power on irrational animals. In our author's time it was supposed that the Irish could kill rats by a song. (IV.493)

I.1.52 BEDFORD.

Henry the Fifth! thy ghost I invoke;
Prosper this realm, keep it from civil broils,
Combat with adverse planets in the heavens;
A far more glorious star thy soul will make,
Than Julius Caesar, or bright— — —

[I can't guess the occasion of the hemystic and imperfect sense in this place; 'tis not impossible it might have been filled up with—"Francis Drake"—tho' that were a terrible anachronism; (as bad as Hector's quoting Aristotle in *Troilus and Cressida*) yet perhaps at the time that brave Englishman was in his glory, to an English-hearted audience, and pronounced by some favourite actor, the thing might be popular, tho' not judicious; and therefore by some critick in favour of the author afterwards struck out. But this is a mere slight conjecture. POPE]

To confute the "slight" conjecture of Pope a whole page of vehement opposition is annexed to this passage by Theobald. Sir T. Hammer has stopped at "Caesar"—perhaps more judiciously. It might however have been written—"or bright Berenice." (IV.494)

I.ii.27 REIGNIER.

The other lords, like lions wanting food,
 Do rush upon us as their hungry prey.
 I believe it should be read,
 As their *hungred* prey. (IV.499)

I.ii.41 REIGNIER.

I think, by some odd gimmals or device
 Their arms are set like clocks, still to strike on
 A “gimmel” is a piece of jointed work, where one piece moves
 within another, whence it is taken at large for an “engine.” It is now
 by the vulgar called a “gimcrack.” (IV.500)

I.ii.48 BASTARD.

Methinks, your looks are sad, your chear appall’d
 “Chear” is countenance, appearance. (IV.500)

I.ii.58 BASTARD.

Speak, shall I call her in? Believe my words
 It should rather be read,
 —believe *her* words. (IV.501)

I.ii.130 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

This night the siege assuredly I’ll raise,
 Expect Saint Martin’s summer, Halcyon days
 That is, expect “prosperity” after “misfortune,” like fair weather at
 Martlemas, after winter has begun. (IV.503)

I.iii.36 GLOUCESTER.

I’ll canvass thee in thy broad Cardinal’s hat
 This means, I believe, “I’ll tumble thee into thy great hat, and shake
 thee as bran and meal are shaken in a sieve.” *Appendix*

I.iii.53 GLOUCESTER.

Winchester Goose! I cry, a rope, a rope.
 A clap, or rather a strumpet was called a Winchester goose.
 (IV.506)
 A strumpet, or the consequences of her love, was a Winchester
 goose. (1773: VI.167)

I.iii.89 MAYOR.

Good God! that nobles should such stomachs bear!

I myself fight not once in forty year.

[Warburton assigns the lines to the Mayor's officer.]

I see no reason for this change. The Mayor speaks first as a magistrate, and afterwards as a citizen. (IV.507)

I.iv.9 MASTER-GUNNER.

The English, in the suburbs close intrench'd,

Went thro' a secret grate of iron bars,

In yonder tow'r, to over-peer the city

That is, "the English went, *not* through a secret grate, *but* went to overpeer the city through a secret grate *which is* in yonder tower." I did not know till of late that this passage had been thought difficult.

Appendix

I.iv.107 TALBOT.

Pucelle or Pussel, Dauphin or Dog-fish

I know not what "pussel" is: perhaps it should be "Pucelle" or "puzzle." Something with a meaning it should be, but a very poor meaning will serve. (IV.511)

I.v.5 TALBOT.

Devil, or devil's dam, I'll conjure thee.

Blood will I draw on thee, thou art a witch;

And straitway give thy soul to him thou serv'st.

The superstition of those times taught that he that could draw the witch's blood, was free from her power. (IV.512)

I.vi.21 DAUPHINE.

A statelier pyramid to her I'll rear,

Than Rhodope's or Memphis' ever was!

Rhodope was a famous strumpet, who acquired great riches by her trade. One of the pyramids of Memphis was raised by the prostitution of the king's daughter. I think he means to call her strumpet all the while he is making this loud praise of her. (1773: VI.176)

II.i.39 ALANSON.

How now, my Lords? what all unready so?

"Unready" was the current word in those times for "undressed." (IV.517)

II.iv.5 PLANTAGENET.

Then say at once, if I maintain'd the truth;
 And was not wrangling Somerset in th' error?
 All the editions read,
 Or else was wrangling Somerset i'th' error?

Here is apparently a want of opposition between the two questions.
 I once read,
 Or else was wrangling Somerset *i'th' right*?
 But I have inserted Sir T. Hanmer's emendation. (IV.523)

II.iv.29 PLANTAGENET.

If he suppose that I have pleaded truth,
 From off this briar pluck a white rose with me.

[This is given as the original of the two badges of the house of York and Lancaster, whether truly or not, is no great matter. But the proverbial expression of "saying a thing under the rose," I am persuaded, came from thence. When the nation had ranged itself into two great factions, under the "white" and "red" rose, and were perpetually plotting and counterplotting against one another, then when a matter of faction was communicated by either party to his friend in the same quarrel, it was natural for him to add, that he "said it under the rose"; meaning that, as it concern'd the faction, it was religiously to be kept secret. Warburton]

Of this proverb other authours give other originals, but the question is not of great importance. (IV.524)

II.iv.34 WARWICK.

I love no colours; and without all colour
 Of base insinuating flattery,
 I pluck this white rose with Plantagenet.

"Colours" is here used ambiguously for "tints" and "deceits."
 (IV.524)

II.iv.43 SOMERSET.

Good master Vernon, it is well objected
 Properly thrown in our way, justly proposed. (IV.525)

II.iv.86 PLANTAGENET.

He bears him on the place's privilege

The Temple, being a religious house, was an asylum, a place of exemption, from violence, revenge and bloodshed. (IV.526)

II.v.2 MORTIMER.

Let dying Mortimer here rest himself.

I know not whether Milton did not take from this hint the lines with which he opens his tragedy. (IV.528)

II.v.5 MORTIMER.

And these grey locks, the pursuivants of death

Pursuivants. The heralds that, forerunning death, proclaim its approach. (1773: VI.190)

II.v.11 MORTIMER.

And pithless arms, like to a wither'd vine

"Pith" was used for "marrow," and, figuratively, for "strength." (1773: VI.191)

II.v.29 MORTIMER.

Just death, kind umpire of men's miseries

That is, he that terminates or concludes misery. The expression is harsh and forced. (IV.529)

II.v.113 MORTIMER.

And so, farewell; and fair be all thy hopes,

And prosp'rous be thy life, in peace and war!

[Theobald: fair befall]

This emendation is received by Sir T. Hanmer and Dr. Warburton. I do not see how the readings differ in sense. "Fair" is "lucky," or "prosperous." So we say, a "fair" wind, and "fair" fortune. (IV.531)

III.i.51 WINCHESTER.

This Rome shall remedy.

WARWICK. Roam thither then.

"Roam" to Rome. To "roam" is supposed to be derived from the cant of vagabonds, who often pretended a pilgrimage to Rome. (1773: VI.197)

III.i.92 GLOUCESTER.

You of my houshold, leave this peevish broil;

And set this unaccustom'd fight aside.

"Unaccustomed" is "unseemly, indecent." (IV.536)

III.i.99 3 SERVANT.

To be disgraced by an inkhorn mate
A "bookman." (IV.536)

III.i.131 WARWICK.

Sweet King! the Bishop hath a kindly gird?
i.e. Feels an emotion of kind remorse. (1773: VI.200)

III.i.192 EXETER.

As fester'd members rot but by degrees,
Till bones, and flesh, and sinews, fall away;
So will this base and envious discord breed.
That is, so will the malignity of this discord "propagate itself" and
advance. (IV.539)

III.ii.20 BASTARD.

Here enter'd Pucelle, and her practisants.
"Practice," in the language of that time, was "treachery," and per-
haps in the softer sense "stratagem." "Practisants" are therefore "con-
federates in stratagem." (IV.540)

III.ii.25 REIGNIER.

No way to that for weakness which she enter'd.
That is, "no way equal to that," no way so fit as that. (IV.541)

III.iii.44 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

Look on thy country, look on fertile France;
And see the cities, and the towns defac'd
By wasting ruin of the cruel foe.
As looks the mother on her lowly babe
[It is plain Shakespeare wrote, "lovely babe," it answering to "fer-
tile France" above, which this domestic image is brought to illustrate.
WARBURTON]

The alteration is easy and probable, but perhaps the poet by "lowly
babe" meant the "babe" lying "low" in death. "Lowly" answers
as well to "towns defaced" and "wasting ruin," as "lovely" to "fer-
tile." (IV.547)

III.iii.78 BURGUNDY.

These haughty words of hers
Have batter'd me like roaring cannon-shot

How these lines came hither I know not, there was nothing in the speech of Joan haughty or violent, it was all soft entreaty and mild expostulation. (IV.548)

III.iii.85 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

Done like a Frenchman: turn, and turn again!

[This seems to be an offering of the poet to his royal mistress's resentment, for Henry the Fourth's last great turn in religion, in the year 1593. *WARBURTON*]

The inconstancy of the French was always the subject of satire. I have read a dissertation written to prove that the index of the wind upon our steeples was made in form of a cock, to ridicule the French for their frequent changes. (IV.548)

III.iv.38 BASTARD.

Villain, thou know'st, the law of arms is such,
That, whoso draws a sword, 'tis present death
[*Warburton*: sword i'th' presence 't's death]

This reading cannot be right, because, as Mr. Edwards observed, it cannot be pronounced. It is however a good comment, as it shews the author's meaning. (IV.550)

IV.i.6 GLOUCESTER.

such as shall pretend
Malicious practices against his state.
To "pretend" is to "design," to "intend." (IV.550)

IV.i.35 TALBOT.

full of haughty courage
"Haughty" is here in its original sense for "high." (IV.551)

IV.i.179 WARWICK.

I dare presume, sweet Prince, he thought no harm.
YORK. And, if I wis, he did.
[Earlier reading: And if I wish he did.]

This is followed by the succeeding editors, and is indeed plausible enough, but perhaps this speech may become intelligible enough without any change, only supposing it broken.

And if—I wish—he did.
or perhaps,
And if he did, I wish— — — (IV.556)

IV.ii.28 GENERAL.

Ten thousand French have ta'en the sacrament,
 To rive their dangerous artillery
 Upon no Christian soul but English Talbot.

I do not understand the phrase "to *rive* artillery," perhaps it might be to "drive"; we say "to drive a blow," and to "drive at a man," when we mean to express furious assault. (IV.558)

IV.ii.34 GENERAL.

That I thy enemy due thee withal
 To "due" is to "endue," to "deck," to "grace." (IV.558)

IV.ii.48 TALBOT.

If we be English deer, be then in blood
 Be high in spirits; be of true mettle. (IV.558)

IV.ii.49 TALBOT.

Not rascal like to fall down with a pinch
 A rascal deer is the term of chase for lean poor deer. (1773: VI.221)

IV.ii.51 TALBOT.

Turn on the bloody hounds with heads of steel
 Continuing the image of the "deer" he supposes the lances to be their horns. (IV.558)

IV.iii.13 YORK.

And I am lowted by a traitor villain
 To "lowt" may signify to "depress," to "lower," to "dishonour"; but I do not remember it so used. We may read, "And I am *flouted*." "I am mocked," and treated with contempt. (IV.559)

IV.iii.47 LUCY.

Thus while the vulture of sedition
 Feeds in the bosom of such great commanders
 Alluding to the tale of Prometheus. (IV.560)

IV.iv.19 LUCY.

And, in advantage ling'ring, looks for rescue
 Protracting his resistance by the advantage of a strong post.
 (IV.561)

IV.iv.20 LUCY.

You, his false hopes, the trust of England's honour,
Keep off aloof with worthless emulation.

In this line "emulation" signifies merely "rivalry," not struggle for superior excellence. (IV.561)

IV.v.7 TALBOT.

Now art thou come unto a feast of death
To a field where "death" will be "feasted" with slaughter. (IV.562)

IV.v.16 JOHN TALBOT.

The world will say, he is not Talbot's blood,
That basely fled, when noble Talbot stood.

For what reason this scene is written in rhyme I cannot guess. If Shakespeare had not in other plays mingled his rhymes and blank verses in the same manner, I should have suspected that this dialogue had been a part of some other poem which was never finished, and that being loath to throw his labour away, he inserted it here. (IV.563)

IV.v.22 JOHN TALBOT.

Your loss is great, so your regard should be.
Your care of your own safety. (IV.563)

IV.vi.44 JOHN TALBOT.

Oh what advantage bought with such a shame,
To save a paultry life, and slay bright fame!
[Theobald: Out on that vantage]

Sir T. Hanmer reads, "Oh what advantage," which I have followed, though Mr. Theobald's conjecture may be well enough admitted. (IV.565)

IV.vi.48 JOHN TALBOT.

And like me to the peasant boys of France

"To like one to the peasants" is, to "compare," to "level by comparison," the line is therefore intelligible enough by itself, but in this sense it wants connection. Sir T. Hanmer reads, "And *leave* me," which makes a clear sense and just consequence. But as change is not to be allowed without necessity, I have suffered "like" to stand, because I suppose the authour meant the same as "make like," or "reduce to a level with." (IV.566)

IV.vii.3 TALBOT.

Triumphant Death, smear'd with captivity!

That is, Death stained and dishonoured with captivity. (IV.566)

IV.vii.9 TALBOT.

But when my angry guardant stood alone,

Tendring my ruin

Watching me with tenderness in my fall. (IV.567)

IV.vii.18 TALBOT.

Thou antick death, which laught'st us here to scorn

The "fool," or "antick" of the play, made sport by mocking the graver personages. (IV.567)

IV.vii.21 TALBOT.

Two Talbots winged through the lither sky

"Lither" is "flexible" or "yielding." In much the same sense Milton says,

He with broad sails

Winnow'd the *buxom* air.

That is, the obsequious air. (IV.567)

IV.vii.35 BASTARD.

How the young whelp of Talbot's raging brood

Did flesh his puny sword in Frenchmen's blood!

The return of rhyme where young Talbot is again mentioned, and in no other place, strengthens the suspicion, that these verses were originally part of some other work, and were copied here only to save the trouble of composing new. (IV.568)

IV.vii.40 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

He answer'd thus: "Young Talbot was not born

To be the pillage of a giglot wench."

"Giglot" is a "wanton," or a "strumpet." (IV.568)

IV.vii.51 LUCY.

Conduct me to the Dauphin's tent, to know

Who hath obtain'd the glory of the day.

Lucy's message implied that he knew who had obtained the victory: therefore Sir T. Hanmer reads,

Herald, conduct me to the Dauphin's tent. (IV.569)

V.i.58 WINCHESTER.

Humphry of Glo'ster, thou shalt well perceive,
 That nor in birth, or for authority,
 The Bishop will be over-borne by thee
 I would read "*for birth.*" That is, thou shalt not rule me though thy
 birth is legitimate and thy authority supreme. (IV.572)

V.iii.5 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

You speedy helpers, that are substitutes
 Under the lordly monarch of the north
 The north was always supposed to be the particular habitation of
 bad spirits. Milton therefore assembles the rebel angels in the north.
 (IV.573)

V.iii.62 SUFFOLK.

As plays the sun upon the glassy streams,
 Twinkling another counterfeited beam,
 So seems this gorgeous beauty to mine eyes.
 This comparison, made between things which seem sufficiently
 unlike, is intended to express the softness and delicacy of Lady Mar-
 garet's beauty, which delighted, but did not dazzle; which was bright,
 but gave no pain by its lustre. (IV.575)

V.iii.67 SUFFOLK.

Fy, De La Pole, disable not thyself
 Do not represent thyself so weak. To "*disable*" the judgment of
 another was, in that age, the same as to destroy its credit or authority.
 (IV.576)

V.iv.17 SHEPHERD.

Fy, Joan, that thou wilt be so obstacle
 A vulgar corruption of "*obstinate,*" which I think has oddly lasted
 since our authour's time till now. (IV.580)

V.iv.21 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

You have suborn'd this man
 Of purpose to obscure my noble birth.

SHEPHERD.

'Tis true, I gave a noble to the priest

This passage seems to corroborate an explanation, somewhat far fetched, which I have given in *Henry IV* of the "nobleman" and "Royal man." (IV.580)

V.iv.74 YORK.

Alanson! that notorious Machiavel!

Machiavel being mentioned somewhat before his time, this line is by some of the editors given to the players, and ejected from the text. (IV.582)

V.iv.89 JOAN LA PUCELLE.

But darkness and the gloomy shade of death

Inviron you, 'till mischief and despair

Drive you to break your necks, or hang yourselves!

Perhaps Shakespeare intended to remark in this execration, the frequency of suicide among the English, which has been commonly imputed to the gloominess of their air. (IV.582)

V.iv.98 WINCHESTER.

Have earnestly implor'd a gen'ral peace

Betwixt our nation and th' aspiring French

[Warburton: th'respiring]

The ambassadour yet uses no argument, but if he did, "respiring" would not much help the cause. Shakespeare wrote what might be pronounced, and therefore did not write "th'respiring." (IV.583)

V.iv.120 YORK.

Speak, Winchester; for boiling choler chokes

The hollow passage of my prison'd voice,

By sight of these our baleful enemies.

In the old copies "poison'd voice," which agrees well enough with "baneful enemies," or with "baleful," if it can be used in the same sense. The modern editors read, "prison'd voice." (1773: VI.248)

V.iv.122 YORK.

By sight of these our baleful enemies.

"Baleful" is "sorrowful"; I therefore rather imagine that we should read "baneful," hurtful, or mischievous. (IV.584)

V.iv.150 YORK.

Standst thou aloof upon comparison?

Do you stand to compare your present state, a state which you have neither right or power to maintain, with the terms which we offer? (IV.585)

V.iv.151 YORK.

Either accept the title thou usurp'st,
Of benefit proceeding from our King
"Benefit" is here a term of law. Be content to live as the "beneficiary" of our King. (IV.585)

V.v.5 KING HENRY.

And, like as rigour of tempestuous gusts
Provokes the mightiest hulk against the tide,
So am I driv'n by breath of her renown,
Either to suffer shipwreck, or arrive
Where I may have fruition of her love.
This simile is somewhat obscure; he seems to mean, that as a ship is driven against the tide by the wind, so he is driven by love against the current of his interest. (IV.586)

V.v.31 SUFFOLK.

one, that at a triumph having vow'd
To try his strength
That is, at the sports by which a triumph is celebrated. (IV.587)

V.v.55 SUFFOLK.

But marriage is a matter of more worth,
Than to be dealt in by attorneyship
By the intervention of another man's choice; or the discretional agency of another. (IV.587)

V.v.97 KING HENRY.

If you do censure me, by what you were,
Not what you are, I know, it will excuse
This sudden execution of my will.
To "censure" is here simply to "judge." "If in judging me you consider the past frailties of your own youth." (IV.589)

V.v.100 KING HENRY.

And so conduct me, where, from company,
I may revolve and ruminate my grief.

GLOUCESTER.

Ay; grief, I fear me, both at first and last.

"Grief" in the first line is taken generally for "pain" or "uneasiness"; in the second specially for "sorrow." (IV.589)

Of this play there is no copy earlier than that of the folio in 1623, though the two succeeding parts are extant in two editions in quarto. That the second and third parts were published without the first may be admitted as no weak proof that the copies were surreptitiously obtained, and that the printers of that time gave the publick those plays not such as the authour designed, but such as they could get them. That this play was written before the two others is indubitably collected from the series of events; that it was written and played before *Henry the Fifth* is apparent, because in the epilogue there is mention made of this play, and not of the other parts.

Henry the Sixth in swaddling bands crown'd king,
Whose state so many had the managing
That they lost France, and made his England bleed,
Which oft our stage hath shewn.

France is lost in this play. The two following contain, as the old title imports, the contention of the houses of York and Lancaster.

The two first parts of *Henry VI* were printed in 1600. When *Henry V* was written we know not, but it was printed likewise in 1600, and therefore before the publication of the first and second parts, the first part of *Henry VI* had been often "shown on the stage," and would certainly have appeared in its place had the authour been the publisher. (IV.589)

HENRY VI, PART 2

It is apparent that this play begins where the former ends, and continues the series of transactions, of which it presupposes the first part already known. This is a sufficient proof that the second and third parts were not written without dependance on the first, though they were printed as containing a complete period of history. (V.3)

I.i.25 QUEEN MARGARET.

The mutual conf'rence that my mind hath had,
By day, by night, waking and in my dreams,
In courtly company, or at my beads,
With you, mine alder-liefest Sovereign,
Makes me the bolder to salute my King
I am the bolder to address you, having already familiarised you to
my imagination. (V.4)

I.i.99 BEAUFORD.

Nephew, what means this passionate discourse?
This peroration with such circumstances?
This speech crowded with so many instances of aggravation. (V.7)

I.i.116 WARWICK.

And are the cities, that I got with wounds,
Deliver'd up again with peaceful words?
The indignation of Warwick is natural, and I wish it had been better expressed; there is a kind of jingle intended in "wounds" and "words." (V.7)

I.i.148 BEAUFORD.

Had Henry got an empire by his marriage,
And all the wealthy kingdoms of the west
[Warburton: east]
There are wealthy kingdoms in the west as well as in the east, and the western kingdoms were more likely to be in the thought of the speaker. (V.8)

I.ii.107 HUME.

Sort how it will
Let the issue be what it will. (V.15)

I.iii.95 SUFFOLK.

As for the Duke of York, this late complaint
Will make but little for his benefit.

That is, the complaint of Peter the armourer's man against his master, for saying that York was the rightful king. (V.18)

I.iii.114 GLOUCESTER.

Madam, the King is old enough himself
To give his censure.

Through all these plays "censure" is used in an indifferent sense, simply for "judgment" or "opinion." (V.18)

II.i.1 QUEEN MARGARET.

for flying at the brook,
I saw no better sport these seven years' day
The falconer's term for hawking at water-fowl. (V.26)

II.i.3 QUEEN MARGARET.

the wind was very high,
And, ten to one, old Joan had not gone out.

I am told by a gentleman better acquainted with falconry than myself, that the meaning, however expressed, is, that, the wind being high, it was ten to one that the old hawk had flown quite away; a trick which hawks often play their masters in windy weather. (V.26)

II.i.19 BEAUFORD.

Thy heaven is on earth, thine eyes and thoughts
Bent on a crown, the treasure of thy heart
[1773: Beat on a crown.]
To "bait" or "beat" ("bathe") is a term in falconry. (1773: VI.283)

II.i.25 GLOUCESTER.

Churchmen so hot? good uncle, hide such malice.
With such Holiness can you do it?
[Warburton: not do it.]

The verse is lame enough after the emendation, nor does the negative particle improve the sense. When words are omitted it is not often easy to say what they were if there is a perfect sense without them. I read, but somewhat at random,

A churchman, with such holiness can you do it?

The transcriber saw "churchman" just above, and therefore omitted it in the second line. (V.27)

II.i.174 BEAUFORD.

Your Lady is forth-coming yet at London.
That is, your Lady is in custody. (V.33)

II.i.199 KING HENRY.

And poise the cause in Justice' equal scales,
Whose beam stands sure, whose rightful cause prevails.
The sense will, I think, be mended if we read in the optative mood,
Justice' equal scale,
Whose beam *stand* sure, whose rightful cause *prevail*. (V.33)

II.ii.4 YORK.

In craving your opinion of my title,
Which is infallible, to England's crown.
I know not well whether he means the "opinion" or the "title" is
"infallible." (V.34)

II.iii.21 GLOUCESTER.

Sorrow would solace, and my age would ease.
That is, "Sorrow *would have*, sorrow requires solace, and age re-
quires ease." (V.37)

II.iii.30 QUEEN MARGARET.

God and King Henry govern England's realm:
Give up your staff, Sir, and the King his realm.
The word "realm" at the end of two lines together is displeasing;
and when it is considered that much of this scene is written in rhyme,
it will not appear improbable that the authour wrote, "govern Eng-
land's *helm*." (V.37)

II.iii.89 ARMOURER.

Peter, have at thee with a downright blow. As Bevis of Southamp-
ton fell upon Ascapart.

Ascapart was the giant of the story. (V.40)

Ascapart—the giant of the story—a name familiar to our ancestors,
is mentioned by Dr. Donne,

Those *Ascaparts*, men big enough to throw
Charing-cross for a bar, &c. (1773: VI.297)

II.iv.30 DAME ELEANOR.

Methinks, I should not thus be led along,
 Mail'd up in shame, with papers on my back
 Wrapped up; bundled up in disgrace; alluding to the sheet of
 penance. (V.42)

II.iv.67 GLOUCESTER.

Thy greatest help is quiet, gentle Nell
 The poet has not endeavoured to raise much compassion for the
 dutchess, who indeed suffers but what she had deserved. (V.43)

II.iv.82 GLOUCESTER.

You use her well; the world may laugh again;
 And I may live to do you kindness
 That is, the world may look again favourably upon me. (V.43)

II.iv.110 DAME ELEANOR.

Go, lead the way, I long to see my prison.
 This impatience of a high spirit is very natural. It is not so dreadful
 to be imprisoned, as it is desirable in a state of disgrace to be sheltered
 from the scorn of gazers. (V.44)

III.i.23 QUEEN MARGARET.

Me seemeth then, it is no policy
 That is, "it seemeth to me," a word more grammatical than "me-
 thinks," which has, I know not how, intruded into its place. (V.45)

III.i.42 SUFFOLK.

Well hath your Highness seen into this Duke.
 And, had I first been put to speak my mind,
 I think I should have told your Grace's tale.
 Suffolk uses "Highness" and "Grace" promiscuously to the Queen.
 "Majesty" was not the settled title till the time of King James the First.
 (V.46)

III.i.91 YORK.

But I will remedy this gear ere long
 "Gear" was a general word for "thing" or "matters." (V.48)

III.i.133 SUFFOLK.

My Lord, these faults are easy, quickly answer'd
 "Easy" is "slight," inconsiderable, as in other passages of this au-
 thour. (V.49)

III.I.210 KING HENRY.

And as the butcher takes away the calf,
 And binds the wretch, and beats it when it strays
 [Thirlby: strives]

This emendation is admitted by the succeeding editors, and I had once put it in the text. I am, however, inclined to believe that in this passage, as in many, there is a confusion of ideas, and that the poet had at once before him a butcher carrying a calf bound, and a butcher driving a calf to the slaughter, and beating him when he did not keep the path. Part of the line was suggested by one image and part by another, so that "strive" is the best word, but "stray" is the right. (V.51)

III.I.245 YORK.

'Tis York, that hath more reason for his death.

Why York had more reason than the rest for desiring Humphry's death, is not very clear; he had only decided the deliberation about the regency of France in favour of Somerset. (V.53)

III.I.257 SUFFOLK.

No; let him die, in that he is a fox,
 By Nature prov'd an enemy to the flock, Before his chaps be
 stain'd with crimson blood,
 As Humphry prov'd by reasons to my Liege

The meaning of the speaker is not hard to be discovered, but his expression is very much perplexed. He means that the fox may be lawfully killed, as being known to be by nature an enemy to sheep, even before he has actually killed them; so Humphry may be properly destroyed, as being proved by arguments to be the king's enemy, before he has committed any actual crime.

Some may be tempted to read "treasons" for "reasons," but the drift of the argument is to shew that there may be "reason" to kill him before any "treason" has broken out. (V.53)

III.I.272 SUFFOLK.

Say but the word, and I will be his priest.

I will be the attendant on his last scene, I will be the last man whom he will see. (V.54)

III.I.275 BEAUFORD.

Say you consent, and censure well the deed
 That is, approve the deed; "judge" the deed good. (V.54)

III.I.354 YORK.

the fury of this mad-brained flaw
 "Flaw" is a sudden violent gust of wind. (V.56)

III.I.364 YORK.

I have seen
 Him caper upright like a wild Morisco
 A Moor in a military dance, now called a "Morris," that is, a Moorish dance. (V.57)

III.II.72 KING HENRY.

Ah, woe is me for Glo'ster, wretched man!

QUEEN MARGARET.

Be woe for me, more wretched than he is.
 That is, let not woe be to thee for Gloucester, but for me. (V.60)

III.II.97 QUEEN MARGARET.

The splitting rocks cow'r'd in the sinking sands,
 And would not dash me with their ragged sides; Because thy
 flinty heart, more hard than they,
 Might in thy palace perish Margaret.
 "Sinking sands" and "splitting rocks" are the two destroyers of ships, but they are not otherwise allied to one another, and act their mischief by very different powers. I believe here is a transposition, and should read,

The sinking sands, the splitting rocks cow'r'd in.
 Our poet mentions them together, as in *Othello*,
 The gutter'd rocks and congregated sands.
 But finding no commodious allusion for the sands, he let that idea pass without any correspondent, and proceeds to the rocks.
 The splitting rocks cow'r'd in,
 And would not dash me with their ragged sides,
 Because thy flinty heart— — (V.61)

III.II.131 KING HENRY.

But how he died, God knows, not Henry.
 The poet commonly uses "Henry" as a word of three syllables.
 (V.62)

III.ii.152 KING HENRY.

For seeing him, I see my life in death.

Though, by a violent operation, some sense may be extracted from this reading, yet I think it will be better to change it thus;

For seeing him, I see my *death* in *life*.

That is, seeing him I live to see my own destruction. Thus it will aptly correspond with the first line.

Come hither, gracious Sovereign, view this body.

K. Henry. That is to see *how deep my grave is made*. (V.63)

III.ii.160 WARWICK.

See, how the blood is settled in his face.

Oft have I seen a timely-parted ghost,

Of ashy semblance, meager, pale, and bloodless;

Being all descended to the lab'ring heart,

Who, in the conflict that it holds with death,

Attracts the same for aidance 'gainst the enemy;

Which with the heart there cools, and ne'er returneth

To blush and beautify the cheek again.

But see, his face is black and full of blood;

His eye-balls further out, than when he liv'd;

Staring full-ghastly, like a strangled man;

His hair up-rear'd, his nostrils stretch'd with struggling:

His hands abroad display'd, as one that graspt

And tugg'd for life, and was by strength subdu'd.

Look on the sheets; his hair, you see, is sticking;

His well proportion'd beard made rough and rugged,

Like to the summer's corn by tempest lodg'd.

All that is true of the "body" of a dead man is here said by Warwick of the soul. I would read,

Oft have I seen a timely-parted *coarse*,

But of two common words how or why was one changed for the other? I believe the transcriber thought that the epithet "timely-parted" could not be used of the body, but that, as in *Hamlet*, there is mention of "peace-parted souls," so here "timely-parted" must have the same substantive. He removed one imaginary difficulty and made many real. If the soul is parted from the body, the body is likewise parted from the soul.

I cannot but stop a moment to observe that this horrible description is scarcely the work of any pen but Shakespeare's. (V.64)

III.ii.310 SUFFOLK.

Would curses kill, as doth the mandrake's groan

The fabulous accounts of the plant called a "mandrake" give it an inferiour degree of animal life, and relate, that when it is torn from the ground, it groans, and that this groan being certainly fatal to him that is offering such unwelcome violence, the practice of those who gather mandrakes is to tie one end of a string to the plant, and the other to a dog, upon whom the fatal groan discharges its malignity. (V.69)

III.ii.333 SUFFOLK.

You bad me ban, and will you bid me leave?

This inconsistency is very common in real life. Those who are vexed to impatience are angry to see others less disturbed than themselves, but when others begin to rave, they immediately see in them, what they could not find in themselves, the deformity and folly of useless rage. (V.69)

III.ii.343 QUEEN MARGARET.

Oh, could this kiss be printed in thy hand,

[Kissing his hand.]

That thou might'st think upon these by the seal,

Through whom a thousand sighs are breath'd for thee.

That by the impression of my kiss for ever remaining on thy hand thou mightest think on those lips through which a thousand sighs will be breathed for thee. (V.70)

III.ii.381 QUEEN MARGARET.

But wherefore grieve I at an hour's poor loss

She means, I believe, at "a loss" which any "hour" spent in contrivance and deliberation will enable her to supply. Or perhaps she may call the sickness of the cardinal the loss of an hour, as it may put some stop to her schemes. (V.71)

III.ii.407 QUEEN MARGARET.

I'll have an Iris that shall find thee out.

Iris was the messenger of Juno. (V.72)

III.iii.31 KING HENRY.

Forbear to judge, for we are sinners all.

Peccantes culpare cave, nam labimur omnes, Aut sumus, aut fuimus, vel possumus esse quod hic est. (V.73)

III.iii.32 KING HENRY.

Close up his eyes, and draw the curtain close,
And let us all to meditation.

This is one of the scenes which have been applauded by the criticks, and which will continue to be admired when prejudice shall cease, and bigotry give way to impartial examination. These are beauties that rise out of nature and of truth; the superficial reader cannot miss them, the profound can image nothing beyond them. (V.73)

IV.i.1 CAPTAIN WHITMORE.

The gaudy, blabbing, and remorseful day
Is crept into the bosom of the sea

The epithet "blabbing" applied to the day by a man about to commit murder, is exquisitely beautiful. Guilt is afraid of light, considers darkness as a natural shelter, and makes night the confidante of those actions which cannot be trusted to the "tell-tale day." (V.74)

IV.i.3 CAPTAIN WHITMORE.

And now loud howling wolves arouse the jades,
That drag the tragick melancholy night

The "wings" of the "jades" that drag night appears an unnatural image, till it is remembered that the chariot of the night is supposed, by Shakespeare, to be drawn by dragons. (V.74)

IV.i.60 SUFFOLK.

Ay, and allay this thy abortive pride.

Pride that has had birth too soon, pride issuing before its time. (V.76)

IV.i.70 CAPTAIN WHITMORE.

Poole? Sir Poole? Lord?

Ay, kennel—puddle—sink

The dissonance of this broken line makes it almost certain that we should read with a kind of ludicrous climax,

Poole? *Sir* Poole? *Lord* Poole?

He then plays upon the name "Poole, kennel, puddle." (V.76)

IV.i.135 SUFFOLK.

A Roman sworder and banditto slave
Murder'd sweet Tully; Brutus' bastard hand
Stabb'd Julius Caesar; savage islanders
Pompey the Great

The poet seems to have confounded the story of Pompey with some other. (V.78)

IV.ii.32 DICK THE BUTCHER.

stealing a cade of herrings.

That is, a "barrel" of herrings. I suppose the word "keg," which is now used, is "cade" corrupted. (V.80)

IV.ii.33 JACK CADE.

For our enemies shall fall before us

He alludes to his name "Cade," from *cado*, Lat. "to fall." He has too much learning for his character. (V.80)

IV.ii.45 SMITH THE WEAVER.

travel with her furr'd pack

A wallet or knapsack of skin with the hair outward. (V.80)

IV.ii.69 JACK CADE.

There shall be no money; all shall eat and drink upon my score

To mend the world by banishing money is an old contrivance of those who did not consider that the quarrels and mischiefs which arise from money, as the sign or ticket of riches, must, if money were to cease, arise immediately from riches themselves, and could never be at an end till every man was contented with his own share of the goods of life. (V.81)

IV.ii.123 JACK CADE.

As for these silken-coated slaves, I pass not

I pay them no regard.(1773: VI.344)

IV.iii.6 JACK CADE.

The lent shall be as long as it is

Methinks it might be read more humourously, "Lent shall be as long *again* as it is." (V.85)

IV.iii.14 DICK THE BUTCHER.

If we mean to thrive and do good, break open the gaols

I think it should be read thus, "If we mean to thrive, do good; break open the gaols," &c. (V.85)

IV.IV.15 QUEEN MARGARET.

Ah, barbarous villains! hath this lovely face

Rul'd like a wandring planet over me

Predominated irresistibly over my passions, as the planets over the lives of those that are born under their influence. (V.86)

IV.VII.22 JACK CADE.

Ah, thou Say, thou serge, nay, thou buckram Lord

"Say" was the old word for "silk," on this depends the series of degradation, from "say" to "serge," from "serge" to "buckram." (V.90)

IV.VII.32 JACK CADE.

thou hast caused printing to be us'd

Shakespeare is a little too early with this accusation. (V.90)

IV.VII.40 JACK CADE.

because they could not read, thou hast hang'd them

That is, they were hanged because they could not claim the benefit of clergy. (V.91)

IV.VII.45 JACK CADE.

Marry, thou ought'st not to let thy horse wear a cloak when honest men than thou go in their hose and doublets.

This is a reproach truly characteristical. Nothing gives so much offence to the lower ranks of mankind as the sight of superfluities merely ostentatious. (V.91)

IV.VII.65 LORD SAY.

When have I aught exacted at your hands?

Kent to maintain, the King, the realm and you,

Large gifts have I bestow'd on learned clerks,

Because my book preferr'd me to the King

This passage I know not well how to explain. It is pointed so as to make Say declare that he preferr'd clerks to maintain Kent and the King. This is not very clear; and besides he gives in the following line another reason of his bounty, that learning raised him, and therefore he supported learning. I am inclined to think Kent slipped into this passage by chance, and would read,

When have I aught exacted at your hand,

But to maintain the King, the realm, and you? (V.91)

IV.vii.48 OLD CLIFFORD.

To France, to France, and get what you have lost;
Spare England, for it is your native coast.

Henry hath money, you are strong and manly

Dr. Warburton reads, "Henry hath *mercy*," but he does not seem to have attended to the speaker's drift, which is to lure them from their present design by the hope of French plunder. He bids them "spare England, and go to France," and encourages them by telling them that all is ready for their expedition; that they have "strength," and the King has "money." (V.95)

IV.x.52 ALEXANDER IDEN.

As for more words, whose greatness answers words,

Let this my sword report what speech forbears.

Sir T. Hanmer, and after him Dr. Warburton, read,

As for more words, let this my sword report

(Whose greatness answers words) what speech forbears.

It seems to be a poor praise of a sword, that "its greatness answers words," whatever be the meaning of the expression. The old reading, though somewhat obscure, seems to me more capable of explanation. "For more words," whose pomp and tumour may answer words, and only words, I shall forbear them, "and refer the rest to my sword." (V.100)

IV.x.75 ALEXANDER IDEN.

How much thou wrong'st me, heaven be my judge!

That is, in supposing that I am proud of my victory. (V.101)

IV.x.76 ALEXANDER IDEN.

Die damned wretch, the curse of her that bare thee:

And as I thrust thy body in with my sword,

So wish I, I might thrust thy soul to hell.

Hence will I drag thee headlong by the heels

Unto a dunghill, which shall be thy grave;

And there cut off thy most ungracious head,

Which I will bear in triumph to the King,

Leaving thy trunk for crows to feed upon.

Not to dwell upon the wickedness of this horrid wish, with which Iden debases his character, this whole speech is wild and confused. To draw a man "by the heels, headlong," is somewhat difficult; nor can I discover how "the dunghill would be his grave *if* his trunk *were*

left to be fed upon by crows." These I conceive not to be the faults of corruption but of negligence, and therefore do not attempt correction. (V.101)

V.I.7 YORK.

This hand was made to handle nought but gold,
I cannot give due action to my words,
Except a sword, or scepter, balance it.
That is, "balance" my hand. (V.102)

V.I.10 YORK.

A scepter shall it have, have I a soul
I read, "A scepter shall it have, have I a *sword*." York observes that his hand must be employed with a "sword or scepter"; he then naturally observes, that he has a "sword," and resolves that "if he has a sword" he will have a "scepter." (V.102)

V.I.119 YORK.

The sons of York, thy betters in their birth,
Shall be their father's bail, and bane to those
That for my surety will refuse the boys.
[Theobald: bail and bale; bale, detriment, ruin, misfortune.]
"Bale" signifies "sorrow." Either word may serve. (V.106)

V.I.144 YORK.

Call hither to the stake my two brave bears ...
Bid Salisbury and Warwick come to me.
York calls these Lords his "bears" because they had a "bear" for their arms. (V.107)

V.II.26 OLD CLIFFORD.

My soul and body on the action both!
YORK. A dreadful lay.
A dreadful wager; a tremendous stake. (V.111)

V.II.66 RICHARD PLANTAGENET.

So, lie thou there.
[Somerset is killed.]
For underneath an ale-house' paltry sign,
The Castle in St. Albans, Somerset
Hath made the wizard famous in his death.

The particle "for" in the second line seems to be used without any very apparent inference. We might read,

"*Fall'n* underneath an ale-house' paltry sign," &c.

Yet the alteration is not necessary, for the old reading is sense, though obscure. (V.112)

V.III.4 YORK.

And, like a gallant in the brow of youth,

Repairs him with occasion.

The "brow of youth" is an expression not very easily explained. I read "the *blow* of youth." The blossom, the spring. (V.114)

V.III.9 RICHARD PLANTAGENET.

Three times bestrid him; thrice I led him off

That is, three times I saw him fallen, and, striding over him, defended him till he recovered. (V.114)

HENRY VI, PART 3

I.1.1 WARWICK.

I wonder, how the King escap'd our hands!

This play is only divided from the former for the convenience of exhibition; for the series of action is continued without interruption, nor are any two scenes of any play more closely connected than the first scene of this play with the last of the former. (V.119)

I.1.45 WARWICK.

Neither the King, nor he that loves him best,
The proudest he that holds up Lancaster,
Dares stir a wing, if Warwick shake his bells.

The allusion is to falconry. The hawks had sometimes little bells hung upon them, perhaps to "dare" the birds; that is, to fright them from rising. (V.121)

I.1.107 KING HENRY.

I am the son of Henry the Fifth

The military reputation of Henry the Fifth is the sole support of his son. The name of Henry the Fifth dispersed the followers of Cade. (V.123)

I.1.143 WARWICK.

Suppose, my Lords, he did it unconstrain'd,
Think you, 'twere prejudicial to his crown?

The phrase "prejudicial to his crown," if it be right, must mean, "detrimental to the general rights of hereditary royalty"; but I rather think that the transcriber's eye caught "crown" from the line below, and that we should read "prejudicial to his *son*, to his *next heir*." (V.124)

I.1.190 EXETER.

They seek revenge, and therefore will not yield.

They go away not because they doubt the justice of this determination, but because they have been conquered, and seek to be revenged. They are not influenced by principle, but passion. (V.126)

I.I.235 QUEEN MARGARET.

To entail him and's heirs unto the crown,
What is it but to make thy sepulchre

The Queen's reproach is founded on a position long received among politicians, that the loss of a king's power is soon followed by loss of life. (V.127)

I.I.268 KING HENRY.

and, like an empty eagle,
Tire on the flesh of me and of my son!

To "tire" is to "fasten," to "fix the talons," from the French *tirer*. (V.128)

I.I.270 KING HENRY.

The loss of those three Lords torments my heart

That is, of Northumberland, Westmorland, and Clifford, who had left him in disgust. (V.128)

I.II.4 YORK.

Why how now, sons and brother, at a strife?

[Steevens, 1773: sons and cousin.]

It should be "sons and brothers"; my "sons," and "brothers" to each other.(1773: VI.392)

I.II.22 RICHARD.

An oath is of no moment, being not took
Before a true and lawful magistrate;
That hath authority o'er him that swears.
Henry had none; but did usurp the place.

The obligation of an oath is here eluded by very despicable sophistry. A lawful magistrate alone has the power to exact an oath, but the oath derives no part of its force from the magistrate. The plea against the obligation of an oath obliging to maintain an usurper, taken from the unlawfulness of the oath itself in the foregoing play, was rational and just. (V.130)

I.II.42 YORK.

for they are soldiers,
Wealthy and courteous, liberal, full of spirit.

[In former editions: "*Witty*, courteous, liberal, full of spirit." What a blessed harmonious line have the editors given us, and what a promising epithet, in York's behalf, from the Kentishmen being so

“witty”? I can’t be so partial, however, to my own county, as to let this compliment pass. I make no doubt to read,

for they are soldiers,

Wealthy and courteous, liberal, full of spirit.

Now these five characteristicks answer to Lord Say’s description of them in the preceding play.

Kent, in the Commentaries Caesar writ,

Is term’d the *civil’s*t place in all this isle;

The people *liberal, valiant, active, wealthy*.

THEOBALD]

This is a conjecture of very little import. (V.130)

I.ii.49 MESSENGER.

The Queen, with all the northern Earls and Lords,

Intend here to besiege you in your castle.

She is hard by, with twenty thousand men;

And therefore fortify your hold, my Lord.

YORK. Ay, — with my sword.

I know not whether the authour intended any moral instruction, but he that reads this has a striking admonition against that precipitancy by which men often use unlawful means to do that which a little delay would put honestly in their power. Had York staid but a few moments he had saved his cause from the stain of perjury. (V.131)

I.iii.12 RUTLAND.

So looks the pent-up lion o’er the wretch

That is, the lion that hath been long “confined” without food, and is let out to devour a man condemned. (V.132)

I.iv.18 YORK.

With this we charg’d again; but out! alas,

We bodg’d again

Of this word the meaning is plain, but I never saw it in any other place. I suppose it is only the word “budded,” perhaps misprinted. (V.134)

I.iv.59 NORTHUMBERLAND.

It is war’s prize to take all ‘vantages

[Warburton: praise]

I think the old reading right, which means, that “all ‘vantages are in war lawful prize”; that is, “may be lawfully taken and used.” (V.135)

I.iv.132 YORK.

’Tis government, that makes them seem divine;
The want thereof makes thee abominable.

“Government,” in the language of that time, signified evenness of temper, and decency of manners. (V.138)

II.i.20 RICHARD.

Methinks, ’tis prize enough to be his son.

[The old quarto reads “pride,” which is right. Warburton]

I believe “prize” is the right word. Richard’s sense is, though we have missed the “prize” for which we fought, we have yet an honour left that may content us. (V.140)

II.i.21 RICHARD.

See, how the morning opes her golden gates,
And takes her farewell of the glorious sun

Aurora takes for a time her farewell of the sun, when she dismisses him to his diurnal course. (V.140)

II.i.35 EDWARD.

That we the sons of brave Plantagenet,
Each one already blazing by our meeds

Illustrious and shining by the armorial ensigns granted us as “meeds” of our great exploits. “Meed” likewise is “merit.” It might be plausibly read

Blazing by our *deeds*. (V.141)

II.i.48 EDWARD.

Oh, speak no more! for I have heard too much.

RICHARD.

Say, how he dy’d; for I will hear it all.

The generous tenderness of Edward, and savage fortitude of Richard, are well distinguished by their different reception of their father’s death. (V.142)

II.i.103 EDWARD.

Is by the stern Lord Clifford done to death.

Spenser mentions a plague “which many *did to dye*.” (1773: VI.408)

II.i.130 WARWICK.

Our soldiers, like the night-owl’s lazy flight,

Or like a lazy thresher with a flail,

Fell gently down

This image is not very congruous to the subject, nor was it necessary to the comparison, which is happily enough compleated by the thresher. (V.144)

II.i.171 WARWICK.

the easy-melting King, like wax

So again in this play, of the Lady Gray,

As red as fire, nay, then her wax must melt. (V.145)

II.i.209 WARWICK.

Why then it sorts

Why then things are as they should be. (V.146)

II.ii.47 KING HENRY.

And happy always was it for that son,

Whose father for his hoarding went to hell?

Alluding to a common proverb:

Happy the child whose father went to the devil. (V.148)

II.ii.72 MESSENGER.

Darraid your battle

That is, “range” your host, put your host in order. (V.149)

II.ii.124 RICHARD.

I am resolv’d

That Clifford’s manhood lies upon his tongue.

It is my firm persuasion; I am no longer in doubt. (V.151)

II.ii.142 RICHARD.

Sham’st thou not, knowing whence thou art extraught,

To let thy tongue detect thy base-born heart?

To show thy meanness of birth by the indecency of language with which thou railest at my deformity. (V.151)

II.ii.144 EDWARD.

A wisp of straw were worth a thousand crowns,
To make this shameless callat know herself.

I suppose for an instrument of correction that might disgrace but
not hurt her. (V.151)

II.ii.163 CLARENCE.

But when we saw, our sun-shine made thy spring,
And that thy summer bred us no increase,
We set the ax to thy usurping root;
And though the edge hath something hit ourselves,
Yet know thou, since we have begun to strike,
We'll never leave 'till we have hewn thee down

When we saw that by favouring thee we made thee grow in fortune,
but that we received no advantage from thy fortune flourishing by
our favour, we then resolved to destroy thee, and determine to try
some other means, though our first efforts have failed. (V.152)

II.v.21 KING HENRY.

O God! methinks it were a happy life
To be no better than a homely swain

This speech is mournful and soft, exquisitely suited to the char-
acter of the King, and makes a pleasing interchange, by affording,
amidst the tumult and horror of the battle, an unexpected glimpse
of rural innocence and pastoral tranquillity. (V.156)

II.v.55 [Stage directions] Alarm. Enter a son that had kill'd his
father.

Enter a father bearing his son. [l. 79]

These two horrible incidents are selected to show the innumerable
calamities of civil war. (V.157)

II.v.77 KING HENRY.

And let our hearts and eyes, like civil war,
Be blind with tears, and break o'er-charg'd with grief.

The meaning is here inaccurately expressed. The King intends to
say that the state of their "hearts and eyes" shall be like that of the
kingdom in a "civil war," all shall be destroyed by power formed
within themselves. (V.158)

II.v.88 FATHER.

O pity, God, this miserable age!
 What stratagems, how fell, how butcherly
 "Stratagem" seems to stand here only for "an event of war," or may
 intend "snares" and "surprises." (V.158)

II.v.92 FATHER.

O boy! thy father gave thee life too soon,
 And hath bereft thee of thy life too late.
 ["And hath bereft thee," i.e. he should have done it by not bringing
 thee into being, to make both father and son thus miserable. WAR-
 BURTON]

I rather think the meaning of the line, "And hath bereft thee of thy
 life too late," to be this. Thy father exposed thee to danger by "giving
 thee life too soon," and hath "bereft thee of life" by living himself too
 long. (V.158)

II.v.118 FATHER.

And so obsequious will thy father be
 "Obsequious" is here "*careful of* obsequies," or of funeral rites.
 (V.159)

II.v.119 FATHER.

Sad for the loss of thee, having no more,
 As Priam was for all his valiant sons.
 I having but *one* son, will grieve as much for that *one*, as Priam,
 who had *many*, could grieve for *many*. (V.160)

II.vi.6 CLIFFORD.

And, now I fall, thy tough commixtures melt,
 Impairing Henry
 Perhaps better, "*the* tough commixtures." (V.161)

II.vi.23 CLIFFORD.

Bootless are complaints, and cureless are my wounds;
 No way to fly, nor strength to hold our flight.
 This line is clear and proper as it is now read, yet perhaps an op-
 position of images was meant, and Clifford said,
 No way to fly, nor strength to hold *out* *fight*. (V.161)

II.vi.68 CLARENCE.

vex him with eager words.

Sour words; words of asperity. (V.163)

III.i.16 KING HENRY.

Thy place is fill'd, thy scepter wrung from thee;

Thy balm washt off, wherewith thou wast anointed

This is an image very frequent in the works of Shakespeare. So again in this scene,

I was anointed King.

It is common in these plays to find the same images, whether jocular or serious, frequently recurring. (V.165)

III.i.49 KING HENRY.

Inferreth arguments of mighty strength

In the former act was the same line,

Inferring arguments of mighty force. (V.166)

III.ii.16 KING EDWARD.

Widow, we will consider of your suit,

And come some other time to know our mind.

This is a very lively and spritely dialogue; the reciprocation is quicker than is common in Shakespeare. (V.168)

III.ii.161 GLOUCESTER.

Like to a chaos, or unlick'd bearwhelp,

That carries no impression like the dam.

It was an opinion which, in spite of its absurdity, prevailed long, that the bear brings forth only shapeless lumps of animated flesh, which she licks into the form of bears. It is now well known that the whelps of the bear are produced in the same state with those of other creatures. (V.173)

III.ii.165 GLOUCESTER.

Then since this earth affords no joy to me,

But to command, to check, to o'er-bear such

As are of better person than myself;

I'll make my heav'n to dream upon the crown

Richard speaks here the language of nature. Whoever is stigmatised with deformity has a constant source of envy in his mind, and would counterbalance by some other superiority these advantages which he feels himself to want. Bacon remarks that the deformed are

commonly daring, and it is almost proverbially observed that they are ill-natured. The truth is, that the deformed, like all other men, are displeased with inferiority, and endeavour to gain ground by good or bad means, as they are virtuous or corrupt. (V.173)

III.iii.42 QUEEN MARGARET.

O, but impatience waiteth on true sorrow:
And see, where comes the breeder of my sorrow.
[Warburton: waiting, rues tomorrow]

It is strange that, when the sense is so clear, any commentator should thus laboriously obscure it, to introduce a new reading; and yet stranger that he should shew such confidence in his emendation as to insert it in the text. (V.176)

III.iii.124 WARWICK.

his love was an eternal plant,
Whereof the root was fix'd in virtue's ground,
The leaves and fruit maintain'd with beauty's sun,
Exempt from envy, but not from disdain,
Unless the lady Bona quit his pain.

Envy is always supposed to have some fascinating or blasting power, and to be out of the reach of envy is therefore a privilege belonging only to great excellence. I know not well why "envy" is mentioned here, or whose "envy" can be meant, but the meaning is that his love is superiour to "envy," and can feel no blast but from the Lady's "disdain." Or, that if Bona refuse to "quit" or "requite" his pain, his "love" may turn to "disdain," though the consciousness of his own merit will exempt him from the pangs of "envy." (V.179)

III.iii.154 WARWICK.

You have a father able to maintain you

This seems ironical. The poverty of Margaret's father is a very frequent topick of reproach. (V.180)

III.iii.160 QUEEN MARGARET.

Thy sly conveyance

Conveyance is "juggling," and thence is taken for artifice and fraud. (V.180)

III.III.226 KING LEWIS.

go fear thy king
That is "fright" thy king. (V.183)

IV.I.43 HASTINGS.

Let us be back'd with God, and with the seas,
Which he hath given for fence impregnable,
And with their helps alone defend ourselves:
In them, and in ourselves, our safety lies.

This has been the advice of every man who in any age understood and favoured the interest of England. (V.186)

IV.I.56 CLARENCE.

Or else you would not have bestow'd the heir
Of the Lord Bonvil on your new wife's son

It must be remembered, that till the Restoration the heiresses of great estates were in the wardship of the king, who in their minority gave them up to plunder, and afterwards matched them to his favourites. I know not when liberty gained more than by the abolition of the Court of Wards. (V.187)

IV.I.123 CLARENCE.

You, that love me and Warwick, follow me.

That Clarence should make this speech in the King's hearing is very improbable, yet I do not see how it can be palliated. The King never goes out, nor can Clarence be talking to a company apart, for he answers immediately to that which the Post says to the King. (V.189)

IV.II.13 WARWICK.

And now what rests, but in night's overture,
Thy brother being carelessly encamp'd,
His soldiers lurking in the towns about,
And but attended by a simple guard,
We may surprize and take him at our pleasure?

The authour must, I think, have written "night's coverture." For though "overture," which signifies first an "opening," then an "offer," may likewise mean an "opportunity," yet "in *an* overture" seems to be an improper phrase. (V.190)

IV.ii.22 WARWICK.

So we, well cover'd with the night's black mantle,
 At unawares may beat down Edward's guard
 This line may confirm the reading of "coverture." (V.191)

IV.iii.34 WARWICK.

And come now to create you Duke of York.
 Might we read with a slight alteration?
 And come *to new create* you Duke of York. (V.192)

IV.vi.29 WARWICK.

For few men rightly temper with the stars
 I suppose the meaning is, that few men conform their "temper" to their destiny, which King Henry did, when finding himself unfortunate he gave the management of publick affairs to more prosperous hands. (V.197)

IV.vi.67 SOMERSET.

My Liege, it is young Henry, Earl of Richmond.

KING HENRY.

Come hither, England's hope: if secret powers [Lays his hand on his head.

Suggest but truth to my divining thoughts,
 This pretty lad will prove our country's bliss.

He was afterwards Henry VII. A man who put an end to the civil war of the two houses, but not otherwise remarkable for virtue. Shakespeare knew his trade. Henry VII. was grandfather to Queen Elizabeth, and the king from whom James inherited. (V.198)

IV.vii.31 HASTINGS.

The good old man would fain that all were well

The mayor is willing we should enter so he may not be blamed.
 (V.200)

IV.viii.1 EARL OF WARWICK.

What counsel, Lords? Edward from Belgia,
 With hasty Germans, and blunt Hollanders,
 Hath pass'd in safety through the narrow seas;
 And with his troops doth march amain to London;
 And many giddy people flock to him.

KING HENRY.

Let's levy men, and beat him back again.

This line expresses a spirit of war so unsuitable to the character of Henry, that I would give the first cold speech to the King, and the brisk answer to Warwick. This line is not in the old quarto, and when Henry said nothing, the first speech might be as properly given to Warwick as to any other. (V.203)

IV.viii.51 [Stage direction.] Shout within. "A Lancaster! a Lancaster!"

Surely the shouts that ushered King Edward should be "a York, a York." I suppose the authour did not write the marginal directions, and the players confounded the characters. (V.205)

V.i.83 DUKE OF CLARENCE.

I will not ruinate my father's house,
Who gave his blood to lime the stones together
That is, to "cement" the stones. Lime makes mortar. (V.209)

V.i.85 DUKE OF CLARENCE.

Why, trow'st thou, Warwick,
That Clarence is so harsh, so blunt, unnatural,
To bend the fatal instruments of war
Against his brother, and his lawful King?
"Blunt." Stupid, insensible of paternal fondness. (V.209)

V.i.106 EARL OF WARWICK.

O passing traitor, perjur'd and unjust!
Eminent, egregious; traiterous beyond the common track of treason. (V.210)

V.ii.2 KING EDWARD.

For Warwick was a bug that scar'd us all.
"Bug" is a "bugbear," a terrifick being. (V.210)

V.ii.24 EARL OF WARWICK.

My parks, my walks, my manors that I had,
Ev'n now forsake me
Cedes coemptis saltibus, et domo, Villâque. HOR.

This mention of his "parks" and "manours" diminishes the pathetic effect of the foregoing lines. (V.211)

V.iv.67 [Stage direction.] March. Enter King Edward, Gloucester, Clarence, and soldiers, on the other side of the stage.

This scene is ill-contrived, in which the King and Queen appear at once on the stage at the head of opposite armies. It had been easy to make one retire before the other entered. (V.215)

V.v.25 PRINCE OF WALES.

Let Aesop fable in a winter's night,
His currish riddles sort not with this place.

GLOUCESTER.

By heav'n, brat, I'll plague ye for that word.

The Prince calls Richard, for his crookedness, Aesop; and the poet, following nature, makes Richard highly incensed at the reproach. (V.216)

V.v.38 GLOUCESTER.

Take that, thou likeness of this railer here.
Thou that resemblest thy railing mother. (V.217)

V.v.65 QUEEN MARGARET.

But if you ever chance to have a child,
Look in his youth to have him so cut off;
As, deathsmen! you have rid this sweet young prince.

The condition of this warlike queen would move compassion could it be forgotten that she gave York, to wipe his eyes in his captivity, a handkerchief stained with his young child's blood. (V.218)

V.v.77 QUEEN MARGARET.

where is that devil's butcher, Richard?

[Thus all the editions. But "devil's butcher," in other terms, I think, is "kill-devil"; rare news for the free-thinkers, if there were any grounds for depending on it. But the poet certainly wrote "devil-butcher"; and the first part of the compound is to be taken adjectively, meaning, "ex-ecrable, infernal, devilish." THEOBALD]

"Devil's butcher" is a butcher set on by the devil. Either reading may serve without so long a note. (V.218)

V.vi.18 GLOUCESTER.

Why, what a peevish fool was that of Crete

As "peevishness" is the quality of children, "peevish" seems to signify "childish," and by consequence "silly." "Peevish" is explained by "childish," in a former note of Dr. Warburton. (V.220)

V.vi.38 KING HENRY.

Which now mistrust no parcel of my fear
Who suspect no part of what my fears presage. (V.220)

V.vi.46 KING HENRY.

hideous tempest shook down trees,
The raven rook'd her on the chimney's top
[Warburton: raven croak'd hoarse]
The true reading seems to be at no great distance.
the tempest shook down trees,
The raven *rock'd* her on the chimney's top;
on the top of the chimney shaken by the tempest. (V.221)

V.vii.25 GLOUCESTER.

Work thou the way, and that shall execute.
I believe we should read,
and *this* shall execute.
Richard laying his hand on his forehead says,
Work thou the way — —
then bringing down his hand and beholding it,
—and *this* shall execute.
Though "that" may stand, the arm being included in the shoulder.
(V.223)

The three parts of *Henry VI.* are suspected, by Mr. Theobald, of being supposititious, and are declared, by Dr. Warburton, to be "certainly not Shakespeare's." Mr. Theobald's suspicion arises from some obsolete words; but the phraseology is like the rest of our authour's stile, and single words, of which however I do not observe more than two, can conclude little.

Dr. Warburton gives no reason, but I suppose him to judge upon deeper principles and more comprehensive views, and to draw his opinion from the general effect and spirit of the composition, which he thinks inferior to the other historical plays.

From mere inferiority nothing can be inferred; in the productions of wit there will be inequality. Sometimes judgment will err, and sometimes the matter itself will defeat the artist. Of every authour's works one will be the best, and one will be the worst. The colours

are not equally pleasing, nor the attitudes equally graceful, in all the pictures of Titian or Reynolds.

Dissimilitude of stile and heterogeneousness of sentiment, may sufficiently show that a work does not really belong to the reputed authour. But in these plays no such marks of spuriousness are found. The diction, the versification, and the figures, are Shakespeare's. These plays, considered, without regard to characters and incidents, merely as narratives in verse, are more happily conceived and more accurately finished than those of *King John*, *Richard II*, or the tragick scenes of *Henry IV.* and *V.* If we take these plays from Shakespeare, to whom shall they be given? What authour of that age had the same easiness of expression and fluency of numbers?

Having considered the evidence given by the plays themselves, and found it in their favour, let us now enquire what corroboration can be gained from other testimony. They are ascribed to Shakespeare by the first editors, whose attestation may be received in questions of fact, however unskilfully they superintended their edition. They seem to be declared genuine by the voice of Shakespeare himself, who refers to the second play in his epilogue to *Henry V.* and apparently connects the first act of *Richard III.* with the last of the third part of *Henry VI.* If it be objected that the plays were popular, and therefore he alluded to them as well known; it may be answered, with equal probability, that the natural passions of a poet would have disposed him to separate his own works from those of an inferior hand. And indeed if an authour's own testimony is to be overthrown by speculative criticism, no man can be any longer secure of literary reputation.

Of these three plays I think the second the best. The truth is, that they have not sufficient variety of action, for the incidents are too often of the same kind; yet many of the characters are well discriminated. King Henry, and his queen, King Edward, the Duke of Gloucester, and the Earl of Warwick, are very strongly and distinctly painted.

The old copies of the two latter parts of *Henry VI.* and of *Henry V.* are so apparently imperfect and mutilated, that there is no reason for supposing them the first draughts of Shakespeare. I am inclined to believe them copies taken by some auditor who wrote down, during the representation, what the time would permit, then perhaps filled up some of his omissions at a second or third hearing, and when he

had by this method formed something like a play, sent it to the printer.
V.224

RICHARD III

I.1.12 GLOUCESTER.

He capers nimbly in a lady's chamber

War "capers." This is poetical, though a little harsh; if it be York that capers, the antecedent is at such a distance that it is almost forgotten. (V.230)

I.1.19 GLOUCESTER.

Cheated of feature by dissembling nature

[Nature that puts together things of a dissimilar kind, as a brave soul and a deformed body. Warburton]

"Dissembling" is here put very licentiously for "fraudful, deceitful." (V.230)

I.1.28 GLOUCESTER.

And therefore, since I cannot prove a lover,

To entertain these fair well-spoken days,

I am determined to prove a villain

Shakespeare very diligently inculcates, that the wickedness of Richard proceeded from his deformity, from the envy that rose at the comparison of his own person with others, and which incited him to disturb the pleasures that he could not partake. (V.230)

I.1.30 GLOUCESTER.

I am determined to prove a villain,

And hate the idle pleasures of these days.

Perhaps we might read,

And *bate* the idle pleasures. (V.230)

I.1.32 GLOUCESTER.

Plots have I laid, inductions dangerous

Preparations for mischief. The "induction" is preparatory to the action of the play. (V.230)

I.1.36 GLOUCESTER.

if King Edward be as true and just

[i.e. as open hearted and free from deceit. Warburton]

The meaning is only this; if Edward keeps his word. (V.231)

I.i.60 CLARENCE.

such like toys as these
 "Toys." Fancies, freaks of imagination. (V.231)

I.i.76 GLOUCESTER.

Humbly complaining to her Deity,
 Got my Lord Chamberlain his liberty.
 I think these two lines might be better given to Clarence. (V.232)

I.i.106 GLOUCESTER.

We are the Queen's objects, and must obey.
 That is, not the Queen's "subjects," whom she might protect, but
 her "objects," whom she drives away. (V.233)

I.i.108 GLOUCESTER.

And whatsoe'er you will employ me in,
 Were it to call King Edward's widow sister,
 I will perform it to infranchise you.

This is a very covert and subtle manner of insinuating treason. The natural expression would have been, "were it to call King Edward's *wife* sister." I will solicit for you though it should be at the expence of so much degradation and constraint, as to own the lowborn wife of King Edward for a sister. But by slipping as it were casually "widow" into the place of "wife," he tempts Clarence with an oblique proposal to kill the king. (V.233)

I.ii.37 GLOUCESTER.

I'll make a coarse of him that disobeys.
 So in *Hamlet*,
 I'll make a ghost of him that lets me. (V.236)

I.ii.55 ANNE.

Oh, gentlemen, see! see dead Henry's wounds
 Open their congeal'd mouths and bleed afresh.

It is a tradition very generally received, that the murdered body bleeds on the touch of the murderer. This was so much believed by Sir Kenelm Digby that he has endeavoured to explain the reason. (V.236)

I.ii.78 ANNE.

diffus'd infection of a man

I believe "diffused" in this place signifies "irregular, uncouth"; such is its meaning in other passages of Shakespeare.
(V.237)

I.ii.97 GLOUCESTER.

I was provoked by her sland'rous tongue
That laid their guilt upon my guiltless shoulders.

The crime of my brothers. He has just charged the murder of Lady Anne's husband upon Edward. (V.238)

I.ii.117 GLOUCESTER.

Is not the causer of the timeless deaths
Of these Plantagenets, Henry and Edward,
As blameful as the executioner?

ANNE.

Thou wast the cause, and most accurst effect.

["Effect," for executioner. He asks, was not the "causer" as ill as the "executioner"? She answers, thou wast both ... But the Oxford editor, troubling himself with nothing of this, will make a fine oratorical period of it.

Thou wast the cause. And most accurst th' effect!

WARBURTON]

I cannot but be rather of Sir T. Hanmer's opinion than Dr. Warburton's, because "effect" is used immediately in its common sense, in answer to this line. (V.239)

I.ii.152 GLOUCESTER.

For now they kill me with a living death.

In imitation of this passage, and I suppose of a thousand more, Pope writes,

a living death I bear,

Says Dapperwit, and sunk beside his chair. (V.240)

I.ii.155 GLOUCESTER.

These eyes, which never shed remorseful tear

[The twelve following beautiful lines added after the first editions.
POPE]

They were added with many more. (V.240)

I.ii.179 GLOUCESTER.

Nay, do not pause; for I did kill King Henry;
But 'twas thy beauty that provoked me.

Shakespeare countenances the observation, that no woman can ever be offended with the mention of her beauty. (V.241)

I.ii.212 GLOUCESTER.

And presently repair to Crosby-place

A house near Bishopsgate-street belonging to the Duke of Gloucester. (V.242)

I.ii.244 GLOUCESTER.

Young, wise, and valiant, and, no doubt, right royal

Of the degree of royalty belonging to Henry the Sixth there could be "no doubt," nor could Richard have mentioned it with any such hesitation; he could not indeed very properly allow him "royalty." I believe we should read,

and, no doubt, right *loyal*.

That is, "true to her bed." He enumerates the reasons for which she should love him. He was "young, wise and valiant"; these were apparent and indisputable excellencies. He then mentions another not less likely to endear him to his wife, but which he had less opportunity of knowing with certainty, "and, no doubt, right *loyal*." (V.243)

I.iii.117 GLOUCESTER.

'Tis time to speak, my pains are quite forgot.

QUEEN MARGARET.

Out, Devil! I remember thee too well

[Warburton: No, Devil!]

There is no need of change, but if there were, the commentator does not change enough: he should read, "I remember *them* too well"; that is, "his pains." (V.248)

I.iii.129 GLOUCESTER.

was not your husband,

In Marg'ret's battle, at St. Albans slain?

It is said in *Henry VI.* that he died "in quarrel of the house of York." (V.249)

I.iii.163 QUEEN MARGARET.

Ah, gentle villain, do not turn away!

[Warburton: ungentle]

The meaning of "gentle" is not, as the commentator imagines, "tender" or "courteous," but "high born." An opposition is meant between that and "villain," which means at once a "wicked" and a "low born wretch." So before,

Since ev'ry Jack is made a *gentleman*

There's many a *gentle* person made a Jack. (V.250)

I.iii.197 QUEEN MARGARET.

If not by war, by surfeit die your King

Alluding to his luxurious life. (V.251)

I.iii.228 QUEEN MARGARET.

Thou elvish-markt abortive, rooting hog!

[The expression is fine, alluding (in memory of her young son) to the ravage which hogs make, with the finest flowers, in gardens; and intimating that Elizabeth was to expect no other treatment for her sons. Warburton]

She calls him "hog" as an appellation more contemptuous than "bear," as he is elsewhere termed from his ensigns armorial. There is no such heap of allusion as the commentator imagines. (V.252)

I.iii.233 QUEEN MARGARET.

Thou rag of honour

[Warburton: wrack]

"Rag" is, in my opinion, right, and intimates that much of his honour is torn away. "Patch" is, in the same manner, a contemptuous appellation. (V.252)

I.iii.242 QUEEN MARGARET.

Why strew'st thou sugar on that bottled spider

A "spider" is called bottled, because, like other insects, he has a middle slender and a belly protuberant. Richard's form and venom make her liken him to a spider. (V.253)

I.iv.30 CLARENCE.

Where eyes did once inhabit, there were crept,

As 'twere in scorn of eyes, reflecting gems;

That woo'd the slimy bottom of the deep

By seeming to gaze upon it; or, as we now say, to "ogle" it. (V.258)

I.IV.55 CLARENCE.

Clarence is come, false, fleeting, perjur'd

Clarence

"Fleeting" is the same as "changing sides." (V.258)

I.IV.78 BRAKENBURY.

Princes have but their titles for their glories,

An outward honour, for an inward toil

The first line may be understood in this sense. "The glories of princes are nothing more than empty titles": but it would more impress the purpose of the speaker, and correspond better with the following lines, if it were read,

Princes have but their titles for their *troubles*. (V.259)

I.IV.80 BRAKENBURY.

And, for unfelt imaginations,

They often feel a world of restless cares

They often suffer real miseries for "imaginary" and "unreal" gratifications. (V.259)

I.IV.149 2 VILLAIN.

Spoke like a tall fellow that respects his reputations.

The meaning of "tall," in old English, is "stout, daring, fearless" and "strong." (V.261)

I.IV.177 CLARENCE.

Are you call'd forth from out a world of men

I think it may be better read,

Are ye *cull'd* forth. (V.262)

I.IV.217 1 VILLAIN.

Who made thee then a bloody minister,

When gallant, springing, brave Plantagenet

"Springing Plantagenet." Blooming Plantagenet; a prince in the "spring" of life. (V.263)

I.IV.219 1 VILLAIN.

That princely novice, was struck dead by thee?

Youth; one yet "new" to the world. (V.263)

I.iv.254 CLARENCE.

Relent, and save your souls.

Which of you, if you were a prince's son,

Being pent from liberty, as I am now,

If two such murderers, as yourselves, came to you,

Would not intreat for life? ah! you would beg,

Were you in my distress. —

[The six following lines are not in the old edition. POPE]

They are not necessary, but so forced in, that something seems omitted to which these lines are the answer. (V.264)

I.iv.265 CLARENCE.

A begging prince what beggar pities not?

I cannot but suspect that the lines, which Mr. Pope observed not to be in the old edition, are now misplaced, and should be inserted here, somewhat after this manner.

Clar. A begging prince what beggar pities not?

Vil. A begging prince!

Clar. Which of you if you were a prince's son, &c.

Upon this provocation the villain naturally strikes him. (V.265)

II.i.98 KING EDWARD.

Then say at once, what is it thou requestest.

STANLEY.

The forfeit, Sov'reign, of my servant's life

He means the "remission" of the forfeit. (V.269)

II.i.102 KING EDWARD.

Have I a tongue to doom my brother's death?

This lamentation is very tender and pathetick. The recollection of the good qualities of the dead is very natural, and no less naturally does the King endeavour to communicate the crime to others. (V.269)

II.ii.49 DUTCHESS OF YORK.

I have bewept a worthy husband's death,

And liv'd by looking on his images.

The children by whom he was represented. (V.272)

II.ii.69 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

That I, being govern'd by the wat'ry moon,
May send forth plenteous tears to drown the world.

That I may live hereafter under the influence of the moon, which governs the tides, and, by the help of that influence, drown the world. The introduction of the moon is not very natural. (V.272)

II.iii.12 2 CITIZEN.

In him there is a hope of government,
Which in his nonage, council under him

The word "which" has no antecedent, nor can the sense or connection be easily restored by any change. I believe a line to be lost in which some mention was made of the "land" or the "people." (V.276)

II.iv.18 DUTCHESS OF YORK.

He was the wretched'st thing, when he was young

"Wretched" is here used in a sense yet retained in familiar language, for "paltry," "pitiful," being below expectation. (V.278)

II.iv.23 YORK.

Now, by my troth, if I had been remember'd
I could have giv'n my Uncle's grace a flout

"To be remembered" is in Shakespeare, to have one's memory quick, to have one's thoughts about one. (V.278)

II.iv.45 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

For what offence?

This question is given to the Archbishop in former copies, but the messenger plainly speaks to the Queen or Dutchess. (V.279)

II.iv.51 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

Insulting tyranny begins to jut

Upon the innocent and awless throne

Not producing awe, not revered. To "jut upon" is to "encroach." (V.279)

III.i.46 BUCKINGHAM.

Weigh it but with the grossness of this age,

You break not sanctuary

[Warburton: greenness of his age]

This emendation is received by Hanmer, and is very plausible; yet the common reading may stand. "Weigh it but with the grossness of

this age, you break not sanctuary." That is, compare the act of seizing him with the "gross" and licentious practices of "these times," it will not be considered as a violation of sanctuary, for you may give such reasons as men are now used to admit. (V.282)

III.1.76 PRINCE OF WALES.

Methinks, the truth should live from age to age,
As 'twere retail'd to all posterity

[Warburton: intail'd]

"Retail'd" may signify diffused, dispersed. (V.283)

III.1.81 GLOUCESTER.

I say, without characters Fame lives long.
Thus, like the formal vice, Iniquity,
I moralize: Two meanings in one word.

[Warburton: formal-wise Antiquity / I]

This alteration Mr. Upton very justly censures. Dr. Warburton has, in my opinion, done nothing but correct the punctuation, if indeed any alteration be really necessary. See the dissertation on the old Vice at the end of this play.

To this long collection of notes may be added a question, to what equivocation Richard refers? The position immediately preceding, that "Fame lives long without characters," that is, without the help of letters, seems to have no ambiguity. He must allude to the former line,

So young, so wise, they say, did ne'er live long,
in which he conceals, under a proverb, his design of hastening the Prince's death. (V.283)

III.1.94 GLOUCESTER.

Short summer lightly has a forward spring.

"Lightly," commonly, in ordinary course. (V.286)

III.1.97 YORK.

Well, my dread Lord, so must I call you now.

The original of this epithet applied to kings has been much disputed. In some of our old statutes the king is called *Rex metuendissimus*. (V.286)

III.I.114 YORK.

And being but a toy, which is no gift to give.

This is the reading of the quartos; the first folio reads,

And being but a toy, which is no grief to give.

This reading, made a little more metrical, has been followed, I think erroneously, by all the editors. (V.287)

III.I.128 YORK.

You mean to bear me, not to bear with me:

Uncle, my brother mocks both you and me:

Because that I am little like an ape

The reproach seems to consist in this: at country shews it was common to set the monkey on the back of some other animal, as a "bear." The Duke, therefore, in calling himself "ape," calls his uncle "bear." (V.287)

III.I.179 BUCKINGHAM.

For we to-morrow hold divided councils

That is, a "private consultation," "separate" from the known and publick council. So, in the next scene, Hastings says, "Bid him not fear the *separated* councils." (V.289)

III.II.25 HASTINGS.

Tell him, his fears are shallow, wanting instance

That is, "wanting" some "example" or "act of malevolence," by which they may be justified; or which, perhaps, is nearer to the true meaning, "wanting" any "immediate" ground or reason. (V.291)

III.II.92 HASTINGS.

Come, come, have with you.

A familiar phrase in parting, as much as, "Take something along with you," or "I have something to say to you." (V.293)

III.II.94 STANLEY.

They, for their truth, might better wear their heads,

Than some, that have accus'd them, wear their hats.

That is, with respect to their "honesty." (V.293)

III.II.107 PURSUIVANT.

God hold it to your Honour's good content!

"Hold it," that is, "continue" it. (V.293)

III.ii.109 HASTINGS.

I'm in your debt for your last exercise Performance of divine service. (V.294)

III.iv.27 BUCKINGHAM.

Had you not come upon your cue, my Lord,
William Lord Hastings had pronounced your part

This expression is borrowed from the theatre. The "cue," "queue," or "tail" of a speech, consists of the last words, which are the token for an entrance or answer. To "come on the cue," therefore, is to come at the proper time. (V.297)

III.iv.100 HASTINGS.

Who builds his hope in air of your fair looks,
Lives like a drunken sailor on a mast
So Horace,
Nescius aurae fallacis. (V.299)

III.vi.13 SCRIVENER.

Bad is the world, and all will come to nought,
When such ill dealings must be seen in thought.
That is, seen in silence, without notice or detection. (V.304)

III.vii.45 BUCKINGHAM.

The Mayor is here at hand; intend some fear
Perhaps "pretend"; though "intend" will stand in the sense of giving attention. (V.305)

III.vii.52 GLOUCESTER.

I go: and if you plead as well for them,
As I can say, "nay" to thee, for myself
I think it must be read,
If you plead as well for them
As I must say "nay" to *them* for myself. (V.305)

III.vii.76 BUCKINGHAM.

Not sleeping, to engross his idle body
To fatten; to pamper. (V.306)

III.vii.128 BUCKINGHAM.

And almost shoulder'd in the swallowing gulph
Of dark forgetfulness, and deep oblivion

What it is to be "shoulder'd in a gulph," Hanmer is the only editor who seems not to have known: for the rest let it pass without observation. He reads,

Almost shoulder'd *into th'* swallowing gulph.

I believe we should read,

And almost *smoulder'd* in the swallowing gulph.

That is, almost "smother'd," covered and lost. (V.308)

III.vii.166 GLOUCESTER.

And much I need to help you, were there need

And I "want much" of the ability requisite to give you help, if help were needed. (V.309)

III.vii.246 GLOUCESTER.

[To the Clergymen.]

Come let us to our holy work again.

—Farewel, my cousin; farewel, gentle friends.

To this act should, perhaps, be added the next scene, so will the coronation pass between the acts; and there will not only be a proper interval of action, but the conclusion will be more forcible. (V.312)

IV.i.27 BRAKENBURY.

No, madam, no, I may not leave it so.

That is, "I may not so resign my office," which you offer to take on you at your peril. (V.313)

IV.i.83 ANNE.

For never yet one hour in his bed

Did I enjoy the golden dew of sleep,

But with his tim'rous dreams was still awak'd.

'Tis recorded by Polydore Virgil, that Richard was frequently disturbed by terrible dreams: this is therefore no fiction. (V.315)

IV.i.102 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

Rude ragged nurse! old sullen play fellow

To call the Tower "nurse" and "playfellow" is very harsh: perhaps part of this speech is addressed to the Tower, and part to the Lieutenant. (V.316)

IV.i.103 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

use my babies well!

So foolish sorrow bids your stones farewell.

Hither the third act should be extended, and here it very properly ends with a pause of action. (V.316)

IV.ii.99 KING RICHARD.

Henry the Sixth
Did prophesy, that Richmond should be King,
When Richmond was a little peevish boy.
A King, perhaps—

The allusions to the plays of *Henry VI.* are no weak proofs of the authenticity of these disputed pieces. (V.319)

IV.ii.115 KING RICHARD.

But what's a clock?

BUCKINGHAM.

Upon the stroke of ten.

KING RICHARD.

Well, let it strike.

BUCKINGHAM.

Why, let it strike?

KING RICHARD.

Because, that, like a Jack, thou keep'st the stroke
Betwixt thy begging and my meditation.

This passage, though I do not believe it corrupted, I do not understand. (V.320)

IV.iii.51 KING RICHARD.

Come, I have learn'd, that fearful commenting
Is leaden servitor to dull delay

Timorous thought and cautious disquisition are the dull attendants on delay. (V.322)

IV.iv.5 QUEEN MARGARET.

A dire induction am I witness to

"Induction" is preface, introduction, first part. It is so used by Sackville in our authour's time. (V.322)

IV.iv.15 QUEEN MARGARET.

Hover about her; say, that right for right
Hath dimm'd your infant-morn to aged night.
[Warburton: wrong for wrong]

It is so unlikely that words so plain, and so proper, as “wrong for wrong” would have been either ignorantly or officiously changed, that I believe “right for right” is the true though not the best reading. This is one of these conceits which our authour may be suspected of loving better than propriety. “Right for right” is “justice answering to the claims of justice.” So in this play,

That forehead

Where should be branded, if that *right were right*. (V.323)

IV.IV.58 QUEEN MARGARET.

And makes her pue-fellow with others’ moan!

“Pue-fellow” seems to be companion. We have now a new phrase, nearly equivalent, by which we say of persons in the same difficulties, that they are in “the same box.” (V.324)

IV.IV.65 QUEEN MARGARET.

Young York he is but boot

“Boot” is that which is thrown in to mend a purchase. (V.324)

IV.IV.157 KING RICHARD.

Madam, I have a touch of your condition

A “spice” or “particle” of your “temper” or “disposition.” (V.328)

IV.IV.173 DUTCHESS OF YORK.

What comfortable hour canst thou name,

That ever grac’d me in thy company?

To “grace” seems here to mean the same as to “bliss,” to make happy. So “gracious” is kind, and “graces” are favours. (V.328)

IV.IV.195 DUTCHESS OF YORK.

Shame serves thy life, and doth thy death attend.

To “Serve” is to “accompany,” servants being near the persons of their masters. (V.329)

IV.IV.198 KING RICHARD.

Stay, Madam, I must speak a word with you.

On this dialogue ’tis not necessary to bestow much criticism: part of it is ridiculous, and the whole improbable. (V.329)

IV.IV.244 KING RICHARD.

The high imperial type of this earth’s glory.

“Type” is exhibition, shew, display. (V.331)

IV.iv.246 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

Tell me, what state, what dignity, what honour,
Canst thou demise to any child of mine?

The sense of the word "demise" is evident, but I do not remember it any where so used: perhaps it should be "devise," which the lawyers use, for to transfer, or make over. (V.331)

IV.iv.274 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

Therefore present to her, as sometime Marg'ret
Did to thy father, steeped in Rutland's blood,
A handkerchief

Here is another reference to the plays of Henry VI. (V.332)

IV.iv.289 QUEEN ELIZABETH.

Nay then, indeed, she cannot chuse but hate thee;
Having bought love with such a bloody spoil.
"Spoil" is waste, havock. (V.332)

IV.iv.440 KING RICHARD.

Some light-foot friend post to the Duke of Norfolk,
Ratcliff, thyself; or Catesby; where is he?

Richard's precipitation and confusion is in this scene very happily represented by inconsistent orders, and sudden variations of opinion. (V.337)

V.i.18 BUCKINGHAM.

This, this All-Souls day to my fearful soul,
Is the determin'd respite of my wrongs.

[This is nonsense, we should read "respect" of my wrongs, i.e. "requital." Warburton]

Hanmer had rightly explained it, the time to which the punishment of his wrongs was "respited."

"Wrongs" in this line means "wrongs" done, or injurious practices. (V.343)

V.i.28 BUCKINGHAM.

Come, Sirs, convey me to the block of shame;
Wrong hath but wrong, and blame the due of blame.

This scene should, in my opinion, be added to the foregoing act, so the fourth act will have a more full and striking conclusion, and the fifth act will comprise the business of the important day, which put an end to the competition of York and Lancaster. Some of the quarto

editions are not divided into acts, and it is probable that this and many other plays were left by the authour in one unbroken continuity, and afterwards distributed by chance, or what seems to have been a guide very little better, by the judgment or caprice of the first editors. (V.343)

V.ii.10 RICHMOND.

In your embowell'd bosoms

Exenterated; ripped up; alluding, perhaps, to the Promethean vulture; or, more probably, to the sentence pronounced in the English courts against traytors, by which they are condemned to be hanged, drawn, that is, "embowell'd," and quartered. (V.344)

V.iii.16 KING RICHARD.

Call for some men of sound direction

True judgment; tried military skill. (V.345)

V.iii.63 KING RICHARD.

Fill me a bowl of wine—give me a watch

A "watch" has many significations, but I should believe that it means in this place not a "sentinel," which would be regularly placed at the King's tent; nor an instrument to measure time, which was not used in that age; but a watchlight, a candle to burn by him; the light that afterwards "burnt blue"; yet, a few lines after, he says

Bid my guard watch.

which leaves it doubtful whether "watch" is not here a sentinel.

[Steevens: watch, a candle.]

Lord Bacon mentions a species of light called an "allnight," which is a wick set in the middle of a large cake of wax. (V.347)

V.iii.65 KING RICHARD.

Look, that my staves be sound, and not too heavy.

"Staves" are the wood of the lances. (V.348)

V.iii.83 STANLEY.

I, by attorney, bless thee from thy mother

By deputation. (V.348)

V.iii.91 STANLEY.

I, as I may, that which I would, I cannot,

With best advantage will deceive the time

I will take the best opportunity to elude the dangers of this conjuncture. (V.349)

V.III.97 STANLEY.

The leisure, and the fearful time
Cuts off the ceremonious vows of love

We have still a phrase equivalent to this, however harsh it may seem, "I would do this if *leisure* would permit," where "*leisure*," as in this passage, stands for "want of" leisure. So again,

More than I have said
The *leisure* and enforcement of the time
Forbids to dwell upon. (V.349)

V.III.129 GHOST.

Harry, that prophesy'd thou shouldst be king,
Doth comfort thee in sleep

This prophecy, to which this allusion is made, was uttered in one of the parts of *Henry the Sixth*. (V.350)

V.III.177 KING RICHARD.

Give me another horse—bind up my wounds—
Have mercy, Jesu—soft, I did but dream.
O coward conscience, how dost thou afflict me?
The lights burn blue—is it not dead midnight?
Cold fearful drops stand on my trembling flesh.
What? do I fear myself? there's none else by;
Richard loves Richard; that is, I am I.
Is there a murd'rer here? no—yes, I am.
Then fly—what, from myself? Great reason; why?
Lest I revenge. What? myself on myself?
I love myself. Wherefore? for any good,
That I myself have done unto myself?
O, no. Alas, I rather hate myself,
For hateful deeds committed by my self.
I am a villain; yet I lye, I am not.
Fool, of thyself speak well—Fool, do not flatter.
My conscience hath a thousand sev'ral tongues,
And ev'ry tongue brings in a sev'ral tale,
And ev'ry tale condemns me for a villain.
Perjury, perjury in high'st degree,
Murder, stern murder in the dir'st degree,

All several sins, all us'd in each degree,
 Throng to the bar, all crying, "guilty! guilty!"
 I shall despair—there is no creature loves me:
 And if I die, no soul shall pity me.
 Nay, wherefore should they? since that I myself
 Find in myself no pity to myself.

There is in this, as in many of our authour's speeches of passion, something very trifling, and something very striking. Richard's debate, whether he should quarrel with himself, is too long continued, but the subsequent exaggeration of his crimes is truly tragical. (V.353)

V.iii.204 KING RICHARD.

Methought, the souls of all that I had murder'd
 Came to my tent, and every one did threat
 To morrow's vengeance on the head of Richard.

These lines stand with so little propriety at the end of this speech, that I cannot but suspect them to be misplaced. Where then shall they be inserted? Perhaps after these words,
 Fool, do not flatter. (V.354)

V.iii.250 RICHMOND.

A base foul stone, made precious by the foil
 Of England's chair, where he is falsely set
 It is plain that "foil" cannot here mean that of which the obscurity recommends the brightness of the diamond. It must mean the leaf (*feuille*) or thin plate of metal in which the stone is set. (V.356)

V.iii.265 RICHMOND.

For me, the ransom of my bold attempt
 Shall be this cold corps on the earth's cold face
 The "fine" paid by me in atonement for my rashness shall be my dead corps. (V.356)

V.iii.301 KING RICHARD.

This, and St. George to boot!
 That is, this is the order of our battle, which promises success, and over and above this, is the protection of our patron saint. (V.357)

V.III.341 KING RICHARD.

Amaze the welkin with your broken staves!

That is, "Fright the skies with the shivers of your lances." (V.359)

V.V.27 RICHMOND.

All this divided York and Lancaster,

Divided in their dire division.

I think the passage will be somewhat improved by a slight alteration.

All *that* divided York and Lancaster,

Divided in their dire division,

O now let Richmond and Elizabeth,

The true succeeders of each royal house,

By God's fair ordinance conjoin together.

Let them "unite all that York and Lancaster *divided*." (V.361)

This is one of the most celebrated of our authour's performances; yet I know not whether it has not happened to him as to others, to be praised most when praise is not most deserved. That this play has scenes noble in themselves, and very well contrived to strike in the exhibition, cannot be denied. But some parts are trifling, others shocking, and some improbable.

Two dissertations, one by Dr. Warburton, and one by Mr. Upton, upon the Vice. To this, when Mr. Upton's dissertation is subjoined, there will, perhaps, be no need of any other account of the Vice. [Upton: "An abbreviation of Vice-Devil, as Vice-roy, Vice-doges, &c."]

Mr. Upton's learning only supplies him with absurdities. His derivation of Vice is too ridiculous to be answered.

I have nothing to add to the observations of these learned criticks, but that some traces of this antiquated exhibition are still retained in the rustick puppet-plays, in which I have seen the Devil very lustily belaboured by Punch, whom I hold to be the legitimate successor of the old Vice. (V.362)

HENRY VIII

PROLOGUE. 18

To rank our chosen truth with such a show
As fool and fight is, besides forfeiting
Our own brains

This is not the only passage in which Shakespeare has discovered his conviction of the impropriety of battles represented on the stage. He knew that five or six men with swords give a very unsatisfactory idea of an army, and therefore, without much care to excuse his former practice, he allows that a theatrical fight would destroy all "opinion" of "truth," and "leave" him "never an understanding friend." *Magnis ingeniis et multa nihilominus habituris simplex convenit erroris confessio*. Yet I know not whether the coronation shewn in this play may not be liable to all that can be objected against a battle. (V.373)

PROLOGUE. 20

and th' opinion that we bring
To make that only true we now intend,
Will leave us ne'er an understanding friend.

These lines I do not understand, and suspect them of corruption. I believe we may better read thus:

th' opinion which we bring
Or make; that only *truth* we now intend. (V.373)

PROLOGUE. 25

Be sad, as we would make ye. Think ye see
The very persons of our noble story

[Why the rhyme should have been interrupted here, when it was so easily to be supplied, I cannot conceive. It can only be accounted for from the negligence of the press, or the transcribers; and therefore I have made no scruple to replace it thus; "Think before ye." THEOBALD]

This is specious, but the laxity of the versification in this prologue, and in the following epilogue, makes it not necessary. (V.374)

I.I.3 NORFOLK.

Healthful, and ever since a fresh admirer
Of what I saw there.

An admirer untired; an admirer still feeling the impression as if it were hourly renewed. (V.375)

I.i.15 NORFOLK.

'Till this time pomp was single, but now marry'd
To one above itself.

[The thought is odd and whimsical; and obscure enough to need an explanation—'Till this time (says the speaker) Pomp led a single life, as not finding a husband able to support her according to her dignity; but she has now got one in Henry VIII. who could support her even above her condition of finery. Warburton]

Dr. Warburton has here discovered more beauty than the authour intended, who meant only to say in a noisy periphrase, that "pomp was encreased on this occasion to more than twice as much as it had ever been before." Pomp is no more married to the English than to the French king, for to neither is any preference given by the speaker. Pomp is only married to pomp, but the new pomp is greater than the old. (V.376)

I.i.16 NORFOLK.

Each following day
Became the next day's master, 'till the last
Made former wonders, it's.

Dies diem docet. Every day learned something from the preceding, till the concluding day collected all the splendour of all the former shews. (V.376)

I.i.19 NORFOLK.

All clinquant, all in gold, like heathen gods
"All clinquant," all "glittering," all "shining." Clarendon uses this word in his description of the Spanish *Juego de Toros*. (V.376)

I.i.28 NORFOLK.

The two kings,
Equal in lustre, were now best, now worst,
As presence did present them; him in eye,
Still him in praise; and being present both,
'Twas said, they saw but one
So Dryden,
Two chiefs
So match'd as each seem'd worthiest when alone. (V.376)

I.1.40 NORFOLK.

the tract of every thing
 Would by a good discourser lose some life,
 Which action's self was tongue to.

The course of these triumphs and pleasures, however well related, must lose in the description part of that spirit and energy which were expressed in the real action. (V.377)

I.1.44 NORFOLK.

The office did
 Distinctly his full function.

The commission for regulating this festivity was well executed, and gave exactly to every particular person and action the proper place. (V.377)

I.1.48 NORFOLK.

One, certes, that promises no element
 In such a business.

No initiation, no previous practices. "Elements" are first principles of things, or rudiments of knowledge. The word is here applied, not without a *catachresis*, to a person. (V.378)

I.1.53 BUCKINGHAM.

What had he
 To do in these fierce vanities?

"Fierce" is here, I think, used like the French *fier* for "proud," unless we suppose an allusion to the mimical ferocity of the combatants in the tilt. (V.378)

I.1.54 BUCKINGHAM.

I wonder,
 That such a keech can with his very bulk
 Take up the rays o'th' beneficial sun

The word in the folio is "keech," which not being understood, is changed into "ketch."

A "keech" is a solid lump or mass. A cake of wax or tallow formed in a mould is called yet in some places a "keech." (V.378)

I.1.62 NORFOLK.

but spider-like
 Out of his self drawing web

Thus it stands in the first edition. The later editors, by injudicious correction, have printed,

Out of his *self-drawn* web. (V.378)

I.1.65 NORFOLK.

A gift that heaven gives for him, which buys

A place next to the King.

[Warburton: gives; which buys for him]

It is full as likely that Shakespeare wrote "gives *to* him," which will save any greater alteration. (V.378)

I.1.85 BUCKINGHAM.

What did this vanity

But minister communication of

A most poor issue?

What effect had this pompous shew, but the production of a wretched conclusion. (V.379)

I.1.96 ABERGAVENNY.

Is it therefore

Th' ambassador is silenc'd?

[Warburton: silenc'd, recall'd.]

I understand it rather of the French ambassadour residing in England, who, by being refused an audience, may, without any remote meaning, be said to be "silenc'd." (V.380)

I.1.98 ABERGAVENNY.

A proper title of a peace

A fine name of a peace. Ironically. (V.380)

I.1.113 NORFOLK.

Lo, where comes that rock,

That I advise your shunning.

To make the "rock come" is not very just. (V.381)

I.1.120 BUCKINGHAM.

This butcher's cur is venom-mouth'd

Wolsey is said to have been the son of a butcher. (1773: VII.166)

I.1.122 BUCKINGHAM.

A beggar's book

Out-worths a noble's blood.

That is, the literary qualifications of a bookish beggar are more prized than the high descent of hereditary greatness. This is a contemptuous exclamation very naturally put into the mouth of one of the antient, unlettered, martial nobility. (V.381)

I.1.128 BUCKINGHAM.

He bores me with some trick.

He stabs or wounds me by some artifice or fiction. (V.382)

I.1.137 BUCKINGHAM.

And from a mouth of honour quite cry down

This Ipswich fellow's insolence; or proclaim,

There's diff'rence in no persons.

I will crush this baseborn fellow, by the due influence of my rank, or say that all distinction of persons is at an end. (V.382)

I.1.151 BUCKINGHAM.

this top-proud fellow,

(Whom from the flow of gall I name not, but

From sincere motions) by intelligence

"Sincere motions," honest indignation; warmth of integrity. Perhaps "name" not, should be "blame" not.

Whom from the flow of gall I *blame* not. (V.382)

I.1.204 BRANDON.

I am sorry

To see you ta'en from liberty, to look on

The business present.

I am sorry that I am obliged to be present and an eye-witness of your loss of liberty. (V.384)

I.1.223 BUCKINGHAM.

my life is spann'd already.

To "span" is to "gripe" or "inclose in the hand"; to "span" is also to "measure" by the palm and the fingers. The meaning, therefore, may either be, that "hold is taken of my life, my life is in the gripe of my enemies"; or, that "my time is measured, the length of my life is now determined." (V.385)

I.1.224 BUCKINGHAM.

I am the shadow of poor Buckingham,

Whose figure ev'n this instant cloud puts on,

By dark'ning my clear sun.

These lines have passed all the editors. Does the reader understand them? By me they are inexplicable, and must be left, I fear, to some happier sagacity. If the usage of our authour's time could allow "figure" to be taken, as now, for "dignity" or "importance," we might read,

Whose figure ev'n this instant cloud puts *out*.

But I cannot please myself with any conjecture. (V.386)

There may another explanation be given somewhat harsh, but the best that occurs to me. "I am the shadow of poor Buckingham, whose figure even this instant *it* puts on," whose port and dignity is assumed by this cardinal that overclouds and oppresses me, and who gains my place, "by darkening my clear sun." *Appendix*

I.ii.1 KING.

My life itself, and the best heart of it,

Thanks you for this great care.

[The expression is monstrous. The heart is supposed the seat of life: But, as if he had many lives, and to each of them, a heart, he says, "his best heart." A way of speaking that would have become a cat rather than a king. WARBURTON]

This expression is not more monstrous than many others. Heart is not here taken for the great organ of circulation and life, but, in a common and popular sense, for the most valuable or precious part. Our authour, in *Hamlet*, mentions the "heart of heart." Exhausted and effete ground is said by the farmer to be "out of heart." The hard and inner part of the oak is called "heart of oak." (V.386)

I.ii.2 KING.

I stood i'th' level

Of a full-charg'd confed'racy

To stand in the "level" of a gun is to stand in a "line with its mouth," so as to be hit by the shot. (V.386)

I.ii.32 NORFOLK.

The many to them 'longing, have put off

The spinsters, carders, fullers, weavers

The "many" is the "meiny," the train, the people. Dryden is, perhaps, the last that used this word.

The kings before their many rode. (V.388)

I.ii.33 NORFOLK.

who,
 Unfit for other life, compell'd by hunger
 And lack of other means

[“Means” does not signify methods of livelihood, for that was said immediately before—“unfit for other life”; but it signifies, “necessaries”—“compelled,” says the speaker, “for want of bread and other necessities.” But the poet using, for the thing, (“want of bread”) the effect of it, (“hunger”) the passage is become doubly obscure; first, by using a term in a licentious sense, and then by putting it to a vicious construction. The not apprehending that this is one of the distinguishing peculiarities in Shakespeare’s stile, has been the occasion of so much ridiculous correction of him. WARBURTON]

I have inserted this note rather because it seems to have been the writer’s favourite, than because it is of much value. It explains what no reader has found difficult, and, I think, explains it wrong. (V.388)

I.ii.41 WOLSEY.

I know but of a single part in aught
 Pertains to th’ state, and front but in that file
 Where others tell steps with me.

I am but *primus inter pares*. I am but first in the row of counsellors. (V.388)

I.ii.78 WOLSEY.

To cope malicious censurers
 “To cope”; to engage with; to encounter. The word is still used in some counties. (V.390)

I.ii.81 WOLSEY.

What we oft do best,
 By sick interpreters, or weak ones, is
 The old edition reads,
 By sick interpreters (*once* weak ones) is
 Not ours,—

I do not know that the old reading ought to be restored, but it may be noted. (V.390)

I.ii.83 WOLSEY.

what worst, as oft
 Hitting a grosser quality, is cry’d up

For our best act.

The worst actions of great men are commended by the vulgar, as more accommodated to the grossness of their notions. (V.390)

I.ii.113 KING.

That he may furnish and instruct great teachers,
And never seek for aid out of himself.
Beyond the treasures of his own mind. (V.391)

I.ii.115 KING.

Yet see, when noble benefits shall prove
Not well dispos'd
Great gifts of nature and education, not joined with good dispositions. (V.391)

I.ii.118 KING.

This man so compleat,
Who was enroll'd 'mongst wonders, and when we,
Almost with list'ning ravish'd, could not find
His hour of speech, a minute
This sentence is broken and confused, though, with the allowances
always to be made to our authour, it may be understood. Yet it may
be proper to examine the old edition, which gives it thus:

and when we,
Almost with ravish'd list'ning—
I know not whether we may not read,
this man
Who was enroll'd with wonder, and *whom* we
Almost *were* ravish'd listening, could not find
His hour of speech a minute.

"To listen a man," for, to hearken to him, is commonly used by our
authour. So by Milton,

I listen'd them a while.

I do not rate my conjecture at much; but as the common reading
is without authority, something may be tried. Perhaps the passage is
best as it was originally published. (V.391)

I.ii.138 WOLSEY.

Please your Highness, note
This dangerous conception in this point.
Note this particular part of this dangerous design. (V.392)

I.ii.186 KING.

Ha! what so rank?

Rank weeds, are weeds that are grown up to great height and strength. "What," says the King, "was he advanced to this pitch?" (V.395)

I.iii.1 CHAMBERLAIN.

Is't possible, the spells of France should juggle

Men into such strange mysteries?

[Warburton: strange mockeries]

I do not deny this note to be plausible, but am in doubt whether it be right. I believe the explanation of the word "mysteries" will spare us the trouble of trying experiments of emendation. "Mysteries" were allegorical shews, which the "mummers" of those times exhibited in odd and fantastic habits. "Mysteries" are used, by an easy figure, for those that exhibited "mysteries"; and the sense is only, that the travelled Englishmen were metamorphosed, by foreign fashions, into such an uncouth appearance, that they looked like "mummers" in a mystery. (V.396)

I.iii.7 CHAMBERLAIN.

A fit or two o'th' face

A fit of the face seems to be what we now term a "grimace," an artificial cast of the countenance. (V.397)

I.iv.4 GUILFORD.

In all this noble bevy

Milton has copied this word:

A *bevy* of fair dames. (V.399)

I.iv.5 GUILFORD.

he would have all as merry

As first, good company, then good wine, good welcome,

Can make good people.

[Theobald: As first-good company, good]

Sir T. Hanmer has mended it more commodiously:

As first, good company, *then*, good wine, &c. (V.399)

Sir T. Hanmer has mended it more elegantly, but with greater violence:

As first, good company, *then* good wine &c.

(1773: VII.186)

I.iv.89 KING.

You are a churchman, or, I'll tell you, Cardinal,
I should judge now unhappily.

"Unhappily," that is, "unluckily"; "mischievously." (V.403)

II.i.71 BUCKINGHAM.

Ye few, that lov'd me,
And dare be bold to weep for Buckingham,
His noble friends and fellows, whom to leave
Is only bitter to him, only dying,
Go with me, like good angels, to my end:
And as the long divorce of steel falls on me,
Make of your prayers one sweet sacrifice,
And lift my soul to heav'n. — Lead on, o' God's name.
These lines are remarkably tender and pathetick. (V.407)

II.i.84 BUCKINGHAM.

There cannot be those numberless offences
'Gainst me, I can't take peace with: no black envy
Shall make my grave.

[Warburton: mark my grave]

Dr. Warburton has with good judgment observed the error, but has not, I think, very happily corrected it. I do not see how the envy of those that are buried can "mark" the grave. In reading the lines I cannot but suspect that two words, as it may naturally happen, have changed places.

There cannot be those numberless offences
'Gainst me, I can't *take* peace with: no black envy
Shall *make* my grave. — —

I would read thus:

There cannot be those numberless offences
'Gainst me, I can't *make* peace with, no black envy
Shall *take* my grave.

To "take" in this place is to "blast," to "strike with malignant influence." So in *Lear*,

Strike her young limbs
Ye *taking* airs with lameness.
So in *Hamlet*,
No spirit dares walk abroad,
No planet *takes*. — (V.407)

II.i.105 BUCKINGHAM.

I now seal it;

And with that blood, will make 'em one day groan for't.

I now seal my truth, my loyalty, with blood, which blood shall one day make them groan. (V.408)

II.ii.44 NORFOLK.

Or this imperious man will work us all

From princes into pages

This may allude to the retinue of the Cardinal, who had several of the nobility among his menial servants. (V.412)

II.ii.45 NORFOLK.

all men's honours

Lie like one lump before him, to be fashion'd

Into what pitch he please.

[Here is a strange dissonance in the metaphor, which is taken from unbaked dough. I read ... "pinch ...," i.e. into what shape he please. **WARBURTON**]

I do not think this emendation necessary, let the allusion be to what it will. The mass must be fashioned into "pitch" or height as well as into particular form. The meaning is, that the Cardinal can, as he pleases, make high or low. (V.412)

II.ii.75 KING.

My good Lord, have great care

I be not found a talker.

I take the meaning to be, "Let care be taken that my promise be performed, that my professions of welcome be not found empty talk." (V.414)

II.ii.79 NORFOLK.

This priest has no pride in him?

SUFFOLK. Not to speak of:

I would not be so sick though, for his place.

That is, "so sick" as he is proud. (V.414)

II.ii.125 CAMPEIUS.

And fearing he would rise, he was so virtuous,

Kept him a foreign man still

Kept him out of the King's presence, employed in foreign embassies. (V.415)

II.iii.10 ANNE.

To give her the avant!

To send her away contemptuously; to pronounce against her a sentence of ejection. (V.416)

II.iii.14 ANNE.

Yet if that quarrel, fortune, do divorce

It from the bearer

[He calls fortune a "quarrel" or arrow, from her striking so deep and suddenly. "Quarrel" was a large arrow so called. WARBURTON]

Such is Dr. Warburton's interpretation. Sir Thomas Hanmer reads, That *quarreller* Fortune.

I think the poet may be easily supposed to use "quarrel" for "quarreller," as "murder" for "murderer," the act for the agent. (V.417)

II.iii.16 OLD LADY.

Ah! poor lady,

She's stranger now again.

Again an alien; not only no longer Queen but no longer an English-woman. (V.417)

II.iii.22 OLD LADY.

Our content

Is our best having.

That is, our best "possession." So in *Macbeth*,

Promises

Of noble *having* and of royal hope.

In Spanish, *hazienda* (V.417)

II.iii.40 OLD LADY.

Then you are weakly made; pluck off a little.

What must she pluck off? I think we may better read, pluck *up* a little.

"Pluck up!" is an idiomatical expression for "take courage." (V.418)

II.iii.46 OLD LADY.

In faith, for little England

You'd venture an emballing

You would venture to be distinguished by the "ball," the ensign of royalty. (V.418)

II.iii.67 ANNE.

More than my all, is nothing
[Warburton: all, which is nothing.]

It is not nonsense, but only an hyperbole. Not only my "all is nothing," but if my all were more than it is, it were still nothing. (V.419)

II.iii.74 CHAMBERLAIN.

I shall not fail t'approve the fair conceit,
The King hath of you.

I shall not omit to strengthen, by my commendation, the opinion which the King has formed. (V.419)

II.iii.78 CHAMBERLAIN.

But from this lady may proceed a gem,
To lighten all this isle?

Perhaps alluding to the "carbuncle," a gem supposed to have intrinsic light, and to shine in the dark; any other gem may reflect light, but cannot give it. (V.419)

II.iv.1 [Stage direction] Trumpets, Sennet, and Cornets.

I know not the meaning of this word, which is in all the editions, except that Hanmer, not understanding it, has left it out. It should probably be "Seneschals." (V.421)

"Sennet" was an instrument of musick, as appears from other places of this authour, but of what kind I know not. *Appendix*.

II.iv.1 [Stage direction] two gentlemen, bearing two great silver pillars

Pillars were some of the ensigns of dignity carried before cardinals. Sir Thomas More, when he was speaker to the Commons, advised them to admit Wolsey into the house with his maces and his "pillars." *More's Life of Sir T. More*. (V.421)

II.iv.32 QUEEN CATHARINE.

did I

Continue in my liking? nay, gave not notice
He was from thence discharg'd.

In former editions:

"—nay, gave notice," which, though the authour's common liberties of speech might justify, yet I cannot but think that "not" was dropped before "notice," having the same letters, and have therefore followed Sir Thomas Hanmer's correction. (V.422)

II.iv.77 QUEEN CATHARINE.

You are mine enemy, and make my challenge,
 You shall not be my judge.

"Challenge" is here a *verbum juris*, a law term. The criminal, when he refuses a juryman, says, "I *challenge* him." I think there is a slight error which destroys the connection, and would read,

Induc'd by potent circumstances, that
 You are mine enemy, I make my challenge.
 — You shall not be my judge. (V.424)

II.iv.108 QUEEN CATHARINE.

You sign your place and calling, in full seeming,
 With meekness and humility

I think, to "sign" must here be to "show," to "denote." By your outward meekness and humility you "show" that you are of an holy order, but, &c. (V.425)

II.iv.113 QUEEN CATHARINE.

Where pow'rs are your retainers; and your words,
 Domesticks to you, serve your will, as't please
 Yourself pronounce their office.

You have now got "power" at your beck, following in your retinue; and "words" therefore are degraded to the servile state of performing any office which you shall give them. In humbler and more common terms; "Having now got *power* you do not regard your word." (V.425)

II.iv.139 KING.

thy parts
 Sov'reign and pious else, could speak thee out
 If thy several qualities had tongues to speak thy praise. (V.426)

II.iv.146 WOLSEY.

(for where I'm robb'd and bound,
 There must I be unloos'd, although not there
 At once, and fully satisfy'd)
 [Warburton: Aton'd, and]

I do not see what is gained by this alteration. The sense, which is incumbered with words in either reading, is no more than this. I must be "loosed," though when so "loosed" I shall not be "satisfied" fully and "at once"; that is, I shall not be "immediately" satisfied. (V.426)

II.iv.170 KING.

My conscience first receiv'd a tenderness,
 Scruple, and prick, on certain speeches utter'd
 Prick of conscience was the term in confession. (V.427)

II.iv.199 KING.

Thus hulling in
 The wild sea of my conscience
 That is, floating without guidance; tost here and there. (V.428)

II.iv.227 KING.

we are contented
 To wear our mortal state to come, with her,
 Catharine our Queen, before the primest creature
 That's paragon'd i' th' world.
 Hanmer reads, I think, better,
 The primest creature
 That's paragon o' th' world. (V.430)

III.I.22 QUEEN CATHARINE.

They should be good men, their affairs are righteous
 [Affairs for "professions"; and then the sense is clear and pertinent.
 Warburton]

The sentence has no great difficulty; "affairs" means not their
 "present errand," but the "business of their calling." (V.432)

III.I.33 QUEEN CATHARINE.

My Lords, I care not, so much I am happy
 Above a number, if my actions
 Were try'd by ev'ry tongue, ev'ry eye saw 'em,
 Envy and base opinion set against 'em
 I would be glad that my conduct were in some publick confronted
 with my enemies, that envy and corrupt judgment might try their
 utmost power against me. (V.432)

III.I.37 QUEEN CATHARINE.

If your business
 Do seek me out, and that way I am wife in,
 Out with it boldly.
 That is, if you come to examine "the title" by which I am the King's
 "wife"; or, if you come to know how I have behaved as a wife. The
 meaning, whatever it be, is so coarsely and unskilfully expressed,

that the latter editors have liked nonsense better, and, contrarily to the antient and only copy, have published,

And that way I am *wise* in. (V.432)

III.I.83 QUEEN CATHARINE.

can you think, Lords,

That any English man dare give me counsel?

Or be a known friend 'gainst his Highness' pleasure,

Though he be grown so desp'rate to be honest,

And live a subject?

Do you think that any Englishman dare advise me; or, if any man should venture to advise with honesty, that he could live? (V.434)

III.I.88 QUEEN CATHARINE.

They that must weigh out my afflictions

This phrase is obscure. To "weigh out," is, in modern language, "to deliver by weight"; but this sense cannot be here admitted. To "weigh" is likewise "to deliberate upon," "to consider with due attention." This may, perhaps, be meant. Or the phrase, "to weigh out," may signify to "counterballance," to "counteract" with equal force. (V.434)

III.I.102 QUEEN CATHARINE.

The more shame for you; holy men I thought you,

Upon my soul, two rev'rend cardinal virtues,

But cardinal sins, and hollow hearts, I fear you

If I mistake you, it is by your fault, not mine; for I thought you good. The distress of Catharine might have kept her from the quibble to which she is irresistibly tempted by the word "cardinal." (V.435)

III.I.131 QUEEN CATHARINE.

Been, out of fondness, superstitious to him?

That is, served him with superfluous attention; done more than was required. (V.436)

III.I.145 QUEEN CATHARINE.

Ye've angels' faces, but heav'n knows your hearts.

She may perhaps allude to the old jingle of *Angli* and *Angeli*. (V.436)

III.ii.9 SUFFOLK.

Which of the peers
Have unctemn'd gone by him, or at least
Strangely neglected?

[Warburton: Stood not neglected]

Dr. Warburton's alteration makes a more correct sentence, but in our authour's licentious English, the passage, as it stands, means the same as, "Which of the peers has not gone by him contemned or neglected." (V.438)

III.ii.11 SUFFOLK.

when did he regard
The stamp of nobleness in any person
Out of himself?

[Warburton: Out of't himself]

I do not think this correction proper. The meaning of the present reading is easy. "When did he," however careful to carry his own dignity to its utmost height, "regard any dignity of another." (V.438)

III.ii.26 NORFOLK.

In the divorce, his contrary proceedings
Are all unfolded
Private practices opposite to his publick procedure. (V.439)

III.ii.38 CHAMBERLAIN.

The King in this perceives him, how he coasts
And hedges his own way.

[Warburton: edges]

To "hedge," is, to creep along by the hedge; not to take the direct and open path, but to steal covertly through circumvolutions. (V.440)

III.ii.166 WOLSEY.

My Sovereign, I confess your royal graces
Showr'd on me daily have been more than could
My studied purposes requite, which went
Beyond all man's endeavours.

["Endeavours" for deserts. But the Oxford editor, not knowing the sense in which the word is here used, alters it to "ambition." WAR-BURTON]

To put "ambition" in the place of "endeavours" is certainly wrong; and to explain "endeavours" by "deserts" is not right. The sense, and

that not very difficult, is, my "purposes" went beyond all human "endeavour." I purposed for your honour more than it falls within the compass of man's nature to attempt. (V.444)

III.ii.169 WOLSEY.

My endeavours

Have ever come too short of my desires,

Yet, fil'd with my abilities

My endeavours, though less than my desires, have "fil'd"; that is, have gone an equal pace with my abilities. (V.444)

III.ii.186 KING.

your hand and heart,

Your brain, and every function of your power,

Should notwithstanding that your bond of duty,

As 'twere in love's particular, be more

To me, your friend, than any.

Besides the general bond of duty by which you are obliged to "be a loyal and obedient subject," you owe a "particular" devotion of yourself to me, as your "particular" benefactor. (V.445)

III.ii.233 WOLSEY.

words cannot carry

Authority so mighty.

SUFFOLK. Who dare cross 'em,

Bearing the King's will from his mouth expressly?

WOLSEY.

'Till I find more than will, or words to do it,

(I mean, your malice;) know, officious Lords,

I dare, and must deny it.

Wolsey had said,

words cannot carry

Authority so mighty.

to which they reply, "Who dare cross 'em," &c. Wolsey, answering them, continues his own speech. "'Till I find more than will or words (I mean *more than* your malicious *will and words*) to do it"; that is, "to carry authority so mighty"; I will deny to return what the King has given me. (V.447)

III.ii.355 WOLSEY.

The third day comes a frost, a killing frost,
 And when he thinks, good easy man, full surely
 His greatness is a ripening, nips his root;
 And then he falls, as I do.

[Warburton: shoot]

Here is a long note. But at last we may as well continue the ancient reading. Vernal frosts indeed do not kill the “root,” but then to “nip” the “shoots” does not kill the tree or make it fall. The metaphor will not in either reading correspond exactly with nature. (V.452)

III.ii.399 WOLSEY.

May have a tomb of orphans’ tears wept on him!

The Chancellor is the general guardian of orphans. A “tomb of tears” is very harsh. (V.454)

III.ii.455 WOLSEY.

Had I but serv’d my God with half the zeal
 I serv’d my King, he would not in mine age
 Have left me naked to mine enemies.

This sentence was really uttered by Wolsey. (V.456)

IV.i.9 2 GENTLEMAN.

they’re ever forward
 In celebration of this day with shows,
 Pageants, and sights of honour.

Hanmer reads, “these days,” but Shakespeare meant “such a day as this,” a coronation day. And such is the English idiom, which our authour commonly prefers to grammatical nicety. (V.457)

IV.ii.1 [Stage direction] Changes to Kimbolton.

Enter Catharine Dowager, sick, led between Griffith,
 her gentleman usher, and Patience her woman.

This scene is above any other part of Shakespeare’s tragedies, and perhaps above any scene of any other poet, tender and pathetick, without gods, or furies, or poisons, or precipices, without the help of romantick circumstances, without improbable sallies of poetical lamentation, and without any throes of tumultuous misery. (V.462)

V.I.2 GARDNER.

These should be hours for necessities,
Not for delights

Gardiner himself is not much delighted. The delight at which he hints seems to be the King's diversion, which keeps him in attendance. (V.469)

V.I.12 GARDNER.

give your friend

Some touch of your late business.

Some hint of the business that keeps you awake so late. (V.469)

V.I.36 LOVELL.

Stands in the gap and trade for more preferments

[Warburton: tread]

"Trade" is the "practised method," the "general course." (V.470)

V.I.47 GARDINER.

Have broken with the King

They have broken silence; told their minds to the King. (V.471)

V.I.106 KING.

To make your house our Tower. You a brother of us,

It fits we thus proceed; or else no witness

Would come against you.

You being one of the council, it is necessary to imprison you, that the witnesses against you may not be deterr'd. (V.473)

V.I.112 GRANMER.

There's none stands under more calumnious tongues

Than I myself, poor man.

"Poor man" probably belongs to the King's reply. (1773: VII.267)

V.I.122 CRANMER.

The good I stand on is my truth and honesty

Though "good" may be taken for "advantage" or "superiority," or any thing which may help or support, yet it would, I think, be more natural to say,

The *ground* I stand on. (V.474)

V.i.164 LADY.

the God of heav'n

Both now and ever bless her!

It is doubtful whether "her" is referred to the Queen or the girl.
(V.475)

V.iii.10 LORD CHANCELOR.

but we are all men

In our own natures frail, and capable

Of frailty, few are angels

[The sentiment is this, We are sinners by imputation, and liable to become actually so. Warburton]

This sentence I think needed no commentary. The meaning, and the plain meaning, is, "we are men frail by nature, and therefore liable to acts of frailty," to deviations from the right. I wish every commentator, before he suffers his confidence to kindle, would repeat,

We are all men

In our own natures frail, and capable

Of frailty; few are angels. (V.479)

V.iii.71 GARDNER.

your painted gloss discovers,

To men that understand you, words and weakness.

Those that understand you, under this "painted gloss," this fair outside, discover your empty talk and your false reasoning. (V.481)

V.iii.166 KING.

Come, come, my Lord, you'd spare your spoons.

It appears by this and another passage in the next scene, that the gossips gave spoons. (V.484)

V.iv.6 PORTER.

Fetch me a dozen crab tree staves, and strong ones; these are but switches to 'em.

[Warburton: These are but switches.—To 'em.]

The present pointing seems to be right. (V.485)

V.iv.20 MAN.

I am not Sampson, nor Sir Guy, nor Colebrand

Of Guy of Warwick every one has heard. Colebrand was the Danish giant whom Guy subdued at Winchester. Their combat is very elaborately described by Drayton in his *Polyolbion*. (V.486)

V.iv.31 PORTER.

Is this Morefields to muster in?

The train-bands of the city were exercised in Morefields. (V.486)

V.iv.38 MAN.

he should be a brasier by his face

A "brasier" signifies a man that manufactures brass, and a reservoir for charcoal occasionally heated to convey warmth. Both these senses are here understood. (V.486)

V.iv.47 MAN.

I mist the meteor once

The fire-drake, the brasier. (V.487)

V.iv.58 PORTER.

no audience but the Tribulation of

Tower-Hill, or the limbs of Limehouse, their dear brothers, are able to endure.

I suspect the "Tribulation" to have been a puritanical meeting-house. The "limbs of Limehouse" I do not understand.v.487

v.iv.62 PORTER.

the running banquet of two beadles

A publick whipping.v.487

v.iv.78 CHAMBERLAIN.

And here ye lie baiting of bumbards

A "bumbard" is an "ale-barrel"; to "bait bumbards" is "to tipple," to "lie at the spigot." v.488

v.v.36 CRANMER.

God shall be truly known, and those about her

From her shall read the perfect ways of honour,

And claim by those their greatness, not by blood.

[Nor shall this peace sleep with her; but as when

The bird of wonder dies, the maiden Phoenix,

Her ashes new-create another heir,

As great in admiration as herself;

So shall she leave her blessedness to one,

When heav'n shall call her from this cloud of darkness,

Who from the sacred ashes of her honour

Shall star-like rise, as great in fame as she was,

And so stand fix'd. Peace, Plenty, Love, Truth, Terror,
 That were the servants to this chosen infant,
 Shall then be his, and like a vine grown to him;
 Where-ever the bright sun of heav'n shall shine,
 His honour and the greatness of his name
 Shall be, and make new nations. He shall flourish,
 And, like a mountain cedar, reach his branches
 To all the plains about him: childrens' children
 Shall see this, and bless heav'n.

KING.

Thou speakest wonders.]

CRANMER.

She shall be, to the happiness of England,
 An aged Princess; many days shall see her,
 And yet no day without a deed to crown it.
 'Would, I had known no more but she must die,
 She must, the Saints must have her; yet a Virgin,
 A most unspotted lily she shall pass
 To th' ground, and all the world shall mourn her.

These lines, to the interruption by the King, seem to have been inserted at some revisal of the play after the accession of King James. If the passage, included in crotchets, be left out, the speech of Cranmer proceeds in a regular tenour of prediction and continuity of sentiments; but by the interposition of the new lines, he first celebrates Elizabeth's successor, and then wishes he did not know that she was to die; first rejoices at the consequence, and then laments the cause. Our authour was at once politick and idle; he resolved to flatter James, but neglected to reduce the whole speech to propriety, or perhaps intended that the lines inserted should be spoken in the action, and omitted in the publication, if any publication ever was in his thoughts. Mr. Theobald has made the same observation.v.490

The play of *Henry the Eighth* is one of those which still keeps possession of the stage, by the splendour of its pageantry. The coronation about forty years ago drew the people together in multitudes for a great part of the winter. Yet pomp is not the only merit of this play. The meek sorrows and virtuous distress of Catherine have furnished some scenes which may be justly numbered among the greatest efforts of tragedy. But the genius of Shakespeare comes in and goes

out with Catherine. Every other part may be easily conceived, and easily written.v.491

EPILOGUE.

Though it is very difficult to decide whether short pieces be genuine or spurious, yet I cannot restrain myself from expressing my suspicion that neither the prologue nor epilogue to this play is the work of Shakespeare; *non vultus, non color*. It appears to me very likely that they were supplied by the friendship or officiousness of Jonson, whose manner they will be perhaps found exactly to resemble. There is yet another supposition possible: the prologue and epilogue may have been written after Shakespeare's departure from the stage, upon some accidental revisal of the play, and there will then be reason for imagining that the writer, whoever he was, intended no great kindness to him, this play being recommended by a subtle and covert censure of his other works. There is in Shakespeare so much of "fool and fight,"

the fellow

In a long motley coat, guarded with yellow,
appears so often in his drama, that I think it not very likely that he would have animadverted so severely on himself. All this, however, must be received as very dubious, since we know not the exact date of this or the other plays, and cannot tell how our authour might have changed his practice or opinions. (V.492)

The historical dramas are now concluded, of which the two parts of *Henry the Fourth*, and *Henry the Fifth*, are among the happiest of our authour's compositions; and *King John*, *Richard the Third*, and *Henry the Eighth*, deservedly stand in the second class. Those whose curiosity would refer the historical scenes to their original, may consult Hollingshead, and sometimes Hall: from Hollingshead Shakespeare has often inserted whole speeches with no more alteration than was necessary to the numbers of his verse. To transcribe them into the margin was unnecessary, because the original is easily examined, and they are seldom less perspicuous in the poet than in the historian.

To play histories, or to exhibit a succession of events by action and dialogue, was a common entertainment among our rude ancestors upon great festivities. The parish clerks once performed at Clerkenwell a play which lasted three days, containing, *The History of the World*. (V.493)

MACBETH

(392) Most of the notes which the present editor has subjoined to this play were published by him in a small pamphlet in 1745.

I.i (393,*) *Enter three Witches*] In order to make a true estimate of the abilities and merit of a writer, it is always necessary to examine the genius of his age, and the opinions of his contemporaries. A poet who should now make the whole action of his tragedy depend upon enchantment, and produce the chief events by the assistance of supernatural agents, would be censured as transgressing the bounds of probability, be banished from the theatre to the nursery, and condemned to write fairy tales instead of tragedies; but a survey of the notions that prevailed at the time when this play was written, will prove that Shakespeare was in no danger of such censures, since he only turned the system that was then universally admitted, to his advantage, and was far from overburthening the credulity of his audience.

The reality of witchcraft or enchantment, which, though not strictly the same, are confounded in this play, has in all ages and countries been credited by the common people, and in most, by the learned themselves. These phantoms have indeed appeared more frequently, in proportion as the darkness of ignorance has been more gross; but it cannot be shown, that the brightest gleams of knowledge have at any time been sufficient to drive them out of the world. The time in which this kind of credulity was at its height, seems to have been that of the holy war, in which the Christians imputed all their defeats to enchantments or diabolical opposition, as they ascribed their success to the assistance of their military saints; and the learned Dr. Warburton appears to believe (*Suppl. to the Introduction to Don Quixote*) that the first accounts of enchantments were brought into this part of the world by those *who* returned from their eastern expeditions. But there is always some distance between the birth and maturity of folly as of wickedness: this opinion had long existed, though perhaps the application of it had in no foregoing age been so frequent,

nor the reception so general. Olympiodorus, in Photius's extracts, tells us of one Libanius, who practised this kind of military magic, and having promised [Greek: *choris opliton kata barbaron energein*] to perform great things against the Barbarians without soldiers, was, at the instances of the empress Placidia, put to death, when he was about to have given proofs of his abilities. The empress shewed some kindness in her anger by cutting him off at a time so convenient for his reputation.

But a more remarkable proof of the antiquity of this notion may be found in St. Chrysostom's book *de Sacerdotia*, which exhibits a scene of enchantments not exceeded by any romance of the middle age: he supposes a spectator overlooking a field of battle attended by one that points out all the various objects of horror, the engines of destruction, and the arts of slaughter. [Greek: *Deichnuto de eti para tois enantiois kai petomenous hippos dia tinos magganeias, kai oplitas di' aeros pheromenous, kai pasaen goaeteias dunomin kai idean.*] *Let him then proceed to shew him in the opposite armies horses flying by enchantment, armed men transported through the air, and every power and form of magic.* Whether St. Chrysostom believed that such performances were really to be seen in a day of battle, or only endeavoured to enliven his description, by adopting the notions of the vulgar, it is equally certain, that such nations were in his time received, and that therefore they were not imported from the Saracens in a later age; the wars with the Saracens however gave occasion to their propagation, not only as bigotry naturally discovers prodigies, but as the scene of action was removed to a great distance.

The Reformation did not immediately arrive at its meridian, and though day was gradually encreasing upon us, the goblins of witchcraft still continued to hover in the twilight. In the time of queen Elizabeth was the remarkable trial of the witches of Warbois, whose conviction is still commemorated in an annual sermon at Huntingdon. But in the reign of king James, in which this tragedy was written, many circumstances concurred to propagate and confirm this opinion. The king, who was much celebrated for his knowledge, had, before his arrival in England, not only examined in person a woman accused of witchcraft, but had given a very formal account of the practices and illusions of evil spirits, the compacts of witches, the ceremonies used by them, the manner of detecting them, and the justice of punishing them, in his dialogues of *Daemonologie*, written in the

Scottish dialect, and published at Edinburgh. This book was, soon after his accession, reprinted at London, and as the ready way to gain king James's favour was to flatter his speculations, the system of *Dæmonologie* was immediately adopted by all who desired either to gain preferment or not to lose it. Thus the doctrine of witchcraft was very powerfully inculcated; and as the greatest part of mankind have no other reason for their opinions than that they are in fashion, it cannot be doubted but this persuasion made a rapid progress, since vanity and credulity co-operated in its favour. The infection soon reached the parliament, who, in the first year of king James, made a law, by which it was enacted, chap. xii. "That if any person shall use any invocation or conjuration of any evil or wicked spirit; 2. or shall consult, covenant with, entertain, employ, feed or reward any evil or cursed spirit to or for any intent or purpose; 3. or take up any dead man, woman or child out of the grave,—or the skin, bone, or any part of the dead person, to be employed or used in any manner of witchcraft, sorcery, charm, or enchantment; 4. or shall use, practise or exercise any sort of witchcraft, sorcery, charm, or enchantment; 5. whereby any person shall be destroyed, killed, wasted, consumed, pined, or lamed in any part of the body; 6. That every such person being convicted shall suffer death." This law was repealed in our own time.

Thus, in the time of Shakespeare, was the doctrine of witchcraft at once established by law and by the fashion, and it became not only unpolite, but criminal, to doubt it; and as prodigies are always seen in proportion as they are expected, witches were every day discovered, and multiplied as fast in some places, that bishop Hall mentions a village in Lancashire, where their number was greater than that of the houses. The jesuits and sectaries took advantage of this universal error, and endeavoured to promote the interest of their parties by pretended cures of persons afflicted by evil spirits; but they were detected and exposed by the clergy of the established church.

Upon this general infatuation Shakespeare might be easily allowed to found a play, especially since he has followed with great exactness such histories as were then thought true; nor can it be doubted that the scenes of enchantment, however they may now be ridiculed, were both by himself and his audience thought awful and affecting.

I.i.10 (396,5) Fair is foul, and foul is fair] I believe the meaning is, that to us, perverse and malignant as we are, *fair is foul, and foul is fair*.

I.ii.14 (398,9) And Fortune, on his damned quarry smiling] Thus the old copy; but I am inclined to read *quarrel*. *Quarrel* was formerly used for *cause*, or for *the occasion of a quarrel*, and is to be found in that sense in Hollingshed's account of the story of Macbeth, who, upon the creation of the prince of Cumberland, thought, says the historian, that he had *a just quarrel*, to endeavour after the crown. The sense therefore is, *Fortune smiling on his execrable cause*, &c. This is followed by Dr. Warburton. (see 1765, VI, 373, 4).

I.ii.28 (400,4) Discomfort swells] *Discomfort* the natural opposite to *comfort*. *Well'd*, for *flawed*, was an emendation. The common copies have, *discomfort swells*.

I.ii.37 (400,5) As cannons overcharg'd with double cracks,
So they

Doubly redoubled strokes upon the foe]

Mr. Theobald has endeavoured to improve the sense of this passage by altering the punctuation thus:

—*they were*

As cannons overcharg'd, with double cracks

So they redoubled strokes—

He declares, with some degree of exultation, that he has no idea of a *cannon charged with double cracks*; but surely the great author will not gain much by an alteration which makes him say of a hero, that he *redoubles strokes with double cracks*, an expression not more loudly to be applauded, or more easily pardoned than that which is rejected in its favour. That a cannon is charged *with thunder*, or *with double thunders*, may be written, not only without nonsense, but with elegance, and nothing else is here meant by *cracks*, which in the time of this writer was a word of such emphasis and dignity, that in this play he terms the general dissolution of nature the *crack of doom*.

The old copy reads,

They doubly redoubled strokes.

I.ii.46 (401,8) So should he look, that seems to speak things strange]
The meaning of this passage, as it now stands, is, *so should he look, that looks as if he told things strange*. But Rosse neither yet told strange things, nor could look as if he told them; Lenox only conjectured from his air that he had strange things to tell, and therefore undoubtedly said,

What haste looks thro' his eyes?

So should he look, that teems to speak thinks strange.

He looks like one that is *big with* something of importance; a metaphor so natural that it is every day used in common discourse.

I.ii.55 (402,1) Confronted him with self-comparisons] [Theobald interpreted "him" as Cawdor; Johnson, in 1745, accused Shakespeare of forgetfulness on the basis of Theobald's error; and Warburton here speaks of "blunder upon blunder."] The second blunderer was the present editor.

I.iii.6 (403,5) *Aroint thee, witch!*] In one of the folio editions the reading is *Anoint thee*, in a sense very consistent with the common accounts of witches, who are related to perform many supernatural acts by the means of unguents, and particularly to fly through the air to the places where they meet at their hellish festivals. In this sense, *anoint thee, Witch*, will mean, *Away, Witch, to your infernal assembly*. This reading I was inclined to favour, because I had met with the word *aroint* in no other authour till looking into Hearne's Collections I found it in a very old drawing, that he has published, in which St. Patrick is represented visiting hell, and putting the devils into great confusion by his presence, of whom one that is driving the damned before him with a prong, has a label issuing out of his mouth with these words, OUT OUT ARONGT, of which the last is evidently the same with *aroint*, and used in the same sense as in this passage.

I.iii.15 (405,8) And the very points they blew] As the word *very* is here of no other use than to fill up the verse, it is likely that Shakespeare wrote *various*, which might be easily mistaken for *very*, being either negligently read, hastily pronounced, or imperfectly heard.

I.iii.21 (405,9) He shall live a man forbid] Mr. Theobald has very justly explained *forbid* by *accursed*, but without giving any reason of his interpretation.

As to *forbid* therefore implies to *prohibit*, in opposition to the word *bid* in its present sense, it signifies by the same kind of opposition to *curse*, when it is derived from the same word in its primitive meaning.

I.iii.42 (409,3) are you aught/ That man may question?] Are ye any beings with which man is permitted to hold converse, or of which it is lawful to ask questions?

I.iii.53 (410,5) Are ye fantastical] By *fantastical*, he means creatures of fantasy or imagination; the question is, Are these real beings before us, or are we deceived by illusions of fancy?

I.iii.97 (412,8) As thick as tale] [As thick as hail] Was Mr. Pope's correction. The old copy has,

—As *thick* as tale

Can post *with* post;—

which perhaps is not amiss, meaning that the news came as *thick* as a *tale* can *travel* with the *post*. Or we may read, perhaps yet better,

—As *thick* as tale

Came *post with* post;—

That is, posts arrived as fast as they could be counted.

I.iii.130 (414,4) This supernatural solliciting] *Solliciting* is rather, in my opinion, *incitement* than *information*.

I.iii.134 (414,5) why do I yield] To *yield* is, simply, to *give way* to.

I.iii.137 (414,6) Present fears/ Are less than horrible imaginings] [W: feats] *Present fears* are *fears of things present*, which Macbeth declares, and every man has found, to be less than the *imagination* presents them while the objects are yet distant. *Fears* is right.

I.iii.140 (415,7) single state of man] The *single state of man* seems to be used by Shakespeare for an *individual*, in opposition to a *commonwealth*, or *conjunct body*.

I.iii.40 (415,8) function/ Is smother'd in surmise; and nothing is,/ But what is not] All powers of action are oppressed and crushed by one overwhelming image in the mind, and nothing is present to me, but that which is really future. Of things now about me I have no perception, being intent wholly on that which has yet no existence.

I.iii.147 (415,9) Time and the hour runs through the roughest day] I suppose every reader is disgusted at the tautology in this passage, *Time and the hour*, and will therefore willingly believe that Shakespeare wrote it thus,

Come *what* come may,

Time! on!—*the hour runs thro' the roughest day*.

Macbeth is deliberating upon the events which are to befall him, but finding no satisfaction from his own thoughts, he grows impa-

tient of reflection, and resolves to wait the close without harrassing hinaelf with conjectures.

Come what come may.

But to shorten the pain of suspense, he calls upon Time In the usual stile of ardent desire, to quicken his motion,

Time! on! —

He then comforts himself with the reflection that all his perplexity must have an end,

—the hour runs thro' the roughest day.

This conjecture is supported by the passage in the letter to his lady, in which he says, *they referred me to the coming on of time, with Hail, King that shalt be.*

I.iii.149 (416,1) My dull brain was wrought] My head was *worked*, *agitated*, put into commotion.

I.iv.9 (417,3) studied in his death] Instructed in the art of dying. It was usual to say *studied*, for *learned* in science.

I.iv.12 (417,4) To find the mind's construction in the face] The *construction of the mind* is, I believe, a phrase peculiar to Shakespeare; it implies the *frame* or *disposition* of the mind, by which it is determined to good or ill.

I.iv.26 (418,5) Which do but what they should, by doing everything, Safe toward your love and honour] Of the last line of this speech, which is certainly, as it is now read, unintelligible, an emendation has been attempted, which Dr. Warburton and Dr. Theobald once admitted as the true reading:

—our duties

Are to your throne and state, children and servants,

Which do but what they should, in doing every thing

Fiefs to your love and honour.

My esteem for these critics inclines me to believe that they cannot be much pleased with these expressions *fiefs to love*, or *fiefs to honour*, and that they have proposed this alteration rather because no other occured to them, than because they approved of it. I shall therefore propose a bolder change, perhaps with no better success, but *sua cuique placent*. I read thus,

—our duties

Are to your throne and state, children and servants

*Which do but what they should, in doing nothing,
Save toward your love and honour.*

We do but perform our duty when we contract all our views to your service, when we act with *no other* principle than regard to *your love and honour*.

It is probable that this passage was first corrupted by writing *safe* for *save*, and the lines then stood thus:

—*doing nothing*
Safe toward your love and honour.

which the next transcriber observing to be wrong, and yet not being able to discover the real fault, altered to the present reading.

Dr. Warburton has since changed *fiefs* to *fief'd*, and Hanmer has altered *safe* to *shap'd*. I am afraid none of us have hit the right word.

I.v.2 (420, 6) *by the perfected report*] By the best intelligence. Dr. Warburton would read, *perfected*, and explains *report* by *prediction*. Little regard can be paid to an emendation that instead of clearing the sense, makes it more difficult.

I.v.23 (420, 7) *thoud'st have, great Glamis,/ That which cries, Thus thou must do, if thou have it*] As the object of Macbeth's desire is here introduced speaking of itself, it is necessary to read,

—*thoud'st have, great Glamis,*
That which cries, thus thou must do, if thou have me.

I.v.39 (422, 8) *The raven himself is hoarse*] Dr. Warburton reads,
—*The raven himself's not hoarse.*

Yet I think the present words may stand. The messenger, says the servant, had hardly breath *to make up his message*; to which the lady answers mentally, that he may well want breath, such a message would add hoarseness to the raven. That even the bird, whose harsh voice is accustomed to predict calamities, could not *croak the entrance of Duncan* but in a note of unwonted harshness.

I.v.42 (422, 2) *mortal thoughts*] This expression signifies not *the thoughts of mortals*, but *murtherous, deadly, or destructive designs*. So in act 5,

Hold fast the mortal sword.
And in another place,
With twenty mortal murthers.

I.v.47 (422, 3) nor keep peace between/ The effect, and it!] The intent of lady Macbeth evidently is to wish that no womanish tenderness, or conscientious remorse, may hinder her purpose from proceeding to effect; but neither this, nor indeed any other sense, is expressed by the present reading, and therefore it cannot be doubted that Shakespeare wrote differently, perhaps thus,

*That no compunctious visitings of nature
Shake my fell purpose, nor keep pace between
Th' effect, and it.—*

To *keep pace between* may signify *to pass between*, to *intervene*. *Pace* is on many occasions a favourite of Shakespeare's. This phrase is indeed not usual in this sease, but was it not its novelty that gave occasion to the present corruption? [The sense is, *that no compunctious visitings of nature* may prevail upon her, to give place in her mind to *peaceful* thoughts, or to rest one moment in quiet, from the hour of her purpose to its full completion in the effect. REVISAL.] This writer thought himself perhaps very sagacious that he found a meaning which nobody missed, the difficulty still remains how such a meaning is made by the words. (see 1765, VI, 394, 6)

I.v.49 (423, 5) take my milk for gall] *Take away my milk*, and put *gall* into the place.

I.v.51 (423, 6) You wait on nature's mischief!] *Nature's mischief* is mischief done to nature, violation of nature's order committed by wickedness.

I.v.55 (423,8) To cry, *hold, hold!*] On this passage there is a long criticism in the *Rambler*.

I.v.58 (424,1) This ignorant present time] *Ignorant* has here the signification of *unknowing*; that it, I feel by anticipation these future hours, of which, according to the process of nature, the present time would be *ignorant*.

I.vi.3 (425,3) our gentle senses] *Senses* are nothing more *than each man's sense*. *Gentle senses* is very elegant, as it means *placid, calm, composed*, and intimates the peaceable delight of a fine day. (see 1765, VI,396,2)

I.vi.7 (426,5) coigne of 'vantage] Convenient corner.

I.vi.13 (426,7) How you should bid god-yield as for your pains] I believe *yield*, or, as it is in the folio of 1623, *eyld*, is a corrupted contraction of *shield*. The wish implores not *reward* but *protection*.

I.vii.1 (428,1) If it were *done*] A man of learning recommends another punctuation:

If it were done, when 'tis done, then 'twere well.

It were done quickly, if, &c.

I.vii.2 (428,2) If the assassination/ Could trammel up the consequence] Of this soliloquy the meaning is not very clear; I have never found the readers of Shakespeare agreeing about it. I understand it thus,

"If that which I am about to do, when it is once *done* and executed, were *done* and ended without any following effects, it would then be best *to do it quickly*; if the murder could terminate in itself, and restrain the regular course of consequences, if *its success* could secure *its surcease*, if being once *successfully*, without detection, it could *fix a period* to all vengeance and enquiry, so that *this blow* might be all that I have to do, and this anxiety all that I have to suffer; if this could be my condition, even *here in this world*, in this contracted period of temporal existence, on this narrow *bank* in the ocean of eternity, *I would jump the life to come*, I would venture upon the deed without care of any future state. But this is one of *these cases* in which judgment is pronounced and vengeance inflicted upon as *here* in our present life. We teach others to do as we have done, and are punished by our own example." (1773)

I.vii.4 (428,3) With his surcease, success] I think the reasoning requires that we should read,

With its success surcease.

I.vii.6 (429,4) shoal of time] This is Theobald's emendation, undoubtedly right. The old edition has *school*, and Dr. Warburton *shelve*.

I.vii.22 (429,7) or heavens cherubin, hors'd/ Upon the sightless couriers of the air] [W: couriers] *Courier* is only *runner*. *Couriers of air* are *winds*, air in motion. *Sightless* is *invisible*.

I.vii.25 (430,8) That tears shall drown the wind] Alluding to the remission of the wind in a shower.

I.vii.28 (430,9) *Enter Lady*] The arguments by which lady Macbeth persuades her husband to commit the murder, afford a proof of Shakespeare's knowledge of human nature. She urges the excellence and dignity of courage, a glittering idea which has dazzled mankind from age to age, and animated sometimes the house-breaker, and sometimes the conqueror; but this sophism Macbeth has for ever destroyed, by distinguishing true from false fortitude, in a line and a half; of which it may almost be said, that they ought to bestow immortality on the author, though all his other productions had been lost:

*I dare do all that become a man,
Who dares do more, is none.*

This topic, which has been always employed with too much success, is used in this scene with peculiar propriety, to a soldier by a woman. Courage is the distinguishing virtue of a soldier, and the reproach of cowardice cannot be borne by any man from a woman, without great impatience.

She then urges the oaths by which he had bound himself to murder Duncan, another art of sophistry by which men have sometimes deluded their consciences, and persuaded themselves that what would be criminal in others is virtuous in them; this argument Shakespeare, whose plan obliged him to make Macbeth yield, has not confuted, though he might easily have shewn that a former obligation could not be vacated by a latter: that obligations laid on us by a higher power, could not be over-ruled by obligations which we lay upon ourselves.

I.vii.41 (431,1)

—Whouldst thou have that,
Which then esteem'st the ornament of life,
And live a coward in thine own esteem?]
In this there seems to be no reasoning. I should read,
Or live a coward in thine own esteem?
Unless we choose rather,
—*Wouldst thou leave that.*

I.vii.45 (431,2) Like the poor cat i' the adage?] The adage alluded to is, *The cat loves fish, but dares not wet her feet, Catus amat pisces, sed men vult tingere plantas.*

I.vii.64 (432,5) Will I with wine and wassel so convince] To *convince* is in Shakespeare to *overpower* or *subdue*, as in this play,

— *Their malady convinces*

The great assay of art.

I.vii.67 (433,6) A limbeck only] That is, shall be only a vessel to emit *fumes* or *vapours*.

I.vii.71 (433,7) our great quell] *Quell* is *murder*. *manquellers* being in the old language the term for which *murderers* is now used.

II.i (434,8) *Enter Banquo, and Fleance with a torch before him*] The place is not mark'd in the old edition, nor is it easy to say where this encounter can be. It is not in the *hall*, as the editors have all supposed it, for Banquo sees the sky; it is not far from the bedchamber, as the conversation shews: it must be in the inner court of the castle, which Banquo might properly cross in his way to bed.

II.i.25 (435,2) If you shall cleave to my consent, Then 'tis,/It shall make honour for you] Macbeth expressed his thought with affected obscurity; he does not mention the royalty, though he apparently has it in his mind, *If you shall cleave to my consent*, if you shall concur with me when I determine to accept the crown, *when 'tis*, when that happens which the prediction promises, *it shall make honour for you*.

II.i.49 (437,6) Now o'er the one half world/ Nature seems dead] That is, *over our hemisphere all action and motion seem to have ceased*. This image, which is perhaps the most striking that poetry can produce, has been adopted by Dryden in his *Conquest of Mexico*:

All things are hush'd as Nature's self lay dead,

The mountains seem to nod their drowsy head;

The little birds in dreams their song repeat,

And sleeping flow'rs beneath the night dews sweat.

Even lust and envy sleep!

These lines, though so well known, I have transcribed, that the contrast between them and this passage of Shakespeare may be more accurately observed.

Night is described by two great poets, but one describes a night of quiet, the other of perturbation. In the night of Dryden, all the disturbers of the world are laid asleep; in that of Shakespeare, nothing but sorcery, lust, and murder, is awake. He that reads Dryden, finds himself lull'd with serenity, and disposed to solitude and con-

temptation. He that peruses Shakspeare looks round alarmed, and starts to find himself alone. One is the night of a lover, the other, of a murderer.

II.i.52 (438,8)

—wither'd Murther,
—thus with hia stealthy pace,
With Tarquin's ravishing strides, tow'rds his design
moves like a ghost.—]

This was the reading of this passage [ravishing sides] in all the editions before that of Mr. Pope, who for *sides*, inserted in the text *strides*, which Mr. Theobald has tacitly copied from him, though a more proper alteration might perhaps have been made. A *ravishing stride* is an action of violence, impetuosity, and tumult, like that of a savage rushing at his prey; whereas the poet is here attempting to exhibit an image of secrecy and caution, of anxious circumspection and guilty timidity, the *stealthy pace* of a *ravisher* creeping into the chamber of a virgin, and of an assassin approaching the bed of him whom he proposes to murder, without awaking him; these he describes as *moving like ghosts*, whose progression is so different from *strides*, that it has been in all ages represented to be, as Milton expresses it,

Smooth sliding without step.

This hemiatic will afford the true reading of this place, which is, I think, to be corrected thus:

—and wither'd Murder.
—thus with his stealthy pace.
With Tarquin ravishing, slides tow'rds his design,
Moves like a ghost.—

Tarquin is in this place the general name of a ravisher, and the sense is, Now is the time in which every one is a-sleep, but those who are employed in wickedness; the witch who is sacrificing to Hecate, and the ravisher, and the murderer, who, like me, are stealing upon their prey.

When the reading is thus adjusted, he wishes with great propriety, in the following lines, that the *earth* may not *hear his steps*.

II.i.59 (439,3) And take the present horror from the time,/ Which now suits with it] Of this passage an alteration was once proposed by me, of which I have now a less favourable opinion, yet will insert it, as it may perhaps give some hint to other critics:

*And take the present horror from the time,
Which now suits with it. —*

I believe every one that has attentively read this dreadful soliloquy is disappointed at the conclusion, which, if not wholly unintelligible, is, at least, obscure, nor can be explained into any sense worthy of the authour. I shall therefore propose a slight alteration:

*—Thou sound and firm-set earth,
Hear not my steps, which way they walk, for fear
Thy very stones prate of my where-about,
And talk—the present horror of the time!
That now suits with it. —*

Macbeth has, in the foregoing lines, disturbed his imagination by enumerating all the terrors of the night; at length he is wrought up to a degree of frenzy, that makes him afraid of some supernatural discovery of his design, and calls out to the stones not to betray him, not to declare where he walks, nor *to talk*.—As he is going to say of what, he discovers the absurdity of his suspicion, and pauses, but is again overwhelmed by his guilt, and concludes, that such are the horrors of the present night, that the stones may be expected to cry out against him:

That now suits with it. —

He observes in a subsequent passage, that on such occasions *stones have been known to move*. It is now a very just and strong picture of a man about to commit a deliberate murder under the strongest conviction of the wickedness of his design. Of this alteration, however, I do not now see much use, and certainly see no necessity.

Whether to *take horror from the time* means not rather to *catch it* as communicated, than to *deprive the time of horror*, deserves to be considered.

II.ii.37 (443,6) sleeve of care] A skein of silk is called a *sleave* of silk, as I learned from Mr. Seward, the ingenious editor of Beaumont and Fletcher.

II.ii.56 (444,8) gild the faces of the grooms withal,/ For it must seem their guilt] Could Shakespeare possibly mean to play upon the similitude of *gild* and *guilt*.

II.iii.45 (447,5) I made a shift to cast him] To *cast him up*, to ease my stomach of him. The equivocation is between *cast* or *throw*, as a term of wrestling, and *cast* or *cast up*.

II.iii.61 (448,7)

—strange screams of death;
 And prophesying, with accents terrible
 Of dire combustions, and confus'd events,
 New hatch'd to the woeful time: The obscure bird
 Clamour'd the live-long night: some say the earth
 Was feverous, and did shake]
 Those lines I think should be rather regulated thus:
 —*prophecying with accents terrible,*
Of dire combustions and confus'd events.
New-hatch'd to th' woeful time, the obscure bird
Clamour'd the live-long night. Some say the earth
Was fev'rous and did shake.

A prophecy of an event *new hatch'd*, seems to be a prophecy of an event *past*. And a prophecy *new hatch'd* is a wry expression. The term *new hatch'd* is properly applicable to a *bird*, and that birds of ill omen should be *new-hatch'd to the woeful time*, that is, should appear in uncommon numbers, is very consistent with the rest of the prodigies here mentioned, and with the universal disorder into which nature is described as thrown, by the perpetration of this horrid murder. (see 1765, VI, 413, 7)

II.iii.117 (452,3) Here, lay Duncan,/His silver skin lac'd with his golden blood] Mr. Pope has endeavoured to improve one of these lines by substituting *goary blood* for *golden blood*; but it may easily be admitted that he who could on such an occasion talk of *lacing the silyer skin*, would *lace it* with *golden blood*. No amendment can be made to this line, of which every word is equally faulty, but by a general blot.

It is not improbable, that Shakespeare put these forced and unnatural metaphors into the mouth of Macbeth as a mark of artifice and dissimulation, to shew the difference between the studied language of hypocrisy, and the natural outcries of sudden passion. This whole speech so considered, is a remarkable instance of judgment, as it consists entirely of antithesis and metaphor.

II.iii.122 (432,5) Unmannerly breech'd with gore] An *unmannerly dagger*, and a *dagger breech'd*, or as in some editions *breech'd with*, *gore*, are expressions not easily to be understood. There are undoubtedly two faults in this passage, which I have endeavored to take away by reading,

—*daggers*

Unmanly drench'd *with gore*:—

I saw drench'd with the King's blood the fatal daggers, not only instruments of murder but evidence of cowardice.

Each of these words might easily be confounded with that which I have substituted for it, by a hand not exact, a casual blot, or a negligent inspection, [W: Unmanly reech'd] Dr. Warburton has, perhaps, rightly put *reach'd* for *breech'd*.

II.iii.138 (454,8)

In the great hand of God I stand; and thence,
Against the undivulg'd pretence I fight
Of treasonous malice]

Pretence is not act, but *simulation*, a *pretence* of the traitor, whoever he might be, to suspect some other of the murder. I here fly to the protector of innocence from any charge which, yet *undivulg'd*, the traitor may pretend to fix upon me.

II.iii.147 (454,7) This murtherous shaft that's shot,/Hath not yet lighted] The design to fix the murder upon some innocent person, has not yet taken effect.

II.iv.15 (456,9) minions of their race] Theobald reads,

—*minions of the race*,
very probably, and very poetically.

II.iv.24 (456,1) What good could they pretend?] To *pretend* is here to *propose to themselves*, to *set before themselves* as a motive of action.

III.i.7 (457,2) As upon thee, Macbeth, their speeches shine] *Shine*, for appear with all the *lustre* of *conspicuous* truth.

III.i.56 (459,4) as, it is said,/Mark Anthony's was by Caesar] Though I would not often assume the critic's privilege of being confident where certainty cannot be obtained, nor indulge myself too far in departing from the established reading; yet I cannot but propose the rejection of this passage, which I believe was an insertion of some player, that having so much learning as to discover to what Shakespeare alluded, was not willing that his audience should be less knowing than himself, and has therefore weakened the authour's sense by the intrusion of a remote and useless image into a speech bursting from a man wholly possess'd with his own present condition, and therefore not

at leisure to explain his own allusions to himself. If these words are taken away, by which not only the thought but the numbers are injured, the lines of Shakespeare close together without any traces of a breach.

My genius is rebuk'd. He chid the sisters.

This note was written before I was fully acquainted with Shakespeare's manner, and I do not now think it of much weight; for though the words, which I was once willing to eject, seem interpolated, I believe they may still be genuine, and added by the authour in his revision. The authour of the *Revisal* cannot admit the measure to be faulty. There is only one foot, he says, put for another. This is one of the effects of literature in minds not naturally perspicacious. Every boy or girl finds the metre imperfect, but the pedant comes to its defence with a tribrachys or an anapaest, and sets it right at once by applying to one language the rules of another. If we may be allowed to change feet, like the old comic writers, it will not be easy to write a line not metrical. To hint this once, is sufficient. (see 1765, VI, 424, 2)

III.i.65 (460,5) For Banquo's issue have I fil'd my mind] [W: 'filed] This mark of contraction is not necessary. To *file* is in the bishop's *Bible*.

III.i.69 (460,6) the common enemy of man] It is always an entertainment to an inquisitive reader, to trace a sentiment to its original source; and therefore, though the term *enemy of man*, applied to the devil, is in itself natural and obvious, yet some may be pleased with being informed, that Shakespeare probably borrowed it from the first lines of the *Destruction of Troy*, a book which he is known to have read. This expression, however, he might have had in many other places. The word *fiend* signifies enemy.

III.i.71 (461,7) come, Fate, into the list,/ And champion me to the utterance!] This passage will be best explained by translating it into the language from whence the only word of difficulty in it is borrowed, "*Que la destinée se rende en lice, et qu'elle me donne un defi a l'outrance.*" A challenge or a combat *a l'outrance*, to *extremity*, was a fix'd term in the law of arms, used when the combatants engaged with an *odium internecinum*, an *intention to destroy each other*, in opposition to trials of skill at festivals, or on other occasions, where the contest was only for reputation or a prize. The sense therefore is, *Let Fate, that has fore-*

doom'd the exaltation of the sons of Banquo, enter the lists against me, with the utmost animosity, in defence of its own decrees, which I will endeavour to invalidate, whatever be the danger. [Johnson quotes Warburton's note] After the former explication, Dr. Warburton was desirous to seem to do something; and he has therefore made *Fate* the *marshal*, whom I had made the *champion*, and has left Macbeth to enter the lists without an opponent.

III.i.88 (462,9) Are you so gospell'd] Are you of that degree of precise virtue? *Gospeller* was a name of contempt given by the Papists to the Lollards, the puritans of early times, and the precursors of *protestantism*.

III.i.94 (463,1) Showghes] *Showghes* are probably what we now call *shocks*, demi-wolves, *lyciscæ*; dogs bred between wolves and dogs. (1773)

III.i.95 (463,2) the valued file] In this speech the word *file* occurs twice, and seems in both places to have a meaning different from its present use. The expression, *valued file*, evidently means, a list or catalogue of value. A station in the *file*, and not in the worst rank, may mean, a place in the list of manhood, and not in the lowest place. But *file* seems rather to mean in this place, a post of honour; the first rank, in opposition to the last; a meaning which I have not observed in any other place. (1773)

III.i.112 (465,2) So weary with disasters, tug'd with fortune] *Tug'd with fortune* may be, *tug'd* or *worried* by fortune.

III.i.130 (465,4) Acquaint you with the perfect spy o' the time] What is meant by *the spy of the time*, it will be found difficult to explain; and therefore sense will be cheaply gained by a slight alteration.—Macbeth is assuring the assassins that they shall not want directions to find Banquo, and therefore says,

I will—

Acquaint you with a perfect spy o' the time.

Accordingly a third murderer joins them afterwards at the place of action.

*Perfect is well instructed, or well informed, as in this play,
Though in your state of honour I am perfect.*

though I am *well acquainted* with your quality and rank. [Warburton explained this as "the critical juncture"] How the *critical juncture* is the *spy o' the time* I know not, but I think my own conjecture right.

III.ii.38 (467,1) nature's copy's not eternal] The *copy*, the *lease*, by which they hold their lives from nature, has its time of termination limited.

III.iii.1 (469,6) But who did bid thee join with us?] The meaning of this abrupt dialogue is this. The *perfect spy*, mentioned by Macbeth in the foregoing scene, has, before they enter upon the stage, given them the directions which were promised at the time of their agreement; yet one of the murderers suborned suspects him of intending to betray them; the other observes, that, by his exact knowledge of *what they were to do*, he appears to be employed by Macbeth, and needs not be mistrusted.

III.iv.1 (470,9) You know your own degrees, sit down: at first,/ And last the hearty welcome] As this passage stands [sit down:/ At first and last], not only the numbers are very imperfect, but the sense, if any can be found, weak and contemptible. The numbers will be improved by reading,

—sit down at first,
And last a hearty welcome.

But for *last* should then be written *next*. I believe the true reading is,

You know your own degrees, sit down.—To first
And last the hearty welcome.

All of whatever degree, from the highest to the lowest, may be assured that their visit is well received.

III.iv.14 (471,1) 'Tis better thee without, than he within] The sense requires that this passage should be read thus:

'Tis better thee without, than him within.

That is, *I am better pleased that the blood of Banquo should be on thy face than in his body*.

The authour might mean, *It is better that Banquo's blood were on thy face, than he in this room*. Expressions thus imperfect are common in his works.

III.iv.33 (472,2) the feast is sold] The meaning is, — That which ia not *given cheerfully*, cannot be called a *gift*, it is something that must be paid for. (1773)

III.iv.57 (473,3) extend his passion] Prolong his suffering; make his fit longer.

III.iv.60 (473,4) O proper stuff!] This speech is rather too long for the circumstances in which it is spoken. It had begun better at, *Shame itself!*

III.iv.63 (473,5)

Oh, these flaws, and starts,
(Impostors to true fear,) would well become
A woman's story at a winter's fire,
Authoriz'd by her grandam]
Flaws, are sudden gusts. The authour perhaps wrote,
— Those flaws and starts,
Impostures true to fear *would well become;*
A woman's story, —

These symptoms of terrour and amazement might better become *impostures true only to fear, might become a coward at the recital of such falsehoods as no man could credit, whose understanding was not weaken'd by his terrours; tales told by a woman over a fire on the authority of her grandam.*

III.iv.76 (474,6) Ere human statute purg'd the gentle weal] The *gentle weal*, is, the *peaceable community*, the state made quiet and safe by *human statutes*.

Mollia securae peragebant otia gentes.

III.iv.92 (475,7) And all to all] I once thought it should be *hail* to all, but I now think that the present reading is right.

III.iv.105 (475,8) If trembling I inhabit] This is the original reading, which Mr. Pope changed to *inhibit*, which *inhibit* Dr. Warburton interprets *refuse*. The old reading may stand, at least as well as the emendation. Suppose we read,

If trembling I evade it.

III.iv.110 (476,9) Can such things be,/ And overcome us, like a summer's cloud,/ Without our special wonder?] [W: Can't] The alteration is introduced by a misinterpretation. The meaning is not that

these things are like a summer-cloud, but can such wonders as these pass over us without wonder, as a casual summer cloud passes over us.

III.iv.112 (477,1) You make me strange/ Even to the disposition that I owe] You produce in me an *alienation of mind*, which is probably the expression which our author intended to paraphrase.

III.iv.124 (477,2) Augurs, and understood relations] By the word *relation* is understood the *connection* of effects with causes; to *understand relations* as *an angur*, is to know how these things *relate* to each other, which have no visible combination or dependence.

III.iv.141 (479,5) You lack the season of all natures, sleep] I take the meaning to be, *you want sleep*, which *seasons*, or gives the relish to *all nature*. *Indiget somni vitae condimenti*.

III.v.24 (480,8) vaporous drop, profound] That is, a drop that has *profound*, *deep*, or *hidden* qualities.

III.v.26 (480,9) slights] Arts; subtle practices.

III.vi (481,1) *Enter Lenox, and another Lord*] As this tragedy, like the rest of Shakespeare's, is perhaps overstocked with personages, it is not easy to assign a reason why a nameless character should be introduced here, since nothing is said that might not with equal propriety have been put into the mouth of any other disaffected man. I believe therefore that in the original copy it was written with a very common form of contraction Lenox and An. for which the transcriber, instead of Lenox and Angus, set down Lenox and *another Lord*. The author had indeed been more indebted to the transcriber's fidelity and diligence had he committed no errors of greater importance.

III.vi.36 (482,3) and receive free honours] [*Free* for grateful. WAR-BURTON.] How can *free* be *grateful*? It may be either honours *freely bestowed*, not purchased by crimes; or honours *without slavery*, without dread of a tyrant.

IV.i (484,5) As this is the chief scene of enchantment in the play, it is proper in this place to observe, with how much judgment Shakespeare has selected all the circumstances of his infernal ceremonies, and how exactly he has conformed to common opinions and traditions:

Thrice the brinded cat hath mew'd.

The usual form in which familiar spirits are reported to converse with witches, is that of a cat. A witch, who was tried about half a century before the time of Shakespeare, had a cat named Rutterkin, as the spirit of one of these witches was Grimalkin; and when any mischief was to be done she used to bid Rutterkin *go and fly*, but once when she would have sent Rutterkin to torment a daughter of the countess of Rutland, instead of *going* or *flying*, he only cried *mew*, from whence she discovered that the lady was out of his power, the power of witches being not universal, but limited, as Shakespeare has taken care to inculcate:

*Though his bark cannot be lost,
Yet it shall be tempest-tost.*

The common afflictions which the malice of witches produced were melancholy, fits, and loss of flesh, which are threatened by one of Shakespeare's witches:

*Weary sev'n nights, nine times nine,
Shall he dwindle, peak, and pine.*

It was likewise their practice to destroy the cattle of their neighbours, and the farmers have to this day many ceremonies to secure their cows and other cattle from witchcraft; but they seem to have been most suspected of malice against swine. Shakespeare has accordingly made one of his witches declare that she has been *killing swine*, and Dr. Harsenet observes, that about that time, *a sow could not be ill of the measles, nor a girl of the sullens, but some old woman was charged with witchcraft.*

*Toad, that under the cold stone,
Days and night has, thirty-one,
Swelter'd venom sleeping got;
Boil thou first i'the charm'd pot.*

Toads have likewise long lain under the reproach of being by some means accessory to witchcraft, for which reason Shakespeare, in the first scene of this play, calls one of the spirits Padocke or Toad, and now takes care to put a toad first into the pot. When Vaninus was seized at Theleuse, there was found at his lodgings *ingens Bufo Vitro inclusus*, a great toad shut in a vial, upon which those that prosecuted him, *Veneficium expebrabant*, charged him, I suppose, *with witchcraft.*

*Fillet of fenny snake,
In the cauldron boil and bakae:
Eye of newt, and toe of frog;—*

For a charm, &c.

The propriety of these ingredients may be known by consulting the books *de Viribus Animalium* and *de Mirabilibus Mundi*, ascribed to Albertus Magnus, in which the reader, who has time and credulity, may discover very wonderful secrets.

*Finger of birth-strangled babe,
Ditch deliver'd by a drab;—*

It has been already mentioned in the law against witches, that they are supposed to take up dead bodies to use in enchantments, which was confessed by the woman whom king James examined, and who had of a dead body that was divided in one of their assemblies, two fingers for her share. It is observable that Shakespeare, on this great occasion, which involves the fate of a king, multiplies all the circumstances of horror. The babe, whose finger is used, must be strangled in its birth; the grease must not only be human, but must have dropped from a gibbet, the gibbet of a murderer; and even the sow, whose blood is used, must have offended nature by devouring her own farrow. These are touches of judgment and genius.

*And now about the cauldron sing—
Black spirits and white,
Blue spirits and grey,
Mingle, mingle, mingle,
You that mingle say.
And in a former part,
—weyward sisters, hand in hand,—
Thus do go about, about.
Thrice to thine, and thrice to mine.
And thrice again to make up nine!*

These two passages I have brought together, because they both seem subject to the objection of too much levity for the solemnity of enchantment, and may both be shewn, by one quotation from Camden's account of Ireland, to be founded upon a practice really observed by the uncivilised natives of that country: "When any one gets a fall, says the informer of Camden, he starts up, and, turning three times to the right, digs a hole in the earth; for they imagine that there is a spirit in the ground, and if he falls sick in two or three days, they send one of their women that is skilled in that way to the place, where she says, I call thee from the east, west, north, and south, from the groves, the woods, the rivers, and the fens, from the fairies *red, black, white.*"

There was likewise a book written before the time of Shakespeare, describing, amongst other properties, the *colours* of spirits.

Many other circumstances might be particularised, in which Shakespeare has shown his judgment and his knowledge.

IV.i.53 (489,6) yesty waves] That is, *foaming* or *frothy waves*.

IV.i.88 (491,1) the round/ And top of sovereignty?] This *round* is that part of the crown that encircles the head. The *top* is the ornament that rises above it.

IV.i.95 (492,3) Who can impress the forest] i.e. who can command the forest to serve him like a soldier impress'd. (1773)

IV.i.97 (492,4) Rebellious head, rise never] Mr. Theobald, who first proposed this change ["head" for "dead"] rightly observes, that *head* means *host*, or power.

—*Douglas and the rebels met,*
A mighty and a fearful head they are.
 And again,
His divisions—are in three heads.

IV.i.113 (493,6) Thy crown does sear mine eye-balls] The expression of Macbeth, that the *crown* sears *his* eye-balls, is taken from the method formerly practised of destroying the sight of captives or competitors, by holding a burning bason before the eye, which dried up its humidity. Whence the Italian, *abacinare*, to *blind*.

IV.i.113 (493,7) And thy air,/ Thou other gold-bound brow, is like the first:—/ A third is like the former] In former editions,

—*and thy hair,*
Thou other gold-bound brow, is like the first:—
A third is like the former:—

As Macbeth expected to see a train of kings, and was only enquiring from what race they would proceed, he could not be surprised that the *hair* of the second was *bound with gold* like that of the first; he was offended only that the second resembled the first, as the first resembled Banquo, and therefore said,

—*and thy air,*
Thou other gold-bound brow, is like the first.

This Dr. Warburton has followed.

IV.i.144 (495,2) Time, thou anticipat'st my dread exploits] To *anticipate* is here to *prevent*, by taking away the opportunity.

IV.ii.9 (496,3) He wants the natural touch] Natural sensibility. He is not touched with natural affection.

IV.ii.71 (498,7) To do worse to you, were fell cruelty] To do *worse* is, to let her and her children be destroyed without warning.

IV.iii.2 (500,9) Let us rather/ Hold fast the mortal sword; and, like good men,/ Bestride our down-faln birthdom] In former editions,

Let us rather

Hold fast the mortal sword; and, like good men,

Bestride our downfall birthdom. —]

He who can discover what is meant by him that earnestly exhorts him to *bestride* his *downfal birth-doom*, is at liberty to adhere to the present text; but it is probable that Shakespeare wrote,

—like good men,

Bestride our downfaln birthdom —

The allusion is to a man from whom something valuable is about to be taken by violence, and who, that he may defend it without incombrance, lays it on the ground, and stands over it with his weapon in his hand. Our birthdom, or birthright, says he, lies on the ground, let us, like men who are to fight for what is dearest to them, not abandon it, but stand over it and defend it. This is a strong picture of obstinate resolution. So Falstaff says to Hal.

When I am down, if thou wilt bestride me, so.

Birthdom for *birthright* is formed by the same analogy with *masterdom* in this play, signifying the *privileges* or *rights* of a *master*.

Perhaps it might be *birth-dame* for *mother*; let us stand over our *mother* that lies bleeding on the ground.

IV.iii.19 (501,4) A good and virtuous nature may recoil/ In an imperial charge] A good mind may *recede* from goodness in the execution of a *royal commission*.

IV.iii.23 (501,5) Though all things foul would wear the brows of grace,/ Yet grace must look still so] This is not very clear. The meaning perhaps is this: — *My suspicions cannot injure you, if you be virtuous, by supposing that a traitor may put on your virtuous appearance. I do not say that your virtuous appearance proves you a traitor; for virtue must wear its proper form, though that form be often counterfeited by villany.*

IV.iii.26 (502,6) Why in that rawness left you wife and children] Without previous provision, without due preparation, without *maturity* of counsel.

IV.iii.33 (502,7) Wear thou thy wrongs] That is, *Poor country, wear thou thy wrongs*.

IV.iii.69 (503,1) Sudden, malicious] [*Sudden*, for capricious. WARBUR.] Rather violent, passionate, hasty.

IV.iii.85 (504,2) Than summer seeming lust] When I was younger and bolder I corrected it thus,

Than fume, or seething lust.

that is, Than angry passion, or boiling lust. (1773)

IV.iii.135 (506,4) All ready at a point] [W: at appoint] There is no need of change.

IV.iii.136 (506,5) and the chance of goodness/Be like our warranted quarrel!] The *chance of goodness*, as it is commonly read, conveys no sense. If there be not some more important error in the passage, it should at least be pointed thus:

—*and the chance, of goodness,*

Be like our warranted quarrel!—

That is, may the event be, of the goodness of heaven, [*pro justitia divina*] answerable to the cause.

The author of the *Revisal* conceives the sense of the passage to be rather this: *And may the success of that goodness, which is about to exert itself in my behalf, be such as may be equal to the justice of my quarrel.*

But I am inclined to believe that Shakespeare wrote,

—*and the chance, O goodness,*

Be like our warranted quarrel!—

This some of his transcribers wrote with a small *o*, which another imagined to mean *of*. If we adopt this reading, the sense will be, *and O thou sovereign Goodness, to whom we now appeal, may our fortune answer to our cause.* (see 1765, VI, 462, 7)

IV.iii.170 (508,9) A modern ecstasy] I believe *modern* is only *foolish* or *trifling*.

IV.iii.196 (509,2), fee-grief] A peculiar sorrow; a grief that hath a single owner. The expression is, at least to our ears, very harsh.

IV.iii.216 (511,4) He has no children] It has been observed by an anonymous critic, that this is not said of Macbeth, who had children, but of Malcolm, who having none, supposes a father.

V.i.86 (515,8) My mind she has mated] [Conquer'd or subdued. POPE.] Rather astonished, confounded.

V.ii.24 (516,1) When all that is within him does condemn/Itself, for being there?] That is, when all the faculties of the mind are employed in self-condemnation.

V.iii.1 (516,2) Bring me no more reports] *Tell me not any more of desertions—Let all my subjects leave me—I am safe till, &c.*

V.iii.8 (517,3) English Epicures] The reproach of Epicurism, on which Mr. Theobald has bestowed a note, is nothing more than a natural invective uttered by an inhabitant of a barren country, against, those who have more opportunities of luxury.

V.iii.22 (518,6) my way of life/Is fall'n into the sear] As there is no relation between the *way of life*, and *fallen into the sear*, I am inclined to think that the W is only an M inverted, and that it was originally written,

—my May of life.

I am now passed from the spring to the autumn of my days, but I am without those comforts that should succeed the spriteliness of bloom, and support me in this melancholy season.

The authour has *May* in the same sense elsewhere.

V.iv.8 (521,1) the confident tyrant/ Keeps still in Dunsinane, and will endure/Our setting down before't] He was *confident* of success; so *confident* that he would not fly, but endure their *setting down* before his castle.

V.iv.11 (521,2) For where there is advantage to be given,/ Both more and less have given him the revolt] The impropriety of the expression, *advantage to be given*, and the disagreeable repetition of the word *given* in the next line, incline me to read,

—where there is a 'vantage to be gone,

Both more and less have given him the revolt.

Advantage or 'vantage, in the time of Shakespeare, signified *opportunity*. He shut up himself and his soldiers, (says Malcolm) in the castle, because when there is an opportunity to be gone they all desert him.

More and less is the same with *greater and less*. So in the interpolated *Mandeville*, a book of that age, there is a chapter of *India the More and the Less*.

V.iv.20 (522,4) arbitrate] — *arbitrate is determine*.

V.v.11 (523,3) fell of hair] My hairy part, my *capillitium*. *Fell* is *skin*.

V.v.17 (523,7) She should have dy'd hereafter;/ There would have been a time for such a word] This passage has very justly been suspected of being corrupt. It is not apparent for what *word* there would have been a *time*, and that there would or would not be a *time* for any *word* seems not a consideration of importance sufficient to transport Macbeth into the following exclamation. I read therefore,

She should have dy'd hereafter.

There would have been a time for — such a world! —

Tomorrow, &c.

It is a broken speech in which only part of the thought is expressed, and may be paraphrased thus: *The queen is dead. Macbeth. Her death should have been deferred to some more peaceful hour; had she liv'd longer, there would at length have been a time for the honours due to her as a queen, and that respect which I owe her for her fidelity and love. Such is the world — such is the condition of human life, that we always think to-morrow will be happier than to-day, but to-morrow and to-morrow steals over us unenjoyed and unregarded, and we still linger in the same expectation to the moment appointed for our end. All these days, which have thus passed away, have sent multitudes of fools to the grave, who were engrossed by the same dream of future felicity, and, when life was departing from them, were, like me, reckoning on to-morrow.*

Such was once my conjecture, but I am now less confident. Macbeth might mean, that there would have been a more convenient *time* for such a *word*, for such *intelligence*, and so fall into the following reflection. We say we send *word* when we give intelligence.

V.v.21 (524,8) To the last syllable of recorded time] *Recorded time* seems to signify the time fixed in the decrees of Heaven for the period of life. The *record* of *futurity* is indeed no accurate expression, but as we only know transactions past or present, the language of men affords no term for the volumes of prescience, in which future events may be supposed to be written.

V.v.23 (524,9) The way to dusty death] *Dusty* is a very natural epithet. The second folio has,

The way to study death.—

which Mr. Upton prefers, but it is only an error by an accidental transposition of the types.

V.v.42 (525,2) I pull in resolution, and begin/ To doubt the equivocation of the fiend,/ That lies like truth] Though this is the reading of all the editions, yet, as it is a phrase without either example, elegance or propriety, it is surely better to read,

I pall in resolution,—

I languish in my constancy, my confidence begins to forsake as.

It is scarcely necessary to observe how easily *pall* might be changed into *pull* by a negligent writer, or mistaken for it by an unskilful printer. With this emendation Dr. Warburton and Mr. Heath concur. (see 1765, VI,478,8)

V.viii.9 (529,3) the intrenchant air] That is, air which cannot be cut.

V.viii.20 (529,5) That palter with us in a double sense] That *shuffle* with ambiguous expressions.

V.viii.48 (531,7) Had I as many sons as I have hairs, I would not wish them to a fairer death]

This incident is thus related from Henry of Huntingdon by Camden in his *Remains*, from which our authour probably copied it.

When Seyward, the martial earl of Northumberland, understood that his son, whom he had sent in service against the Scotchmen, was slain, he demanded whether his wounds were in the fore part or hinder part of his body. When it was answered, in the fore part, he replied, "I am right glad; neither wish I any other death to me or mine."

General Observation. This play is deservedly celebrated for the propriety of its fictions, and solemnity, grandeur, and variety of its action; but it has no nice discriminations of character, the events are too great to admit the influence of particular dispositions, and the course of the action necessarily determines the conduct of the agents.

The danger of ambition is well described; and I know not whether it may not be said in defence of some parts which now seem improbable, that, in Shakespeare's time, it was necessary to warn credulity against vain and illusive predictions.

The passions are directed to their true end. Lady Macbeth is merely detested; and though the courage of Macbeth preserves some esteem, yet every reader rejoices at his fall.

CORIOLANUS

1.i.19 (292,1) but they think, we are too dear] They think that the charge of maintaining us is more than we are worth.

1.i.23 (292,3) ere we become rakes] It is plain that, in our authour's time, we had the proverb, *as lean as a rake*. Of this proverb the original is obscure. *Rake* now signifies a *dissolute man*, a man worn out with disease and debauchery. But the signification is, I think, much more modern than the proverb. *Raekel*, in Islandick, is said to mean a *cur-dog*, and this was probably the first use among us of the word *rake*; *as lean as a rake* is, therefore, as lean as it dog too worthless to be fed.

1.i.94 (294,4) I will venture/ To scale't a little more] [Warburton had taken Theobald to task for emending to "stale't", offering two quotations to prove that "scale" meant "apply."] Neither of Dr. Warburton's examples afford a sense congruous to the present occasion. In the passage quoted, to *scale* may be to *weigh* and *compare*, but where do we find that *scale* is to *apply*? If we *scale* the two criticks, I think Theobald has the advantage.

1.i.97 (295,5) fob off our disgraces with a tale] *Disgraces* are *hardships*, *injuries*.

1.i.104 (295,6) where the other instruments] *Where* for *whereas*.

1.i.112 (296,7) Which ne'er came from the lungs] with a smile not indicating pleasure, but contempt.

1.i.120 (296,9) The counsellor heart] The heart was anciently esteemed the seat of prudence. *Homo cordatum* is a *prudent man*.

1.i.163 (297,1) Thou rascal, that art worst in blood, to ruin,/ Lead'st first, to win some 'vantage] I think, we may better read, by an easy change, *Thou rascal that art worst, in blood, to ruin* [to run] *Lead'st first, to win, &c.*

Thou that art the meanest by birth, art the foremost to lead thy fellows *to ruin*, in hope of some advantage. The meaning, however, is perhaps only this, Thou that art a hound, or running dog of the lowest breed, lead'st the pack, when any thing is to be gotten. (see 1765, VI, 493, 1)

I.i.172 (298,4) What would you have, ye curs,/ That like not peace, nor war? The one affrights you,/ The other makes you proud] [W: likes] That *to like* is *to please*, every one knows, but in that sense it is as hard to say why peace should not *like* the people, as, in the other sense, why the people should not *like* peace. The truth is, that Coriolanus does not use the two sentences consequentially, but reproaches them with unsteadiness, then with their other occasional vices.

I.i.202 (300,6) I'd make a quarry/With thousands] Why a quarry? I suppose, not because he would pile them square, but because he would give them for carrion to the birds of prey.

I.i.215 (300,7) To break the heart of generosity] To give the final blow to the *nobles*. *Generosity* is *high birth*.

I.i.231 (301,8) 'tis true, that yon have lately told us./The Volscians are in arms] Coriolanus had been but just told himself that *the Volscians were in arms*. The meaning is, *The intelligence which you gave us some little time ago of the designs of the Volscians is now verified; they are in arms*.

I.i.255 (302,8) Your valour puts well forth] That is, You have in this mutiny shewn fair blossoms of valour.

I.i.260 (303,9) to gird. To *sneer*, to *gibe*. So Falstaff uses the noun, when he says, *every man has a gird at me*.

I.i.281 (304,3) in what fashion,/More than his singularity he goes/ Upon this present action] We will learn what he is to do, besides *going himself*; what are his powers, and what is his appointment.

I.ii.28 (305,4) for the remove/Bring up your army] [W:'fore they] I do not see the nonsense or impropriety of the old reading. Says the senator to Aufidius, *Go to your troops, we will garrison Corioli*. If the Romans besiege us, bring up your army *to remove them*. If any change should be made, I would read,
—for their *remove*.

I.iii.16 (307,5) brows bound with oak] The crown given by the Romans to him that saved the life of a citizen, which was accounted more honourable than any other.

I.iv.14 (311,9) nor a man that fears you less than he,/ That's lesser than a little] The sense requires it to be read,
nor a man that fears you more than he,
 Or more probably,
nor a man but fears you less than he,
That's lesser than a little.

I.v.5 (314,4) prize their hours] In the first edition it is, *prize their hours*. I know not who corrected it [to *prize their honours*]. A modern editor, who had made such an improvement, would have spent half a page in ostentation of his sagacity.

I.vi.36 (317,6) Ransoming him, or pitying] i.e. *remitting his ransom*.

I.vi.61 (318,8) swords advanc'd] That is, swords lifted high.

I.vi.83 (319,9) Please you to march,/ And four shall quickly draw out my command,/ Which men are best inclin'd] I cannot but suspect this passage of corruption. Why should they *march*, that *four* might select those that were *best inclin'd*? How would their inclinations be known? Who were the *four* that should select them? Perhaps, we may read,
—Please you to march,
And fear shall quickly draw out of my command,
Which men are least inclin'd.

It is easy to conceive that, by a little negligence, *fear* might be changed to *four*, and *least* to *best*. Let us march, and that fear which incites desertion will free my army from cowards. (see 1765, VI, 512, 1)

I.viii.11 (320,1) Wert thou the Hector,/ That was the whip of your bragg'd progeny] The Romans boasted themselves descended from the Trojans, how then was Hector the *whip of their progeny*? It must mean the whip with which the Trojans scourged the Greeks, which cannot be but by a very unusual construction, or the authour must have forgotten the original of the Romans; unless *whip* has some meaning which includes *advantage* or *superiority*, as we say, *he has the whip-hand*, for *he has the advantage*.

I.viii.14 (321,2) you have sham'd me/ In your condemned seconds] For *condemned*, we may read *contemned*. You have, to my shame, sent me help *which I despise*.

I.ix.12 (321,4) Here is the steed, we the caparisons!] This is an odd encomium. The meaning is, *this man performed the action, and we only filled up the show.*

I.ii.14 (322,5) a charter to extol] A privilege to praise her own son.

I.ix.29 (322,6) Should they not] That is, *not be remembered.*

I.ix.72 (325,9) To the fairness of any power] [*Fairness, for utmost. WARE.*] I know not how *fairness* can mean *utmost*. When two engage on *equal* terms, we say it is *fair*; *fairness* may therefore be *equality*; in *proportion equal to my power.*

I.ix.76 (325,1) The best] The *chief* men of Corioli.

I.x.5 (326,3) Being a Volsce, be that I am] It may be just observed, that Shakespeare calls the *Volsci*, *Volsces*, which the modern editors have changed to the modern termination [Volscian]. I mention it here, because here the change has spoiled the measure. *Being a Volsce, be that I am. Condition.* [Steevens restored *Volsce* in the text.]

I.x.17 (326,2) My valour's poison'd,/ With only suffering stain by him, for him/ Shall flie out of itself] To mischief him, my valour should *deviate from* its own native generosity.

I.x.25 (327,4) At home, upon my brother's guard] In my own house, with my brother posted to protect him.

II.i.8 (328,5) Pray you, who does the wolf love?] When the tribune, in reply to Menenius's remark, on the people's hate of Coriolanus, had observed that even *beasts know their friends*, Menenius asks, *whom does the wolf love?* implying that there are beasts which love nobody, and that among those beasts are the people.

II.i.43 (329,6) towards the napes of your necks] With allusion to the fable, which says, that every man has a bag hanging before him, in which he puts his neighbour's faults, and another behind him, in which he stows his own.

II.i.56 (330,7) one that converses more with the buttock of the night, than with the forehead of the morning] Rather a late lier down than an early riser.

II.i.84 (330,1) set up the bloody flag against all patience] That is, declare war against patience. There is not wit enough in this satire to recompense its grossness.

II.i.105 (331,2) herdsmen of beastly Plebeians] As kings are called [Greek: poimenes laon].

II.i.115 (331,3) Take my cap, Jupiter, and I thank thee] [W: cup] Shakespeare so often mentions throwing up caps in this play, that Menenius may be well enough supposed to throw up his cap in thanks to Jupiter.

II.i.146 (333,4) possest of this?] *Possest*, in our authour's language, is fully informed.

II.i.178 (334,6) Which being advanc'd, declines] Volumnia, in her boasting strain, says, that her son to kill his enemy, has nothing to do but to lift his hand up and let it fall.

II.i.232 (337,3) Commit the war of white and damask, in/ Their nicely gawded cheeks] [W: wars] Has the commentator never heard of roses *contending* with lilies for the empire of a lady's cheek? The *opposition* of colours, though not the *commixture*, may be called a war.

II.i.235 (338,1) As if that whatsoever God] That is, *as if that God who leads him, whatsoever* God he be.

II.i.241 (338,2) From where he should begin, and end] Perhaps it should be read,

From where he should begin t'an end.—

II.i.247 (338,3) As he is proud to do't] [I should rather think the author wrote *prone*: because the common reading is scarce sense or English. Warburton.] *Proud to do*, is the same as, *proud of doing*, very plain sense, and very common English.

II.i.285 (340,4) carry with us ears and eyes] That is, let us observe what passes, but keep our hearts fixed on our design of crushing Coriolanus.

II.ii.19 (340,5) he wav'd indifferently] That is, *he would wave indifferently*.

II.ii.29 (341,6) supple and courteous to the people; bonnetted] The sense, I think, requires that we should read, *unbonnetted*. Who have risen only by *pulling off their hats* to the people. *Bonnetted* may relate to *people*, but not without harshness.

II.ii.57 (342,7) Your loving motion toward the common body] Your kind interposition with the common people.

II.ii.64 (342,9) That's off, that's off] That is, that is nothing to the purpose.

II.ii.82 (343,1) how can he flatter] The reasoning of Menenius is this: How can he be expected to practice flattery to others, who abhors it so much, that he cannot bear it even when offered to himself.

II.ii.92 (343,2) When Tarquin made a head for Rome] When Tarquin, who had been expelled, *raised a power* to recover Rome.

II.ii.113 (344,6) every motion/ Was tim'd with dying cries] The cries of the slaughter'd regularly followed his motions, as musick and a dancer accompany each other.

II.ii.115 (345,7) The mortal gate] The gate that was made the scene of death.

II.ii.127 (345,8) He cannot but with measure fit the honours] That is, no honour will be too great for him; he will show a mind equal to any elevation.

II.ii.131 (345,1)

rewards

His deeds with doing them; and is content

To spend his time, to end it]

I know not whether my conceit will be approved, but I cannot forbear to think that our author wrote thus.

—he *rewards*

His deeds with doing them, and is content

To spend his time, to spend it.

To do great acts, for the sake of doing them; to spend his life, for the sake of spending it.

II.iii.4 (348,2) We have power in ourselves to do it, but it is a power that we have no power to do] [Warburton saw this as "a ridicule on the Augustine manner of defining *free-will*."] A ridicule may be in-

tended, but the sense is clear enough. *Power* first signifies *natural power* or *force*, and then *moral power* or *right*. Davies has used the same word with great variety of meaning.

*Use all thy powers that heavenly power to praise,
That gave thee power to do.*—

II.iii.18 (348,3) many-headed multitude] Hanmer reads, *many-headed monster*, but without necessity. To be *many-headed* includes *monstrousness*.

II.iii.115 (352,7) I will not seal your knowledge] I will not strengthen or compleat your knowledge. The seal is that which gives authenticity to a writing.

II.iii.122 (352,8)

Why in this woolvish tongue should I stand here
To beg of Bob and Dick, that do appear,
Their needless vouches?]

Why stand I here in this ragged apparel to beg of Bob and Dick, and such others as *make their appearance* here, their *unnecessary votes*. I rather think we should read [instead of *voucher*], *Their needless vouches*. But *voucher* may serve, as it may perhaps signify either the act or the agent.

II.iii.122 (352) this woolvish gown] Signifies this *rough hirsute* gown.

II.iii.182 (355,1) ignorant to see't?] [W: "ignorant" means "impotent"] That *ignorant* at any time has, otherwise than consequentially, the same meaning with *impotent*, I do not know. It has no such meaning in this place. *Were you ignorant to see it*, is, did you want knowledge to discern it.

II.iii.208 (356,2) free contempt] That is, with contempt open and unrestrained.

II.iii.227 (357,4) Enforce his pride] Object his pride, and enforce the objection.

II.iii.258 (358,7) Scaling his present bearing with his past] That is, *weighing* his past and present behaviour.

II.iii.267 (359,8) observe and answer/ The vantage of his anger] Mark, catch, and improve the opportunity, which his hasty anger will afford us.

III.i.23 (360,9) prank them in authority] *Plume, deck, dignify* themselves.

III.i.58 (362,3) This paltring/ Becomes not Rome] That is, this trick of dissimulation, this shuffling.

Let these be no more believ'd

That palter with us in a double sense. Macbeth.

III.i.60 (362,4) laid falsly] *Falsly* for *treacherously*.

III.i.66 (362,5) Let them regard me, as I do not flatter, and/ Therein behold themselves] Let them look in the mirror which I hold up to them, a mirror which does not flatter, and see themselves.

III.i.89 (363,6) minnows] a *minnow* is one of the smallest river fish, called in some counties a *pink*.

III.i.90 (364,6) 'Twas from the canon] Was contrary to the established role; it was a form of speech to which he has no right.

III.i.98 (364,9) Then vail your ignorance] [W: "ignorance" means "impotence."] Hanmer's transposition deserves notice

—If they have power,

Let them have cushions by you; if none, awake

Your dang'rous lenity; if you are learned,

Be not as common fools; if you are not,

Then vail your ignorance. You are Plebeians, &c.

I neither think the transposition of one editor right, nor the interpretation of the other. The sense is plain enough without supposing *ignorance* to have any remote or consequential sense. *If this man has power, let the ignorance that gave it him vail or bow down before him.*

III.i.101 (365,1) You are Plebeians,

If they be Senators: and they are no less,

When, both your voices blended, the greatest taste

Most palates theirs]

These lines may, I think, be made more intelligible by a very slight correction.

—they no less [than senators]

When, both your voices blended, the great'st taste

Must palate theirs.

When the *taste* of the *great*, the patricians, must *palate*, must *please* [or must *try*] that of the plebeians.

III.i.124 (366,3) They would not thread the gates] That is, *pass* them. We yet say, to *thread* an alley.

III.i.129 (366,4) could never be the native] [*Native* for natural birth. WARBURTON.] *Native* is here not natural birth, but *natural parent*, or *cause of birth*. But I would read *motive*, which, without any distortion of its meaning, suits the speaker's purpose.

III.i.151 (367,7) That love the fundamental part of state/ More than you doubt the change of't] To *doubt* is to *fear*. The meaning is, You whose zeal predominates over your terrors; you who do not so much fear the danger of violent measures, as wish the good to which they are necessary, the preservation of the original constitution of our government.

III.i.158 (368,2) Mangles true judgment] *Judgment* is *judgment* in its common sense, or the faculty by which right is distinguished from wrong.

III.i.159 (368,3) that integrity which should become it] *Integrity* is in this place *soundness*, uniformity, consistency, in the same sense as Dr. Warburton often uses it, when he mentions the *integrity* of a metaphor. To *become*, is to *suit*, to *befit*.

III.i.221 (370,5) are very poisonous] I read, *are very* poisons.

III.i.242 (371,7) One time will owe another] I know not whether to *owe* in this place means to *possess by right*, or to *be indebted*. Either sense may be admitted. *One time*, in which the people are seditious, will *give us power* in some other time; or, *this time* of the people's predominance will *run them in debt*; that is, will lay them open to the law, and expose them hereafter to more servile subjection.

III.i.248 (372,8) Before the tag return] The lowest and most despicable of the populace are still denominated by those a little above them, *Tag, rag, and bobtail*. (1773)

III.ii.7 (376,4) I muse] That is, *I wonder*. *I am at a loss*.

III.ii.12 (376,5) my ordinance] My *rank*.

III.ii.51 (378,8) Why force you] Why *urge* you.

III.ii.56 (378,9) bastards, and syllables/ Of no allowance, to your bosom's truth] I read,

Of *no* alliance, —

therefore *bastards*. Yet *allowance* may well enough stand, as meaning *legal right, established rank, or settled authority*. (see 1765, VI, 566, 7)

III.ii.64 (379,1) I am in this/Your wife, your son] I rather think the meaning is, *I am in their condition, I am at stake, together with your wife, your son*.

III.ii.66 (379,2) our general lowts] Our *common clowns*.

III.ii.69 (379,3) that want] The *want* of their loves.

III.ii.71 (379,4) Not what] In this place *not* seems to signify *not only*.

III.ii.77 (379,5) Waving thy head,/With often, thus, correcting thy stout heart] [W: thy hand,/Which soften thus] The correction is ingenious, yet I think it not right. *Head* or *hand* is indifferent. The *hand* is *waved* to gain attention; the *head* is shaken in token of sorrow. The word *wave* suits better to the hand, but in considering the authour's language, too much stress must not be laid on propriety against the copies. I would read thus,

—*waving thy head,*

With *often, thus, correcting thy stout heart*.

That is, *shaking thy head, and striking thy breast*. The alteration is slight, and the gesture recommended not improper.

III.ii.99 (381,6) my unbarb'd sconce?] The suppliants of the people used to present themselves to them in sordid and neglected dresses.

III.ii.113 (381,8) Which quired with my drum] Which played in concert with my drum.

III.ii.116 (382,1) Tent in my cheeks] To *tent* is to *take up residence*.

III.ii.121 (382,2) honour mine own truth] [Greek: *Panton de malis aischuneui sauton*]. Pythagoras.

III.ii.125 (382,3) let/ Thy mother rather feel thy pride, than fear/ Thy dangerous stoutness] This is obscure. Perhaps, she means, Go, *do thy worst; let me rather feel the utmost extremity that thy pride can bring upon us, than live thus in fear of thy dangerous obstinacy*.

III.iii.17 (384,3)

Insisting on the old prerogative
 And power in' the truth o' the cause]
 This is not very easily understood. We might read,
 —o'er the truth o' the cause.

III.iii.26 (384,4) and to have his word/Of contradiction] *To have his word of contradiction* is no more than, *he is used to contradict*; and *to have his word*, that is, *not to be opposed*. We still say of an obstinate disputant, *he will have the last word*.

III.iii.29 (384,5) which looks/With us to break his neck] *To look* is to *wait* or *expect*. The sense I believe is, *What he has in his heart* is waiting there *to help us to break his neck*.

III.iii.57 (386,8) Rather than envy you] *Envy* is here taken at large for *malignity* or ill intention.

III.iii.64 (386,9) season'd office] *All office established and settled* by time, and made familiar to the people by long use.

III.iii.96 (387,1) has now at last] Read rather,
 —has *now at last* [instead of *as now at last*].

III.iii.97 (387,2) not in the presence] *Not* stands again for *not only*.

III.iii.114 (388,3) My dear wife's estimate] I love my country beyond the rate at which I *value my dear wife*.

III.iii.127 (389,4)

Have the power still
 To banish your defenders'; till, at length,
 Your ignorance, (which finds not, till it feels)]
Still retain the power of banishing your defenders, till your undiscerning folly, which can foresee no consequences, leave none in the city but yourselves, who are always labouring your own destruction.

It is remarkable, that, among the political maxims of the speculative Harrington, there is one which he might have borrowed from this speech. *The people*, says he, *cannot see, but they can feel*. It is not much to the honour of the people, that they have the same character of stupidity from their enemy and their friend. Such was the power of our authour's mind, that he looked through life in all its relations private and civil.

IV.i.7 (390,1) Fortune's blows,/ When most struck home, being gentle wounded, craves/ A noble cunning] This is the ancient and authentick reading. The modern editors have, for *gentle wounded*, silently substituted *gently warded*, and Dr. Warburton has explained *gently* by *nobly*. It is good to be sure of our authour's words before we go about to explain their meaning.

The sense is, When Fortune strikes her hardest blows, to be wounded, and yet continue calm, requires a generous policy. He calls this calmness *cunning*, because it is the effect of reflection and philosophy. Perhaps the first emotions of nature are nearly uniform, and one man differs from another in the power of endurance, as he is better regulated by precept and instruction.

They bore as heroes, but they felt as men.

(see 1765, VI, 577, 9)

IV.i.33 (391,3) cautelous baits and practice] By artful and false tricks, and treason.

IV.ii.15 (393,6)

Sic. Are you mankind?

Vol. Ay, fool; Is that a shame? Note but this fool.

Was not a man my father?

The word *mankind* is used maliciously by the first speaker, and taken perversely by the second. A *mankind* woman is a woman with the roughness of a man, and, in an aggravated sense, a woman ferocious, violent, and eager to shed blood. In this sense Sicinius asks Volumnia, if she be *mankind*. She takes *mankind* for a *human creature*, and accordingly cries out,

—*Note but this, fool.*

Was not a man my father?

IV.ii.18 (394,7) Hadst thou foxship] Hadst thou, fool as thou art, mean cunning enough to banish Coriolanus?

IV.iii.9 (395,7) but your favour is well appear'd by your tongue] [W: well appeal'd] I should read,

—*is well affear'd,*

That is, *strengthened, attested*, a word used by our authour.

My title is affear'd. Macbeth.

To *repeal* may be to *bring to remembrance*, but *appeal* has another meaning.

IV.iii.48 (397,8) already in the entertainment] That is, tho' not actually encamped, yet already in *pay*. To *entertain* an army is to take them into pay.

IV.iv.22 (398,1)

So, with me:—

My birth-place hate I, and my love's upon

This enemy's town:—I'll enter: if he slay me]

He who reads this [My country have I and my lovers left;/ This enemy's town I'll enter] would think that he was reading the lines of Shakespeare: except that Coriolanus, being already in the town, says, *he will enter it*. Yet the old edition exhibits it thus

— *So with me*.

My birth-place have I; and my loves upon

This enemic towne; I'll enter if he slay me, &c.

The intermediate line seems to be lost, in which, conformably to his former observation, he says, that *he has lost his birth-place, and his loves upon* a petty dispute, and is trying his chance in *this enemy town*, he then cries, turning to the house of Anfidius, *I'll enter if he slay me*.

I have preferred the common reading, because it is, though faulty, yet intelligible, and the original passage, for want of copies, cannot be restored.

IV.v.76 (403,3) a good memory] The Oxford editor, not knowing that *memory* was used at that time for *memorial*, alters it to *memorial*.

IV.v.90 (403,4) A heart of wreak in thee] A heart of resentment.

IV.v.91 (403,5) maims/ Of shame] That is, disgraceful diminutions of territory.

IV.v.207 (406,5) sanctifies himself with's hands] Alluding, improperly, to the act of *crossing* upon any strange event.

IV.v.212 (407,6) He will go, he says, and sowle the porter of Rome gates by the ears] That is, I suppose, drag him down by the ears into the dirt. *Souiller*, Fr.

IV.v.214 (407,7) his passage poll'd] That is, *bared, cleared*.

IV.v.238 (408,8) full of vent] Full of *rumour*, full of materials for *discourse*.

IV.vi.2 (408,1) His remedies are tame i' the present peace] The old reading is,

His remedies are tame, the present peace.

I do not understand either line, but fancy it should be read thus,
—*neither need we fear him;*

His remedies are ta'en, the present peace,

And quietness o' the people, —

The meaning, somewhat harshly expressed, according to our authour's custom, is this: *We need not fear him*, the proper *remedies* against him *are taken*, by restoring *peace and quietness*.

IV.vi.32 (410,2) affecting one sole throne,/ Without assistance] That is, without *assessors*; without any other suffrage.

IV.vi.51 (411,3) reason with the fellow] That is, have some *talk* with him. In this sense Shakespeare often uses the word.

IV.vi.72 (412,4) can no more atone] To *atone*, in the active sense, is to *reconcile*, and is so used by our authour. To *atone* here, is, in the neutral sense, to *come to reconciliation*. To *atone* is to *unite*.

IV.vi.85 (412,5) burned in their cement] [W: "cement" for "cincture or inclosure"] *Cement* has here its common signification.

IV.vi.98 (413,5) The breath of garlick-eaters!] To smell of garlick was once such a brand of vulgarity, that garlick was a food forbidden to an ancient order of Spanish knights, mentioned by Guevara.

IV.vi.112 (414,7)

they charge him even

As those should do that had deserv'd his hate,

And therein shew'd like enemies]

Their *charge* or injunction would shew them insensible of his wrongs, and make them *shew like enemies*. I read *shew*, not *shewed*, *like enemies*.

IV.vi.124 (414,8) They'll roar him in again] As they *hooted* at his departure, they will *roar* at his return; as he went out with scoffs, he will come back with lamentations.

IV.vii.37 (417,1)

whether pride,

Which out of daily fortune ever taints

The happy man; whether]

Ausidius assigns three probable reasons of the miscarriage of Coriolanus; pride, which easily follows an uninterrupted train of success; unskilfulness to regulate the consequences of his own victories; a stubborn uniformity of nature, which could not make the proper transition from the *casque* or *helmet* to the *cushion* or *chair of civil authority*; but acted with the same despotism in peace as in war.

IV.vii.48 (418,2) he has a merit,/ To choak it in the utterance] He has a merit, for no other purpose than to destroy it by boasting it.

IV.vii.55 (418,4) Right's by right fouler] [W: fouled] I believe *rights*, like *strengths*, is a plural noun. I read,

Rights by rights founder, strengths by strengths do fail.

That is, by the exertion of one right another right is lamed.

Vi.20 (420,2) It was a bare petition] [*Bare*, for mean, beggarly. WARBURTON.] I believe rather, a petition unsupported, unaided by names that might give it influence.

Vi.63 (422,4) I tell you, he does sit in gold] He is enthroned in all the pomp and pride of imperial splendour.

[Greek: Chruzothonos Aerae] — Hom.

Vi.69 (422,5) Bound with an oath to yield to his conditions] This if apparently wrong. Sir T. Hanmer, and Dr. Warburton after him, read,

Bound with an oath not to yield to new conditions.

They might have read more smoothly,

— *to yield no new conditions.*

But the whole speech is in confusion, and I suspect something left out. I should read,

— *What he would do,*

He sent in writing after; what he would not,

Bound with an oath. To yield to his conditions.

Here is, I think, a chasm. The speaker's purpose seems to be this: *To yield to his conditions* is ruin, and better cannot be obtained, *so that all hope is vain.*

V.ii.10 (424,7) it is lots to blanks] *A lot* here is a *prize*.

V.ii.17 (424,8)

For I have ever verify'd my friends,

(Of whom he's chief) with all the size that verity

Would without lapsing suffer]

[W: narrified] [Hanmer: magnified] If the commentator had given any example of the word *narrify*, the correction would have been not only received, but applauded. Now, since the new word stands without authority, we must try what sense the old one will afford. To *verify* is to *establish by testimony*. One may say with propriety, he brought false witnesses to verify his title. Shakespeare considered the word with his usual laxity, as importing rather *testimony* than *truth*, and only meant to say, *I bore witness to my friends with all the size that verity would suffer*.

V.ii.45 (426,1) the virginal palms of your daughters] [W: *pasmes* or *pames*, French for "swooning fits." Warburton also quotes *Tarquin and Lucrece*, "To dry the old oak's sap, and cherish springs" and emends to "tarnish," from the French, meaning "to dry up," used of springs and rivers.] I have inserted this note, because it contains an apology for many others. It is not denied that many French words were mingled in the time of Elizabeth with our language, which have since been ejected, and that any which are known to have been then in use may be properly recalled when they will help the sense. But when a word is to be admitted, the first question should be, by whom was it ever received? in what book can it be shown? If it cannot be proved to have been in use, the reasons which can justify its reception must be stronger than any critick will often have to bring. Even in this certain emendation, the new word is very liable to contest. I should read,
—and perish *springs*.

The verb *perish* is commonly neutral, but in conversation is often used actively, and why not in the works of a writer negligent beyond all others of grammatical niceties?

V.ii.60 (427,2) Back, I say, go; lest I let forth your half pint of blood;—back, that's the utmost of your having:—Back] [Warburton emended the punctuation] I believe the meaning never was mistaken, and therefore do not change the reading.

V.ii.69 (428,3) guess by my entertainment with him] I read, *Guess by my entertainment with him, if thou standest not i' the state of hanging* [in place of *guess* but *my entertainment*].

V.ii.80 (428,4) Though I owe/My revenge properly] Though I have a *peculiar right* in revenge, in the power of forgiveness the Volacians are conjoined.

V.ii.104 (429,5) how we are shent] *Shent* is *brought to destruction*.

V.iii.3 (430,6) how plainly/I have born this business] That is, *how openly, how* remotely from artifice or concealment.

V.iii.39 (431,7) The sorrow, that delivers us thus chang'd,/ Makes you think so] Virgilia makes a voluntary misinterpretation of her husband's words. He says, *These eyes are not the same*, meaning, that he saw things with *other eyes*, or other *dispositions*. She lays hold on the word *eyes*, to turn his attention on their present appearance.

V.iii.46 (431,8) Now by the jealous queen of heaven] That is, *by Juno*, the guardian of marriage, and consequently the avenger of connubial perfidy.

V.iii.64 (432,1) The noble sister of Poplicola] Valeria, methinks, should not have been brought only to fill up the procession without speaking.

V.iii.68 (432,2) epitome of yours] I read,
—*epitome of you*.

An epitome of you which, enlarged by the commentaries of time, may equal you in magnitude.

V.iii.74 (433,4) every flaw] That is, every *gust*, every *storm*.

V.iii.100 (435,2) Constrains them weep, and shake] That is, *constrain* the eye to *weep*, and the heart to *shake*.

V.iii.149 (436,3) the fine strains] The niceties, the refinements.

V.iii.159 (436,5) he lets me prate,/Like one i' the stocks] Keep me in a state of ignominy talking to no purpose.

V.iii.176 (437,6) Does reason our petition] Does *argue for* us and our petition.

V.iii.201 (438,7) I'll work/Myself a former fortune] I will take advantage of this concession to restore myself to my former credit and power.

V.iii.206 (438,8) Come, enter with us,—Ladies, you deserve] [Warburton proposed to give the speech beginning "Ladies, you deserve" to Aufidius] The speech suits Aufidius justly enough, if it had been written for him; but it may, without impropriety, be spoken by Coriolanus: and since the copies give it to him, why should we dispossess him?

V.iv.22 (439,1) He sits in state as a thing made for Alexander] In a foregoing note he was said to *sit in gold*. The phrase, *as a thing made for Alexander*, means, *as one made to resemble Alexander*.

V.vi.39 (443,2) He wag'd me with his countenance] This is obscure. The meaning, I think, is, he *prescribed* to me with an air of authority, and gave me *his countenance* for *my wages*; thought me sufficiently rewarded with good looks.

V.vi.44 (443,3) For which my sinews shall be stretch'd upon him] This is the point on which I will attack him with my utmost abilities.

V.vi.66 (444,4) answering us/ With our own charge] That is, *rewarding us with our own expences*; making the cost of the war its recompence.

V.vi.125 (446,5) his fame folds in/ This orbe o' th' earth] His fame overspreads the world.

(447) General Observation. The tragedy of Coriolanus is one of the most amusing of our author's performances. The old man's merri-ment in Menenius; the lofty lady's dignity in Volumnia; the bridal modesty in Virgilia; the patrician and military haughtiness in Coriolanus; the plebeian malignity and tribunitian insolence in Brutus and Sicinius, make a very pleasing and interesting variety: and the various revolutions of the hero's fortune fill the mind with anxious curiosity. There is, perhaps, too much bustle in the first act, and too little in the last.

JULIUS CAESAR

I.i.20 (4,2) *Mar.* What meanest thou by that?] [Theobald gave this speech to Flavius] I have replaced *Marullus*, who might properly enough reply to a saucy sentence directed to his colleague, and to whom the speech was probably given, that he might not stand too long unemployed upon the stage.

I.ii.25 (7,5) [*Sennet. Exeunt Caesar and Train*] I have here inserted the word *Sennet*, from the original edition, that I may have an opportunity of retracting a hasty conjecture in one of the marginal directions in *Henry VIII*. *Sennet* appears to be a particular tune or mode of martial musick.

I.ii.35 (8,6) You bear too stubborn and too strange a hand] *Strange*, is alien, unfamiliar, such as might become a stranger.

I.ii.39 (8,7) Vexed I am,/Of late, with passions of some difference] With a fluctation of discordant opinions and desires.

I.ii.73 (9,9) To stale with ordinary oaths my love/To every new protester] To invite *every new protestor* to my affection by the *stale* or allurement of *customary* oaths.

I.ii.87 (10,1) And I will look on both indifferently] Dr. Warburton has a long note on this occasion, which is very trifling. When *Brutus* first names *honour* and *death*, he calmly declares them indifferent; but as the image kindles in his mind, he sets *honour* above *life*. Is not this natural?

I.ii.160 (12,6) eternal devil] I should think that our author wrote rather, *infernal devil*.

I.ii.171 (13,7) chew upon this] Consider this at leisure; *ruminate* on this.

I.ii.186 (13,8) Looks with such ferret, and such fiery eyes] A ferret has red eyes.

I.ii.268 (16,2) a man of any occupation] Had I been a mechanick, one of the Plebeians to whom he offered his threat.

I.ii.313 (17,3) Thy honourable metal may be wrought/From what it is dispos'd] The best *metal* or *temper* may be worked into qualities contrary to its original constitution.

I.ii.318 (17,4) If I were Brutus now, and he were Cassius,/He should not humour me] The meaning, I think, is this, *Caesar loves Brutus, but if Brutus and I were to change places, his love should not humour me*, should not take hold of my affection, so as to make me forget my principles.

I.iii.1 (18,5) brought you Caesar home?] Did you attend Caesar home?

I.iii.3 (18,6) sway of earth] The whole weight or *momentum* of this globe.

I.iii.21 (19,7) Who glar'd upon me] The first edition reads,
Who glaz'd upon me,—
 Perhaps, *Who gaz'd upon me.*

I.iii.64 (20,8) Why birds, and beasts, from quality and kind] That is, Why they *deviate* from quality and nature. This line might perhaps be more properly placed after the next line.

Why birds, and beasts, from quality and kind;
Why all these things change from their ordinance.

I.iii.65 (20,9) and children calculate] [Shakespeare, with his usual liberty, employs the *species* [calculate] for the *genus* foretel]. WARB.] Shakespeare found the liberty established. *To calculate a nativity*, is the technical term.

I.iii.114 (22,2) My answer must be made] I shall be called to account, and must *answer* as for seditious words.

I.iii.117 (22,3) Hold my hand] Is the same as, *Here's my hand.*

I.iii.118 (22,4) Be factious for redress] *Factious* seems here to mean *active*.

I.iii.129 (23,5) It favours, like the work] The old edition reads,
 It favours, *like the work—*
 I think we should read,
 In favour's, *like the work we have in hand,*
Most bloody, fiery, and most terrible.

Favour is look, countenance, appearance. (rev. 1778, VIII, 25, 7)

II.i.19 (25,6) Remorse from power] [*Remorse*, for mercy. WARB.] *Remorse* (says the Author of the *Ravisa*) signifies the conscious uneasiness arising from a sense of having done wrong; to extinguish which feeling, nothing hath so great a tendency as absolute uncontrouled power.

I think Warbuton right. (1773)

II.i.21 (25,7) common proof] Common experiment.

II.i.26 (25,8) base degrees] Low steps.

II.i.33 (26,9) as his kind] According to his nature.

II.i.63 (27,3)

Between the acting of a dreadful thing,
And the first motion, all the interim is
Like a phantasma, or a hideous dream:
The genius, and the mortal instruments
Are then in council; and the state of man,
Like to a little kingdom, suffers then
The nature of an insurrection]

The [Greek: *deinon*] of the Greek critics does not, I think, mean sentiments which *raise fear*, more than *wonder*, or any other of the tumultuous passions; [Greek: *to deinon*] is that which *strikes*, which *astonishes*, with the idea either of some great subject, or of the author's abilities.

Dr. Warburton's pompous criticism might well have been shortened. The *genius* is not the *genius* of a *kingdom*, nor are the *instruments*, *conspirators*. Shakespeare is describing what passes in a single bosom, the *insurrection* which a conspirator feels agitating the *little kingdom* of his own mind; when the *Genius*, or power that watches for his protection, and the *mortal instruments*, the passions, which excite him to a deed of honour and danger, are in council and debate; when the desire of action and the care of safety, keep the mind in continual fluctuation and disturbance.

II.i.76 (29,5) any mark of favour] Any distinction of countenance.

II.i.83 (30,6) For if thou path thy native semblance on] If thou *walk* in thy true form.

II.i.114 (31,7) No, not an oath. If not the face of men] Dr. Warburton would read *fate of men*; but his elaborate emendation is, I think, erroneous. *The face of men* is the *countenance*, the *regard*, the *esteem* of the publick; in other terms, *honour* and *reputation*; or *the face of men* may mean the dejected look of the people.

He reads, with the other modern editions,
 —If that *the face of men*,
 but the old reading is,
 —if not *the face*, &c.

II.i.129 (32,1) Swear priests, and cowards, and men cautelous] This is imitated by Utway,

When you would bind me, is there need of oaths? &c.
 Venice preserved.

II.i.187 (34,2) take thought] That is, *turn* melancholy.

II.i.196 (34,3) Quite from the main opinion he held once] *Main opinion*, is nothing more than *leading*, *fixed*, *predominant opinion*.

II.i.225 (36,6) Let not our looks put on our purposes] Let not our faces *put on*, that is, *wear* or *show* our designs.

II.ii.36 (42,3) death, a necessary end,/ Will come, when it will come] This is a sentence derived from the Stoical doctrine of predestination, and is therefore improper in the mouth of Caesar.

II.ii.41 (42,4) The Gods do this in shame of cowardice:/ Caesar should be a beast without a heart] The ancients did not place courage but wisdom in the heart.

II.ii.88 (44,7) and that great men shall press/ For tinctures, stains, relics, and cognisance] [Warburton conjectured some lines lost] I am not of opinion that any thing is lost, and have therefore marked no omission. This speech, which is intentionally pompous, is somewhat confused. There are two allusions; one to coats armorial, to which princes make additions, or give new *tinctures*, and new marks of *cognisance*; the other to martyrs, whose reliques are preserved with veneration. The Romans, says Brutus, all come to you as to a saint, for reliques, as to a prince, for honours.

II.ii.104 (45,8) And reason to my love is liable] And reason, or propriety of conduct and language, is subordinate to my love.

II.iii.16 (47,9) the fates with traitors do contrive] The fates join with traitors in contriving thy destruction.

III.i.38 (51,2) And turn pre-ordinance and first decree/ Into the lane of children] I do not veil understand what is meant by the *lane* of children. I should read, the *law* of children. It was, *change pre-ordinance and decree into the law of children*; into such slight determinations as every start of will would alter. *Lane* and *laws* in some manuscripts are not easily distinguished.

III.i.67 (52,4) apprehensive] Susceptible of fear, or other passions.

III.i.68 (52,5) but one] One, and only one.

III.i.69 (52,6) holds on his rank] Perhaps, *holds on his* race; continues his course. We commonly say, *To hold a rank*, and *To hold on a course* or *way*.

III.i.75 (52,7) Doth not Brutus bootless kneel?] I would read, *Do not Brutus bootless kneel!*

III.i.152 (55,9) Who else must be let blood, who else is rank] Who else may be supposed to have *overtopped* his equals, and *grown too high* for the public safety.

III.i.257 (59,3) in the tide of times] That is, in the course of times.

III.i.262 (60,4) A curse shall light upon the limbs of men] Hanmer reads,

—kind *of men*.

I rather think it should be,

—*the* lives *of men*.

unless we read,

—these *lymms of men*;

That is, *these bloodhounds* of men. The uncommonness of the word *lymm* easily made the change.

III.i.273 (60,5) Cry *Havock*] A learned correspondent has informed me, that, in the military operations of old times, *havock* was the word by which declaration was made, that no quarter should be given.

In a tract intitled, *The Office of the Conestable & Mareschall in the Tyme of Werre*, contained in the Black Book of the Admiralty, there is the following chapter:

"The peyne of hym that crieth *havock* and of them that followeth hym. etit. v."

"Item Si quis inventus fuerit qui clamorem inceperit qui vecatur *Havok*."

"Also that no man be so hardy to crye *Havok* upon peyne that he that is begynner shal be deede therefore: & the remanent that doo the same or folow shall lose their horse & harneis: and the persones of such as foloweth & escrien shal be under arrest of the Conestable & Mareschall warde unto tyme that they have made fyn; & founde suretie no morr to offende; & his body in prison at the Kyng wylle. —"

III.ii.116 (66,8) Caesar has had great wrong] [Pope has a rather ridiculous note on this] I have inserted this note, because it is Pope's, for it is otherwise of no value. It is strange that he should so much forget the date of the copy before him, as to think it not printed in Jonson's time. (see 1765, VII, 81, 1)

III.ii.126 (68,9) And none so poor] The meanest man is now too high to do reverence to Caesar.

III.ii.192 (68,2)

And, in his mantle muffling up his face,
Even at the base of Pompey's statue,
Which all the while ran blood, great Caesar fell.
O, what a fall was there, my countrymen!]

[Warburton suggested transposing the second and third of these lines] The image seems to be, that the blood of Caesar flew upon the statue, and trickled down it. And the exclamation,

O what a fall was there —

follows better after

-great Caesar fell,

than with a line interposed, (see 1765, VII, 64, 3)

III.ii.226 (70,4) For I have neither writ] The old copy reads instead of *wit*,

For I have neither writ, nor words, —

which may mean, I have no *penned* and premeditated oration.

IV.ii.4 (77,1)

Your master, Pindarus,
In his own change, or by ill officers,
Hath given me some worthy cause to wish

Things done, undone]

[W: own charge] The arguments for the change proposed are insufficient. Brutus could not but know whether the wrongs committed were done by those who were immediately under the command of Cassius, or those under his officers. The answer of Brutus to the servant is only an act of artful civility; his question to Lucilius proves, that his suspicion still continued. Yet I cannot but suspect a corruption, and would read,

In his own change, or by ill offices.

That is, either *changing* his inclination of *himself*, or by the *ill offices* and bad influences of others. (see 1765, VII, 71, 8)

IV.iii.30 (80,4) To hedge me in] That is, to limit my authority by your direction or censure.

IV.iii.32 (80,5) To make conditions] That is, to know on what terms it is fit to confer the offices which are at my disposal.

IV.iii.86 (82,7)

A friend should bear a friend's infirmities,
But Brutus makes mine greater than they are.

Bru. I do not, till you practise them on me]

The meaning is this; I do not look for your faults, I only see them, and mention them with vehemence, when you force them into my notice, *by practising them on me.* (see 1765, VII, 77, 6)

IV.iii.100 (53,8)

There is my dagger,
And here my naked breast; within, a heart
Dearer than Plutus' mine, richer than gold:
If that thou be'st a Roman, take it forth]

[W: thou needst a Roman's,] I am not satisfied with the change proposed, yet cannot deny, that the words, as they now stand, require some interpretation. I think he means only, that he is so far from Avarice, when the cause of his country requires liberality, that if any man should wish for his heart, he would not need enforce his desire any otherwise, than by showing that he was a Roman.

Vi.1 (92,5) They mean to warn as at Philippi here] To warn, seems to mean here the same as to alarm. Hanmer reads,

They mean to wage us.

V.i.43 (93,6) While damned Casca, like a cur behind,/ Struck Caesar on the neck] Casca struck Caesar on the neck, coming *like* a degenerate *cur behind him*.

V.i.100 (96,2)

Even by the rule of that philosophy,
By which I did blame Cato for the death
Which he did give himself; (I know not how,
But I do find it cowardly and vile,
For fear of what might fall, so to prevent
The time of life:) arming myself with patience]

Dr. Warburton thinks, that in this speech something is lost, but there needed only a parenthesis to clear it. The construction is this; I am determined to act according to that philosophy which directed me to blame the suicide of Cato, arming myself with patience.

V.iv.12 (102,6) *Luc.* Only I yield to die:/ There is so much, that then wilt kill me straight] Dr. Warburton has been much inclined to find *lacunae*, or passages broken by omission, throughout this play. I think he has been always mistaken. The soldier here says, *Yield, or thou diest*. Lucilius replies, I yield only on this condition, that I may die; here is so much gold as thou seest in my hand, which I offer thee as a reward for speedy death. What now is there wanting?

(106) General Observation. Of this tragedy many particular passages deserve regard, and the contention and reconciliation of Brutus and Cassius is universally celebrated; but I have never been strongly agitated in perusing it, and think it somewhat cold and unaffecting, compared with some other of Shakespeare's plays; his adherence to the real story, and to Roman manners, seems to have impeded the natural vigour of his genius.

ANTONY AND CLEOPATRA

I.i.9 (110,2) And is become the bellows, and the fan,/ To cool a gypsy's lust] In this passage something seems to be wanting. The bellows and fan being commonly used for contrary purposes, were probably opposed by the author, who might perhaps have written,

—*is become the bellows, and the fan,*
To kindle and to cool a gypsy's lust.

I.i.10 (110,3) gypsy's lust] Gypsy is here used both in the original meaning for an *Egyptian*, and in its accidental sense for a *bad woman*.

I.i.17 (110,6) Then must thou needs find out new heaven] Thou must set the boundary of my love at a greater distance than the present visible universe affords.

I.i.18 (110,7) The sum] Be brief, *sum* thy business in a few words.

I.i.33 (111,8) and the wide arch/ Of the rang'd empire fall!] [Taken from the Roman custom of raising triumphal arches to perpetuate their victories. Extremely noble. Warburton.] I am in doubt whether Shakespeare had any idea but of a fabrick standing on pillars. The later editions have all printed the *raised* empire, for the *ranged* empire, as it was first given, (see 1765, VII, 107, 8)

I.i.42 (112,1)

Antony

Will be himself.

Ant. But stirr'd by Cleopatra]

But, in this passage, seems to have the old Saxon signification of *without, unless, except*. Antony, says the queen, *will recollect his thoughts*. Unless *kept*, he replies, *in commotion by Cleopatra*. (see 1765, VII, 108,1)

I.ii.5 (113,2) change his horns with garlands] [W: charge] Sir Thomas Hanmer reads, not improbably, *change* for *horns* his *garlands*. I am in doubt, whether to *change* is not merely to *dress*, or to *dress with changes* of garlands.

I.ii.23 (114,3) I had rather heat my liver] To know why the lady is so averse from *heating* her *liver*, it must be remembered, that a heated liver is supposed to make a pimpled face.

I.ii.35 (114,5) Then, belike, my children shall have no names] If I have already had the best of my fortune, then I suppose *I shall never name children*, that is, I am never to be married. However, tell me the truth, tell me, *how many boys and wenches*?

1.ii.38 (114,6) If every of your wishes had a womb, and foretel every wish, a million] [W: fertil ev'ry] For *foretel*, in ancient editions, the latter copies have *foretold*. *Foretel* favours the emendation, which is made with great acuteness; yet the original reading may, I think, stand. *If you had as many wombs as you will have wishes; and I should foretel all those wishes, I should foretel a million of children*. It is an ellipsis very frequent in conversation; *I should shame you, and tell all*; that is, *and if I should tell all*. *And* is for *and if*, which was anciently, and is still provincially, used for *if*.

I.ii.105 (117,8) extended Asia] To *extend*, is a term used for to *seize*; I know not whether that be not the sense here.

I.ii.113 (118,9) Oh, when we bring forth weeds,/When our quick winds lie still] The sense is, that man, not agitated by censure, like soil not ventilated by *quick winds*, produces more evil than good.

I.ii.128 (118,1)

the present pleasure,

By revolution lowring, does become

The opposite of itself]

[The allusion is to the sun's diurnal course; which rising in the *east*, and by *revolution lowering*, or setting in the *west*, becomes *the opposite of itself*. WARB.] This is an obscure passage. The explanation which Dr. Warburton has offered is such, that I can add nothing to it; yet perhaps Shakespeare, who was less learned than his commentator, meant only, that our pleasures, as they are *revolved* in the mind, turn to pain.

I.ii.146 (119,3) upon far poorer moment] For less reason; upon meaner motives.

I.ii.169 (120,4) It shews to man the tailors of the earth; comforting therein] I have printed this after the original, which, though harsh and obscure, I know not how to amend. Sir Tho. Hanmer reads, *They shew to man the tailors of the earth comforting* him therein. I think the passage, with somewhat less alteration, for alteration is always

dangerous, may stand thus; *It shews to men the tailors of the earth, comforting them, &c.*

I.ii.187 (121,6) more urgent touches] Things that touch me more sensibly, more pressing motives.

I.ii.190 (121,7) Petition us at home] Wish us at home; call for us to reside at home.

I.ii.201 (121,9)

Say, our pleasure

To such whose places under us, requires

Our quick remove from hence]

This is hardly sense. I believe we should read,

Their *quick remove from hence*.

Tell our design of going away to those, who being by their places obliged to attend us, must remove in haste.

I.iii.3 (122,1) I did not send you] You must go as if you came without my order or knowledge.

I.iii.37 (123,2) a race of heaven] [i.e. had a smack or flavour of heaven. WARB.] This word is well explained by Dr. Warburton; the *race* of wine is the taste of the woil. Sir T. Hanmer, not understanding the word, reads, *ray*.

I.iii.44 (124,3) Remains in use] The poet seems to allude to the legal distinction between the *use* and *absolute possession*.

I.iii.54 (124,4) should safe my going] [T: salve] Mr. Upton reads, I think rightly,

—*safe* my going.

I.iii.62 (125,5)

O most false love!

Where be the sacred vials thou shouldst fill

With sorrowful water?]

Alluding to the lachrymatory vials, or bottles of tears, which the Romans sometimes put into the urn of a friend.

I.iii.77 (125,6) the tears/Belong to Egypt] To me, the queen of Egypt.

I.iii.90 (126,7) Oh, ny oblivion is a very Antony,/ And I am all forgotten] [The plain meaning is, *My forgetfulness makes me forget myself*. WARBURTON.] [Hanmer explained "all forgotten" as "apt to forget everything"] I cannot understand the learned critic's explanation. It appears to me, that she should rather have said,

*O my remembrance is a very Antony,
And I am all forgotten.*

It was her memory, not her oblivion, that, like Antony, was forgetting and deserting her. I think a slight change will restore the passage. The queen, having something to say, which she is not able, or would not seem able to recollect, cries out,

O my oblivion! — 'Tis a very Antony.

The thought of which I was in quest is a very Antony, is treacherous and fugitive, and has irrevocably left me,

And I am all forgotten.

If this reading stand, I think the explanation of Hanmer must be received, (see 1765, VII, 122, 6)

I.iv.3 (127,9) One great competitor] Perhaps, *Our* great competitor.

I.iv.12 (128,1) as the spots of heaven,/More fiery by night's blackness] If by spots are meant stars, as night has no other fiery spots, the comparison is forced and harsh, stars having been always supposed to beautify the night; nor do I comprehend what there is in the counter-part of this simile, which answers to night's blackness. Hanmer reads,

—spots on ermine
Or fires, *by night's blackness*.

I.iv.14 (128,2) purchas'd] Procured by his own fault or endeavour.

I.iv.21 (128,3) say, this becomes him, (As his composure must be rare, indeed, Whom these things cannot blemish] This seems inconsequent. I read

And his composure, &c.

Grant that this becomes him, and if it can become him, he must have in him something very uncommon; yet, &c.

I.iv.25 (128,4) So great weight in his lightness] The word *light* it one of Shakespeare's favourite play-things. The sense is, His trifling levity throws so much burden upon us.

I.iv.25 (129,5)

If he fill'd

His vacancy with his voluptuousness,

Full surfeits, and the dryness of his bones,

Call on him for't]

Call on him, is, visit him. Says Caesar, *If Antony followed his debaucheries at a time of leisure, I should leave him to be punished by their natural consequences, by surfeits and dry bones.*

I.iv.31 (129,6) boys; who being mature in knowledge] For this Hamner, who thought the *maturity* of a boy an inconsistent idea, has put, — *who, immature in knowledge,*

but the words *experience* and *judgment* require that we read *mature*; though Dr. Warburton has received the emendation. By *boys mature in knowledge*, are meant, *boys old enough to know their duty.*

I.iv.38 (129,7) he is belov'd of these/ That only have fear'd Caesar] Those whom not *love* but *fear* made adherents to Caesar, now shew their affection for Pompey.

I.iv.49 (130,2) which they ear] To *ear*, is to *plow*; a common metaphor.

I.iv.52 (130,3) Lack blood to think on't] Turn pale at the thought of it.

I.v.4 (132,5) mandragora] A plant of which the infusion was supposed to procure sleep. Shakespeare mentions it in *Othello*:

Not poppy, nor mandragora,

Can ever med'cine thee to that sweet sleep.

I.v.38 (133,8) that great medicine hath/ With his tinct gilded thee] Alluding to the philosopher's stone, which, by its touch, converts base metal into gold. The alchemists call the matter, whatever it be, by which they perform transmutation, a *medicine*.

I.v.48 (134,9) arm-gaunt steed] [i.e. his steed worn lean and thin by much service in war. So Fairfax, *His stall-worn steed the champion stout bestrode*. WARB.] On this note Mr. Edwards has been very lavish of his pleantry, and indeed has justly censured the misquotation of *stall-worn*, for *stall-worth*, which means *strong*, but makes no attempt to explain the word in the play. Mr. Seyward, in his preface to Beaumont, has very elaborately endeavoured to prove, that an *arm-gaunt* steed is a steed with *lean shoulders*. *Arm* is the Teutonic word for *want*, or *poverty*. *Arm-gaunt* may be therefore an old word, signifying,

lean for *want*, ill fed. Edwards's observation, that a worn-out horse is not proper for Atlas to mount in battle, is impertinent; the horse here mentioned seems to be a post horse, rather than a war horse. Yet as *arm-gaunt* seems not intended to imply any defect, it perhaps means, a horse so slender that a man might clasp him, and therefore formed for expedition. Hammer reads,

—*arm-girt steed*.

I.v.50 (134,1) Was beastly dumb by him] Mr. Theobald reads *dumb'd*, put to silence. *Alexas* means, (says he) *the horse made such a neighing, that if he had spoke he could not have been heard*.

I.v.76 (136,3) Get me ink and paper: he shall have every day/ A several greeting, or I'll unpeople Aegypt] By sending out messengers.

II.i (136,4) *Enter Pompey, Menecrates, and Menas*] The persons are so named in the first edition; but I know not why Menecrates appears; Menas can do all without him.

II.i.4 (136,5) While we are suitors to their throne, decays/ The thing we sue for] [W: delays] It is not always prudent to be too hasty in exclamation; the reading which Dr. Warburton rejects as *nonsense*, is in my opinion right; if *delay* be what they sue for, they have it, and the consolation offered becomes superfluous. The meaning is, *While we are praying, the thing for which we pray* is losing its value.

II.i.38 (138,8) The ne'er-lust-wearied Antony] [Theobald emended "near lust-wearied" to "ne'er-lust-wearied"] Could it be imagined, after this swelling exultation, that the first edition stands literally thus, *The neere lust wearied Antony*.

II.i.45 (139,9) square] That is, quarrel.

II.i.51 (139,1) Our lives upon] This play is not divided into acts by the authour or first editors, and therefore the present division may be altered at pleasure. I think the first act may be commodiously continued to this place, and the second act opened with the interview of the chief persons, and a change of the state of action. Yet it must be confessed, that it is of small importance, where these unconnected and desultory scenes are interrupted.

II.ii.7 (140,2) Were I the wearer of Antonius' beard,/I would not shav't to-day] I believe he means, *I would meet him undressed, without shew of respect.*

II.ii.25 (141,3) Nor curstness grow to the matter] Let not *ill-humour* be added to the real *subject* of our difference.

II.ii.28 (141,4) *Caes. Sit./Ant. Sit, sir!*] [Antony appears to be jealous of a circumstance which seemed to indicate a consciousness of superiority in his too successful partner in power; and accordingly resents the invitation of Caesar to be seated: Caesar answers, *Nay then*—i.e. *if you are so ready to resent what I meant an act of civility, there can be no reason to suppose you have temper enough for the business on which at present we are met.* STEEVENS.] The following circumstance may serve to strengthen Mr. Steevens's opinion: When the fictitious Sebastian made his appearance in Europe, he came to a conference with the Conde de Lemos; to whom, after the first exchange of civilities, he said, *Conde de Lemos, be covered.* And being asked by that nobleman, by what pretences he laid claim to the superiority expressed by such permission, he replied, I do it by right of my birth; I am Sebastian. (1773)

II.ii.43 (142,5) their contestation/ Was theam for you, you were the word of war] [W: theam'd] I am neither satisfied with the reading nor the emendation; *theam'd* is, I think, a word unauthorised, and very harsh. Perhaps we may read,

—*their contestation*

Had *theme* from you, you were the word o' th' war. The dispute derived its subject from you. It may be corrected by mere transposition,

—*their contestation*

You were theme for, you were the word.

II.ii.51 (143,8) Having alike your cause?] The meaning seems to be, *having the same cause as you to be offended with me.* But why, because he was offended with Antony, should he make war upon Caesar? May it not be read thus,

—*Did he not rather*

Discredit my authority with yours,

And make the wars alike against my stomach,

Hating alike our cause?

II.ii.53 (143,9) As matter whole you have not to make it with] The original copy reads,

As matter whole you have to make it with.

Without doubt erroneously; I therefore only observe it, that the reader may more readily admit the liberties which the editors of this authour's works have necessarily taken.

II.ii.61 (144,1) fronted] i.e. *opposed*.

II.ii.85 (145,4) The honour's sacred which he talks on now,/Supposing that I lack'd it] [*Sacred*, for unbroken, unviolated. WARB.] Dr. Warburton seems to understand this passage thus; *The honour which he talks of me as lacking, is unviolated, I never lacked it.* This may perhaps be the true meaning, but before I read the note, I understood it thus: Lepidus interrupts Caesar, on the supposition that what he is about to say will be too harsh to be endured by Antony; to which Antony replies, *No, Lepidus, let him speak, the security of honour on which he now speaks, on which this conference is held now, is sacred, even supposing that I lacked honour before.*

II.ii.112 (146,5) your considerate stone] This line is passed by all the editors, as if they understood it, and believed it universally, intelligible. I cannot find in it any very obvious, and hardly any possible meaning. I would therefore read,

Go to then, you considerate ones.

You, who dislike my frankness and temerity of speech, and are so *considerate* and discreet, *go to*, do your on business.

II.ii.113 (146,6) I do not much dislike the matter, but/The manner of his speech] I do not, says Caesar, think the man wrong, but too free of him interposition; *for't cannot be, we shall remain in friendship: yet if it were possible, I would endeavour it.*

II.ii.123 (147,7) your reproof/Were well deserv'd] In the old edition, —*your proof*

Were well deserv'd—

Which Mr. Theobald, with his usual triumph, changes to *aproof*, which he explains, *allowance*. Dr. Warburton inserted *reproof* very properly into Hanmer's edition, but forgot it in his own.

II.ii.159 (148,8) Lest my remembrance suffer ill report] Lest I be thought too willing to forget benefits, I must barely return him thanks, and then I will defy him.

II.ii.210 (150,1) And what they undid, did] It might be read less harshly,

And what they did, undid.

II.ii.212 (150,2) tended her i' the eyes] Perhaps *tended her* by *th' eyes*, discovered her will by her eyes.

II.iii.21 (153,6) thy angel/ Becomes a Fear] Mr.Uptan reads,
Becomes afear'd, —

The common reading is more poetical.

II.iii.37 (154,7) his quails ever/ Beat mine] The ancients used to match quails as we match cocks.

II.iii.38 (154,8) inhoop'd, at odds] Thus the old copy. *Inhoop'd* is *in-closed, confined*, that they may fight. The modern editions read,

Beat mine, in whoop'd-at odds. —

II.v.1 (155,9) musick, moody food] [The *mood* is the *mind*, or *mental disposition*. Van Haaren's panegyrick on the English begins, *Groot-moedig Volk, great-minded nation*.] Perhaps here is a poor jest intended between *mood* the *mind* and *moods* of musick.

II.v.41 (157,4) Not like a formal man] [*Formal*, for ordinary. WARB.] Rather decent, regular.

II.v.103 (161,8) Thou art not what thou'rt sure of!] For this, which is not easily understood, Sir Thomas Hanmer has given,

That say'st but what thou'rt sure of!

I am not satisfied with the change, which, though it affords sense, exhibits little spirit. I fancy the line consists only of abrupt starts.

Oh that his fault should make a knave of thee,

That art—not what?—Thou'rt sure on't.—Get thee hence.

That his fault should make a knave of thee that art—but what shall I say *thou art not?* Thou art then sure of *this marriage*.—Get thee hence.

Dr. Warburton has received Sir T. Hanmer's emendation.

II.v.115 (161,9) Let him for ever go] She is now talking in broken sentences, not of the messenger, but Antony.

II.vi.24 (163,2) Thou canst not fear us] Thou canst not affright us with thy numerous navy.

II.vi.28 (163,3) But since the cuckow builds not for himself] Since, like the cuckow, that seizes the nests of other birds, you have invaded a house which you could not build, keep it while you can.

II.vii.1 (167,6) some o' their plants] *Plants*, besides its common meaning, is here used for the *foot*, from the Latin.

II.vii.14 (167,9) a partizan] A pike.

II.vii.16 (167,1) To be call'd into a huge sphere, and not to be seen to move in't, are the holes where eyes should be, which pitifully disaster the cheeks] This speech seems to be mutilated; to supply the deficiencies is impossible, but perhaps the sense was originally approaching to this.

To be called into a huge sphere, and not to be seen to move in it, is a very ignominious state; great offices *are the holes where eyes should be, which*, if eyes be wanting, *pitifully disaster the cheeks*.

II.vii.88 (170,2) thy pall'd fortunes] *Palled*, is vapid, past its time of excellence; *palled* wine, is wine that has lost its original spriteliness.

II.vii.102 (171,3) Strike the vessels] Try whether the casks sound as empty.

II.vii.116 (171,4) The holding every man shall bear] Every man shall accompany the chorus by drumming on his sides, in token of concurrence and applause. [Theobald had emended "beat" to "bear"] (1773)

III.i.1 (173,6) Now, darting Parthia, art thou struck] *Struck* alludes to darting. Thou whose darts have so often struck others, art struck now thyself. (1773)

III.ii.12 (175,8) Arabian bird!] The phoenix.

III.ii.16 (176,9)

Ho! hearts, tongues, figure, scribes, bards, poets, cannot
Think, speak, cast, write, sing, number, ho!]

Not only the tautology of *bards* and *poets*, but the want of a correspondent action for the *poet*, whose business in the next line is only to *number*, makes me suspect some fault in this passage, which I know not how to mend.

III.ii.26 (176,1) as my furthest bond] As I will venture the greatest pledge of security, on the trial of thy conduct.

III.ii.40 (177,1) The elements be kind to thee, and make/Thy spirits all of comfort!] This is obscure. It seems to mean, *May the different elements of the body, or principles of life, maintain such proportion and harmony as may keep you cheerful.*

III.iv.26 (182,7) I'll raise the preparation of a war/Shall stain your brother] [T: strain] I do not see but *stain* may be allowed to remain unaltered, meaning no more than *shame* or *disgrace*.

III.iv.30 (182,8) Wars 'twixt you 'twain would be/As if the world should cleave] The sense is, that war between Caesar and Antony would engage the world between them, and that the slaughter would be great in so extensive a commotion.

III.v.8 (183,9) rivalry] Equal rank.

III.v.11 (183,1) Upon his own appeal] To *appeal*, in Shakespeare, is to *accuse*; Caesar seized Lepidus without any other proof than Caesar's accusation.

III.v.21 (184,3) More, Domitius] I have something *more* to tell you, which I might have told at first, and delayed my news. Antony requires your presence.

III.vi.9 (184,4) made her/Of Lower Syria, Cyprus, Lydia./Absolute queen] For *Lydia*, Mr. Upton, from Plutarch, has restored *Lybia*.

III.vi.68-75 (187,6) Mr. Upton remarks, that there are some errors in this enumeration of the auxiliary kings; but it is probable that the authour did not much wish to be accurate.

III.vi.95 (188,7) And gives his potent regiment to a trull] *Regiment*, is *government, authority*; he puts his *power* and his empire into the hands of a false woman.

It may be observed, that *trull* was not, in our author's time, a term of mere infamy, but a word of slight contempt, as *wench* is now.

III.vii.3 (188,8) forespoke my being] To *forespeak*, is to *contradict*, to *speak against*, as *forbid* is to order negatively.

III.vii.68 (191,1)

By Hercules, I think, I am i' the right.

Can. Soldier, thou art: but his whole action grows

Not in the power on't]

That is, his whole conduct becomes, ungoverned by the right, or by reason.

III.vii.77 (191,2) distractions] Detachments; separate bodies.

III.x.6 (193,4) The greater cantle] [A piece or lump. POPE.] *Cantle* is rather a *corner*. Caesar in this play mentions the *three-nook'd world*. Of this triangular world every triumvir had a corner. (see 1765, VII, 185, 6)

III.x.9 (193,5) token'd pestilence] Spotted.

III.x.10 (193,6) Yon' ribauld nag of Aegypt] The word is in the old edition *ribaudred*, which I do not understand, but mention it, in hopes others may raise some happy conjecture. [Tyrwhitt: hag] The brieze, or oestrum, the fly that stings cattle, proves that *nag* is the right word. (1773)

III.x.11 (193,7) Whom leprosy o'ertake!] *Leprosy*, an epidemical distemper of the Aegyptians; to which Horace probably alludes in the controverted line.

Contaminato cum grege turpium

Morbo virorum.

III.x.36 (195,1) The wounded chance of Antony] I know not whether the author, who loves to draw his images from the sports of the field, might not have written,

The wounded chase of Antony,—

The allusion is to a deer wounded and chased, whom all other deer avoid. *I will*, says Enobarbus, *follow Antony*, though *chased* and *wounded*.

The common reading, however, may very well stand.

III.xi.3 (195,2) so lated in the world] Alluding to a benighted traveller.

III.xi.23 (196,3) I have lost command] I am not master of my own emotions.

III.xi.35 (196,4) He at Philippi kept/His sword e'en like a dancer]
In the Moriaco, and perhaps anciently in the Pyrrhick dance, the
dancers held swords in their hands with the points upward.

III.xi.39 (196,6) he alone/Dealt on lieutenantry] I know not whether
the meaning is, that Caesar acted only as lieutenant at Philippi, or
that he made his attempts only on lieutenants, and left the generals
to Antony.

III.xi.47 (197,7) death will seize her; but/Your comfort] *But* has here,
as once before in this play, the force of *except*, or *unless*.

III.ii.52 (197,8) How I convey my shame] How, by looking another
way, I withdraw my ignominy from your sight.

III.ii.57 (197,9) ty'd by the strings] That is by the *heart string*.

III.xii.18 (199,1) The circle of the Ptolemies] The diadem; the ensign
of royalty.

III.xii.34 (199,2) how Antony becomes his flaw] That is, how Antony
conforms himself to this breach of his fortune.

III.xiii.1 (200,3) Think, and die] [Hanmer: Drink] This reading, of-
fered by sir T. Hanmer, is received by Dr. Warburton and Mr. Upton,
but I have not advanced it into the page, not being convinced that it
is necessary. *Think, and die*; that is, *Reflect on your folly, and leave the
world*, is a natural answer.

III.xiii.9 (201,4) he being/The meered question] The *meered* question
is a term I do not understand. I know not what to offer, except,
The mooted question. —

That is, the *disputed* point, the subject of debate. *Mere* is indeed a
boundary, and the *meered question*, if it can mean any thing, may, with
some violence of language, mean, the *disputed boundary*.

III.xiii.25 (202, 5)

I dare him therefore
To lay his gay comparisons apart
And answer me declin'd]

I require of Caesar not to depend on that superiority which the *comparison* of our different fortunes may exhibit to him, but to answer me man to man, in this decline of my age or power.

III.xiii.42 (202,6) The loyalty, well held to fools, does make/ Our faith meer folly] [T: Though loyalty, well held] I have preserved the old reading: Enobarbus is deliberating upon desertion, and finding it is more prudent to forsake a fool, and more reputable to be faithful to him, makes no positive conclusion. Sir T. Hanmer follows Theobald; Dr. Warburton retains the old reading.

III.xiii.77 (204,9) Tell him, from his all-obeying breath I hear/ The doom of Aegypt] *Doom* is declared rather by an *all-commanding*, than an *all-obeying breath*. I suppose we ought to read,
—*all-obeyed breath*.

III.xiii.81 (205,1) Give me grace] Grant me the favour.

III.xiii.109 (206,3) By one that looks on feeders?] One that waits at the table while others are eating.

III.xiii.128 (207,4) The horned herd] It is not without pity and indignation that the reader of this great poet meets so often with this low jest, which is too much a favourite to be left out of either mirth or fury.

III.xiii.151 (208,5) to quit me] To repay me this insult; to *requite* me.

III.xiii.180 (209,9) Were nice and lucky] [*Nice*, for delicate, courtly, flowing in peace. Warburton.] *Nice* rather seems to be, *just fit for my purpose, agreeable to my wish*. So we vulgarly say of any thing that is done better than was expected, it is *nice*.

IV.i.5 (210,1) I have many other ways to die] [Upton: He hath.../I laugh] I think this emendation deserves to be received. It had, before Mr. Upton's book appeared, been made by sir T. Hanmer.

IV.i.9 (211,2) Make boot of] Take advantage of.

IV.ii.8 (212,3) *take all*] Let the survivor take all. No composition, victory or death.

IV.ii.14 (212,4) one of those odd tricks] I know not what obscurity the editors find in this passage. *Trick* is here used in the sense in which it is uttered every day by every mouth, elegant and vulgar: yet

sir T. Hanmer changes it to *freaks*, and Dr. Warburton, in his rage of Gallicism, to *traits*.

IV.ii.26 (213,5) Haply, you shall not see me more; or if,/ A mangled shadow] *Or if* you see me more, you will see me *a mangled shadow*, only the external form of what I was.

IV.ii.35 (213,6) onion-ey'd] I have my eyes as full of tears as if they had been fretted by onions.

IV.iv.3 (215,8) Come, good fellow, put thine iron on] I think it should be rather,
—mine *iron*—

IV.iv.5 (215,9) Nay, I'll help too] These three little speeches, which in the other editions are only one, and given to Cleopatra, were happily disentangled by sir T. Hanmer.

IV.iv.10 (215,1) Briefly, sir] That is, *quickly*, sir.

IV.v.17 (218,3) Dispatch. Enobarbus!] Thus [*Dispatch, my Eros*] the modern editors. The old edition reads,

—*Dispatch Enobarbus*.

Perhaps, it should be,

—*Dispatch! To Enobarbus!* (see 1765, VII, 208, 3)

IV.vi.12 (219,6) persuade] The old copy has *dissuade*, perhaps rightly.

IV.vi.34 (219,7) This blows my heart] All the latter editions have,
—*This bows my heart*;

I have given the original word again the place from which I think it unjustly excluded. *This generosity*, (says Enobarbus) swells *my heart*, so that it will quickly break, *if thought break it not, a swifter mean*.

IV.vii.2 (220,8) and our oppression] Sir T. Hanmer has received *opposition*. Perhaps rightly.

IV.viii.1 (221,9) run one before,/ And let the queen know of our guests] [W: gests] This passage needs neither correction nor explanation. Antony after his success intends to bring his officers to sup with Cleopatra, and orders notice to be given her of their *guests*.

IV.viii.12 (222,1) To this great fairy] Mr. Upton has well observed, that *fairy*; which Dr. Warburton and sir T. Hanmer explain by *Inchantress*, comprises the idea of power and beauty.

IV.viii.22 (222,2) get goal for goal of youth] At all plays of barriers, the boundary is called a *goal*; to *win a goal*, is to be superiour in a contest of activity.

IV.viii.31 (223,4) Bear our hack'd targets like the men that owe them] i.e. hack'd as much as the men are to whom they belong. WARB.] Why not rather, *Bear our hack'd targets* with spirit and exaltation, such as becomes the brave warriors *that own them*?

IV.ix.15 (224,5)

Throw my heart

Against the flint and hardness of my fault;

Which, being dried with grief, will break to powder,

And finish all foul thoughts]

The pathetick of Shakespeare too often ends in the ridiculous. It is painful to find the gloomy dignity of this noble scene destroyed by the intrusion of a conceit so far-fetched and unaffecting.

IV.xii.13 (226,1) Triple turn'd whore!] She was first for Antony, then was supposed by him to have *turned* to Caesar, when he found his messenger kissing her hand, then she *turned* again to Antony, and now has *turned* to Caesar. Shall I mention what has dropped into my imagination, that our author might perhaps have written *triple-tongued*? *Double-tongued* is a common term of reproach, which rage might improve to *triple-tongued*. But the present reading may stand.

IV.xii.21 (227,2) That pannell'd me at heels] All the editions read,
That pannell'd me at heels,—

Sir T. Hanmer substituted *spaniel'd* by an emendation, with which it was reasonable to expect that even rival commentators would be satisfied; yet Dr. Warburton proposes *pantler'd*, in a note, of which he is not injur'd by the suppression; and Mr. Upton having in his first edition proposed plausibly enough,

That paged me at heels,—

in the second edition retracts his alteration, and maintains *pannell'd* to be the right reading, being a metaphor taken, he says, from a *pannel* of wainscot.

IV.xii.25 (227,3) this grave charm] I know not by what authority, nor for what reason, *this grave charm*, which the first, the only original copy exhibits, has been through all the modern editors changed to

this gay charm. By this grave charm, is meant, this sublime, this majestic beauty.

IV.xii.29 (227,4) to the very heart of loss] To the utmost loss possible.

IV.xii.45 (228,7) Let me lodge, Lichas] Sir T. Hanmer reads thus,
 —thy *rage*
 Led thee lodge *Lichas*—and—
Subdue thy worthiest self.—

This reading, harsh as it is, Dr. Warburton has received, after having rejected many better. The meaning is, Let me do something in my rage, becoming the successor of Hercules,

IV.xiv.19 (230,2) Pack'd cards with Caesar, and false play'd my glory/Unto an enemy's triumph] [Warburton had explained and praised Shakespeare's "metaphor"] This explanation is very just, the thought did not deserve so good an annotation.

IV.xiv.39 (231,3) The battery from my heart] I would read,
This battery from my heart.—

IV.xiv.49 (232,4) Seal then, and all is done] I believe the reading is,
 —seel *then, and all is done*—
 To seel *hawks*, is to close their eyes. The meaning will be,
 —since the torch is out,
Lie down, and stray no further. How all labour
Marrs what it does.—Seel *then, and all is done.*
 Close thine eyes *for ever, and be quiet.*

IV.xiv.73 (233,5) pleach'd arms] Arms folded in each other.

IV.xiv.77 (233,6) His baseness that ensued?] The poor conquered wretch that followed.

IV.xiv.86 (233,7) the worship of the whole world] The *worship*, is the *dignity*, the *authority*.

IV.xv.9 (237,9)

O sun,
 Burn the great sphere thou mov'st in!—darkling stand
 The varying shore o' the world]
 She desires the sun, to *burn* his own *orb*, the vehicle of light, and then the earth will be dark.

IV.xv.19-23 (237,1) I here importune death] [Theobald had regularized the versification and had added two words] Mr. Theobald's emendation is received by the succeeding editors; but it seems not necessary that a dialogue so distressful should be nicely regular. I have therefore preserved the original reading in the text, and the emendation below.

IV.xv.28 (238,2) still conclusion] Sedate determination; silent coolness of resolution.

IV.xv.32 (236,3) Here's sport, indeed!] I suppose the meaning of these strange words is, *here's trifling, you do not work in earnest.*

IV.xv.39 (239,4) Quicken with kissing] That is, *Revive by my kiss.*

IV.xv.44 (239,6) That the false huswife Fortune break her wheel] This despicable line has occurred before.

IV.xv.65 (240,8) The soldier's pole] He at whom the soldiers pointed, as at a pageant held high for observation.

IV.xv.72 (240,9)

Char. Peace, peace, Iras.

Cleo. No more—but e'en a woman]

[W: peace, Isis] Of this note it may be truly said, that it at least deserves to be right, nor can he, that shall question the justness of the emendation, refuse his esteem to the ingenuity and learning with which it is proposed.

Hanmer had proposed another emendation, not injudiciously. He reads thus,

Iras. *Royal Aegypt! empress!*

Cleo. *Peace, peace, Iras.*

No more but a mere woman, &c.

That is, no more an empress, but a mere woman.

It is somewhat unfortunate that the words, *mere woman*, which so much strengthen the opposition to either *empress* or *Isis*, are not in the original edition, which stands thus,

No more but in a woman.

Mere woman was probably the arbitrary reading of Rowe. I suppose, however, that we may justly change the ancient copy thus,

No more, but e'en a woman.

which will enough accommodate either of the editors.

I am inclined to think that she speaks abruptly, not answering her woman, but discoursing with her own thoughts,

No more—but e'en a woman.

I have no more of my wonted greatness, but am even a woman, on the level with other women; were I what I once was.

—It were for me

To throw my scepter, &c.

If this simple explanation be admitted, how much labour has been thrown away. *Peace, peace, Iras*, is said by Charmian, when she sees the queen recovering, and thinks speech troublesome.

V.i.15 (244,4) The round world/ Should have shook lions into civil streets] I think here is a line lost, after which it is in vain to go in quest. The sense seems to have been this: *The round world should have shook*, and this great alteration of the system of things should send lions into streets, and citizens into dens. There is sense still, but it is harsh and violent.

V.i.27 (244,5) but it is tidings/ To wash the eyes of kings!] That is, *May the Gods rebuke me*, if this be not tidings to make kings weep.

But, again, for if not.

V.i.46 (245,7) that our stars,/ Unreconcilable, should divide/ Our equalness to this] That is, *should have made us*, in our equality of fortune, disagree to a pitch like this, that one of us must die.

V.i.52 (246,8) A poor Aegyptian yet; the queen my mistress] If this punctuation be right, the man means to say, that he is *yet an Aegyptian*, that is, *yet a servant of the queen of Aegypt*, though soon to become, a subject of Rome.

V.i.65 (246,9) her life in Rome/ Would be eternal in our triumph] Hammer reads judiciously enough, but without necessity,

Would be eternalling our triumph.

The sense is, *If she dies here, she will be forgotten, but if I send her in triumph at Rome, her memory and my glory will be eternal.*

V.ii.3 (247,1) fortune's knave] The *servant* of fortune.

V.ii.4 (247,2)

it is great

To do that thing, that ends all other deeds;

Which shackles accidents, and bolts up change;

Which sleeps, and never palates more the dung,
The beggar's nurse, and Caesar's]

[Warburton added a whole line and emended "dung" to "dugg"]

I cannot perceive the loss of a line, or the need of an emendation. The commentator seems to have entangled his own ideas; his supposition that *suicide* is called *the beggar's nurse and Caesar's*, and his concession that the position is *intelligible*, show, I think, a mind not intent upon the business before it. The difficulty of the passage, if any difficulty there be, arises only from this, that the act of suicide, and the state which is the effect of suicide are confounded. Voluntary death, says she, is an act *which bolts up change*; it produces a state,

*Which sleeps, and never palates more the dung,
The beggar's nurse, and Caesar's.*

Which has no longer need of the gross and terrene sustenance, in the use of which Caesar and the beggar are on a level.

The speech is abrupt, but perturbation in such a state is surely natural.

V.ii.29 (249,4) I am his fortune's vassal, and I send him/ The greatness he has got] I allow him to be my conqueror; I own his superiority with complete submission.

V.ii.34 (249,5) You see how easily she may be surpriz'd] This line in the first edition is given not to Charuian, but to Proculeius; and to him it certainly belongs, though perhaps misplaced. I would put it at the end of his foregoing speech,

Where he for grace is kneel'd to.

[Aside to Gallus.] *You see, how easily she may be surpriz'd.*

Then while Cleopatra makes a formal answer, Gallus, upon the hint given, seizes her, and Proculeius, interrupting the civility of his answer,

*—your plight is pity'd
Of him that caus'd it.*

*Cries out,
Guard her till, Caesar come.*

V.ii.40 (250,6) who are in this/Reliev'd, but not betray'd] [W: Be-reav'd, but] I do not think the emendation necessary, since the sense is not made better by it, and the abruptness in Cleopatra's answer is more forcible in the old reading.

V.ii.42 (250,7) rids our dogs of languish] For *languish*, I think we may read, *anguish*.

V.ii.48 (251,8) Worth many babes and beggars] Why, death, wilt thou not rather seize a queen, than employ thy force upon *babes* and *beggars*. (see 1765, VII, 238, 9)

V.ii.50 (251,9) If idle talk will once be necessary] [This nonsense should be reformed thus,

If idle TIME whill once be necessary.

i.e. if *repose* be necessary to cherish life, I will not sleep. WARBURTON.] I do not see that the nonsense is made sense by the change. Sir T. Hanmer reads,

If idle talk will once be accessary;

Neither is this better. I know not what to offer better than an easy explanation. That is, *I will not eat*, and *if it will be necessary now for once* to waste a moment in *idle talk* of my purpose, *I will not sleep neither*. In common conversation we often use *will be*, with as little relation to futurity. As, Now I am going, *it will be* fit for me to dine first.

V.ii.98 (254,2)

yet to imagine

An Antony, were Nature's piece 'gainst Fancy,

Condemning shadows quite]

[W: Nature's prize] In this passage I cannot discover any temptation to critical experiments. The word *piece*, is a term appropriated to works of art. Here Nature and Fancy produce each their *piece*, and the *piece* done by Nature had the preference. Antony was in reality *past the size of dreaming*; he was more by *Nature* than *Fancy* could present in sleep.

V.ii.121 (255,3) I cannot project mine own cause so well] [W: procter] Sir T. Hanmer reads,

I cannot parget my own cause—

meaning, I cannot *whitewash*, *varnish*, or *gloss* my cause. I believe the present reading to be right. To *project a cause* is to *represent* a cause; to *project it well*, is to *plan* or *contrive* a scheme of defense.

V.ii.139 (256,4) 'tis exactly valued, /Not petty things admitted] [T: omitted] Notwithstanding the wrath of Mr. Theobald, I have restored the old reading. She is angry afterwards, that she is accused

of having reserved more than petty things. Dr. Warburton and sir T. Hanmer follow Theobald.

V.ii.146 (257,5) seel my lips] Sew up my mouth.

V.ii.163 (258,7) Parcel the sum of my disgraces by] *To parcel her disgraces*, might be expressed in vulgar language, *to bundle up her calamities*. (see 1765, VII, 244, 8)

V.ii.176 (259,8)

Cleo. Be't known, that we, the greatest, are misthought
for things that others do; and, when we fall,
We answer others merits in our names;
Are therefore to be pitied]

I do not think that either of the critics [Warburton and Hanmer] have reached the sense of the author, which may be very commodiously explained thus;

We suffer at our highest state of elevation in the *thoughts of mankind for that which others do, and when we fall*, those that contented themselves only to think ill before, call us to *answer in our own names for the merits of others*. *We are therefore to be pitied*. *Merits* is in this place taken in an ill sense, for actions *meriting* censure.

If any alteration be necessary, I should only propose, *Be 't known, that we at greatest, &c.*

V.ii.185 (259,1) Make not your thoughts your prisons] I once wished to read,

make not your thoughts your poison:—

Do not destroy yourself by musing on your misfortune. Yet I would change nothing, as the old reading presents a very proper sense. *Be not a prisoner in imagination, when in reality you are free.*

V.ii.215 (261,2) scald rhimers] Sir T. Hanmer reads,
—stall 'd rhimers.

Scald was a word of contempt, implying poverty, disease, and filth.

V.ii.216 (261,3) quick comedians] The gay inventive players.

V.ii.226 (261,5) Their most absurd intents] [T: assured] I have preserved the old reading. The design certainly appeared *absurd* enough to Cleopatra, both as she thought it unreasonable in itself, and as she knew it would fail.

V.ii.243 (263,7) the pretty worm of Nilus] *Worm* is the Teutonic word for *serpent*; we have the *blind-worm* and *slow-worm* still in our language, and the Norwegians call an enormous monster, seen sometimes in the northern ocean, the *sea-worm*.

V.ii.264 (263,9) the worm will do him kind] The serpent will act according to his nature.

V.ii.305 (205,2) He'll make demand of her, and spend that kiss,/ Which is my heaven to have] He will enquire of her concerning me, and kiss her for giving him intelligence.

V.ii.352 (267,5) something blown] The flesh is somewhat *puffed* or *swoln*.

(268) General Observation. This play keeps curiosity always busy, and the passions always interested. The continual hurry of the action, the variety of incidents, and the quick succession of one personage to another, call the mind forward without intermission from the first act to the last. But the power of delighting is derived principally from the frequent changes of the scene; for, except the feminine arts, some of which are too low, which distinguish Cleopatra, no character is very strongly discriminated. Upton, who did not easily miss what he desired to find, has discovered that the language of Antony is, with great skill and learning, made pompous and superb, according to his real practice. But I think his diction not distinguishable from that of others: the most tumid speech in the play is that which Caesar makes to Octavia.

The events, of which the principal are described according to history, are produced without any art of connexion or care of disposition.

TIMON OF ATHENS

I.i.3 (271,3)

Poet. Ay, that's well known:

But what particular rarity! what strange,
Which manifold record not matches? See,
Magick of bounty!]

The learned commentator's [Warburton's] note must shift for itself. I cannot but think that this passage is at present in confusion. The poet asks a question, and stays not for an answer, nor has his question any apparent drift or consequence. I would range the passage thus:

Poet. Ay, *that's well known.*

*But what particular rarity? what so strange,
That manifold record not matches?*

Pain. See!

Poet. *Magick of—bounty, &c.*

It may not be improperly observed here, that as there is only one copy of this play, no help can be had from collation, and more liberty must be allowed to conjecture.

I.i.10 (272,4) breath'd as it were/ To an untirable and continue good-
ness] *Breathed is inured by constant practice*; so trained as not to be wearied. To *breathe* a horse, is to exercise him for the course.

I.i.20 (273,8) *Poet.*

A thing slipt idly from me.

Our poesy is as a gum, which oozes
From whence 'tis nourished. The fire i' the flint
Shews not, 'till it be struck: our gentle flame
Provokes itself, and, like the current flies
Each bound it chafes. What have you there!]

This speech of the poet is very obscure. He seems to boast the copiousness and facility of his vein, by declaring that verses drop from a poet as gums from odoriferous trees, and that his flame kindles itself without the violence necessary to elicit sparkles from the flint. What follows next? that it, *like a current, flies each bound it chafes*. This may mean, that it expands itself notwithstanding all obstructions: but the images in the comparison are so ill-sorted, and the effect so obscurely expressed, that I cannot but think something omitted that connected

the last sentence with the former. It is well known that the players often shorten speeches to quicken the representation; and it may be suspected, that they sometimes performed their amputations with more haste than judgment, (see 1765, VI, 169, 6)

I.i.27 (274,9) *Poet.* Upon the heels of my presentment, sir.] As soon as my book has been presented to lord Timon.

I.i.29 (274,1) This comes off well and excellent] [By this we are to understand what the painters call the *goings off* of a picture, which requires the nicest execution. WARBURTON.] The note I understand less than the text. The meaning is, This figure rises well from the canvas. *C'est bien relevé.*

I.i.37 (275,3) artificial strife] *Strife* is either the contest or act with nature.

Hic ille est Raphael, timuit, quo aospite vinci

Rerum magna parens, & moriente, mori.

Or it is the contrast of forms or opposition of colours.

I.i.43 (275,4) this confluence, this great flood of visitors] *Mane salutantum totis vomit aedibus undam.*

I.1.46 (275,5) Halts not particularly] My design does not stop at any single characters.

I.1.47 (276,7)

no level'd malice

Infests one comma in the course I hold;

But flies an eagle-flight, bold, and forth on,

Leaving no tract behind]

To *level* is to *aim*, to point the shot at a mark. Shakespeare's meaning is, my poem is not a satire written with any particular view, or *levelled* at any single person; I fly like an eagle into the general expanse of life, and leave not, by any private mischief, the trace of my passage.

I.i.51 (276,8) I'll unbolt] I'll open, I'll explain.

I.i.53 (276,9) glib and slippery creatures] Hanmer, and Warburton after him, read, *natures*. *Slippery* is *smooth*, unresisting.

I.i.58 (276,1) glass-fac'd flatterer] That shows in his own look, as by reflection, the looks of his patron.

I.i.65 (277,3) rank'd with all deserts] *Cover'd with ranks* of all kinds of men.

I.i.67 (277,4) To propagate their states] To advance or improve their various conditions of life.

I.i.72 (277,5) conceiv'd to scope] Properly imagined, appositely, to the purpose.

I.i.82 (278,8) through him/ Drink the free air] That is, catch his breath in affected fondness.

I.i.90 (278,9) A thousand moral paintings I can shew] Shakespeare seems to intend in this dialogue to express some competition between the two great arts of imitation. Whatever the poet declares himself to have shewn, the painter thinks he could have shewn better. (1773)

I.i.107 (279,1) 'Tis not enough to help the feeble up,/ But to support him after] This thought is better expressed by Dr. Madden in his elegy on archbishop Boulter.

—*He thought it mean*

Only to help the poor to beg again.

I.i.129 (280,2) Therefore he will be, Timon] I rather think an emendation necessary, and read,

Therefore well be him, Timon.

His honesty rewards him in itself.

That is, *If he in honest, bene fit illi, I wish him the proper happiness of an honest man, but his honesty gives him no claim to my daughter.*

The first transcriber probably wrote *will be him*, which the next, not understanding, changed to, *he will be*. (1773)

I.i.149 (281,3)

never may

That state, or fortune, fall into my keeping,

Which is not ow'd to you!]

The meaning is, let me never henceforth consider any thing that I possess, but as *owed* or *due* to you; held for your service, and at your disposal.

I.i.159 (281,4) pencil'd figures are/ Even such as they give out] Pictures have no hypocrisy; they are what they profess to be.

I.i.165 (282,5) unclaw me quite] To *unclaw*, is to *unwind* a ball of thread. To *unclaw* a man, is to draw out the whole mass of his fortunes.

I.i.171 (282,5) Are prized by their masters] Are rated according to the, esteem in which their possessor is held.

I.i.178 (282,8)

Tim. Good-morrow to thee, gentle Apemantua!

Apam. 'Till I be gentle, stay for thy good-morrow.

When thou art Timon's dog, and these knaves honest,—]

[Warburton conjectured a line lost and added one of his own making] I think my punctuation may clear the passage without any greater effort.

I.i.180 (283,9) Then thou art Timon's dog] When thou hast gotten a better character, and instead of being Timon, as thou art, shalt be changed to Timon's dog, and become more worth; of kindness and salutation. (1773)

I.i.241 (284,9) That I had no angry wit to be a lord] [W: so hungry a wit] The meaning may be, I should hate myself for *patiently enduring to be a lord*. This is ill enough expressed. Perhaps some happy change may set it right. I have tried, and can do nothing, yet I cannot heartily concur with Dr. Warburton.

I.i.259 (286,2) The strain of man's bred out/ Into baboon and monkey] Man is exhausted and degenerated; his *strain* or lineage is worn down into monkey.

I.ii.12 (288,5)

If our betters play at that game, we must not dare

To imitate them. Faults that are rich, are fair]

[Warburton gave the second line to Apemantus] I cannot see that these lines are more proper in any other mouth than Timon's, to whose character of generosity and condescension they are very suitable. To suppose that by *our betters* are meant the Gods, is very harsh, because to imitate the Gods has been hitherto reckoned the highest pitch of human virtue. The whole is a trite and obvious thought, uttered by Timon with a kind of affected modesty. If I would make any alteration, it should be only to reform the numbers thus:

Our betters play that game; we must not dare

T' imitate then; faults that are rich are fair.

I.ii.34 (289,6) thou art an Athenian,/Therefore welcome: I myself would have no power] If this be the true reading, the sense is, *all Athenians are welcome to share my fortune*; I would myself have no *exclusive right or power in this house*. Perhaps we might read, *I myself would have no poor*. I would have every Athenian consider himself as joint possessor of my fortune.

I.ii.38 (289,7) I scorn thy meat, 'twould choke me, for I should/ Ne'er flatter thee] [W: 'fore/I should e'er] Of this emendation there is little need. The meaning is, I could not swallow thy meat, for I could not pay for it with flattery; and what was given me with an ill will would stick in my throat.

I.ii.41 (290,8) so many dip their meat/In one man's blood] The allusion is to a pack of hounds trained to pursuit by being gratified with the blood of the animal which they kill, and the wonder is that the animal on which they are feeding *cheers them* to the chase.

I.ii.52 (290,9) wind-pipe's dangerous notes] The notes of the wind-pipe seem to be the only indications which shew where the windpipe is. (see 1765, VI, 184, 4)

I.ii.54 (290,1) My lord, in heart] That is, *my lord's health with sincerity*. An emendation has been proposed thus:

My love in heart;—

but it is not necessary.

I.ii.89 (292,2) we should think ourselves for ever perfect] That is, arrived at the perfection of happiness.

I.ii.94 (292,4) did not you chiefly belong to my heart?] I think it should be inverted thus: *did I not chiefly belong to your hearts*. Laciws wishes that Timon would give him and the rest an opportunity of *expressing some part of their zeals*. Timon answers that, *doubtless the Gods have provided that I should have help from you; how else are you my friends?* why are you stiled my friends, if—what? *if I do not love you*. Such is the present reading; but the consequence is not very clear; the proper close must be, *if you do not love me*, and to this my alteration restores it. But, perhaps, the old reading may stand. [The *Revisal's* note on this line is quoted.] The meaning is probably this. Why are you distinguished from thousands by that title of endearment, was there not

a particular connection and intercourse of tenderness between you and me. (see 1765, VI, 185, 8)

I.ii.97 (293,5) I confirm you] I fix your characters firmly in my own mind.

I.ii.99 (293,7) O joy, e'en made away, ere it can be born!] For this Hanmer writes, *O joy, e'en made a joy ere't can be born*; and is followed by Dr. Warburton. I am always inclinable to think well of that which is approved by so much learning and sagacity, yet cannot receive this alteration. Tears being the effect both of joy and grief, supplied our author with an opportunity of conceit, which he seldom fails to indulge. Timon, weeping with a kind of tender pleasure, cries out, *O joy, e'en made away*, destroyed, turned to tears, before *it can be born*, before it can be fully possessed.

I.ii.110 (293,8) Mine eyes cannot hold water, methinks: to forget their faults, I drink to you] In the original edition the words stand thus: *mine eyes cannot hold out water, methinks. To forget their faults, I drink to you*. Perhaps the true reading is this, *Mine eyes cannot hold out; they water. Methinks, to forget their faults, I will drink to you*. Or it may be explained without any change. *Mine eyes cannot hold out water*, that is, cannot keep water from breaking in upon them, (see 1765, VI, 186, 2)

I.ii.113 (294,9) *Apem*. Thou weep'st to make them drink] Hanmer reads,

— *to make then drink thee*,

and is again followed by Dr. Warburton, I think without sufficient reason. The covert sense of Apemantus is, *what thou lovest, they get*.

I.ii.118 (294,1) like a babe] That is a *weeping babe*.

I.ii.138 (295,3)

They dance! They are mad women.

Like madness is the glory of this life,

As this pomp shews to a little oil and root]

[Warburton conjectured some lines lost after the second verse]

When I read this passage, I was at first of the same opinion with this learned man; but, upon longer consideration, I grew less confident, because I think the present reading susceptible of explanation, with no more violence to language than is frequently found in our author.

The glory of this life is very near to madness, as may be made appear from this pomp, exhibited in a place where a philosopher is feeding on oil and roots. When we see by example how few are the necessities of life, we learn what madness there is in so much superfluity.

I.ii.146 (296,5) who dies, that bears/ Not one spurn to their graves, of their friends gift?] That is, given them by their friends.(1773)

I.ii.155 (297,6) mine own device] The mask appears to have been design'd by Timon to surprise his guests.

I.ii.157 (297,7) *L Lady.* My lord, you take us even at the best] This answer seems rather to belong to one of the ladies. It was probably only mark'd *L* in the copy.

I.ii.169 (298,1) 'Tis pity, bounty has not eyes behind] To see the miseries that are following her.

I.ii.170 (298,2) That man might ne'er be wretched for his mind] For nobleness of soul.

I.ii.176 (298,3) to/ Advance this jewel] To prefer it; to raise it to honour by wearing it.

I.ii.230 (300,6)

all the lands thou hast

Lie in a pitch'd field.

Alc. I' defiled land, my lord]

This is the old reading, which apparently depends on a very low quibble. Alcibiades is told, that *his estate lies in a pitch'd field*. Now *pitch*, as Falstaff says, *doth defile*. Alcibiades therefore replies, that his estate lies *in defiled land*. This, as it happened, was not understood, and all the editors published,

I defy land, —

I.ii.237 (301,8) Serving of becks] [W: serring] The commentator conceives *beck* to mean the *mouth* or the *head*, after the French, *bec*, whereas it means a salutation made with the head. So Milton,

"Nods and *becks*, and wreathed smiles."

To *serve a beck*, is to offer a salutation.

I.ii.238 (301,9) I doubt, whether their legs] He plays upon the word *leg*, as it signifies a *limb* and a *bow* or *act of obeisance*.

I.ii.247 (302,1) I fear me, thou/Wilt give away thyself in paper shortly] [W: in proper] Hanmer reads very plausibly,
— *thou*

Wilt give away thyself in perpetuum.

I.ii.235 (302,2) I'll lock/ Thy heaven from thee] The pleasure of being flattered.

II.i.10 (304,5) No porter at his gate;/ But rather one that smiles, and still invites] I imagine that a line is lost here, in which the behaviour of a surly porter was described.

II.i.12 (304,6) no reason/ Can found his state in safety] The supposed meaning of this [Can sound his state] must be, *No reason*, by *sounding*, fathoming, or trying, *his state*, can find it *safe*. But as the words stand, they imply, that *no reason can safely sound his state*. I read thus,

— *no reason*

Can found his state in safety.—

Reason cannot find his fortune to have any *safe* or solid *foundation*.

The types of the first printer of this play were so worn and defaced, that *f* and *s* are not always to be distinguished.

II.ii.5 (305,9) Never mind/ Was to be so unwise, to be so kind] Of this mode of expression conversation affords many examples: "I was always to be blamed, whatever happened." "I am in the lottery, but I was always to draw blanks." (1773)

II.ii.9 (306,1) Good even, Varro] It is observable, that this *good evening* is before dinner; for Timon tells Alcibiades, that they will *go forth again as soon as dinner's done*, which may prove that by *dinner* our author meant not the *coena* of ancient times, but the mid-day's repast. I do not suppose the passage corrupt: such inadvertencies neither author nor editor can escape.

There is another remark to be made. Varro and Isidore sink a few lines afterwards into the servants of Varro and Isidore. Whether servants, in our author's time, took the names of their masters, I know not. Perhaps it is a slip of negligence.

II.ii.47 (308,4) *Enter Apemantus and a Fool*] I suspect some scene to be lost, in which the entrance of the fool, and the page that follows him, was prepared by some introductory dialogue, in which the audience was informed that they were the fool and page of Phrynia, Timandra,

or some other courtesan, upon the knowledge of which depends the greater part of the ensuing jocularity.

II.ii.60-66 (309,4) Poor rogues] This is said so abruptly, that I am inclined to think it misplaced, and would regulate the passage thus:

Caph. *Where's the fool now?*

Apem. *He last ask'd the question.*

All. *What are we, Apemantus?*

Apem. *Asses.*

All. *Why?*

Apem. *That you ask me what you are, and do not know yourselves.*

*Poor rogues', and usurers' men! bawds between
gold and want! Speak, &c.*

Thus every word will have its proper place. It is likely that the passage transposed was forgot in the copy, and inserted in the margin, perhaps a little beside the proper place, which the transcriber wanting either skill or care to observe, wrote it where it now stands.

II.ii.71 (309,5) She's e'en setting on water to scald] The old name for the disease got at Corinth was the *brenning*, and a sense of *scalding* is one of its first symptoms.

II.ii.117 (311,7) with two stones more than's artificial one] Meaning the celebrated philosopher's stone, which was in those times much talked of. Sir Thomas Smith was one of those who lost considerable sums in seeking of it.

II.ii.152 (312,9) Though you hear now, yet now's too late a time] [Warburton objected to this, an emendation by Hanmer] I think Hanmer right, and have received his emendation.

II.ii.155 (313,1) and at length/How goes our reckoning?] [W: Hold good our] It is common enough, and the commentator knows it is common to propose interrogatively, that of which neither the speaker nor the hearer has any doubt. The present reading may therefore stand.

II.ii.171 (314,2) a wasteful cock] [i.e. a *cockloft*, a garret. And a *wasteful cock*, signifies a garret lying in waste, neglected, put to no use. HANMER.] Hanmer's explanation is received by Dr. Warburton, yet I think them both apparently mistaken. A *wasteful cock* is a *cock* or pipe with a turning stopple *running to waste*. In this sense, both the terms have their usual meaning; but I know not that *cock* is ever used

for cockloft, or wasteful for *lying in waste*, or that lying in waste is at all a phrase.

II.ii.187 (314,4) And try the arguments] [*Arguments* for natures. *WARB.*] How *arguments* should stand for natures I do not see. But the licentiousness of our author forces us often upon far fetched expositions. *Arguments* may mean *contents*, as the *arguments* of a book; or for *evidences* and *proofs*.

II.ii.209 (315,5) I knew it the most general way] *General* is not speedy, but *compendious*, the way to try many at a time.

II.ii.219 (316,6) And so, intending other serious matters] *Intending* is *regarding*, *turning their notice* to other things.

II.ii.220 (316,7) these hard fractions] [Warburton saw an allusion to fractions in mathematics] This is, I think, no conceit in the head of Flavius, who, by *fractions*, means *broken hints*, *interrupted sentences*, *abrupt* remarks.

II.ii.221 (316,8) half-caps] A *half cap* is a *cap* slightly moved, not put off.

II.ii.241 (317,3) I would, I could not] The original edition has, *I would, I could not think it, that thought*, &c. It has been changed [‘Would], to mend the numbers, without authority.

II.ii.242 (317,4)

That thought is bounty’s foe;
Being free itself, it thinks all other so]
Free, is *liberal*, not parsimonious.

III.i.57 (319,6) Has friendship such a faint and milky heart, It turns in less than two nights?] Alluding to the *turning* or *acescence* of milk.

III.ii.3 (320,3) We know him for no less] That is, *we know him* by report to be *no less* than you represent him, though we are strangers to his person.

III.ii.24 (321,5) yet had he mistook him, and sent him to me] [W: mislook’d] I rather read, *yet had he not mistook him, and sent to me*.

III.ii.45 (322,7) If his occasion were not virtuous] [*Virtuous*, for strong, forcible, pressing. *WARBURTON.*] The meaning may more naturally be;—If he did not want it for a good use. (1773)

III.ii.51 (322,9) that I should purchase the day before for a little part, and undo a great deal of honour?] [T: a little dirt] This emendation is received, like all others, by sir T. Hanmer, but neglected by Dr. Warburton. I think Theobald right in suspecting a corruption; nor is his emendation injudicious, though perhaps we may better read, *purchase the day before for a little park*.

III.ii.71 (323,1) And just of the same piece is every flatterer's soul] This is Dr. Warburton's emendation. The other editions read,

Why this is the world's soul;

Of the same piece is every flatterer's sport.

Mr. Upton has not unluckily transposed the two final words, thus, *Why, this is the world's sport:*

Of the same piece is ev'ry flatterer's soul.

The passage is not so obscure as to provoke so much enquiry. *This*, says he, *is the soul or spirit of the world: every flatterer* plays the same game, makes *sport* with the confidence of his friend. (see 1765, VI, 211, 4)

III.ii.81 (324,2) He does deny him, in respect of his, What charitable men afford to beggars] That is, *in respect of his* fortune, what Lucius denies to Timon is in proportion to what Lucius possesses, less than the usual alms given by good men to beggars.

III.ii.90 (324,3) I would have put my wealth into donation, And the best half should ha' return'd to him] Hanmer reads,

I would have put my wealth into partition,

And the best half should have attorn'd to him.

Dr. Warbarton receives *attorn'd*. The only difficulty is in the word *return'd*, which, since he had received nothing from him, cannot be used but in a very low and licentious meaning, (see 1765, VI, 212, 6)

III.iii.5 (325,4) They have all been touch'd] That is, *tried*, alluding to the *touchstone*.

III.iii.11 (325,5) His friends, like physicians, / Thrive, give him over?] The original reading is,

—his friends, (*like physicians*)

Thrive, give him over?

which Theobald has misrepresented. Hanmer reads, *try'd*, plausibly enough. Instead of *three* proposed by Mr. Pope, I should read *thrice*. But perhaps the old reading is the true.

III.iii.24 (326,6) I had such a courage] Such an ardour, such an eager desire.

III.iii.28 (326,8) The devil knew not what he did] I cannot but think that, the negative *not* has intruded into this passage, and the reader will think so too, when he reads Dr. Warburton's explanation of the next words.

III.iii.28 (326,9) The devil knew not what he did, when he made men politick; he cross'd himself by't: and I cannot think, but in the end the villainies of man will set him clear] [*Set him clear* does not mean acquit him before heaven; for then *the devil* must be supposed to know what he did: but it signifies puzzle him, outdo him at his own weapons. WARBURTON.] How the devil, or any other being, should be *set clear* by being *puzzled* and *outdone*, the commentator has not explained. When in a crowd we would have an opening made, we say, *Stand clear*, that is, *out of the way of danger*. With some affinity to this use, though not without great harshness, to *set clear*, may be to *set aside*. But I believe the original corruption is the insertion of the negative, which was obtruded by some transcriber, who supposed *crossed* to mean *thwarted*, when it meant, *exempted from evil*. The use of *crossing*, by way of protection or purification, was probably not worn out in Shakespeare's time. The sense of *set clear* is now easy; he has no longer the guilt of tempting man. To cross himself may mean, in a very familiar sense, *to clear his score, to get out of debt, to quit his reckoning*. He knew not *what he did*, may mean, he knew not how much good he was doing himself. There is then no need of emendation. (1773)

III.iii.42 (327,2) keep his house] i.e. keep within doors for fear of duns.

III.iv (328,3) Enter Varro, Titus, Hortense, Lucius] Lucius is here again for the servant of Lucius.

III.iv.12 (328,4) a prodigal's course/Is like the sun's] That is, like him in blaze and splendour.

Soles occidere et redire possunt. Catul.

III.iv.25 (329,5) I am weary of this charge] That is, of this *commission*, of this *employment*.

III.iv.32 (329,6) Else, surely, his had equall'd] Should it not be, *else, surely, mine had equall'd*.

III.iv.67 (330,7) *Enter Servilius*] It may be observed that Shakespeare has unskilfully filled his Greek story with Roman names.

III.v.14 (333,6)

He is a man, setting his fate aside,
Of comely virtues:
Nor did he soil the fact with cowardise;
(An honour in him which buys out his fault)]

I have printed these lines after the original copy, except that, for *an honour*, it is there, *and honour*. All the latter editions deviate unwarrantably from the original, and give the lines thus:

*He is a man, setting his fault aside,
Of virtuous honour, which buys out his fault;
Nor did he soil, &c.*

III.v.22 (333,3)

He did behave, his anger ere 'twas spent,
As if he had but prov'd an argument]

The original copy reads not *behave* but *behoove*. I do not well understand the passage in either reading. Shall we try a daring conjecture?

*—with such sober and unnoted passion
He did behold his adversary shent,
As if he had but prov'd an argument.*

He looked with such calmness on his slain adversary. I do not suppose that this is right, but put it down for want of better. (1773)

III.v.24 (334,4) You undergo too strict a paradox] You undertake a paradox too *hard*.

III.v.32 (334,5) and make his wrongs His outsides: to wear them like an argument, carelessly. We outside wear; hang like his] The present reading is better.

III.v.46 (335,6) What make we/ Abroad?] *What do we, or what have we to do in the field.*

III.v.46 (335,7)

what make we
Abroad? why then, women are more valiant,
That stay at home, if bearing carry it;

The ass, more than the lion; and the fellow,
 Loaden with irons, wiser than the judge,
 If wisdom be in suffering]
 Here is another arbitrary regulation, the original reads thus,
what make we
Abroad, why then women are more valiant
That stay at home, if bearing carry it:
And the ass more captain than the lion,
The fellow, loaden with irons, wiser than the judge,
If wisdom, &c.
 I think it may be better adjusted thus:
what make we
Abroad, why then the women are more valiant
That stay at home;
If bearing carry it, than is the ass
More captain than the lion, and the felon
Loaden with irons, wiser than the judge,
If wisdom, &c.

III.v.54 (336,8) sin's extreamest gust] *Gust* is here in its common sense; the utmost degree of *appetite* for sin.

III.v.55 (336,9) by mercy, 'tis most just] [By *mercy* is meant *equity*. WARBURTON] *Mercy* is not put for *equity*. If such explanation be allowed, what can be difficult? The meaning is, *I call mercy herself* to witness, that defensive violence is just.

III.v.68 (338,2) a sworn rioter] A *sworn rioter* is a man who practises riot, as if he had by an oath made it his duty.

III.v.80 (337,3) your reverend ages love/Security] He charges them obliquely with being usurers.

III.v.96 (337,5) Do you dare our anger?/'Tis in few words, but spacious in effect] This reading may pass, but perhaps the author wrote,
our anger?
'Tis few in words, but spacious in effect.

III.v.114 (338,7)
 I'll cheer up
 My discontented troops, and play for hearts.
 'Tis honour with most hands to be at odds]

[Warburton had substituted "hands" for "lands"] I think *hands* is very properly substituted for *lands*. In the foregoing line, for, *lay for hearts*, I would read, *play for hearts*.

III.vi.4 (339,7) Upon that were my thoughts tiring] A hawk, I think, is said to *tire*, when she amuses herself with pecking a pheasant's wing, or any thing that puts her in mind of prey. To *tire* upon a thing, is therefore, to be *idly employed upon it*.

III.vi.100 (342,9) Is your perfection] Your *perfection*, is the *highest of your excellence*.

III.vi.101 (342,1) and spangled you with flatteries] [W: with your] The present reading is right.

III.vi.106 (342,2) time-flies] Flies of a season.

III.vi. 107 (342,5) minute-jacks!] Hanmer thinks it means *Jack-a-lantern*, which shines and disappears in an instant. What it was I know not; but it was something of quick motion, mentioned in Richard III.

III.vi.108 (342,4) the infinite malady] Every kind of disease incident to man and beast.

IV.i.19 (344,6)

Degrees, observances, customs and laws,
Decline to your confounding contraries,
And yet confusion live!]

Hanmer reads, *let* confusion; but the meaning may be, *though by such confusion all things seem to hasten to dissolution, yet let not dissolution come, but the miseries of confusion continue*.

IV.ii (345,1) Enter Flavius] Nothing contributes more to the exaltation of Timon's character than the zeal and fidelity of his servants. Nothing but real virtue can be honoured by domesticks; nothing but impartial kindness can gain affection from dependants.

IV.ii.10 (345,2) So his familiars from his buried fortunes/Slink all away] The old copies have *to* instead of *from*. The correction is Hanmer's; but the old reading might stand (see 1765, VI, 231, 2)

IV.ii.38 (346,4) strange unusual blood] Of this passage, I suppose, every reader would wish for a correction; but the word, harsh as it is, stands fortified by the rhyme, to which, perhaps, it owes its introduction. I know not what to propose. Perhaps,

—*strange unusual mood*,
may, by some, be thought better, and by others worse.

IV.iii.1 (347,5) O blessed, breeding sun] [W: blessing breeding] I do not see that this emendation much strengthens the sense.

IV.iii.2 (347,6) thy sister's orb] That is, the moon's, this *sublunary* world.

IV.iii.6 (348,7) Not nature,/To whom all sores lay siege] I have preserved this note rather for the sake of the commentator [Warburton] than of the author. How *nature, to whom all sores lay siege*, can so emphatically express *nature in its greatest perfection*, I shall not endeavour to explain. The meaning I take to be this: *Brother, when his fortune is enlarged, will scorn brother*; for this is the general depravity of human nature, which, *besieged as it is by misery*, admonished as it is of want and imperfection, when *elevated by fortune*, will despise beings of *nature like its own*.

IV.iii.12 (349,9) It is the pastor lards the brother's sides,/The want that makes him leave] [W: weather's sides] This passage is very obscure, nor do I discover any clear sense, even though we should admit the emendation. Let us inspect the text as I have given it from the original edition,

It is the pastour lards the brother's sides,
The want that makes him leave.

Dr. Warburton found the passage already changed thus,
It is the pasture lards the beggar's sides,
The want that makes him lean.

And upon this reading of no authority, raised another equally uncertain.

Alterations are never to be made without necessity. Let us see what sense the genuine reading will afford. Poverty, says the poet, *bears contempt hereditary*, and *wealth native honour*. To illustrate this position, having already mentioned the case of a poor and rich brother, he remarks, that this preference is given to wealth by those whom it least becomes; *it is the pastour that greases or flatters the rich brother*,

and will grease him on till *want makes him leave*. The poet then goes on to ask, *Who dares to say this man, this pastour, is a flatterer*; the crime is universal; through all the world *the learned pate*, with allusion to the pastour, *ducks to the golden fool*. If it be objected, as it may justly be, that the mention of pastour is unsuitable, we must remember the mention of *grace* and *cherubims* in this play, and many such anachronisms in many others. I would therefore read thus:

*It is the pastour lards the brother's sides,
'Tis want that makes him leave.*

The obscurity is still great. Perhaps a line is lost. I have at least given the original reading.

IV.iii.27 (350,2) no idle votarist] No insincere or inconstant suppliant. *Gold* will not serve me instead of *roots*.

IV.iii.38 (351,5) That makes the wappen'd widow wed again] Of *wap-pened* I have found no example, nor know any meaning. To *awhape* is used by Spenser in his *Hubberd's Tale*, but I think not in either of the senses mentioned. I would read *wained*, for *decayed by time*. So our author in *Richard the Third*, *A beauty-waining and distressed widow*.

IV.iii.41 (352,6) To the April day again] That is, *to the wedding day*, called by the poet, satirically, *April day*, or *fool's day*.

IV.iii.44 (352,7) Do thy right nature] Lie in the earth where nature laid thee.

IV.iii.44 (352,8) Thou'rt quick] Thou hast life and motion in thee.

IV.iii.64 (353,9) I will not kiss thee] This alludes to an opinion in former times, generally prevalent, that the venereal infection transmitted to another, left the infector free. I will not, says Timon, take the rot from thy lips by kissing thee.

IV.iii.72 (353,1)

Tim. Promise me friendship, but perform none. If
Thou wilt not promise, the Gods plague thee, for
Thou art a man; if thou dost perform, confound thee,
For thou art a man!]

That is, however thou may'st act, since thou art man, hated man, I wish thee evil.

IV.iii.82 (354,2)

Be a whore still! They love thee not that use thee;
 Give them diseases, leaving with thee their lust:
 Make use of thy salt hours]

There is here a slight transposition. I would read,
*— They love thee not that use thee,
 Leaving with thee their lust; give them diseases;
 Make use of thy salt hours; season the slaves
 For tubs and baths;—*

IV.iii.115 (356,6) milk-paps,/ That through the window-bars bore at
 mens' eyes] [W: window-lawn] The reading is more probably,
— window-bar,—

The virgin that shews her bosom through the lattice of her chamber.

IV.iii.119 (356,8) exhaust their mercy] For *exhaust*, sir T. Hanmer, and
 after him Dr. Warburton, read *extort*; but *exhaust* here signifies literally
 to *draw forth*.

IV.iii.120 (356,7)

Think it a bastard, whom the oracle
 Hath doubtfully prunounc'd thy throat shall cut]
 An allusion to the tale of OEdipus.

IV.iii.134 (357,8) And to make whores a bawd] [W: make whole] The
 old edition reads,

And to make whores a bawd.

That is, *enough to make a whore leave whoring, and a bawd leave making
 whores.*

IV.iii.139 (357,9) I'll trust to your conditions] You need not swear to
 continue whores, I will trust to your inclinations.

IV.iii.140 (358,1) Yet may your pains, six months,/ Be quite contrary]
 The explanation [Warburton's] is ingenious, but I think it very remote,
 and would willingly bring the author and his readers to meet
 on easier terms. We may read,

*— Yet may your pains six months
 Be quite contraried.—*

Timon is wishing ill to mankind, but is afraid lest the whores
 should imagine that he wishes well to them; to obviate which he

lets them know, that he imprecates upon them influence enough to plague others, and disappointments enough to plague themselves. He wishes that they may do all possible mischief, and yet take *pains six months* of the year in vain.

In this sense there is a connection of this line with the next. Finding *your pains contraried*, try new expedients, *thatch your thin roofs*, and *paint*.

To *contrary* is an old verb. Latymer relates, that when he went to court, he was advised not to *contrary* the king.

IV.iii.153 (359,3) mens' spurring] Hanmer reads *sparring*, properly enough, if there be any ancient example of the word.

IV.iii.158 (359,5)

take the bridge quite away

Of him, that his particular to foresee

Smells from the general weal]

[W: to forefend] The metaphor is apparently incongruous, but the sense is good. To *foresee his particular*, is to *provide for his private advantage*, for which *he leaves the right scent of publick good*. In hunting, when hares have cross'd one another, it is common for some of the hounds to *smell from the general weal*, and *foresee their own particular*. Shakespeare, who seems to have been a skilful sportsman, and has alluded often to falconry, perhaps, alludes here to hunting.

To the commentator's emendation it may be objected, that he used *forefend* in the wrong meaning. To *forefend*, is, I think, never to *provide for*, but to *provide against*. The verbs compounded with *for* or *fore* have commonly either an evil or negative sense.

IV.iii.182 (361,8) eyeless venom'd worm] The serpent, which we, from the smallness of his eyes, call the *blind worm*, and the Latins, *caecilia*.

IV.iii.183 (361,9) below crisp heaven] [W: cript] Mr. Upton declares for *crisp*, curled, bent, hollow.

IV.iii.188 (361,1) Let it no more bring out ingrateful man!] [W: out to ungrateful] It is plain that *bring out* is *bring forth*, with which the following lines correspond so plainly, that the commentator might be suspected of writing his note without reading the whole passage.

IV.iii.193 (362,2) Dry up thy marrows, vines, and plough torn leas] I cannot concur to censure Theobald [as Warburton did] as a *critic* very *unhappy*. He was weak, but he was cautious: finding but little power in his mind, he rarely ventured far under its conduct. This timidity hindered him from daring conjectures, and sometimes hindered him happily.

This passage, among many others, may pass without change. The genuine reading is not *marrows*, *veins*, but *marrows*, vines: the sense is this; *O nature! cease to produce men, enseat thy womb*; but if thou wilt continue to produce them, at least cease to pamper them; *dry up thy marrows*, on which they fatten with *unctuous morsels*, thy *vines*, which give them *liquorish draughts*, and thy *plow-torn leas*. Here are effects corresponding with causes, *liquorish draughts* with *vines*, and *unctuous morsels* with *marrows*, and the old reading literally preserved.

IV.iii.209 (363,3) the cunning of a carper] *Cunning* here seems to signify *counterfeit appearance*.

IV.ii.223 (364,4) moist trees] Hanmer reads very elegantly,
—moss'd trees.

IV.iii.37 (364,5)

Tim. Always a villain's office, or a fool's.

Dost please thyself in't?

Apem. Ay.

Tim. What! a knave too?]

Such was Dr. Warburton's first conjecture [“and know't too”], but afterwards he adopted Sir T. Hanmer's conjecture,

What a knave thou!

but there is no need of alteration. Timon had just called Apemantus *fool*, in consequence of what he had known of him by former acquaintance; but when Apemantus tells him, that he comes to *vex him*, Timon determines that to *vex* is either *the office of a villain or a fool*; that to *vex by design* is *villainy*, to *vex without design* is *folly*. He then properly asks Apemantus whether he takes delight in *vexing*, and when he answers, *yes*, Timon replies, *What! and knave too?* I before only knew thee to be a *fool*, but I now find thee likewise a *knave*. This seems to be so clear as not to stand in need of a comment.

IV.iii.242 (365,6) Willing misery/Out-lives incertain pomp; is crown'd before] Arrives sooner at *high wish*; that is, at the *completion of its wishes*.

IV.iii.247 (365,7) Worse than the worst, content] Best states contentless have a wretched being, a being worse than that of the worst states that are content. This one would think too plain to have been mistaken. (1773)

IV.iii.249 (365,8) by his breath] It means, I believe, by his *counsel*, by his *direction*.

IV. iii. 252 (366,1) Hadst thou, like us] There is in this speech a sullen haughtiness, and malignant dignity, suitable at once to the lord and the man-hater. The impatience with which he bears to have his luxury reproached by one that never had luxury within his reach, is natural and graceful.

There is in a letter, written by the earl of Essex, just before his execution, to another nobleman, a passage somewhat resembling this, with which, I believe every reader will be pleased, though it is so serious and solemn that it can scarcely be inserted without irreverence.

"God grant your lordship may quickly feel the comfort I now enjoy in my unfettered conversion, but that you may never feel the torments I have suffered for my long delaying it. *I had none but deceivers to call upon me, to whom I said, if my ambition could have entered into their narrow breasts, they would not have been so precise. But your lordship hath one to call upon you, that knoweth what it is you now enjoy; and what the greatest fruit and end is of all contentment that this world can afford.* Think, therefore, dear earl, that I have staked and buoyed all the ways of pleasure unto you, and left them as sea-marks for you to keep the channel of religious virtue. For shut your eyes never so long, they must be open at the last, and then you must say with me, *there is no peace to the ungodly.*"

IV.iii.252 (366,2) from our first swath] From infancy. *Swath* is the dress of a new-born child.

IV.iii.258 (366,3) precepts of respect] Of obedience to laws.

IV.iii.259 (366,4) But myself] The connection here requires some attention. *But* is here used to denote opposition; but what immediately precedes is not opposed to that which follows. The adversative particle refers to the two first lines.

*Thou art a slave, whom fortune's tender arm
With favour never claspt; but bred a dog.
— But myself,
Who had the world as my confectionary, &c.*

The intermediate lines are to be considered as a parenthesis of passion.

IV.iii.271 (367,5) If thou wilt curse, thy father, that poor rag,/ Must be thy subject] If we read *poor rogue*, it will correspond rather better to what follows.

IV.iii.276 (367,6) Thou hadst been knave and flatterer] Dryden has quoted two verses of Virgil to shew how well he could have written satires. Shakespeare has here given a specimen of the same power by a line bitter beyond all bitterness, in which Timon tells Apemantus, that he had not virtue enough for the vices which he condemns.

Dr. Warburton explains *worst* by *lowest*, which somewhat weakens the sense, and yet leaves it sufficiently vigorous.

I have heard Mr. Bourke commend the subtilty of discrimination with which Shakespeare distinguishes the present character of Timon from that of Apemantus, whom to vulgar eyes he would now resemble. (see 1763, VI, 249, 6) (rev. 1778, VIII, 424, 4)

IV.iii.308 (369,8) Ay, though it look like thee] Timon here supposes that an objection against hatred, which through the whole tenor of the conversation appears an argument for it. One would have expected him to have answered,

Yes, for it looks like thee.

The old edition, which always gives the pronoun instead of the affirmative particle, has it,

I, though it look like thee.

Perhaps we should read,

I thought it look'd like thee.

IV.iii.363 (371,2) Thou art the cap] i.e. the property, the bubble. **WARBURTON.**] I rather think, the *top*, the *principal*.

The remaining dialogue has more malignity than wit.

IV.iii.383 (372,4) 'Twixt natural, son and sire!']

[Greek: *dia touton ouk adelphoi*

dia touton ou toxaeas. ANAC.]

IV.iii.398 (373,6) More things like men?] This line, in the old edition, is given to Aremantus, but it apparently belongs to Timon. Hanmer has transposed the foregoing dialogue according to his own mind, not unskilfully, but with unwarrantable licence.

IV.iii.419 (373,7) you want much of meat] [T: of meet] Such is Mr. Theobald's emendation, in which he is followed by Dr. Warburton. Sir T. Hanmer reads,

—*you want much of men.*

They have been all busy without necessity. Observe the series of the conversation. The thieves tell him, that they are *men that much do want*. Here is an ambiguity between *much want* and *want of much*. Timon takes it on the wrong side, and tells them that their *greatest want is*, that, like other men, *they want much of meat*; then telling them where meat may be had, he asks, *Want? why want?* (see 1765, VI, 254, 5)

IV.iii.420 (374,8) the earth hath roots;/ Within this mile break forth an hundred springs]

Vile plus, et duris haerentia mora rubetis

Pugnantis stomachi composuere famen:

Flumine vicino stultus sitit.

I do not suppose these to be imitations, but only to be similar thoughts on similar occasions.

IV.iii.442 (375,2) The sea's a thief, whose liquid surge resolves/ The moon into salt tears] [W: The mounds] I am not willing to receive *mounds*, which would not be understood but by him that suggested it. The *moon* is supposed to be humid, and perhaps a source of humidity, but cannot be *resolved* by the *surges* of the sea. Yet I think *moon* is the true reading. Here is a circulation of thievery described: The sun, moon, and sea all rob, and are robbed.

IV.iii.456 (376,3) 'Tis in the malice of mankind, that he thus advises us; not to have us thrive in our mystery] [Hanmer: his malice to] Hanmer's emendation, though not necessary, is very probable, and very unjustly charged with nonsense [by Warburton]. The reason of his advice, says the thief, is *malice to mankind*, not any kindness to us, or desire *to have us thrive in our mystery*.

IV.iii.468 (378,5) What an alteration of honour has/ Desperate want made!] [W: of humour] The original copy has,

What an alteration of honour has desperate want made!

The present reading is certainly better, but it has no authority. To change *honour* to *humour* is not necessary. *An alteration of honour*, is an *alteration* of an *honourable state* to a state of disgrace.

IV.iii.474 (378,8)

Grant, I may ever love, and rather woe

Those that would mischief me, than those that do!]

[W: rather too/ ...that woo] In defiance of this criticism, I have ventured to replace the former reading, as more suitable to the general spirit of these scenes, and as free from the absurdities charged upon it. It is plain, that in this whole speech *friends* and *enemies* are taken only for those who *profess friendship* and *profess enmity*; for the *friend* is supposed not to be more kind, but more dangerous than the *enemy*. In the amendment, *those that would mischief* are placed in opposition to *those that woo*, but in the speaker's intention *those that woo* are *those that mischief* most. The sense is, *Let me rather woo or caress those that would mischief, that profess to mean me mischief, than those that really do me mischief under false professions of kindness*. The Spaniards, I think, have this proverb; *Defend me from my friends, and from my enemies I will defend myself*. This proverb is a sufficient comment on the passage.

IV.iii.484 (379,9) all/I kept were knaves, to serve in meat to villains] *Knave* is here in the compounded sense of a *servant* and a *rascal*.

IV.iii.492 (379,1) Pity's sleeping] I do not know that any correction is necessary, but I think we might read,

—*eyes do never give*

But thorough lust and laughter, pity sleeping.

Eyes never flow (to *give* is to dissolve as saline bodies in moist weather) *but by lust or laughter*, undisturbed by emotions of *pity*.

IV.iii.499 (380,2) It almost turns my dangerous nature wild] [W: mild] This emendation is specious, but even this may be controverted. To *turn wild* is to *distract*. An appearance so unexpected, says Timon, *almost turns my savageness* to distraction. Accordingly he examines with nicety lest his phrenzy, should deceive him,

Let me behold thy face. Surely this man

Was born of woman.

And to this suspected disorder of mind he alludes,
Perpetual, sober, Gods!—

Ye powers whose intellects are out of the reach of perturbation.

IV.iii.533 (381,3) thou shalt build from men] Away from human habitations.

V.i (382,5) *Enter Poet and Painter*] The poet and the painter were within view when Apemantus parted from Timon, and might then have seen Timon, since Apemantus, standing by him could not see them: But the scenes of the thieves and steward have passed before their arrival, and yet passed, as the drama is now conducted within their view. It might be suspected that some scenes are transposed, for all these difficulties would be removed by introducing the poet and painter first, and the thieves in this place. Yet I am afraid the scenes must keep their present order; for the painter alludes to the thieves when he says, *he likewise enriched poor straggling soldiers with great quantity*. This impropriety is now heightened by placing the thieves in one act, and the poet and painter in another: but it must be remembered, that in the original edition this play is not divided into separate acts, so that the present distribution is arbitrary, and may be changed if any convenience can be gained, or impropriety obviated by alteration.

V.i.47 (384,6) While the day serves, before black-corner'd night]
 [W: black-cornette] *Black-corner'd night* is probably corrupt, but *black-cornette* can hardly be right, for it should be *black-cornetted night*. I cannot propose any thing, but must leave the place in its present state. (1773)

V.i.101 (386,8) a made-up villain] That is a villain that adopts qualities and characters not properly belonging to him; a hypocrite.

V.i.105 (386,9) drown them in a draught] That is, *in the jakes*.

V.i.109 (388,1)

But two in company —

Each man apart, all single and alone,

Yet an arch villain keeps him company]

This passage is obscure. I think the meaning is this: *but two in company*, that is, stand apart, *let only two be together*; for even when each stands single there are two, he himself and a villain.

V.i.151 (388,3) Of its own fall] [The Oxford editor alters *fall* to *fault*, not knowing that Shakespeare uses *fall* to signify dishonour, not destruction. So in *Hamlet*,

What a falling off was there! Warburton.]

The truth is, that neither *fall* means *disgrace*, nor is *fault* a necessary emendation. *Falling off* in the quotation is not *disgrace* but *defection*. The Athenians *had sense*, that is, felt the danger of *their own fall*, by the arms of Alcibiades.

V.i.151 (388,4) restraining aid to Timon] I think it should be *refraining aid*, that is, with-holding aid that should have been given to Timon.

V.i.154 (389,5) Than their offence can weigh down by the dram] This which was in the former editions can scarcely be right, and yet I know not whether my reading will be thought to rectify it. I take the meaning to be, We will give thee a recompence that our offences cannot outweigh, *heaps of wealth down by the dram*, or delivered according to the exactest measure. A little disorder may perhaps have happened in transcribing, which may be reformed by reading,

— Ay, ev'n such heaps

And sums of love and wealth, down by the dram,

As shall to thee —

V.i.165 (389,6) Allow'd with absolute power] *Allowed* is *licensed, privileged, uncontrolled*. So of a buffoon, in *Love's Labour lost*, it is said, that he is *allowed*, that is, at liberty to say what he will, a privileged scoffer.

V.i.139 (390,7) My long sickness/ Of health and living now begins to mend] The disease of life begins to promise me a period.

V.i.211 (391,8) in the sequence of degree] Methodically, from highest to lowest.

V.iii.4 (393,2) Some beast read this; here does not live a man] [W: rear'd] Notwithstanding this remark, I believe the old reading to be the right. *The soldier had only seen the rude heap of earth*. He had evidently seen something that told him *Timon was dead*; and what could tell that but his tomb? The tomb he sees, and the inscription upon it, which not being able to read, and finding none to read it for him, he exclaims peevishly, *some beast read this*, for it must be read, and in this place it cannot be read by man.

There is something elaborately unskilful in the contrivance of sending a soldier, who cannot read, to take the epitaph in wax, only that it may close the play by being read with more solemnity in the last scene.

V.iv.7 (394, 3) *traverst arms*] Arms across.

V.iv.8 (394,4) the time is flush] A bird is *flush* when his feathers are grown, and he can leave the nest. *Flush* is *mature*.

V.iv.18 (395,7)

So did we woo

Transformed Timon to our city's love,

By humble message, and by promis'd means]

[T: promis'd mends] Dr. Warburton agrees with Mr. Theobald, but the old reading may well stand.

V.iv.28 (395,8) Shame, that they wanted cunning, in excess/Hath broke their hearts] [Theobald had emended the punctuation] I have no wish to disturb the means of Theobald, yet think some emendation may be offered that will make the construction less harsh, and the sentence more serious. I read,

Shape that they wanted, coming in excess,

Hath broke their hearts.

Shame which they had so long wanted at last coming in its utmost excess.

V.iv.36 (396,8) not square] Not regular, not equitable.

V.iv.35 (397,9) uncharged ports] That is, *unguarded gates*.

V.iv.59 (397,1) not a man/Shall pass his quarter] Not a soldier shall quit his station, or be let loose upon you; and, if any commits violence, he shall answer it regularly to the law.

V.iv.76 (308.,3) our brain's flow; Hanmer and Dr. Warburton read,
—brine's flow,—

Our brain's flow is our tears; but we any read our brine's flow, our salt tears. Either will serve. (see 1765, VI, 276, 6)

(399) General Observation. The play of *Timon* is a domestic tragedy, and therefore strongly fastens on the attention of the reader. In the plan there is not much art, but the incidents are natural, and the characters various and exact. The catastrophe affords a very powerful

warning against that ostentations liberality, which scatters bounty, but confers no benefits, and buys flattery, but not friendship.

In this tragedy are many passages perplexed, obscure, and probably corrupt, which I have endeavoured to rectify, or explain, with due diligence; but having only one copy, cannot promise myself that my endeavours shall be much applauded.

TITUS ANDRONICUS

(403,1) It is observable, that this play is printed in the quarto of 1611, with exactness equal to that of the other books of those times. The first edition was probably corrected by the author, so that here is very little room for conjecture or emendation; and accordingly none of the editors have much molested this piece with officious criticism.

I.i.70 (406,2) Hail, Rome, victorious in thy mourning weeds!] [W: my] *Thy* is as well as *my*. We may suppose the Romans in a grateful ceremony, meeting the dead sons of Andronicus with mourning habits.

I.i.77 (407,3) Thou great defender of this Capitol] Jupiter, to whom the Capitol was sacred.

I.i.168 (410,5) And fame's eternal date for virtue's praise!] [W: In] To *live in fame's date* is, if an allowable, yet a harsh expression. To *outlive an eternal date*, is, though not philosophical, yet poetical sense. He wishes that her life may be longer than his, and her praise longer than fame.

I.i.309 (414,6) changing piece] Spoken of Lavinia. *Piece* was then, as it is now, used personally as a word of contempt.

II.i (421,8) In the quarto, the direction is, *Manet Aaron*, and he is before made to enter with Tamora, though he says nothing. This scene ought to continue the first act.

II.i.9 (421,9) So Tamora—/Upon her wit doth earthly honour wait] [W: her will] I think *wit*, for which she is eminent in the drama, is right.

II.i.116 (425,2) by kind] That is, by *nature*, which is the old signification of *kind*.

II.ii (425,3) *Changes to a Forest*] The division of this play into acts, which was first made by the editors in 1623, is improper. There is here an interval of action, and here the second act ought to have begun.

II.iii.8 (427,6)

And so repose, sweet gold, for their unrest,
That have their alms out of the empress' chest]

This is obscure. It seems to mean only, that they who are to come at this gold of the empress are to suffer by it.

II.iii.72 (430,9) swarth Cimmerian] *Swarth* is *black*. The Moor is called Cimmerien, from the affinity of blackness to darkness.

II.iii.85 (430,1)

Bas. The king, my brother, shall have note of this.

Lav. Ay, for these slips have made him noted long]

He had yet been married but one night.

II.iii.104 (431,2) Should straight fall mad, or else die suddenly] This is said in fabulous physiology, of those that hear the groan of the mandrake torn up.

II.iii.126 (432,3) And with that painted hope she braves your mightiness] [W: cope] *Painted hope* is only *specious* hope, or ground of confidence more plausible than solid.

II.iii.227 (435,4) A precious ring, that lightens all the hole] There is supposed to be a gem called a carbuncle, which emits not reflected but native light. Mr. Boyle believes the reality of its existence.

II.iv.13 (438,5) If I do dream, 'would all my wealth would wake me'] If this be a dream, I would give all my possessions to be delivered from it by waking.

III.i.91 (443,8) It was my deer] The play upon *deer* and *dear* has been used by Waller, who calls a lady's girdle, *The pale that held my lovely deer*.

III.i.216 (447,1) And do not break into these deep extremes] [We should read, instead of this nonsense,

—woe-*extremes*.

i.e. extremes caused by excessive sorrow. But Mr. Theobald, on his own authority, alters it to *deep*, without notice given. WARB.] It is *deep* in the old quarto of 1611, (rev. 1778, VIII, 510, 8)

III.ii (450,2) *An apartment in Titus's house*] This scene, which does not contribute any thing to the action, yet seems to have the same author

with the rest, is omitted in the quarto of 1611, but found in the folio of 1623.

III.ii.45 (452,3) by still practice] By *constant* or *continual* practice.

IV.i.129 (458,6) Revenge the heavens] It should be,

Revenge, ye Heavens!—

Ye was by the transcriber taken for *y'e*, the.

IV.ii.85 (461,7) I'll broach the tadpole] A *broach* is a *spit*. I'll *spit* the tadpole.

IV.ii.99 (462,8) Coal-black is better than another hue,/ In that it seems to bear another hue] We may better read, *In that it scorns to bear another hue*.

IV.iii.88 (466,1) Yet wrung with wrongs] To *wring* a horse is to press or strain his back.

IV.iv.90 (472,4) With words more sweet, and yet more dangerous,/ Than baits to fish, or honey-stalks to sheep] *Honey-stalks* are clover-flowers, which contain a sweet juice. It is common for cattle to overcharge themselves with clover, and die.

Vi.i.102 (476,7) As true a dog, as ever fought at head] An allusion to bull-dogs, whose generosity and courage are always shown by meeting the bull in front, and seizing his nose.

Vi.ii.189 (484,1) And of the paste a coffin will I rear] A *coffin* is the term of art for the cavity of a raised pye.

Vi.iii.19 (486,2) break the parley] That is, *begin* the parley. We yet say, he *breaks* his mind.

(492) General Observation. All the editors and critics agree with Mr. Theobald in supposing this play spurious. I see no reason for differing from them; for the colour of the stile is wholly different from that of the other plays, and there is an attempt at regular versification, and artificial closes, not always inelegant, yet seldom pleasing. The barbarity of the spectacles, and the general massacre, which are here exhibited, can scarcely be conceived tolerable to any audience; yet we are told by Jonson, that they were not only borne, but praised. That Shakespeare wrote any part, though Theobald declares it *incontestible*, I see no reason for believing.

The testimony produced at the beginning of this play, by which it is ascribed to Shakespeare, is by no means equal to the argument against its authenticity, arising from the total difference of conduct, language, and sentiments, by which it stands apart from all the rest. Meeres had probably no other evidence than that of a title-page, which, though in our time it be sufficient, was then of no great authority; for all the plays which were rejected by the first collectors of Shakespeare's works, and admitted in later editions, and again rejected by the critical editors, had Shakespeare's name on the title, as we must suppose, by the fraudulence of the printers, who, while there were yet no gazettes, nor advertisements, nor any means of circulating literary intelligence, could usurp at pleasure any celebrated name. Nor had Shakespeare any interest in detecting the imposture, as none of his fame or profit was produced by the press.

The chronology of this play does not prove it not to be Shakespeare's. If it had been written twenty-five years, in 1614, it might have been written when Shakespeare was twenty-five years old. When he left Warwickshire I know not, but at the age of twenty-five it was rather too late to fly for deer-stealing.

Ravenscroft, who in the reign of Charles II, revised this play, and restored it to the stage, tells us, in his preface, from a theatrical tradition, I suppose, which in his time might be of sufficient authority, that this play was touched in different parts by Shakespeare, but written by some other poet. I do not find Shakespeare's touches very discernible, (see 1765, VI, 364) (rev. 1778, VIII, 559)

TROILUS AND CRESSIDA

Prologue. (4,2)

And hither am I come

A prologue arm'd; but not in confidence

Of author's pen, or actor's voice; but suited

In like conditions as our argument]

I come here to speak the prologue, and come in armour; not defying the audience, in confidence of either the author's or actor's abilities, but merely in a character suited to the subject, in a dress of war, before a warlike play.

I.i.12 (8,3) And skill-less as unpractis'd infancy] Mr. Dryden, in his alteration of this play, has taken this speech as it stands, except that he has changed *skill-less* to *artless*, not for the better, because *skill-less* refers to *skill* and *skilful*.

I.i.58 (10,4) The cignet's down is harsh, and spirit of sense/Hard as the palm of ploughman!] *In comparison with* Cressid's hand, says he, *the spirit of sense*, the utmost degree, the most exquisite power of sensibility, which implies a soft hand, since the sense of touching, as Scaliger says in his *Exercitationes*, resides chiefly in the fingers, is hard as the callous and insensible palm of the ploughman. Warburton reads,

—SPITE *of sense*:

HANMER,

—to th' *spirit of sense*.

It is not proper to make a lover profess to praise his mistress in *spite of sense*; for though he often does it in *spite of the sense* of others, his own senses are subdued to his desires.

I.i.66 (10,5) if she be fair, 'tis the better for her; an she be not, she has the mends in her own hands] She may mend her complexion by the assistance of cosmetics.

I.ii.4 (12,1) Hector, whose patience/Is, as a virtue, fix'd] [W: Is as the] I think the present text may stand. Hector's patience was as a virtue, not variable and accidental, but fixed and constant. If I would alter it, it should be thus:

—Hector, whose patience

Is ALL a virtue fix'd,—

All, in old English, is the *intensive* or enforcing particle.

I.ii.8 (13,2) Before the sun rose, he was harness'd light] [Warburton stated that "harnessed light" meant Hector was to fight on foot] How does it appear that Hector was to fight on foot rather to-day than on any other day? It is to be remembered, that the ancient heroes never fought on horseback; nor does their manner of fighting in chariots seem to require less activity than on foot.

I.ii.23 (14,4) his valour is crushed into folly] To be *crushed into folly*, is to be *confused* and mingled with *folly*, so as that they make one mass together.

I.ii.46 (15,6) Ilium] Was the palace of Troy.

I.ii.120 (17,7) compass-window] The *compass-window* is the same as the *bow-window*. (1773)

I.ii.212 (20,2)

Cre. Will he give you the nod?

Pan. You shall see.

Cre. If he do, the rich shall have more]

[W: rich] I wonder why the commentator should think any emendation necessary, since his own sense is fully expressed by the present reading. Hanmer appears not to have understood the passage. That to *give the nod* signifies to *set a mark of folly*, I do not know; the allusion is to the word *noddy*, which, as now, did, in our author's time, and long before, signify, a *silly fellow*, and may, by its etymology, signify likewise *full of nods*. Cressid means, that a *noddy shall have more nods*. Of such remarks as these is a comment to consist?

I.ii.260 (22,3) money to boot] So the folio. The old quarto, with more force, Give *an eye* to boot. (rev. 1778, IX, 25, 1)

I.ii.285 (22,4) upon my wit to defend my wiles] So read both the copies) yet perhaps the author wrote,

Upon my wit to defend my will.

The terms *wit* and *will* were, in the language of that time, put often in opposition.

I.ii.300 (23,5) At your own house; there he unarms him] [These necessary words added from the quarto edition. POPE.] The words added are only, *there he unarms him*.

I.ii.313 (23,6) joy's soul lies in the doing] So read both the old editions, for which the later editions have poorly given,
—the *soul's joy* lies in doing.

I.ii.316 (23,7) That she] Means, that woman.

I.iii.31 (25,2) With due observance of thy godlike seat] [T: godlike seat] This emendation [for goodly seat] Theobald might have found in the quarto, which has,
—the *godlike* seat.

I.iii.32 (25,3) Nestor shall apply/ Thy latest words] Nestor *applies* the words to another instance.

I.iii.54 (26,7) Returns to chiding fortune] For *returns*, Hanmer reads *replies*, unnecessarily, the sense being the same. The folio and quarto have *retires*, corruptly.

I.iii.62 (27,8)

both your speeches; which are such,
As Agamemnon and the hand of Greece
Should hold up high in brass; and such again,
As venerable Nestor, hatch'd in silver,
Should with a bond of air (strong as the axle-tree
On which heaven rides) knit all the Greekish ears
To his experienc'd tongue]

Ulysses begins his oration with praising those who had spoken before him, and marks the characteristick excellencies of their different eloquence, strength, and sweetness, which he expresses by the different metals on which he recommends them to be engraven for the instruction of posterity. The speech of Agamemnon is such that it ought to be engraven in brass, and the tablet held up by him on the one side, and Greece on the other, to shew the union of their opinion. And Nestor ought to be exhibited in silver, uniting all his audience in one mind by his soft and gentle elocution. Brass is the common emblem of strength, and silver of gentleness. We call a soft voice a *silver* voice, and a persuasive tongue a *silver* tongue. —I once read for *hand*, the *band* of Greece, but I think the text right. —To *hatch* is a term of art for a particular method of *engraving*. *Hatcher*, to cut, Fr.

I.iii.78 (28,1) The specialty of rule] The particular rights of supreme authority.

I.iii.81 (29,2) When that the general is not like the hive] The meaning is, *When the general is not to the army like the hive to the bees*, the repository of the stock of every individual, that to which each particular resorts with whatever he has collected for the good of the whole, *what honey is expected?* what hope of advantage? The sense is clear, the expression is confused.

I.iii.101 (30,5) Oh, when degree is shak'd] I would read,
—So when degree is shak'd. (see 1765, VII, 431, 5)

I.iii.103 (30,6) The enterprize] Perhaps we should read,
Then enterprize is sick!—

I.iii.104 (30,7) brotherhoods in cities] Corporations, companies, *confraternities*.

I.iii.128 (31,8) That by a pace goes backward] That goes backward *step by step*.

I.iii.128 (31,9) with a purpose/It hath to climb] With a design in each man to aggrandize himself, by slighting his immediate superior.

I.iii.134 (31,1) bloodless emulation] An emulation not vigorous and active, but malignant and sluggish.

I.iii.152 (31,2) Thy topless deputation] *Topless* is that has nothing *topping* or *overtopping* it; supreme; sovereign.

I.iii.167 (32,3) as near as the extremest ends/Of parallels] The parallels to which the allusion seems to be made are the parallels on a map. As like as East to West.

I.iii.179 (32,4)

All our abilities, gifts, natures, shapes,
Severals and generals of grace exact,
Atchievements, plots]

The meaning is this, All our good *grace exact*, means of *excellence irreprehensible*.

I.iii.184 (32,5) to make paradoxes] *Paradoxes* may have a meaning, but it is not clear and distinct. I wish the copies had given,
—to make *parodies*.

I.iii.188 (33,6) bears his head/ In such a rein] That is, holds up his head as haughtily. We still say of a girl, *she bridles*.

I.iii.196 (33,7) How rank soever rounded in with danger] A *rank weed* is a *high weed*. The modern editions silently read,
How *hard* soever —

I.iii.202 (33,8) and know by measure/ Of their observant toil the enemies' weight] I think it were better to read,
—and know *the* measure,
By their observant toil, of th' enemies' weight.

I.iii.220 (34,1) Achilles' arm] So the copies. Perhaps the author wrote,
—*Alcides'* arm.

I.iii.262 (35,4) long continu'd truce] Of this long *truce* there has been no notice taken; in this very act it is said, that *Ajax coped Hector yesterday in the battle*.

I.iii.270 (36,7) (With truant vows to her own lips he loves)] That is, *confession made with idle vows to the lips of her whom he loves*.

I.iii.319 (37,1) nursery] Alluding to a plantation called a nursery.

I.iii.341 (38,4) scantling] That is, a *measure, proportion*. The carpenter cuts his wood to a certain *scantling*.

I.iii.343 (38,5) small pricks] Small *points compared* with the volumes.

II.i (40,1) *The Grecian camp. Enter Ajax and Thorsites*] ACT II.] This play is not divided into acts in any of the original editions.

II.i.13 (41,2) The plague of Greece] Alluding perhaps to the plague sent by Apollo on the Grecian army.

II.i.15 (41,3) Speak then, thou unsalted leaven, speak] [T: unwinnow'dst] [W: windiest] Hanmer preserves *whinid'st*, the reading of the folio; but does not explain it, nor do I understand it. If the folio be followed, I read, *vinew'd*, that is *mouldy leaven*. Thou composition of *mustiness* and *sourness*. — Theobald's assertion, however confident, is false. *Unsalted* leaven is in the old quarto. It means *sour* without *salt*, malignity without wit. Shakespeare wrote first *unsalted*; but recollecting that want of *salt* was no fault in leaven, changed it to *vinew'd*.

II.i.38 (42,5) aye that thou bark'st at him] I read, *O that thou bark'dst* at him.

II.i.42 (42,6) pun thee into shivers] *Pun* is in the midland counties the vulgar and colloquial word for *pound*. (1773)

II.i.125 (45,1) when Achilles' brach bids me] The folio and quarto read, *Achilles' brooch*. *Brooch* is an appendant ornament. The meaning may be, equivalent to one of *Achilles' hangers on*.

II.ii.29 (47,2) The past-proportion of his infinite?] Thus read both the copies. The meaning is, *that greatness, to which no measure bears any proportion*. The modern editors silently give,

The *vast* proportion—

II.ii.58 (48,4) And the will dotes that is inclinable] [Old edition, not so well, has it, *attributive*. POPE.] By the old edition Mr. Pope means the old quarto. The folio has, as it stands, *inclinable*.—I think the first reading better; *the will dotes that attributes* or gives *the qualities which it affects*; that first causes excellence, and then admires it.

II.ii.60 (48,5) Without some image of the affected merit] The present reading is right. The will *affects* an object for some supposed *merit*, which Hector says, is uncensurable, unless the *merit* so *affected* be really there.

II.ii.71 (48,7) unrespective sieve] That is, into a *common voider*. *Sieve* is in the quarto. The folio reads,

—unrespective *fame*;

for which the modern editions have silently printed,

—unrespective *place*.

II.ii.88 (49,9)

why do you now

The issue of your proper wisdoms rate;

And do a deed that fortune never did,

Beggar that estimation which you priz'd

Richer than sea and land?]

If I understand this passage, the meaning is, "Why do you, by censuring the determination of your own wisdoms, degrade Helen, whom fortune has not yet deprived of her value, or against whom, as the wife of Paris, fortune has not in this war so declared, as to make us value her less?" This is very harsh, and much strained.

II.ii.122 (50,2) her brain-sick raptures/ Cannot distaste the goodness of a quarrel] Corrupt; change to a worse state.

II.ii.179 (52,3) benumbed wills] That is, inflexible, inmoveable, no longer obedient to superior direction.

II.ii.180 (52,4) There is a law in each well-ordered nation] What the law does in every nation between individuals, justice ought to do between nations.

II.ii.188 (52,5) Hector's opinion/ Is this in way of truth] Though considering *truth* and *justice* in this question, this is my opinion; yet as a question of honour, I think on it as you.

II.ii.196 (53,6) the performance of our heaving spleens] The execution of spite and resentment.

II.ii.212 (53,7) emulation] That is, envy, factious contention.

II.iii.18 (54,8) without drawing the massy iron and cutting the web] That is, *without drawing their swords to cut the web*. They use no means but those of violence.

II.iii.55 (55,1) decline the whole question] Deduce the question from the first case to the last.

II.iii.108 (57,6) but it was a strong composure, a fool could disunite] So reads the quarto very properly; but the folio, which the moderns have followed, has, *it was a strong COUNSEL*.

II.iii.118 (57,7) noble state] Person of high dignity; spoken of Agamemnon.

II.iii.137 (58,8) under-write] To *subscribe*, in Shakespeare, is to *obey*.

II.iii.215 (60,2) pheese his pride] To *pheese* is to *comb* or *curry*.

II.iii.217 (60,3) Not for the worth that hangs upon our quarrel] Not for the value of all for which we are fighting.

II.iii.267 (62,6)

Ajax. Shall I call you father?

Nest. Ay, my good son]

In the folio and in the modern editions Ajax desires to give the title of *father* to Ulysses; in the quarto, more naturally, to Nestor.

III.i.35 (64,1) love's invisible soul] *love's visible soul.*] So HANMER. The other editions have *invisible*, which perhaps may be right, and may mean the *soul of love* invisible every where else.

III.i.83 (65,3) And, my lord, he desires you] Here I think the speech of Pandarus should begin, and the rest of it should be added to that of Helen, but I have followed the copies.

III.i.96 (65,4) with my disposer Cressida] [W: dispouser] I do not understand the word *disposer*, nor know what to substitute in its place. There is no variation in the copies.

III.i.132 (67,6) *Yet that which seems the wound to kill*] *To kill the wound* is no very intelligible expression, nor is the measure preserved. We might read,

*These lovers cry,
Oh! oh! they die!
But that which seems to kill,
Doth turn, &c.
So dying love lives still.*

Yet as *the wound to kill* may mean *the wound that seems mortal*, I alter nothing.

III.ii.25 (69,1) tun'd too sharp in sweetness] —and *too sharp in sweetness.*] So the folio and all modern editions; but the quarto more accurately,

—*tun'd too sharp in sweetness.*

III.ii.99 (71,4) our head shall go bare, 'till merit crown it] I cannot forbear to observe, that the quarto reads thus: *Our head shall go bare, 'till merit lower part no affection, in reversion, &c.* Had there been no other copy, how could this have been corrected? The true reading is in the folio.

III.ii.102 (72,5) his addition shall be humble] We will give him no high or pompous titles.

III.ii.162 (74,6)
but you are wise,
Or else you love not; to be wise and love,
Exceeds man's might]
I read,
—but *we're not wise,*

Or else *we* love not; to be wise and love,
Exceeds man's might;—

Cressida, in return to the praise given by Troilus to her wisdom, replies, "That lovers are never wise; that it is beyond the power of man to bring love and wisdom to an union."

III.ii.173 (74,8) Might be affronted with the match] I wish "my integrity might be met and matched with such equality and force of pure unmingled love."

III.ii.184 (75,2) As true as steel, as plantage to the moon] *Plantage* is not, I believe, a general term, but the herb which we now call *plantain*, in Latin, *plantago*, which was, I suppose, imagined to be under the peculiar influence of the moon.

III.ii.187 (76,3)

Yet after all comparisons of truth,
As truth's authentic author to be cited
As *true as Troilus*, shall crown up the verse]

Troilus shall *crown the verse*, as a man *to be cited as the authentic author of truth*; as one whose protestations were true to a proverb.

III.iii.1-16 (77,5) Now, princes, for the service I have done you] I am afraid, that after all the learned commentator's [Warburton's] efforts to clear the argument of Calchas, it will still appear liable to objection; nor do I discover more to be urged in his defence, than that though his skill in divination determined him to leave Troy, yet that he joined himself to Agamemnon and his army by unconstrained good-will; and though he came as a fugitive escaping from destruction, yet his services after his reception, being voluntary and important, deserved reward. This argument is not regularly and distinctly deduced, but this is, I think, the best explication that it will yet admit.

III.iii.4 (78,6) through the sight I bear in things, to Jove] This passage in all the modern editions is silently depraved, and printed thus:

—through the sight I bear in things to come.

The word is so printed that nothing but the sense can determine whether it be *love* or *Jove*. I believe that the editors read it as *love*, and therefore made the alteration to obtain some meaning.

III.iii.28 (79,7)

he shall buy my daughter; and her presence
 Shall quite strike off all service I have done,
 In most accepted pain]
 Sir T. HANMER, and Dr. Warburton after him, read,
 In most accepted *pay*.

They do not seem to understand the construction of the passage. *Her presence*, says Calchas, shall strike off, or recompence *the service I have done*, even in these *labours* which were *most accepted*.

III.iii.44 (80,8) derision med'cinable] All the modern editions have *decision*. The old copies are apparently right. The folio in this place agrees with the quarto, so that the corruption was at first merely accidental.

III.iii.96 (82,9) how dearly ever parted] I do not think that in the word *parted* is included any idea of *division*; it means, *however excellently endowed*, with however *dear* or precious *parts* enriched or adorned.

III.iii.113 (82,2) but the author's drift:/ Who, in his circumstance] In the detail or circumduction of his argument.

III.iii.125 (83,3) The unknown Ajax] Ajax, who has abilities which were never brought into view or use.

III.iii.134 (83,4)

How some men creep in skittish Fortune's hall,
 While others play the idiots in her eyes!]

To *creep* is to *keep out of sight* from whatever motive. Some men *keep out of notice in the hall of Fortune*, while others, though they but *play the idiot*, are always *in her eye*, in the way of distinction.

III.iii.137 (83,5) feasting] Folio. The quarto has *fasting*. Either word may bear a good sense.

III.iii.145 (84,6) Time hath, my lord, a wallet at his back] This speech is printed in all the modern editions with such deviations from the old copy, as exceed the lawful power of an editor.

III.iii.171 (85,2) for beauty, wit,/ High birth, vigour of bone, desert in service] The modern editors read,

For beauty, wit, high birth, desert in service, &c.

I do not deny but the changes produce a more easy lapse of numbers, but they do not exhibit the work of Shakespeare, (see 1765, VII, 435, 2)

III.iii.178 (85,3)

And shew to dust, that is a little gilt,
More laud than gilt o'er-dusted]

[T: give to ... laud than they will give to gold] This emendation has been received by the succeeding editors, but recedes too far from the copy. There is no other corruption than such as Shakespeare's incorrectness often resembles. He has omitted the article *to* in the second line: he should have written,

More laud than to gilt o'er-dusted. (1773) (rev. 1778, IX, 93, 7)

III.iii.189 (86,4) Made emulous missions] The meaning of *mission* seems to be *dispatches* of the gods *from heaven* about mortal business, such as often happened at the siege of Troy.

III.iii.197 (86,5) Knows almost every grain of Pluto's gold] For this elegant line the quarto has only,

Knows almost every *thing*.

III.iii.201 (86,7) (with which relation/Durst never meddle)] There is a secret administration of affairs, which no *history* was ever able to discover.

III.iii.230 (87,9)

Omission to do what is necessary
Seals a commission to a blank of danger]

By *neglecting* our duty we *commission* or enable that *danger* of dishonour, which could not reach us before, to lay hold upon us.

III.iii.254 (88,1) with a politic regard] With a *sly* look.

IV.i.11 (91,1) During all question of the gentle truce] I once thought to read,

During all *quiet* of the gentle truce.

But I think *question* means intercourse, interchange of conversation.

IV.i.36 (92,4) His purpose meets you] I bring you his meaning and his orders.

IV.i.65 (93,6)

Both merits pois'd, each weighs no less nor more,
But he as he, the heavier for a whore]

I read,

But he as he, *each* heavier for a whore.

Heavy is taken both for *weighty*, and for *sad* or *miserable*. The quarto reads,

But he as he, *the* heavier for a whore.

I know not whether the thought is not that of a wager. It must then be read thus:

But he as he. Which heavier for a whore?

That is, *for a whore* staked down, *which is the heavier*.

IV.i.78 (94,7) We'll not commend what we intend to sell] I believe the meaning is only this: though you practise the buyer's art, we will not practise the seller's. We intend to sell Helen dear, yet will not commend her.

IV.ii.62 (96,4) My matter is so rash] My business is so *hasty* and so abrupt.

IV.ii.74 (97,6) the secrets of neighbour Pandar] [Pope had emended the Folio's "secrets of nature" to the present reading] Mr. Pope's reading is in the old quarto. So great is the necessity of collation.

IV.iv.3 (99,1) The grief] The folio reads,

The grief is fine, full perfect, that I taste,
And no less in a sense as strong
As that which causeth it.—

The quarto otherwise,

The grief is fine, full, perfect, that I taste,
And *violenteth* in a sense as strong
As that which causeth it.—

Violenteth is a word with which I am not acquainted, yet perhaps it may be right. The reading of the text is without authority.

IV.iv.65 (101,3) For I will throw my glove to death] That is, I will *challenge* death himself in defence of thy fidelity.

IV.iv.105 (103,5)

While others fish, with craft, for great opinion,
I, with great truth, catch mere simplicity.]

The meaning, I think, is, *while others*, by their art, gain high estimation, I, by honesty, obtain a plain simple approbation.

IV.iv.109 (103,6) the moral of my wit/Is, *plain and true*] That is, the governing principle of my understanding; but I rather think we should read,

—the *motto* of my wit
Is, plain and true, —

IV.iv.114 (103,7) possess thee what she is] I will *make thee fully understand*. This sense of the word *possess* is frequent in our author.

IV.iv.134 (104,9) I'll answer to my list] This, I think, is right, though both the old copies read *lust*.

IV.v.8 (105,1) bias cheek] Swelling out like the bias of a bowl.

IV.v.37 (106,3) I'll make my match to live./ The kiss you take is better than you give] I will make such *bargains* as I may live by, *such as may bring me profit*, therefore will not take a worse kiss than I give.

IV.v.48 (107,4) Why, beg then] For the sake of rhyme we should read, Why beg *two*.

If you think kisses worth begging, beg more than one.

IV.v.52 (107,5) Never's my day, and then a kiss of you] I once gave both these lines to Cressida. She bids Ulysses beg a kiss; he asks that he may have it,

When Helen is a maid again—
She tells him that then he shall have it:
When Helen is a maid again—
Cre. I am your debtor, claim it when 'tis due;
Never's my day, and then a kiss *for* you.

But I rather think that Ulysses means to slight her, and that the present reading is right.

IV.v.57 (107,6) motive of her body] *Motive for part that contributes to motion*.

IV.v.59 (107,7) a coasting] An amorous address; courtship.

IV.v.62 (107,8) sluttish spoils of opportunity] Corrupt wenches, of whose chastity every opportunity may make a prey.

IV.v.73 (108,9) *Aga*. 'Tis done like Hector, but securely done] [Theobald gave the speech to Achilles] As the old copies agree, I have made no change.

IV.v.79 (108,1) Valour and pride excel themselves in Hector] Shakespeare's thought is not exactly deduced. Nicety of expression is not his character. The cleaning is plain, "Valour (says Aeneas) is in Hector greater than valour in other men, and pride in Hector is less than pride in other men. So that Hector is distinguished by the excellence of having pride less than other pride, and valour more than other valour."

IV.v.103 (109,2) an impair thought] A thought suitable to the dignity of his character. This word I should have changed to *impure*, were I not over-powered by the unanimity of the editors, and concurrence of the old copies, (rev. 1778, IX, 120, 8)

IV.v.105 (109,3) Hector in his blaze of wrath subscribes/ To tender objects] That is, *yields, gives* way.

IV.v.112 (110,4) thus translate him to me] Thus *explain his character*.

IV.v.142 (111,5) *Hect*. Not Neoptolemus so mirable] [W: Neoptolemus's sire irascible] After all this contention it is difficult to imagine that the critic believes *mirable* to have been changed to *irascible*. I should sooner read,

Not Neoptolemus th' admirable;

as I know not whether *mirable* can be found in any other place. The correction which the learned commentator gave to Hanmer,

Not Neoptolemus' *sire* so mirable,

as it was modester than this, was preferable to it. But nothing is more remote from justness of sentiment, than for Hector to characterise Achilles as the father of Neoptolemus, a youth that had not yet appeared in arms, and whose name was therefore much less known than his father's. My opinion is, that by Neoptolemus the author meant Achilles himself; and remembering that the son was Pyrrhus Neoptolemus, considered Neoptolemus as the nomen gentilitium, and thought the father was likewise Achilles Neoptolemus.

IV.v.147 (112,6) We'll answer it] That is, answer the *expectance*.

IV.v.275 (117,5) Beat loud the tabourines] For this the quarto and the latter editions have,

To taste your bounties. —

The reading which I have given from the folio seems chosen at the revision, to avoid the repetition of the word *bounties*.

Vi.5 (118,1) Thou crusty batch of nature] *Batch* is changed by Theobald to *botch*, and the change is justified by a pompous note, which discovers that he did not know the word *batch*. What is more strange, Hanmer has followed him. *Batch* is any thing *baked*.

Vi.19 (119,3) Male-varlet] HANMER reads *male-harlot*, plausibly enough, except that it seems too plain to require the explanation which Patroclus demands.

Vi.23 (119,4) cold palsies] This catalogue of loathsome maladies ends in the folio at *cold palsies*. This passage, as it stands, is in the quarto: the retrenchment was in my opinion judicious. It may be remarked, though it proves nothing, that, of the few alterations made by Milton in the second edition of his wonderful poem, one was, an enlargement of the enumeration of diseases.

Vi.32 (119,5) you ruinous butt; you whoreson indistinguishable cur] Patroclus reproaches Thersites with deformity, with having one part crowded into another.

Vi.35 (119,6) thou idle immaterial skeyn of sley'd silk] All the terms used by Thersites of Patroclus, are emblematically expressive of flexibility, compliance, and mean officiousness.

Vi.40 (119,7) Out, gall!] HANMER reads *nut-gall*, which answers well enough to *finch-egg*; it has already appeared, that our author thought the *nut-gall* the bitter gall. He is called *nut*, from the conglobation of his form; but both the copies read, *Out, gall!*

Vi.41 (120,8) Finch egg!] Of this reproach I do not know the exact meaning. I suppose he means to call him *singing bird*, as implying an useless favourite, and yet more, something more worthless, a singing bird in the egg, or generally, a slight thing easily crushed.

Vi.64 (121,2) forced with wit] Stuffed with wit. A term of cookery. — In this speech I do not well understand what is meant by *loving quails*.

V.i.73 (121,3) spirits and fires!] This Thersites speaks upon the first sight of the distant lights.

V.ii.11 (124,1) And any man may sing her, if he can take her cliff] That is, her *key*. *Clef*, French.

V.ii.41 (125,2) You flow to great distraction] So the moderns. The folio has,

You *flow* to great *distraction*. —

The quarto,

You *flow* to great *destruction*. —

I read,

You *show too* great *distraction*. —

V.ii.108 (128,7) But with my heart the other eye doth see] I think it should be read thus,

But *my heart with* the other eye doth see.

V.ii.113 (128,8) A proof of strength she could not publish more] She could not publish a stronger proof.

V.ii.125 (129,1) I cannot conjure, Trojan] That is, I cannot raise spirits in the form of Cressida.

V.ii.141 (129,2) If there be rule in unity itself] I do not well understand what is meant by *rule in unity*. By *rule* our author, in this place as in others, intends *virtuous restraint, regularity of manners, command of passions and appetites*. In Macbeth,

He cannot buckle his distemper'd cause

Within the belt of rule. —

But I know not how to apply the word in this sense to *unity*. I read,

If there be rule in *purity* itself,

Or, If there be rule in *verity* itself.

Such alterations would not offend the reader, who saw the state of the old editions, in which, for instance, a few lines lower, *the almighty sun* is called *the almighty fenne*. — Yet the words may at last mean, If there be *certainty* in *unity*, if it be a *rule* that *one is one*.

V.ii.144 (130,3) Bi-fold authority!] This is the reading of the quarto. The folio gives us,

By foul authority! —

There is *madness* in that disquisition in which a man reasons at once *for* and *against himself upon authority* which he knows *not to be valid*. The quarto is right.

V.ii.144 (130,4)

where reason can revolt
Without perdition, and loss assume all reason
Without revolt]

The words *loss* and *perdition* are used in their common sense, but they mean the *loss* or *perdition* of *reason*.

V.ii.157 (131,6) And with another knot five-finger-tied] A knot tied by giving her hand to Diomed.

V.ii.160 (131,7) o'er-eaten faith] Vows which she has already swallowed *once over*. We still say of a faithless man, that he has *eaten his words*.

V.ii.161 (131,8)

Ulyss. May worthy Troilus be half attach'd
With that which here his passion doth express!]

Can Troilus really feel on this occasion half of what he utters? A question suitable to the calm Ulysses.

V.iii.21 (133,2)

For us to count we give what's gain'd by thefts,
And rob in the behalf of charity]

This is so oddly confused in the folio, that I transcribe it as a specimen of incorrectness:

—do not count it holy,
To hurt by being just; it were as lawful
For we would count give much to as violent thefts,
And rob in the behalf of charity.

V.iii.23 (133,3)

Cas. It is the purpose that makes strong the vow;
But vows to every purpose must not hold]

The mad prophetess speaks here with all the coolness and judgment of a skilful casuist. "The essence of a lawful vow, is a lawful purpose, and the vow of which the end is wrong must not be regarded as cogent."

V.iii.27 (134,4)

Life every man holds dear; but the dear man
Holds honour far more precious dear than life]
Valuable man. The modern editions read,
—*brave* man.
The repetition of the word is in our author's manner.

V.iii.37 (134,5)

Brother, you have a vice of mercy in you,
Which better fits a lion, than a man]

The traditions and stories of the darker ages abounded with examples of the lion's generosity. Upon the supposition that these acts of clemency were true, Troilus reasons not improperly, that to spare against reason, by mere instinct of pity, became rather a generous beast than a wise man.

V.x.33 (137,9) Hence, broker lacquey!] For *brothel*, the folio reads *brother*, erroneously for *broker*, as it stands at the end of the play where the lines are repeated. Of *brother* the following editors made *brothel*.

V.iv.18 (138,2) the Grecians begin to proclaim barbarism, and policy grows into an ill opinion] To set up the authority of ignorance to declare that they will be governed by policy no longer.

V.vi.11 (142,1) you cogging Greeks] This epithet has no particular propriety in this place, but the author had heard of *Graecia Mendax*.

V.vi.29 (144,3) I'll frush it] The word *frush* I never found elsewhere, nor understand it. HANMER explains it, to *break* or *bruise*.

V.viii.7 (146,1) Even with the vail and darkening of the sun] The *vail* is, I think, the *sinking* of the sun; not *veil* or *cover*.

(149) General Observation. This play is more correctly written than most of Shakespeare's compositions, but it is not one of those in which either the extent of his views or elevation of his fancy is fully displayed. As the story abounded with materials, he has exerted little invention; but he has diversified his characters with great variety, and preserved them with great exactness. His vicious characters sometimes disgust, but cannot corrupt, for both Cressida and Pandarus are detested and contemned. The comic characters seem to have been the favourites of the writer; they are of the superficial kind, and exhibit more of manners than nature; but they are copi-

ously filled and powerfully impressed. Shakespeare has in his story followed, for the greater part, the old book of Caxton, which was then very popular; but the character of Thersites, of which it makes no mention, is a proof that this play was written after Chapman had published his version of *Homer*.

CYMBELINE

I.i.1 (153,2)

You do not meet a man, but frowns: our bloods
No more obey the heavens, than our courtiers'
Still seen, as does the king's]

[W: brows/No more] This passage is so difficult, that commentators may differ concerning it without animosity or shame. Of the two emendations proposed, Hanmer's is the more licentious; but he makes the sense clear, and leaves the reader an easy passage. Dr. Warburton has corrected with more caution, but less improvement: his reasoning upon his own reading is so obscure and perplexed, that I suspect some injury of the press.—I am now to tell my opinion, which is, that the lines stand as they were originally written, and that a paraphrase, such as the licentious and abrupt expressions of our author too frequently require, will make emendation unnecessary. *We do not meet a man but frowns; our bloods*—our countenances, which, in popular speech, are said to be regulated by the temper of the blood,—*no more obey the laws of heaven*,—which direct us to appear what we really are,—*than our courtiers*;—that is, than the *bloods of our courtiers*; but our bloods, like theirs,—*still seem, as doth the king's*.

I.i.25 (155,3) I do extend him, Sir, within himself] I extend him within himself: my praise, however *extensive*, is *within* his merit.

I.i.46 (156,4) liv'd in court,/ (Which rare it is to do) most prais'd, most lov'd] This encomium is high and artful. To be at once in any great degree *loved* and *praised* is truly *rare*.

I.i.49 (156,5) A glass that feated them] *A glass that featur'd them*] Such is the reading in all the modern editions, I know not by whom first substituted, for

A glass that *feared* them;—

I have displaced *featur'd*, though it can plead long prescription, because I am inclined to think that *feared* has the better title. *Mirroure* was a favourite word in that age for an *example*, or a *pattern*, by noting which the manners were to be formed, as dress is regulated by looking in a glass. When Don Bellianis is stiled *The Mirroure of Knighthood*, the idea given is not that of a glass in which every knight may behold his own resemblance, but an example to be viewed by knights

as often as a glass is looked upon by girls, to be viewed, that they may know, not what they are, but what they ought to be. Such a glass may *fear the more mature*, as displaying excellencies which they have arrived at maturity without attaining. To *fear* is here, as in other places, to *fright*. [I believe Dr. Johnson is mistaken as to the reading of the folio, which is *feated*. The page of the copy which he consulted is very faintly printed; but I have seen another since, which plainly gives this reading. STEEVENS.] If *feated* be the right word, it must, I think, be explained thus; *a glass that formed them*; a model, by the contemplation and inspection of which they formed their manners. (see 1765, VII, 260, 4)

I.i.86 (158,1)

I something fear my father's wrath; but nothing
(Always reserv'd my holy duty) what
His rage can do on me]

I say I do not fear my father, so far as I may say it without breach of duty.

I.i.101 (158,2) Though ink be made of gall] Shakespeare, even in this poor conceit, has confounded the vegetable *galls* used in ink, with the animal *gall*, supposed to be bitter.

I.i.132 (160,4) then heapest/ A year's age on me] Dr. Warburton reads,

A *yare* age on me.

It seems to me, even from Skinner, whom he cites, that *yare* is used only as a personal quality. Nor is the authority of Skinner sufficient, without some example, to justify the alteration. HANMER's reading is better, but rather too far from the original copy:

—thou heapest *many*

A year's age on me.

I read,

—thou heap'st

Years, ages on me.

I.i.135 (160,5) a touch more rare/ Subdues all pangs, all fears] *Rare* is used often for *eminently good*; but I do not remember any passage in which it stands for *eminently bad*. May we read,

—a touch more *near*.

Cura deam propior luctusque domesticus angit. Ovid.

Shall we try again,
—a touch more *rear*.

Crudum vulnus. But of this I know not any example. There is yet another interpretation, which perhaps will remove the difficulty. A *touch more rare*, may mean a *nobler passion*.

I.i.140 (161,6) a puttock] A kite.

I.ii.31 (163,1) her beauty and her brain go not together] I believe the lord means to speak a sentence, "Sir, as I told you always, beauty and brain go not together."

I.ii.32 (164,2) She's a good sign] [W: shine] There is acuteness enough in this note, yet I believe the poet meant nothing by *sign*, but *fair outward shew*.

I.iii.8 (165,2)

for so long

As he could make me with this eye, or ear,

Distinguish him from others]

[W: this eye] Sir T. HANMER alters it thus:

—for so long

As he could *mark* me with his eye, or I

Distinguish—

The reason of Hanmer's reading was, that Pisanio describes no address made to the *ear*.

I.iii.18 (165,3) till the diminution/ Of space had pointed him sharp as my needle] *The diminution of space*, is *the diminution* of which *space* is the cause. Trees are killed by a blast of lightning, that is, by *blasting*, not *blasted* lightning.

I.iii.24 (166,4) next vantage] Next *opportunity*.

I.iii.37 (166,6) Shakes all our buds from growing] A bud, without any distinct idea, whether of flower or fruit, is a natural representation of any thing incipient or immature; and the buds of flowers, if flowers are meant, *grow* to flowers, as the buds of fruits *grow* to fruits.

I.iv.9 (167,1) makes him] In the sense in which we say, This will *make* or *mar* you.

I.iv.16 (167,2) words him, I doubt not, a great deal from the matter]
Makes the description of him very distant from the truth.

I.iv.20 (167,3) under her colours] Under her banner; by her influence.

I.iv.47 (168,6) I was then a young traveller; rather shunn'd to go even
with what I heard, than in my every action to be guided by others'
experiences] This is expressed with a kind of fantastical perplexity.
He means, I was then willing to take for my direction the experience
of others, more than such intelligence as I had gathered myself.

I.iv.58 (169,7) 'Twas a contention in publick, which may, without contradiction,
suffer the report] Which, undoubtedly, may be publickly told.

I.iv.73 (169,8) tho' I profess myself her adorer, not her friend] Though
I have not the common obligations of a lover to his mistress, and regard
her not with the fondness of a friend, but the reverence of an adorer.

I.iv.77 (169,9) If she went before others I have seen, as that diamond
of yours out-lustres many I have beheld, I could not believe she excelled
many] [W: could believe] I should explain the sentence thus:
"Though your lady excelled, as much as your diamond, *I could not believe she excelled many*; that is, I too *could yet believe that there are many whom she did not excel.*" But I yet think Dr. Warburton right. (1773)

I.iv.104 (171,1) to convince the honour of my mistress] [*Convince*, for overcome. WARBURTON.] So in *Macbeth*,
—their malady *convinces*
"The great essay of art."

I.iv.124 (171,2) abus'd] *Deceiv'd*.

I.iv.134 (172,3) approbation] Proof.

I.iv.148 (172,4) You are a friend, and therein the wiser. If you buy
ladies' flesh at a million a dram, you cannot preserve it from tainting.
But, I see, you have some religion in you, that you fear] *You are a friend*
to the lady, *and therein the wiser*, as you will not expose her to hazard;
and that you *fear*, is a proof of your *religious* fidelity. (see 1765, VII,
276, 1)

I.iv.160 (173,5) *Iach.* If I bring you no sufficient testimony that I have enjoy'd the dearest bodily part of your mistress, my ten thousand ducats are yours, so is my diamond too: if I come off, and leave her in such honour as you have trust in, she your jewel, this your jewel, and my gold are yours—

Post. I embrace these conditions]

[W: bring you sufficient] I once thought this emendation right, but am now of opinion, that Shakespeare intended that Iachimo, having gained his purpose, should designedly drop the invidious and offensive part of the wager, and to flatter Posthumus, dwell long upon the more pleasing part of the representation. One condition of a wager implies the other, and there is no need to mention both.

I.v.18 (176,1) Other conclusions] Other *experiments*. *I commend*, says WALTON, *an angler that tries conclusions*, and improves his art.

I.v.23 (175,2) Your highness/ Shall from this practice but make hard your heart] There is in this passage nothing that much requires a note, yet I cannot forbear to push it forward into observation. The thought would probably have been more amplified, had our author lived to be shocked with such experiments as have been published in later times, by a race of men that have practised tortures without pity, and related then without shame, and are yet suffered to erect their heads among human beings.

"Cape saxa manu, cape robora, pastor."

I.v.33-44 (175,3) I do not like her] This soliloquy is very inartificial. The speaker is under no strong pressure of thought; he is neither resolving, repenting, suspecting, nor deliberating, and yet makes a long speech to tell himself what himself knows.

I.v.54 (176,4) to shift his being] To change his abode.

I.v.58 (118,5) What shalt thou expect,/ To be depend on a thing that leans?] That *inclines* towards its fall.

I.v.80 (177,7) Of leigers for her sweet] A *leiger* ambassador, is one that resides at a foreign court to promote his master's interest.

I.vi.7 (178,9)

Bless'd be those,

How mean soe'er, that have their honest wills,

Which seasons comfort]

I am willing to comply with any meaning that can be extorted from the present text, rather than change it, yet will propose, but with great diffidence, a slight alteration:

—Bless'd be those,

How mean soe'er, that have their honest wills,

With reason's comfort.—

Who gratify their innocent wishes with reasonable enjoyments.

I.vi.35 (180,2) and the twinn'd stones/ Upon the number'd beach?] I know not well how to regulate this passage. *Number'd* is perhaps *numerous*. *Twinn'd stones* I do not understand. *Twinn'd shells*, or *pairs of shells*, are very common. For *twinn'd*, we might read *twin'd*; that is, *twisted*, *convolved*; but this sense is more applicable to shells than to stones.

I.vi.44 (181,3)

Sluttery, to such neat excellence oppos'd,

Should make desire vomit emptiness,

Not so allur'd to feed]

[i.e. that appetite, which is not allured to feed on such excellence, can have no stomach at all; but, though empty, must nauseate every thing. WARB.] I explain this passage in a sense almost contrary. Iachimo, in this counterfeited rapture, has shewn how the *eyes* and the *judgment* would determine in favour of Imogen, comparing her with the present mistress of Posthumus, and proceeds to say, that appetite too would give the same suffrage. *Desire*, says he, when it approached *sluttery*, and considered it in comparison with *such neat excellence*, would not only be *not so allured to feed*, but, seized with a fit of loathing, *would vomit emptiness*, would feel the convulsions of disgust, though, being unfed, it had nothing to eject. [Tyrwhitt: vomit, emptiness ... allure] This is not ill conceived; but I think my own explanation right. *To vomit emptiness* is, in the language of poetry, to feel the convulsions of eructation without plenitude. (1773)

I.vi.54 (182,4) He's strange, and peevish] He is a foreigner, easily fretted.

I.vi.97 (184,5) timely knowing] Rather timely *known*.

I.vi.99 (184,6) What both you spur and stop] What it is that at once incites you to speak, and restrains you from it. [I think Imogen means to enquire what is that news, that intelligence, or information, you

profess to bring, and yet with-hold: at least, I think Dr. JOHNSON's explanation a mistaken one, for Imogen's request supposes Iachimo an agent, not a patient. HAWKINS.] I think my explanation true. (see 1765, VII, 286, 7)

I.vi.106 (184,7)

join gripes with hands
 Made hard with hourly falshood (falshood as
 With labour) then lye peeping in an eye]
 The old edition reads,
 —join gripes with hands
 Made hard with hourly falshood (*falshood* as
 With labour) then by peeping in an eye, &c.
 I read,
 —then *lye* peeping—

The author of the present regulation of the text I do not know, but have suffered it to stand, though not right. *Hard with falshood* is, hard by being often griped with frequent change of hands.

I.vi.122 (185,8) With tomboys, hir'd with that self-exhibition/ Which your own coffers yield!] *Gross strumpets*, hired with the *very pension* which you allow your husband.

I.vi.152 (186,9) As in a Romish stew] The stews of Rome are deservedly censured by the reformed. This is one of many instances in which Shakespeare has mingled in the manners of distant ages in this play.

II.i.2 (188,1) kiss'd the jack upon an up-cast] He is describing his fate at bowls. The *jack* is the small bowl at which the others are aimed. He who is nearest to it wins. *To kiss the jack* is a state of great advantage. (1773)

II.i.15 (189,2) 2 *Lord*. No, my lord; nor crop the ears of them. [*Aside*.] This, I believe, should stand thus:

1 *Lord*. No, my lord.

2 *Lord*. Nor crop the ears of them, [*Aside*.

II.i.26 (189,3) you crow, cock, with your comb on] The allusion is to a fool's cap, which hath a *comb* like a cock's.

II.i.29 (189,4) every companion] The use of *companion* was the same as of *fellow* now. It was a word of contempt.

II.ii.12 (191,1) our Tarquin] The speaker is an Italian.

II.ii.13 (191,2) Did softly press the rushes] It was the custom in the time of our author to strew chambers with rushes, as we now cover them with carpets. The practice is mentioned in *Caius de Ephemera Britannica*.

II.iii.24 (194,2) *His steeds to water at those springs On chalic'd flowers that lies*]

Hanmer reads,
Each *chalic'd* flower supplies;
to escape a false concord: but correctness must not be obtained by such licentious alterations. It may be noted, that the *cup* of a flower is called *calix*, whence *chalice*.

II.iii.28 (195,3) *With, every thing that pretty bin*] is very properly restored by Hanmer, for *pretty is*; but he too grammatically reads,
With all the things that pretty bin.

II.iii.102 (197,5) one of your great knowing/Should learn, being taught, forbearance] i.e. A man *who is taught forbearance should learn it*.

II.iii.111 (198,7) so verbal] Is, so *verbose*, so full of talk.

II.iii.118-129 (199,8) The contract you pretend with that base wretch] Here Shakespeare has not preserved, with his common nicety, the uniformity of character. The speech of Cloten is rough and harsh, but certainly not the talk of one,

Who can't take two from twenty, for his heart,
And leave eighteen. —

His argument is just and well enforced, and its prevalence is allowed throughout all civil nations: as for rudeness, he seems not to be much undermatched.

II.iii.124 (199,9) in self-figur'd knot] [This is nonsense. We should read,

—SELF-FINGER'D *knot*;

WARBURTON.] But why nonsense? A *self-figured knot* is a knot formed by yourself. (see 1765, VII, 301, 8)

II.iv.71 (204,4) And Cydnus swell'd above the banks, or for/ The press of boats, or pride] [This is an agreeable ridicule on poetical exaggeration, which gives human passions to inanimate things: and particularly, upon what he himself writes in the foregoing play on this very subject:

"—And made

The water, which they beat, to follow faster,
As amorous of their strokes."

WARBURTON.] It is easy to sit down and give our author meanings which he never had. Shakespeare has no great right to censure poetical exaggeration, of which no poet is more frequently guilty. That he intended to ridicule his own lines is very uncertain, when there are no means of knowing which of the two plays was written first. The commentator has contented himself to suppose, that the foregoing play in his book was the play of earlier composition. Nor is the reasoning better than the assertion. If the language of Iachimo be such as shews him to be mocking the credibility of his hearer, his language is very improper, when his business was to deceive. But the truth is, that his language is such as a skilful villain would naturally use, a mixture of airy triumph and serious deposition. His gaiety shews his seriousness to be without anxiety, and his seriousness proves his gaiety to be without art.

II.iv.83 (205,5) never saw I figures/ So likely to report themselves] So near to speech. The Italians call a portrait, when the likeness is remarkable, a *speaking picture*.

II.iv.84 (205,6) the cutter/ Was as another nature, dumb, out-went her;/ Motion and breath left out] [W: done; out-went her.] This emendation I think needless. The meaning is this, The *sculptor* was as *nature*, but as *nature dumb*; he gave every thing that nature gives, but *breath* and *motion*. In *breath* is included *speech*.

II.iv.91 (205,7) *Post.* This is her honour!] [T: What's this t'her honour?] This emendation has been followed by both the succeeding editors, but I think it must be rejected. The expression is ironical. Iachimo relates many particulars, to which Posthumus answers with impatience, This is her honour! That is, And the attainment of this knowledge is to pass for the corruption of her honour.

II.iv.95 (206,8) if you can/ Be pale] If you can forbear to flush your cheek with rage.

II.iv.110 (207,9)

The vows of women

Of no more bondage be, to where they are made,
Than they are to their virtues]

The love vowed by women no more abides with him to whom it is vowed, than women adhere to their virtue.

II.iv.127 (207,2) The cognizance] The badge; the token; the visible proof.

III.i.26 (211,2) and his shipping,/(Poor ignorant baubles!) on our terrible seas] [*Ignorant, for of no use.* WARB.] Rather, *unacquainted* with the nature of our boisterous seas.

III.i.51 (212,3) against all colour] Without any pretence of right.

III.i.73 (213,5) keep at utterance] [i.e. At extreme distance. WARB.] More properly, in a state of hostile defiance, and deadly opposition.

III.i.73 (213,6) I am perfect] I am well informed. So, in Macbeth, "— in your state of honour *I am perfect.*" (see 1765, VII, 314,7)

III.ii.4 (214,2) What false Italian (As poisonous tongu'd as handed)] About Shakespeare's time the practice of poisoning was very common in Italy, and the suspicion of Italian poisons yet more common.

III.ii.9 (214,3) take in some virtue] To *take in* a town, is to *conquer* it.

III.ii.34 (215,6) For it doth physic love] That is, grief for absence, keeps love in health and vigour.

III.ii.47 (215,8) *loyal to his vow, and your increasing in love*] I read, Loyal to his vow and *you*, increasing in love.

III.ii.79 (216,1) A franklin's housewife] A *franklin* is literally a *freeholder*, with a small estate, neither *villain* nor *vassal*.

III.ii.80 (217,2)

I see before me, man, nor here, nor here,
Nor what ensues; but have a fog in them,
That I cannot look thro']

This passage may, in my opinion, be very easily understood, without any emendation. The lady says, "I can see neither one way nor other, before me nor behind me, but all the ways are covered with an impenetrable fog." There are objections insuperable to all that I can propose, and since reason can give me no counsel, I will resolve at once to follow my inclination.

III.iii.5 (218,2) giants may jet through/ And keep their impious turbans on] The idea of a *giant* was, among the readers of romances, who were almost all the readers of those times, always confounded with that of a Saracen.

III.iii.16 (218,3) This service it not service, so being done,/ But being so allow'd] In war it is not sufficient to do duty well; the advantage rises not from the act, but the acceptance of the act.

III.iii.23 (219,5) Richer, than doing nothing for a babe] I have always suspected that the right reading of this passage is what I had not in my former edition the confidence to propose: Richer, than doing nothing for a *brabe*.

Brabium is a badge of honour, or the ensign of an honour, or any thing worn as a mask of dignity. The word was strange to the editors as it will be to the reader: they therefore changed it to *babe*; and I am forced to propose it without the support of any authority. *Brabium* is a word found in Holyoak's Dictionary, who terms it a *reward*. Cooper, in his *Thesaurus*, defines it to be a *prize, or reward for any game*. (1773) (rev. 1778, IX, 248, 8)

III.iii.35 (219,6) To stride a limit] To overpass his bound.

III.iii.35 (220,7) What should we speak of,/ When we are as old as you?] This dread of an old age, unsupplied with matter for discourse and meditation, is a sentiment natural and noble. No state can be more destitute than that of him who, when the delights of sense forsake him, has no pleasures of the mind.

III.iii.82 (221,9)

tho' trained up thus meanly

I' the cave, wherein they bow, their thoughts do hit

The roof of palaces]

[W: wherein they bow] HANMER reads,

I' the cave, *here in this brow*. —

I think the reading is this:

I' the cave, wherein the BOW, &c.

That is, they are trained up in the *cave*, where their thoughts in hitting the *bow*, or arch of their habitation, hit the roofs of palaces. In other words, though their condition is low, their thoughts are high. The sentence is at last, as THEOBALD remarks, abrupt, but perhaps no less suitable to Shakespeare. I know not whether Dr. WARBURTON's conjecture be not better than mine.

III.iii.101 (223,2) I stole these babes] Shakespeare seems to intend Belarius for a good character, yet he makes him forget the injury which he has done to the young princes, whom he has robbed of a kingdom only to rob their father of heirs. — The latter part of this soliloquy is very inartificial, there being no particular reason why Belarius should now tell to himself what he could not know better by telling it.

III.iv.15 (224,2) drug-damn'd Italy] This is another allusion to Italian poisons.

III.iv.39 (225,4) Kings, queens, and states] Persons of highest rank.

III.iv.52 (225,6) Some jay of Italy,/Whose mother was her painting] *Some jay of Italy*, made by art the creature, not of nature, but of painting. In this sense *painting* may be not improperly termed her *mother*. (see 1765, VII, 325, 9)

III.iv.63 (226,7) So thou, Posthumus,/Wilt lay the leaven on all proper men] HANMER reads,
—lay the *level*—
without any necessity.

III.iv.97 (228,1) That now thou tir'st on] A hawk is said to *tire* upon that which he pecks; from *tirer*, French.

III.iv.104 (228,2)

I'll wake mine eye-balls blind first.

Imo. Wherefore then]

This is the old reading. The modern editions for *wake* read *break*, and supply the deficient syllable by *ah*, wherefore. I read, I'll wake mine eye-balls *out* first, or, *blind*, first.

III.iv.111 (228,3) To be unbent] To have thy bow unbent, alluding to a hunter.

III.iv.146 (229,4)

Now, if you could wear a mind
Dark as your fortune is, and but disguise
That, which, to appear itself, must not yet be,
But by self-danger]

To wear a dark mind, is to carry a mind impenetrable to the search of others. *Darkness* applied to the *mind* is *secrecy*, applied to the *fortune* is *obscurity*. The next lines are obscure. *You must*, says Pisanio, *disguise that greatness, which, to appear hereafter in its proper form, cannot yet appear without great danger to itself.* (see 1765, VII, 329, 6)

III.iv.149 (230,5) full of view] With opportunities of examining your affairs with your own eyes.

III.iv.155 (230,6) Though peril to my modesty, not death on't,/ I would adventure] I read,

Through peril—

I would for such means adventure through peril of my modesty; I would risque every thing but real dishonour.

III.iv.162 (230,7)

nay, you must
Forget that rarest treasure of your cheek;
Exposing it (but, oh, the harder heart!
Alack, no remedy)]

I think it very natural to reflect in this distress on the cruelty of Posthumus. Dr. WARBURTON proposes to read,

—the harder *hap!*—

III.iv.177 (231,8) which you'll make him know] This is HANMER's reading. The common books have it,

—which *will* make him know.

Mr. THEOBALD, in one of his long notes, endeavours to prove, that it should be,

—which will make him *so*.

He is followed by Dr. WARBURTON.

III.iv.184 (231,9) we'll even/ All that good time will give us] We'll make our work *even* with our *time*; we'll do what time will allow.

III.v.71 (235,2)

And that she hath all courtly parts more exquisite
Than lady, ladies, woman; from every one
The best she hath]

[The second line is intolerable nonsense. It should be read and pointed thus,

Than lady ladies; *winning* from each one.

WARBURTON.]

I cannot perceive the second line to be intolerable, or to be nonsense. The speaker only rises in his ideas. *She has all courtly parts*, says he, *more exquisite than any lady*, than all *ladies*, than all *womankind*. Is this nonsense?

III.v.101 (236,3) *Pia*. Or this, or perish] These words, I think, belong to Cloten, who, requiring the paper, says,

Let's see't: I will pursue her
Even to Augustus' throne. Or this, or perish.
Then Pisanio giving the paper, says to himself,
She's far enough, &c.

III.vi.12 (239,1) To lapse in fullness/ Is sorer, than to lye for need] Is a *greater*, or *heavier* crime.

III.vi.23 (239,3) If any thing that's civil, speak; if savage,/Take, or lend] [W: Take 'or 't end.] I suppose the emendation proposed will not easily be received; it is strained and obscure, and the objection against Hanmer's reading is likewise very strong. I question whether, after the words, *if savage*, a line be not lost. I can offer nothing better than to read,

—Ho! who's here?

If any thing that's civil, *take or lend*,

If savage, *speak*.

If you are *civilised* and *peaceable*, *take a price* for what I want, or *lend* it for a future recompence; if you are *rough inhospitable* inhabitants of the mountain, *speak*, that I may know my state.

III.vi.77 (242,4) then had my prize/ Been less; and so more equal ballasting] HANMER reads plausibly, but without necessity, *price*, for *prize*, and *balancing*, for *ballasting*. He is followed by Dr. WARBUR-

TON. The meaning is, Had I been a less prize, I should not have been too heavy for Posthumus.

III.vi.86 (243,5) That nothing-gift of differing multitudes] [T: deferring] He is followed by Sir T. HANMER and Dr. Warburton; but I do not see why *differing* may not be a general epithet, and the expression equivalent to the *many-headed* rabble.

III.vii.8 (244,2)

and to you, the tribunes,
For this immediate levy, he commands
His absolute commission]

The plain meaning is, he *commands* the commission to be given to you. So we say, I *ordered* the materials to the workmen.

IV.ii.10 (245,1) Stick to your journal course: the breach of custom/ Is breach of all] Keep your *daily* course uninterrupted; if the stated plan of life is once broken, nothing follows but confusion.

IV.ii.17 (246,2) How much the quantity] I read, As much the quantity.—

IV.ii.38 (247,3) I could not stir him] Not *move* him to tell his story.

IV.ii.39 (247,4) gentle, but unfortunate] *Gentle*, is *well born*, of birth above the vulgar.

IV.ii.59 (248,6) And let the stinking elder, Grief, untwine/ His perishing root, with the encreasing vine!] Shakespeare had only seen *English vines* which grow against walls, and therefore may be sometimes entangled with the *elder*. Perhaps we should read *untwine from the vine*.

IV.ii.105 (251,9) the snatches in his vice,/ And burst of speaking] This is one of our author's strokes of observation. An abrupt and tumultuous utterance very frequently accompanies a confused and cloudy understanding.

IV.ii.111 (251,1) for the effect of judgment/Is oft the cause of fear] HANMER reads, with equal justness of sentiment,

—for defect of judgment

Is oft the *cure* of fear.—

But, I think, the play of *effect* and *cause* more resembling the manner of our author.

IV.ii.118 (252,2) I am perfect, what] I am *well informed*, what. So in this play,

I'm *perfect*, the Pannonians are in arms.

IV.ii.121 (252,3) take us in] To *take in*, was the phrase in use for to *apprehend* an out-law, or to make him amenable to public justice.

IV.ii.148 (253,5) the boy Fidele's sickness/ Did make my way long forth] Fidele's sickness made my *walk forth* from the cave *tedious*.

IV.ii.159 (254,6) revenges/ That possible strength might meet] Such pursuit of vengeance as fell within any possibility of opposition.

IV.ii.168 (254,7) I'd let a parish of such Clotens blood] [W: marish] The learned commentator has dealt the raproach of nonsense very liberally through this play. Why this is nonsense, I cannot discover. I would, says the young prince, to recover Fidele, kill as many Clotens as would fill a *parish*.

IV.ii.246 (258,1) He was paid for that] HANMER reads,

He *has* paid for that:—

rather plausibly than rightly. *Paid* is for *punished*. So JONSON, "Twenty things more, my friend, which you know due, For which, or pay me quickly, or I'll *pay* you."

(see 1765, VII, 356, 3)

IV.ii.247 (258,2) reverence,/ (That angel of the world)] *Reverence*, or due regard to subordination, is the power that keeps peace and order in the world.

IV.ii.268 (259,4) *The scepter, learning, physic, must/ All follow this, and come to dust*] The poet's sentiment seems to have been this. All human excellence is equally the subject to the stroke of death: neither the power of kings, nor the science of scholars, nor the art of those whose immediate study is the prolongation of life, can protect then from the final destiny of man. (1773)

IV.ii.272 (260,5) *Fear not slander, censure rash*] Perhaps, Fear not *slander's* censure rash.

IV.ii.275 (260,6) Consign to thee] Perhaps, Consign to *this*. And in the former stanza, for *all follow this*, we might read, *all follow thee*.

IV.ii.280 (260,7) Both. *Quiet consummation have;/ And renowned be thy grave!*] For the obsequies of Fidele, a song was written by my unhappy friend, Mr. William Collins of Chichester, a man of uncommon learning and abilities. I shall give it a place at the end in honour of his memory.

IV.ii.315 (262,1) Conspired with] The old copy reads thus,
 —thou
 Conspir'd with that irregulous divel, Cloten.
 I suppose it should be,
 Conspir'd with *th' irreligious* devil, Cloten.

IV.ii.346 (263,2) Last night the very gods shew'd me a vision] [W: warey] Of this meaning I know not any example, nor do I see any need of alteration. It was no common dream, but sent from *the very gods*, or the gods themselves.

IV.ii.363 (264,3)

who was he,
 That, otherwise than noble nature did,
 Hath alter'd that good figure?]

Here are many words upon a very slight debate. The sense is not much cleared by either critic [Theobald and Warburton]. The question is asked, not about a *body*, but a *picture*, which is not very apt to grow shorter or longer. To *do* a picture, and a picture is well *done*, are standing phrases; the question therefore is, Who has altered this picture, so as to make it otherwise than nature *did* it.

IV.ii.389 (266,5) these poor pickaxes] Meaning her fingers.

IV.iii (266,1) *Cymbeline's palace*] This scene is omitted against all authority by Sir T. HANMER. It is indeed of no great use in the progress of the fable, yet it makes a regular preparation for the next act.

IV.iii.22 (267,3) our jealousy/ Does yet depend] My suspicion is yet undetermined; if I do not condemn you, I likewise have not acquitted you. We now say, the *cause* is *depending*.

IV.iii.29 (267,4) Your preparation can affront no less/ Than what you hear of] Your forces are able to *face* such an army as we hear the enemy will bring against us.

IV.iii.44 (268,6) to the note o' the king] I will so distinguish myself, the king shall remark my valour.

IV.iv.11 (269,1) a render/Where we have liv'd] An account of our place of abode. This dialogue is a just representation of the superfluous caution of an old man.

IV.iv.13 (269,2) That which we have done, whose answer would be death] The *retaliation* of the death of Cloten would be *death*, &c.

IV.iv.18 (269,3) their quarter'd fires] Their fires regularly disposed.

V.i (271,1) *Enter Posthumus, with a bloody handkerchief*] The bloody token of Imogen's death, which Pisanio in the foregoing act determined to send.

V.i.1-33 (271,2) Yea, bloody cloth, I'll keep thee] This is a soliloquy of nature, uttered when the effervescence of a mind agitated and perturbed spontaneously and inadvertently discharges itself in words. The speech, throughout all its tenor, if the last conceit be excepted, seems to issue warm from the heart. He first condemns his own violence; then tries to disburden himself, by imputing part of the crime to Pisanio; he next soothes his mind to an artificial and momentary tranquility, by trying to think that he has been only an instrument of the gods for the happiness of Imogen. He is now grown reasonable enough to determine, that having done so much evil he will do no more; that he will not fight against the country which he has already injured; but as life is not longer supportable, he will die in a just cause, and die with the obscurity of a man who does not think himself worthy to be remembered.

V.i.9 (271,3) to put on] Is to *incite*, to *instigate*.

V.i.14 (272,4) To second ills with ills, each elder worse] For this reading all the later editors have contentedly taken,

—each worse than other,

without enquiries whence they have received it. Yet they know, or might know, that it has no authority. The original copy reads,

—each elder worse,

The last deed is certainly not the oldest, but Shakespeare calls the *deed* of an *elder* man an *elder deed*.

V.i.15 (272,5) And make them dread it, to the doers' thrift] [T: dreaded, to] This emendation is followed by HANMER. Dr. WARBURTON reads, I know not whether by the printer's negligence,

And make them *dread*, to the doers' thrift.

There seems to be no very satisfactory sense yet offered. I read, but with hesitation,

And make them *deeded*, to the doers' thrift.

The word *deeded* I know not indeed where to find; but Shakespeare has, in another sense *undeeded*, in *Macbeth*:

"—my sword

"I sheath again *undeeded*."—

I will try again, and read thus,

—others you permit

To second ills with ills, each other worse,

And make them *trade it*, to the doers' thrift.

Trade and *thrift* correspond. Our author plays with *trade*, as it signifies a lucrative vocation, or a frequent practice. So Isabella says,

"Thy sins, not accidental, but a *trade*."

V.i.16 (273,9) Do your best wills,/ And make me blest to obey!] So the copies. It was more in the manner of our author to have written,

—Do your blest wills,

And make me blest t' obey.—

V.iii.41 (276,3) A rout, confusion thick] [W: confusion-thick] I do not see what great addition is made to *fine diction* by this compound. Is it not as natural to enforce the principal event in a story by repetition, as to enlarge the principal figure in a figure?

V.iii.51 (276,4) bugs] Terrors.

V.iii.53 (277,5) Nay, do not wonder at it] [T: do but] There is no need of alteration. Posthumus first bids him not wonder, then tells him in another mode of reproach, that wonder is all that he was made for.

V.iii.79 (278,8) great the answer be] *Answer*, as once in this play before, is *retaliation*.

V.iii.87 (278,9) That gave the affront with them] That is, that turned their faces to the enemy.

V.iv.1 (279,1) You shall not now be stolen, you have locks upon you;/ So, graze, as you find pasture] This wit of the gaoler alludes to the custom of putting a lock on a horse's leg, when he is turned to pasture.

V.iv.27 (280,3) If you will take this audit, take this life,/ And cancel those cold bonds] This equivocal use of *bonds* is another instance of our author's infelicity in pathetic speeches.

V.iv.45 (281,5) That from me my Posthumus ript] The old copy reads, That from me *was* Posthumus ript.
Perhaps we should read,
That from *my womb* Posthumus ript,
Came crying 'mongst his foes.

V.iv.146 (284,7)

'Tis still a dream; or else such stuff, as madmen
Tongue, and brain not: either both or nothing:
Or senseless speaking, or a speaking such
As sense cannot untie. Be what it is,
The action of my life is like it]

The meaning, which is too thin to be easily caught, I take to be this: *This is a dream or madness, or both—or nothing—but whether it be a speech without consciousness, as in a dream, or a speech unintelligible, as in madness, be it as it is, it is like my course of life.* We might perhaps read,

Whether *both, or nothing*—

V.iv.164 (285,8) sorry that you have paid too much, and sorry that you are paid too much] *Tavern bills, says the gaoler, are the sadness of parting, as the procuring of mirth—you depart reeling with too much drink; sorry that you have paid too much, and—what? sorry that you are paid too much.* Where is the opposition? I read, *And merry that you are paid so much.* I take the second *paid* to be *paid*, for *appaid, filled, satiated.*

V.iv.171 (286,9) debtor and creditor] For an *accounting book.*

V.iv.188 (286,1) jump the after-enquiry] That is, *venture* at it without thought. So *Macbeth*,

"We'd *jump* the life to come." (see 1765, VII, 382, 7)

V.v.9 (288,1) one that promis'd nought/ But beggary and poor looks]
To promise *nothing but* poor looks, may be, to give no promise of courageous behaviour.

V.v.88 (291,2) So feat] So ready; so dextrous in waiting.

V.v.93 (291,3) His favour is familiar to me] I am acquainted with his countenance.

V.v.120 (292,4) One sand another/ Not more resembles. That sweet rosy lad] [W: resembles, than be th' sweet] There was no great difficulty in the line, which, when properly pointed, needs no alteration.

V.v.203 (296,8) averring notes/ Of chamber-hanging, pictures] Such marks of the chamber and pictures, as *averred* or confirmed my report.

V.v.220 (297,9) the temple/ Of virtue was she; yea, and she herself]
That is, She was not only *the temple of virtue*, but *virtue herself*.

V.v.233 (297,1) these staggers] This wild and delirious perturbation. *Staggers* is the horse's apoplexy.

V.v.262 (298,2) Think, that you are upon a rock; and now/ Throw me again] In this speech, or in the answer, there is little meaning. I suppose, she would say, Consider such another act as equally fatal to me with precipitation from a rock, and now let me see whether you will repeat it.

V.v.308 (300,3) By tasting of our wrath] [W: hasting] There is no need of change; the consequence is taken for the whole action; *by tasting* is *by forcing us to make thee taste*.

V.v.334 (301,5) Your pleasure was my near offence, my punishment,/ Itself, and all my treason] I think this passage may better be read thus,

Your pleasure was my *dear* offence, my punishment
Itself *was* all my treason; that I suffer'd,
Was all the harm I did. —

The offence which cost me so *dear* was only your caprice. My sufferings have been all my crime.

V.v.352 (302,6)

Thou weep'st, and speak'st.
The service that you three have done is more

Unlike than this thou tell'st]

"Thy tears give testimony to the sincerity of thy relation; and I have the less reason to be incredulous, because the actions which you have done within my knowledge are more incredible than the story which you relate." The king reasons very justly.

V.v.378 (303,7) When ye were so, indeed] The folio gives,

When *we* were so, indeed.

If this be right, we must read,

Imo. I, you brothers.

Arv. When we were so, indeed.

V.v.382 (303,8) fierce abridgment] *Fierce*, is *vehement*, *rapid*.

V.v.459 (306,1) My peace we will begin] I think it better to read,

By peace we will begin.—

(307) General Observation. This play has many just sentiments, some natural dialogues, and some pleasing scenes, but they are obtained at the expence of much incongruity. To remark the folly of the fiction, the absurdity of the conduct, the confusion of the names, and manners of different times, and the impossibility of the events in any system of life, were to waste criticism upon unresisting imbecility, upon faults too evident for detection, and too gross for aggravation.

KING LEAR

I.i.4 (311,2) in the division of the kingdom] There is something of obscurity or inaccuracy in this preparatory scene. The king has already divided his kingdom, and yet when he enters he examines his daughters, to discover in what proportions he should divide it. Perhaps Kent and Gloucester only were privy to his design, which he still kept in his own hands, to be changed or performed as subsequent reasons should determine him.

I.i.37 (313,7) express our darker purpose] [*Darker*, for more secret; not for indirect, oblique. Warburton.] This word may admit a further explication. *We shall express our darker purpose*: that is, we have already made known in some measure our design of parting the kingdom; we will now discover what has not been told before, the reasons by which we shall regulate the partition. This interpretation will justify or palliate the exordial dialogue.

I.i.39 (313,8) and 'tis our fast intent] [This is an interpolation of Mr. Lewis Theobald, for want of knowing the meaning of the old reading in the quarto of 1608, and first folio of 1623; where we find it,

—and 'tis our *first* intent.

Warburton.]

Fast is the reading of the first folio, and, I think, the true reading.

I.i.44 (314,9) We have this hour a constant will] *constant will* seems a confirmation of *fast* intent.

I.i.62 (314,2) Beyond all manner of so much I love you] Beyond all assignable quantity. I love you beyond limits, and cannot say it is *so much*, for how much soever I should name, it would yet be more.

I.i.73 (315,4)

I find, she names my very deed of love,

Only she comes too short; that I profess]

That seems to stand without relation, but is referred to *find*, the first conjunction being inaccurately suppressed. I find *that* she names my deed, I find that I profess, &c.

I.i.76 (315,5) Which the most precious square of sense possesses] [Warburton explained "square" as the "four nobler senses"] This is acute; but perhaps *square* means only *compass, comprehension*.

I.i.80 (315,6) More pond'rous than my tongue] [W: their tongue] I think the present reading right.

I.i.84 (316,8) Now our joy] Here the true reading is picked out of two copies. Butter's quarto reads,

—But now our joy,
Although the last, not least in our dear love,
What can you say to win a third, &c.
The folio,
—Now our joy,
Although our last, *and* least; to whose young love
The vines of France, and milk of Burgundy,
Strive to be int'ress'd. *What can you say?*

I.i.138 (318,5) The sway, revenue, execution of the rest] [W: of th' hest] I do not see any great difficulty in the words, *execution of the rest*, which are in both the old copies. The *execution of the rest* is, I suppose, *all the other business*. Dr. Warburton's own explanation of his amendment confutes it; if *hest* be a *regal command*, they were, by the grant of Lear, to have rather the *hest* than the execution.

1.1.149 (319,6)

Think'st thou, that duty shall have dread to speak,
When power to flattery bows? To plainness honour's bound,
When majesty stoops to folly. Reverse thy doom,
And in thy best consideration check
This hideous rashness: answer my life my judgment,
Thy youngest daughter does not love thee least]

I have given this passage according to the old folio, from which the modern editions have silently departed, for the sake of better numbers, with a degree of insincerity, which, if not sometimes detected and censured, must impair the credit of ancient books. One of the editors, and perhaps only one, knew how much mischief may be done by such clandestine alterations. The quarto agrees with the folio, except that for *reserve thy state*, it gives, *reverse thy doom*, and has *stoops* instead of *falls to folly*. The meaning of *answer my life my judgment*, is, *Let my life be answerable for my judgment*, or, *I will stake my life on my*

opinion.—The reading which, without any right, has possessed all the modern copies is this;

—to plainness honour

Is bound, when majesty to folly falls.

Reserve thy state; with better judgment check

This hideous rashness; with my life I answer,

Thy youngest daughter, &c.

I am inclined to think that *reverse thy doom* was Shakespeare's first reading, as more apposite to the present occasion, and that he changed it afterwards to *reserve thy state*, which conduces more to the progress of the action.

I.i.161 (320,9) The true blank of thine eye] The *blank* is the *white* or exact mark at which the arrow is shot. *See better*, says Kent, and *keep me always in your view*.

I.i.172 (320,1) strain'd pride] The oldest copy reads *strayed pride*; that is, *pride exorbitant*; pride passing due bounds.

I.i.174 (320,3) Which nor our nature, nor our place, can bear;/ Our potency made good] [T: (Which ... bear) ... made good] [Warburton defended "make"] Theobald only inserted the parenthesis; he found *made good* in the best copy of 1623. Dr. Warburton has very acutely explained and defended the reading that he has chosen, but I am not certain that he has chosen right. If we take the reading of the folio, *our potency made good*, the sense will be less profound indeed, but less intricate, and equally commodious. *As thou hast come with unreasonable pride between the sentence which I had passed, and the power by which I shall execute it, take thy reward in another sentence which shall make good, shall establish, shall maintain, that power.* If Dr. Warburton's explanation be chosen, and every reader will wish to choose it, we may better read,

Which nor our nature, nor our state can bear,

Or potency make good.—

Mr. Davies thinks, that *our potency made good* relates only to *our place*.—Which our nature cannot bear, nor our *place*, without departure from the *potency* of that place. This is easy and clear.—Lear, who is characterized as hot, heady, and violent, is, with very just observation of life, made to entangle himself with vows, upon any sudden provocation to vow revenge, and then to plead the obligation of a vow in defence of implacability.

I.i.181 (322,4) By Jupiter] Shakespeare makes his Lear too much a mythologist: he had Hecate and Apollo before.

I.i.190 (322,6) He'll shape his old course] He will follow his old maxims; he will continue to act upon the same principles.

I.i.201 (323,7) If aught within that little, seeming, substance] *Seeming is beautiful.*

I.i.209 (323,9) Election makes not up on such conditions] To *make up* signifies to complete, to conclude; as, *they made up the bargain*; but in this sense it has, I think, always the subject noun after it. To *make up*, in familiar language, is, neutrally, *to come forward*, to *make advances*, which, I think, is meant here.

I.i.221 (324,2)

Sure her offence
Must be of such unnatural degree,
That monsters it: or your fore-vouch'd affection
Fall into taint]
The common books read,
—or your fore-vouch'd affection
Fall'n into taint:—

This line has no clear or strong sense, nor is this reading authorized by any copy, though it has crept into all the late editions. The early quarto reads,

—or you for vouch'd affections
Fall'n into taint.—
The folio,
—or your fore-vouch'd affection
Fall into taint.—

Taint is used for *corruption* and for *disgrace*. If therefore we take the oldest reading it may be reformed thus:

—sure her offence
Must be of such unnatural degree,
That monsters it; or you for vouch'd affection
Fall into taint.

Her offence must be prodigious, or *you* must *fall into reproach* for having *vouched affection* which you did not feel. If the reading of the folio be preferred, we may with a very slight change produce the same sense:

—sure her offence
 Must be of such unnatural degree,
 That monsters it, or your fore-vouch'd affection
Falls into taint. —

That is, *falls into reproach or censure*. But there is another possible sense. *Or* signifies *before*, and *or ever* is *before ever*; the meaning in the folio may therefore be, *Sure her crime must be monstrous before your affection can be affected with hatred*. Let the reader determine. — As I am not much a friend to conjectural emendation, I should prefer the latter sense, which requires no change of reading.

I.i.243 (325,3) from the intire point] *Intire*, for right, true. WARB.]
 Rather, single, unmixed with other considerations.

I.i.264 (326,5) Thou lovest here, better where to find] *Here* and *where*
 have the power of nouns. Thou lovest this residence to find a better
 residence in another place.

I.i.282 (326,6) And well are worth the want that you have wanted]
 [This I take to be the poet's meaning, stript of the jingle which
 makes it dark: "You well deserve to meet with that *want* of love
 from your husband, which you have professed to *want* for our father."
 THEOBALD.] [W: have vaunted] I think the common reading very
 suitable to the manner of our author, and well enough explained by
 Theobald.

I.i.283 (327,7) plaited cunning] i.e. *complicated, involved* cunning.
 (1773)

I.ii.3 (328,2) Stand in the plague of custom] The word *plague* is in all
 the copies; I can scarcely think it right, nor can I yet reconcile myself
 to the emendation proposed, though I have nothing better to offer
 [Warburton had proposed *plage*].

I.ii.21 (330,7) Shall be the legitimate] [Hanmer: toe th'] Hanmer's
 emendation will appear very plausible to him that shall consult the
 original reading. Butter's quarto reads,

—Edmund the base
 Shall *tooth'* legitimate. —
 The folio,
 —Edmund the base
 Shall *to th'* legitimate. —

Hanmer, therefore, could hardly be charged with coining a word, though his explanation may be doubted. To *toe* him, is perhaps to *kick him out*, a phrase yet in vulgar use; or, to *toe*, may be literally to *supplant*. The word *be* has no authority.

I.ii.24 (331,1) subscrib'd his power!] To subscribe, is, to transfer by signing or *subscribing* a writing of testimony. We now use the term, He *subscribed* forty pounds to the new building.

I.ii.25 (331,2) Confin'd to exhibition!] Is *allowance*. The term is yet used in the universities.

I.ii.25 (331,3) All this done/Upon the gad!] So the old copies; the later editions read,

—All is gone

Upon the gad!—

which, besides that it is unauthorized, is less proper. *To* do upon the *gad*, is, to act by the sudden stimulation of caprice, as cattle run madding when they are stung by the gad fly.

I.ii.47 (332,4) taste of my virtue] Though *taste* may stand in this place, yet I believe we should read, *assay* or *test* of my virtue: they are both metallurgical terms, and properly joined. So in Hamlet,

Bring me to the *test*.

I.ii.51 (323,6) idle and fond] Weak and foolish.

I.ii.95 (333,7) pretence] *Pretence* is design, purpose. So afterwards in this play,

Pretence and purpose of unkindness.

I.ii.106 (333,8) wind me into him] I once thought it should be read, *you* into him; but, perhaps, it is a familiar phrase, like *do me this*.

I.ii.107 (333,9) I would unstate myself to be in a due resolution] [i.e. I will throw aside all consideration of my relation to him, that I may act as justice requires. Warburton.] Such is this learned man's explanation. I take the meaning to be rather this, *Do you frame the business*, who can act with less emotion; *I would unstate myself*; it would in me be a departure from the paternal character, *to be in a due resolution*, to be settled and composed on such an occasion. The words *would* and *should* are in old language often confounded.

I.ii.109 (334,1) convey the business] [*Convey*, for introduce. WARB.] To *convey* is rather to *carry through* than to introduce; in this place it is to *manage artfully*: we say of a juggler, that he has a clean *conveyance*.

I.ii.112 (334,2) These late eclipses in the sun and moon portend no good to us: tho' the wisdom of nature can reason it thus and thus, yet nature finds itself scourg'd by the frequent effects] That is, though natural philosophy can give account of eclipses, yet we feel their consequences.

I.ii.156 (338,8) I promise you, the effects he writes of, succeed unhappily] The folio edition commonly differs from the first quarto, by augmentations or insertions, but in this place it varies by omission, and by the omission of something which naturally introduces the following dialogue. It is easy to remark, that in this speech, which ought, I think, to be inserted as it now is in the text, Edmund, with the common craft of fortune-tellers, mingles the past and future, and tells of the future only what he already foreknows by confederacy, or can attain by probable conjecture. (see 1765, VI, 27, 6)

I.ii.178 (339,1) that with the mischief of your person it would scarcely allay] This reading is in both copies; yet I believe the author gave it, *that* but *with the mischief* of your person it would scarce allay.

I.iii.19 (341,2) Old fools are babes again; and must be us'd/ With checks, as flatteries when they are seen abus'd] These lines hardly deserve a note, though Mr. Theobald thinks them *very fine*. Whether *fools* or *folks* should be read is not worth enquiry. The controverted line is yet in the old quarto, not as the editors represent it, but thus:

With checks as flatteries when they are seen abus'd.

I am in doubt whether there is any error of transcription. The sense seems to be this: *Old men must be treated with checks*, when as *they are seen to be deceived with flatteries*: or, *when they are weak enough to be seen abused by flatteries*, they are then weak enough to be *used with checks*. There is a play of the words *used* and *abused*. To *abuse* is, in our author, very frequently the same as to *deceive*. This construction is harsh and ungrammatical; Shakespeare perhaps thought it vicious, and chose to throw away the lines rather than correct them, nor would now thank the officiousness of his editors, who restore what they do not understand.

I.iv.118 (347,5) Would I had two coxcombs, and two daughters] Two fools caps, intended, as it seems, to mark double folly in the man that gives all to his daughters.

I.iv.133 (347,7) Lend less than thou owest] That is, *do not lend all that thou hast*. To *owe*, in old English, is *to possess*. If *owe* be taken for *to be in debt*, the more prudent precept would be, Lend *more* than thou owest.

I.iv.153-170 (348,9) This dialogue, from *No, lad; teach me*, down to, *Give me an egg*, was restored from the first edition by Mr. Theobald. It is omitted in the folio, perhaps for political reasons, as it seemed to censure monopolies.

I.iv.181 (349,2) Fools ne'er had less grace in a year] There never was a time when fools were less in favour; and the reason is, that they were never so little wanted, for wise men now supply their place. Such I think is the meaning. The old edition has *wit* for *grace*.

I.iv.219 (350,5) That's a sheal'd peascod] i.e. Now a mere husk, which contains nothing. The outside of a king remains, but all the intrinsic parts of royalty are gone: he has nothing to give. (1773)

I.iv.245 (351,3) Whoop, Jug] There are in the fool's speeches several passages which seem to be proverbial allusions, perhaps not now to be understood.

I.iv.256 (352,1) *Fool*. Which they will make an obedient father] [This line I have restored from the quarto. STEEVENS] This note [Tyr-whitt's, quoted by Steevens] is written with confidence disproportionate to the conviction which it can bring. Lear might as well know by the marks and tokens arising from sovereignty, knowledge, and reason, that he had or had not daughters, as he could know by any thing else. But, says he, if I judge by these tokens, I find the persuasion false by which I long thought myself the father of daughters. (1773)

I.iv.302 (355,7) from her derogate body] [*Derogate* for *unnatural*. WARB.] Rather, I think, *degraded; blasted*.

I.iv.320 (356,9)

That these hot tears, which break from me perforce,
Should make thee worth them.—Blasts and fogs upon thee!

The untented woundings of a father's curse
 Pierce every sense about thee! — Old fond eyes,
 Beweep this cause again]

I will transcribe this passage from the first edition, that it may appear to those who are unacquainted with old books, what is the difficulty of revision, and what indulgence is due to those that endeavour to restore corrupted passages. — *That these hot tears, that breake from me perforce, should make the worst blasts and fogs upon the untender woundings of a father's curse, peruse every sense about the old fond eyes, beweep this cause again, &c.*

I.iv.362 (358,3) compact it more] Unite one circumstance with another, so as to make a consistent account.

I.iv.366 (358,4) You are much more at task for want of wisdom] It is a common phrase now with parents and governesses. *I'll take you to task*, i.e. *I will reprehend and correct you*. *To be at task*, therefore, is to be liable to *reprehension and correction*. (1773)

I.v.5 (358,1) I shall be there afore you] He seems to intend to go to his daughter, but it appears afterwards that he is going to the house of Glo'ster.

I.v.25 (359,2) I did her wrong] He is musing on Cordelia.

I.v.42 (359,3) To take it again perforce!] He is meditating on the resumption of his royalty.

II.i.9 (360,1) ear-kissing arguments] Subjects of discourse; topics.

II.i.19 (361,2) queazy question] Something of a *suspicious, questionable, and uncertain nature*. This is, I think, the meaning.

II.i.27 (361,4) have you nothing said/ Upon his party 'gainst the duke of Albany?] I cannot but think the line corrupted, and would read,
Against his party, for the duke of Albany?

II.i.57 (363,7) gasted] Frighted.

II.i.59 (363,8) Not in this land shall he remain uncaught;/ And found — Dispatch] [Not in this land shall he remain uncaught; And found dispatch—the noble duke, &c.]

[W: found, dispatch'd.] I do not see how this change mends the sense: I think it may be better regulated as in the page above. The

sense is interrupted. He shall be caught—and found, *he shall be punished*. Dispatch.

II.i.67 (363,2) And found him pight to do it, with curst speech] *Pight* is *pitched*, fixed, settled. *Curst* is severe, harsh, vehemently angry.

II.i.122 (366,7) Occasions, noble Glo'ster, of some prize] [W: poize] *Prize*, or *price*, for value. (1773)

II.i.126 (366,8) from our home] Not at home, but at some other place.

II.ii.9 (367,1) Lipsbury pinfold] The allusion which seems to be contained in this line I do not understand. In the violent eruption of reproaches which bursts from Kent in this dialogue, there are some epithets which the commentators have left unexpounded, and which I am not very able to make clear. Of a *three-suited knave* I know not the meaning, unless it be that he has different dresses for different occupations. *Lilly-liver'd* is *cowardly*; *white-blooded* and *white-liver'd* are still in vulgar use. An *one-trunk-inheriting slave*, I take to be a wearer of old cast-off cloaths, an inheritor of torn breeches.

II.ii.36 (368,4) barber-monger] Of this word I do not clearly see the force.

II.ii.39 (368,5) Vanity the puppet's] Alluding to the mysteries or allegorical shews, in which vanity, iniquity, and other vices, were personified.

II.ii.45 (369,6) neat slave] You mere slave, you very slave.

II.ii.69 (369,8) Thou whoreson zed; thou unnecessary letter!] I do not well understand how a man is reproached by being called *zed*, nor how Z is an *unnecessary letter*. Scarron compares his deformity to the shape of Z, and it may be a proper word of insult to a crook-backed man; but why should Gonerill's steward be crooked, unless the allusion be to his bending or cringing posture in the presence of his superiors. Perhaps it was written, *thou whoreson C* (for cuckold) *thou unnecessary letter*. C is a letter unnecessary in our alphabet, one of its two sounds being represented by S, and one by K. But all the copies concur in the common reading.

II.ii.87 (371,3) epileptic visage!] The frightened countenance of a man ready to fall in a fit.

II.ii.103 (372,5) constrains the garb/ Quite from his nature] Forces his *outside* or his *appearance* to something totally *different from* his natural disposition.

II.ii.109 (372,8) Than twenty silly ducking observants] [W: silky] The alteration is more ingenious than the arguments by which it is supported.

II.ii.119 (373,8) though I should win your displeasure to intreat me to't] Though I should win you, displeased as you now are, to like me so well as to intreat me to be a knave.

II.ii.167 (375,3)

Good king, that must approve the common saw!
Thou out of heaven's benediction com'at
To the warm sun!]

That art now to exemplify the common proverb, *That out of, &c.* That changest better for worse. Hanmer observes, that it is a proverbial saying, applied to those who are turned out of house and home to the open weather. It was perhaps first used of men dismissed from an hospital, or house of charity, such as was erected formerly in many places for travellers. Those houses had names properly enough alluded to by *heaven's benediction*.

II.ii.173 (376,4)

I know 'tis from Cordelia;
Who hath most fortunately been inform'd
Of my obscur'd coarse, and shall find time
From this enormous state, seeking to give
Losses their remedies]

This passage, which some of the editors have degraded, as spurious, to the margin, and others have silently altered, I have faithfully printed according to the quarto, from which the folio differs only in punctuation. The passage is very obscure, if not corrupt. Perhaps it may be read thus:

—Cordelia—has been—informed.
Of my obscur'd course, and shall find time
From this enormous state-seeking, to give
Losses their remedies.—

Cordelia is informed of our affairs, and when the *enormous* care of *seeking her fortune* will allow her time, she will employ it in remedying

losses. This is harsh; perhaps something better may be found. I have at least supplied the genuine reading of the old copies. *Enormous* is unwonted, out of rule, out of the ordinary course of things.

II.iii.18 (377,2) Poor pelting villages] *Pelting* is, I believe, only an accidental deprivation of *petty*. Shakespeare uses it in the *Midsummer-Night's Dream* of *small brooks*.

II.iii.20 (378,3) Poor Turlygood! poor Tom!] [W: Turlupin] Hanmer reads, *poor* Turlurd. It is probable the word *Turlygood* was the common corrupt pronunciation.

II.iii.21 (378,4) Edgar I nothing am] As Edgar I am out-lawed, dead in law; I have no longer any political existence.

II.iv (378,1) *Changes again to the earl of Glo'ster's castle*] It is not very clearly discovered why Lear comes hither. In the foregoing part he sent a letter to Glo'ster; but no hint is given of its contents. He seems to have gone to visit Glo'ster while Cornwall and Regan might prepare to entertain him.

II.iv.24 (380,4) To do upon respect such violent outrage] To violate the public and venerable character of a messenger from the king.

II.iv.46 (380,7) Winter's not gone yet, if the wild geese fly that way] If this be their behaviour, the king's troubles are not yet at an end.

II.iv.70 (381,9) All that follow their noses are led by their eyes, but blind men; and there's not a nose among twenty, but can smell him that's stinking] There is in this sentence no clear series of thought. If he that follows his nose is led or guided by his eyes, he wants no information from his nose. I persuade myself, but know not whether I can persuade others, that our author wrote thus:—"All men are led by their eyes, but blind men, and they follow their noses; and there's not a nose among twenty but can smell him that's stinking."—Here is a succession of reasoning. You ask, why the king has no more in his train? why, because men who are led by their eyes see that he is ruined; and if there were any blind among them, who, for want of eyes, followed their noses, they might by their noses discover that it was no longer fit to follow the king.

II.iv.83 (382,2)

But I will tarry; the fool will stay,
And let the wise man fly;
The knave turns fool, that runs away;
The fool no knave, perdy]

I think this passage erroneous, though both the copies concur. The sense will be mended if we read,

But I will tarry; the fool will stay,
And let the wise man fly;
The fool turns knave, that runs away;
The knave no fool,—

That I stay with the king is a proof that I am a fool, the wise men are deserting him. There is knavery in this desertion, but there is no folly.

II.iv.116 (383,3) Is practice only] *Practice* is in Shakespeare, and other old writers, used commonly in an ill sense for *unlawful artifice*.

II.iv.122 (384,4) Cry to it, nuncle, as the cockney did to the eels, when she put them i' the paste alive] Hinting that the eel and Lear are in the same danger.

II.iv.142 (384,7) Than she to scant her duty] The word *scant* is directly contrary to the sense intended. The quarto reads,

—*slack* her duty,
which is no better. May we not change it thus:
You less know bow to value her desert,
Than she to *scan* her duty.

To *scan* may be to *measure* or *proportion*. Yet our author uses his negatives with such licentiousness, that it is hardly safe to make any alteration. — *Scant* may mean to *adapt*, to *fit*, to *proportion*; which sense seems still to be retained in the mechanical term scantling. (see 1765, VI, 67, 4)

II.iv.155 (385,1) Do you but mark how this becomes the house?] [T: the use?] [Warburton called "becomes the house" "a most expressive phrase"] with this *most expressive phrase* I believe no reader is satisfied. I suspect that it has been written originally,

Ask her forgiveness?
Do you but mark how this becometh—thus.
Dear daughter, I confess, &c.

Becomes the house, and becometh thus, might be easily confounded by readers so unskilful as the original printers.

II.iv.157 (386,2) *Age is unnecessary*] i.e. Old age has few wants.

II.iv.162 (386,3) Look'd black upon me] To *look black*, may easily be explained to *look cloudy* or *gloomy*. See Milton:

"So frown'd the mighty combatants, that hell
Grew darker at their frown." —

II.iv.170 (386,4) To fall, and blast her pride!] Thus the quarto: the folio reads not so well, *to fall and blister*. I think there is still a fault, which may be easily mended by changing a letter:

— Infect her beauty,
Ye fen-suck'd fogs, drawn by the powerful sun,
Do, fall, and blast her pride!

II.iv.174 (387,6) Thy tender-hested nature shall not give/ Thee o'er to harshness] This word, though its general meaning be plain, I do not critically understand.

II.iv.178 (387,7) to scant my sizes] To contract my allowances or proportions settled.

II.iv.203 (388,9) much less advancement] The word *advancement* is ironically used here for *conspicuousness* of punishment; as we now say, *a man is advanced to the pillory*. We should read,

—but his own disorders
Deserv'd much *more* advancement.

II.iv.204 (388,1) I pray you, father, being weak, seem so] [W: deem't so] The meaning is, since *you are weak*, be content to think yourself weak. No change is needed.

II.iv.218 (389,3) base life] i.e. In a *servile* state.

II.iv.227 (390,5) embossed carbuncle] *Embossed* is *swelling, protuberant*.

II.iv.259 (391,6) Those wicked creatures yet do look well-favour'd:/ When others are more wicked] Dr. Warburton would exchange the repeated epithet *wicked* into *wrinkled* in both places. The commentator's only objection to the lines as they now stand, is the discrepancy of the metaphor, the want of opposition between *wicked* and

well-favoured. But he might have remembered what he says in his own preface concerning *mixed modes*. Shakespeare, whose mind was more intent upon notions than words, had in his thoughts the pulchritude of virtue, and the deformity of wickedness; and though he had mentioned *wickedness*, made the correlative answer to *deformity*.

III.i.7 (394,1) That things might change, or cease: tears his white hair] The first folio ends the speech at *change, or cease*, and begins again with Kent's question, *But who is with him?* The whole speech is forcible, but too long for the occasion, and properly retrenched.

III.i.18 (395,3) my note] My observation of your character.

III.i.29 (395,6) *are but furnishings*] *Furnishings* are what we now call *colours, external pretences*. (1773)

III.i.19 (395,8)

There is division,
 Although as yet the face of it is cover'd
 with mutual cunning, 'twixt Albany and Cornwall;
Who have (as who have not, whom their great stars
Throne and set high?) servants, who seem no less;
Which are to France the spies and speculations
Intelligent of our state. What hath been seen,
Either in snuffs and packings of the dukes;
Or the hard rein, which both of them have borne
Against the old kind king; or something deeper,
Whereof, perchance, these are but furnishings.
 [But, true it is, from France there comes a power
 Into this scatter'd kingdom; who already,
 Wise in our negligence, have secret fee
 In some of our best ports, and are at point
 To shew their open banner.—Now to you:]]

The true state of this speech cannot from all these notes be discovered. As it now stands it is collected from two editions: the lines which I have distinguished by Italics are found in the folio, not in the quarto; the following lines inclosed in crotchets are in the quarto, not in the folio. So that if the speech be read with omissions of the Italics, it will stand according to the first edition; and if the Italics are read, and the lines that follow them omitted, it will then stand according to the second. The speech is now tedious, because it is formed by

a coalition of both. The second edition is generally best, and was probably nearest to Shakespeare's last copy, but in this passage the first is preferable; for in the folio, the messenger is sent, he knows not why, he knows not whither. I suppose Shakespeare thought his plot opened rather too early, and made the alteration to veil the event from the audience; but trusting too much to himself, and full of a single purpose, he did not accommodate his new lines to the rest of the scene. — The learned critic's [Warburton] emendations are now to be examined. *Scattered* he has changed to *scathed*; for *scattered*, he says, gives the idea of an anarchy, which was not the case. It may be replied that *scathed* gives the idea of ruin, waste, and desolation, which was not the case. It is unworthy a lover of truth, in questions of great or little moment, to exaggerate or extenuate for mere convenience, or for vanity yet less than convenience. *Scattered* naturally means *divided, unsettled, disunited*. — Next is offered with great pomp a change of *sea* to *seize*; but in the first edition the word is *fee*, for *hire*, in the sense of having any one in *fee*, that is, at *devotion for money*. *Fee* is in the second quarto changed to *see*, from which one made *sea* and another *seize*.

III.ii.4 (398,1) thought-executing] Doing execution with rapidity equal to thought.

III.ii.19 (399,4) Here I stand, your slave] [W: brave] The meaning is plain enough, he was not their *slave* by right or compact, but by necessity and compulsion. Why should a passage be darkened for the sake of changing it? Besides, of *brave* in that sense I remember no example.

III.ii.24 (399,5) 'tis foul] Shameful; dishonourable.

III.ii.30 (399,6) So beggars marry many] i.e. A beggar marries a wife and lice.

III.ii.46 (400,1) Man's nature cannot carry/ The affliction, nor the fear] So the folio: the later editions read, with the quarto, *force* for *fear*, less elegantly.

III.ii.56 (401,3) That under covert and convenient seeming] *Convenient* needs not be understood in any other than its usual and proper sense; *accommodate* to the present purpose; *suitable* to a design. *Convenient seeming* is *appearance* such as may promote his purpose to destroy.

III.ii.53 (401,4) concealing continents] *Continent* stands for that which *contains* or *incloses*.

III.ii.72 (401,(5) Poor fool and knave, I have one part in my heart,
That's sorry yet for thee] Some editions read,

—*thing* in my heart;

from which Hanmer, and Dr. Warburton after him, have made *string*, very unnecessarily; both the copies have *part*.

III.ii.74 (402,7)

He that has a little tiny wit, —

With heigh ho, the wind and the rain;

Must make content with his fortunes fit,

Though the rain it raineth every day]

I fancy that the second line of this stanza had once a termination that rhymed with the fourth; but I can only fancy it; for both the copies agree. It was once perhaps written,

With heigh ho, the wind and the rain *in his way*.

The meaning seems likewise to require this insertion. "He that has wit, however small, and finds wind and rain in his way, must content himself by thinking, that somewhere or other *it raineth every day*, and others are therefore suffering like himself." Yet I am afraid that all this is chimerical, for the burthen appears again in the song at the end of *Twelfth Night*, and seems to have been an arbitrary supplement, without any reference to the sense of the song. (see 1765, VI, 84, 6)

III.ii.80 (402,8) I'll speak a prophecy ere I go] [W: or two ere] The sagacity and acuteness of Dr. Warburton are very conspicuous in this note. He has disentangled the confusion of the passage, and I have inserted his emendation in the text. *Or e'er* is proved by Mr. Upton to be good English, but the controversy was not necessary, for *or* is not in the old copies. [Steevens retained "ere"]

III.ii.84 (403,1) No heretics burnt, but wenches' suitors] The disease to which *wenches' suitors* are particularly exposed, was called in Shakespeare's time the *brenning* or *burning*.

III.iv.26 (406,1)

In, boy; go first. [*To the Fool.*] You houseless poverty —

Nay, get thee in. I'll pray, and then I'll sleep]

These two lines were added in the author's revision, and are only in the folio. They are very judiciously intended to represent that hu-

mility, or tenderness, or neglect of forms, which affliction forces on the mind.

III.iv.52 (407,3) led through fire and through flame] Alluding to the *ignis fatuus*, supposed to be lights kindled by mischievous beings to lead travellers into destruction.

III.iv.54 (407,4) laid knives under his pillow] He recounts the temptations by which he was prompted to suicide; the opportunities of destroying himself, which often occurred to him in his melancholy moods.

III.iv.60 (407,5) Bless thee from whirlwinds, star-blasting, and taking!] To *take* is to blast, or strike with malignant influence:

—strike her young limbs,
Ye taking airs, with lameness.

III.iv.77 (408,6) pelican daughters] The young pelican is fabled to suck the mother's blood.

III.iv.95 (408,8) light of ear] [i.e. Credulous. Warburton.] Not merely *credulous*, but *credulous of evil*, ready to receive malicious reports. (1773)

III.iv.103 (409,1) says suum, mun, ha no nonny, dolphin my boy, boy, Sessy: let him trot by] Of this passage I can make nothing. I believe it corrupt: for wildness, not nonsense, is the effect of a disordered imagination. The quarto reads, *hay no on ny, dolphins, my boy, cease, let him trot by*. Of interpreting this there is not much hope or much need. But any thing may be tried. The madman, now counterfeiting a proud fit, supposes himself met on the road by some one that disputes the way, and cries *Hey!—No—*but altering his mind, condescends to let him pass, and calls to his boy *Dolphin* (Rodolph) not to contend with him. *On—Dolphin, my boy, cease. Let him trot by*.

III.iv.122 (410,3) web and the pin] Diseases of the eye.

III.iv.125 (411,4)

Saint Withold footed thrice the void;
He met the night-mare, and her nine-fold;
Bid her alight, and her troth plight,
And aroynt thee, witch, aroynt thee!]

In the old quarto the corruption is such as may deserve to be noted. "Swithold footed thrice the old another night moore and her nine fold bid her, O light, and her troth plight, and arint thee, with arint thee."

III.iv.144 (412,6) *small deer*] Sir Thomas Hanmer reads *geer*, and is followed by Dr. Warburton. But *deer* in old language is a general word for wild animals.

III.iv.187 (414,8) *Child Rowland*] This word is in some of our ballads. There is a song of *Child Walter, and a Lady*.

III.v.21 (415,2) If I find him comforting the king] He uses the word in the juridical sense for *supporting, helping*, according to its derivation; *salvia* comfortat *ne vos*.—*Schol. Sal.* (rev. 1778, IX, 477, 3)

III.vi.20 (416,2) a horse's health] [W: heels] Shakespeare is here speaking not of things maliciously treacherous, but of things uncertain and not durable, A horse is above all other animals subject to diseases.

III.vi.26 (416,3) Wantest thou eyes at trial, madam?] It may be observed that Edgar, being supposed to be found by chance, and therefore to have no knowledge of the rest, connects not his ideas with those of Lear, but pursues his own train of delirious or fantastic thought. To these words, *At trial, madam?* I think therefore that the name of Lear should be put. The process of the dialogue will support this conjecture. (1773)

III.vi.27 (417,4) *Come oe'er the broom, Bessy, to me*] As there is no relation between *broom* and a *boat*, we may better read,
Come o'er the *brook*, Bessy, to me.

III.vi.43 (417,6)

Sleepest, or wakest thou, jolly shepherd?

Thy sheep be in the corn;

And for one blast of thy minikin mouth,

Thy sheep shall take no harm.]

This seems to be a stanza of some pastoral song. A shepherd is desired to pipe, and the request is enforced by a promise, that though his sheep be in the corn, i.e. committing a trespass by his negligence, implied in the question, *Sleepest thou or wakest?* Yet a single tune upon his pipe shall secure them from the pound. (1773)

III.vi.77 (419,8) Sessy, come] Here is *sessey* again, which I take to be the French word *cessez* pronounced *cessey*, which was, I suppose, like some others in common use among us. It is an interjection enforcing cessation of any action, like, *be quiet, have done*. It seems to have been gradually corrupted into, *so, so*.

III.vi.78 (419,9) thy horn is dry] Men that begged under pretence of lunacy used formerly to carry a horn, and blow it through the streets.

III.vi.103-121 (420,2) [*Kent*. Opprest nature sleeps] The lines inserted from the quarto are in crotchets. The omission of them in the folio is certainly faulty: yet I believe the folio is printed from Shakespeare's last revision, carelessly and hastily performed, with more thought of shortening the scenes, than of continuing the action.

III.vi.111 (421,4) free things] States clear from distress.

III.vi. 117 (421,5)

Mark the high noises! and thyself bewray,
When false opinion, whose wrong thought defiles thee,
In thy just proof, repeals, and reconciles thee]

Attend to the great events that are approaching, and make thyself known. Then that *false opinion* now prevailing against thee shall, in consequence of *just proof* of thy integrity, revoke its erroneous sentence, and recall thee to honour and reconciliation.

III.vii.13 (421,6) ray lord of Glo'ster] Meaning Edmund, newly invested with his father's titles. The steward, speaking immediately after, mentions the old duke by the same title.

III.vii.24 (422,3)

Though well we may not pass upon his life
Without the form of justice; yet our power
Shall do a courtesy to our wrath]

To do a courtesy is to gratify, to comply with. *To pass*, is to pass a judicial sentence. (1773)

III.vii.29 (422,4) corky arms] Dry, wither'd, husky arms.

III.vii.54 (424,9) I am ty'd to the stake, and I must stand the course]
The running of the dogs upon me.

III.vii.65 (425,2) All cruels else subscrib'd] Yielded, submitted to the necessity of the occasion.

III.vii.99-107 (426,3) I'll never care what wickedness I do] [This short dialogue I have inserted from the old quarto, because I think it full of nature. Servants could hardly see such a barbarity committed on their master, without pity; and the vengeance that they presume canst overtake the actors of it is a sentiment and doctrine well worthy of the stage. THEOBALD.] It is not necessary to suppose them the servants of Glo'ster; for Cornwall was opposed to extremity by his own servant.

IV.i.1 (427,1) Yet better thus, and known to be contemn'd] The meaning is, *'Tis better to be thus contemned, and known to yourself to be contemned.* Or perhaps there is an error, which may be rectified thus:

Yet better thus unknown to be contemn'd.

When a man divests himself of his real character he feels no pain from contempt, because he supposes it incurred only by a voluntary disguise which he can throw off at pleasure. I do not think any correction necessary.

IV.i.20 (429,3) Our mean secures us] [i.e. Moderate, mediocre condition. WARBURTON.] Banner writes, by an easy change, *meanness* secures us. The two original editions have,

Our *meanes* secures us. —

I do not remember that *mean* is ever used as a substantive for low fortune, which is the sense here required, nor for mediocrity, except in the phrase, the *golden mean*. I suspect the passage of corruption, and would either read,

Our means *seduce* us: —

Our powers of body or fortune draw us into evils. Or,

Our *maims* secure us. —

That hurt or deprivation which makes us defenceless, proves our safeguard. This is very proper in Glo'ster, newly maimed by the evulsion of his eyes.

IV.i.59-64 (431,8) [Five fiends have been in poor Tom at once; of lust, as *Obidicut*; *Hobbididance*, prince of dumbness; *Mahu*, of stealing; *Modo*, of murder; and *Flibbertigibbet*, of mopping and mowing; who since possesses chamber-maids and waiting-women. So bless thee,

master!]] The passage in crotchets is omitted in the folio, because I suppose as the story was forgotten, the jest was lost.

IV.i.68 (432,1) Let the superfluous and lust-dieted man] Lear has before uttered the same sentiment, which indeed cannot be too strongly impressed, tho' it may be too often repeated.

IV.i.69 (432,2) That slaves your ordinance] [W: *braves*] The emendation is plausible, yet I doubt whether it be right. The language of Shakespeare is very licentious, and his words have often meanings remote from the proper and original use. To *slave* or *beslave* another is to *treat him with terms of indignity*; in a kindred sense, to *slave the ordinance*, may be, to *slight or ridicule* it.

IV.ii.1 (433,1) our mild husband] It must be remembered that Albany, the husband of Gonerill, disliked, in the end of the first act, the scheme of oppression and ingratitude.

IV.ii.29 (434,5) I have been worth the whistle] This expression is a reproach to Albany for having neglected her; *though you disregard me thus*, I have been worth the whistle, *I have found one that thinks me worth calling*. (1773)

IV.ii.35 (435,9) From her maternal sap] [W: *material*] I suppose no reader doubts but the word should be *maternal*. Dr. Warburton has taken great pains without much success, and indeed without much exactness of attention, to prove that *material* has a more proper sense than *maternal*, and yet seemed glad at last to infer from an apparent error of another press that *material* and *maternal* meant the same.

IV.ii.45 (436,2) A man, a prince by him so benefited?] [After this line I suspect a line or two to be wanting, which upbraids her for her sister's cruelty to Glo'ster. WARBURTON.] Here is a pompous note to support a conjecture apparently erroneous, and confuted by the next scene, in which the account is given for the first time to Albany of Glo'ster's sufferings.

IV.ii.50 (436,3) Like monsters of the deep] Fishes are the only animals that are known to prey upon their own species.

IV.ii.62 (437,5) Thou changed, and self-cover'd thing] Of these lines there is but one copy, and the editors are forced open conjecture. They have published this line thus;

Thou chang'd, and *self-converted* thing;

but I cannot but think that by *self-cover'd* the author meant, thou that hast *disguised* nature by wickedness; thou that hast *hid* the woman under the fiend.

IV.ii.83 (438,6) One way, I like this well] Gonerill is well pleased that Cornwall is destroyed, who was preparing war against her and her husband, but is afraid of losing Edmund to the widow.

IV.iii (439,1) *The French camp, near Dover. Enter Kent, and a Gentleman*] This scene seems to have been left out only to shorten the play, and is necessary to continue the action. It is extant only in the quarto, being omitted in the first folio. I have therefore put it between crotchets.

IV.iii (439,2) *a Gentleman*] The gentleman whom he sent in the foregoing act with letters to Cordelia.

IV.iii.26 (440,4) Made she no verbal question?] I do not see the impropriety of *verbal question*; such pleonasm is common. So we say, *my ears have heard, my eyes have beheld*. Besides, where is the word *quest* [Warburton's emendation] to be found?

IV.iii.33 (440,6) And clamour-moisten'd] *Clamour moisten'd her*; that is, *her out-cries were accompanied with tears*.

IV.iii.36 (441,7) one self-mate and mate] The same husband and the same wife.

IV.iii.51 (441,9) 'Tis so they are a-foot] Dr. Warburton thinks it necessary to read, *'tis said*; but the sense is plain, *So it is that they are on foot*.

IV.iv.4 (442,1) With bur-docks, hemlock] I do not remember any such plant as a *hardock*, but one of the most common weeds is a *burdock*, which I believe should be read here; and so Hanmer reads.

IV.iv.20 (443,2) the means to lead it] The reason which should guide it.

IV.iv.26 (443,3) My mourning and important tears hath pitied] In other places of this author for *importunate*.

IV.iv.27 (443,4) No blown embition] No inflated, no swelling pride. Beza on the Spanish Armada:

"Quem bene te ambitio mersit vanissima, ventus,

Et tumidos tumidae voa superastis aquae."

IV.v.4 (444,1) *Reg.* Lord Edmund spake not with your lady at home?]
The folio reads, *your lord*; but lady is the first and better reading.

IV.v.22 (444,3) Let me unseal the letter./ *Stew.* Madam, I had rather]
I know not well why Shakespeare gives the steward, who is a mere
factor of wickedness, so much fidelity. He now refuses the letter; and
afterwards, when he is dying, thinks only how it may be safely deliv-
ered.

IV.v.29 (445,5) I do advise you, take this note] *Note* means in this place
not a *letter* but a *remark*. Therefore *observe* what I am saying.

IV.v.32 (446,6) You may gather more] You may infer more than I have
directly told you.

IV.vi (446,1) *The country near Dover. Enter Glo'ster, and Edgar as a peas-
ant*] This scene, and the stratagem by which Glo'ster is cured of his
desperation, are wholly borrowed from Sidney's *Arcadia*.

IV.vi.7 (447,2) thy voice is alter'd] Edgar alters his voice in order to
pass afterwards for a malignant spirit.

IV.vi.11 (447,5) How fearful/ And dizzy 'tis, to cast one's eyes so low!]
This description has been much admired since the time of Addison,
who has remarked, with a poor attempt at pleasantry, that "he who
can read it without being giddy, has a very good head, or a very bad
one." The description is certainly not mean, but I am far from thinking
it wrought to the utmost excellence of poetry. He that looks from
a precipice finds himself assailed by one great and dreadful image
of irresistible destruction. But this overwhelming idea is dissipated
and enfeebled from the instant that the mind can restore itself to the
observation of particulars, and diffuse its attention to distinct objects.
The enumeration of the choughs and crows, the samphire-man, and
the fishers, counteracts the great effect of the prospect, as it peoples
the desert of intermediate vacuity, and stops the mind in the rapidity
of its descent through emptiness and horror.

IV.vi.19 (447,4) her cock] Her cock-boat.

IV.vi.43 (448,6) when life itself/ Yields to the theft] When life is will-
ing to be destroyed.

IV.vi.47 (449,7) Thus might he pass, indeed] Thus he might *die* in reality. We still use the word *passing* bell.

IV.vi.53 (449,9) Ten masts at each make not the altitude] [Pope: attach] Mr. Pope's conjecture may stand if the word which he uses were known in our author's time, but I think it is of later introduction. He may say,

Ten masts *on end*—

IV.vi.57 (449,1) chalky bourn] *Bourn* seems here to signify a *hill*. Its common signification is a *brook*. Milton in *Comus* uses *bosky bourn* in the same sense perhaps with Shakespeare. But in both authors it may mean only a *boundary*.

IV.vi.73 (450,2) the clearest gods] The purest; the most free from evil.

IV.vi.80 (450,3) Bear free and patient thoughts] To be melancholy is to have the mind *chained down* to one painful idea; there is therefore great propriety in exhorting Glo'ster to *free thoughts*, to an emancipation of his soul from grief and despair.

IV.vi.81 (450,4) The safer sense will ne'er accommodate/His master thus] [W: sober sense] I read rather,

The *saner* sense will ne'er accomodate
His master thus.

"Here is Lear, but he must be mad: his sound or *sane* senses would never suffer him to be thus disguised."

IV.vi.87 (451,5) That fellow handles his bow like a crow-keeper] This *crow-keeper* was so common in the author's time, that it is one of the few peculiarities mentioned by Ortellius in his account of our island.

IV.vi.93 (451,8) Give the word] Lear supposes himself in a garrison, and before he lets Edgar pass, requires the watch-word.

IV.vi.97 (452,7) Ha! Gonerill!—with a white beard!] So reads the folio, properly; the quarto, whom the later editors have followed, has, *Ha! Gonerill, ha! Regan! they flattered me, &c.* which is not so forcible.

IV.vi.98 (452,8) They flattered me like a dog] They played the spaniel to me.

IV.vi.121 (453,2) Whose face between her forks] I believe that the *forks* were two prominences of the ruff rising on each side of the face.

IV.vi.124 (453,4) nor the soyled horse] *Soiled* horse is probably the same as *pampered* horse, *un cheval soûlé*.

IV.vi.169 (454,5) Robes and furr'd gowns hide all] From *hide all* to *accuser's lips*, the whole passage is wanting in the first edition, being added, I suppose, at his revisal.

IV.vi.187 (455,8) This a good block!] I do not see how this *block* corresponds either with his foregoing or following train of thoughts. Madmen think not wholly at random. I would read thus, *a good flock*. *Flocks* are wool moulded together. The sentence then follows properly:

It were a delicate stratagem to shoe

A troop of horse with felt;—

i.e. with *flocks* kneaded to a mass, a practice I believe sometimes used in former ages, for it is mentioned in *Ariosto*:

"—Fece nel cader strepito quanto

Avesse avuto sotto i piedi il feltro."

It is very common for madmen to catch an accidental hint, and strain it to the purpose predominant in their minds. Lear picks up a *flock*, and immediately thinks to surprize his enemies by a troop of horse shod with *flocks* or *felt*. Yet *block* may stand, if we suppose that the sight of a block put him in mind of mounting his horse.

IV.vi.199 (457,1) Why, this would make a man, a man of salt] Would make a man melt away like salt in wet weather.

IV.vi.206 (457,2) Then there's life in't] The case is not yet desperate.

IV.vi.217 (457,3) the main descry/ Stands on the hourly thought] The *main* body is *expected* to be *descry'd* every hour. The expression is harsh.

IV.vi.246 (459,7) che vor'ye] *I warn you*. Edgar counterfeits the western dialect.

IV.vi.281 (460,3) Thee I'll rake up] I'll *cover* thee. In Staffordshire, to *rake* the fire, is to cover it with fuel for the night.

IV.vi.234 (460,4) the death-practis'd duke] The duke of Albany, whose death is machinated by *practice* or treason.

IV.vii.3 (461,1) every measure fail me] All good which I shall allot thee, or *measure out* to thee, will be scanty.

IV.vii.9 (461,4) shortens my made intent] [W: laid] An intent *made*, is an intent *formed*. So we say in common language, to *make a design*, and to *make a resolution*.

IV.vii.41 (464,2) 'Tis wonder, that thy life and wits, at once,/ Had not concluded all] [W: concluded. — Ah!] The plain construction is this: *It is wonder that the wits and life had not all ended*.

IV.vii.85-97 (466,9)

[Gent. Holds it true, Sir,
That the duke of Cornwall was so slain?]

What is printed in crotchets is not in the folio. It is at least proper, if not necessary; and was omitted by the author, I suppose, for no other reason than to shorten the representation.

Vi.4 (467,2) his constant pleasure] His settled resolution.

Vi.54 (470,7) We will greet the time] We will be ready to meet the occasion.

Vi.61 (470,8) carry out my side] Bring my purpose to a successful issue, to completion. *Side* seems here to have the sense of the French word *partie*, in *prendre partie*, to take his resolution.

Vi.68 (471,9) for my state/ Stands on me to defend, not to debate] I do not think that *for* stands in this place as a word of inference or causality. The meaning is rather: *Such is my determination concerning Lear; as for my state it requires now, not deliberation, but defence and support*.

V.iii.16 (472,1) And take upon us the mystery of things,/ As if we were God's spies] As if we were angels commissioned to survey and report the lives of men, and were consequently endowed with the power of prying into the original motives of action and the mysteries of conduct.

V.iii.18 (472,2) packs and sects] Packs is used for *combinations* or *collection*, as is a *pack of cards*. For *sects* I think *sets* might be more commodiously read. So we say, *affairs are now managed by a new set*. *Sect*, however, may well stand.

V.iii.24 (473,6) flesh and fell] Flesh and skin.

V.iii.54 (475,1)

[At this time

We sweat and bleed: the friend hath lost his friend;

And the best quarrels, in the heat, are curs'd

By those that feel their sharpness:—

The question of Cordelia, and her father,

Requires a fitter place.]]

This passage, well worthy of restoration, is omitted in the folio.

V.iii.65 (475,4) The which immediacy] [*Immediacy*, for representation. WARBURTON.] *Immediacy* is rather *supremacy* in opposition to *subordination*, which has *quiddam medium* between itself and power.

V.iii.79 (476,7) The lett alone lies not in your good will] Whether he shall not or shall depends not on your choice.

V.iii.89 (476,8) An interlude!] This short exclamation of Gonerill is added in the folio edition, I suppose, only to break the speech of Albany, that the exhibition on the stage might be more distinct and intelligible.

V.iii.129 (478,1) Behold, it is the privilege of mine honours,/My oath, and my profession] The *privilege* of this *oath* means the privilege gained by taking the oath administered in the regular initiation of a knight professed.

V.iii.151 (479,3)

Alb. Save him, save him!

Gon. This is mere practice, Glo'ster]

He desired that Edmund's life might be spared at present, only to obtain his confession, and to convict him openly by his own letter.

V.iii.166 (480,6) Let us exchange charity] Our author by negligence gives his heathens the sentiments and practices of Christianity. In *Hamlet* there is the same solemn act of final reconciliation, but with exact propriety, for the personages are Christians.

V.iii. 204-221 (481,2) [Edg;.—This would have seem'd a period] The lines between crotchets are not in the folio.

V.iii.229 (433,4) Here comes Kent, Sir] The manner in which Edgar here mentions Kent, seems to require the lines which are inserted from the first edition in the foregoing scene.

V.iii.264 (485,7)

Edg. Or image of that horror?

Alb. Fall, and cease!]

These two exclamations are given to Edgar and Albany in the folio, to animate the dialogue, and employ all the persons on the stage; but they are very obscure.

V.iii.301 (487,4) With boot] With advantage, with increase.

(488) General Observation. The tragedy of Lear is deservedly celebrated among the dramas of Shakespeare. There is perhaps no play which keeps the attention so strongly fixed; which so much agitates our passions and interests our curiosity. The artful involutions of distinct interests, the striking opposition of contrary characters, the sudden changes of fortune, and the quick succession of events, fill the mind with a perpetual tumult of indignation, pity, and hope. There is no scene which does not contribute to the aggravation of the distress or conduct of the action, and scarce a line which does not conduce to the progress of the scene. So powerful is the current of the poet's imagination, that the mind, which once ventures within it, is hurried irresistibly along.

On the seeming improbability of Lear's conduct it may be observed, that he is represented according to histories at that time vulgarly received as true. And, perhaps, if we turn our thoughts upon the barbarity and ignorance of the age to which this story is referred, it will appear not so unlikely as while we estimate Lear's manners by our own. Such preference of one daughter to another, or resignation of dominion on such conditions, would be yet credible, if told of a petty prince of Guinea or Madagascar. Shakespeare, indeed, by the mention of his earls and dukes, has given us the idea of times more civilized, and of life regulated by softer manners; and the truth is, that though he so nicely discriminates, and so minutely describes the characters of men, he commonly neglects and confounds the characters of ages, by mingling customs ancient and modern, English and foreign.

My learned friend Mr. Warton, who has in the *Adventurer* very minutely criticised this play, remarks, that the instances of cruelty

are too savage and shocking, and that the intervention of Edmund destroys the simplicity of the story. These objections may, I think, be answered, by repeating, that the cruelty of the daughters is an historical fact, to which the poet has added little, having only drawn it into a series by dialogue and action. But I am not able to apologize with equal plausibility for the extrusion of Glo'ster's eyes, which seems an act too horrid to be endured in dramatic exhibition, and such as must always compel the mind to relieve its distress by incredulity. Yet let it be remembered that our author well knew what would please the audience for which he wrote.

The injury done by Edmund to the simplicity of the action is abundantly recompensed by the addition of variety, by the art with which he is made to co-operate with the chief design, and the opportunity which he gives the poet of combining perfidy with perfidy, and connecting the wicked son with the wicked daughters, to impress this important moral, that villainy is never at a stop, that crimes lead to crimes, and at last terminate in ruin.

But though this moral be incidentally enforced, Shakespeare has suffered the virtue of Cordelia to perish in a just cause, contrary to the natural ideas of justice, to the hope of the reader, and, what is yet more strange, to the faith of chronicles. Yet this conduct is justified by *The Spectator*, who blames Tate for giving Cordelia success and happiness in his alteration, and declares, that, in his opinion, *the tragedy has lost half its beauty*. Dennis has remarked, whether justly or not, that, to secure the favourable reception of *Cato*, *the town was poisoned with much false and abominable criticism*, and that endeavours had been used to discredit and decry poetical justice. A play in which the wicked prosper, and the virtuous miscarry, may doubtless be good, because it is a just representation of the common events of human life: but since all reasonable beings naturally love justice, I cannot easily be persuaded, that the observation of justice makes a play worse; or, that if other excellencies are equal, the audience will not always rise better pleased from the final triumph of persecuted virtue.

In the present case the public has decided. Cordelia, from the time of Tate, has always retired with victory and felicity. And, if my sensations could add any thing to the general suffrage, I might relate, I was many years ago so shocked by Cordelia's death, that I know not whether I ever endured to read again the last scenes of the play till I undertook to revise them as an editor.

There is another controversy among the critics concerning this play. It is disputed whether the predominant image in Lear's disordered mind be the loss of his kingdom or the cruelty of his daughters. Mr. Murphy, a very judicious critic, has evinced by induction of particular passages, that the cruelty of his daughters is the primary source of his distress, and that the loss of royalty affects him only as a secondary and subordinate evil. He observes with great justness, that Lear would move our compassion but little, did we not rather consider the injured father than the degraded king.

The story of this play, except the episode of Edmund, which is derived, I think, from Sidney, is taken originally from Geoffry of Monmouth, whom Hollinshed generally copied; but perhaps immediately from an old historical ballad. My reason for believing that the play was posterior to the ballad, rather than the ballad to the play, is, that the ballad has nothing of Shakespeare's nocturnal tempest, which is too striking to have been omitted, and that it follows the chronicle; it has the rudiments of the play, but none of its amplifications: it first hinted Lear's madness, but did not array it in circumstances. The writer of the ballad added something to the history, which is a proof that he would have added more, if more had occurred to his mind, and more must have occurred if he had seen Shakespeare. [Johnson appends "A lamentable SONG of the Death of King Leir and his Three Daughters"]

ROMEO AND JULIET

I.i.82 (9,7) Give me my long sword] The *long sword* was the sword used in war, which was sometimes wielded with both hands.

I.i.158 (11,2)

As is the bud bit with an envious worm,
Ere he can spread his sweet leaves to the air,
Or dedicate his beauty to the same]

I cannot but suspect that some lines are lost, which connected this simile more closely with the foregoing speech; these lines, if such there were, lamented the danger that Romeo will die of his melancholy, before his virtues or abilities were known to the world.

I.i.176 (12,3)

Alas, that love, whose view is muffled still,
Should, without eyes, see path-ways to his will.]

Sir T. Hanmer, and after him Dr. Warburton, read, to his *ill*. The present reading has some obscurity; the meaning may be, that *love* finds out means to pursue his *desire*. That the *blind* should *find paths to ill* is no great wonder.

I.i.183 (13,4) O brawling love! O loving hate!] Of these lines neither the sense nor occasion is very evident. He is not yet in love with an enemy, and to love one and hate another is no such uncommon state, as can deserve all this toil of antithesis.

I.i.192 (14,5) Why, such is love's transgression] Such is the consequence of unskilful and mistaken kindness. (see 1765, VIII, 12, 2)

1.i.198 (14,6) Being purg'd, a fire sparkling in lovers' eyes] The author may mean *being purged of smoke*, but it is perhaps a meaning never given to the word in any other place. I would rather read, *Being urged, a fire sparkling*. Being excited and inforced. To *urge* the fire is the technical term.

I.i.199 (14,7) Being vex'd, a sea nourish'd with lovers' tears] As this line stands single, it is likely that the foregoing or following line that rhym'd to it, is lost.

I.i.206 (14,8) Tell me in sadness] That is, tell me *gravely*, tell me in *seriousness*.

I.i.217 (15,1) in strong proof] In chastity *of proof*, as we say in armour *of proof*.

I.i.222 (15,2)

O, she is rich in beauty; only poor

That when she dies, with beauty dies her store]

Mr. Theobald reads, "*With her dies beauties store;*" and is followed by the two succeeding editors. I have replaced the old reading, because I think it at least as plausible as the correction. *She is rich*, says he, *in beauty*, and *only poor* in being subject to the lot of humanity, that *her store*, or riches, *can be destroyed by death*, who shall, by the same blow, put an end to beauty.

I.ii.15 (17,2) She is the hopeful lady of my earth] *The lady of his earth* is an expression not very intelligible, unless he means that she is heir to his estate, and I suppose no man ever called his lands his earth. I will venture to propose a bold change:

She is the hope *and stay* of my *full years*.

I.ii.25 (18,3) Earth-treading stars that make dark heaven light] [W: dark even] But why nonsense [Warburton's comment]? Is any thing mere commonly said, than that beauties eclipse the sun? Has not Pope the thought and the word?

"Sol through white curtains shot a tim'rous ray,

"And spe'd those eyes that must *eclipse the day*."

Both the old and the new reading are philosophical nonsense, but they are both, and both equally poetical sense.

I.ii.26 (18,4) Such comfort as do lusty young men feel] To say, and to say in pompous words, that a *young man shall feel* as much in an assembly of beauties, *as young men feel in the month of April*, is surely to waste sound upon a very poor sentiment. I read,

Such comfort as do lusty *yeomen* feel.

You shall feel from the sight and conversation of these ladies, such hopes of happiness and such pleasure, as the farmer receives from the spring, when the plenty of the year begins, and the prospect of the harvest fills him with delight.

I.ii.32 (18,5)

Such, amongst view of many, mine, being one.

May stand in number, the' in reckoning none]

The first of these lines I do not understand. The old folio gives no help; the passage is there, *Which one more view*. I can offer nothing better than this:

Within your view of many, mine being one,

May stand in number, &c.

I.iii.13 (22,1) to my teen] To my sorrow.

I.iii.66 (24,4) It is an honour] The modern editors all read, *it is an honour*. I have restored the genuine word ["hour"], which is more seemly from a girl to her mother. *Your, fire*, and such words as are vulgarly uttered in two syllables, are used as dissyllables by Shakespeare. [The first quarto reads *honour*; the folio *hour*. I have chosen the reading of the quarto. STEEVENS.] (rev. 1778, X, 28, 2)

I.iii.92 (25,9) That in gold clasps locks in the golden story] The *golden story* is perhaps the *golden legend*, a book in the darker ages of popery much read, and doubtless often exquisitely embellished, but of which Canus, one of the popish doctors, proclaims the author to have been *homo ferrei oris, plumbei cordis*.

I.iv.6 (27,2) like a crow-keeper] The word *crow-keeper* is explained in Lear.

I.iv.37 (28,8) for I am proverb'd with a grand-sire phrase] The grand-sire phrase is—*The black ox has trod upon my foot*.

I.iv.42 (30,1) Or (save your reverence) love] The word *or* obscures the sentence; we should read *O!* for *or love*. Mercutio having called the affection with which Romeo was entangled by so disrespectful a word as *mire*, cries out,

O! save your reverence, love.

I.iv.84 (34,7) Spanish blades] A sword is called a toledo, from the excellence of the Toletan steel. So Gratius,

"—*Ensis Toletanus*

"*Unda Tagi non est alie celebranda metallo,*

Utilis in cives est ibi lamna sues."

I.iv.113 (35,9) Direct my sail:] [I have restored this reading from the elder quarto, as being more congruous to the metaphor in the preceding line. *Suit* is the reading of the folio. STEEVENS.]

Direct my suit! Guide the *sequel* of the adventure.

I.v.27 (37,4)

You are welcome, gentlemen. Come musicians, play.

A ball! a ball! Give room. And foot it, girls]

These two lines, omitted by the modern editors, I have replaced from the folio.

I.v.32 (37, 6) good cousin Capulet] This *cousin* Capulet is *unkle* in the paper of invitation; but as Capulet is described as old, *cousin* is probably the right word in both places. I know not how Capulet and his lady might agree, their ages were very disproportionate; he has been past masking for thirty years, and her age, as she tells Juliet, is but eight-and-twenty.

II.Prologue (42,3) *Enter CHORUS*] The use of this chorus is not easily discovered; it conduces nothing to the progress of the play, but relates what is already known, or what the next scenes will shew; and relates it without adding the improvement of any moral sentiment.

II.ii.1 (45,1) He jests at scars] That is, Mercutio jests, whom he overheard.

II.ii.7 (45,2) Be not her maid] Be not a votary to the moon, to Diana.

II.ii.10 (45,3)

It is my lady; O! it is my love;

O, that she knew we were!]

This line and half I have replaced.

II.ii.39 (47,7) Thou art thyself, though not a Montague] I think the true reading is,

Thou art thyself, *then* not a Montague.

Thou art a being of peculiar excellence, and hast none of the malignity of the family, from which thou hast thy name.—Hanmer reads,

Thour't not *thyself* so, *though* a Montague.

II.iii.15 (53,6) the powerful grace, that lies/In plants] Efficacious virtue.

II.iii.27 (53,7) Two such opposed foes encamp them still] [W: opposed kin] *Foes* may be the right reading, or *kings*, but I think *kin* can hardly be admitted. Two *kings* are two opposite *powers*, two contending *potentates*, in both the natural and moral world. The word *encamp* is proper to *commanders*. (see 1765, VIII, 46, 2)

II.iv.20 (57,3) courageous captain of compliments] A complete master of all the laws of ceremony, the principal man in the doctrine of punctilio.

"A man of compliments, whom right and wrong

"Have chose as umpire;"

says our author of Don Armado, the Spaniard, in *Love's Labour Lost*.

II.iv.27 (57,6) the hay!] All the terms of the modern fencing-school were originally Italian; the rapier, or small thrusting sword, being first used in Italy. The *hay* is the word *hai*, you *have* it, used when a thrust reaches the antagonist, from which our fencers, on the same occasion, without knowing, I suppose, any reason for it, cry out, *ha!*

II.iv.35 (58,9) these pardonnez-moy's] *Pardonnez-moi* became the language of doubt or hesitation among men of the sword, when the point of honour was grown so delicate, that no other mode of contradiction would be endured.

II.iv.64 (59,3) then is my pump wall flower'd] Here is a vein of wit too thin to be easily found. The fundamental idea is, that Romeo wore *pinked* pumps, that is, pumps punched with holes in figures.

II.iv.87 (60,7) a wit of cheverel] *Cheverel* is soft-leather for gloves.

II.iv.138 (62,8) No hare, Sir] Mercutio having roared out, *So ho!* the cry of the sportsmen when they start a hare; Romeo asks *what he has found*. And Mercutio answers, *No hare*, &c. The rest is a series of quibbles unworthy of explanation, which he who does not understand, needs not lament his ignorance.

II.iv.162 (63,1) none of his skains-mates] The word *skains-mate*, I do not understand, but suppose that *skains* was some low play, and *skains-mate*, a companion at such play.

II.iv.200 (64,2) like a tackled stair] Like stairs of rope in the tackle of a ship.

II.iv.222 (65,4) Ah, mocker! that's the dog's name. R is for the nonce; I know it begins with another letter] This passage is thus in the old folio. *A mocker, that's the dog's name. R is for the no, I know it begins with some other letter.* In this copy the error is but small. I read, *Ah, mocker. that's the dog's name. R is for the nonce, I know it begins with another letter.* For the *nonce*, is for some *design*, for a *sly trick*.

II.vi.15 (70,2) Too swift arrives as tardy as too slow] He that travels too fast is as long before he comes to the end of his journey, as he that travels slow. Precipitation produces mishap.

III.i.2 (71,1) The day is hot] It is observed, that in Italy almost all assassinations are committed during the heat of summer.

III.i.124 (75,6) This day's black fate on more days does depend] This day's unhappy destiny *hangs over* the days yet to come. There will yet be more mischief.

III.i.141 (78,7) Oh! I am fortune's fool] I am always running in the way of evil fortune, *like* the fool in the play. *Thou art death's fool*, in *Measure for Measure*. See Dr. Warburton's note.

III.i.153 (77,8) as thou art true] As thou art *just* and *upright*.

III.i.159 (77,9) How nice the quarrel] How *slight*, how *unimportant*, how *petty*. So in the last act,

The letter was not *nice*, but full of charge

Of dear import.

III.i.182 (78,2) Affection makes him false] The charge of falshood on Bonvolio, though produced at hazard, is very just. The author, who seems to intend the character of Bonvolio as good, meant perhaps to shew, how the best minds, in a state of faction and discord, are detorted to criminal partiality.

III.i.193 (78,3) I have an interest in your hate's proceeding: Sir Thomas Hanmer saw that this line gave no sense, and therefore put, by a very easy change,

I have an interest in your *heat's* proceeding!

which is undoubtedly better than the old reading which Dr. Warburton has followed; but the sense yet seems to be weak, and perhaps a more licentious correction is necessary. I read therefore,

I *had* no interest in your *heat's* preceding.

This, says the prince, is no quarrel of mine, *I had no interest in your former discord*; I suffer merely by your private animosity.

III.ii.5 (79,3) Spread thy close curtain, love-performing night,/ That run-away's eyes may wink] [Warburton explained the "run-away" as the "sun"] I am not satisfied with this explanation, yet have nothing better to propose.

III.ii.10 (80,4) Come, civil night] *Civil is grave, decently solemn.*

III.ii.14 (80,5) unmann'd blood] Blood yet unacquainted with man.

III.ii.25 (81,6) the garish sun] Milton had this speech in his thoughts when he wrote *Il Penseroso*.

"—Civil night,

"Thou sober-suited matron." — *Shakespeare.*

"Till civil-suited morn appear." — *Milton.*

"Pay no worship to the gairish sun." — *Shakespeare.*

"Hide me from day's gairish eye." — *Milton.*

III.ii.46 (82,7) the death-darting eye of cockatrice] [The strange lines that follow here in the common books are not in the old edition. POPE.] The strange lines are these:

I am not I, if there be such an I,

Or these eyes shot, that makes thee answer I;

If he be slain, say I; or if not, no;

Brief sounds determine of my weal or woe.

These lines hardly deserve emendation; yet it may be proper to observe, that their meanness has not placed them below the malice of fortune, the two first of them being evidently transposed; we should read,

—That one vowel *I* shall poison more,

Than the death-darting eye of cockatrice,

Or these eyes shot, that make thee answer, I.

I am not I, &c.

III.ii.114 (85,9) Hath slain ten thousand Tybalts] Hath put Tybalt out of my mind, as if out of being.

III.ii.120 (85,1) Which modern lamentation might have mov'd] This line is left out of the later editions, I suppose because the editors did not remember that Shakespeare uses *modern* for *common*, or *slight*: I

believe it was in his time confounded in colloquial language with *moderate*.

III.iii.112 (89,4)

Unseemly woman in a seeming man!

And ill-beseeming beast in seeming both!]

[W: seeming groth] The old reading is probable. *Thou art a beast of ill qualities, under the appearance both of a woman and a man.*

III.iii.135 (90,5) And thou dismember'd with thine own defence] And thou torn to pieces with thy own weapons.

III.iii.166-168 (91,6) Go hence. Good night] These three lines are omitted in all the modern editions.

III.iii.166 (91,7) here stands all your state] The whole of your fortune depends on this.

III.iv.12 (92,9) Sir Paris, I will make a desperate tender/ Of my child's love] *Desperate* means only *bold, advent'rous*, as if he had said in the vulgar phrase, *I will speak a bold word, and venture to promise you my daughter.*

III.v.20 (94,1) 'Tis but the pale reflex of Cynthia's brow] The appearance of a cloud opposed to the moon.

III.v.23 (94,2) I have more care to stay, than will to go] Would it be better thus, *I have more will to stay, than care to go?*

III.v.31 (94,3) Some say, the lark and loathed toad chang'd eyes] This tradition of the toad and lark I have heard expressed in a rustick rhyme,

—to heav'n I'd fly,

But the toad beguil'd me of my eye.

III.v.33 (95,4)

Since arm from arm that voice doth us affray,

Hunting thee hence with huntaup to the day]

These two lines are omitted in the modern editions, and do not deserve to be replaced, but as they may shew the danger of critical temerity. Dr. Warburton's change of *I would* to *I wot* was specious enough, yet it is evidently erroneous. The sense is this, *The lark, they say, has lost her eyes to the toad, and now I would the toad had her voice too, since she uses it to the disturbance of lovers.*

III.v.86 (97,3)

Jul. Ay, Madam, from the reach of these my hands:

'Would, none but I might venge my cousin's death.!]'

Juliet's equivocations are rather too artful for a mind disturbed by the loss of a new lover.

III.v.91 (98,4) That shall bestow on him so sure a draught] [Thus the elder quarto, which I have followed in preference to the quarto 1609, and the folio 1623, which read, less intelligibly,

"Shall give him such an unaccustom'd dram." STEEVENS.]

—*unaccustomed dram.*] In vulgar language, Shall give him a *dram* which he is *not used* to. Though I have, if I mistake not, observed, that in old books *unaccustomed* signifies *wonderful, powerful, efficacious*.

III.v.112 (98,6) in happy time] *A la bonne heure*. This phrase was interjected, when the hearer was not quite so well pleased as the speaker.

III.v.227 (103,3) As living here] Sir T. HANMER reads, *as living* hence; that is, at a distance, in banishment; but *here* may signify, *in this world*.

IV.i.3 (104,1) And I am nothing slow to slack his haste] *His haste shall not be abated by my slowness*. It might be read,

And I am nothing slow to *back* his haste:

that is, I am diligent to *abet* and *enforce* his haste.

IV.i.18 (104,2)

Par. Happily met, my lady and my wife!

Jul. That may be, Sir, when I may be a wife]

As these four first lines seem intended to rhyme, perhaps the author wrote thus:

—my lady and my *life*!

IV.i.62 (106,3) this bloody knife/ Shall play the umpire] That is, this knife shall decide the struggle between me and my distress.

IV.i.64 (106,4) commission of thy years and art] *Commission* is for *authority* or *power*.

IV.i.79 (106,5)

Or chain me to some sleepy mountain's top,

Where rearing bears and savage lions roam;

Or shut me nightly in a charnel house]

[Or walk in thievish ways, or bid me lurk

Where serpents are; chain me with rearing bears,
Or hide me nightly, &c.

It is thus the editions vary. POPE.] my edition has the words which Mr. Pope has omitted; but the old copy seems in this place preferable; only perhaps we might better read,

Where *savage* bears and *rearing* lions roam.

IV.i.119 (108,8) If no unconstant toy] If no *fickle freak*, no *light caprice*, no *change of fancy*, hinder the performance.

IV.ii.38 (110,2) We shall be short] That is, we shall be *defective*.

IV.iii.3 (110,3) For I have need of many orisons] Juliet plays most of her pranks under the appearance of religion: perhaps Shakespeare meant to punish her hypocrisy.

IV.iii.46 (112,6) Alas, alas! it is not like that I] This speech is confused, and inconsequential, according to the disorder of Juliet's mind.

IV.iv.4 (113,1) The curfeu bell] I knew not that the morning-bell is called the *curfeu* in any other place.

IV.iv.107 (119,9) O, play me some merry dump] This is not in the folio, but the answer plainly requires it.

Vi (121,1) ACT V. SCENE I. MANTUA] The acts are here properly enough divided, nor did any better distribution than the editors have already made, occur to me in the perusal of this play; yet it may not be improper to remark, that in the first folio, and I suppose the foregoing editions are in the same state, there is no division of the acts, and therefore some future editor may try, whether any improvement can be made, by reducing them to a length more equal, or interrupting the action at more proper intervals.

Vi.1 (121,2) If I may trust the flattering truth of sleep] The sense is, *If I may only trust the honesty of sleep*, which I know however not to be so nice as not often to practise *flattery*.

Vi.3 (121,3)

My bosom's lord sits lightly on his throne;

And all this day an unaccustom'd spirit

Lifts me above the ground with chearful thoughts]

These three lines are very gay and pleasing. But why does Shakespeare give Romeo this involuntary cheerfulness just before the ex-

tremity of unhappiness? Perhaps to shew the vanity of trusting to these uncertain and casual exaltations or depressions, which many consider as certain foretokens of good and evil.

V.i.45 (123,6) A beggarly account of empty boxes] Dr. Warburton would read, a *braggartly* account; but *beggarly* is probably right: if the *boxes* were *empty*, the *account* was more *beggarly*, as it was more pompous.

V.iii.31 (127,1) a ring that I must use/ In dear employment] That is, *action of importance*. Gems were supposed to have great powers and virtues.

V.iii.86 (129,4) her beauty makes/ This vault a feasting presence full of light] A *presence* is a *public room*.

V.iii.90 (129,5) O, how may I/ Call this a lightning?] I think we should read,

—O, now *may* I
Call this a lightning!—

V.iii.178 (135,1)

Raise up the Montagues.—Some others; search:—
We see the ground whereon these woes do lie;
But the true ground of all these piteous woes
We cannot without circumstance descry]
Here seems to be a rhyme intended, which may be easily restored;
"Raise up the Montagues. Some others, go.
"We see the ground whereon these woes do lie,
"But the true ground of all *this* piteous *woe*
"We cannot without circumstance descry."

V.iii.194 (136,2) What fear is this, which startles in our ears?] [Originally *your ears*] Read,

"What fear is this, which startles in *our* ears?"

V.iii.229 (138,6) *Fri.* I will be brief] It is much to be lamented, that the poet did not conclude the dialogue with the action, and avoid a narrative of events which the audience already knew.

(141) General Observation. This play is one of the most pleasing of our author's performances. The scenes are busy and various, the incidents numerous and important, the catastrophe irresistibly affecting,

and the process of the action carried on with such probability, at least with such congruity to popular opinions, as tragedy requires.

Here is one of the few attempts of Shakespeare to exhibit the conversation of gentlemen, to represent the airy sprightliness of juvenile elegance. Mr. Dryden mentions a tradition, which might easily reach his time, of a declaration made by Shakespeare, that *he was obliged to kill Mercutio in the third act, lest he should have been killed by him*. Yet he thinks him *no such formidable person, but that he might have lived through the play, and died in his bed*, without danger to a poet. Dryden well knew, had he been in quest of truth, that, in a pointed sentence, more regard is commonly had to the words than the thought, and that it is very seldom to be rigorously understood. Mercutio's wit, gaiety, and courage, will always procure him friends that wish him a longer life; but his death is not precipitated, he has lived out the time allotted him in the construction of the play; nor do I doubt the ability of Shakespeare to have continued his existence, though some of his sallies are perhaps out of the reach of Dryden; whose genius was not very fertile of merriment, nor ductile to humour, but acute, argumentative, comprehensive, and sublime.

The Nurse is one of the characters in which the author delighted: he has, with great subtilty of distinction, drawn her at once loquacious and secret, obsequious and insolent, trusty and dishonest.

His comic scenes are happily wrought, but his pathetic strains are always polluted with some unexpected depravations. His persons, however distressed, *have a conceit left them in their misery, a miserable conceit*.

HAMLET

(145,2) This play is printed both in the folio of 1623, and in the quarto of 1637, more correctly, than almost any other of the works of Shakespeare.

I.i.29 (147,7) approve our eyes] Add a new testimony to that of our eyes.

I.i.33 (147,8) What we two nights have seen] This line is by Hanmer given to Marcellus, but without necessity.

I.i.63 (149,9) He smote the sledded Polack on the ice] Polack was, in that age, the term for an inhabitant of Poland: Polaque, French. As in a translation of Passeratius's epitaph on Henry III. of France, published by Camden:

"Whether thy chance or choice thee hither brings,

"Stay, passenger, and wail the best of kings.

"this little stone a great king's heart doth hold,

"Who rul'd the fickle French and Polacks bold:

"So frail are even the highest earthly things,

"Go, passenger, and wail the hap of kings." (rev. 1776, I, 174,3)

I.i.65 (149,2) and just at this dead hour] The old reading is, *jump at this same hour*; *same* is a kind of correlative to *jump*; *just* is in the oldest folio. The correction was probably made by the author.

I.i.68 (149,4) gross and scope] General thoughts, and tendency at large. (1773)

I.i.93 (151,7) And carriage of the articles design'd] *Carriage*, is *import*; *design'd*, is *formed*, *drawn up between them*.

I.i.96 (151,8) Of unimproved mettle hot and full] *Full of unimproved mettle*, is full of spirit not regulated or guided by knowledge or experience.

I.i.100 (151,1) That hath a stomach in't] *Stomach*, in the time of our author, was used for *constancy*, *resolution*.

I.i.107 (152,3) romage] Tumultous hurry. (1773)

I.i.108-125 (152,3) These, and all other lines confin'd within crotchets throughout this play, are omitted in the folio edition of 1623. The omissions leave the play sometimes better and sometimes worse, and seen made only for the sake of abbreviation.

I.i.109 (152,4) Well may it sort] The cause and the effect are proportionate and suitable. (1773)

I.i.121 (152,7) Was even the like precursor of fierce events] Not only such prodigies have been seen in Rome, but the elements have shewn our countrymen like forerunners and foretokens of violent events. (1773)

I.i.128 (153,1) If thou hast any sound] The speech of Horatio to the spectre is very elegant and noble, and congruous to the common traditions of the causes of apparitions.

I.i.153 (154,2)

Whether in sea or fire, in earth or air,
The extravagant and erring spirit hies
To his confine]

According to the pneumatology of that time, every element was inhabited by its peculiar order of spirits, who had dispositions different, according to their various places of abode. The meaning therefore is, that all *spirits extravagant*, wandering out of their element, whether aerial spirits visiting earth, or earthly spirits ranging the air, return to their station, to their proper limits in which they are *confined*. We might read,

"—And at his warning
"Th' extravagant and erring spirit hies
"To his confine, whether in sea or air,
"Or earth, or fire. And of, &c.

But this change, tho' it would smooth the construction, is not necessary, and being unnecessary, should not be made against authority.

I.i.163 (154,5) No fairy takes] No fairy *strikes*, with lameness or diseases. This sense of *take* is frequent in this author.

I.ii.37 (156,8) more than the scope/Of these dilated articles allows]
More than is comprised in the general design of these articles, which you may explain in a more diffuse and dilated stile. (1773)

I.ii.47 (157,9)

The head is not more native to the heart,
The hand more instrumental to the mouth,
Than to the throne of Denmark is thy father]

[W: The blood ... Than to the throne] Part of this emendation I have received, but cannot discern why the *head* is not as much *native to the heart*, as the *blood*, that is, *natural* and *congenial* to it, *born with it*, and co-operating with it. The relation is likewise by this reading better preserved, the *counsellor* being to the *king* as the *head* to the *heart*.

I.ii.62 (158,1)

Take thy fair hour, Laertes; time be thine,
And thy best graces spend it at thy will]
I rather think this line is in want of emendation. I read,
— *Time is thine*,
And my best graces; *spend it at thy will*.

I.ii.65 (158,2) A little more than kin, and less than kind] *Kind* is the Teutonic word for *child*. Hamlet therefore answers with propriety, to the titles of *cousin* and *son*, which the king had given him, that he was somewhat more than *cousin*, and less than *son*.

I.ii.67 (159,3) too much i' the sun] He perhaps alludes to the proverb, *Out of heaven's blessing into the warm sun*.

I.ii.70 (159,4) veiled lids] With lowering eyes, cast down eyes. (1773)

I.ii.89 (160,5) your father lost a father;/ That father lost, lost his] I do not admire the repetition of the word, but it has so much of our author's manner, that I find no temptation to recede from the old copies.

I.ii.92 (160,6) obsequious sorrow] *Obsequious* is here from *obsequies*, or *funeral ceremonies*.

I.ii.103 (161,9) To reason most absurd] Reason is here used in its common sense, for the *faculty* by which we form conclusions from arguments.

I.ii.110 (161,1) And with no less nobility of love] [*Nobility*, for *magnitude*. Warburton.] *Nobility* is rather *generosity*.

I.ii.112 (161,2) Do I impart toward you] I believe *impart* is, *impart myself*, *communicate* whatever I can bestow.

I.ii.125 (162,4) No jocund health] The king's intemperance is very strongly impressed; every thing that happens to him gives him occasion to drink.

I.ii.163 (164,9) I'll change that name] I'll be your servant, you shall be my friend. (1773)

I.ii.164 (164,1) what make you] A familiar phrase for *what are you doing*.

I.ii.167 (164,2) good Even, Sir] So the copies. Sir Th. Hanmer and Dr. Warburton put it, *good morning*. The alteration is of no importance, but all licence is dangerous. There is no need of any change. Between the first and eighth scene of this act it is apparent, that a natural day must pass, and how much of it is already over, there is nothing that can determine. The king has held a council. It may now as well be *evening* as *morning*.

I.ii.182 (165,3) 'Would I had met my dearest foe in heaven] *Dearest*, for *direst*, most dreadful, most dangerous.

I.ii.192 (165,5) Season your admiration] That is, *temper* it.

I.ii.204 (166,6) they, distill'd/ Almost to jelly with the act of fear,/ Stand dumb] [W: th' effect of] Here is an affectation of subtilty without accuracy. *Fear* is every day considered as an *agent*. *Fear laid hold on him; fear drove him away*. If it were proper to be rigorous in examining trifles, it might be replied, that Shakespeare would write more erroneously, if he wrote by the direction of this critick; they were not *distilled*, whatever the word may mean, *by the effect of fear*; for that *distillation* was itself the *effect*; *fear* was the cause, the active cause, that *distilled* them by that force of operation which we strictly call *act* involuntary, and *power* in involuntary agents, but popularly call *act* in both. But of this too much.

I.iii.15 (169,9) The virtue of his will] *Virtue* seems here to comprise both *excellence* and *power*, and may be explained the *pure effect*.

I.iii.21 (169,1) The sanity and health of the whole state] [W: safety] HANMER reads very rightly, *sanity*. *Sanctity* is elsewhere printed for *sanity*, in the old edition of this play.

I.iii.32 (170,2) unmaster'd] i.e. *licentious*. (1773)

I.iii.34 (170,3) keep you in the rear of your affection] That is, do not advance so far as your affection would lead you.

I.iii.49 (170,4) Whilst, like a puft and reckless libertine] [W: Whilst he] The emendation is not amiss, but the reason for it is very inconclusive; we use the same mode of speaking on many occasions. When I say of one, *he squanders like a spendthrift*, of another, *he robbed me like a thief*, the phrase produces no ambiguity; it is understood that the one is a *spendthrift*, and the other a *thief*.

I.iii.64 (172,7) But do not dull thy palm with entertainment/ Of each new-hatch'd, unfledg'd comrade] The literal sense is, *Do not make thy palm callous by shaking every man by the hand*. The figurative meaning may be, *Do not by promiscuous conversation make thy mind insensible to the difference of characters*.

I.iii.81 (173,1) my blessing season this in thee!] [*Season*, for *infuse*. WARBURTON.] It is more than to *infuse*, it is to infix it in such a manner as that it never may wear out.

I.iii.83 (173,3) your servants tend] i.e. your servants are waiting for you. (1773)

I.iii.86 (173,4) 'Tis in my memory lock'd,/ And you yourself shall keep the key of it] That is, By thinking on you, I shall think on your lessons.

I.iii.107 (174,6)

Tender yourself mere dearly;

Or (not to crack the wind of the poor phrase)

Wronging it thus, you'll tender me a fool]

I believe the word *wronging* has reference, not to the phrase, but to Ophelia; if you go on *wronging it thus*, that is, *if you continue to go on thus wrong*. This is a mode of speaking perhaps not very grammatical, but very common, nor have the best writers refused it.

To sinner it or saint it,

is in Pope. And Rowe,

— *Thus to coy it,*

To one who knows you too.

The folio has it,

— *roaming it thus,* —

That is, *letting yourself loose to such improper liberty*. But *wronging* seems to be more proper.

I.iii.112 (175,7) fashion you may call it] She uses *fashion* for *manner*, and he for a *transient practice*.

I.iii.122 (175,8) Set your intreatments] *Intreatments* here means *company, conversation*, from the French *entrétien*.

I.iii.125 (175,9) larger tether] *Tether* is that string by which an animal, set to graze in grounds uninclosed, is confined within the proper limits. (1773)

I.iii.132 (176,2) I would not, in plain terms, from this time forth,/ Have you so slander any moment's leisure] [The humour of this is fine. WARBURTON.] Here is another *fine* passage, of which I take the beauty to be only imaginary. Polonius says, *in plain terms*, that is, not in language less elevated or embellished than before, but *in terms that cannot be misunderstood: I would not have you so disgrace your most idle moments, as not to find better employment for them than lord Hamlet's conversation*.

I.iv.9 (177,3) the swaggering up-spring] The blustering upstart.

I.iv.17 (177,4) This heavy-headed revel, east and west] I should not have suspected this passage of ambiguity or obscurity, had I not found my opinion of it differing from that of the learned critic [Warburton]. I construe it thus, *This heavy-headed revel makes us traduced east and west, and taxed of other nations*.

I.iv.22 (178,5) The pith and marrow of our attribute] The best and most valuable part of the praise that would be otherwise attributed to us.

I.iv.32 (178,7) fortune's scar] In the old quarto of 1637, it is
—*fortune's star*:
But I think *scar* is proper.

I.iv.34 (178,8) As infinite as man may undergo] As large as can be accumulated upon man.

I.iv.39-57 (179,2) Angels and ministers of grace defend us!] Hamlet's speech to the apparition of his father seems to me to consist of three

parts. When first he sees the spectre, he fortifies himself with an invocation.

Angel and ministers of grace defend us!

As the spectre approaches, he deliberates with himself, and determines, that whatever it be he will venture to address it.

Be thou a spirit of health, or goblin damn'd,

Bring with thee airs from heaven, or blasts from hell,

Be thy intents wicked or charitable,

Thou com'st in such a questionable shape,

That I will speak to thee. I'll call thee, &c.

This he says while his father is advancing; he then, as he had determined, *speaks to him, and calls him* — *Hamlet, King, Father, Royal Dane: oh! answer me.* (1773)

I.iv.43 (180,4) questionable shape] [By *questionable* is meant provoking question. HANMER.] So in *Macbeth*,

Live you, or are you aught

That man may question?

I.iv.46 (180,5) tell,/Why thy canoniz'd bones, hearsed in death,/ Have burst their cearments?] [W: in earth] It were too long to examine this note period by period, though almost every period seems to me to contain something reprehensible. The critic, in his zeal for change, writes with so little consideration, as to say, that Hamlet cannot call his father *canonized*, because *we are told he was murdered with all his sins fresh upon him*. He was not then told it, and had so little the power of knowing it, that he was to be told it by an apparition. The long succession of reasons upon reasons prove nothing, but what every reader discovers, that the king had been buried, which is implied by so many adjuncts of burial, that the direct mention of *earth* is not necessary. Hamlet, amazed at an apparition, which, though in all ages credited, has in all ages been considered as the most wonderful and most dreadful operation of supernatural agency, enquires of the spectre, in the most emphatic terms, why he breaks the order of nature, by returning from the dead; this he asks in a very confused circumlocution, confounding in his fright the soul and body. Why, says he, have *thy bones*, which with due ceremonies have been intombed *in death*, in the common state of departed mortals, *burst* the folds in which they were embalmed? Why has the tomb, in which we saw thee quietly laid, opened his mouth, that mouth which, by its weight and stabil-

ity, seemed closed for ever? The whole sentence is this: *Why dost thou appear, whom we know to be dead?*

Had the change of the word removed any obscurity, or added any beauty, it might have been worth a struggle; but either reading leaves the sense the same.

If there be any asperity in this controversial note, it must be imputed to the contagion of peevishneas, or some resentment of the incivility shewn to the Oxford editor, who is represented as supposing the ground *canonized* by a funeral, when he only meant to say, that the *body* has deposited in *holy ground*, in ground consecrated according to the *canon*.

I.iv.65 (183,9) I do not set my life at a pin's fee] The value of a pin. (1773)

I.iv.73 (183,1) deprive your sovereignty] I believe *deprive* in this place signifies simply to *take away*.

I.iv.77 (184,4) confin'd to fast in fires] I am rather inclined to read, *confin'd to lasting fires*, to fires *unremitted* and *unconsumed*. The change is slight.

I.v.30 (186,7) As meditation or the thoughts of love] The comment [Warburton's] on the word *meditation* is so ingenious, that I hope it is just.

I.v.77 (188,6) Unhonsel'd, disappointed, unaneal'd] This is a very difficult line. I think Theobald's objection to the sense of *unaneal'd*, for *notified by the bell*, must be owned to be very strong. I have not yet by my enquiry satisfied myself. Hanmer's explication of *unaneal'd* by *unprepar'd*, because to *anneal* metals, is to *prepare* them in manufacture, is too general and vague; there is no resemblance between any funeral ceremony and the practice of *annealing* metals.

Disappointed is the same as *unappointed*, and may be properly explained *unprepared*; a man well furnished with things necessary for any enterprize, was said to be well *appointed*.

I.v.80 (190,7) Oh, horrible! oh, horrible! most horrible!] It was ingeniously hinted to me by a very learned lady, that this line seems to belong to Hamlet, in whose mouth it is a proper and natural exclamation; and who, according to the practice of the stage, may be supposed to interrupt so long a speech. (1773)

I.v.154 (193,5) Swear by my sword] [Here the poet has preserved the manners of the ancient Danes, with whom it was *religion* to swear upon their swords. Warburton.] I was once inclinable to this opinion, which is likewise well defended by Mr. Upton; but Mr. Garrick produced me a passage, I think, in *Brantoms*, from which it appeared, that it was common to swear upon the sword, that is, upon the cross which the old swords always had upon the hilt.

II.i.25 (197,8) drinking, fencing, swearing] I suppose, by *fencing* is meant a too diligent frequentation of the fencing-school, a resort of violent and lawless young men.

II.i.46 (197,4) *Good Sir*, or so, or *friend*, or *gentleman*] [W: sire] I know not that *sire* was ever a general word of compliment, as distinct from *sir*; nor do I conceive why any alteration should be made. It is a common mode of colloquial language to use, *or so*, as a slight intimation of more of the same, or a like kind, that might be mentioned. We might read, but we need not,

Good sir, forsooth, or *friend*, or *gentleman*.

Forsooth, a term of which I do not well know the original meaning, was used to men as well as to women.

II.i.71 (198,5) Observe his inclination in yourself] HANMER reads, *e'en* yourself, and is followed by Dr. Warburton; but perhaps *in* yourself means, *in your own person*, not by spies.

II.i.112 (200,7) I had not quoted him] To *quote* is, I believe, to *reckon*, to take an account of, to take the *quotient* or result of a computation.

II.i.114 (201,8)

it as proper to our age

To cast beyond ourselves in our opinions,

As it is common for the younger sort

To lack discretion]

This is not the remark of a weak man. The vice of age is too much suspicion. Men long accustomed to the wiles of life *cast* commonly *beyond themselves*, let their cunning go further than reason can attend it. This is always the fault of a little mind, made artful by long commerce with the world.

II.ii.24 (202,2)

For the supply and profit of our hope,

Your visitation shall receive such thanks]

That the hope which your arrival has raised may be completed by the desired effect.

II.ii.47 (203,4) the trail of policy] The *trail* is the *course of an animal pursued by the scent*.

II.ii.52 (203,5) My news shall be the fruit of that great feast] The *desert* after the meat.

II.ii.84 (204,7) at night we'll feast] The king's intemperance is never suffered to be forgotten.

II.ii.86-167 (205,8) My liege, and Madam, to expostulate] This account of the character of Polonius, though it sufficiently reconciles the seeming inconsistency of so much wisdom with so much folly, does not perhaps correspond exactly to the ideas of our author. The commentator Warburton makes the character of Polonius, a character only of manners, discriminated by properties superficial, accidental, and acquired. The poet intended a nobler delineation of a mixed character of manners and of nature. Polonius is a man bred in courts, exercised in business, stored with observations, confident of his knowledge, proud of his eloquence, and declining into dotage. His mode of oratory is truly represented as designed to ridicule the practice of those times, of prefaces that made no introduction, and of method that embarrassed rather than explained. This part of his character is accidental, the rest is natural. Such a man is positive and confident, because he knows that his mind was once strong, and knows not that it is become weak. Such a man excels in general principles, but fails in the particular application. He is knowing in retrospect, and ignorant in foresight. While he depends upon his memory, and can draw from his repositories of knowledge, he utters weighty sentences, and gives useful counsel; but as the mind in its enfeebled state cannot be kept long busy and intent, the old man is subject to sudden dereliction of his faculties, he loses the order of his ideas, and entangles himself in his own thoughts, till he recovers the leading principle, and falls again into his former train. This idea of dotage encroaching upon wisdom, will solve all the phaenomena of the character of Polonius.

II.ii.109 (207,1) *To the celestial, and my soul's idol, the most beautified Ophelia*] [T: beatified] Both Sir Thomas Hanmer and Dr. Warburton have followed Theobald, but I am in doubt whether *beautified*, though,

as Polonius calls it, a *vile phrase*, be not the proper word. *Beautified* seems to be a *vile phrase*, for the ambiguity of its meaning, (rev. 1778, X, 241, 3)

II.ii.126 (208,2) more above] is, *moreover, besides*.

II.ii.145 (209,6) she took the fruits of my advice] She took the *fruits* of advice when she obeyed advice, the advice was then made *fruitful*.

II.ii.181 (211,9) For if the sun breed maggots in a dead dog,/Being a god, kissing carrion] [This is Warburton's emendation for "a good kissing"] This is a noble emendation, which almost sets the critic on a level with the author.

II.ii.265 (214,2) the shadow of a dream] Shakespeare has accidentally inverted an expression of Pindar, that the state of humanity is the *dream* of a *shadow*.

II.ii.269 (215,3) Then are our beggars, bodies] Shakespeare seems here to design a ridicule of these declamations against wealth and greatness, that seem to make happiness consist in poverty.

II.ii.336 (217,7) shall end his part in peace] [After these words the folio adds, *the clown shall make those laugh whose lungs are tickled o' th' sere*. Warburton.] This passage I have omitted, for the same reason, I suppose, as the other editors: I do not understand it.

II.ii.338 (217,8) the lady shall say her mind freely, or the blank verse shall halt for't] *The lady shall have no obstruction, unless from the lameness of the verse*.

II.ii.346 (217,9) I think, their inhibition comes by the means of the late innovation] I fancy this is transposed: Hamlet enquires not about an *inhibition*, but an *innovation*; the answer therefore probably was, *I think, their innovation, that is, their new practice of strolling, comes by the means of the late inhibition*.

II.ii.352-379 (218,1) *Ham*. How comes it? do they grow rusty?] The lines marked with commas are in the folio of 1623, but not in the quarto of 1637, nor, I suppose, in any of the quartos.

II.ii.355 (218,2) cry out on the top of question] The meaning seems to be, they ask a common question in the highest notes of the voice.

II.ii.362 (218,3) escorted] Paid.

II.ii.362 (218,4) Will they pursue quality no longer than they can *sing*?] Will they follow the *profession* of players no longer than they keep the voices of boys? So afterwards he says to the player, *Come, give us a taste of your quality; come, a passionate speech.*

II.ii.370 (219,6) to tarre them on to controversy] To provoke any animal to rage, is to *tarre him*. The word is said to come from the Greek. (1773)

II.ii.380 (219,8) It is not very strange, for mine uncle is king of Denmark] I do not wonder that the new players have so suddenly risen to reputation, my uncle supplies another example of the facility with which honour is conferred upon new claimants.

II.ii.412 (220,2) Buz, buz!] Mere idle talk, the *buz* of the vulgar.

II.ii.414 (220,3) *Then came each actor on his ass*] This seems to be a line of a ballad.

II.ii.420 (221,6) For the law of writ, and the liberty, these are the only men] All the modern editions have, *the law of wit, and the liberty*; but both my old copies have, *the law of writ*, I believe rightly. *Writ*, for *writing, composition*. *Wit* was not, in our author's time, taken either for *imagination*, or *acuteness*, or *both together*, but for *understanding*, for the faculty by which we *apprehend* and *judge*. Those who wrote of the human mind distinguished its primary powers into *wit* and *will*. Ascham distinguishes *boys* of tardy and of active faculties into *quick wits* and *slow wits*.

II.ii.438 (221,8) the first row of the pious chanson] [It is *pons chansons* in the first folio edition. POPE.] It is *pons chansons* in the quarto too. I know not whence the *rubric* has been brought, yet it has not the appearance of an arbitrary addition. The titles of old ballads were never printed red; but perhaps *rubric* may stand for *marginal explanation*.

II.ii.439 (222,9) For, look, where my abridgment comes] He calls the players afterwards, *the brief chronicles of the time*; but I think he now means only *those who will shorten my talk*.

II.ii.448 (223,2) be not crack'd within the ring] That is, *crack'd too much for use*. This is said to a young player who acted the parts of women.

II.ii.450 (223,3) like French falconers] HANMER, who has much illustrated the allusions to falconry, reads, *like French falconers*. [*French falconers* is not a correction by Hanmer, but the reading of the first folio. STEEVENS.] (see 1765, VIII, 198, 1)

II.ii.459 (223,5) (as I received it, and others whose judgment in such matters cried in the top of mine)] [i.e. whose judgment I had the highest opinion of. WARBURTON.] I think it means only that *were higher than mine*.

II.ii.466 (224,8) but called it, an honest method] Hamlet is telling how much his judgment differed from that of others. *One said, there was no salt in the lines, &c. but call'd it an honest method*. The author probably gave it, *But I called it an honest method, &c.*

II.ii.525 (226,9) *the mobled queen*] Mobled signifies *huddled, grossly covered*.

II.ii.587 (228,5) the cue for passion] The *hint, the direction*.

II.ii.589 (228,6) the general ear] The ears of all mankind. So before, *Caviare to the general, that is, to the multitude*.

II.ii.595 (229,7) unpregnant of my cause] [*Unpregnant, for having no due sense of*. WARBURTON.] Rather, *not quickened with a new desire of vengeance; not teeming with revenge*.

II.ii.598 (229,8) A damn'd defeat was made] [*Defeat, for destruction*. WARBURTON.] Rather, *dispossession*.

II.ii.608 (229,1) kindless] *Unnatural*.

II.ii.616 (229,3) About, my brain!] *Wits, to your work. Brain, go about the present business*.

II.ii.625 (230,5) tent him] Search his wounds.

II.ii.632 (230,7) More relative than this] [*Relative, for convictive*. WARB.] *Convictive* is only the consequential sense. *Relative* is, *nearly related, closely connected*.

III.i.17 (231,2) o'er-raught on the way] *Over-raught* is *over-reached*, that is, *over-took*.

III.i.31 (232,4) Affront Ophelia.] To *affront*, is only *to meet directly*.

III.i.47 (233,5) 'Tis too much prov'd] It is found by too frequent experience.

III.i.52 (233,6) more ugly to the thing that helps it] That is, *compared with* the thing that helps it.

III.i.56-88 (233,7) To be, or not to be?] Of this celebrated soliloquy, which bursting from a man distracted with contrariety of desires, and overwhelmed with the magnitude of his own purposes, is connected rather in the speaker's mind, than on his tongue, I shall endeavour to discover the train, and to shew how one sentiment produces another. Hamlet, knowing himself injured in the most enormous and atrocious degree, and seeing no means of redress, but such as must expose him to the extremity of hazard, meditates on his situation in this manner: *Before I can form any rational scheme of action under this pressure of distress*, it is necessary to decide, whether, *after our present state*, we are to be or not to be. That is the question, which, as it shall be answered, will determine, *whether 'tis nobler*, and more suitable to the dignity of reason, *to suffer the outrages of fortune* patiently, or to take arms against *them*, and by opposing end them, *though perhaps* with the loss of life. If *to die*, were *to sleep*, no more, and *by a sleep* to end the miseries of our nature, such a sleep were *devoutly to be wished*; but if *to sleep* in death, be *to dream*, to retain our powers of sensibility, we must *pause* to consider, *in that sleep of death what dreams may come*. This consideration *makes calamity* so long endured; for *who would* bear the vexations of life, which might be ended *by a bare bodkin*, but that he is afraid of something in unknown futurity? This fear it is that gives efficacy to conscience, which, by turning the mind upon *this regard*, chills the ardour of *resolution*, checks the vigour of *enterprize*, and makes the *current* of desire stagnate in inactivity. We may suppose that he would have applied these general observations to his own case, but that he discovered Ophelia.

III.i.59 (234,8) Or to take arms against a sea of troubles] [W: against assail] Mr. Pope proposed *siege*. I know not why there should be so much solicitude about this metaphor. Shakespeare breaks his metaphors often, and in this desultory speech there was less need of preserving them.

III.i.70 (235,2) the whips and scorns of time] [W: of th' time] I doubt whether the corruption of this passage is not more than the editor has suspected. *Whips* and *scorns* have no great connexion with one another, or with *time*: *whips* and *scorns* are evils of very different magnitude, and though at all *times* *scorn* may be endured, yet the *times* that put men ordinarily in danger of *whips*, are very rare. Falstaff has said, that the *courtiers* would whip him with their quick wits; but I know not that *whip* can be used for a *scoff* or *insult*, unless its meaning be fixed by the whole expression.

I am afraid lest I should venture too far in correcting this passage. If *whips* be retained, we may read,

For who would bear the whips and scorns of tyrant.

But I think that *quip*, a *sneer*, a *sarcasm*, a *contemptuous* jest, is the proper word, as suiting very exactly with *scorn*. What then must be done with *time*? it suits no better with the new reading than with the old, and *tyrant* is an image too bulky and serious. I read, but not confidently,

For who would bear the quips and scorns of title.

It say be remarked, that Hamlet, in his enumeration of miseries, forgets, whether properly or not, that he is a prince, and mentions many evils to which inferior stations only are exposed.

III.i.77 (236,4) To groan and sweat] All the old copies have, *to grunt and sweat*. It is undoubtedly the true reading, but can scarcely be borne by modern ears.

III.i.89 (237,5) Nymph, in thy orisons] This is a touch of nature. Hamlet, at the sight of Ophelia, does not immediately recollect, that he is to personate madness, but makes her an address grave and solemn, such as the foregoing meditation excited in his thoughts.

III.i.107 (237,6) That if you be honest and fair, you should admit no discourse to your beauty] This is the reading of all the modern editions, and is copied from the quarto. The folio reads, *your honesty should admit no discourse to your beauty*. The true reading seems to be this, *If you be honest and fair, you should admit your honesty to no discourse with your beauty*. This is the sense evidently required by the process of the conversation.

III.i.127 (238,7) I have thoughts to put them in] *To put a thing into thought*, is *to think on it*.

III.i.148 (239,8) I have heard of your paintings too, well enough] This is according to the quarto; the folio, for *painting*, has *prattlings*, and for *face*, has *pace*, which agrees with what follows, *you jig, you amble*. Probably the author wrote both. I think the common reading best.

III.i.152 (239,9) make your wantonness your ignorance] You mistake by *wanton* affectation, and pretend to mistake by *ignorance*.

III.i.161 (239,2) the mould of form] The model by whom all endeavoured to form themselves.

III.ii.12 (241,3) the groundlings] The meaner people then seem to have sat below, as they now sit in the upper gallery, who, not well understanding poetical language, were sometimes gratified by a mimical and mute representation of the drama, previous to the dialogue.

III.ii.14 (242,4) inexplicable dumb shews] I believe the meaning is, *shews, without words to explain them*.

III.ii.26 (242,6) the very age and body of the time, his form and pressure] The *age* of the *time* can hardly pass. May we not read, the *face* and *body*, or did the author write, the *page*? The *page* suits well with *form* and *pressure*, but ill with *body*.

III.ii.28 (242,7) pressure] Resemblance, as in a *print*.

III.ii.34 (242,8) (not to speak it profanely)] *Profanely* seems to relate, not to the praise which he has mentioned, but to the censure which he is about to utter. Any gross or indelicate language was called *profane*.

III.ii.66 (243,9) the pregnant hinges of the knee] I believe the sense of *pregnant* in this place is, *quick, ready, prompt*.

III.ii.68 (244,1) my dear soul] Perhaps, my *clear* soul.

III.ii.74 (244,2) Whose blood and judgment] According to the doctrine of the four humours, *desire* and *confidence* were seated in the blood, and *judgment* in the phlegm, and the due mixture of the humours made a perfect character.

III.ii.89 (244,3) Vulcan's stithy] *Stithy* is a smith's *anvil*.

III.ii.103 (245,4) nor mine now] A man's words, says the proverb, are his own no longer than he keep them unspoken.

III.ii.112 (245,5) they stay upon your patience] May it not be read more intelligibly, *They stay upon your pleasure*. In *Macbeth* it is, "Noble Macbeth, we stay upon your *leisure*."

III.ii.123 (245,6) Do you think I meant country matters?] I think we must read, *Do you think I meant country manners?* Do you imagine that I meant to sit in your lap, with such rough gallantry as clowns use to their lasses?

III.ii.137 (246,7) Nay, then, let the devil wear black, for I'll have a suit of sables] I know not why our editors should, with such implacable anger, persecute our predecessors. The dead, it is true, can make no resistance, they may be attacked with great security; but since they can neither feel nor mend, the safety of mauling them seems greater than the pleasure; nor perhaps would it much misbeseem us to remember, amidst our triumphs over the *nonsensical* and the *senseless*, that we likewise are men; that *debemur morti*, and, as Swift observed to Burnet, shall soon be among the dead ourselves.

I cannot find how the common reading is nonsense, nor why Hamlet, when he laid aside his dress of mourning, in a country where it was *bitter cold*, and the air was *nipping and eager*, should not have a *suit of sables*. I suppose it is well enough known, that the fur of sables is not black.

III.ii.147 (249,1) Marry, this is miching maliche; it means mischief [W: malhechor] I think Hanmer's exposition most likely to be right. Dr. Warburton, to justify his interpretation, must write, *miching* for *malechor*, and even then it will be harsh.

III.ii.167 (250,3) sheen] Splendor, lustre.

III.ii.177 (250,4) For women fear too much, even as they love] Here seems to be a line lost, which should have rhymed to *love*.

III.ii.192 (251,6) The instances, that second marriage move] The *motives*.

III.ii.202 (252,7)

Most necessary 'tis, that we forget

To pay ourselves what to ourselves is debt]

The performance of a resolution, in which only the *resolver* is interested, is a debt only to himself, which he may therefore remit at pleasure.

III.ii.206 (252,8)

The violence of either grief or joy,
Their own enactures with themselves destroy]

What grief or joy *enact* or determine in their violence, is revealed in their abatement. *Enactures* is the word in the quarto; all the modern editions have *enactors*.

III.ii.229 (252,9) An anchor's cheer in prison be my scope] May my whole liberty and enjoyment be to live on hermit's fare in a prison. *Anchor* is for *anchoret*.

III.ii.250 (253,1) Baptista] *Baptista* is, I think, in Italian, the name always of a man.

III.ii.262 (254,4) So you must take your husbands] Read, *So you* must take *your husbands* [in place of "mistake"]; that is, *for better, for worse*.

III.ii.288 (255,5) with two provencial roses on my rayed shoes] When shoe-strings were worn, they were covered, where they met in the middle, by a ribband, gathered into the form of a rose. So in an old song,

Gil-de-Roy *was a bonny boy,*
Had roses tull his shoen.

Rayed shoes, are shoes braided in lines.

III.ii.304 (256,1) For if the king like not the comedy/Why, then, belike] Hamlet was going on to draw the consequence when the courtiers entered.

III.ii.314 (256,2) With drink, Sir?] Hamlet takes particular care that his uncle's love of drink shall not be forgotten.

III.ii.346 (257,3) further trade] Further business; further dealing.

III.ii.348 (257,4) by these pickers] By these hands.

III.ii.373 (258,6) ventages] The holes of a flute.

III.ii.401 (259,9) they fool me to the top of my bent] They compel me to play the fool, till I can endure to do it no longer.

III.iii.7 (261,4) Out of his lunes] [The old quartos read,
Out of his brows.

This was from the ignorance of the first editors; as is this unnecessary Alexandrine, which we owe to the players. The poet, I am persuaded, wrote,

—us doth hourly grow
out of his lunes.

i.e. his *madness, frenzy*. THEOBALD.]

Lunacies is the reading of the folio.

I take *brows* to be, properly read, *frows*, which, I think, is a provincial word for *perverse humours*; which being, I suppose, not understood, was changed to *lunacies*. But of this I am not confident. [Steevens adopted Theobald's emendation]

III.iii.33 (262,7) of vantage] By some opportunity of secret observation.

III.iii.56 (263,9) May one be pardon'd, and retain the offence?] He that does not amend what can be amended, *retains* his *offence*. The king kept the crown from the right heir.

III.iii.66 (263,1) Yet what can it, when one cannot repent?] What can repentance *do for a man that cannot be penitent*, for a man who has only part of penitence, distress of conscience, without the other part, resolution of amendment.

III.iii.77 (264,1) I, his sole son, do this same villain send] The folio reads *foule son*, a reading apparently corrupted from the quarto. The meaning is plain. *I, his only son*, who am bound to punish his murderer.

III.iii.88 (264,2) Up, sword, and know thou a more horrid hent] [T: bent] This reading is followed by Sir T. HANMER and Dr. WARBURTON; but *hent* is probably the right word. To *hent* is used by Shakespeare for, to *seize*, to *catch*, to *lay hold on*. *Hent* is, therefore, *hold*, or *seizure*. *Lay hold* on him, sword, at a more horrid time.

III.iii.94 (265,3) his soul may be as damn'd and black/As hell, whereto it goes] This speech, in which Hamlet, represented as a virtuous character, is not content with taking blood for blood, but contrives damnation for the man that he would punish, is too horrible to be read or to be uttered.

III.iv.4 (266,4) I'll silence me e'en here:/ Pray you, be round with him]
 Sir T. HANMER, who is folloved by Dr. WARBURTON, reads,
 —*I'll sconce me here.*

Retire to a place of security. They forget that the contrivance of Polonius to overhear the conference, was no more told to the queen than to Hamlet. —*I'll silence me even here, is, I'll use no more words.*

III.iv.48 (268,8)

Heaven's face doth glow;
 Yea, this solidity and compound mass,
 With tristful visage, as against the doom,
 It thought-sick at the act]

[W: O'er this ... visage, and, as 'gainst] The word *heated* [from the "old quarto"], though it agrees well enough with *glow*, is, I think, not so striking as *tristful*, which was, I suppose, chosen at the revisal. I believe the whole passage now stands as the author gave it. Dr. WARBURTON's reading restores two improprieties, which Shakespeare, by his alteration, had removed. In the first, and in the new reading: *Heaven's face glows with tristful visage*; and, *Heaven's face is thought-sick*. To the common reading there is no just objection.

III.iv.52 (268,9) what act,/ That roars so loud, and thunders in the index?] The meaning is, *What is this act*, of which the *discovery*, or *mention*, cannot be made, but with this violence of clamour?

III.iv.82 (270,5) *Rebellious hell*,/ If thou canst mutiny in a matron's bones] I think the present reading right, but cannot admit that HANMER's emendation ["*Rebellious heat*"] produces nonsense. May not what is said of *heat*, be said of *hell*, that it will mutiny wherever it is quartered? Though the emendation be elegant, it is not necessary. (1773)

III.iv.88 (271,6) reason panders will] So the folio, I think rightly; but the reading of the quarto is defensible;
 —*reason pardons will.*

III.iv.90 (271,7) grained] Dyed in grain.

III.iv.92 (271,8) incestuous bed] The folio has *enseamed*, that is, *greasy* bed.

III.iv.98 (271,9) vice of kings!] a low mimick of kings. The vice is the fool of a farce; from whom the modern *punch* is descended.

III.iv.102 (272,2) A king of shreds and patches] This is said, pursuing the idea of the *vice of kings*. The *vice* was dressed as a fool, in a coat of party-coloured patches.

III.iv.107 (272,3) lap's in time and passion] That, having suffered *time* to *slip*, and *passion* to *cool*, *lets go*, &c.

III.iv.151 (274,6) And do not spread the compost on the weeds/ To make them ranker] Do not, by any new indulgence, heighten your former offences.

III.iv.155 (274,7) curb] That is, *bend* and *truckle*. Fr. *courber*.

III.iv.161 (274,8) That monster custom, who all sense doth eat/ Of habits evil, is angel yet in this] [Thirlby: habits evil] I think THIRLBY's conjecture wrong, though the succeeding editors have followed it; *angel* and *devil* are evidently opposed. [Steevens accepted "evil"]

III.iv.203 (277,5) adders fang'd] That is, adders with their *fangs*, or *poisonous teeth*, undrawn. It has been the practice of mountebanks to boast the efficacy of their antidotes by playing with vipers, but they first disabled their fangs.

IV.i (278,1) *A royal apartment. Enter King, Queen, Rosencrantz, and Guildenstern*] This play is printed in the old editions without any separation of the acts. The division is modern and arbitrary; and is here not very happy, for the pause is made at a time when there is more continuity of action than in almost any other of the scenes.

IV.i.18 (278,2) out of haunt] I would rather read, *out of harm*.

IV.i.25 (279,3)

his very madness, like some ore
among a mineral of metals base,
Shews itself pure]

Shakespeare seems to think *ore* to be *or*, that is, gold. Base metals have *ore* no less than precious.

IV.ii.19 (281,5) he keeps them, like an ape, in the corner of his jaw] The quarto has *apple*, which is generally followed. The folio has *ape*,

which HANMER has received, and illustrated with the following note.

"It is the way of monkeys in eating, to throw that part of their food, which they take up first, into a pouch they are provided with on the side of their jaw, and then they keep it, till they have done with the rest."

IV.ii.28 (281,6) The body is with the king] This answer I do not comprehend. Perhaps it should be, *The body is not with the king, for the king is not with the body.*

IV.ii.32 (282,7) Of nothing] Should it not be read, *Or nothing?* When the courtiers remark, that Hamlet has contemptuously called the *king a thing*, Hamlet defends himself by observing, that the king must be *a thing*, or *nothing*.

IV.ii.46 (283,9) the wind at help] I suppose it should be read, *The bark is ready, and the wind at helm.*

IV.ii.68 (284,3) And thou must cure me: till I know 'tis done,/ Howe'er my haps, my joys will ne'er begin] This being the termination of a scene, should, according to our author's custom, be rhymed. Perhaps he wrote,

Howe'er my hopes, my joys are not begun.

If *haps* be retained, the meaning will be, *'till I know 'tis done, I shall be miserable, whatever befall me* (see 1785, VIII, 257, 3)

IV.iv.33 (286,4)

What is a man,

If his chief good and market of his time

Be but to sleep and feed?]

If his highest good, and *that for which he sells his time*, be to sleep and feed.

IV.iv.36 (286,5) large discourse] Such latitude of comprehension, such power of reviewing the past, and anticipating the future.

IV.iv.53 (286,6) Rightly to be great,/Is not to stir without great argument] This passage I have printed according to the copy. Mr. THEOBALD had regulated it thus:

— *'Tis not to be great,*

Never to stir without great argument;

But greatly, &c.

The sentiment of Shakespeare is partly just, and partly romantic.

—*Rightly to be great,*

Is not to stir without great argument;

is exactly philosophical.

But greatly to find quarrel in a straw,

When honour is at stake,

is the idea of a modern hero. *But then, says he honour is an argument, or subject of debate, sufficiently great, and when honour is at stake, we must find cause of quarrel in a straw.*

IV.iv.56 (287,7) Excitements of my reason and my blood] Provocations which excite both my reason and my passions to vengeance.

IV.v.37 (289,4) *Larded all with sweet flowers*] The expression is taken from cookery. (1773)

IV.v.53 (290,6) *And dupt the chamber-door*] To *dup*, is to *do up*; to lift the latch. It were easy to write,

And op'd —

IV.v.58 (290,7) *By Gis*] I rather imagine it should be read,

By Cis, —

That is, by St. Cecily.

IV.v.83 (291,8) but greenly] But *unskilfully*; with *greenness*; that is, without *maturity* of judgment.

IV.v.84 (291,9) In hugger-mugger to inter him] All the modern editions that I have consulted give it,

In private to inter him; —

That the words now replaced are better, I do not undertake to prove; it is sufficient that they are Shakespeare's: if phraseology is to be changed as words grow uncouth by disuse, or gross by vulgarity, the history of every language will be lost; we shall no longer have the words of any author; and, as these alterations will be often unskilfully made, we shall in time have very little of his meaning.

IV.v.89 (292,1) Feeds on his wonder] The folio reads,

Keeps on his wonder, —

The quarto,

Feeds on this wonder. —

Thus the true reading is picked out from between them. HANMER reads unnecessarily,

Feeds on his anger. —

IV.v.92 (292,2) Wherein necessity, of matter beggar'd,/ Will nothing stick our persons to arraign] HANMER reads,

Whence animosity, of matter beggar'd.

He seems not to have understood the connection. *Wherein*, that is, *in which pestilent speeches, necessity, or, the obligation of an accuser to support his charge, will nothing stick, &c.*

IV.v.99 (293,4) The ocean, over-peering of his list] The lists are the barriers which the spectators of a tournament must not pass.

IV.v.105 (293,5) The ratifiers and props of every ward] [W: ward] With this emendation, which was in Theobald's edition, Hanmer was not satisfied. It is indeed harsh. HANMER transposes the lines, and reads,

They cry, "Chuse we Laertes for our king;"

The ratifiers and props of every word,

Caps, hands, and tongues, applaud it to the clouds.

I think the fault may be mended at less expence, by reading,

Antiquity forgot, custom not known,

The ratifiers and props of every weal.

That is, of every government.

IV.v.110 (294,6) Oh, this is counter, you false Danish dogs] Hounds run *counter* when they trace the trail backwards.

IV.v.161 (296,9)

Nature is fine in loves and, where 'tis fine,

It sends some precious instance of itself

After the thing it loves]

These lines are not in the quarto, and might have been omitted in the folio without great loss, for they are obscure and affected; but, I think, they require no emendation. *Love* (says Laertes) is the passion by which *nature is most exalted and refined*; and as substances *refined* and subtilised, easily obey any impulse, or follow any attraction, some part of nature, so purified and *refined*, flies off after the attracting object, after the thing it loves.

As into air the purer spirits flow,

And separate from their kindred dregs below,

So flew her soul. —

IV.v.171 (297,1) O how the wheel becomes it!] [W: weal] I do not see why *weal* is better than *wheel*. The story alluded to I do not know; but perhaps the lady stolen by the steward was reduced to *spin*.

IV.v.175 (297,2) There's rosemary, that'll far remembrance. Pray you, love, remember. And there's pansies, that's for thoughts] There is probably some mythology in the choice of these herbs, but I cannot explain it. *Pansies* is for *thoughts*, because of its name, *Pensées*; but *rosemary* indicates *remembrance*, except that it is an ever-green, and carried at funerals, I have not discovered.

IV.v.214 (300,7) No trophy, sword, nor batchment] It was the custom, in the times of our author, to hang a sword over the grave of a knight.

IV.v.218 (300,8) And where the offence is, let the great axe fall] [W: tax] *Fall* corresponds better to *axe*.

IV.vi.26 (301,9) *for the bore of the matter*] The *bore* is the calibier of a gun, or the capacity of the barrel. *The matter* (says Hamlet) *would carry the heavier words*.

IV.vii.18 (302,1) the general gender] The *common race* of the people.

IV.vii.19 (302,2)

dipping all his faults in their affection,
Would, like the spring that turneth wood to stone,
Convert his gyves to graces]

This simile is neither very seasonable in the deep interest of this conversation, nor very accurately applied. If the *spring* had changed base metals to gold, the thought had been more proper.

IV.vii.27 (302,3) if praises may go back again] If I may praise what has been, but is now to be found no more.

IV.vii.77 (304,5) Of the unworthiest siege] Of the lowest rank. *Siege*, for *seat*, *place*.

IV.vii.82 (304,6) Importing health and graveness] [W: wealth] *Importing* here may be, not *inferring* by logical consequence, but *producing* by physical effect. A young man regards show in his dress, an old man, *health*.

IV.vii.90 (305,7) I, in forgery of shapes and tricks/ Come short of what he did] I could not contrive so many proofs of dexterity as he could perform.

IV.vii.98 (305,8) in your defence] That is, *in the science of* defence.

IV.vii.101 (305,9) The scrimers] The *fencers*.

IV.vii.112 (305,1) love is begun by time] This is obscure. The meaning may be, *love* is not innate in us, and co-essential to our nature, but begins at a certain time from some external cause, and being always subject to the operations of time, suffers change and diminution. (1773)

IV.vii.113 (300,2) in passages of proof] In transactions of daily experience.

IV.vii.123 (306,4) And then this *should* is like a spendthrift sigh/ That hurts by easing] [W: sign] This conjecture is so ingenious, that it can hardly be opposed, but with the same reluctance as the bow is drawn against a hero, whose virtues the archer holds in veneration. Here may be applied what Voltaire writes to the empress:

Le genereux Francois—

Te combat & t'admire.

Yet this emendation, however specious, is mistaken. The original reading is, not a *spendthrift's* sigh, but a *spendthrift* sigh; a *sigh* that makes an unnecessary waste of the vital flame. It is a notion very prevalent, that *sighs* impair the strength, and wear out the animal powers.

IV.vii.135 (307,5) He being remiss] He being not vigilant or cautious.

IV.vii.139 (307,7) a pass of practice] Practice is often by Shakespeare, and other writers, taken for an *insidious stratagem*, or *privy* treason, a sense not incongruous to this passage, where yet I rather believe, that nothing more is meant than a *thrust for exercise*.

IV.vii.151 (308,8) May fit us to our shape] May *enable* us to *assume proper characters*, and to act our part.

IV.vii.155 (308,9) blast in proof] This, I believe, is a metaphor taken from a mine, which, in the proof or execution, sometimes breaks out with an ineffectual *blast*.

Vi.3 (310,1) make her grave straight] Make her grave from east to west in a direct line parallel to the church; not from north to south, athwart the regular line. This, I think, is meant.

Vi.87 (313,1) which this ass now o'er-reaches] In the quarto, for *over-offices* is, *over-reaches*, which agrees better with the sentence: it is a strong exaggeration to remark that an *ass* can *over-reach* him who would once have tried to *circumvent*.—I believe both the words were Shakespeare's. An author in revising his work, when his original ideas have faded from his mind, and new observations have produced new sentiments, easily introduces images which have been more newly impressed upon him, without observing their want of congruity to the general texture of his original design.

Vi.96 (314,2) and now my lady Worm's] The scull that was *my lord Such a one's*, is now *my lady Worm's*.

Vi.100 (314,3) to play at loggats with 'em?] A play, in which pins are set up to be beaten down with a bowl.

Vi.149 (316,5) by the card] The *card* is the paper on which the different points of the compass were described. *To do any thing by the card*, is, *to do it with nice observation*.

Vi.151 (316,6) the age is grown so picked] So *smart*, so *sharp*, says HANMER, very properly; but there was, I think, about that time, a *picked* shoe, that is, *a shoe with a long pointed toe*, in fashion, to which the allusion seems likewise to be made. *Every man now is smart; and every man now is a man of fashion*.

Vi.239 (319,7) winter's flaw!] Winter's *blast*.

Vi.242 (319,8) maimed rites!] Imperfect obsequies.

Vi.244 (319,9) some estate] Some person of high rank.

Vi.255 (319,2) Yet here she is allow'd her virgin crants] I have been informed by an anonymous correspondent, that *crants* is the German word for *garlands*, and I suppose it was retained by us from the Saxons. To carry *garlands* before the bier of a maiden, and to hang them over her grave, is still the practice in rural parishes.

Crants therefore was the original word, which the author, discovering it to be provincial, and perhaps not understood, changed to a term more intelligible, but less proper. *Maiden rites* give no certain or

definite image. He might have put *maiden wreaths*, or *maiden garlands*, but he perhaps bestowed no thought upon it, and neither genius nor practice will always supply a hasty writer with the most proper diction.

V.i.310 (323,6) When that her golden couplets] [W: E'er that] Perhaps it should be,

Ere yet—

Yet and *that* are easily confounded.

V.ii.6 (324,7) mutinies in the bilboes] *Mutinies*, the French word for seditious or disobedient fellows in the army or fleet. *Bilboes*, the *ship's prison*.

V.ii.6 (324,8) Rashly,/ And prais'd be rashness for it—Let us know] Both my copies read,

—Rashly,

And prais'd be rashness for it, let us know.

Hamlet, delivering an account of his escape, begins with saying, that he *rashly*—and then is carried into a reflection upon the weakness of human wisdom. I rashly—praised be rashness for it—*Let us* not think these events casual, but *let us know*, that is, *take notice and remember*, that we sometimes succeed by *indiscretion*, when we *fail* by *deep plots*, and infer the perpetual superintendence and *agency* of the *Divinity*. The observation is just, and will be allowed by every human being who shall reflect on the course of his own life.

V.ii.22 (325,9) With, ho! such bugs and goblins in my life] With *such causes of terror*, arising from my character and designs.

V.ii.29 (325,2) Being thus benetted round with villainies,/ Ere I could make a prologue to my brains] [W: mark the prologue ... bane] In my opinion no alteration is necessary. Hamlet is telling how luckily every thing fell out; he groped out their commission in the dark without waking them; he found himself doomed to immediate destruction. Something was to be done for his preservation. An expedient occurred, not produced by the comparison of one method with another, or by a regular deduction of consequences, but before he *could make a prologue to his brains*, they *had begun the play*. Before he could summon his faculties, and propose to himself what should be done, a complete scheme of action presented itself to him. His mind operated before he had excited it. This appears to me to be the meaning.

V.ii.41 (326,5) As peace should still her wheaten garland wear,/ And stand a comma 'tween their amities] HANMER reads,

And stand a cement —

I am again inclined to vindicate the old reading.

The expression of our author is, like many of his phrases, sufficiently constrained and affected, but it is not incapable of explanation. The *comma* is the note of *connection* and continuity of sentences; the *period* is the note of *abruption* and disjunction. Shakespeare had it perhaps in his mind to write, That unless England complied with the mandate, *war should put a period to their amity*; he altered his mode of diction, and thought that, in an opposite sense, he might put, that *Peace should stand a comma between their amities*. This is not an easy stile; but is it not the stile of Shakespeare?

V.ii.43 (327,6) as's of great charge] *Asses heavily loaded*. A quibble is intended between *as* the conditional particle, and *ass* the beast of burthen. That *charg'd* anciently signified *leaded*, may be proved from the following passage in *The Widow's Tears*, by Chapman, 1612.

"Thou must be the *ass charg'd with crowns* to make way." (see 1765, VIII, 294, 2)

V.ii.53 (327,7) The changeling never known] A *changeling* is a *child* which the fairies are supposed to leave in the room of that which they steal.

V.ii.68 (328,1) To quit him] To requite him; to pay him his due.

V.ii.84 (329,2) Dost know this water-fly] A *water-fly*, skips up and down upon the surface of the water, without any apparent purpose or reason, and is thence the proper emblem of a busy trifler.

V.ii.89 (329,3) It is a chough] A kind of jackdaw.

V.ii.112 (330,5) full of most excellent differences] Full of *distinguishing* excellencies.

V.ii.114 (330,6) the card or calendar of gentry] The general preceptor of elegance; the *card* by which a gentleman is to direct his course; the *calendar* by which he is to choose his time, that what he does may be both excellent and seasonable.

V.ii.115 (330,7) for you shall find in him the continent of what part a gentleman would see] *You shall find him containing* and comprising

every *quality* which a *gentleman* would desire to *contemplate* for imitation. I know not but it should be read, *You shall find him the continent*

V.ii.119 (330,9) and yet but raw neither in respect of his quick sail] [W: but slow] I believe *raw* to be the right word; it is a word of great latitude; *raw* signifies *unripe, immature*, thence *unformed, imperfect, unskilful*. The best account of him would be *imperfect*, in respect of his quick sail. The phrase *quick sail* was, I suppose, a proverbial term for *activity of mind*.

V.ii.122 (330,1) a soul of great article] This is obscure. I once thought it might have been, *a soul of great altitude*; but, I suppose, *a soul of great article*, means *a soul of large comprehension, of many contents*; the particulars of an inventory are called *articles*.

V.ii.122 (331,2) his infusion of such dearth and rareness] *Dearth* is *dearness*, value, price. And his internal qualities of such value and rarity.

V.ii.131 (331,3) Is't not possible to understand in another tongue? you will do't, Sir, really] Of this interrogatory remark the sense is very obscure. The question may mean, *Might not all this be understood in plainer language*. But then, *you will do it, Sir, really*, seems to have no use, for who could doubt but plain language would be intelligible? I would therefore read, *Is't possible* not to be understood in a mother tongue. You will do it, Sir, really.

V.ii.140 (331,4) if you did, it would not much approve me] If you knew I was not ignorant, your esteem would not much advance my reputation. To *approve*, is to *recommend to approbation*.

V.ii.145 (331,5) I dare not confess that, lest I should compare with him in excellence] I dare not pretend to know him, lest I should pretend to an equality: no man can completely know another, but by knowing himself, which is the utmost extent of human wisdom.

V.ii.149 (332,6) in his meed] In his excellence.

V.ii.156 (332,7) impon'd] Perhaps it should be, *depon'd*. So Hudibras,
"I would upon this cause *depone*,
"As much as any I have known."

But perhaps *imponed* is pledged, *impawned*, so spelt to ridicule the affectation of uttering English words with French pronunciation.

V.ii.165 (332,9) more germane.] *Morea-kin*.

V.ii.172 (333,1) The king, Sir, hath laid, that in a dozen passes between yourself and him, he shall not exceed you three hits; he hath laid on twelve for nine] This wager I do not understand. In a dozen passes one must exceed the other more or less than three hits. Nor can I comprehend, how, in a dozen, there can be twelve to nine. The passage is of no importance; it is sufficient that there was a wager. The quarto has the passage as it stands. The folio, *He hath one twelve for mine*.

V.ii.193 (333,2) This lapwing runs away with the shell on his head] I see no particular propriety in the image of the lapwing. Osrick did not run till he had done his business. We may read, *This lapwing ran away*—That is, *this fellow was full of unimportant bustle from his birth*.

V.ii.199 (334,4) a kind of yesty collection, which carries them through and through the most fond and winnowed opinions] [W: most fann'd] This is a very happy emendation; but I know not why the critic should suppose that *fond* was printed for *fann'd* in consequence of any reason or reflection. Such errors, to which there is no temptation but idleness, and of which there was no cause but ignorance, are in every page of the old editions. This passage in the quarto stands thus: "They have got out of the habit of encounter, a kind of misty collection, which carries them through and through the most profane and renowned opinions." If this printer preserved any traces of the original, our author wrote, "the most fane and renowned opinions," which is better than fann'd and winnow'd.

The meaning is, "these men have got the cant of the day, a superficial readiness of slight and cursory conversation, a kind of frothy collection of fashionable prattle, which yet carried them through the most select and approved judgment. This airy facility of talk sometimes imposes upon wise men."

Who has not seen this observation verified?

V.ii.201 (335,6) and do but blow them to their trials, the bubbles are out] These men of show, without solidity, are like bubbles raised from soap and water, which dance, and glitter, and please the eye, but if you extend them, by blowing hard, separate into a mist; so if you oblige these specious talkers to extend their compass of conversation, they at once discover the tenuity of their intellects.

V.ii.216 (335,7) gentle entertainment] Mild and temperate conversation.

V.ii.234 (336,1) Since no man knows aught of what he leaves, what is't to leave betimes?] The reading of the quarto was right, but in some other copy the harshness of the transposition was softened, and the passage stood thus: *Since no man knows aught of what he leaves*. For *knows* was printed in the later copies *has*, by a slight blunder in such typographers.

I do not think Dr. Warburton's interpretation of the passage the best that it will admit. The meaning may be this, *Since no man knows aught of the state of life which he leaves*, since he cannot judge what others years may produce, why should he be afraid of *leaving* life betimes? Why should he dread an early death, of which he cannot tell whether it is an exclusion of happiness, or an interception of calamity. I despise the superstition of augury and omens, which has no ground in reason or piety; my comfort is, that I cannot fall but by the direction of Providence.

Hanmer has, *Since no man owes aught*, a conjecture not very reprehensible. *Since no man can call any possession certain*, what is it to leave?

V.ii.237 (337,2) Give me your pardon, Sir] I wish Hamlet had made some other defence; it is unsuitable to the character of a good or a brave man, to shelter himself in falsehood.

V.ii.272 (338,5) Your grace hath laid upon the weaker side] Thus Hanmer. All the others read,

Your grace hath laid the odds o' the weaker side.

When the odds were on the side of Laertes, who was to hit Hamlet twelve times to nine, it was perhaps the author's slip.

V.ii.310 (340,7) you make a wanton of me] A *wanton* was, a man feeble and effeminate. In *Cymbeline*, Imogen says,

"I am not so citizen a *wanton*,
To die, ere I be sick."

V.ii.346 (342,8) That are but mutes or audience to this act] That are either mere *auditors* of this *catastrophe*, or at most only *mute performers*, that fill the stage without any part in the action.

V.ii.375 (344,2) This quarry cries, on havock!] Hanmer reads,
 —cries out, *havock!*

To *cry on*, was to *exclaim against*. I suppose, when unfair sportsmen destroyed more *quarry* or *game* than was reasonable, the censure was to cry, *Havock*.

(346) General Observation. If the dramas of Shakespeare were to be characterised, each by the particular excellence which distinguishes it from the rest, we must allow to the tragedy of Hamlet the praise of variety. The incidents are so numerous, that the argument of the play would make a long tale. The scenes are interchangeably diversified with merriment and solemnity; with merriment that includes judicious and instructive observations, and solemnity, not strained by poetical violence above the natural sentiments of man. New characters appear from time to time in continual succession, exhibiting various forms of life and particular modes of conversation. The pretended madness of Hamlet causes much mirth, the mournful distraction of Ophelia fills the heart with tenderness, and every personage produces the effect intended, from the apparition that in the first act chills the blood with horror, to the fop in the last, that exposes affectation to just contempt. The conduct is perhaps not wholly secure against objections. The action is indeed for the most part in continual progression, but there are some scenes which neither forward nor retard it. Of the feigned madness of Hamlet there appears no adequate cause, for he does nothing which he might not have done with the reputation of sanity. He plays the madman most, when he treats Ophelia with so much rudeness, which seems to be useless and wanton cruelty.

Hamlet is, through the whole play, rather an instrument than an agent. After he has, by the stratagem of the play, convicted the king, he makes no attempt to punish him, and his death is at last effected by an incident which Hamlet had no part in producing.

The catastrophe is not very happily produced; the exchange of weapons is rather an expedient of necessity, than a stroke of art. A scheme might easily have been formed to kill Hamlet with the dagger, and Laertes with the bowl.

The poet is accused of having shewn little regard to poetical justice, and may be charged with equal neglect of poetical probability. The apparition left the regions of the dead to little purpose; the revenge which he demands is not obtained, but by the death of him that was

required to take it; and the gratification which would arise from the destruction of an usurper and a murderer, is abated by the untimely death of Ophelia, the young, the beautiful, the harmless, and the pious.

OTHELLO

I.i.20 (358,4)

One Michael Cassio, a Florentine,
A fellow almost damn'd in a fair wife]

This is one of the passages which must for the present be resigned to corruption and obscurity. I have nothing that I can, with any approach to confidence, propose. I cannot think it very plain from Act 3. Scene 1. that Cassio was or was not a Florentine.

I.i.30 (361,6) must be belee'd and calm'd] [—*must be LED and calm'd*. So the old quarto. The first folio reads *belee'd*: but that spoils the measure. I read LET, hindered. Warburton.] *Belee'd* suits to *calm'd*, and the measure is not less perfect than in many other places.

I.i.36 (361,7) Preferment goes by letter] By *recommendation* from powerful friends.

I.i.37 (361,8) And not by old gradation] [W: Not (as of old)] *Old gradation*, is *gradation* established by *ancient* practice. Where is the difficulty?

I.i.39 (361,9) If I in any just term am affin'd] *Affine* is the reading of the third quarto and the first folio. The second quarto and all the modern editions have *assign'd*. The meaning is, *Do I stand within any such terms of propinquity or relation to the Moor, as that it is my duty to love him?*

I.i.49 (362,1) honest knaves] *Knave* is here for *servant*, but with a mixture of sly contempt.

I.i.63 (362,2) In compliment extern] In that which I do only for an outward shew of civility.

I.i.76 (363,3) As when, by night and negligence, the fire/Is spied in populous cities] [Warburton, objecting to "by": Is spread] The particle is used equivocally; the same liberty is taken by writers more correct.

The wonderful creature! a woman of reason!

Never grave out of pride, never gay out of season.

I.i.115 (364,4) What profane wretch art thou?] That is, *what wretch of gross and licentious language?* In that sense Shakespeare often uses the word *profane*.

I.i.124 (365,6) this odd even] The *even of night* is *midnight*, the time when night is divided into *even* parts.

I.i.149 (366,7) some check] Some rebuke.

I.i.150 (366,8) cast him] That is, *dismiss* him; *reject* him. We still say, a *cast* coat, and a *cast* serving-man.

I.i.162 (366,9) And what's to come of my despised time] [W: despited] *Despised time*, is *time of no value*; time in which

"There's nothing serious in mortality,
The wine of life is drawn, and the mere dregs
Are left, this vault to brag of." *Macbeth*.

I.i.173 (367,2) By which the property of youth and maidhood/ May be abus'd?] By which the faculties of a young virgin may be infatuated, and made subject to illusions and to false imagination.

"Wicked dreams *abuse*
The curtain'd sleep." *Macbeth*.

I.ii.2 (368,3) stuff o' the conscience] This expression to common readers appears harsh. *Stuff* of the *conscience* is, *substance*, or *essence* of the conscience. *Stuff* is a word of great force in the Teutonic languages. The elements are called in Dutch, *Hoefd stoffen*, or *head stuffs*.

I.ii.13 (368,4) And hath, in his effect, a voice potential/ As double as the duke's] [Warburton had given a source in Dioscorides and Theocritus for "double"] This note has been much censured by Mr. Upton, who denies, that the quotation is in Dioscorides, and disputes, not without reason, the interpretation of Theocritus.

All this learning, if it had even been what it endeavours to be thought, is, in this place, superfluous. There is no ground of supposing, that our author copied or knew the Greek phrase; nor does it follow, that, because a word has two senses in one language, the word which in another answers to one sense, should answer to both. *Manus*, in Latin, signifies both a *hand* and *troop of soldiers*, but we cannot say, that *the captain marched at the head of his hand*; or, that *he laid his troop upon his sword*. It is not always in books that the meaning

is to be sought of this writer, who was much more acquainted with naked reason and with living manners.

Double has here its natural sense. The president of every deliberative assembly has a *double voice*. In our courts, the chief justice and one of the inferior judges prevail over the other two, because the chief justice has a *double voice*.

Brabantio had, *in his effect*, though not by law, yet by *weight* and *influence*, a voice not *actual* and formal, but *potential* and operative, as *double*, that is, a voice that when a question was suspended, would turn the balance as effectually as *the duke's*. *Potential* is used in the sense of science; a *caustic* is called *potential* fire.

I.ii.23 (370,7) speak, unbonnetted] [Pope: unbonnetting] I do not see the propriety of Mr. Pope's emendation, though adopted by Dr. Warburton. *Unbonnetting* may as well be, *not putting on*, as *not putting off*, the bonnet. Hamner reads *e'en* bonnetted.

I.ii.26 (370,8) unhoused] Free from *domestic* cares. A thought natural to an adventurer.

I.ii.28 (370,9) For the sea's worth] I would not marry her, though she were as rich as the Adriatic, which the Doge annually marries.

I.ii.30 (371,2) a land-carrack] A *carrack* is a ship of great bulk, and commonly of great value; perhaps what we now call a *galleon*.

I.ii.55 (372,3) be advis'd] That is, be *cool*; be *cautious*; be *discreet*.

I.ii.68 (372,4) The wealthy curled darlings of our nation] *Curled* is *elegantly and ostentatiously dressed*. He had not the hair particularly in his thoughts.

I.ii.74 (373,6) Abused her delicate youth with drugs, or minerals,/ That weaken notion] [T: notion] Hanmer reads with equal probability, *That waken motion*. [Originally *motion*].

I.iii.6 (375,9) As in these cases where they aim reports] [W: the aim] The folio has,
—*the aim* reports.

But, *they aim reports*, has a sense sufficiently easy and commodious. There men *report* not by certain knowledge, but by *aim* and conjecture.

I.ii.18 (375,1) By no assay of reason] Bring it to the *test*, examine it by reason as we examine metals by the *assay*, it will be found counterfeit by all trials.

I.iii.23 (376,2) facile question] *Question* is for the *act of seeking*. With more *easy endeavour*.

I.iii.24 (376,4) warlike brace] State of defence. To arm was called to *brace on* the armour.

I.iii.42 (376,5) And prays you to believe him] The late learned and ingenious Mr. Thomas Clark, of Lincoln's Inn, read the passage thus:
And prays you to relieve him.

But the present reading may stand. *He intreats you not to doubt the truth of this intelligence.*

I.iii.54 (377,6) Hath rais'd me from my bed; nor doth the general care] The word *care*, which encumbers the verse, was probably added by the players. Shakespeare uses *the general* as a substantive, though, I think, not in this sense.

I.iii.69 (373,8) though our proper son/ Stood in your action] Were the man exposed to your *charge* or *accusation*.

I.iii.80 (378,9) The very head and front of my offending] The *main*, the *whole*, unextenuated.

I.iii.85 (379,2) Their dearest action] That is *dear*, for which much is paid, whether money or labour; *dear action*, is action performed at great expence, either of ease or safety.

I.iii.107 (380,4) overt test] Open proofs, external evidence.

I.iii.108 (380,5) thin habits and poor likelihoods/ Of modern seeming] Weak shew of slight appearance.

I.iii.139 (381,6) And portance in my travel's history] [I have restored,
And with it all my travel's history:
From the old edition. It is in the rest,
And portance in my travel's history.

Rymer, in his criticism on this play, has changed it to *portents*, instead of *portance*. POPE.] Mr. Pope has restored a line, to which there is little objection, but which has no force. I believe *portance* was the author's word in some revised copy. I read thus,

*Of being — — sold
 To slavery, of my redemption, thence,
 And portance in't; my travel's history.
 My redemption from slavery, and behaviour in it.*

I.iii.140-170 (381,7) Wherein of antres vast, and desarts idle] Whoever ridicules this account of the progress of love, shows his ignorance, not only of history, but of nature and manners. It is no wonder that, in any age, or in any nation, a lady, recluse, timorous, and delicate, should desire to hear of events and scenes which she could never see, and should admire the man who had endured dangers and performed actions, which, however great, were yet magnified by her timidity. [Pope: deserts wild] Every mind is liable to absence and inadvertency, else Pope could never have rejected a word so poetically beautiful. Idle is an epithet used to express the infertility of the chaotic state, in the Saxon translation of the Pentateuch. (1773)

I.iii.140 (382,8) antres] [French grottos. POPE.] Rather *caves* and *dens*.

I.iii.142 (382,9) It was my hint to speak] [W: hent] *Hent* is not used in Shakespeare, nor, I believe, in any other author; *hint*, or *cue*, is commonly used for occasion of speech, which is explained by, *such was the process*, that is, the course of the tale required it. If *hent* be restored, it may be explained by *handle*. I had a *handle*, or *opportunity*, to speak of cannibals.

I.iii.144 (382,1) men whose heads/ Do grow beneath their shoulders] Of these men there is an account in the interpolated travels of Mondeville, a book of that time.

I.iii.199 (384,4) Let me speak like yourself;] [W: our self] Hanmer reads,

Let me now speak more like your self.

Dr. Warburton's emendation is specious; but I do not see how Hanmer's makes any alteration. The duke seems to mean, when he says he will speak like Brabantio, that he will speak sententiously.

I.iii.213 (385,6) But the free comfort which from thence he hears] But the moral precepts of consolation, which are liberally bestowed on occasion of the sentence.

I.iii.232 (386,8) thrice-driven bed of down] A *driven* bed, is a bed for which the feathers are selected, by *driving* with a fan, which separates the light from the heavy.

I.iii.237 (337,9)

I crave fit disposition for my wife;
Due reverence of place, and exhibition]

I desire, that a proper *disposition* be made for my wife, that she may have *precedency*, and *revenue*, accommodation, and *company*, suitable to her rank.

For *reference* of place, the old quartos have *reverence*, which Hanmer has received. I should read,

Due preference of place. —

I.iii.246 (387,1) And let me find a charter in your voice] Let your favour *privilege* me.

I.iii.250 (387,2) My down-right violence and storm of fortunes] [W: to forms, my fortunes] There is no need of this emendation. *Violence* is not *violence suffered*, but *violence acted*. Breach of common rules and obligations. The old quarto has, *scorn* of fortune, which is perhaps the true reading.

I.iii.253 (388,3) I saw Othello's visage in his mind] It must raise no wonder, that I loved a man of an appearance so little engaging; I saw his face only in his mind; the greatness of his character reconciled me to his form.

I.iii.264 (386,4)

Nor to comply with heat (the young affects,
In me defunct) and proper satisfaction]

[T: me distinct, i.e. with that heat and new affections which the indulgence of my appetite has raised and created. This is the meaning of *defunct*, which has made all the difficulty of the passage. WARBURTON.] I do not think that Mr. Theobald's emendation clears the text from embarrassment, though it is with a little imaginary improvement received by Hanmer, who reads thus:

Nor to comply with heat, affects the young
In my distinct and proper satisfaction.

Dr. Warburton's explanation is not more satisfactory: what made the difficulty, will continue to make it. I read,

—*I beg it not*,

*To please the palate of my appetite,
Nor to comply with heat (the young affects
In me defunct) and proper satisfaction;
But to be free and bounteous to her mind.*

Affects stands here, not for *love*, but for *passions*, for that by which any thing is affected. *I ask it not*, says he, *to please appetite, or satisfy loose desires*, the passions of youth which I have now outlived, or for any particular gratification of myself, but merely that I may indulge the wishes of my wife.

Mr. Upton had, before me, changed *my* to *me*; but he has printed young *effects*, not seeming to know that *affects* could be a noun. (1773)

I.iii.290 (391,6) If virtue no delighted beauty lack] [W: belighted] Hanmer reads, more plausibly, *delighting*. I do not know that *belighted* has any authority. I should rather read,

If virtue no delight or beauty lack.

Delight, for *delectation*, or *power of pleasing*, as it is frequently used.

I.iii.299 (391,8) best advantage] Fairest opportunity.

I.iii.317 (392,9) a Guinea-hen] A showy bird with fine feathers.

I.iii.346 (392,1) defeat thy favour with an usurped beard] [W: disseat] It is more English, to *defeat*, than *disseat*. To *defeat*, is to *undo*, to *change*.

I.iii.350 (393,2) It was a violent commencement in her, and thou shalt see an answerable sequestration] There seems to be an opposition of terms here intended, which has been lost in transcription. We may read, *It was a violent conjunction, and thou shalt see an answerable sequestration*; or, what seems to me preferable, *It was a violent commencement, and thou shalt see an answerable sequel*.

I.iii.363 (393,4) betwixt an erring Barbarian] [W: errant] Hanmer reads, *errant*. *Erring* is as well as either.

II.i.15 (396,1) And quench the guards of the ever-fixed pole] Alluding to the star *Arctophylax*.

II.i.48 (397,3)

His bark is stoutly timber'd, and his pilot
Of very expert and approv'd allowance;
Therefore my hopes, not surfeited to death,
Stand in bold cure]

I do not understand these lines. I know not how *hope* can be *surfeited to death*, that is, *can be encreased, till it is destroyed*; nor what it is *to stand in bold cure*; or why *hope* should be considered as a disease. In the copies there is no variation. Shall we read

Therefore my fears, not surfeited to death,
Stand in bold cure?

This is better, but it is not well. Shall we strike a bolder stroke, and read thus?

Therefore my hopes, not forfeited to death,
Stand bold, not sure.

II.i.49 (398,4) Of very expert and approv'd allowance] I read, *Very expert, and of approv'd allowance*.

II.i.64 (308,5) And in the essential vesture of creation/ Does bear all excellency; We in terrestrial] I do not think the present reading inexplicable. The author seems to use *essential*, for *existent*, *real*. She excels the praises of invention, says he, and in *real qualities*, with which *creation* has *invested* her, *bears all excellency*.

Does bear all excellency— —] Such is the reading of the quartos, for which the folio has this,

And in the essential vesture of creation
Do's tyre the ingeniuier.
Which I explain thus,
Does tire the ingenious verse.

This is the best reading, and that which the author substituted in his revisal.

II.i.112 (401,9) Saints in your injuries] When you have a mind to do injuries, you put on an air of sanctity.

II.i.120 (402,1) I am nothing, if not critical] That is, *ensorious*.

II.i.137 (402,2) *She never yet was foolish*] We may read,
She ne'er was yet so foolish that was fair,
But even her folly help'd her to an heir.

Yet I believe the common reading to be right; the lay makes the power of cohabitation a proof that a man is not a *natural*; therefore, since the foolishlest woman, if *pretty*, may have a child, no *pretty woman* is ever foolish.

II.i.146 (403,3) put on the vouch of very malice itself] *To put on the vouch of malice*, is to assume a character vouched by the testimony of malice itself.

II.i.165 (404,5) profane] Gross of language, of expression broad and brutal. So Brabantio, in the first act, calls Iago *profane* wretch.

II.i.165 (404,6) liberal counsellor.] *Counsellor* seems to mean, not so much a man that *gives counsel*, us one that discourses fearlessly and volubly. A talker.

II.i.177 (405,8) well kiss'd! an excellent courtesy!] [*—well kissed, and excellent courtesy;—*] This I think should be printed, *well kiss'd! an excellent courtesy!* Spoken when Cassio kisses his hand, and Desdemona courtesies. [The old quarto confirms Dr. Johnson's emendation. STEEVENS.]

II.i.208 (406,1) I prattle out of fashion] Out of method, without any settled order of discourse.

II.i.211 (406,2) the master] The pilot of the ship.

II.i.223 (406,3) Lay thy finger thus] On thy mouth, to stop it while thou art listening to a wiser man.

II.i.252 (407,5) green minds] Minds unripe, minds not yet fully formed.

II.i.254 (408,6) she is full of most bless'd condition] Qualities, disposition of mind.

II.i.274 (408,7) tainting his discipline] Throwing a slur upon his discipline.

II.i.279 (408,8) sudden in choler] *Sudden*, is precipitately violent.

II.i.283 (408,9) whose qualification shall come into no true taste again] Whose resentment shall not be so *qualified* or *tempered*, as to be *well tasted*, as not to retain *some bitterness*. The phrase is harsh, at least to our ears.

II.i.306 (409,1) like a poisonous mineral] This is philosophical. Mineral poisons kill by corrosion.

II.i.314 (411,4) I'll have our Michael Cassio on the hip] A phrase from the art of wrestling.

II.i.321 (411,6) Knavery's plain face is never seen] An honest man acts upon a plan, and forecasts his designs; but a knave depends upon temporary and local opportunities, and never knows his own purpose, but at the time of execution.

II.iii.14 (413,8) Our general cast us] That is, *appointed us to our stations*. To *cast the play*, is, in the stile of the theatres, to assign to every actor his proper part.

II.iii.26 (413,9) And when she speaks, is it not an alarum to love?] The voice may *sound* an *alarm* more properly than the *eye* can *sound* a *parley*.

II.iii.46 (413,1) I have drunk but one cap to-night, and that was carefully qualified too] Slily mixed with water.

II.iii.59 (414,2) The very elements; As quarrelsome as the as the *discordia semina rerum*; as quick in opposition as fire and water.

II.iii.64 (414,3) If consequence do but approve my dream] [T: my deer] This reading is followed by the succeeding editions. I rather read,

If consequence do but approve my scheme.

But why should *dream* be rejected? Every scheme subsisting only in the imagination may be termed a *dream*.

II.iii.93-99 (416,6) *King Stephen was a worthy peer*] These stanzas are taken from an old song, which the reader will find recovered and preserved in a curious work lately printed, intitled, *Relicks of Ancient Poetry*, consisting of old heroic ballands, songs, &c. 3 vols. 12.

II.iii.95 (416,7) *lown*] Sorry fellow, paltry wretch.

II.iii.135 (417,8) He'll watch the horologe a double set] If he have no drink, he'll keep awake while the clock strikes two rounds, or four and twenty hours.

Chaucer uses the ward *horologe* in more places than one.

"Well skirer was his crowing in his loge

"Than is a clock or abbey *horologe*."]

The bracketed part of Johnson's note is taken verbatim from Zachary Gray, *Critical ... Notes on Shakespeare*, 1754, II, 316.] (see 1765, VIII, 374, 6) (rev. 1778, I, 503, 9)

II.iii.145 (418,9) ingraft infirmity; An infirmity *rooted, settled* in his constitution.

II.iii.175 (419,3) it frights the isle/ From her propriety] From her regular and *proper state*.

II.iii.180 (419,4) In quarter] In their quarters; at their lodging.

II.iii.194 (420,5) you unlace your reputation thus] Slacken, or *loosen*. Put in danger of dropping; or perhaps strip of its ornaments.

II.iii.195 (420,6) spend your rich opinion] Throw away and squander a reputation as valuable as yours.

II.iii.202 (420,7) self-charity] Care of one's self.

II.iii.211 (421,9) he that is approv'd in this offence] He that is convicted by proof, of having been engaged in this offence.

II.iii.274 (423,1) cast in his mood] Ejected in his anger.

II.iii.343 (425,4) this advice is free] This counsel has an appearance of honest openness, of frank good-will.

II.iii.348 (425,5) free elements] Liberal, bountiful, as the elements, out of which all things are produced.

II.iii.355 (425,6) to this parallel course] i.e. a course level, and even with his design.

II.iii.363 (425,8) That she repeals him] That is, recalls him.

II.iii.382 (426,1)

Though ether things grew fair against the sun,
Yet fruits, that blossom first, will first be ripe]

Of many different things, all planned with the same art, and promoted with the same diligence, some must succeed sooner than others, by the order of nature. Every thing cannot be done at once; we must proceed by the necessary gradation. We are not to *despair* of slow events any *more* than of tardy fruits, while the causes are in regular progress, and the fruits *grow fair against the sun*. Hanmer has not, I think, rightly conceived the sentiment; for he reads,

Those fruits which blossom first, are not first ripe.

I have therefore drawn it out at length, for there are few to whom that will be easy which was difficult to Hanmer.

III.i.3 (427,2) Why, masters, have your instruments been in Naples, that they speak i' the nose thus?] The venereal disease first appeared at the siege of Naples.

III.iii.14 (430,6)

That policy may either last so long,
Or feed upon such nice and waterish diet,
Or breed itself so out of circumstance,
That I, being absent, and my place supplied,
My general will forget my love and service]

He may either of himself think it politic to keep me out of office so long, or he may be satisfied with such slight reasons, or so many accidents may make him think my re-admission at that time improper, that I may be quite forgotten.

III.iii.23 (431,7) I'll watch him tame] It is said, that the ferocity of beasts, insuperable and irreclaimable by any other means, is subdued by keeping them from sleep.

III.iii.47 (431,8) His present reconciliation take] [W: make] To *take his reconciliation*, may be to accept the submission which he makes in order to be reconciled.

III.iii.65 (432,1) the wars must make examples/ Out of their best] The severity of military discipline must not spare the *best men* of the army, when their punishment may afford a wholesome *example*.

III.iii.90 (433,2) Excellent wretch! — Perdition catch my soul,/ But I do love thee!] The meaning of the word *wretch*, is not generally understood. It is now, in some parts of England, a term of the softest and fondest tenderness. It expresses the utmost degree of amiableness, joined with an idea, which perhaps all tenderness includes, of feebleness, softness, and want of protection. Othello, considering Desdemona as excelling in beauty and virtue, soft and timorous by her sex, and by her situation absolutely in his power, calls her *Excellent wretch*! It may be expressed,

Dear, harmless, helpless Excellence.

III.iii.91 (433,3) when I love thee not,/ Chaos is come again] When my love is for a moment suspended by suspicion, I have nothing in my mind but discord, tumult, perturbation, and confusion.

III.iii.123 (435,4) They are close delations working from the heart,/ That passion cannot rule] *They are cold dilations working from the heart,/ That passion cannot rule.*] I know not why the modern editors are satisfied with this reading, which no explanation can clear. They might easily have found, that it is introduced without authority. The old copies uniformly give, *close dilations*, except that the earlier quarto has *close denotements*; which was the author's first expression, afterwards changed by him, not to *cold dilations*, for *cold* is read in no ancient copy; nor, I believe, to *close dilations*, but to *close delations*; to *occult* and *secret accusations*, *working involuntarily from the heart*, which, though resolved to conceal the fault, cannot rule its *passion* of resentment.

III.iii.127 (435,5) Or, those that be not, 'would they might seem none!] [W: seem knaves] I believe the meaning is, *would they might no longer seem*, or bear the shape of *men*.

III.iii.140 (436,6) Keep leets and law-days] [i.e. govern. WARBURTON.] Rather *visit* than *govern*, but visit with authoritative intrusion.

III.iii.149 (437,8) From one that so improbably conceits] —imperfectly *conceits*,] In the old quarto it is,
—improbably *conceits*,
Which I think preferable.

III.iii.166 (437,9) the green-ey'd monster, which doth make/ The meat it feeds on] *which doth mock The meat it feeds on.*] I have received Hanmer's emendation [“make”]; because *to mock*, does not signify *to loath*; and because, when Iago bids Othello *beware of jealousy, the green-eyed monster*, it is natural to tell why he should beware, and for caution he gives him two reasons, that jealousy *often* creates its own cause, and that, when the causes are real, jealousy is misery.

III.iii.173 (438,1) But riches, fineless] Unbounded, endless, unnumbered treasures.

III.iii.180 (438,3)
Exchange me for a goat,
When I shall turn the business of my soul

To such exsuffolate and blown surmises,
Matching thy inference]

This odd and far-fetched word was made yet more uncouth in all the editions before Hanmer's, by being printed, *exsufflicate*. The allusion is to a bubble. Do not think, says the Moor, that I shall change the noble designs that now employ my thoughts, to suspicions which, like bubbles *blown* into a wide extent, have only an empty shew without solidity, or that in consequence of such empty fears, I will close with thy inference against the virtue of my wife.

III.iii.188 (439,4) Where virtue is, those are most virtuous] An action in itself indifferent grows virtuous by its end and application.

III.iii.201 (439,6)

I know our country disposition well;
In Venice they do let heaven see the pranks]
Here Iago seems to be a Venetian.

III.iii.207 (440,7) And, when she seem'd to shake, and fear your looks,/ She lov'd them most] This and the following argument of Iago ought to be deeply impressed on every reader. Deceit and falsehood, whatever conveniencies they may for a time promise or produce, are, in the sum of life, obstacles to happiness. Those, who profit by the cheat, distrust the deceiver, and the act, by which kindness was sought, puts an end to confidence.

The same objection may be made with a lower degree of strength against the imprudent generosity of disproportionate marriages. When the first heat of passion is over, it is easily succeeded by suspicion, that the same violence of inclination, which caused one irregularity, may stimulate to another; and those who have shown, that their passions are too powerful for their prudence, will, with very alight appearances against them, be censured, as not very likely to restrain them by their virtue. (see 1765, VIII, 397, 1)

III.iii.210 (440,8) To seel her father's eyes up, close as oak] There is little relation between *eyes* and *oak*. I would read,

She seel'd her father's eyes up close as owl's.
As blind as an owl, is a proverb.

III.iii.222 (441,1) My speech would fall into such vile success] [*Success*, far succession, i.e. conclusion; not prosperous issue. WARB.] I rather think there is a depravation, and would read,

My speech would fall into such vile excess.

If *success* be the right word, it seems to mean *consequence* or *event*, as *successo* is used in Italian.

III.iii.232 (441,2) will most rank] *Will*, is for wilfulness. It is so used by Ascham. A *rank will*, is *self-will* overgrown and exuberant.

III.iii.249 (442,3) You shall by that perceive him, and his means] You shall discover whether he thinks his best *means*, his most powerful *interest*, is by the solicitation of your lady.

III.iii.250 (442,4) strain his entertainnent] Press hard his re-admission to his pay and office. *Entertainment* was the military term for admission of soldiers.

III.iii.256 (442,5) Fear not my government] Do not distrust ay ability to contain my passion.

III.iii.259 (442,6) knows all qualities, with a learned spirit,/ Of human dealings] The construction is, He knows with a learned spirit all qualities of human dealings.

III.iii.260 (442,7) If I do prore her haggard] A *haggard* hawk, is a *wild* hawk, a *hawk unreclaimed*, or *irreclaimable*.

III.iii.262 (443,8) I'd whistle her off, and let her down the wind,/ To prey at fortune] The falconers always let fly the hawk against the wind; if she flies with the wind behind her, she seldom returns. If therefore a hawk was for any reason to be dismissed, she was *let down the wind*, and from that time shifted far herself, and *preyed at fortune*. This was told me by the late Mr. Clark.

III.iii.276 (443,9) forked plague] In allusion to a *barbed* or *forked* arrow, which, once infixed, cannot be extracted.

III.iii.312 (445,2) And, to the advantage, I, being here, took it up] I being *opportunely* here, took it up.

III.iii.319 (445,3) Be not you known on't] Should it not rather be read,
Be not you known in't?
 The folio reads,
Be not unknown on't.

The sense is plain, but of the expression I cannot produce any example.

III.iii.332 (446,5) that sweet sleep,/ Which thou owedst yesterday] To *owe* is, in our author, oftener to *possess*, than to *be indebted*, and such was its meaning here; but as that sense was growing less usual, it was changed unnecessarily by the editors to *hadst*; to the sane meaning, more intelligibly expressed.

III.iii.351 (447,6)

Farewell the neighing steed, and the shrill trump,
The spirit-stirring drum, the ear-piercing fife]

Dr. Warburton has offered *fear-spersing*, for *fear-dispersing*. But *ear-piercing* is an epithet so eminently adapted to the *fife*, and so distinct from the shrillness of the trumpet, that it certainly ought not to be changed. Dr. Warburton has been censured for this proposed emendation with more noise than honesty, for he did not himself put it in the text.

III.iii.369 (449,8) abandon all remorse] [*Remorse*, for repentance. WARBURTON.] I rather think it is, Let go all scruples, throw aside all restraints.

III.iii.429 (451,4) *Oth.* 'tis a shrewd doubt] [The old quarto gives this line, with the two following, to Iago; and rightly. WARB.] I think it more naturally spoken by Othello, who, by dwelling so long upon the proof, encouraged Iago to enforce it.

III.iii.448 (452,8) hearted throne] [W: parted] *Hearted* throne, is the heart on which thou wast *enthroned*. *Parted* throne has no meaning.

III.iii.467 (453,3)

Let him command,
And to obey, shall be in me remorse,
What bloody business ever]

[Pope: Not to obey] [T: Nor, to obey.] [W: me. Remord] Of these two emendations, I believe, Theobald's will have the greater number of suffrages; it has at least mine. The objection against the propriety of the declaration in Iago is a cavil; he does not say that he has no principle of remorse, but that it shall not operate against Othello's commands. *To obey shall be in me*, for *I will obey you*, is a mode of expression not worth the pains here taken to introduce it; and the word *remords* has not in the quotation the meaning of *withhold*, or *make reluctant*, but of *reprove*, or *censure*; nor do I know that it is used by any of the contemporaries of Shakespeare.

I will offer an interpretation, which, if it be received, will make alteration unnecessary, but it is very harsh and violent. Iago devotes himself to wronged Othello, and says, *Let him command whatever bloody business*, and in me it shall be an act, not of cruelty, but of *tenderness*, to obey him; not of malice to other, but of *tenderness* for him. If this sense be thought too violent, I see nothing better than to follow Pope's reading, as it is improved by Theobald.

III.iv.26 (457,5) cruzadoes] [A Portugeze coin, in value three shillings sterling. Dr. GREY.] So called from the cross stamped upon it.

III.iv.46 (458,6) The hearts, of old, gave hands] [Warburton explains this is an allusion to James the First's practice of creating baronets for money and emends to "The hands of old gave hearts"] The historical observation is very judicious and acute, but of the emendation there is no need. She says, that her hand gave away *her heart*. He goes on with his suspicion, and the hand which he had before called *frank*, he now terms *liberal*; then proceeds to remark, that *the hand was formerly given by the heart*; but now it neither gives it, nor is given by it.

III.iv.51 (459,7) salt and sullen rheum] —*salt and sorry rheum*] The old quarto has,

—*salt and sullen rheum*—

That is, a *rheum* obstinately troublesome. I think this better.

III.iv.70 (459,8)

A Sybil, that had numbred in the world

The sun to course two hundred compasses]

The expression is not very infrequent; we say, *I counted the clock to strike four*; so she *number'd* the sun to course, to run *two hundred compasses*, two hundred annual circuits.

III.iv.79 (460,1) Why do you speak so startingly, and rash?] Is *vehement*, violent.

III.iv.103 (461,2) 'Tis not a year, or two, shews us a man] From this line it may be conjectured, that the author intended the action of the play to be considered as longer than is marked by any note of time. Since their arrival at Cyprus, to which they were hurried on their wedding-night, the fable seems to have been in one continual progress, nor can I see any vacuity into which a *year or two*, or even a

month or two, could be put. On the night of Othello's arrival, a feast was proclaimed; at that feast Cassio was degraded, and immediately applies to Desdemona to get him restored. Iago indeed advises Othello to hold him off a while, but there is no reason to think, that he has been held off long. A little longer interval would increase the probability of the story, though it might violate the rules of the drama. See Act. 5. Sc. 2. (see 1765, VIII, 416, 1)

III.iv.113 (461,3) the duty of my heart] —the office of *my heart*.] The elder quarto reads,

—*the duty of my heart*.

The author used the more proper word, and then changed it, I suppose, for fashionable diction; but, as fashion is a very weak protectress, the old word is now ready to resume its place.

III.iv.119 (462,4)

But to know so, must be my benefit]

"Si nequeo placidas affari Caesaris aures,

"Saltem aliquis veniat, qui mihi dicat, abi."

III.iv.125 (462,7) in favour] In *look*, in *countenance*.

III.iv.128 (462,8) within the blank of his displeasure] Within the *shot* of his anger.

III.iv.141 (463,9) some unhatch'd practice] Some treason that has not taken effect.

III.iv.146 (463,1)

for let our finger ach,

And it endues our other healthful members

Even to that sense of pain]

Endue with a sense of pain, is an expression, which, though it might be endured, if it were genuine, cannot deserve to be introduced by artifice. The copies, both quarto and folio, read, *Endue our other healthful members even to a sense of pain*. I believe it should be rather, SUBDUE *our other healthful members to a sense of pain*.

III.iv.151 (463,2) (unhandsome warrior as I am)] [W: wrangler] *Unhandsome warrior*, is evidently *unfair assailant*.

III.iv.178 (464,3) a more continue time] — *more convenient time*] The folio has,

— *more continue time*;

Time *less interrupted*, time which I can call more my own. It gives a more distinct image than *convenient*.

III.iv.180 (464,4) Take me this work out] The meaning is not, "Pick out the work, and leave the ground plain;" but, "Copy this work in another handkerchief."

IV.i.5 (466,6)

Naked in bed, Iago, and not mean harm?

It is hypocrisy against the devil]

Hypocrisy against the devil, means hypocrisy to cheat the devil. As common hypocrites cheat men, by seeming good, and yet living wickedly, these men would cheat the devil, by giving him flattering hopes, and at last avoiding the crime which he thinks them ready to commit.

IV.i.22 (467,8) Boding to all] Thus all the old copies. The moderns, less grammatically,

Boding to ill—

IV.i.42 (468,2) without sone instruction] [W: induction] This is a noble conjecture, and whether right or wrong does honour to its author. Yet I am in doubt whether there is any necessity of emendation. There has always prevailed in the world an opinion, that when any great calamity happens at a distance, notice is given of it to the sufferer by some dejection or perturbation of mind, of which he discovers no external cause. This is ascribed to that general communication of one part of the universe with another, which is called sympathy and antipathy; or to the secret monition, *instruction*, and influence of a superior Being, which superintends the order of nature and of life. Othello says, *Nature could not invest herself in such shadowing passion without instruction. It is not words that shake me thus*. This passion, which spreads its clouds over me, is the effect of some agency more than the operation of words; it is one of those notices which men have of unseen calamities.

IV.i.76 (471,4) Confine yourself but in a patient list] For attention; act of listening.

IV.i.82 (471,5) encave yourself] Hide yourself in a private place.

IV.i.89 (471,6) Or I shall say, you are all in all in spleen,/ And nothing of a man] I read,

Or shall I say, you're all in all a spleen.

I think our author uses this expression elsewhere.

IV.i.121 (472,8) Do you triumph, Roman? do you triumph?] Othello calls him *Roman* ironically. *Triumph*, which was a Roman ceremony, brought Roman into his thoughts. *What* (says he) *you are now triumphing as great as a Roman?*

IV.i.123 (472,9) a customer!] A common woman, one that invites custom.

IV.i.130 (473,1) Have you scar'd me? Have you made my reckoning? have you settled the term of my life? The old quarto reads, *stored* me. Have you disposed of me? have you laid me up?

IV.i.150 (473,2) 'Tis such another fitchew! marry, a perfum'd one] Shakespeare has in another place mentioned the lust of this animal. He tells Iago, that she is as lewd as the *polecat*, but of better scent, the polecat being a very stinking animal.

IV.i.244 (476,4) atone them] Make them *one*; reconcile them.

IV.i.256 (477,5)

If that the earth could teem with woman's tears,
Each drop she falls would prove a crocodile]

If womens tears could impregnate the earth. By the doctrine of equivocal generation, new animals were supposed producible by new combinations of matter. See Bacon.

IV.i.277 (478,7)

whose solid virtue
The shot of accident, nor dart of chance,
Could neither graze nor pierce]

[T: of change] To *graze* is not merely to touch superficially, but to strike not directly, not so as to bury the body of the thing striking in the matter struck.

Theobald trifles, as is usual. *Accident* and *chance* may admit a subtle distinction; *accident* may be considered as the *act*, and *chance* as the *power* or *agency* of fortune; as, *It was by chance that this accident befel*

me. At least, if we suppose all corrupt that is inaccurate, there will be no end of emendation.

IV.ii.57 (482,1) garner'd up my heart] That is, *treasured* up; the *garner* and the *fountain* are improperly conjoined.

IV.ii.62 (482,2)

Turn thy complexion there!

Patience, thou young and rose-lipp'd cherubim;

Ay, there, look grim as hell]

At such an object do thou, *patience*, thyself *change colour*; at this do thou, even thou, *rosy cherub* as thou art, *look grim as hell*. The old editions and the new have it,

I here look grim as hell.

I was written for *ay*, and not since corrected.

IV.ii.109 (484,4) The small'st opinion on my great'st abuse] The old quarto reads [for "*least misuse*"],

The small'st opinion on my great'st abuse.

Which I think is better.

IV.ii.140 (486,6) Some base notorious knave] For *gross*, not in its proper meaning for *known*.

IV.ii.144 (486,7) Speak within door] Do not clamour so as to be heard beyond the house.

IV.ii.146 (486,8) the seamy side without] That is, *inside out*.

IV.iii.27 (490,2) and he, she lov'd, prov'd mad,/ And did forsake her] I believe that *mad* only signifies *wild*, *frantick*, *uncertain*.

IV.iii.31 (490,3) I have much to do,/ But to go hang my head] *I have much* ado to do any thing *but hang my head*. We might read,

Not to go hang my head.

This is perhaps the only insertion made in the latter editions which has improved the play. The rest seem to have been added for the sake of amplification, or of ornament. When the imagination had subsided, and the mind was no longer agitated by the horror of the action, it became at leisure to look round for specious additions. This addition is natural. Desdemona can at first hardly forbear to sing the song; she endeavours to change her train of thoughts, but her imagination at last prevails, and she sings it.

IV.iii.41 (491,4)

Des. "The poor soul sat singing by a sycamore-tree,
"Sing all a green willow]

This song, in two parts, is printed in a late collection of old ballads; the lines preserved here differ somewhat from the copy discovered by the ingenious collector.

IV.iii.55 (491,5)

Des. "I call'd my love false love; but what said
"he then?
"Sing willow, &c.]

This couplet is not in the ballad, which is the complaint, not of a woman forsaken, but of a man rejected. These lines were probably added when it was accommodated to a woman.

IV.iii.94 (493,6) our former having] Our former allowance of experience.

IV.iii.107 (493,7) heaven me such usage send] —*heaven me such uses send,*] Such is the reading of the folio, and of the subsequent editions; but the old quarto has,

—*such usage send.*—

Usage is an old word for *custom*, and, I think, better than *uses*.

V.i.11 (494,1) I have rubb'd this young quat *almost to the sense*] In some editions,

*I've rubb'd this young gnat almost to the sense,
And he grows angry.]*

This is a passage much controverted among the editors. Sir T. Hanmer reads *quab*, a *gudgeon*; not that a *gudgeon* can be *rubbed* to much *sense*, but that a man grossly deceived is often called a *gudgeon*. Mr. Upton reads *quail*, which he proves, by much learning, to be a very choleric bird. Dr. Warburton retains *gnat*, which is found in the early quarto. Theobald would introduce *knot*, a small bird of that name. I have followed the text of the folio, and third and fourth quartos.

A *quat* in the midland counties is a *pimple*, which by rubbing is made to smart, or is *rubbed to sense*. Roderigo is called a *quat* by the same mode of speech, as a low fellow is now termed in lay language a *scab*. *To rub to the sense*, is *to rub to the quick*.

V.i.37 (496,2) No passage?] No passengers? No body going by?

V.i.42 (499,4) a heary night] A *thick cloudy* night, in which an ambush may be commodiously laid.

V.ii.1 (499,4) It is the cause, it is the cause, my soul;—/ Let me not name it] The abruptness of this soliloquy makes it obscure. The meaning, I think, is this: "I am here (says Othello in his mind) overwhelmed with horror. What is the reason of this perturbation? Is it want of resolution to do justice? Is it the dread of shedding blood? No; it is not the action that shocks me, but *it is the cause, it is the cause, my soul; let me not name it to you, ye chaste stars; it is the cause.*"

V.ii.20 (500,7)

I must weep,
But they are cruel tears: this sorrel's heavenly;
It strikes, where it doth love.—She wakes—]

This tenderness, with which I lament the punishment which justice compels me to inflict, is a holy passion.

I wish these two lines could be honestly ejected. It is the fate of Shakespeare to counteract his own pathos.

V.ii.65 (502,8) A murder, which I thought a sacrifice] This line is difficult. *Thou hast hardened my heart, and makest me* kill thee with the rage of a murderer, when I thought to have sacrificed thee to justice with the calmness of a priest striking a victim.

It must not be omitted, that one of the elder quartos reads, *thou dost stone thy heart*; which I suspect to be genuine. The meaning then will be, *thou forcest me* to dismiss thee from the world in the state of the murdered without preparation for death, *when I intended* that thy punishment should have been a *sacrifice* atoning for thy crime.

I am glad that I have ended my revisal of this dreadful scene. It is not to be endured.

V.ii.134 (505,3) false as water] As water that will support no weight, nor keep any impression.

V.ii.151 (506,4) villainy has made mocks with love] *Villainy* has taken advantage to *play upon* the weakness of a violent passion.

V.ii.162 (506,5) Thou hast not half that power to do me harm, / As I have to be hurt] [Hamner: to bear hurt] The Oxford Editor saw well the meaning of his author, but weakened his expression. She means

to say, *I have in this cause power to endure more than thou hast power to inflict.*

V.ii.183 (507, 6) charm your tongue] I know not whether I have read, or whether my own thoughts have suggested, an alteration of this passage. It seems to me not improbable, that Shakespeare wrote *clam* your tongue; to *clam* a bell, is to cover the clapper with felt, which drowns the blow, and hinders the sound.

V.ii.211 (509,7) she with Cassio had the act of shame/ A thousand times committed] This is another passage which seems to suppose a longer space comprised in the action of this play than the scenes include.

V.ii.253 (512,2) It was a sword of Spain, the ice-brook's temper] [In the first edition it is, *Isebroke's temper*. Thence corrupted to *Icebrook's*.—*Ebro's temper*; the waters of that river of Spain are particularly famous for tempering of steel. POPE.] I believe the old reading changed to *ice-brook* is right. Steel is hardened by being put red hot into very cold water.

V.ii.286 (513,3)

I look down towards his feet; but that's a fable.

If that thou be'st a devil, I cannot kill thee]

To see if, according to the common opinion, his feet be cloven.

V.ii.292 (513,4) Fall'n in the practice of a cursed slave] In the *snare*, by the *stratagem*.

V.ii.317 (514,5) in the interim] The first copy has, *in the nick*. It was, I suppose, thought upon revisal, that *nick* was too familiar.

V.ii.342 (515,6) Speak of me as I am] The early copies read, *Speak of them as they are*. The present reading has more force. (rev. 1778, X, 622, 6)

(520,2) General Observation. The beauties of this play impress themselves so strongly upon the attention of the reader, that they can draw no aid from critical illustration. The fiery openness of Othello, magnanimous, artless, and credulous, boundless in his confidence, ardent in his affection, inflexible in his resolution, and obdurate in his revenge; the cool malignity of Iago, silent in his resentment, subtle in his designs, and studious at once of his interest and his vengeance;

the soft simplicity of Desdemona, confident of merit, and conscious of innocence, her artless perseverance in her suit, and her slowness to suspect that she can be suspected, are such proofs of Shakespeare's skill in human nature, as, I suppose, it is vain to seek in any modern writer. The gradual progress which Iago makes in the Moor's conviction, and the circumstances which he employs to inflame him, are so artfully natural, that, though it will perhaps not be said of him as he says of himself, that he is *a man not easily jealous*, yet we cannot but pity him, when at last we find him *perplexed in the extreme*.

There is always danger, lest wickedness, conjoined with abilities, should steal upon esteem, though it misses of approbation; but the character of Iago is so conducted, that he is from the first scene to the last hated and despised.

Even the inferior characters of this play would be very conspicuous in any other piece, not only for their justness, but their strength. Cassio is brave, benevolent, and honest, ruined only by his want of stubbornness to resist an insidious invitation. Roderigo's suspicious credulity, and impatient submission to the cheats which he sees practised upon him, and which by persuasion he suffers to be repeated, exhibit a strong picture of a weak mind betrayed by unlawful desires to a false friend; and the virtue of Aemilia is such as we often find, worn loosely, but not cast off, easy to commit small crimes, but quickened and alarmed at atrocious villainies.

The scenes from the beginning to the end are busy, varied by happy interchanges, and regularly promoting the progression of the story; and the narrative in the end, though it tells but what is known already, yet is necessary to produce the death of Othello.

Had the scene opened in Cyprus, and the preceding incidents been occasionally related, there had been little wanting to a drama of the most exact and scrupulous regularity.

(LI 2) Appendix. Some apology perhaps is necessary for the inconvenience of an Appendix, which, however, we can justify by the strongest of all pleas, the plea of necessity. The Notes which it contains, whether communicated by correspondents, or collected from published volumes, were not within our reach when the plays were printed, to which they relate. Of that which chance has supplied, we could have no previous knowledge; and he that waited till the river should run dry, did not act with less reason than the Editor would do, who should suspend his publication for possibilities of intelligence, or promises of improvement. Had we foreseen the *Oxford* edition, the assistance we expected from it might have persuaded us to pause; but our volumes were completely finished before its publication. [There are no notes by Johnson in this Appendix; several are by Steevens.]